“Śrī Caitanya-caritāmṛta”

Ādi-līlā

Chapter 1

The Auspicious Invocation: Obeisance to the Guru and Others

(English translation from the Bengali, following the Gauḍīya Maṭha edition and the «Anubhāṣya», 2026 — draft)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya

Summary. The chapter opens with fourteen verses that establish the truth (*tattva*). In verses 15–17 the author offers the *maṅgalācaraṇa*, the auspicious invocation, glorifying Śrī Madana-mohana, Śrī Govinda and Śrī Gopīnātha. The first of the fourteen verses is a general obeisance to six truths, and the whole chapter is nothing but its detailed explanation. The word “guru” means both the *dīkṣā-guru*, who gives initiation, and the *śikṣā-guru*, who instructs. The disciple must regard them as a manifestation (*prakāśa*) of Kṛṣṇa. The Lord's devotees (*īśa-bhaktas*) are of two kinds: *siddhas*, who have reached perfection, and *sādhakas*, who are still on the path of practice (*sādhana*). The Lord (*Īśa*) is Kṛṣṇa in His original form, His *svayaṁ-rūpa*, together with His *kāya-vyūhas*, the expansions of His body. The avatāras are of three kinds: *aṁśa-avatāras*, *guṇa-avatāras* and *śaktyāveśa-avatāras*. In this connection the chapter examines the truth of Kṛṣṇa's *prakāśa*, and with it the truth of *vilāsa*. Kṛṣṇa has three kinds of potency (*śakti*): the Lakṣmīs in Vaikuṇṭha and other abodes, the queens in Dvārakā, and, best of all, the gopīs of Vraja. Kṛṣṇa and His *kāya-vyūhas* are *īśa-tattva*, the truth of the Lord. All the devotees are *āvaraṇa-tattva*, His surrounding retinue, and are therefore a special potency of His. A potency and its possessor are eternally one when they are seen as non-different, and eternally distinct when the potency is seen apart from its possessor. Thus His inconceivable potency establishes one undivided Truth. This conclusion agrees with Vedānta, and its name is *acintya-bhedābheda-tattva*, the truth of

inconceivable oneness and difference. The last part of the chapter tells of the true nature (*svarūpa*) and greatness of Śrī Caitanya and Nityānanda.

Śrī Caitanya, Nityānanda, Advaita — the root of *prema* — Haridāsa, Svarūpa Gosvāmī, Śrī Vaṁśīvadanānanda, Sārvabhauma, Rāmānanda, the two brothers Rūpa and Sanātana; Śrī Jīva, Gopāla Bhaṭṭa, Raghunātha — Dāsa and Bhaṭṭa, Śivānanda, Kavi Karṇapūra, Narottama, Śrīnivāsa, Rāmacandra, Kṛṣṇadāsa, Baladeva, and Cakravartī, the foremost. I have bowed with care to the Lord and His devotees, and in the *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*, which gives the essence, I have explained the *Caitanya-caritāmṛta* at length. O devotees, weigh it well! The stories of Gaura are an ocean; Kṛṣṇadāsa sailed upon it and brought back a stream of nectar. Vaiṣṇavas drink the nectar of this poem, their hearts grow peaceful, and they long to drink it again and again. Everyone told me, poor and destitute as I am, to compose a commentary on it. I took the sādhus' command upon my head, composed this commentary with care, and placed it in the sādhus' hands.

*The auspicious invocation begins. General obeisance to Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya as the Truth (*tattva*) —*

1 I worship the gurus, the devotees of the Lord, His avatāras, His manifestations and His potencies — and the Lord Himself, who is known as Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya.[1]

Special obeisance to the two worshipful Lords: Nitāi and Gaura rise together like the moon and the sun and show mercy to living beings —

2 I worship Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya and Śrī Nityānanda, who are like a wonderful sun and moon. They have risen together on the eastern horizon of Gauḍa, dispelling the darkness and bestowing good on all.

The Truth this book establishes. The one nondual Supreme Truth, Gaura-Kṛṣṇa, is perceived in three different ways —

3 There is no Truth in the world higher than Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya. That which the Upaniṣads call the non-dual Brahman is the effulgence of His body; the Puruṣa, the Supersoul who dwells within every heart, is His partial manifestation; and Bhagavān, full in all six opulences, is He Himself.

*The blessing, and the external reason for Gaura's descent — (*Vidagdha-mādhava*, Act 1, verse 2)*

4 “May the Lord Hari, the son of Śacī, illumined by a mass of lustre more beautiful than gold, ever shine in the inmost cave of your hearts. Out of His mercy He has descended in the age of Kali to bestow what had not been given for a very long time — the treasure of devotion to Himself, rich in the most exalted, radiant *ujjvala-rasa*.” (Vidagdha-mādhava, 1.2)

The root purpose of Gaura's descent; the truth about Gaura — (from the diary of Svarūpa Gosvāmī)

5 “Śrī Rādhā is the transformation of Kṛṣṇa’s love, His pleasure potency, *hlādinī-śakti*. Therefore, though Rādhā and Kṛṣṇa are one in Self, from time without beginning They have appeared in the world in two different forms. Now these Two have become one and are manifest as Śrī Caitanya. I bow to Him, Kṛṣṇa Himself, adorned with the sentiment and the lustre of Śrī Rādhā.” (diary of Svarūpa Dāmodara)

The root purpose of Gaura's descent: three confidential reasons —

6 “What is the greatness of Śrī Rādhā’s love? What is My own wondrous sweetness, which She alone tastes through that love? And what is the happiness She feels in experiencing Me?” Longing to know this, the moon Hari, rich with Her sentiment, was born from the ocean of Śacī’s womb. (diary of Svarūpa Dāmodara)

The truth about Śrī Nityānanda, and obeisance to Him —

7 “Saṅkarṣaṇa, the Lord who lies in the Causal Ocean, the Lord who lies in the Garbha Ocean, the Lord who lies in the Ocean of Milk, and Śeṣa are His portions and the parts of His portions: may that Rāma who is called Nityānanda be my refuge.” (diary of Svarūpa Dāmodara)

The five forms of Śrī Nityānanda. (1) His form as Saṅkarṣaṇa in Vaikuṇṭha —

8 "I take refuge in Śrī Nityānanda Rāma, whose form called Saṅkarṣaṇa shines amid the fourfold expansion (catur-vyūha) in the all-pervading world of Vaikuṇṭha, full of every opulence and beyond māyā." (diary of Svarūpa Dāmodara)

(2) The Supersoul, the cause of living beings and the world — Kāraṇodakaśāyī, the first Puruṣa —

9 "I take refuge in Śrī Nityānanda Rāma. A part of Him is the original Lord, the Puruṣa, the master of māyā, who lies in person in the midst of the Causal Ocean, His body the shelter of countless universes." (diary of Svarūpa Dāmodara)

(3) The father of the lotus-born — Garbhodakaśāyī, the second Puruṣa —

10 "I take refuge in Śrī Nityānanda Rāma. A part of His part is the blessed Garbhodakaśāyī, whose navel-lotus, with all the worlds as its stem, is the birthplace of Brahmā, the creator of the worlds." (diary of Svarūpa Dāmodara)

(4) Kṣīrodaśāyī, the third Puruṣa; (5) Śeṣa, who holds up the earth —

11 "I take refuge in Śrī Nityānanda Rāma. A part of a part of His part is Viṣṇu who lies on the Ocean of Milk, the Supersoul and maintainer of all beings; and Ananta, who upholds the earth, is a portion of that Viṣṇu." (diary of Svarūpa Dāmodara)

The truth about Śrī Advaita, and obeisance to Him —

12 Mahā-Viṣṇu is the maker of the world, who creates it through māyā; and this Lord Advaita Ācārya is His avatāra.

13 He is called Advaita because He is non-different from Hari, and Ācārya because He teaches bhakti. I take shelter of Him, the Lord Advaita Ācārya,

who has descended as a devotee.

*The intrinsic nature (*svarūpa*) of the Pañca-tattva, and obeisance to Them —*

14 "I bow to Kṛṣṇa, who is manifest as five truths — the Pañca-tattva: as a devotee in form and a devotee in essence, as the incarnation of a devotee, as the one called a devotee, and as the potency of devotion." (Śrī Rūpa Gosvāmī)[2]

Anubhāṣya.

At the very beginning the author wrote fourteen verses as the *maṅgalācaraṇa*, the auspicious invocation. In them he pointed out the subject this book establishes, blessed the listeners and offered them his respects. The first seven chapters of the Ādi-līlā explain exactly this, step by step and in detail.

*Obeisance to his own cherished Deity, the Lord of *sambandha* (relationship with the Lord) —*

15 All glory to the merciful Śrī Śrī Rādhā and Madana-mohana! I am lame and dull of mind, and They are my only refuge; Their lotus feet are all I have.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

I am lame and dull-witted. My only refuge is the supremely merciful Śrī Śrī Rādhā-Madana-mohana, and Their lotus feet are all my wealth. May They be glorified!

Anubhāṣya.

Verses composed by the author himself —

paṅgoḥ (of one who cannot go elsewhere on his own feet, by his own strength) **manda-mateḥ** (of one whose small intelligence is absorbed in sense objects; of one who makes no effort in practices driven by other desires, karma, jñāna and the like; of one devoted exclusively [*ekāntin*]) **mama gatī** (my refuge: such are They for me. *Gati* is "that toward which one goes" [*gamyate*], that is, a shelter) **mat-sarvasva-padāmbhojau** (They whose lotus feet are all my wealth) **suratau** (merciful; or, boundlessly attached to each other) **rādhā-madana-mohanau** (the Deities who bear these names) **jayatām** (may They abide in all Their supremacy).

*Obeisance to his own cherished Deity, the Lord of *abhidheya* (the means) —*

16 I remember Śrī Śrī Rādhā and Śrī Govindadeva, seated on a throne in a beautiful temple of jewels beneath a wish-fulfilling tree in the radiant forest of Vṛndāvana, served by Their dearest companions.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Śrī Śrī Rādhā-Govinda sit on a throne in a jewelled temple, beneath the wish-fulfilling tree of Vṛndāvana, a land of radiant beauty. Their dear companions serve Them. I remember Them.

Anubhāṣya.

dīvyad-vṛndāraṇya-kalpa-drumādhaḥ (at the foot of the wish-fulfilling tree in the radiant forest of Vṛndāvana. "Radiant" means supremely beautiful and enchanting to the mind) **śrīmad-ratnāgāra-siṁhāsana-sthau** (seated on a jewelled throne within a jewelled chamber of wondrous beauty) **preṣṭhālībhiḥ** (by Their dearest companions, devoted to service: the intimate confidantes [*priya-narma-sakhīs*] led by Śrī Lalitā, who are surrounded by Śrī Rūpa-mañjarī and others) **sevyamānau** (Those whom they serve) **śrī-śrī-rādhā-śrīla-govinda-devau smarāmi** (I remember Śrī Śrī Rādhā and Śrīla Govindadeva).

*Obeisance to his own cherished Deity, the Lord of *prayojana* (the goal) —*

17 May the beautiful Śrī Gopīnātha, who begins the sweet rāsa dance, be our good fortune. Standing on the bank by Vaṁśīvaṭa, He draws the gopīs to Himself with the sounds of His flute.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Śrīmān Gopīnātha, who begins the rapturous *rāsa* dance, stands on the bank by Vaṁśīvaṭa and draws the gopīs with the sound of His flute. May He grant us what is auspicious.

Anubhāṣya.

śrīmān (He whose form is full of supreme beauty) **rāsa-rasārambhī** (He who begins the rapturous *rāsa* dance) **veṇu-svanaiḥ** (with the sounds of His flute) **gopīḥ** (the gopīs, the young cowherd women of Vraja) **karṣan** (drawing. He loosens in them every desire unrelated to Kṛṣṇa and, by the rope of *prema* that is His flute's sound, draws them out of their homes) **vaṁśīvaṭa-taṭa-sthitaḥ**

(standing at the foot of the Vaṁśīvaṭa tree) **gopī-nāthaḥ** (He who sports freely) **naḥ** (for us) **śriye** (for the wealth of *prema*) **astu** (may He be).

18 Glory, glory to Śrī Caitanya! Glory to Nityānanda! Glory to Advaitacandra, and glory to all the devotees of Gaura!

The three Deities whom the Gauḍīyas long to worship —

19 These three Deities have made the Gauḍīya devotees Their own. I worship Their feet: these Three are my Lords.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

These three Deities — Śrī Madana-mohana, Śrī Govindadeva and Śrī Gopīnātha — are the presiding Lords of Vṛndāvana. They gave the Gauḍīya devotees the right to serve each of Them, and so made them Their own.

Anubhāṣya.

The Gauḍīya Vaiṣṇavas serve the eighteen-syllable mantra. The Kṛṣṇa named in it is Madana-mohana; its Govinda is Govinda; and its Gopījana-vallabha is Gopīnātha. To realize Kṛṣṇa as Madana-mohana is *sambandha*. To serve Govinda is *abhidheya*. To be drawn by Gopījana-vallabha is *prayojana*. Śrī Mahāprabhu taught these three truths: *sambandha*, *abhidheya* and *prayojana*. These three Deities are forms of Bhagavān that embody those three truths, and They are the presiding Lords of Śrī Vṛndāvana.

The word *gauḍīya* means “of the land of Gauḍa.” The part of Bhārata-varṣa south of the Himālayas and north of the Vindhyas is called Āryāvarta. It holds the five lands of Gauḍa: Sārasvata, Kānyakubja (Lakṣmaṇāvatī), Madhya-gauḍa, Maithila and Utkala. Many call Bengal Gauḍa, and the name “Gauḍa” belonged above all to the capital of Bengal. Devotees from Utkala are called “Oriya devotees,” and in the same way the people of Bengal are called “Gauḍīya.” The south, in turn, is known as Pañca-draviḍa, “the five Draviḍas.” All four ācāryas of the Vaiṣṇava sampradāyas were born in the land of Draviḍa. The Draviḍian Vaiṣṇavas took shelter of these ācāryas. So the word “Gauḍīya” may well have come into use from a wish to be distinguished from them. Śrī Rāmānujācārya was born at Mahābhūtapurī in southern Andhra; Śrī Madhvācārya in the village of Uḍupī in Paraśurāma-kṣetra, in the Mangalore district; Śrī Nimbāditya in the village of Muṅgerapattana in Dakṣiṇāpatha; and Śrī Viṣṇusvāmī in the land of

Pāṇḍya. Śrī Mahāprabhu accepted the Śrī Mādhva-sampradāya. Yet the Vaiṣṇava ācāryas of the Tattvavāda branch, who hold to Madhva's teaching, are Draviḍians. Therefore the sampradāya that has taken shelter at Śrī Gaura's feet is called "Gauḍīya." Moreover, Śrī Ānandatīrtha Pūrṇaprajña Madhvācārya has another name: Śrī Gauḍa-pūrṇānanda. So Śrī Gaura's devotees may be called "Mādhva" as well as "Gauḍīya."

The author explains his own auspicious invocation —

20 At the beginning of the book I make the auspicious invocation — the remembrance of three: the Guru, the Vaiṣṇavas and Bhagavān.

21 Remembering these three, one overcomes all obstacles and easily attains one's heart's desire.

22 This invocation is of three kinds: indicating the subject, giving blessing and offering obeisance.

23 In the first two verses is the obeisance to the worshipful Lord, in two ways — general and specific.

24 In the third verse I indicate the subject, through which the Supreme Truth is made known.

25 In the fourth verse I bless the world, praying that the grace of Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya may reach all.

26 In that verse I also tell the external reason for His descent; in the fifth and sixth verses I tell its root purpose.

27 In these six verses is the truth of Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya, and in the next five, the greatness of Śrī Nityānanda.

28 Then two verses tell the truth of Advaita, and one verse explains the Pañca-tattva.

29 In these fourteen verses I make the auspicious invocation, and within them I describe the whole subject.

30 Offering obeisance to all the Vaiṣṇavas who hear this, I shall now consider the meaning of all these verses.

31 O Vaiṣṇavas, hear with one-pointed mind how the scriptures establish the truth of Caitanya-Kṛṣṇa.[3]

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
What the scriptures establish about Kṛṣṇa, who appeared as Caitanya.

The explanation of the fourteen verses above begins. Explanation of the first verse —

32 Kṛṣṇa, the two kinds of guru, the devotees, the avatāras, the manifestations and the potencies — in these six forms He enjoys His pastimes.

Anubhāṣya.
The word *guru-dvaya* (“two gurus”) means the *dīkṣā-guru* and the *śikṣā-guru*. Both are the one, undivided *guru-tattva*. The *dīkṣā-guru* and the *śikṣā-guru* differ in their *līlās*, but for the disciple both are the same truth and deserve the same honour.

33 I worship the feet of these six truths; first I make the invocation in general.

34 I worship the gurus, the devotees of the Lord, His avatāras, His manifestations and His potencies — and the Lord Himself, who is known as Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

I worship the two gurus, distinguished as the *dīkṣā-guru* and the *śikṣā-guru*; the Lord's devotees, Śrīvāsa and others; the Lord's avatāras, Advaita Prabhu and others; the Lord's manifestations, Prabhu Śrī Nityānanda and others; and the Lord's potencies, Śrī Gadādhara and others. And I worship the Supreme Truth, the Lord Himself, named Mahāprabhu Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya.

Anubhāṣya.

(**grantha-kāraḥ** (the author of the book, that is, I, Kṛṣṇadāsa)) **gurūn** (the host of gurus, that is, those who show the way, give the mantra and instruct: Śrī Nityānanda, Raghunātha, Rūpa and others) **īśa-bhaktān** (the servants of Gaura-Kṛṣṇa: Śrīvāsa and others) **kṛṣṇa-caitanya-saṁjñakam īśam** (Bhagavān, known as Kṛṣṇa Caitanya) **īśāvatārakān** (Śrī Advaitācārya and others) **tat-prakāśān** (His manifestations, that is, those of Caitanya-Kṛṣṇa: Śrī Nityānanda and others, my own gurus) **tac-chaktīḥ** (His potencies, that is, those of Gaura-Kṛṣṇa: Śrī Gadādhara, Dāmodara, Jagadānanda and others) (These six truths are non-different from Him and form His surrounding retinue, His *āvaraṇa*) **vande** ([I] worship).

*Gurus who differ in their *līlās* —*

35 First I offer obeisance at the feet of my mantra-guru and of all my instructing gurus.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Tāṅhāra (“his”): the singular is used because both kinds of guru are regarded as one truth. A variant reading has *tāṅ-sabāra* (“of them all”).

Anubhāṣya.

Śrī Jīva Prabhu writes in the *Bhakti-sandarbha* (section 202): “The means to be followed (*abhidheya*) is selfless devotion, *akiñcanā bhakti*. Yet its cause is ‘association with My devotees,’ so that association is itself the means, and in devotion too one should see that very association. At first a person associates with particular devotees. That association gives rise to a corresponding faith, a taste for the narratives handed down in their line, and so on, and so he turns toward Bhagavān. Through that same association a taste (*ruci*) awakens in him for the particular manifestation of Bhagavān whom those devotees worship, and for their particular path of worship. Then, wishing to know these more fully, he takes one or many of them as his guru and hears from them. * * For those who long for devotion marked by love (*prīti*), the path led by taste is better than the path of

reasoning, which guides those in whom taste has not yet awakened. On both paths the former *śravaṇa-guru*, the guru from whom one hears, becomes the *śikṣā-guru* and teaches the rules of worship. But the *mantra-guru* is only one, for accepting many will be forbidden later." (Section 206): "The *śravaṇa-guru* and the *śikṣā-guru* who teaches worship are usually the same person. One should also know that there may be many *śikṣā-gurus*." (Section 208): "Knowledge of the scriptures arises only from association with the *śravaṇa-guru*." (Section 207): "Mercy (*anugraha*) means initiation into the mantra." (Section 209): "Those who reject the guru's feet and try to turn toward Bhagavān grow weary in their various means. Therefore hundreds of calamities befall them, and they remain here in worldly existence (*saṁsāra*), like those adrift on the ocean without a helmsman." "He is attained through devotion to the guru, and the wise serve Him by remembrance. But even when He is met, living beings absorbed in pride cannot attain Him." (Section 210): "One should take shelter of the guru who guides one to the highest goal, even if one must give up a worldly guru and others to do so."

If selfless devotion is the means, then what one should see in it is association with Kṛṣṇa's devotees. At first the *jīva* associates with Kṛṣṇa's devotees, gains faith (*śraddhā*) and turns toward Kṛṣṇa. Through that association a taste awakens in him for the particular manifestation of Bhagavān he will serve, and for a particular path of worship. A *jīva* endowed with pious merit (*sukṛti*) then wishes to know more about Kṛṣṇa. He takes shelter of one or more gurus and hears from them. For those who seek devotion marked by love, the path of taste is commended, not the path of reasoning followed by those in whom taste has not awakened. On both paths the former *śravaṇa-guru* becomes the *śikṣā-guru* and teaches the corresponding rules of worship. The *mantra-guru* is one; accepting many is forbidden. The *śravaṇa-guru* and the guru who teaches worship are usually the same person, while *śikṣā-gurus* may be many. And knowledge of the scriptures comes only from association with the *śravaṇa-guru*. Initiation into the mantra is itself the mercy (*anugraha*). Those who disregard the guru's lotus feet and seek nearness to Bhagavān grow weary in their various means. So hundreds upon hundreds of calamities fall upon the living being who lacks devotion to the guru. He bears the name of a devotee, yet the calamities keep him only in worldly existence. Like a boat on the ocean without a helmsman, he finds no deliverance from it. Kṛṣṇa is attained only by serving the guru. Devotees serve Him by remembrance and other practices. Someone may think, "I already understand more — what more could another guru teach me?" Such pride is an offense, and because

of it one cannot attain devotion to Kṛṣṇa. One should take shelter not of an unworthy pretender (*guru-bruva*) — a worldly, conventional or hereditary guru — but of the *pāramārthika-guru*, who guides one to the highest goal.

*The author's *śikṣā-gurus* —*

36 Śrī Rūpa, Sanātana, Raghunātha Bhaṭṭa, Śrī Jīva, Gopāla Bhaṭṭa and Raghunātha Dāsa —

Anubhāṣya.
Śrī Rūpa, Śrī Sanātana and Śrī Jīva — see Ādi 10.85. Śrī Raghunātha Bhaṭṭa — see Ādi 10.153–158. Śrī Raghunātha Dāsa — see Ādi 10.91. Śrī Gopāla Bhaṭṭa — see Ādi 10.105.

37 these six are my instructing gurus; at the lotus feet of them all I offer millions of obeisances.

*The Lord's devotee (*īśa-bhakta*) —*

38 To all the devotees of the Lord, of whom Śrīvāsa is the chief, I offer thousands of obeisances at their lotus feet.

Anubhāṣya.
Śrīvāsa — see Ādi 10.8.

*The Lord's avatāra (*īśāvatāra*) —*

39 Advaita Ācārya is a partial avatāra of the Lord; at His lotus feet I offer millions of obeisances.

Anubhāṣya.
Śrī Advaita — see Ādi, Chapter 6.

*The Lord's manifestation (*īśa-prakāśa*) —*

40 Śrī Nityānanda Rāya is the Lord’s own direct manifestation (*svarūpa-prakāśa*). I worship His lotus feet: I am His servant.

Anubhāṣya.

Śrī Nityānanda — see Ādi, Chapter 5.

*The Lord's potency (*īśa-śakti*) —*

41 Gadādhara Paṇḍita and the others are the Lord's own potencies; at the feet of them all I offer thousands of obeisances.

*The Lord Himself (*īśa-tattva*) —*

42 Lord Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya is Bhagavān Himself; at His lotus feet I offer endless obeisances.

43 Having bowed to the Lord together with His entourage, I shall now consider how He Himself is these six.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Āvaraṇa, the surrounding retinue: the devotees who surround the Lord on every side are His *āvaraṇa*. I have bowed to Him together with this retinue. The six truths — the guru, the Lord's devotee, the Lord's avatāra, the Lord's manifestation, the Lord's potency, and the Lord Himself, Kṛṣṇa Caitanya — are His own *svarūpa*. Now I shall consider how this is so.

Anubhāṣya.

Śrī Gaurasundara receives endless obeisances, Śrī Advaita and the *śikṣā-gurus* millions, and the truths of potency and of the devotees thousands. This difference in the number of obeisances does not imply a worldly notion of difference born of *māyā*.

Kṛṣṇa Caitanyadeva displays Himself (*vilāsa*) in exactly these six forms of truth: the two gurus, the Lord's devotee, the Lord, the avatāra, the manifestation and the potency. By the principle of *acintya-bhedābheda*, this nondual Knowledge (*advaya-jñāna*) is called by the name "Kṛṣṇa Caitanya."

44 Although my Guru is a servant of Śrī Caitanya, I know him to be His manifestation.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

All *jīvas* are servants of Kṛṣṇa, so my guru too is in truth Kṛṣṇa's servant. Even so, I shall know my guru as Kṛṣṇa's manifestation (*prakāśa*). For the disciple, the guru is the very form of Kṛṣṇa's manifestation. But Nityānanda, who is Baladeva, is in truth *prakāśa-tattva* whose nature is *vilāsa*.

*The truth of the guru. (1) The *dīkṣā-guru* —*

45 On the evidence of scripture the guru is a form of Kṛṣṇa: in the form of the guru, Kṛṣṇa bestows His mercy on the devotees.

Anubhāṣya.

Everyone except Mahāprabhu Caitanyadeva is His servant. So in the guru no manifestation is possible other than service to Caitanya. He is a servant because he is the *āśraya-vigraha*, the form who shelters and holds love. The guru is a form in which service is manifest, and he appears in no other way than in service to the One who is served. The guru is the very form of a manifestation (*prakāśa*), and there is no room to regard him as the *viṣaya-vigraha*, the object of love. It is as the *āśraya-vigraha* that the scriptures call him a form of Kṛṣṇa.

*(*Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 11.17.27)*

46 "Know the ācārya to be Me. Never show him disrespect, and do not envy him, thinking him an ordinary mortal, for the Guru embodies all the gods." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 11.17.27)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Bhagavān said to Uddhava: "O Uddhava, know the guru to be My very self. Do not regard the guru with *asūyā*, that is, with disrespect, thinking him an ordinary man. The guru embodies all the gods."

Anubhāṣya.

Uddhava heard about *svadharma*, one's true duty, both for those who follow *varṇāśrama* and for others; its defining mark is devotion to Kṛṣṇa. He then asked Bhagavān how to practise this devotion. The Lord describes the nature of each *varṇa*. Speaking of the *brahmacārī*'s life in the guru's house, He tells how one should behave toward the guru:

ācāryam (the guru) **mām** (as My dearest one) **vijānīyāt** (one should know) **karhicit** (ever) **na avamanyeta** (one should not reproach, even if there is a reason)

guruḥ sarva-deva-mayaḥ ([for] the guru embodies all the gods) **martya-buddhyā** ([him] with an intellect bound by conditioned, material place, time and person) **na asūyeta** (one should not, growing envious through one's own material dullness, think him equal to oneself).

Ācārya: “The twice-born who performs the *upanayana* rite for a disciple and teaches him the Veda with its rituals and secret portions is called an ācārya.” (*Manu-saṁhitā* 2.140). “He who gathers the meaning of the scriptures, establishes others in right conduct and himself acts accordingly is called an ācārya.” (*Vāyu Purāṇa*).

Śrī Bhagavān Himself appears before the disciple in the form of the ācārya. In the conduct of the revered ācārya there is nothing but service to Hari. He is the *āśraya-vigraha* in person. If someone has turned away from serving Hari yet fancies himself an ācārya, no one will take his bad conduct for good. The ācārya's undivided worship is what shows him to be a manifestation of Bhagavān. Those devoted to their senses and unsatisfied in enjoyment envy even the ācārya's faultless conduct. The ācārya is a limb inseparable from Bhagavān, the One who is served. Therefore a *jīva* who harbours hostility toward him loses the mercy of Bhagavān and His associates and falls into misfortune.

The guru is in truth a servant of Kṛṣṇa Caitanya. Yet the disciple looks with transcendental vision and will know him as a special manifestation of Śrī Gaurasundara. This does not mean that the guru in fact lacks the eternal relationship of a servant with Kṛṣṇa, the One he serves, or that he differs in no way from Vrajendranandana in the variety of *līlā*. The impersonalists (*nirviśeṣa-vādīs*) hold that transcendental realization contains no distinctions — neither internal ones, nor those among things of one kind, nor those among things of different kinds. But no Vaiṣṇava ācārya endowed with devotion follows their view or says that there is no difference whatever between the guru and Kṛṣṇa. He teaches *acintya-bhedābheda-tattva*. Śrī Raghunātha Dāsa Gosvāmī Prabhu says of the guru: “Remember the best of gurus as most dear to Mukunda.” Śrī Jīva Gosvāmī Prabhu wrote in the *Bhakti-sandarbha* (section 213): “Pure devotees see Śrī Guru and Śrī Śiva as non-different from Bhagavān only in the sense that they are supremely dear to Him.” Following him, Śrī Viśvanātha Cakravartī Ṭhākura said in his hymn to Śrī Gurudeva: “All the scriptures call him Hari Himself, and the virtuous regard him so; yet he is the Lord's dear servant. I worship the lotus feet of such a guru.” That is, all the scriptures say that for the disciple the guru is “Hari,” and the sādhus know the guru as such. But the guru, eternally the

very form of a manifestation, has the right to the dear service of Kṛṣṇa Caitanyadeva. I, the guru's eternal servant, worship the lotus feet of such a guru. Every Gauḍīya Vaiṣṇava meditates on the guru, knowing Śrī Gurudeva, the *āśraya-vigraha*, as *tadīya*, “His own.” In all the ancient systems of worship and in the songs of pure devotion, Śrī Gurudeva is named a dear friend of Śrī Rādhā or a manifestation of Śrī Nityānanda's own form.

*(2) The truth of the *śikṣā-guru*; his two forms: (a) the *caitya-guru* (the guru within the heart), (b) the *mahānta-guru* —*

47 I know the instructing Guru to be Kṛṣṇa’s own form, in two aspects: the Indweller within, and the best of devotees.

Anubhāṣya.

He who teaches worship (*bhajana*) is the *śikṣā-guru*. One who is without worship and of bad conduct is neither a guru nor an ācārya. Teachers are of two kinds: the *mahānta-guru*, who delights in worship, and the *caitya-guru*, who grants the discernment favourable to worship. Instruction in worship differs according to the goal (*sādhya*) and the practice. Śrī Gurudeva, who gives Kṛṣṇa, enriches the disciple with knowledge of *sambandha* and awakens in him a realization of his own service. The disciple receives the mercy of this *dīkṣā-guru* and learns to serve Viṣṇu properly. This instruction is called *abhidheya*. The *śikṣā-guru* is the *āśraya-vigraha* who embodies *abhidheya*. So he is not different from the *dīkṣā-guru*, who gives knowledge of *sambandha*. Both are Śrī Gurudeva. To treat one of them as higher and the other as lower, outwardly or at heart, brings offense. As words, Kṛṣṇa's “*rūpa*” (form) and “*svarūpa*” do not differ. The *dīkṣā-guru* Śrī Sanātana gives the lotus feet of Madana-mohana. The *jīva* has forgotten Bhagavān and cannot wander in Vraja. Sanātana gives him the realization that Bhagavān's feet are all his wealth. The *śikṣā-guru* Śrī Rūpa gives the right to serve the feet of Śrī Govinda and His dearest ones.

*(*Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 11.29.6)*

48 “O Lord! Even if the wise lived as long as Brahmā and remembered with ever-growing joy all that You have done for them, they could not repay their debt to You. For, dispelling all that is inauspicious in embodied souls, You come to them from without as the ācārya and from within as the

Supersoul, and reveal to them the way to Yourself." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 11.29.6)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

O Lord! The wise are filled with bliss when they remember You, yet even with a lifespan like Brahmā's they could not repay You. For in Your boundless mercy You abide outside as the ācārya and within as the indwelling Lord (*antaryāmī*). You do this to destroy all that is inauspicious in embodied souls and to reveal to them their own path.

Anubhāṣya.

Uddhava had heard the scripture of yoga in detail and saw that the path of yoga is very difficult. He wishes to hear from Bhagavān briefly about *bhakti-yoga*, and he says to Him:

īśa (O Lord) **tava kṛtam** (the kindness You have done) **smarantaḥ** (thinking of it) **ṛddha-mudaḥ** (those whose supreme bliss has grown) **kavayaḥ** (the discerning) **brahmāyuṣā api** (even with a lifespan equal to Brahmā's, spent worshipping You) **apacitim** (repayment, that is, discharge of the debt) **naiva upayanti** (do not attain) **yaḥ** ([for] You) **bahiḥ ācārya-vapuṣā** (outwardly in the form of the ācārya, that is, as the *mantra-guru* or the *śikṣā-guru*) **antaḥ caitya-vapuṣā** (inwardly in the form of the indwelling Lord [*antaryāmī*]) **tanubhṛtām** (of embodied living beings) **aśubham** (what is inauspicious, that is, absorption in objects other than Kṛṣṇa) **vidhunvan** (dispelling) **sva-gatim** (their own path, that is, their true nature, marked by being the Lord's associate) **vyanakti** (You reveal).

*Śrī Bhagavān grants the perfection of love to the surrendered practitioner — (*Bhagavad-gītā* 10.10)*

49 "To those who are ever devoted to Me and worship Me with love, I give the understanding that brings them to Me." (Bhagavad-gītā, 10.10)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

"To those who worship Me with love through eternal *bhakti-yoga*, I give the pure *prema-yoga* born of pure knowledge. Through it they reach My abode of supreme bliss."

Anubhāṣya.

There are wise devotees (*paṇḍitas*) who know that everything arises and acts from Bhagavān. They are fixed in unwavering *bhakti-yoga* and worship Him; their minds are turned to Kṛṣṇa, and Kṛṣṇa is their life. They share their feelings with one another and speak about Hari; so they please Kṛṣṇa and delight in Him. Of them Kṛṣṇa says to Arjuna:

teṣām satata-yuktānām (of those who always long to be joined with Me in service) **prīti-pūrvakam** (with love, with reverence) **bhajatām** (who serve: those who have given up other desires, karma and jñāna and are devoted to serving Hari) **tam buddhi-yogam dadāmi** (I give that *buddhi-yoga*, that is, I Myself awaken it in the movements of their hearts) **yena te mām upayānti** (by which they attain Me).

(The sense: this *buddhi-yoga* cannot be gained by oneself or from anyone else; I alone can give it, and only they, such devotees, can receive it.)

50 "Thus the Lord Himself instructed Brahmā and made him realise it."

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
Bhagavān Himself made Brahmā realize this by instructing him as follows.

*(*Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 2.9.30–35)*

51 "Receive from Me, as I speak it, the supremely confidential knowledge of Myself, endowed with realisation, together with its secret and that secret's integral part." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 2.9.31)[4]

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
"Out of mercy I am telling you My supreme secret knowledge, filled with realization (*vijñāna*), together with its mystery and its parts. Accept it.

Anubhāṣya.
Brahmā resolved to create and sank into deep thought. He heard a divine voice say "*Tapa*" (austerity), and he gave himself sincerely to austerity. Viṣṇu became pleased with him, and Brahmā beheld Vaikuṇṭha. There he was freed from pride and began to inquire about the truth, and Bhagavān spoke six verses. See the *Gauḍīya-bhāṣya* on the *Bhāgavatam*, pp. 577–629.

me (My, that is, Bhagavān's) **jñānam parama-guhyam** (knowledge that surpasses even knowledge of the impersonal Brahman and the like) **vijñāna-samanvitam**

(joined with realization [*vijñāna*]. I give you not merely knowledge of My form, but knowledge joined with *vijñāna*, the realization of Kṛṣṇa and of all that belongs to Kṛṣṇa) **sa-rahasyam** (with its mystery. If there is anything secret in it, that comes too, namely *prema-bhakti*) **tad-aṅgam ca** (and with its limb: *sādhana-bhakti-yoga*, which consists of hearing and the rest and aids knowledge of *sambandha*) **mayā gaditam** (spoken by Me. You did not ask about these three, yet I speak of them out of mercy, and no one else has spoken of them) **sat gṛhāṇa** (accept).

52 "By My grace may you truly realise Me as I am — My being, My forms, My qualities and My deeds." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 2.9.32)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

By My mercy, realize the full truth of what My own nature (*svarūpa*) is, and what My characteristics, form, qualities and *līlās* are.

Anubhāṣya.

yāvān (of what size and shape. That is, what My form is like, its limbs joined in a particular harmony of fullness, slenderness, length, height and the rest, and what My measure is in My own nature) **aham yathā-bhāvaḥ** (what My being is, what My characteristics are) **aham yad-rūpa-guṇa-karmakaḥ** (He who has these forms, qualities and deeds. The forms are the dark, the four-armed, the two-armed and the golden, the form of Kṛṣṇa, of Rāma, of Nṛsiṁha and others. The qualities are love for the devotees and others. The deeds are accepting Lakṣmī, lifting Govardhana and others) **tathaiva** (just so, in every respect) **tattva-vijñānam** (realization of their truth) **mad-anugrahāt** (by My mercy) **te** (to you) **astu** (may it be).

(As *sādhana-bhakti* and *prema-bhakti* grow in you, you will realize ever more of the sweetness of My form, qualities and *līlās*. So you will directly realize Me in the land of Vraja — Kṛṣṇa, supremely hard to attain, whose sweetness surpasses even My own form.) (This by itself refutes the view that the four verses point to the impersonal.)

53 "Before creation I alone existed; there was nothing else — neither effect, nor cause, nor That which is beyond them. After creation this whole

world is not other than Me, and what remains after its dissolution is also I." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 2.9.33)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Before this world was created, I alone existed. Nothing existed apart from Me — neither *sat* nor *asat*, nor even the indescribable Brahman without attributes (*nirviśeṣa*). After creation I exist as all this, and when creation dissolves, I alone shall remain."

Anubhāṣya.

aham (the word *aham* ["I"] denotes the speaker, the one who has form, not the impersonal Brahman, for that cannot be its object. If knowledge of the self [*ātmā*] were meant, then, as in *tat tvam asi* ["you are that"], it would have been proper to say *tvam eva asīḥ* ["you alone were"]. I am that most enchanting divine form [*śrī-vigraha*] who now appears before you) **eva agre** (before creation, even at the time of the great dissolution) **āsam** (I was) **anyat na** (nothing else was. So say the Śrutis: "Vāsudeva alone was, neither Brahmā nor Śaṅkara," "Nārāyaṇa alone was, neither Brahmā nor Īśāna," and so on. Vaikuṇṭha, His associates and the rest are His inseparable part, so the same word *aham* includes them, just as the phrase "the king is setting out" includes his retinue.[11]) **sad-asat-param** (beyond *sat* and *asat*. *Sat* is the effect, *asat* the cause) **yat** (that, that is, Brahman) **tat anyat na** (is not other than Me. Or else: at that time, since there was no variety in the cosmos, I was in the form of pure, attributeless spirit, and in Vaikuṇṭha in the form of Bhagavān with attributes) **paścāt** (and after creation) **aham** (I alone am: in Vaikuṇṭha as Bhagavān and other forms, in the worlds as the indwelling Lord and other forms) **yad etat** (this universe) **tat api aham eva asmi** (that too is only I, for the universe is not other than Me and is Mine by nature) **yo 'vaśiṣyeta so 'ham eva asmi** ([and at dissolution] what remains is I).

(The sense: the form of Śrī Kṛṣṇa's eternal *līlās* is not limited by time and the like, and He is manifest at all times.)

54 "Whatever appears to exist apart from Me, the Reality, and does not appear in Me, know that to be My māyā, like a reflection and like darkness." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 2.9.34)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

The previous verse established knowledge of the nature (*svarūpa*) of the Supreme Truth. But there is no realization (*vijñāna*) until that knowledge of the *svarūpa-tattva* is made firm by knowing the truth that is other than the *svarūpa*. The truth other than the *svarūpa-tattva* is called *māyā*. This verse sets out knowledge of the *māyā-tattva* in detail. The *svarūpa-tattva* is the *artha*, that is, the true reality. Whatever is perceived outside that truth, and whatever has no place in the perception of the *svarūpa-tattva* itself, should be known as a manifestation of *māyā* (*māyā-vaibhava*) belonging to the *ātma-tattva*. Since this is not easy to grasp, here are two particular examples. Think of the *svarūpa-tattva* as the sun. What is other than the sun is perceived in two forms: as *ābhāsa*, a reflection, and as *tamas*, darkness. The sun's reflection falls from water onto another place; this is called *ābhāsa*. The side where the sun's power is not seen is called *tamas*, that is, darkness. The spiritual world is the rays of Bhagavān's own form. The manifestation of *māyā* is an *ābhāsa* that rests on its likeness to that world; this is the example of *ābhāsa*. The darkness far removed from the spiritual truth (*cit-tattva*) is that same manifestation of *māyā*; this is the second example. The point is this: the *ātma-tattva* and the *māyā-tattva* stand in a twofold relation. First, whatever is manifest as a form other than the *ātma-svarūpa* is *māyā*. And the ignorance, the non-self far removed from the *ātma-svarūpa*, is also *māyā*.

Anubhāṣya.

artham (the highest reality) **mām ṛte** (without Me) **yat pratīyeta** (what is perceived. When I am perceived it is not perceived, so it is perceived only outside Me) **yac ca ātmani na pratīyeta** (and what is not perceived without resting on Me, that is, is not perceived by itself) **tat** (a thing with these marks) **ātmanaḥ** (of Me, the Supreme Lord) **yathābhāsaḥ** (like *ābhāsa*, a reflection. *Ābhāsa* is a particular reflection of a luminary, somehow cast onto a place beyond its own light. It is perceived only outside the luminary, yet without the luminary it cannot be perceived at all) **yathā tamaḥ** (like darkness. Here the word *tamas* means a play of colours close to darkness. It does not exist in the light that is its source, yet it cannot exist without resting on that light) **māyām** (so too this potency called *māyā*, which is twofold: *jīva-māyā* and *guṇa-māyā*) **vidyāt** (one should know).

55 “As the great elements enter all beings, great and small, and yet remain outside them, so I am within all that is created and yet beyond it.” (Śrīmad-

Bhāgavatam, 2.9.35)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

The great elements enter beings large and small, yet they also remain independent, as if they had not entered. In the same way I, as the Supersoul (*Paramātmā*), the shelter of their existence, enter all beings in this world of elements, and yet I eternally abide apart in My form as Bhagavān. For the devotees I am the only object of love. The meaning is this. The great elements — earth, water, fire, air and ether — combine and manifest the gross world. They are present within it as its components, yet in their state as great elements they remain independent. In the same way the spiritual Supreme Lord creates the world through His material potency and His potency of the *jīvas*. With one portion of Himself He pervades the world, yet at the same time He eternally abides in His spiritual abode in the fullness of His spiritual form. And the *jīvas*, the tiniest particles of the rays of His spiritual form, taste pure love for Him on the path of pure love. This is the secret.

Anubhāṣya.

yathā mahānti bhūtāni (as the great elements, ether and the rest) **uccāvaceṣu bhūteṣu** (in higher and lower beings: gods, humans, animals and others) **apraviṣṭāni** (though situated outside) **anupraviṣṭāni** (appear to be within) **tathā** (so too [though I have not entered, for I abide in Vaikuṇṭha, beyond the worlds]) **aham teṣu** (I, in those renowned for the corresponding qualities) **nateṣu** (in those who bow down to Me) **praviṣṭaḥ** (have entered: I abide in the heart to show Myself to their inner sight).

In the same way, without entering, I also abide outside. I do this to give their eyes My beauty and their nostrils My fragrance; to converse with them and fill their ears with the nectar of My sweet voice; and by touch, embrace and the like to let their bodies feel the tenderness, sweetness and other graces of My body. These devotees are beyond the *guṇas*, and I cannot leave them, either within or without: My play with them is always full of attachment. This shows that the “mystery” is their *prema-bhakti*, which brings Me so under their control.

56 “This much must be inquired into by one who seeks the truth of the Self: That which exists everywhere and always, both directly and indirectly.” (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 2.9.36)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

One who seeks knowledge of the *ātma-tattva* should examine this subject by *anvaya-vyatireka*, the direct and the indirect method, and search for the reality that is eternal everywhere and always. The point is this: the means by which the secret of love is attained is called *sādhana-bhakti*. The seeker of truth learns *anvaya-vyatireka*, that is, injunctions and prohibitions, at the feet of a true guru. Cultivating the truth constantly in this way, he will attain knowledge of the truth.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

The *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* contains the teaching of Mahāprabhu Śrī Caitanyadeva in full. The *Bhāgavatam* has 18,000 verses.

The root of everything in those eighteen thousand verses lies in these four. The verse *aham eva* briefly describes the truth of Bhagavān, His own form, His qualities and His *līlās*. The verse *ṛte 'rtham* examines the truths of *māyā*, of the *jīva* and of matter. *Māyā-tattva* appears separately from Bhagavān's *svarūpa-tattva*. *Jīva-tattva*, through its connection with this *māyā-tattva*, is liable to fall under the control of the *māyā* potency. *Jaḍa-tattva*, matter, is the field of the *jīva*'s enjoyment. From these two verses one should fully grasp knowledge of *sambandha*. The verse *yathā mahānti* says that Bhagavān's eternal form abides separately, although the truth of Bhagavān is inconceivably one with the *jīvas* and matter and different from them. It also names the supreme goal (*prayojana*): the *jīvas* take shelter at His feet and gain the wealth of great love, *mahā-prema*. The verse *etāvad eva* names the only means to reach this supreme goal: *sādhana-bhakti*. *Sādhana-bhakti* includes injunctions that lead to the goal; as favourable, they are called *anvaya*. Actions that obstruct the goal and produce what is unfavourable are counted among the prohibitions and called *vyatireka*. The truth of practice is called *abhidheya*. *Abhidheya* is the instruction one receives through the direct meaning of the scriptures (*abhidhā-vṛtti*).

Anubhāṣya.

ātmanaḥ (of Me, Bhagavān) **tattva-jijñāsunā** (by one who wishes to realize what truly brings about his good) **etāvad eva jijñāsyam** (this alone should be learned at the feet of Śrī Guru).

(What is it?)

yat (that one reality which…) **anvaya-vyatirekābhyām** (through injunctions and prohibitions…) **sarvadā sarvatra syāt** (exists always and everywhere).

(If one asks which of heaven, liberation and *prema* is one's own good, the answer is: *prema* is established by its own *anvaya* and *vyatireka*, whereas heaven and liberation are not established by them.) (That is: of all that is to be learned, this alone should be learned. What is it?)

anvaya-vyatirekābhyām (through union and separation, that is, through *sambhoga* and *vipralambha*) **yat syāt sarvatra** (what exists everywhere: in Śrī Vṛndāvana and the other abodes beyond all the universes — in the servants, friends, elders and beloveds) **sarvadā** (eternally, even at the time of the great dissolution).

(This points to the relishing of the four *rasas* of servitude, friendship, parental love and amorous love: *dāsya*, *sakhya*, *vātsalya* and *śṛṅgāra*.)

*(In the first verse of the *Śrī Kṛṣṇa-karṇāmṛta*) —*

57 “Glory to Cintāmaṇi and to Somagiri, my guru! Glory to my instructing guru, the Lord whose crown is a peacock feather! At the tips of His feet, like the tender shoots of a wish-fulfilling tree, Jayaśrī (Śrī Rādhā) tastes the joy of choosing Him as Her own.” (Kṛṣṇa-karṇāmṛta, 1)[5]

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Glory to my guru named Somagiri, who is like a wish-fulfilling gem (*cintāmaṇi*)![10] Glory also to my *śikṣā-guru*, Bhagavān, who wears a peacock feather! Jayaśrī, that is, Śrīmatī Rādhikā, tastes the joy of *svayaṁvara*, the free choice of a husband: she is drawn by the beauty of His toenail tips, on feet that are like shoots of the wish-fulfilling tree.

Anubhāṣya.

The book *Śrī Vallabha-digvijaya* places the time of Śrī Bilvamaṅgala — a Draviḍian king of ascetics, a *tridaṇḍī* — in the eighth century of the Śaka era. Bilvamaṅgala is mentioned as the chief disciple of Rāja-Viṣṇusvāmī, who installed the Deity of Dvārakādhīśa. Bilvamaṅgala's disciples were Devamaṅgala and others. Bilvamaṅgala worshipped for seven hundred years in Vṛndāvana at Brahma-kuṇḍa. After his meeting with Vallabha Bhaṭṭa, the worship of his Deity was entrusted to Hari Brahmacārī. Bilvamaṅgala's name also appears in the list of the Dvārakā *maṭha* of Śaṅkara's sampradāya: “Citsukhācārya (Kali era 2715), Bilvamaṅgala.” Līlāśuka Śrī Bilvamaṅgala Ṭhākura longed to enter the

transcendental *līlās* of Vṛndāvana. At the beginning of his song *Śrī Kṛṣṇa-karṇāmṛta* he glorifies three kinds of guru:

me (my) **guruḥ** (the *śravaṇa-guru*, who shows the way) **cintāmaṇiḥ jayati** (Cintāmaṇi — may this guru be glorified) **somagiriḥ** ([the *mantra-guru*] Somagiri [may he be glorified]) **śikṣā-guruḥ śikhi-piñcha-mauliḥ** ([the *caitya*] *śikṣā-guru*, He whose crown ornament is a peacock feather) **bhagavān** (Vṛndāvana-candra [may He be glorified]) **yat-pāda-kalpa-taru-pallava-śekhareṣu** (at the toenail tips on His feet, which are shoots of the wish-fulfilling tree) **jaya-śrīḥ** (She who is both Jayā and Śrī, that is, Mahālakṣmī, the Queen of Vṛndāvana) **līlā-svayam-vara-rasam** (the sweetness, the joy, of a *svayaṁvara* [free choice] enacted in play, with deep *anurāga*) **labhate** (attains).

*Kṛṣṇa's mercy in the form of the *śikṣā-guru* —*

58 The soul cannot see Kṛṣṇa directly; therefore He is the guru within as the Indweller, and becomes the instructing guru in the form of a great devotee.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

The indwelling guru abides as the *caitya*, that is, within the mind. So one cannot see Him directly, face to face. That is why Kṛṣṇa becomes the *śikṣā-guru* in the form of the *mahānta*, the best of devotees.

Anubhāṣya.

The conditioned *jīva* cannot see Kṛṣṇa directly. Therefore Kṛṣṇa awakens in the *jīva*'s heart the discernment that leads to devotion to Kṛṣṇa, and so becomes the *caitya-śikṣā-guru*. And appearing as a *mahānta*, He becomes the *śikṣā-guru*.

*The need for the company of sādhus; the dharma, marks and nature of the sādhu-guru — (*Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 11.26.26)*

59 "Therefore the wise should give up bad company and associate with the saintly, for the saints alone, by their words, cut through the attachments of his mind." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 11.26.26)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Therefore an intelligent person will give up bad company and associate with sādhus. With their good instructions the sādhus will cut all the bonds of his desires

that are unfavourable to devotion.

Anubhāṣya.

Urvaśī left Purūravā and went away. Beside himself with grief, he lamented for a whole year; then he gained discernment and understood the fruits of bad company. Śrī Bhagavān tells this story to Uddhava:

tataḥ duḥsaṅgam (bad company: the company of women and of those who keep company with women) **utsṛjya** (leaving far behind) **buddhimān** (one who discerns *sat* from *asat*) **satsu sajjeta** (should associate wholeheartedly with Hari's detached servants) **santaḥ** ([for] the sādhus) **asya** (of one absorbed in sense objects) **mano-vyāsaṅgam** (the mind's perverse attachment) **uktibhiḥ** (by their good instructions) **chindanti** (destroy).

*The fruit of hearing *hari-kathā* in the company of sādhus: the awakening of faith, *bhāva* and *prema* — (*Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 3.25.25)*

60 (Lord Kapila to His mother Devahūti:) “In the company of the saints there are talks revealing My power, delightful to the heart and to the ear. By relishing them one quickly comes to faith in Me, the path of liberation, and after it to attraction (*rati*) and love (*prema-bhakti*).” (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 3.25.25)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

In the company of sādhus, narratives that reveal My power are discussed, an elixir for the heart and ears. As a person listens to them, there soon awakens in him faith in Me, the path of liberation; then *rati*; and at last loving devotion (*prema-bhakti*).

Anubhāṣya.

Devahūti asked her son Kapiladeva what her highest good was, and Kapila replied:

satām (of Hari's servants) **prasaṅgāt** (through excellent association) **mama vīrya-saṁvidaḥ** (those in which My power is rightly understood) **hṛt-karṇa-rasāyanāḥ** (an elixir for the heart and ears: delightful to hearing and mind, giving happiness) **kathāḥ bhavanti** (narratives arise) **taj-joṣaṇāt** (by serving them) **apavarga-vartmani** (toward Hari, on the path to whom ignorance ceases) **śraddhā** ([first] faith) **ratiḥ** ([then] *bhāva*) **bhaktiḥ** ([then] *prema*) **āśu** (soon) **anukramiṣyati** (will come one after another).

(First comes faith, then the company of sādhus. Through that company one hears these narratives, and an inclination to serve arises — the activity of worship. Then, through excellent association, come narratives that remove the *anarthas*, the unwanted things in the heart. Next these same narratives produce steadiness (*niṣṭhā*) and so let one understand My greatness. Then they produce taste (*ruci*) and become an elixir for the heart and ears. By serving these narratives and relishing them with love, there will come one after another: faith in Bhagavān, which here means attachment (*āsakti*); *rati*, which is *bhāva*; and *bhakti*, which is *prema*.)

The truth about the Lord's devotees, and their kinds —

61 The devotee is the Lord’s own form, His abode: in the devotee’s heart Kṛṣṇa always rests.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
Whoever is devoted to the Lord (*Īśvara*) in His form of eternal being, knowledge and bliss — that is, his heart — is the place where Kṛṣṇa dwells.

Anubhāṣya.
The one and only nondual reality is the Lord (*Īśvara*). This reality, the Lord, possesses all potencies. By nature the devotee is of the same kind as His potency, not of the same kind as the possessor of potency. The inclination to serve Kṛṣṇa lives in the devotee who worships Him. Therefore Kṛṣṇa abides in the devotee as His support.

*(*Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 9.4.68)*

62 “The saints are My heart, and I am the heart of the saints. They know no one but Me, and I know no one but them.” (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 9.4.68)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
The sādhus are My heart, and I am the heart of the sādhus. They know no one but Me, and I regard no one but them as My own.

Anubhāṣya.
The sage Durvāsā offended the feet of the great devotee Mahārāja Ambarīṣa, and Viṣṇu's disc rushed forth to kill Durvāsā. He sought help from all the gods. At last Bhagavān Viṣṇu advised the sage Durvāsā to beg forgiveness at Ambarīṣa's lotus

feet. In truth, with this verse He revealed the supreme greatness of the saintly devotees:

sādhavaḥ (the sādhus) **mahyam hṛdayam** (are My heart, as dear as My life) **sādhūnām tu aham hṛdayam** (and I am the heart of the sādhus) **te** (they, the sādhus) **mad-anyat** (anything other than Me) **na jānanti** (do not know) **aham** (and I) **tebhyaḥ** (apart from them) **manāg api** (even slightly) **anyat na** ([know] nothing else).

(The devotees always think of Me alone with all their being. And I always meditate on the devotees, who are wholly devoted to serving Me and have taken shelter at My feet with all their being.)

*(*Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 1.13.10)*

63 "Devotees such as you are themselves holy places, my lord. By the Lord who dwells within your hearts, you make even the holy places holy." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 1.13.10)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
Devotees (*bhāgavatas*) like you are themselves holy places. The holy places are stained by the sins of sinners, and such devotees purify them by the holiness of Bhagavān, who dwells within them.

Anubhāṣya.
Vidura Mahāśaya had wandered through many holy places and returned to Hastināpura. Mahārāja Yudhiṣṭhira greeted him with this verse:

prabho (O lord) **bhavad-vidhāḥ** (those like you) **bhāgavatāḥ** (devotees, sādhus) **tīrtha-bhūtāḥ** (are themselves holy places) **svāntaḥ-sthena** (by Him who dwells within them) **gadābhṛtā** (by Bhagavān Viṣṇu) **tīrthāni** (the holy places, which through contact with impure people have ceased to be holy) **tīrthī-kurvanti** (make into great holy places again).

(And your pilgrimage is the good fortune of the holy places themselves.)

64 These devotees are of two kinds: the Lord's eternal associates and those who practise devotion.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Devotees are of two kinds: Bhagavān's associates and practitioners (*sādhakas*). Bhagavān's associates are the circle of perfected servants (*siddha-sevakas*). Some of them are devoted to His majesty (*aiśvarya*) and dwell in the spiritual sky, Paravyoma. Others are devoted to His sweetness, *mādhurya*, and are absorbed in serving Kṛṣṇa in Śrī Vṛndāvana. The *sādhakas* are those who follow *vaidhī* or *rāgānugā sādhana-bhakti* in order to attain perfection in service.

The kinds of the Lord's avatāras —

65–66 The Lord’s avatāras are of three kinds: partial avatāras, guṇa-avatāras, and, third, empowered avatāras. The partial avatāras are the Puruṣas, Matsya and the others.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

The *aṁśa-avatāras* are direct avatāras of Viṣṇu, masters of *māyā*. The *guṇa-avatāras* are avatāras of Bhagavān manifest in the three *guṇas*: *sattva*, *rajas* and *tamas*. The *śaktyāveśa-avatāras* are exalted *jīvas* whom a special potency of Kṛṣṇa enters.

67 Brahmā, Viṣṇu and Śiva are counted as the three guṇa-avatāras; the Kumāras, Pṛthu and the sage Vyāsa are empowered avatāras.

Anubhāṣya.

Īśvarera, “of the Lord,” means of Kṛṣṇa in His original form (*svayaṁ-rūpa*). See the first part of the *Laghu-bhāgavatāmṛta*, the section on the object of worship and on the avatāras, and also *Caitanya-caritāmṛta*, Madhya-līlā, Chapter 20.

*The Lord's manifestations differ by *līlā* —*

68 The Lord manifests Himself in two ways: one is *prakāśa*, the other *vilāsa*.

Anubhāṣya.

Bhagavānera, “of Bhagavān”: of His original form (*svayaṁ-rūpa*). See *Caitanya-caritāmṛta*, Madhya-līlā, Chapter 20.

*The Lord's manifestation (*īśa-prakāśa*) —*

69–70 When one Person appears in many forms, alike in appearance and one in identity — as at the marriage of the queens or in the rāsa dance — this is called Kṛṣṇa's chief *prakāśa*.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Bhagavān manifests in two ways: as *prakāśa* and as *vilāsa*. Kṛṣṇa displayed many forms at once when He married the queens in Dvārakā and when He danced the *rāsa* in Vṛndāvana. Those forms did not differ in shape: one and the same form (*vigraha*) became many. This is Kṛṣṇa's principal *prakāśa*. But where the *svarūpa* takes another shape, one resembling itself, that manifestation is called *vilāsa*. Baladeva in Vṛndāvana, and Nārāyaṇa, Vāsudeva, Pradyumna, Saṅkarṣaṇa and others in Paravyoma, are *vilāsa* forms in which Bhagavān's own form appears.

Anubhāṣya.

"A *prakāśa* is not counted among the distinct forms, for He is not separate from Him." (*Laghu-bhāgavatāmṛta*, first part).

Anubhāṣya.

"As one body became many forms in the *rāsa* dance, so at His marriage to the queens He appeared in many forms. This is known in the scriptures as *prābhava-vilāsa*."[12] (*Caitanya-caritāmṛta*, Madhya 20.168).

*(*Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 10.69.2)*

71 "How wonderful! The one Kṛṣṇa, in one and the same body, married sixteen thousand princesses at once, each in her own palace." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 10.69.2)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

What is wonderful is this: the one Kṛṣṇa, each time in a single form, married sixteen thousand wives at once in separate palaces.

Anubhāṣya.

bata (oh!) **etat citram** (this is wonderful) **ekaḥ** (the one Kṛṣṇa) **ekena vapuṣā** (in a single body) **yugapat pṛthag gṛheṣu** (at once in separate palaces) **dvy-aṣṭa-sāhasram** (sixteen thousand) **striyaḥ** (queens) **udāvahat** (married).

*(*Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 10.33.3–5)*

72 "The festival of the rāsa dance began, adorned with circles of gopīs; Kṛṣṇa, the Master of yoga, stood between each two of them —" (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 10.33.3)

73–74 "— having entered between them and embraced each by the neck, so that every girl thought Him beside her alone. At once the sky was crowded with hundreds of celestial cars of the gods and their wives, their hearts filled with intense eagerness. Then the drums sounded and showers of flowers fell." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 10.33.3–4)[6]

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Śrī Kṛṣṇa, the master of mystic power (*yogeśvara*), by His inconceivable potency manifested a form of Himself between every two gopīs. Adorned by the circle of gopīs, He began the festival of the *rāsa*. When He had entered among them in this way, the gopīs felt that Śrī Kṛṣṇa was embracing them, His arm about their necks. At that moment the gods and their wives appeared in the sky, having come eagerly on hundreds of chariots. Then kettledrums sounded and a rain of flowers began to fall.

Anubhāṣya.

tāsām (of them, standing in a circle) **dvayor dvayor madhye** (between each two) **praviṣṭena** (by Him who entered in a separate form) **yam** (Śrī Kṛṣṇa, whom) **sva-nikaṭam** (as being close to herself [that is, "He has embraced me alone"]) **manyeran** (they thought) **yogeśvareṇa** (by that Kṛṣṇa) **kaṇṭhe gṛhītānām** (of those embraced at the neck from both sides) **gopī-maṇḍala-maṇḍitaḥ** (adorned by the circle of gopīs) **rāsotsavaḥ sampravṛttaḥ** (the festival of the *rāsa* began) **tāvat** (at that very moment) **atyautsukya-bhṛtātmanām** (of those whose minds were deeply stirred by longing to see) **sa-dārāṇām** (with their wives) **divaukasām** (of the gods) **vimāna-śata-saṅkulam** (full, filled, crowded with hundreds of aerial chariots) **abhavat** ([the sky] became) **tataḥ dundubhayo nedur nipetuḥ puṣpa-vṛṣṭayaḥ** (then kettledrums sounded and showers of flowers fell).

*(*Laghu-bhāgavatāmṛta*, first part, 1.21)*

75 "When one form appears at one time in many places, identical in every way, that is called *prakāśa*." (Laghu-bhāgavatāmṛta, 1.21)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
When one form manifests at the same time as many identical forms, this is called *prakāśa*.

Anubhāṣya.
ekadā (at one time) **ekasya rūpasya** (of one form) **yā anekatra prakaṭatā** (the manifestation in many places) **sarvathā tat-svarūpaiva** (identical with it in nature in every way, that is, one in shape, qualities, *līlās* and the rest) **sa prakāśa itīryate** (is called *prakāśa*).

*The Lord's *vilāsa* (*īśa-vilāsa*) —*

76 But when one and the same Person appears in many forms that differ in appearance, that is called *vilāsa*.

*(*Laghu-bhāgavatāmṛta*, in the description of the *tad-ekātma-rūpa*, 1.15)*

77 "When by His potency His own form appears for His pastimes in a different shape, almost equal to Him, it is called *vilāsa*." (Laghu-bhāgavatāmṛta, 1.15)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
When, in the play of His inconceivable potency, His own form appears in another shape, almost like Himself, it is called *vilāsa*.

Anubhāṣya.
tasya (of the original form) **yat svarūpam anyākāram** (a *svarūpa* different in shape, that is, with a different arrangement of the limbs) **vilāsataḥ** (through a particular *līlā*) **prāyeṇa** (less or greater in certain qualities) **ātma-samam** (like its own original form) **śaktyā bhāti** (appears by potency) **sa vilāso nigadyate** (is called *vilāsa*).

78 Examples are Baladeva, Nārāyaṇa in the spiritual sky, and Vāsudeva, Saṅkarṣaṇa, Pradyumna and the others.

Anubhāṣya.
Baladeva is *svayaṁ-prakāśa*. Nārāyaṇa is *prābhava-vilāsa*.

*The Lord's potency (*īśa-śakti*) —*

79–80 The Lord’s potencies are of three kinds: the Lakṣmīs in Vaikuṇṭha, the queens in Dvārakā, and the gopīs in Vraja. The gopīs are the foremost of all, for with them the son of the king of Vraja is Bhagavān Himself.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
The Lakṣmīs dwell in Vaikuṇṭha, the queens in the city, that is, in Dvārakā, and the gopīs in Vraja are the third kind of potency. *Sabāte* means “among all.” *Yāte* means “since”: since Vrajendranandana, the son of the king of Vraja, is Bhagavān Himself. His companions in Vraja are His very own potency (*svarūpa-śakti*).

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
From *yadyapi āmāra guru* (“although my guru,” verse 44) to *sādhaka-gaṇa āra* (“and the others are practitioners,” verse 64): the examination of two truths, the guru and the devotee. From *īśvarera avatāra* (“the Lord's avatāras,” verse 65) to *pṛthu vyāsa muni* (“Pṛthu and the sage Vyāsa,” verse 67): the examination of the Lord and His avatāras. From *dui-rūpe haya* (“is of two kinds,” verse 68) to *pradyumnādi-saṅkarṣaṇa* (“Pradyumna and the others, Saṅkarṣaṇa,” verse 78): the examination of His *prakāśa* and *vilāsa*. Then from *īśvarera śakti haya* (“the Lord's potencies are,” verse 79) to *svayaṁ bhagavān* (“Bhagavān Himself,” verse 80): the examination of His potencies.

81 The expansions of the body of Kṛṣṇa’s original form are equal to Him, and together with the devotees they form His entourage.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
Svayaṁ-rūpa: the verses of the *Laghu-bhāgavatāmṛta* on *tad-ekātma* and related forms show that the two-armed Kṛṣṇa alone is the *svayaṁ-rūpa*. His *kāya-vyūha* is equal to Him; *kāya-vyūha* means the expansion of His own body. The devotees who stand beside this form are His *āvaraṇa*. When we consider the *āvaraṇa* together with the truth it surrounds, the six truths named above prove to be one. This conclusion is established only by considering *acintya-bhedābheda-tattva*.

82 Thus, beginning with the devotees, I have worshipped them all in order; worship of them all is the source of every good.

83 In the first verse is the general invocation; in the second I offer specific worship.

Explanation of the second of the opening fourteen verses —

84 I worship Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya and Śrī Nityānanda, who are like a wonderful sun and moon. They have risen together on the eastern horizon of Gauḍa, dispelling the darkness and bestowing good on all.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
I worship Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya and Nityānanda. Like the sun and the moon, They have risen wondrously at the same time in the land of Gauḍa, which is like Udayācala, the mountain of sunrise. They bestow good fortune and dispel the darkness of the *jīvas*.

Anubhāṣya.
gauḍodaye (in the land of Gauḍa, which is the Udayācala, the mountain of sunrise) **sahoditau** (risen at the same time) **puṣpavantau** (the sun and the moon together; and therefore —) **citrau** (wondrous) **śan-dau** (bestowing good fortune) **tamo-nudau** (dispelling darkness) **śrī-kṛṣṇa-caitanya-nityānandau** (Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya and Nityānanda) **aham vande** (I worship).

**Gauḍodaye puṣpavantau* —*

85–86 Kṛṣṇa and Balarāma, who sported in Vraja long ago, Their radiance surpassing millions of suns and moons, have now, out of compassion for the world, risen on the eastern horizon in the land of Gauḍa.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
Nija-dhāma: radiance.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
Pūrva-śaile, “on the eastern mountain”: on the Udayācala that is Gauḍa, on the eastern bank of the Gaṅgā.

87 Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya and Prabhu Nityānanda — by Their appearance the whole world is filled with joy.

An example of causeless mercy —

88–89 As the sun and moon remove all darkness and, revealing things, set the world about its duties, so these two Brothers dispelled the darkness of the soul's ignorance and gave it the gift of the Truth.

*The definition of *kaitava* (cheating) —*

90 I call this darkness of ignorance *kaitava*, deceit: it is the desire for religious merit, wealth, pleasure and the rest.[7]

*(*Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 1.1.2)*

91 "In this beautiful *Bhāgavatam*, composed by the great sage, is taught the supreme dharma of the saintly who are free from envy, from which all deceit has been cast out. Here is known the true Reality, which bestows good and uproots the threefold miseries. What need is there of other scriptures? As soon as the pious wish to hear it, the Lord is at once captured within their hearts." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 1.1.2)[8]

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

This *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* was first composed by the great sage Śrī Nārāyaṇa in the form of four verses (*catuḥ-ślokī*). It sets forth the highest dharma for those free from envy, that is, kind to all beings. This dharma is free from cheating (*kaitava*), and that cheating includes *dharma*, *artha*, *kāma* and even *mokṣa*. It destroys the threefold miseries of the *jīva*, bestows good fortune and gives knowledge of the true reality. Those who wish to hear the *Bhāgavatam* can hold the Lord captive in their hearts at will. What need, then, is there for any scripture other than the *Bhāgavatam*?

Anubhāṣya.

mahā-muni-kṛte (composed by the great sage Śrī Nārāyaṇa) **atra śrīmad-bhāgavate** (in this beautiful *Bhāgavata*) **projjhita-kaitavaḥ** (that from which cheating has been entirely cast out: so *pra-* and *ujjhita* are understood. The

cheating is hypocrisy made up of *dharma*, *artha*, *kāma* and *mokṣa* and marked by the pursuit of results. The mark of this dharma is service to Bhagavān alone) **satām** (of Hari's servants) **nirmatsarāṇām** (free from lust, anger, greed, delusion, pride and envy) **paramaḥ** (the highest, for its aim is to set aside the scriptures of karma and jñāna) **dharmaḥ** (dharma [is described]) **atra** (in the *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam*) **tāpa-trayonmūlanam** (uprooting the sins that bring suffering from one's own body and mind, from other beings and from the forces of nature) **śivadam** (bestowing good fortune) **vāstavam** (eternal, supreme, nondual) **vastu vedyam** (the reality to be known) **atra** (in the *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam*) **śuśrūṣubhiḥ** (by those who wish to hear) **kṛtibhiḥ** (by those endowed with pious merit) **hṛdi tat-kṣaṇāt** (in the heart at once) **sadyaḥ** (without any delay) **īśvaraḥ avarudhyate** (the Lord is held captive).

92 Among them the chief deceit is the desire for liberation, by which devotion to Kṛṣṇa disappears.

Śrīdhara Svāmī's comment on this verse —

93 "By the prefix *pra* even the intention of liberation is excluded."[9]

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Among these, the chief cheating is the desire for liberation (*mukti*). That is why Svāmipāda pointed out that the prefix *pra-* means freedom even from the cheating that consists in aiming at liberation.

94 All good and bad deeds that obstruct devotion to Kṛṣṇa also belong to the soul's darkness of ignorance.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Śrī Caitanya and Nityānanda, the two brothers, are like the sun and the moon. Rising, They destroy the darkness in the hearts of the *jīvas*. The meaning of these verses is this. The *jīva* is by nature a spiritual truth. The *jīva*'s own original nature (*svadharma*) is devotion to Kṛṣṇa and love for Kṛṣṇa. Pious action (*puṇya*), sinful action (*pāpa*) and the aim of liberation have entered the *jīva* in the guise of his own nature and filled him with the qualities of darkness (*tamo-dharma*). All teachings that establish karma and jñāna are *kaitava*, cheating, and therefore serve the qualities of darkness. Before Caitanya and

Nityānanda rose, these qualities of darkness polluted the hearts of the *jīvas*. The two brothers rose, drove the darkness out of the cave of the *jīvas*' hearts and revealed the true reality (*vastu-tattva*).

The fruit of Nitāi and Gaura's mercy —

95 By Their grace this darkness is destroyed, and, destroying it, They reveal the Truth.

*What the true reality (*tattva-vastu*) is —*

96 The Truth is Kṛṣṇa, devotion to Kṛṣṇa in the form of pure love (prema), and the congregational chanting of the Holy Name, the embodiment of all bliss.

How They surpass the sun and the moon —

97 The sun and moon dispel the outer darkness and reveal outer things — pots, cloth and the like.

98 But the two Brothers wash away the darkness of the heart and bring one to meet the two *bhāgavatas*.

99 One *bhāgavata* is the great scripture *Bhāgavatam*; the other *bhāgavata* is the devotee, the vessel of the rasa of devotion.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
“The two *bhāgavatas*” are the scripture *Bhāgavatam* and the devotee *bhāgavata*, the vessel of the *rasa* of devotion. The brothers let the *jīvas* meet these two face to face, gave them the *rasa* of devotion, and were conquered by the *jīvas*' love.

100 Through these two *bhāgavatas* They give the rasa of devotion, and the Lord, dwelling in the devotee’s heart, is held captive by his love.

**Citrau* —*

101 One wonder is that the Two appeared at the same time; the other wonder is that They destroy the darkness in the cave of the heart.

102 This moon and sun, supremely kind, have risen in Gauḍa for the good fortune of the world.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Jagatera bhāgye, "for the good fortune of the world": the two brothers preached the dharma of love, and it will gradually spread throughout this world. This is the world's good fortune.

Gauḍe, "in Gauḍa": the kings of the Sena dynasty moved the throne of their empire to the region of Śrī Navadvīpa from the ancient city of Gauḍa in the Maldah district. That is why the region of Śrī Navadvīpa is called the land of Gauḍa. In this Gauḍa, on the eastern bank of the Gaṅgā, Mahāprabhu was born. Nityānanda Prabhu came there and joined Him, and together They rose.

**Śan-dau* —*

103 I worship the feet of these two Lords, from whom come the destruction of obstacles and the fulfilment of desire.

104 In these two verses I have made the auspicious worship; now, all of you, hear the meaning of the third verse.

105 Fearing the abundance of what could be said and the swelling of the book, I do not describe it at length; I tell the essence in few words.

(A saying of the ancients in their own scriptures, established by immemorial usage) —

106 "Speech that is measured and essential is true eloquence."

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Eloquence means speech of few words, full of substance.

Anubhāṣya.

mitam ca (free of idle talk, only to the point) **sāram ca** (pointing to the essence) **vacaḥ hi vāgmitā** (such speech is eloquence, the skill of speaking).

**Śan-dau* —*

107 By hearing this, one's heart will be freed from ignorance and other faults; deep love for Kṛṣṇa will arise, and one will find true satisfaction.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Instead of *kṛṣṇe gāḍha prema habe* ("there will be deep love for Kṛṣṇa"), a variant reading has *sarva-tattva jñāna haibe* ("there will be knowledge of all truths").

Thus ends the first chapter of the "Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya."

Anubhāṣya.

The *Mahābhārata* (Udyoga-parva, Chapter 43, verse 16) names twelve kinds of faults, and the *Viṣṇu Purāṇa* eighteen. The difficulty of knowing the *svarūpa*: (1) *ajñāna*, ignorance — the notion "I am the material body"; (2) *viparyāsa*, inversion — the conceit of being an enjoyer of matter; (3) *bheda*, division — absorption in a second thing; (4) fear, and taking on a distorted form; (5) grief. These five are ignorance.

The subject the book describes —

108–109 The greatness of Śrī Caitanya, Nityānanda and Advaita, Their devotees, devotion, the Holy Name and the truth of the rasa of prema — I have written of each separately, after careful consideration. Whoever hears it will know the essence of all Truth.

Anubhāṣya.

Thus ends the first chapter of the "Anubhāṣya."

110 Praying at the feet of Śrī Rūpa and Śrī Raghunātha, I, Kṛṣṇadāsa, narrate the *Caitanya-caritāmṛta*.

Notes

1. According to the *Anubhāṣya* (on 1.34): the gurus are Śrī Nityānanda, Śrī Raghunātha, Śrī Rūpa and others; the devotees — Śrīvāsa and others; the avatāras — Śrī Advaita and others; the manifestations — Śrī Nityānanda and others; the potencies — Śrī Gadādhara, Svarūpa Dāmodara, Jagadānanda and others. “Known as Kṛṣṇa Caitanya” qualifies the Lord Himself (*īśam*). The verse is explained in 1.32–1.82. ↩
2. According to the *Anubhāṣya* (on Ādi 7.6): the devotee in form is Śrī Gaurāṅga, who tastes His own sweetness; the devotee in essence (in the form of His brother) is Śrī Nityānanda; the devotee-avatāra is Śrī Advaita; the devotee is Śrīvāsa and others; the potency is Gadādhara, Svarūpa Dāmodara, Rāmānanda and others. Ascribed in the edition to Śrī Rūpa Gosvāmī. ↩
3. Bengali text as in the Gauḍīya Maṭha edition: «শাস্ত্র যে মত নিরূপণ». ↩
4. According to the *Anubhāṣya*: the knowledge is *sambandha*; the secret (*rahasya*) is prema-bhakti; its limb (*aṅga*) is sādhana-bhakti — hearing and the rest; all this the Lord speaks out of mercy, though Brahmā did not ask. ↩
5. According to the *Anubhāṣya*: Cintāmaṇi is the guru who showed the path (*śravaṇa-guru*), Somagiri the mantra-guru, and Kṛṣṇa the *caitya-śikṣā-guru*; *jayaśrī* is Vṛndāvaneśvarī; *līlā-svayaṁvara-rasa* — the joy of choosing Him out of deep love. ↩
6. The Bengali reading of 1.74 follows the Gauḍīya Maṭha edition, «অত্যৌৎসুক্যভৃতাত্মনাম্», which the *Anubhāṣya* glosses: “their minds greatly agitated by the eagerness to see”. ↩
7. The Gauḍīya Maṭha edition reads «…বাঞ্ছা আদি এই সব» (“and so on”). ↩
8. The verse says only «শ্রীমদ্ভাগবতে মহামুনিকৃতে» (*śrīmad-bhāgavate mahā-muni-kṛte*), “in the beautiful *Bhāgavata* composed by the great sage”; the sage is not named. ↩
9. Śrīdhara Svāmī’s comment on Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam 1.1.2 (heading in the edition). ↩
10. Our verse translation of 1.57 reads differently: it takes Cintāmaṇi and Somagiri as two different gurus, whereas for Bhaktivinoda *cintāmaṇi* is a simile for Somagiri. (The *Anubhāṣya* on this verse likewise distinguishes them: Cintāmaṇi showed the way, Somagiri was the initiating guru.) ↩
11. The edition has «রাজহসৌ প্রজাতীতিবৎ»: the «হ» is the *avagraha* (ঽ), as usual in this edition («রাজাঽসৌ», *rājā ’sau*), while «প্রজাতীতিবৎ» is a misprint for «প্রয়াতীতিবৎ» (*prayātīti-vat*): “as [one says] ‘the king is setting out’,” meaning

his retinue as well; compare the same example in Śrīdhara Svāmī's commentary on *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 2.9.32. ↩

12. The quotation in the *Anubhāṣya* is made up of lines from CC Madhya 20.168, in a different order and with the reading *prābhava-vilāsa* (the VCD translation of that verse has *prābhava*). ↩

“Śrī Caitanya-caritāmṛta”

Ādi-līlā

Chapter 2

The Auspicious Invocation Indicating the Object: Determining the Truth of Caitanya

(English translation from the Bengali, following the Gauḍīya Maṭha edition and the «Anubhāṣya», 2026 — draft)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya

Summary. In this second chapter the author reveals that Śrī Caitanya and Śrī Kṛṣṇa are one truth (*tattva*), and he proves that Brahman is the radiance of His body and the Paramātmā, the Supersoul, His part (*aṁśa*). He then proves that Śrī Kṛṣṇa is the supreme shelter of the *puruṣa-avatāras* and of all living beings, and so establishes that Kṛṣṇa is the original Nārāyaṇa. He shows why one must know Kṛṣṇa's intrinsic nature (*svarūpa*) and His three potencies. Kṛṣṇa's *svarūpa* manifests in two ways, as *prābhava* and *vaibhava*; the avatāras are of two kinds, *aṁśa-avatāras* and *śaktyāveśa-avatāras*; and His original pastimes are of two kinds, marked by childhood (*bālya*) and boyhood (*paugaṇḍa*). Having shown this, the author establishes that Kṛṣṇa in His youthful form (*kiśora*) is Himself the source of all avatāras. He also shows that the spiritual potency (*cit-śakti*) manifests as Vaikuṇṭha and the other abodes, the potency of *māyā* as countless universes, and the potency of living beings (*jīva-śakti*) as countless living beings. He establishes that Kṛṣṇa Caitanya is the cause of all causes and the beginning of all; He Himself has no beginning; He is the eternal form of being, consciousness and bliss, Kṛṣṇacandra Himself. And he concludes that every devotee must know the truth of his relationship with the Lord (*sambandha-jñāna*), that is, must know Kṛṣṇa's *svarūpa*, His three potencies and His *vilāsas*.

*Obeisance to Gaura through examining the conclusions (*siddhānta*) of devotion —*

1 I worship Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu, by whose mercy even an ignorant child can cross the ocean of philosophical conclusions, which teems with the crocodiles of various doctrines.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

I worship Śrī Caitanya Prabhu. By His mercy even an ignorant person easily crosses the ocean of conclusions (*siddhānta*), full of crocodiles and other beasts — the doctrines of every kind.

Anubhāṣya.

bālaḥ api (even one who is ignorant, a child) **yad-anugrahāt** (by whose mercy, that is, by whose compassion) **nānā-mata-grāha-vyāptam** (full of doctrines that are like crocodiles and sharks. These doctrines were proclaimed by Aulūkya, Jina, Buddha, Jaimini, Patañjali, Gotama, Kaṇāda, Kapila, Śaṅkara and Dattātreya; they quarrel with one another and are full of worldly self-interest) **siddhānta-sāgaram** (the ocean of reasoning) **taret** (crosses. That is, he counts the mixed doctrines of these worldly people as straw and comes to know Kṛṣṇa's pure feet) **śrī-caitanya-prabhum** ([that] Śrī Caitanya Prabhu) **vande** ([I] worship).

*A prayer for Śrī Caitanya's mercy, for the sake of *kīrtana* about Kṛṣṇa —*

2 O Śrī Caitanya, ocean of mercy! May the celestial Gaṅgā of the nectar of Your shining pastimes flow over the desert of my tongue. She is adorned with the lotuses of the loud glorification of Kṛṣṇa, of singing and of dancing; she is the place of delight for the rows of true devotees, who are like swans, cakravāka birds and bees; and her sweet murmur gladdens the ear.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

O Caitanyadeva, ocean of mercy! The nectar of Your pastimes is a shining Bhāgīrathī, the Gaṅgā. May it flow unceasingly through the field of my tongue, which is like a desert courtyard. Its lotuses are loud *kīrtana* about Kṛṣṇa, singing, dancing and the like; in it sport the saintly devotees — swans, *cakravāka* birds and bees; and its current makes a soft, sweet murmur that delights everyone's ears.

Anubhāṣya.

śrī-caitanya dayā-nidhe (O Śrī Caitanya, treasury of mercy) **kṛṣṇotkīrtana-gāna-nartana-kalā-pāthojani-bhrājitā** (shining, that is, adorned, with lotuses [*pāthojani*]. These lotuses are the arts [*kalā*]: *utkīrtana*, the loud glorification of Kṛṣṇa's name, form, qualities, pastimes and so on, together with singing and dancing) **sad-bhaktāvali-haṁsa-cakra-madhupa-śreṇī-vihārāspadam** (the place of play, the field of *vilāsa*, for the hosts of true, that is, pure devotees. They abide in various moods [*bhāvas*] and are like different flocks of swans, *cakravāka* birds and bees. The sense is that in these pastimes the hosts of pure devotees find the highest joy) **karṇānandi-kala-dhvaniḥ** (she whose gentle sound delights the ear and becomes an elixir for the devotees' ears. This gentle sound is the soft, sweet murmur of the streams of Hari's pastimes; the servants of Hari, who are like swans, *cakravākas* and bees, make it) **tava lasal-līlā-sudhā-svardhunī** (such is Your shining [*lasatī*, radiant] heavenly river [*svardhunī*], the Mandākinī, the heavenly Gaṅgā, full of the nectar of Gaura's pastimes) **me** (my) **jihvā-maru-prāṅgaṇe** (in the desert courtyard of the tongue. It has no taste, because it has been deprived of relishing the *rasa* of Gaura's pastimes) **vahatu** ([may she] flow).

3 Glory, glory to Śrī Caitanya! Glory to Nityānanda! Glory to Advaitacandra! Glory to all the devotees of Gaura!

Explanation of the third of the fourteen opening verses. Pointing out the Truth

—

4 Now I shall explain in detail the meaning of the third verse. It is an auspicious invocation that points to the Supreme Truth (*vastu-nirdeśa*).[1]

5 “There is no Truth in the world higher than Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya. That which the Upaniṣads call the non-dual Brahman is the effulgence of His body; the Puruṣa, the Supersoul who dwells within every heart, is His partial manifestation; and Bhagavān, full in all six opulences, is He Himself.”[2]

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

The One whom the Upaniṣads call the nondual Brahman is the radiance of my Lord's body. The One whom the scriptures of yoga call the Puruṣa who dwells within (*antaryāmī*), or Paramātmā, is a part (*aṁśa*) of my Lord. The One who is the shelter of Brahman and Paramātmā, the whole (*aṁśī*) of which they are parts, is called Bhagavān, full in the six opulences. My Lord is that Bhagavān Himself. Therefore in the world there is no Supreme Truth higher than Kṛṣṇa Caitanya.

Anubhāṣya.

upaniṣadi (in the Upaniṣad, that is, in a special branch of the Vedas, the highest of all, called *brahma-vidyā* [the knowledge of Brahman]. [The word *upaniṣad* is formed from the root *ṣad* with the prefixes *upa-* and *ni-* and the suffix *kvip*; the root means “to destroy,” “to go” and “to wear down.” Here *upa* means “having approached,” that is, having received it through the guru's instruction, and *ni* means “with resolve.” Some have approached *brahma-vidyā*, have resolutely fixed themselves in it and have lost their thirst for objects, both those that are seen and those promised in the Vedas. For them it destroys the seed of worldly existence — loosens it, wears it down, annihilates it — and leads them to Brahman.]) **yat advaitam** (that which [is called] nondual, without a second), **brahma** (Brahman), **tat api** (that too) **asya** (His [Gaura-Kṛṣṇa's]) **tanu-bhā** (is the radiance [of His transcendental body]) **yaḥ ātmā** (He who is the Self [the Paramātmā, the Controller of all living beings and the rest]), **antar-yāmī puruṣaḥ** (the Puruṣa who dwells within), **saḥ asya aṁśa-vibhavaḥ** (is His partial manifestation [one of His opulences, a particular expression of His all-pervasiveness]) **iha** ([in this examination of the truth]) **yaḥ ṣaḍ-aiśvaryaiḥ** (He who in the six opulences, that is, in the six kinds of lordship — complete wealth, strength, fame, beauty, knowledge and renunciation —) **pūrṇaḥ** (is full [needs nothing, is perfect]), **saḥ ayam** (He, this Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya), **svayam bhagavān** (is Bhagavān Himself) **iha** ([in the world, in the examination of the truth, or in the Kali age]) **caitanyāt kṛṣṇāt** (than Kṛṣṇa Caitanya) **param** (other) **para-tattvam** (supreme truth [better shelter]) **na** (there is none).

(Brahman is the goal of the scriptures of knowledge (*jñāna-śāstras*), and Paramātmā the goal of the scriptures of yoga. In truth they are equal to Bhagavān. But the view differs with the qualification (*adhikāra*) of the one who sees, and so they are only two aspects of Bhagavān's form — His spiritual radiance and His part. They are not the whole, complete Reality, endowed with all qualities and potencies; only Bhagavān is that.)

With this verse one should compare the following verse from Śrī Jīva Prabhu's *Tattva-sandarbha* (8): “His being, purely spiritual, receives the name Brahman in some places of the Vedas. His part is the Puruṣa, who subdues *māyā* and through His own parts displays variety. His one form sports in the spiritual sky (*paravyoma*) under the name Nārāyaṇa. May that Śrī Kṛṣṇa, Bhagavān Himself, grant love of God (*prema*) here to those who take shelter of His feet.”

Some are deprived of beholding the being and bliss (*sat* and *ānanda*) of Bhagavān, who is full of *sat*, *cit* and *ānanda*. They rely only on the function of consciousness (*saṁvit*) and, pursuing the Truth endowed with spiritual pastimes, in the end see Brahman. Others are deprived of beholding Bhagavān's bliss (*ānanda*). They rely only on the functions of being and consciousness (*sat* and *cit*) and, pursuing the same Truth, in the end see Paramātmā. Thus Bhagavān is the form of being, consciousness and bliss and of divine pastimes. The spiritual radiance of His body is Brahman, devoid of spiritual *vilāsa* and free from *māyā*,[12] and the being that is a portion of His majesty (*aiśvarya*) is Paramātmā.

Examining the Truth —

6 Brahman, Paramātmā and Bhagavān are the three *anuvādas* (that which is spoken of); the effulgence of the body, the partial manifestation and His own form are the three *vidheyas* (that which is stated about them).

7 First the *anuvāda* is stated, and afterwards the *vidheya* is set down. In this way I shall tell the meaning of the verse; hear now the explanation according to scripture.

Kṛṣṇa, and the truth about Caitanya —

8 Kṛṣṇa is Bhagavān Himself, the supreme truth among all forms of Viṣṇu (*viṣṇu-tattva*). He is fullness of knowledge, fullness of bliss and the highest greatness.

9 He whom the *Bhāgavatam* glorifies as the son of Nanda — that same Kṛṣṇa has descended as Śrī Caitanya Gosāñi.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

According to the science of poetics (*alaṅkāra-śāstra*), one first states what is already known (the *anuvāda*) and only then indicates what is said about it (the *vidheya*). In many places the Vedas and other scriptures speak of three subjects — Brahman, Paramātmā and Bhagavān. These truths are therefore already known, and they must be taken as the *anuvāda*. But it is not yet known that Brahman is the radiance of Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya's body, Paramātmā His part and Bhagavān His *svarūpa*. So one must first state these three *anuvādas* and then, after examining the meaning of the scriptures, establish the *vidheya*. The conclusion of the scriptures is this: among the *viṣṇu-tattvas* the Supreme Truth is Bhagavān Kṛṣṇacandra Himself. He whom the *Bhāgavatam* sings of as the son of Nanda has descended as Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya. Therefore, when I discuss the truth, I shall speak of Kṛṣṇa and Caitanya as entirely non-different. And so the Supreme Truth appears in three ways — as Brahman, Paramātmā and Bhagavān Himself — and I may rightly call all three special manifestations of Śrī Caitanya.

Examining Brahman, Paramātmā and Bhagavān —

10 In His particular manifestations He bears three names: Brahman, Paramātmā and Bhagavān Himself.

Anubhāṣya.

Prabhu Śrī Jīva Gosvāmī writes in the *Bhagavat-sandarbha* (3): “Thus, when [the Truth] displays all Its distinguishing features, It is Bhagavān: He is Its full appearance and therefore the form of the undivided Truth. Brahman, however, is an incomplete appearance of that same Truth, for in Brahman the form with distinguishing features is not manifest. ‘O sage! The sound *bha* carries two meanings, *sambhartā* and *bhartā*; the meanings of the sound *ga* are *netā*, *gamayitā* and *sraṣṭā*. Beings dwell in Him, the Self of beings, the Self of all, and He, the Imperishable, abides in all beings without exception — this is the meaning of the sound *va*. Knowledge, potency, strength, lordship, power and splendor in their fullness, without inferior qualities and the like — this is what the word Bhagavān denotes.’ *Sambhartā* is He who nourishes His devotees; *bhartā*, He who sustains and establishes; *netā*, He who leads to the fruit of devotion to Him, that is, to *prema*; *gamayitā*, He who brings to His own abode; *sraṣṭā*, He who gives rise to various qualities in His devotees. (4) He Himself is not a cause: He is wholly absorbed in the *vilāsa* of His own potency

(*svarūpa-śakti*) alone and is therefore indifferent to the world. Yet through the Puruṣa, His part, also called the Paramātmā, who sets *prakṛti* and the *jīvas* in motion, He becomes the cause of the world's creation, maintenance and so on. Know this as the form of Bhagavān. <…> As the efficient cause, He makes the *jīvas*, particles of Himself, enter bodies and the rest and so brings them to life. Impelled by Him, all the elements — *pradhāna* and the others, indicated by bodies and so on — move, that is, set about their work. Know this as the form of the Paramātmā. The *jīva* is an *ātmā*, a self, and compared with him He is the supreme (*parama*); therefore the word Paramātmā denotes just Him, the *jīva*'s companion. That same Truth is present as the accompanying presence (*anvaya*) in dream and the other states; outside them It likewise abides in the pure potency called the *jīva*; and the particle *ca* (‘and’) shows that It also abides beyond them, separately (*vyatireka*), remaining by Itself. Know this as the form of Brahman.”

Bhagavān is endowed with all potencies and reveals Himself in all His fullness; therefore He is the undivided Truth. In Brahman such a form with distinguishing features is not manifest; therefore Brahman is only a partial, incomplete appearance of Bhagavān. O sage! The first sound of the word Bhagavān, *bha*, has two meanings, *sambhartā* and *bhartā*; the sound *ga* means *netā*, *gamayitā* and *sraṣṭā*. Beings dwell in the universal Self, the Self of beings, and He, the imperishable Puruṣa, dwells in all beings without exception — this is the meaning of the sound *va*. Boundless knowledge, potency, strength, lordship, power and splendor, without inferior qualities — this is what the word Bhagavān denotes. *Sambhartā* means “He who nourishes His devotees”; *bhartā*, “He who sustains and establishes”; *netā*, “He who leads to the fruit of devotion to Him, that is, to *prema*”; *gamayitā*, “He who brings to His own abode”; *sraṣṭā*, “He who gives rise to various qualities in His devotees.” There is a Truth that is not Itself a cause: through Its own potency (*svarūpa-śakti*) It has a single *vilāsa* and is entirely indifferent to the world. And yet, through the Puruṣa, Its part, who sets *prakṛti* and the *jīvas* in motion, It becomes the cause of the world's birth, maintenance and so on. Know this as the truth of Bhagavān (*bhagavat-tattva*). There is One who, as the efficient cause, makes the *jīvas*, particles of Himself, enter the world and so brings the world to life. Impelled by Him, the elements — *pradhāna* and the others, indicated by bodies and so on — remain in place and each sets about its own work. Know Him as the Paramātmā. By his intrinsic nature the *jīva* is an *ātmā*, and the One higher than the *jīva*

is *parama*; therefore the word Paramātmā reveals Him as the *jīva*'s eternal companion. There is a Truth that is present as the accompanying presence (*anvaya*) in waking, dreaming and deep sleep. In *samādhi* It abides [as] the pure *jīva-śakti*, yet afterwards It also abides beyond it, separately (*vyatireka*), remaining by Itself. Know It as Brahman.

*(*Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 1.2.11)*

11 "The knowers of the Truth call the non-dual knowledge the Truth; it is named Brahman, Paramātmā and Bhagavān." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 1.2.11)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Those who know the truth call nondual knowledge the Truth. This nondual knowledge is first perceived as Brahman, then as Paramātmā, and thirdly as Bhagavān.

Anubhāṣya.

The sages headed by Śaunaka asked Sūta, the disciple of Śukadeva, six questions. This verse answers the second of them: "What is the essence of the scriptures?"

tattva-vidaḥ (those who know the truth) **tat** ([just] that) **tattvam** (the Truth), **advayam jñānam** (nondual knowledge [one, purely spiritual]), **vadanti** (they call) **yat** ([This nondual knowledge]) **brahma iti** ([in some places] Brahman), **paramātmā iti** ([in some places] Paramātmā), **bhagavān iti ca** ([and in some places] Bhagavān) **śabdyate** (is called).

The sense is this: nondual knowledge realized through the function of knowledge alone is Brahman; nondual knowledge realized through the functions of being and consciousness (*sat* and *cit*) is Paramātmā; and that same nondual knowledge realized through the functions of being, consciousness and bliss (*sat*, *cit* and *ānanda*) is Bhagavān.

Bhagavān's devotees know that the embodiment of nondual knowledge is Vrajendranandana, the son of the king of Vraja. In Kṛṣṇa's name, form, qualities and pastimes they see nothing second. If one separates Kṛṣṇa from His transcendental name, form, qualities and pastimes, a mundane conception of Viṣṇu's body arises; this is the very absence of nondual knowledge. Things other than Kṛṣṇa are not Viṣṇu, and nondual knowledge is not in them. Therefore everything other than Kṛṣṇa is separated from Kṛṣṇa, that is, from nondual knowledge, by *māyā*, or dual knowledge.[13] So it becomes liable to fall under

māyā's control, and is therefore subject to *māyā*, or dual knowledge. In all of Kṛṣṇa's manifestations (*prakāśas*) and forms of *vilāsa*, however, there is no knowledge of anything second; therefore they are *viṣṇu-tattva* and the masters of *māyā*. The yogīs regard only one state as free from knowledge of a second: the unmixed union (*yoga*) of the pure soul with the Paramātmā, the embodiment of nondual knowledge. The *jñānīs*, for their part, regard as nondual knowledge, as Brahman, a featureless knowledge free from all distinctions — internal, homogeneous and heterogeneous (*svagata*, *sajātīya* and *vijātīya*). See the *Gauḍīya-bhāṣya* on the *Bhāgavatam* by the author of this commentary, pp. 88–89.

(1) Examining Brahman —

12 That which the Upaniṣads call the spotless Brahman is the pure radiance of the rays of His body.

Anubhāṣya.

Muṇḍaka Upaniṣad, second *muṇḍaka*, second *khaṇḍa*, mantras 9–11: "In the highest, golden sheath dwells Brahman, stainless and undivided. It is pure, the light of lights; those who know the Self know It. There the sun does not shine, nor the moon and stars, nor do these lightnings shine — how then this fire? As He shines, everything shines after Him; by His light all this is illumined. Truly, Brahman is this immortal one: Brahman in front, Brahman behind, Brahman to the right and to the left, below and above — spread everywhere. Truly, Brahman is all this, this most excellent universe."

13 As the sun appears to fleshly eyes as mere brilliance without features, so on the path of knowledge one cannot perceive His particular features.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Nirviśeṣa. A *viśeṣa* is a feature by which a thing is recognized; what lacks such features is *nirviśeṣa*, featureless.

*(*Brahma-saṁhitā* 5.40)*

14 "I worship Govinda, the original Person. Brahman — undivided, infinite and complete, distinct from all the opulences of countless universes, their

earths and all else — is the effulgence of Him, the Almighty." (Brahma-saṁhitā, 5.40)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
I worship Govinda, the original Puruṣa. From His radiance comes Brahman — undivided, infinite, boundless, and distinct from the countless opulences of millions and millions of universes, such as their lands.

Anubhāṣya.
Śrī Brahmā set forth the truth and greatness of Śrī Govinda in the form of a prayer; it is given in the fifth chapter of the *Brahma-saṁhitā*.

jagad-aṇḍa-koṭi-koṭiṣu (in millions and millions of universes, that is, in countless universes) **aśeṣa-vasudhādi-vibhūti-bhinnam** (distinct, that is, set apart, by the opulences — the countless universes and all else that has form and so on) **niṣkalam** ([that which is] without parts: undivided, perfect), **anantam** (beyond limited knowledge), **aśeṣa-bhūtam** (boundless —) **tat brahma** (that Brahman) **prabhavataḥ** ([of the One endowed with power]) **yasya** (whose [Govinda's]) **prabhā** (is the radiance of the body) **tam ādi-puruṣam govindam aham bhajāmi** (that original Puruṣa, Govinda, I worship).

15 That Brahman whose glory is spread through millions upon millions of universes is the radiance of Govinda's body.

16 I worship that Govinda; He is my Lord. By His grace I (Brahmā) have the power to create.

Anubhāṣya.
"I" is Brahmā.

*(*Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 11.6.47)*

17 "Sages clothed by the wind, ascetics who keep their seed drawn upward, peaceful, pure renunciants — they go to the abode called Brahman." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 11.6.47)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Naked sages who practice austerity and keep their seed, and peaceful, pure *sannyāsīs*, attain the abode of Brahman.

Anubhāṣya.

Uddhava learned that Śrī Kṛṣṇa would soon withdraw from view, and in a prayer at His holy feet he said: devotees reach Kṛṣṇa's feet with ease, while *sannyāsīs* who impose hardships on themselves win the fruit of their practice by hard labor — and attain only Brahmaloka.

vāta-vasanāḥ (clothed in the wind, that is, naked, without garments) **śramaṇāḥ** (mendicant monks who emaciate the body) **ūrdhva-manthinaḥ** (who keep their seed) **śāntāḥ** (those whose minds are fixed on Brahman alone) **amalāḥ** (free from the filth of sense objects) **sannyāsinaḥ** (*sannyāsīs*) **te** (they) **brahmākhyam** (called Brahman [impersonal]) **dhāma** (the abode) **yānti** (attain).

(2) Examining Paramātmā —

18 The Supersoul, the Indweller, of whom the scriptures of yoga speak, is a partial manifestation of Govinda.

Anubhāṣya.

Bhagavān is a form full of spiritual *vilāsa*. He is the *turīya-vigraha*, the form beyond the three states, and so He Himself has no part in any affairs of Devī-dhāma, the material world: He controls *pradhāna* and the *jīvas* through the *puruṣa-avatāras*. As soon as the *jīva* understands the truth of the three *puruṣa-avatāras*, he is freed from perceiving the twenty-four elements of *māyā*. Kṣīrodakaśāyī Mahā-Viṣṇu is the indwelling Lord (*antaryāmī*) of each *jīva*; Garbhodakaśāyī Mahā-Viṣṇu is the indwelling Lord of the aggregate *jīva* of the universe; and the creator of the universes, Kāraṇārṇavaśāyī Mahā-Viṣṇu, is also an indwelling Lord. These three *puruṣa-avatāras* carry out the creation of Devī-dhāma and govern this partial work. The scriptures of yoga prescribe union (*yoga*) with Paramātmā in order to pass beyond the twenty-four elements of *māyā*. Thus the indwelling Puruṣa, Paramātmā, is only a partial manifestation (*aṁśa-vibhūti*) of Govinda.

19 As one sun is reflected in countless crystals, so Govinda’s portion, the Supersoul, is manifest in every living being.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

A single sun, reflected in countless pieces of crystal, shows itself in each as a separate image. So too Paramātmā, a part of Govinda, manifests in countless *jīvas*.

Anubhāṣya.

The one sun stays in its place and is reflected in countless pieces of crystal as countless images. So too the one Śrī Govinda, eternally manifest in Goloka-Vṛndāvana, manifests in the hearts of countless *jīvas* as the indwelling Paramātmā, the Puruṣa whom the *jīva* is meant to serve. The three mantras that begin "Two birds, inseparable friends…"[14] speak of two birds on one tree, the *jīvātmā* and Paramātmā; they stand in the relation of the servant and the One served. Paramātmā makes the *jīvātmā* taste the fruits of karma, but He Himself does not taste such fruits. When the *jīva* stops enjoying the fruits of karma and comes to know the glory of Paramātmā, whom he is meant to serve, he becomes stainless and attains the supreme equality — Vaikuṇṭha.

*(*Bhagavad-gītā* 10.42)*

20 "But what need have you, Arjuna, of all this detailed knowledge? By one portion of Myself I pervade and support this entire universe." (Bhagavad-gītā, 10.42)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

O Arjuna, what more need I say? With one part of Myself, as Paramātmā, I have entered the whole universe and abide in it.

Anubhāṣya.

Bhagavān explained to Arjuna in many ways the truth of His relationship with all that exists (*sambandha-tattva*), and in this verse He states it briefly.

atha vā (or else) **arjuna** (O Arjuna) **bahunā** (with many details, taught one by one) **jñātena kim** (what use is it [for you] to know? That is, enough) **idam** (this [made of spirit and matter]) **kṛtsnam** (entire) **jagat** (universe) **ekāṁśena** (with one part [the part called the Puruṣa, the indwelling Lord of *prakṛti* and the rest]) **viṣṭabhya** (supporting [as its foundation, bearing it; as its overseer, governing it; as its controller, subduing it; as the all-pervading one, pervading it]), **aham** (I [Bhagavān]) **sthitaḥ** (abide).

*(*Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 1.9.42)*

21 (Grandsire Bhīṣma said:) “O Śrī Kṛṣṇa! Having cast off the illusion of ‘difference’ between all Your forms, I have attained You, the Unborn, who abide in the heart of each of the embodied beings You have created — like the one sun, which each eye sees in its own way.” (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 1.9.42)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Bhīṣma said: “O Kṛṣṇa, one and the same sun appears to each eye as a separate, distinct object. So too Paramātmā, Your part, abides in the heart of every embodied being, and people take Him to be a separate truth. But when they become *ātma-kalpita* — Your own, that is, when they know themselves to be Your servants — this delusion of difference vanishes. I have come to know Paramātmā as Your part, and so I too am free from the delusion of difference: I have gained knowledge of You, who are unborn in Your own nature (*svarūpa*).”[11]

Anubhāṣya.

Yudhiṣṭhira went to Bhīṣma wishing to ask him about *dharma*, and Śrī Kṛṣṇa followed him on Arjuna's chariot. Other divine and brahminical sages (*devarṣis* and *brahmarṣis*) also gathered there to see Bhīṣma. Bhīṣma answered some of Yudhiṣṭhira's questions. Then, when the time of his departure came, he praised Śrī Kṛṣṇa, who stood before him, in many verses; this verse is one of them.

prati-dṛśam (to each eye [of beings in different places]) **naikadhā** (in many ways [because they abide in different places]), **ekam arkam iva** (like the one sun) **ātma-kalpitānām** (created by Himself) **śarīra-bhājām** (of the embodied) **hṛdi hṛdi** (in each heart) **dhiṣṭhitam** (abiding), **tam imam ajam** (this Unborn One [Śrī Kṛṣṇa]) **vidhūta-bheda-mohaḥ** (one whose delusion of difference is cast off [*vidhūta*, removed]. This delusion is the idea that Bhagavān's name, form, qualities and pastimes are different from Him. It shows itself as a perception of multiplicity: one imagines that Bhagavān's form divides into different forms — *prakāśas* and *vilāsa-mūrtis* — in order to become all-pervading) **aham** (I) **samadhigataḥ asmi** (have fully realized [attained]).

(3) Examining Bhagavān —

22 That very Govinda is Śrī Caitanya Gosāñi Himself. There is none so merciful in delivering the souls.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

By using the word *sākṣāt* (directly, in person) here, the author establishes that Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya is Govinda Himself, not a *prakāśa* or *vilāsa* of Govinda.

Anubhāṣya.

In the *Caitanya Upaniṣad*: "Gaura is the Self of all, the Great Person, the Great Soul, the great yogī; He is beyond the three modes and is the embodiment of pure goodness (*sattva*). He will reveal devotion in the world." In the *Śvetāśvatara*: "He is the supreme great Lord of lords, the supreme Deity of deities, the supreme Master of masters, higher than the highest. We know Him as God, the Lord of the worlds, worthy of praise." "Truly, the great Lord is the Puruṣa. He impels the intelligence toward this purest attainment; He is the Ruler, the imperishable Light." "When the seer sees the golden-colored Creator, the Lord, the Puruṣa, the source of Brahman…" "O Great Person! I bow to Your lotus feet. They are always to be meditated on; they destroy humiliation and fulfill desires; they are the refuge of the holy places, praised by Śiva and Brahmā, and they are the shelter. They destroy the sufferings of servants; O Protector of the surrendered, they are the boat on the ocean of birth and death. O most righteous One! At the word of a worthy one You gave up a glorious kingdom, so hard to renounce and coveted even by the gods, and went to the forest; You ran after the illusory deer that Your beloved desired…" "Thus, O Great Person, You descend as human, animal, sage, demigod and fish, sustain the worlds, slay the enemies of the world and protect the *dharma* proper to each age. But in Kali You came concealed (*channa*), and therefore You are Triyuga" — these are Prahlāda's words.[15]

There is no need to cite here the evidence already quoted in the *Caritāmṛta*. In the *Kṛṣṇa-yāmala*: "In the holy place Navadvīpa I shall become the son of Śacī." In the *Brahma-yāmala*: "Or else I shall descend to earth in the form of My devotee and appear in Māyā[16] in the Kali age, when *saṅkīrtana* begins." In the *Vāyu Purāṇa*: "When *saṅkīrtana* begins in the Kali age, I shall become the son of Śacī." In the *Ananta-saṁhitā*: "That same Bhagavān Kṛṣṇa, the beloved of Rādhikā's life, who at the beginning of creation is the Lord of the universe, became Gaura, O Maheśvarī!" And so on.

Nārāyaṇa, the Lord of Paravyoma, is described in all the scriptures —

23 In the spiritual sky dwells the Lord called Nārāyaṇa — Bhagavān, full in the six opulences, the beloved of Lakṣmī.

24 He whom the Vedas, the *Bhāgavatam*, the Upaniṣads and the Āgamas call "the complete Truth", and who has no equal —

Anubhāṣya.

In the *Ṛg-veda-saṁhitā* (1.22.20): "The sages always see that supreme abode of Viṣṇu, like an eye spread across the sky," and so on. In the *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* (11.3.34–35): "You are the best knowers of Brahman; tell us, then, of the foundation of Brahman, the Paramātmā called Nārāyaṇa." "It is the cause of the creation, maintenance and dissolution of this world, but Itself has no cause. It is present in dreaming, waking and deep sleep, and also beyond them. By It the body, the senses, the life air and the heart come alive and act. Know It as the Supreme, O king." In the *Nārāyaṇa-atharvaśira Upaniṣad*: "From Nārāyaṇa alone everything is born, by Nārāyaṇa it is set in motion, in Nārāyaṇa it dissolves. Nārāyaṇa is eternal. All this is Nārāyaṇa alone — all that has been and all that will be. Pure is the one God Nārāyaṇa, and there is no second." In the *Nārāyaṇa Upaniṣad*: "He from whom the mother of the world was born." In the *Hayaśīrṣa-pañcarātra*: "The Paramātmā is the Lord Hari."

A difference in vision brings a difference in what is seen; a difference in means brings a difference in how the goal is perceived —

25 Him the devotees behold through bhakti-yoga, as the gods behold the sun in its own form.

26 Those who worship Him on the paths of knowledge and yoga realize Him as Brahman and as the Supersoul.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Bhagavān's eternal form (*nitya-vigraha*) cannot be seen with the material senses or by the efforts of knowledge. Only devotees, through *bhakti-yoga*, that is, through *bhakti-rati*, the loving attraction of devotion, become fit to see it. Here is an example. The sun is an object that has a form. Ordinary eyes of flesh, or

demoniac eyes, cannot see that form; but the divine eyes of the demigods pierce the network of the sun's rays and see it. Those who seek Bhagavān on the path of knowledge and on the path of yoga can follow only Brahman, the network of rays of the eternal form, and Paramātmā, His part. They do not become fit to see the spiritual eternal form.

27 By the differences in worship we know the greatness of the Lord; that is why He is compared to the sun.

(1) Kṛṣṇa and Nārāyaṇa are one, yet differ in Their pastimes —

28 That Nārāyaṇa is not different from Kṛṣṇa's own form: They are one and the same Person, differing only in shape.

29 This One has two arms, while that One has four; this One holds the flute, that One the disc and the other emblems.[3]

*(*Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 10.14.14)*

30 "Are You not Nārāyaṇa? For You are the Self of all embodied beings, O Lord, and the witness of all the worlds. Nārāyaṇa is Your portion — so called because His abode is the waters born of Nara; and that too is true, not Your māyā." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 10.14.14)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

O Adhīśa, Supreme Lord, You are the witness of all the worlds. You are the Self of all embodied beings, that is, what is dearest to them; are You not, then, my father Nārāyaṇa? The water born of Nara is called *nāra*, and He whose resting place (*ayana*) is in it is Nārāyaṇa. He is Your *aṅga*, that is, Your part. None of Your parts — Kāraṇābdhiśāyī, Kṣīrodaśāyī and Garbhodaśāyī — is subject to *māyā*: They are the masters of *māyā*, the supreme Truth beyond *māyā*.

Anubhāṣya.

Brahmā stole the calves, then came to understand the truth about Śrī Kṛṣṇa and offered Him praise; this is one of the verses of that prayer.

adhīśa (O Adhīśa [Lord, endowed with majesty greater than that of the three *puruṣa-avatāras*]!) **tvam** (You) **nārāyaṇaḥ** (are Nārāyaṇa (He from whom

comes the movement [*ayana*], that is, the activity, of *nāra*)) **sarva-dehinām** (of all the embodied [of all living beings]) **ātmā** (the Self; [and so]) **tvam** (You) **nārāyaṇaḥ** ((He whose shelter [*ayana*] is *nāra*, that is, the totality of *jīvas*: the third *puruṣa-avatāra*, who abides in the Ocean of Milk)) **asi na hi** (are You not?) **akhila-loka-sākṣī** (the witness of all the worlds [the indwelling Lord of the aggregate [of *jīvas*]]) **tvam** (You) **nārāyaṇaḥ** ((He who knows [*ayase*] *nāra*: the second *puruṣa-avatāra*, who abides in the Garbhodaka)) **nara-bhū-jalāyanāt** ([because His shelter is the *arthas*, that is, the twenty-four elements that arose from Nara, the Paramātmā, and also the water born of Nara]) **nārāyaṇaḥ** (Nārāyaṇa [that celebrated first *puruṣa-avatāra*, who abides in the Kāraṇodaka] —) **saḥ api** (He too) **tava aṅgam** (is Your *aṅga* [part]) **tat ca api satyam** (And this too is true), **na tava eva māyā** (and not at all *māyā* [not transient, like what belongs to *māyā*]).

(Even when You descend as an avatāra, *māyā* cannot touch Your spiritual body. O Kṛṣṇa, You are the original Nārāyaṇa, and the Puruṣa and the other avatāras are Your parts; You alone are the whole. These avatāras are limbs (*aṅgas*), and You are the possessor of the limbs (*aṅgī*) — such is my conviction.)

Explanation of the verse —

31 Having stolen the boys and the calves, Brahmā had committed an offence; to have it forgiven, he begged for mercy:

*Since Kṛṣṇa is the original Nārāyaṇa, all the *puruṣa-avatāras* are contained in Him —*

32 “From the lotus of Your navel I was born; You are my father and mother, and I am Your son.

33 A father and mother do not hold a child’s offences against him. Forgive my offence and be merciful to me.”

34 Kṛṣṇa said: “Brahmā, your father is Nārāyaṇa. I am a cowherd boy — how can you be My son?”

The first proof —

35 Brahmā said: “Are You not Nārāyaṇa? You are Nārāyaṇa — hear the reason.

36 You are the Self of all living beings, as many as there are in the material and spiritual creation; You are their original source.[4]

Anubhāṣya.

All the various things that have arisen from *prakṛti* through the modes are material (*prākṛta*). There are also the eternal varieties of spiritual *vilāsa*, which the modes cannot disturb; this is the transcendental (*aprākṛta*) creation. The hosts of liberated *jīvas* who belong to the transcendental manifestation are devoted to serving Kṛṣṇa. The conditioned *jīvas* are subject to time, are under the sway of the three modes and belong to the material creation. The liberated *jīvas* of the transcendental manifestation are always engaged in serving Kṛṣṇa, while the material *jīvas* are always bound to taste happiness and distress. Saṅkarṣaṇa is the original *svarūpa* of both the liberated and the conditioned *jīvas*. From His marginal potency (*taṭastha-śakti*) come various *jīvas*; some are turned toward service and others away from it, and all abide in various forms. When liberated, the *jīva* serves Bhagavān in the transcendental kingdom: in the five different *rasas* he abides under the protection of the *āśraya* (the shelter). In the kingdom of enjoyment, however, he is gripped by ignorance (*avidyā*): he thinks himself the enjoyer and sees in other things a “woman” (*yoṣid-buddhi*), that is, an object to enjoy. Both kinds of *jīvas* are manifestations of the transformation of the *taṭastha-śakti*; both depend on the Possessor of potency.

37 As the earth is the cause and the support of all earthen pots, so You are the cause of all souls, and You are the shelter of all.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

The material (*prākṛta*) creation lies within the bounds of *māyā*, *prakṛti*. “Earth, water, fire, air, ether, mind, intelligence and false ego — these are the eight divisions of My separated *prakṛti*. This is the lower…” (*Bhagavad-gītā* 7.4–5). According to these words of the *Gītā*, all of it belongs to *māyā*, that is, is material: both the subtle world — mind, intelligence and false ego — and the five great elements beginning with earth. The pure *jīva* and the spiritual world are

transcendental (*aprākṛta*). There are two worlds, the material and the transcendental, and two kinds of *jīvas*, the conditioned and the pure; You are the Self of them all, and therefore their original *svarūpa*. Earth is the cause and shelter of all pots; so too You alone are the *nidāna* of the *jīvas*, that is, their cause and shelter.

Anubhāṣya.

All-pervading clay is the material cause of the various pots it pervades. So too from Bhagavān, nondual knowledge, all the hosts of *jīvas* are eternally manifest, like pots. Bhagavān, the cause of all causes, always abides [in them] as the cause of the *jīvas*. The Śruti "The eternal among the eternal, the conscious among the conscious"[17] shows that the shelter of all that exists is the Supreme Truth.

The Viśiṣṭādvaitins define the subject of Vedānta like this. The *jīva*, the possessor of the subtle and gross bodies, is seen in three states. So too the spiritual and the material worlds appear in two states, separately from Bhagavān's *svarūpa*, and so establish His nonduality endowed with distinguishing features. The spiritual world is full of Bhagavān's associates, and the material world is the field of enjoyment for the conditioned *jīvas*, who have turned away from Bhagavān. Bhagavān's internal potency is the cause of the variety of His retinue; His external potency has created the world born of the material modes. The material world is the gross, external part of Bhagavān's body, and the world of *jīvas* the subtle part of His body. Bhagavān is the possessor (*aṅgī*) of both kinds of parts. Gauḍīya philosophy (*Gauḍīya-darśana*) has established inconceivable oneness and difference (*acintya-bhedābheda*), present at once in the relation of cause and effect: between the Possessor of His own potency (*svarūpa-śakti*) and the two worlds, which are transformations of the spiritual and the non-spiritual potencies.

38 The word *nāra* means the aggregate of all souls, and the word *ayana* means their shelter.

39 Therefore You are the original Nārāyaṇa. That is one reason; hear now the second.

The second proof —

40 The Puruṣas and the other avatāras are the lords of the souls, but Your majesty is unlimited, greater than that of Them all.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
"The Puruṣa and the other avatāras" are the three *puruṣa-avatāras*: Kāraṇābdhiśāyī, Garbhodakaśāyī and Kṣīrodakaśāyī.

41 Therefore You are the supreme Lord, the father of all; it is by Your power that They protect the world.

42 Since You protect those who are the shelter of the nāras, You are the original Nārāyaṇa.

The third proof —

43 Hear the third reason, O Śrī Bhagavān. There are unlimited universes and many abodes — the Vaikuṇṭhas and others.

44 All the beings in them, and their deeds in past, present and future — You see it all; You are the witness, You know the heart of everything.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
Ithe (in them) means in the material multitudes of universes and in the transcendental abodes, Vaikuṇṭha and the rest. You are the one witness, that is, the seer, of all the deeds of the conditioned and the pure *jīvas* — past, future and present.

45 By Your glance all the worlds exist; if You did not look on them, nothing could either stand or move.

46 Since You see the ways of all the nāras, by that too You are the original Nārāyaṇa."

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Yāte means “because”: because You see the *jīvas*, You are Nārāyaṇa, the shelter (*ayana*) of *nāra*. Brahmā establishes by three arguments that Kṛṣṇa is the original Nārāyaṇa. First: Kṛṣṇa is the *nidāna* (cause) and shelter of all *jīvas*, and therefore He is the original Nārāyaṇa. Second: the Lord of all *jīvas* is the Kāraṇābdhiśāyī Puruṣa; the Self of the aggregate *jīva*, that is, of Hiraṇyagarbha, is the Garbhodaśāyī Puruṣa; and the indwelling Lord, the Self of the individual *jīva*, is the Kṣīrodaśāyī Puruṣa. These three Puruṣas and Their avatāras receive Their power from Kṛṣṇa; He is its original source and thus the shelter of *nāra*, and therefore He is the original Nārāyaṇa. Third: in countless universes, in Vaikuṇṭha and in the other abodes, Kṛṣṇa is the witness of the deeds of the conditioned and the pure *jīvas* in all three times; thus He is the shelter of *nāra*, and therefore the original Nārāyaṇa.

47 Kṛṣṇa said: “Brahmā, I do not understand your words. Nārāyaṇa is He who dwells in the hearts of living beings and in the waters.”

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Jīva-hṛdi means in the heart of the individual and of the aggregate *jīva*. *Jale* (in the water) means in the Kāraṇābdhi, the Garbhodaka and the Kṣīrodaka.

48 Brahmā said: “The Nārāyaṇa who lies in the waters and dwells in the beings — in all these forms He is Your portion. What I say is true.

*The marks of the three *puruṣa-avatāras* —*

49 Kāraṇodakaśāyī, Garbhodakaśāyī and Kṣīrodakaśāyī Viṣṇu create through māyā; therefore all of Them are *māyī*, masters of māyā.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Tāte saba māyī: because these three Puruṣas create through *māyā*, They are *māyī*, that is, the masters of *māyā*.

50 These three, who lie on the waters, dwell within all as the Supersoul: They who are called Puruṣas are the Self of all the universes.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Ye puruṣa-nāmī means “They whose name is Puruṣa.”

51 Garbhodakaśāyī is the Self of Hiraṇyagarbha, and Kṣīrodakaśāyī is the Indweller of each individual being.

52 They glance upon māyā, and in this there is, as it were, a trace of māyā; but Kṛṣṇa, who abides in the fourth state (*turīya*), has no connection with māyā at all.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Hiraṇyagarbha is the aggregate *jīva*; his indwelling Lord is Garbhodakaśāyī. The indwelling Lord of the *vyaṣṭi*, that is, of each separate *jīva*, is the Puruṣa Kṣīrodakaśāyī. The Puruṣa beyond these three Puruṣas is *turīya*, that is, the fourth. He is Kṛṣṇacandra's *vilāsa-mūrti*, Nārāyaṇa, the Lord of Paravyoma; in Him there is not even a trace of *māyā*.

*(from the *Bhāvārtha-dīpikā* on *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 11.15.16)*

53 "Virāṭ, Hiraṇyagarbha and Kāraṇa are designations of the Lord; that which is free from these three is called the fourth (*turīya*)." (Śrīdhara Svāmī's commentary on Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 11.15.16)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Virāṭ, Hiraṇyagarbha and Kāraṇa are all designations (*upādhis*) connected with *māyā*. The truth free of *upādhis* is *turīya*, the fourth.

Anubhāṣya.

Śrīdhara Svāmī quotes this verse in his commentary to explain the word *turīya*.

virāṭ ([the gross]), **hiraṇya-garbhaḥ** ([the subtle]) **ca** (and) **kāraṇam** ([ignorance, or *prakṛti*] —) **iti** ([these]) **īśasya** (of the Lord [the *puruṣa-avatāra*, creator of the *mahat-tattva*]) **upādhayaḥ** (are the *upādhis* [particular manifestations]) **yat** (That which) **tribhiḥ** (by [these] three [*upādhis*]) **hīnam** (is untouched [not connected with them]), **tat** (that [state]) **turīyam** (the fourth [Vaikuṇṭha, beyond the three Puruṣas]) **pracakṣate** (they call).

54 Although the three have dealings with māyā, she does not touch Them: all of Them are beyond māyā.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Hiraṇyagarbha and the rest — the aggregate and the individual *jīvas* — are subject to *māyā*. The three Puruṣas mentioned have dealings with *māyā*, yet They are beyond it. They are the truth that rules over *māyā*: They glance at *māyā* but do not touch it.

*To descend into the material world and remain beyond it — this is the very nature of Bhagavān — (*Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 1.11.38)*

55 "This is the lordship of the Lord: though He abides within material nature, He is never affected by its qualities — just as the intelligence of those who have taken shelter of Him is not affected." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 1.11.38)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

The Lord's lordship consists in just this: He abides in *prakṛti* yet does not come under the sway of its modes. When the intelligence of a *jīva* bound by *māyā* takes shelter of the Lord (*Īśa*), it does not join with the modes of *māyā* even when near *māyā*.

Anubhāṣya.

Śrī Kṛṣṇa returned to His palace in the city of Dvārakā and spent His time with the queens. There was not even a trace of *māyā* in His conduct, and Śrī Sūta spoke of it like this:

tad-āśrayā ([sheltered in Śrī Bhagavān, as is that of the great devotees]) **buddhiḥ** (intelligence) **yathā** (just as [though it has somehow come to be in *prakṛti*] [**na yujyate**] does not become bound [to the modes], so [He too]. Or else, by contrast): **tad-āśrayā** ([resting on *prakṛti*]) **buddhiḥ** (intelligence [the knowledge of the *jīva*]) **yathā** (just as [**yujyate**] becomes bound, so [He] **na** — does not [become bound]) **prakṛti-sthaḥ api** (even while abiding in *prakṛti* [being in the world made of the three modes]), **sadā** (always) **ātma-sthaiḥ** (abiding in Him) **tad-guṇaiḥ** (by its modes) **na yujyate** (is not bound [does not become attached to the material modes]) **etat** ([Just] this) **īśasya** (of the Lord [Bhagavān, all-powerful and beyond *māyā*]) **īśanam** (is the lordship [*aiśvarya*]).

56 You are the supreme shelter of those three; You are the original Nārāyaṇa — what doubt can there be?

Anubhāṣya.
For “those three” — Kṣīrodakaśāyī, Garbhodakaśāyī and Kāraṇārṇavaśāyī Mahā-Viṣṇu — You are the supreme shelter. Their source is Your *vilāsa-mūrti*, the *catur-vyūha*: Vāsudeva, Saṅkarṣaṇa, Pradyumna and Aniruddha. From Saṅkarṣaṇa, in the Causal Waters, appears the first *puruṣa-avatāra*, the creator of the *mahat-tattva*, Kāraṇārṇavaśāyī; from Pradyumna, the second *puruṣa-avatāra*, Garbhodakaśāyī; and from Aniruddha, the third *puruṣa-avatāra*, Kṣīrodakaśāyī. Once They appear, They remain under the shelter of Nārāyaṇa alone.

57 The source of those three is the Nārāyaṇa of the spiritual sky. He is Your manifestation (*prakāśa*), and You are the original Nārāyaṇa.”[5]

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
Aṁśī is the One of whom [another] is a part. The Nārāyaṇa of Paravyoma is the *aṁśī* of the *puruṣa-avatāras*. He is Your secondary manifestation (*prakāśa*) in the form of *vilāsa*.

58 Thus, by Brahmā’s words, the Nārāyaṇa of the spiritual sky is a manifestation of Kṛṣṇa. This is the explanation of the truth.[6]

59 This verse (2.30), which reveals the characteristics of the Truth, is the essence of the *Bhāgavatam*; as a rule of interpretation (*paribhāṣā*) it applies everywhere.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
Paribhāṣā means a [defining] *sūtra*. *Sarvatrādhikāra*: you will find this mark everywhere in the *Bhāgavatam*.

Anubhāṣya.
“This verse” is the verse *nārāyaṇas tvam…* quoted above as number 30.

60 Brahman, Paramātmā and Bhagavān are manifestations of Kṛṣṇa. Not knowing this meaning, fools interpret otherwise.

Refuting the view that Kṛṣṇa is a part of Nārāyaṇa and Nārāyaṇa the whole —

61 They say: “Nārāyaṇa is the source of the avatāras, and Kṛṣṇa is His avatāra; for That One has four arms, while this One has a human form.”

62 In this way they raise various objections, but a verse of the *Bhāgavatam* skilfully refutes them.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
Vihāra means *vihāra* in the form of manifestations (*prakāśas*). Fools do not understand this meaning and interpret otherwise, for example: “Nārāyaṇa is the source of the avatāras, and Kṛṣṇa is an avatāra.” When such conclusions are put forward as a *pūrvapakṣa* (an opponent's thesis), the verses of the *Bhāgavatam* refute them with special skill.

*(2) Refuting the view that Kṛṣṇa and Nārāyaṇa are different — (*Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 1.2.11)*

63 “The knowers of the Truth call the non-dual knowledge the Truth; it is named Brahman, Paramātmā and Bhagavān.” (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 1.2.11)[7]

Anubhāṣya.
See Ādi 2.11.

64 Hear, brothers, and consider the meaning of this verse: the principal Truth is one, and It is manifest in three ways.

65 The non-dual knowledge, the Truth itself, is Kṛṣṇa’s own form; Brahman, Paramātmā and Bhagavān are His three forms.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
In this verse the word *advaya-jñāna* (nondual knowledge) means the original Truth, Kṛṣṇa's *svarūpa*.

66 The meaning of this verse has left you speechless. Now hear another statement of the *Bhāgavatam*.

*Refuting the view that Kṛṣṇa is an avatāra or a part — (*Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 1.3.28)*

67 "All these (avatāras) are portions (*aṁśa*) and parts of portions (*kalā*) of the Puruṣa, but Kṛṣṇa is Bhagavān Himself. Age after age They bring happiness to the world when it is troubled by the enemies of Indra." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 1.3.28)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
Rāma, Nṛsiṁha and the others are parts (*aṁśas*) or parts of parts (*kalās*) of the *puruṣa-avatāra*. But Kṛṣṇa is Bhagavān Himself. These avatāras protect the world, oppressed by the Daityas (demons), in age after age.

Anubhāṣya.
After listing Śrī Kṛṣṇa's avatāras, Śrī Sūta concludes with this verse.

ete ([the avatāras named before]) **puṁsaḥ** ([of the *puruṣa-avatāra*]) **aṁśa-kalāḥ** (are parts and *kalās* [parts of parts]) **kṛṣṇaḥ tu** (But Kṛṣṇa) **bhagavān svayam** (is Bhagavān Himself) **indrāri-vyākulam** ([These partial avatāras] [oppressed by the demons]) **lokam** ([the universe]) **yuge yuge** ([in every age, at the proper time]) **mṛḍayanti** ([make happy]).

68 Describing the general characteristics of all the avatāras, he counted Kṛṣṇacandra among them.

69 Then Sūta Gosāñi, feeling great apprehension in his mind, determined the distinguishing characteristic of each.

70 All the avatāras are portions and parts of the Puruṣa, but Kṛṣṇa is Bhagavān Himself, the crown of all.

71 An opponent says: "Your explanation is fine, but the Nārāyaṇa of the spiritual sky is Bhagavān Himself.

72 It is He who comes and descends in the form of Kṛṣṇa. This is the meaning I see in the verse — what more is there to consider?"

(3) Refuting, by the rules of poetics, the view that Kṛṣṇa is a part of Nārāyaṇa —

73 To him I say: “Why do you draw inferences by false logic? A meaning contrary to scripture can never be evidence.

*(a rule of poetics, *Ekādaśī-tattva* 13)*

74 ‘One should not state the predicate without first stating the subject; for nothing that has not found its footing can stand anywhere.’ (Ekādaśī-tattva, 13)[8]

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

In poetics the unknown is called the *vidheya*, and the known the *anuvāda*. Take the sentence “This brāhmaṇa is learned.” Everyone knows that this man is a brāhmaṇa; so this is the *anuvāda*. Not everyone knows that the brāhmaṇa is learned; so this is the *vidheya*. If someone states the *vidheya* first without stating the *anuvāda*, his statement has nothing to rest on and cannot stand.

Anubhāṣya.

anuvādam (the *uddeśya*, that is, the known subject) **anuktvā** (without stating) **vidheyam** (the unknown subject) **na udīrayet** (one should not state) **hi** (for) **alabdhāspadam** (that which has not found a footing, its own place) **kiñcit** (anything) **kutracit** (anywhere) **na pratitiṣṭhati** (does not stand firm).

*The rule for using the *anuvāda* and the *vidheya* —*

75 Without stating the subject one does not state the predicate: first the subject is stated, and afterwards the predicate.

*Definition of the *anuvāda* and the *vidheya* —*

76 That which is unknown is called the predicate (*vidheya*); that which is known is called the subject (*anuvāda*).

An example —

77 For example, we say: “This brāhmaṇa is a great scholar.” Here “brāhmaṇa” is the subject, and its predicate is “scholarship”.

78 That he is a brāhmaṇa is known, but his scholarship is not; therefore “brāhmaṇa” comes first, and “scholarship” afterwards.

*Explaining the verse *ete cāṁśa-kalāḥ…* by the rule of *anuvāda* and *vidheya*, or: Kṛṣṇa is the source of the avatāras —*

79 In the same way, here the avatāras are all known, but whose avatāras They are — that is unknown.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Iha means “this one” (He). “His avatāras” is a known subject. But whose avatāras they are is not yet known.

80 First, by the word “these”, the avatāras are stated as the subject; afterwards the predicate is given: “portions of the Puruṣa”.[9]

81 So too Kṛṣṇa became known among the avatāras, but the particular knowledge of Him remained unknown.

82 Therefore the word “Kṛṣṇa” comes first, as the subject, and afterwards the predicate is stated: that He is “Bhagavān Himself”.

83 Thus it is established that Kṛṣṇa is Bhagavān Himself; and it follows of necessity that Bhagavān Himself is Kṛṣṇa.

Otherwise Sūta's words would contradict themselves —

84 If Kṛṣṇa were the portion and Nārāyaṇa the source, Sūta’s statement would have been the reverse.

85 He would have said: “Nārāyaṇa, the source, is Bhagavān Himself, and He is Śrī Kṛṣṇa.”

Freedom from the four defects is the mark and distinction of the words of liberated souls —

86 In the words of the wise seers there are none of these faults: error, inattention, the wish to deceive, and imperfection of the senses.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

In the verse *ete cāṁśa-kalāḥ…* the word *ete* (these) names the avatāras; this is its *anuvāda*. That they are parts of the *puruṣa-avatāra* was not known before, and this is stated next as the *vidheya*. In this verse Kṛṣṇa too is mentioned among the avatāras. But the special knowledge about Kṛṣṇa is not yet known, so a *vidheya* is needed. That is why the word “Kṛṣṇa” comes first, as the *anuvāda*, and its *vidheya* is that Kṛṣṇa is “Bhagavān Himself.” This is what must be established here (*sādhya*): the reasoning must prove that Kṛṣṇa is Bhagavān Himself. Therefore the words *kṛṣṇas tu bhagavān svayam* necessarily (*bādhya*) mean “Kṛṣṇa is Bhagavān Himself,” and they can have no other meaning. If Nārāyaṇa were the whole and Kṛṣṇa the part, Sūta's words would stand in the reverse order: “Bhagavān Himself is Kṛṣṇa.” But *ārṣa*, the wise sayings of the sages, are free from the four defects — *bhrama*, *pramāda*, *vipralipsā* and *karaṇāpāṭava*. That is why the text reads *kṛṣṇas tu bhagavān svayam*. *Bhrama* is false knowledge; *pramāda*, inattention; *vipralipsā*, a mind distracted elsewhere; *karaṇāpāṭava*, the imperfection of the senses.

Anubhāṣya.

Bhrama is false knowledge of a thing, taking it to be what it is not, as when one takes a rope for a snake or mother-of-pearl for silver. **Pramāda** is inattention: one perceives, hears or says one thing as another. **Vipralipsā** is the desire to cheat. **Karaṇāpāṭava** is the imperfection of the senses. For example, the eye cannot see what is far away or make out what is tiny; in jaundice and other diseases the perception of color (form) is distorted; and the ear cannot hear a sound from far away.

87 You speak against the scriptures and grow angry when this is pointed out. The fault in your interpretation is that the predicate is wrongly placed

(*avimṛṣṭa-vidheyāṁśa*).

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

The defect called *avimṛṣṭa-vidheyāṁśa* arises when the *vidheya* is stated before the *anuvāda*. *Avimṛṣṭa* means unconsidered.

Anubhāṣya.

Avimṛṣṭa-vidheyāṁśa. The *vidheyāṁśa* is the unknown subject. If it is not set forth as the main thing, the defect called *avimṛṣṭa-vidheyāṁśa* arises. Its other name is *vidheya-avimarśa*.

The meaning and definition of the words "Bhagavān Himself" —

88 He from whose Godhood the Godhood of all others proceeds — in Him alone the words "Bhagavān Himself" have their meaning.

An example of the source of the avatāras and of the avatāras —

89 As many lamps are kindled from one lamp, and that one I count as the original,

Anubhāṣya.

Brahma-saṁhitā, Chapter 5, verse 46: "The flame of a lamp passes to another wick and itself becomes a lamp: it burns separately, yet has the same qualities as its source. In the same way He shines in the form of Viṣṇu. I worship Govinda, the original Puruṣa."

All the *viṣṇu-tattvas* are like lamps: they are full of light and have the same qualities as the original Nārāyaṇa. Yet they are lit from the original lamp. The *viṣṇu-tattvas* are equal to Govinda in being light. But Viriñci (Brahmā) and Śambhu (Śiva) are not so, even though they too are *guṇa-avatāras*. Śrī Jīva Gosvāmī says: "Śambhu, however, is the seat of *tamas*. He is like a thin lamp flame mixed with soot, and so there is no such equality."

90 so Kṛṣṇa is the cause of all the avatāras. Hear another verse, which refutes wrong interpretations.

*(4) By the marks of a Purāṇa too, the original shelter is not Nārāyaṇa but Kṛṣṇa — (*Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 2.10.1–2)*

91–92 "In this *Bhāgavatam* there are ten subjects: primary creation (*sarga*), secondary creation (*visarga*), maintenance (*sthāna*), the Lord's favour to His devotees (*poṣaṇa*), the impulses to action (*ūti*), the reigns of Manu (*manvantara*), the narrations of the Lord (*īśānukathā*), the winding up of the world (*nirodha*), liberation (*mukti*) and the shelter (*āśraya*). To reveal clearly the tenth, the great souls describe here the characteristics of the other nine — sometimes in prayers and narratives, sometimes by direct explanation." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 2.10.1–2)[10]

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

The *Bhāgavatam* describes ten subjects: *sarga*, *visarga*, *sthāna*, *ūti*, *poṣaṇa*, the *manvantaras*, *īśa-kathā*, *nirodha*, *mukti* and *āśraya*. The tenth truth is *āśraya*, the shelter. To examine it in its purity, the great souls have described the nine preceding marks: in some places through prayers and narratives, and in others through direct reasoning.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

In the Tenth Canto Śrī Kṛṣṇa is pointed out as the *āśraya-vigraha*, the form who is the shelter of all who seek shelter. I bow to that supreme abode and abode of the universe whose name is Śrī Kṛṣṇa. The meaning is this. In the world there are two truths: *āśraya*, the shelter, and *āśrita*, that which rests on the shelter. The original truth on which all the *āśrita-tattvas* rest is the *āśraya*. All the truths that exist by resting on it are *āśrita-tattvas*. Everything from *sarga* to *mukti* is *āśrita-tattva*. Thus the *puruṣa-avatāras* and all the avatāras who follow Them, all the potencies, and after them the worlds of *jīvas* and of matter — all of these rest on that shelter, on Kṛṣṇa. In its prayers and narratives the *Bhāgavatam* examines the *āśraya-tattva* partly indirectly, and in its direct teachings directly. Therefore one must know Kṛṣṇa's *svarūpa* and His three potencies.

Anubhāṣya.

Parīkṣit asked how the *rājasic* creations arose from the Vairāja Puruṣa. In answer Śukadeva speaks this verse at the start of his explanation of the *catuḥ-ślokī*, the four verses.

atra (here, in the *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam*) **sargaḥ** (the birth of the elements, the subtle elements, the senses and the intelligence) **visargaḥ** (the imbalance of the modes in Brahmā's creation) **sthānam** (maintenance [*sthiti*]. This is Bhagavān's victory: His excellence shows in the fact that everything created keeps within its bounds) **poṣaṇam** (His mercy to His devotees) **ūtayaḥ** (the desires that impel one to karma) **manvantara** (the *manvantaras*, that is, the *dharma* of goodness) **īśānukathāḥ** (the narratives of Hari's avatāras) **nirodhaḥ** (withdrawal: the world, together with the potencies, lies down to sleep following the Self) **muktiḥ** (abiding in the pure state) **āśrayaḥ** (the Parabrahman, the Paramātmā, the cause of creation, maintenance and dissolution).

These are the ten subjects.

Anubhāṣya.

mahātmānaḥ (the great souls, Vidura and others) **iha** (here, in the Purāṇa *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam*) **daśamasya** (of the tenth, that is, of the *āśraya*) **viśuddhy-artham** (for clear knowledge, that is, knowledge of the truth) **navānām** (of the nine [subjects]) **lakṣaṇam** (the nature) **śrutena** (by the word that names them directly) **añjasā** (directly) **arthena** (by the meaning) **varṇayanti** (describe).

1. *Sarga* — the arising of the five great elements, the five *tanmātras* (subtle elements), the ten senses, the mind, the *mahat-tattva* and false ego (*ahaṅkāra*), both in the form of the Virāṭ and in their own nature. 2. *Visarga* — Brahmā's creation of the moving and the unmoving. 3. *Sthiti* — Bhagavān's victory, His excellence over Brahmā, the creator, and over Śiva, the destroyer. 4. *Poṣaṇa* — Bhagavān's mercy to His devotees. 5. *Ūti* — the desires that impel one to karma. 6. *Manvantara* — the *dharma* followed by the *jīvas* in goodness. 7. *Īśa-kathā* — the narratives of Hari's avatāras and of the *bhāgavatas* (His devotees). 8. *Nirodha* — Hari enters His mystic sleep (*yoga-nidrā*) and lies down together with His potencies, the *upādhis*. 9. *Mukti* — the *jīva* gives up his gross and subtle forms and abides in the form of a pure *jīva* or of an associate of the Lord. 10. *Āśraya* — that celebrated Parabrahman and Paramātmā from whom creation and dissolution proceed and in whom the universe is manifest.

93 To make the shelter known I have named these nine categories; the cause from which these nine arise — that is what “the shelter” means.

94 Kṛṣṇa alone is the shelter of all; Kṛṣṇa is the abode of all. In Kṛṣṇa's body all the universes rest.

*(from the *Bhāvārtha-dīpikā* on *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 10.1.1)*

95 "In the Tenth Canto the tenth subject is revealed: the embodiment of the shelter of all who take shelter, the supreme abode named Śrī Kṛṣṇa, the abode of the world. To That I bow down." (Śrīdhara Svāmī, *Bhāvārtha-dīpikā* on Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 10.1.1)

Anubhāṣya.

daśame (in the Tenth Canto of the *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam*) **āśritāśraya-vigraham** (the form who is the shelter of the *āśritas*, the surrendered souls) **daśamam** (the tenth, that is, the *āśraya-tattva*) **lakṣyam** (is pointed out) **tat paraṁ dhāma** (that supreme abode, the best shelter), **jagad-dhāma** (the abode of the universe, the shelter of all), **śrī-kṛṣṇākhyam** (named Śrī Kṛṣṇa), **namāmi** (I worship).

The basis of knowledge about Kṛṣṇa —

96 One who knows Kṛṣṇa's own form and His three potencies is no longer ignorant of Kṛṣṇa.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

The three potencies are the *cit-śakti*, the *jīva-śakti* and the *māyā-śakti*.

Anubhāṣya.

Śrī Jīva Prabhu writes in the *Bhagavat-sandarbha* (16): "The one Supreme Truth, by Its own natural inconceivable potency, always abides in four ways: as Its *svarūpa*, as the manifestations of the *svarūpa* (*vaibhava*), as the *jīvas* and as *pradhāna*. So too the radiance within the sun's disc abides as the disc itself, as the rays issuing from it, and as their reflection. Inconceivability is the power to accomplish the impossible. Potency is of three kinds: internal, external and marginal. By the internal potency, called *svarūpa-śakti*, the Truth abides in Its full form and in the manifestations of that form, Vaikuṇṭha and the rest. By the marginal potency It abides as the pure *jīvas*: they are like the rays, spiritual and one with It in nature. By the external potency, called *māyā*, It abides as *pradhāna*: this is Its external, material manifestation, like the play of colors in a reflection. These are the four ways. The *jīva* is a part of It and therefore the

marginal potency, while *pradhāna* belongs to *māyā*; with this in view the *Viṣṇu Purāṇa* counts three potencies. The potency whose work (*karma*) is ignorance (*avidyā*) is named there *avidyā-karma*; this is *māyā*. Although it is external, it has the power to cover even the *jīva*, who consists of the marginal potency. Its covering lies on bodies from Brahmā down to the unmoving beings, now lighter, now heavier. *Pradhāna* lacks such qualities as spirituality and changelessness; one should understand that it is this inconceivable *māyā* that makes it material and changeable. The internal, marginal and external potencies are one in nature [with the Truth]. It is said here only that each of them resembles its image in one respect, not in all: they take the place of the disc, the rays and the reflection, but are not identical with them. Therefore the defects of these images do not apply here."

This one Supreme Truth, by the power of a natural potency beyond human understanding, always abides in four ways: as the *svarūpa*, as the manifestations of the *svarūpa*, as the *jīva* and as *pradhāna*. So too the sun has four aspects: the radiance within the disc, the disc itself, the rays issuing from the disc, and their reflection. Inconceivability means that the Truth accomplishes the impossible. Potency, too, is of three kinds: internal, external and marginal. The internal *svarūpa-śakti* reveals the full form of the *svarūpa* and its manifestations — Vaikuṇṭha, Goloka and the rest. The marginal potency reveals the spiritual forms of the pure *jīvas*, which are like the rays. The external potency, *māyā*, reveals the external manifestation connected with the Truth — material *pradhāna*, like the play of colors in a reflection. These are the four ways. The *jīva* is a part of It and therefore the marginal potency, while *pradhāna* belongs to *māyā*; understanding this, the *Viṣṇu Purāṇa* counts three potencies. The potency that does the work of ignorance (*avidyā*) is called *māyā*. This potency is external, and yet it is given the power to cover the *jīva*, who consists of the marginal potency. The *jīvas* covered by *māyā* abide, to a greater or lesser degree, in bodies from the unmoving beings up to Brahmā. *Pradhāna* lacks such qualities as spirituality and changelessness — it is material and changeable; one should know that this happens only by the will of the inconceivable *māyā*. The internal, marginal and external potencies are one in nature, and they are equal in being potencies. But they do not resemble each other in everything: it is said of them only that they take the place [of the disc, the rays and the reflection], not that they are those images. Therefore the defects proper to the marginal and external

potencies have no place in the internal potency. Nor do the defects of the external potency have a place in the marginal, or those of the marginal in the external.

97 Kṛṣṇa's own form has six kinds of pastime forms (*vilāsa*): His manifestations are of two kinds, *prābhava* and *vaibhava*;

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Prābhava and *vaibhava* are those whose forms, full of being, consciousness and bliss, are equal to Hari's, but who are slightly below His supreme state. Their names depend on the measure of potency: where lordship (*prabhutā*) predominates, there is *prābhava*; where greatness (*vibhutā*) predominates, *vaibhava*. *Prābhava* is of two kinds. *Prābhavas* of the first kind remain in the world only briefly: for example, Mohinī, Haṁsa, Śukla and other short-lived avatāras connected with particular ages. The fame of *prābhavas* of the second kind does not spread very widely: for example, Dhanvantari, Ṛṣabha, Vyāsa, Dattātreya, Kapila and others. But Kūrma, Matsya, Nara-Nārāyaṇa, Varāha, Hayagrīva, Pṛśnigarbha, Baladeva and the avatāras of the fourteen *manvantaras* — Yajña, Vibhu, Satyasena, Hari, Vaikuṇṭha, Ajita, Vāmana, Sārvabhauma, Ṛṣabha, Viṣvaksena, Dharmasetu, Sudhāmā, Yogeśvara and Bṛhadbhānu — are *vaibhava-avatāras*.

98 His avatāras are of two kinds, partial (*aṁśa*) and empowered (*śaktyāveśa*); and His pastimes are of two kinds, those of childhood (*bālya*) and of boyhood (*paugaṇḍa*).

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

The *aṁśāveśa-* and *śaktyāveśa-avatāras* are explained elsewhere. They too are counted among the *prābhavas* and *vaibhavas*. The same holds for the *guṇa-avatāras*.

99 Kṛṣṇa in His own form is youthful (*kiśora*): He Himself is the source of the avatāras. In these six forms He sports, filling the universe.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Kṛṣṇa is eternally youthful (*nitya-kiśora*), and He has two kinds of pastimes, in childhood (*bālya*) and in boyhood (*paugaṇḍa*). Therefore the source of the avatāras Himself is precisely Kṛṣṇa in His youthful form.

100 Within these six forms there are unlimited varieties; yet in all those unlimited forms there is one form, and no difference at all.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Kṛṣṇa's *svarūpa* displays six kinds of *vilāsa*: two kinds of manifestation, *prābhava* and *vaibhava*; two kinds of avatāra, *aṁśa* and *śaktyāveśa*; and two ages, *bālya* and *paugaṇḍa*. In these six kinds of *vilāsa* of His *svarūpa*, Kṛṣṇa in His youthful form performs pastimes throughout the universe. Thus these six forms divide without end. But even having become endless, Kṛṣṇa remains the one undivided Truth.

*The *cit-śakti* and its manifestations —*

101 The spiritual potency (*cit-śakti*) is also called the personal potency (*svarūpa-śakti*) and the internal potency (*antaraṅgā*); her opulence is the unlimited abodes, such as the Vaikuṇṭhas.

*The *māyā-śakti* and its manifestations —*

102 The potency māyā, the external potency, is the cause of the world: her opulence is the unlimited multitude of universes.

*The *jīva-śakti* —*

103 The potency of the souls, called marginal (*taṭasthā*), has no end. These are the three principal potencies, and their varieties are unlimited.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

The *cit-śakti*, or *svarūpa-śakti*, is also called the internal potency. From it come the endless manifestations of splendor in Vaikuṇṭha and the other abodes. From the marginal potency, the *jīva-śakti*, come the countless *jīvas*, conditioned and liberated. From the external potency, the *māyā-śakti*, comes the endless variety of material universes.

Anubhāṣya.

Śvetāśvatara Upaniṣad, Chapter 6, mantra 8: “He has no work and no organs of action; no one is seen equal to Him or higher than Him. The Śrutis say that His

supreme potency is manifold, and knowledge, strength and action belong to Him by nature."

*Where the forms of the *svarūpa* and the potencies abide —*

104 Such are His personal forms and His three potencies. Kṛṣṇa is the shelter of them all; in Kṛṣṇa they all abide.

105 Although the Puruṣa is the shelter of the universes, Kṛṣṇa is the original shelter of all — of the Puruṣas and the rest.

Who Kṛṣṇa is —

106 Kṛṣṇa is Bhagavān Himself; Kṛṣṇa is the shelter of all. All the scriptures declare Kṛṣṇa to be the Supreme Lord.

*(*Brahma-saṁhitā* 5.1)*

107 "Kṛṣṇa, Govinda, is the Supreme Lord; His form is eternal being, knowledge and bliss. He has no beginning, yet He is the beginning of all, the cause of all causes." (Brahma-saṁhitā, 5.1)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

The Supreme Lord is Kṛṣṇa, the form of being, consciousness and bliss. He Himself has no beginning, yet He is the beginning of all and the cause of all causes.

Anubhāṣya.

kṛṣṇaḥ (Kṛṣṇa, Vrajendranandana) **paramaḥ īśvaraḥ** (the Supreme Lord. He is the Master of all: of Baladeva, Nārāyaṇa, Vāsudeva, Saṅkarṣaṇa, Pradyumna and Aniruddha; of the *puruṣa-avatāras*, the Paramātmās who lie in the three oceans — Kāraṇa, Garbha and Kṣīrārṇava; of the *naimittika-avatāras* — Matsya, Kūrma, Varāha, Rāma, Nṛsiṁha and others; of the *guṇa-avatāras* — Brahmā, Śiva and others; of the impersonal Brahman; and of the *vibhūti-avatāras* — Mahendra and the rest) **sac-cid-ānanda-vigrahaḥ** (the form of being, consciousness and bliss, endowed with three potencies: *sandhinī*, *saṁvit* and *hlādinī*) **anādiḥ** (without beginning; of Him it is said, "I alone was in the

beginning.") **ādiḥ** (the original form of all) **sarva-kāraṇa-kāraṇam** (the cause, the root, of all causes) **govindaḥ** (Govinda).

108 You know all these conclusions well, and yet you raise objections, only to unsettle me.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
Calāite means "to unsettle me needlessly."

Śrī Caitanya is Kṛṣṇa, Himself the source of the avatāras —

109 That Kṛṣṇa, the source of all avatāras, the son of the king of Vraja, has Himself descended in the form of Caitanya.

In Śrī Caitanya, the source of the avatāras, all the avatāras are contained —

110 Therefore Caitanya Gosāñi is the furthest limit of the Supreme Truth. To call Him Kṣīrodaśāyī — what glory is that to Him?

Therefore it is no error to call Him by any name of Viṣṇu —

111 Yet such words of a devotee are not wrong: everything is possible in Him, for He is the source of the avatāras.

Anubhāṣya.
Śrī Caitanya-bhāgavata, Madhya, Chapter 6, 95: "I was lying in the Ocean of Milk — and Nāḍā's roar broke My sleep."[18]

112 All the avatāras are present in the body of their source; so each speaks of Him in his own way, according to his understanding.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
In some books Śrī Caitanya is called Kṣīrodaśāyī, the Lord of Vaikuṇṭha. This does not describe His greatness fully, yet the words of those devotees are not false either. For Kṛṣṇa Caitanya, who is non-different from Kṛṣṇa, is Himself the source of the avatāras, and so all the avatāras abide in Him.

113 Some call Kṛṣṇa Nara-Nārāyaṇa; others say that Kṛṣṇa is Vāmana Himself.

114 Some say that Kṛṣṇa is an avatāra of Kṣīrodaśāyī. Nothing of this is impossible; the words of all of them are true.

Anubhāṣya.

In the *Laghu-bhāgavatāmṛta*, where Kṛṣṇa is described as the source of the avatāras, it is said: "Therefore in the Purāṇas and other scriptures the sages, following particular events, name Kṛṣṇa differently: some call Him Narasakha, the Friend of Nara; others, the younger brother of Mahendra; still others, the One who lies in the Ocean of Milk; some, the Thousand-headed One; and some, the Lord of Vaikuṇṭha."

115 Some call Him Nārāyaṇa, Hari of the spiritual sky. Everything is possible in Kṛṣṇa, for He is the source of the avatāras.

*All devotees, on the path of *vaidhī* and on the path of *rāgānugā* alike, absolutely need to know the conclusions of devotion —*

116 I bow down at the feet of all my listeners: hear all these conclusions with undivided attention.

117 Do not be indifferent to them, thinking them mere doctrine; from them the mind becomes firmly attached to Kṛṣṇa.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Some who thirst for devotion do not count these conclusions (*siddhāntas*) as part of devotion and are too lazy to study them. But this does not lead to good. For when one has understood one's relationship with Kṛṣṇa (*sambandha-jñāna*), the mind becomes firmly attached to His lotus feet. Therefore such true conclusions are the root of pure devotion.

Thus ends the second chapter of the "Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya."

Anubhāṣya.

Many see the example of devotees in whom taste (*ruci*) has awakened and think it is not so necessary to study the conclusions (*siddhānta*). Out of such laziness

many grow poor in worship (*bhajana*) and turn away from Kṛṣṇa. They take for devotion material feelings hostile to devotion, and fall under the sway of *anarthas*. The path led by reasoning suits those in whom taste has not yet awakened. Yet those in whom taste has awakened but is still weak have special need of hearing, a part of devotion (*śravaṇāṅga*). Without hearing the conclusions about Kṛṣṇa, taste does not grow. Among the nine kinds of devotion, hearing is prescribed at the very beginning, before glorification. The creeper of devotion grows only when it is watered with hearing and glorification. Even Brahmā, when he praised Kṛṣṇa and described the devotees who had given up the effort for knowledge, said: "…the news of You, resounding from the mouths of the sādhus and reaching the ear." The *Bhāgavatam* grants the pure knowledge of the *paramahaṁsas*. Only one who reads and hears it while reflecting on it attains the level of a *mahā-bhāgavata*. In Śrī Mahāprabhu's teachings to Sanātana we hear: "One who is expert in scripture and reasoning and has firm faith is a devotee of the highest level; he delivers the world." And Śrī Rūpa Gosvāmīpāda said that one must give up laziness: "Devotion is perfected by six qualities: enthusiasm, conviction, patience, carrying out the prescribed duties, giving up [bad] company, and following the conduct of the sādhus."[19]

Those who claim to be devotees without knowing the conclusions often, out of foolishness, artificially practice the *sāttvika-vikāras* (spiritual transformations), and so lower the standing of a Vaiṣṇava in people's eyes. Condemning this bad habit, the *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* gives the verse *tad aśma-sāram…*.[20] In his commentary on it Śrīpāda Cakravartī Ṭhākura says: "If there are tears and thrilling outside but the heart is not transformed, that heart is made of stone. This censure is aimed at devotees of the lowest level (*kaniṣṭha-adhikārīs*): even when they have tears, thrilling and the like, their hearts are of stone." When the conclusions are not respected, artificial devotion appears; Śrī Rūpa Prabhu painted its picture like this: "In those whose hearts are slippery by nature, and in those who practice it, tears, thrilling and the like sometimes appear even without a semblance of *sattva*." Here too is a vivid example of how the crowd of false devotees, lacking the conclusions, take transformations of *māyā* for transcendental ones.

Many condemn even reading the works on *siddhānta* written by the Vaiṣṇava ācāryas — Śrī Rāmānuja, Madhvācārya, Nimbārka, Viṣṇusvāmī and others — just as they condemn studying the books of the Advaitavādīs, who are hostile to devotion. Yet for the good of the Vaiṣṇavas Śrī Jīva quoted precisely their excellent conclusions in the *Ṣaṭ-sandarbha*. The impersonalists (*nirviśeṣa-vādīs*)

mistakenly take the parts of devotion for parts of karma. So too *jīvas* who are Vaiṣṇavas in name only, not knowing the conclusions, imagine that conclusions favorable to devotion are hostile to it — and fall away from devotion to Kṛṣṇa.

*Love for worship (*bhajana*) is born of the conclusions of devotion —*

118 Through all these conclusions I come to know the greatness of Caitanya; and from knowing His greatness the mind becomes firm and attached to Him.

Anubhāṣya.

In the *Pañcarātra*: “Firm love (*sneha*), surpassing all and joined with knowledge of [the Lord's] greatness, is called devotion; by it [one attains] *sārṣṭi* and the rest, and by nothing else.” “In those who follow the path of rules it is joined with knowledge of His greatness; but in those who have taken shelter of *rāgānugā* it is usually pure (*kevala*).”

The author describes the truth about Kṛṣṇa only to establish faith in Caitanya —

119 To tell the greatness of Caitanya Prabhu, I have described the greatness of Kṛṣṇa in detail.

He who is Kṛṣṇa is Caitanya —

120 This is the determination of the truth of Caitanya Gosāñi: He is Bhagavān Himself, Kṛṣṇa, the son of the king of Vraja.

Anubhāṣya.

Thus ends the second chapter of the “Anubhāṣya.”

121 Praying at the feet of Śrī Rūpa and Śrī Raghunātha, I, Kṛṣṇadāsa, narrate the *Caitanya-caritāmṛta*.

Notes

1. Indicating the Object (*vastu-nirdeśa*) is one of the three kinds of auspicious invocation (Ādi 1.22). ↩
2. The same verse as Ādi 1.3. ↩
3. As in the Gauḍīya Maṭha edition: «চারি হাত» (another spelling: «হাথ»). ↩
4. This is the first reason why Kṛṣṇa is the original Nārāyaṇa: *nāra* — all souls, *ayana* — their shelter (2.38). ↩
5. As in the Gauḍīya Maṭha edition: «তেঁহ তোমার প্রকাশ» — “He is Your manifestation”. ↩
6. As in the Gauḍīya Maṭha edition: «তেঁহ কৃষ্ণের প্রকাশ» (another reading: «তেঁহো কৃষ্ণের বিলাস»). In meaning this manifestation is a *vilāsa*: on 2.57 the *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya* calls Nārāyaṇa “a secondary manifestation in the form of *vilāsa*”. ↩
7. The same verse as 2.11 (so the *Anubhāṣya* also notes). ↩
8. The reference is as in the edition: “a rule of rhetoric, *Ekādaśī-tattva*, 13”. ↩
9. This refers to verse 2.67 (*ete cāṁśa-kalāḥ puṁsaḥ*). ↩
10. According to the *Anubhāṣya*: *ūti* — karmic desires; *manvantara* — the righteous path given by Manu; *īśānukathā* — the accounts of Hari’s avatāras; *nirodha* — the Lord with His potencies lying down in sleep; *mukti* — abiding in one’s pure nature; *āśraya* — the Supreme Brahman, the cause of creation, maintenance and dissolution. ↩
11. The verse translation reads differently: it takes *ātma-kalpita* as “created by Himself” (as the *Anubhāṣya* also glosses it), whereas here it is read as “made one’s own,” that is, those who know themselves as the Lord’s servants. ↩
12. The edition reads *atan-māyā-rahita* (literally “free from *māyā*, [which is] not-That”); taken here as “untouched by *māyā*.” ↩
13. The edition reads *māyā vā advaya-jñāna-dvārā* (“by *māyā*, or nondual knowledge”); the sense probably requires *dvaya-jñāna*, dual knowledge (compare *dvaita-jñāna* in the same sentence); translated by the sense. ↩
14. *Muṇḍaka Upaniṣad* 3.1.1–3. ↩
15. Sources not named in the edition: *Śvetāśvatara Upaniṣad* 6.7 and 3.12; *Muṇḍaka Upaniṣad* 3.1.3; *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 11.5.33–34 and 7.9.38. ↩
16. *Māyāyām*, literally “in Māyā”; usually understood as Māyāpura. ↩
17. *Kaṭha Upaniṣad* 2.2.13; *Śvetāśvatara Upaniṣad* 6.13. ↩
18. Nāḍā is a nickname of Advaita Ācārya. ↩
19. *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 10.14.3; *Caitanya-caritāmṛta*, Madhya 22.65; *Upadeśāmṛta* 3. ↩
20. *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 2.3.24. ↩

“Śrī Caitanya-caritāmṛta”

Ādi-līlā

Chapter 3

The Auspicious Invocation of Blessing: The General Cause of Caitanya’s Descent

(English translation from the Bengali, following the Gauḍīya Maṭha edition and the «Anubhāṣya», 2026 — draft)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya

Summary. This chapter considers the reasons why Śrī Caitanya descended. At the end of His pastimes Śrī Kṛṣṇa reflected: how could the four *rasas* of those pastimes — *dāsya*, *sakhya*, *vātsalya* and *śṛṅgāra* (servitude, friendship, parental love and amorous love) — once manifest in the world, become something people could relish? Reflecting thus, He Himself descended in the form of a devotee to show the world how to relish these *rasas* of *prema-bhakti*. The chief *dharma* of the age of Kali is *nāma-saṅkīrtana*, and the *yuga-avatāra*, the avatāra of the age, can reveal it. But *prema-bhakti* in those four *rasas* no *aṁśa-avatāra* or any other avatāra has the power to give — only Kṛṣṇacandra Himself. Therefore Kṛṣṇacandra Himself took birth in Navadvīpa. The author cites the words of the *Bhāgavatam* and other scriptures as proof that Kṛṣṇa Himself would take birth. By the marks of a *mahāpuruṣa*, a great personality, he establishes that Caitanya is Bhagavān Himself. He further shows that Kṛṣṇa Caitanya descended with His limbs and their parts (*aṅga-upāṅga*) — that is, with Advaita, Nityānanda, Śrīvāsa and the other devotees — and preached *hari-bhakti* to the world. For the world the avatāra of Caitanya is more precious than all other avatāras, and therefore He is hidden. He is perceived through devotion alone (He is *bhakti-vyaṅgya*): only a devotee is fit to see Him with the eye of devotion. He takes great pains to keep this precious truth secret, yet before the highest devotees He stands revealed. To keep Him hidden, the Vedas, Purāṇas and other scriptures mention His future appearance only by hints. This makes clear how hidden His

concealed avatāra (*channa-avatāra*) is and how especially precious. Advaita Ācārya appeared together with his elders and saw that the world had become utterly devoid of devotion to Kṛṣṇa. He reasoned: “If some *aṁśa-avatāra* descends, He will not be able to bring the world good fortune. The world will be blessed only if I can make Kṛṣṇa Himself descend.” With this in mind he began to offer water and *tulasī* at Kṛṣṇa's lotus feet and to call out loudly (*huṅkāra*), so that Kṛṣṇa, the Truth free of all designations, would descend. At the prayer of a pure and guileless devotee, Kṛṣṇa manifests His supreme form, the form on which that devotee meditates. Therefore Gaurāṅga descended in answer to the loving call of the pure devotee Advaita Ācārya — to give *prema* to the world.

*Obeisance to Mahāprabhu in order to gather the conclusions (*siddhānta*) of devotion —*

1 I bow to the Lord Śrī Caitanya. Through the power of taking shelter at His feet, even an ignorant man gathers the precious jewels of conclusive truth (*siddhānta*) from the many mines of scripture.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

I bow down to Śrī Caitanya Prabhu. By the strength of shelter at His feet even an ignorant person can gather from the mines of the scriptures the finest jewels of *siddhānta*, the conclusions of truth.

Anubhāṣya.

A verse composed by the author himself.

ajñaḥ (even an ignorant person) **yat-pādāśraya-vīryataḥ** (by the power of shelter at whose feet, that is, at the feet of Śrī Caitanya) **ākara-vrātāt** (from the many mines, the places where metals are born) **siddhānta-san-maṇīn** (the true jewels of conclusions) **saṅgṛhṇāti** (is able to gather fully) ([that]) **śrī-caitanya-prabhum** (Śrī Caitanya Prabhu) ([I]) **vande** (worship).

2 Glory, glory to Śrī Caitanya! Glory to Nityānanda! Glory to Advaitacandra! Glory to all the devotees of Gaura!

3 I have explained the meaning of the third verse. Now, O devotees, hear the meaning of the fourth.

*Explanation of the fourth of the fourteen opening verses (*Vidagdha-mādhava*, Act 1, verse 2) —*

4 "May the Lord Hari, the son of Śacī, illumined by a mass of lustre more beautiful than gold, ever shine in the inmost cave of your hearts. Out of His mercy He has descended in the age of Kali to bestow what had not been given for a very long time — the treasure of devotion to Himself, rich in the most exalted, radiant *ujjvala-rasa*." (Vidagdha-mādhava, 1.2)[1]

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

May Hari, the son of Śacī, radiant with masses of golden splendor, manifest within your hearts. He has descended in the age of Kali to bestow the treasure of devotion to Himself — the supreme *ujjvala-rasa*, the radiant *rasa* of amorous love, which He had never before given to the world.

Anubhāṣya.

Śrī Rūpa Gosvāmī used this verse as the *maṅgalācaraṇa* (blessing the world) at the opening of his play *Vidagdha-mādhava*. The author, his follower, therefore follows in the footsteps of his own beloved guru.

cirāt (for a long time) **anarpita-carīm** (never given before) **unnatojjvala-rasām** (in which the *ujjvala-rasa*, the *rasa* of amorous love [*śṛṅgāra*], is exalted, that is, fully developed) **sva-bhakti-śriyam** (the beauty of love for Himself) **samarpayitum** (in order to bestow fully) **kalau** (in the age of Kali) **karuṇayā avatīrṇaḥ** (who has come into the world out of mercy) **puraṭa-sundara-dyuti-kadamba-sandīpitaḥ** (He who is brightly illumined by a mass of beautiful golden radiance) **śacī-nandanaḥ** (the son of Śacī) **hariḥ** (Hari) **vaḥ** (your) **hṛdaya-kandare** (in the cave of the heart, that is, of the mind) **sadā** (always, day and night) **sphuratu** (may He manifest).

The time of His descent —

5 Kṛṣṇa, the son of the king of Vraja, is Bhagavān in all His fullness. Together with all Vraja He enjoys His pastimes eternally in Goloka.

6 Once in a day of Brahmā He descends and displays those pastimes in this world.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

The previous chapter established that Kṛṣṇa, the son of the king of Vraja, is Bhagavān in full. He eternally enjoys His pastimes in Goloka, the majestic manifestation (*vaibhava*) of Gokula, with everything that makes up the *rasa* of Vraja. These are called His unmanifest pastimes (*aprakaṭa-vihāra*). Descending into the world, He displays His manifest pastimes (*prakaṭa-vihāra*) once in every *kalpa*, that is, once in every day of Brahmā.

7 The four ages are Satya, Tretā, Dvāpara and Kali, and together they make up one divine age (*divya-yuga*).

8 Seventy-one such cycles make one manvantara, the reign of a Manu, and fourteen manvantaras make up a day of Brahmā.

Anubhāṣya.

The age of Kali lasts 432,000 solar years. Dvāpara has twice as many years as Kali, Tretā three times as many and Satya four times as many. Satya, Tretā, Dvāpara and Kali together therefore last 4,320,000 solar years. This *mahā-yuga* has been given the name *divya-yuga*. Seventy-one such *mahā-yugas* make one *manvantara*. Fourteen *manvantaras*, together with the junctions (*sandhi*) between them, which altogether equal fifteen Satya-yugas, make a thousand *yugas* — one day of Brahmā, or a *kalpa*.

"…A *catur-yuga* is declared to be, in solar years, [the numbers] two, three and [the four] oceans, multiplied by ten thousand.[21] Seventy-one such *yugas* are here called a *manvantara*. Know that in a *kalpa* there are fourteen Manus together with their junctions [*sandhi*]; at the beginning of the *kalpa* there is one more junction, as long as a Kṛta-yuga, and so fifteen are counted. Thus a *kalpa* of a thousand *yugas*, which brings about the destruction of living beings, is called a day of Brahmā; his night is just as long." (*Sūrya-siddhānta*, the chapter on mean motions [*Madhyamādhikāra*])

9 The present, seventh manvantara is called Vaivasvata, and twenty-seven of its cycles have already passed.

Anubhāṣya.

Mahāprabhu appears in the *manvantara* of the seventh Manu, named Vaivasvata. “The first Manu was Svāyambhuva. [After him] were born Svārociṣa, Uttama, Tāmasa, then Raivata and Cākṣuṣa; the present one, the seventh, is Vaivasvata. After him come Sāvarṇi, Dakṣa-sāvarṇi, Brahma-sāvarṇi, Dharma-sāvarṇi, Rudraputra, Raucya and Bhautyaka.” These are the fourteen Manus: (1) Svāyambhuva, (2) Svārociṣa, (3) Uttama, (4) Tāmasa, (5) Raivata, (6) Cākṣuṣa, (7) Vaivasvata, (8) Sāvarṇi, (9) Dakṣa-sāvarṇi, (10) Brahma-sāvarṇi, (11) Dharma-sāvarṇi, (12) Rudraputra (Sāvarṇi), (13) Raucya (Deva-sāvarṇi), (14) Bhautyaka (Indra-sāvarṇi). The reign of each lasts 71 *mahā-yugas*.

10 At the end of the Dvāpara of the twenty-eighth cycle, Kṛṣṇa appears in this world together with His Vraja.[2]

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

At the end of the Dvāpara of the twenty-eighth *catur-yuga* in the *manvantara* of Vaivasvata, Kṛṣṇa appears with everything that belongs to the truth of Vraja.

Anubhāṣya.

Of the 71 *mahā-yugas* of the Vaivasvata *manvantara*, 27 have passed. In the twenty-eighth *catur-yuga*, after Satya and Tretā have passed, the time of Kṛṣṇa's manifest presence comes at the end of Dvāpara. From the beginning of Brahmā's day to the end of that Dvāpara, six Manus pass, together with their junctions. Adding this time to the 27 *yugas* of Vaivasvata Manu and to the Satya, Tretā and Dvāpara [of the twenty-eighth] (and subtracting the time of creation), one finds that 975,320,000[22] solar years have passed.

*The four principal *rasas*, apart from *śānta* —*

11 Servitude, friendship, parental affection and the love of the beloved (*śṛṅgāra*) are the four rasas, and Kṛṣṇa is under the sway of all the devotees who have these four moods.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Rasa is the very substance of Kṛṣṇa's pastimes. *Rasa* is of five kinds: *śānta*, *dāsya*, *sakhya*, *vātsalya* and *śṛṅgāra*. Of these, Kṛṣṇa is wholly subject to the devotees of four — *dāsya*, *sakhya*, *vātsalya* and *śṛṅgāra*.

Anubhāṣya.

Śānta-rasa is not named here for this reason. In the material world *śānta-rasa* stands highest of all, but in the spiritual world it stands very low. *Śānta-rasa* is transcendental, yet in it the *ālambana* of *rasa* — the *viṣaya* and the *āśrayas*, the object of love and those who love — do not exchange the roles of knower and known. Therefore in *dāsya*, *sakhya*, *vātsalya* and *madhura-rasa* love for Kṛṣṇa rises step by step in excellence.

12 With His servants and friends, His father and mother and His beloved ones, Kṛṣṇa sports in Vraja, absorbed in love.

An intimation of the Gaura-avatāra, in which magnanimity is foremost —

13 Having sported as He wished, Kṛṣṇa disappears, and afterwards He reflects:

14 "For a long time I have not given the gift of loving devotion (*prema-bhakti*), and without devotion the world has no ground to stand on.

*The world is driven by *vaidhī-bhakti* and therefore knows nothing of love for Kṛṣṇa —*

15 All over the world they worship Me by the rules of scripture (*vidhi-bhakti*), but devotion by rule has no power to reach the love of Vraja.

*In the mood of reverence, love for Kṛṣṇa, which is attained by pure *rāga* (spontaneous attraction), is extremely rare —*

16 The whole world is permeated by the awareness of My majesty, and love slackened by awe gives Me no joy.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

"Until now I have not given *prema-bhakti* to the world. People in the world read the scriptures and worship Me through *vidhi-bhakti*, devotion by rules. But My highest mood is the mood of Vraja, and *vidhi-bhakti* cannot attain it. In *vidhi-bhakti* the awareness of My majesty (*aiśvarya-jñāna*) prevails. In the mood of majesty *prema* grows slack — that is, it loses its depth. Therefore such *prema* does not please Me."

*The fruit of *vaidhī-bhakti* full of reverence: the four kinds of liberation and attaining Nārāyaṇa in Vaikuṇṭha —*

17 Worshipping by rule in the awareness of My majesty, they go to Vaikuṇṭha and attain the four kinds of liberation.

18 These are *sārṣṭi* (opulence equal to Mine), *sārūpya* (a form like Mine), *sāmīpya* (nearness to Me) and *sālokya* (residence in My world). But *sāyujya*, in which one becomes one with Brahman, the devotee never accepts.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Sārṣṭi is attaining majesty equal to Viṣṇu's; *sārūpya* is attaining a form like Viṣṇu's, with four arms and the other limbs and the same complexion; *sāmīpya* is dwelling near Viṣṇu; *sālokya* is living in Viṣṇu's world.

Anubhāṣya.

"Even when I offer them *sālokya*, *sārṣṭi*, *sārūpya*, *sāmīpya* and even oneness [with Me], people do not accept anything other than serving Me." (*Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 3.29.13); see also (*Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 9.7.67).[23]

Kṛṣṇa's own desire to teach how to worship Him —

19 I shall inaugurate the religion of the age, the congregational chanting of the holy name (*nāma-saṅkīrtana*), and, giving devotion in the four moods, I shall make the whole world dance.

For this very reason He descends as a devotee and a guru; preaching and personal example —

20 I shall take on the mood of a devotee, and by practising devotion Myself I shall teach it to all.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

"Those who worship Me on the path of rules, aware of My majesty, attain the four kinds of liberation — *sārṣṭi*, *sārūpya*, *sāmīpya* and *sālokya* — and go to Vaikuṇṭha. For *sāyujya-mukti*, liberation as oneness with Brahman, even the followers of *vidhi-bhakti* do not pray. But once devotees attain *prema-bhakti*,

they reject even those four kinds of liberation and live in the happiness of serving Me. It is My desire to preach to the world this *prema-bhakti*, which lies beyond *vidhi-bhakti*. I will give the world the *dharma* of the age of Kali, *nāma-saṅkīrtana*, together with the *rasas* of *dāsya*, *sakhya*, *vātsalya* and *śṛṅgāra*, and make all people dance. And I Myself will accept the mood of a devotee and teach the living beings of the world by My own conduct."

Preaching without personal example is fruitless —

21 Unless one practises dharma oneself, one cannot teach it. This is the conclusion sung in the *Gītā* and the *Bhāgavatam*.

*The time of descent (*Bhagavad-gītā*, Chapter 4, verses 7–8) —*

22 "Whenever, O descendant of Bharata, dharma declines and irreligion rises, then I manifest Myself." (Bhagavad-gītā, 4.7)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
O Arjuna, whenever *dharma* declines and *adharma* rises, I manifest Myself.

Anubhāṣya.
Śrī Kṛṣṇa recalled ancient times. The path of yoga He had once told the sun-god had been lost over time, so He told it again to Arjuna. To convince Arjuna, Bhagavān speaks of His own appearance:

he bhārata yadā yadā hi dharmasya glāniḥ (decline) **adharmasya abhyutthānam** (increase) **bhavati**, **tadā aham** (unable to bear these two [calamities], and in order to reverse them) **ātmānaṁ sṛjāmi**.

The work of the avatāra —

23 "To deliver the saints, to destroy the wicked and to establish dharma, I appear in age after age." (Bhagavad-gītā, 4.8)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
To deliver the sādhus, to destroy the wicked and to establish *dharma*, I appear in every *yuga*.

Anubhāṣya.

sādhūnām (of those wholly devoted to serving Me) **paritrāṇāya** (to remove the obstacles to their service) **duṣkṛtām** (of the enemies of the devotees — Rāvaṇa, Kaṁsa, Keśī and others, whom no one but I can slay) **vināśāya**, **dharma-saṁsthāpanārthāya ca** (and in order to practise and preach properly the *dharma* free of envy — devotion to the service of Bhagavān, which consists of *paricaryā* [service] and *saṅkīrtana*) **yuge yuge** (at the respective times) **sambhavāmi**.

*Preaching without personal example is futile and bears poisonous fruit (*Bhagavad-gītā*, Chapter 3, verse 24) —*

24 "If I did not act, these worlds would perish; I would be the cause of confusion among the classes of men and would ruin all these beings." (Bhagavad-gītā, 3.24)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

If I do not uphold the order of duties (*karma*) by performing My duties, this world will be ruined. I will become the cause of the mixing of the social orders, and I Myself will turn out to be the destroyer of the people.

Anubhāṣya.

Arjuna asked a doubting question about action. In reply, Bhagavān, who has no desire for material enjoyment, explains why He acts (sets an example):

cet (if) **ahaṁ karma na kuryām**, **ime lokāḥ utsīdeyuḥ** (would fall, taking Me as their example), **saṅkarasya ca kartā syām**, **imāḥ prajāḥ upahanyām** (I would make impure).

*The conduct of one who sets the example is the model for ordinary people (*Bhagavad-gītā*, Chapter 3, verse 21) —*

25 "Whatever the best of men does, others do the same; whatever standard he sets, the world follows." (Bhagavad-gītā, 3.21)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Whatever the best person does, others imitate. Whatever the best declares to be the "standard," everyone follows and holds dear.

Anubhāṣya.

śreṣṭhaḥ (a *mahājana*, a great soul) **yad yad yathā ācarati**, **tat tad** (the same) **itaraḥ** (the lesser) **janaḥ** ([does]); **saḥ** (the best) **yat pramāṇaṁ kurute**, **lokaḥ** (the other person) **tad anuvartate** (follows it).

*Preaching the *dharma* of the age is Viṣṇu's work, but no *aṁśa* of the Viṣṇu-*tattva* other than Kṛṣṇa can give love for Kṛṣṇa —*

26 The religion of the age can be established by My portion (*aṁśa*), but none but Me can give the love of Vraja.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
"I wish to appear in order to preach two things: the *dharma* of the age, *nāma-saṅkīrtana*, and the love of Vraja. An *aṁśa-avatāra* can do the work of preaching the *dharma* of the age. But no one other than Me — Śrī Kṛṣṇa, Bhagavān in full — can preach the love of Vraja."

*The words of Bilvamaṅgala in the *Laghu-bhāgavatāmṛta* (first part, 5.37) —*

27 "Let there be many all-auspicious avatāras of the Lord whose navel is a lotus; but who other than Kṛṣṇa gives prema even to the creepers?" (Laghu-bhāgavatāmṛta, 1.5.37)[3]

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
Bhagavān Paṅkajanābha may have many auspicious avatāras. But who other than Kṛṣṇa gives *prema* to the creepers — that is, to those who have taken shelter of Him?

Anubhāṣya.
paṅkaja-nābhasya (of Bhagavān Padmanābha) **sarvato-bhadrāḥ** (bestowing auspiciousness) **bahavaḥ avatārāḥ santu**; **api kṛṣṇāt anyaḥ ko vā latāsu** (to those who have taken shelter of Him) **prema-daḥ** (the giver of *prema-bhakti*) **bhavati**.

28 Therefore, taking My own devotees with Me, I shall descend to earth and enjoy many kinds of pastimes."

29 Thinking thus, Kṛṣṇa Himself descended in Nadia in the first junction (*sandhyā*) of the age of Kali.

Anubhāṣya.

Prathama sandhyā: the first *sandhyā*. A *sandhyā* is the time at the beginning and at the end of a *yuga*, which [together] make up a sixth part of the *yuga*. The first *sandhyā* of a *yuga* is a twelfth part, and the last *sandhyā* is also a twelfth. The first *sandhyā* of the age of Kali is therefore 36,000 solar years. Śrī Gaurasundara appeared when 4,586 years of the age of Kali had passed; therefore He took birth in the first *sandhyā*, in Śrī Māyāpura Navadvīpa. "The *sandhyās* of Kṛta and the other *yugas* are, in order, a sixth part of their own *yuga*." (Śrī *Sūrya-siddhānta*, *Madhyamādhikāra*, verse 17)

30 So the lion Caitanya appeared in Navadvīpa — with the neck of a lion, the strength of a lion and the roar of a lion.

31 May that lion take His seat in the cave of every soul's heart — the lion at whose roar the elephant of sin perishes.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Kalmaṣa means sin; *dvirada*, an elephant.

*The name "Viśvambhara" — the presiding deity of *abhidheya*, the means —*

32 In His early pastimes His name was Viśvambhara. He filled the world with the nectar of devotion and upheld all living beings.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Bhūta-grāma is the multitude of living beings.

33 The root *ḍubhṛñ* means "to nourish and to sustain": giving love, He nourished and sustained the three worlds.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

The word *Viśvambhara* is formed from the root *ḍubhṛñ*. The meaning of that root is to nourish and to sustain. By giving *prema* He nourished and sustained the three worlds.

*The name "Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya" — the presiding deity of *sambandha*, the relationship with the Lord —*

34 In His later pastimes He bears the name Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya. Making Śrī Kṛṣṇa known to all, He blessed the whole world.[4]

Anubhāṣya.

"In His last pastimes": that is, in the twenty-four years after He accepted *sannyāsa*. In the *sampradāya* of Śrī Viṣṇusvāmī, *tridaṇḍī* Vedic *sannyāsīs* of the ten names and of the hundred and eight names existed long before Śrī Śaṅkarapāda. But when Śaṅkara arose — a Vedāntist in name only, fond of reasoning about the attributeless — the society of the *pañcopāsakas*, the worshippers of five deities, was reorganized in India on the principle of reconciling all doctrines. Therefore Śrī Mahāprabhu accepted Vedic *sannyāsa* according to the custom of the *daṇḍī-sannyāsīs* of the ten names in the *sampradāya* of Śrī Śaṅkarācārya. In Āryāvarta, in an Ārya society that only resembles the Vedic — that is, merely calls itself a follower of the Vedas — many follow Śaṅkarācārya and, by the rule of Śaṅkara's *sampradāya*, worship the five deities.

The *sannyāsīs* of the ten names are these: "Tīrtha, Āśrama, Vana, Araṇya, Giri, Parvata, Sāgara, Sarasvatī, Bhāratī and Purī — these are the ten names." Below, for each, the title of the *sannyāsī*, the place and the title of the *brahmacārī* are given in order (see *Mañjuṣā*, issue 2, pp. 104–107). Tīrtha and Āśrama are titles of *sannyāsīs*; the place is Dvārakā; the *brahmacārī*'s name is Svarūpa. Vana and Araṇya are titles of *sannyāsīs*; the place is Puruṣottama; the *brahmacārī*'s name is Prakāśa. Giri, Parvata and Sāgara are titles of *sannyāsīs*; the place is Badarikāśrama; the *brahmacārī*'s name is Ānanda. Sarasvatī, Bhāratī and Purī are titles of *sannyāsīs*; the place is Śṛṅgerī; the *brahmacārī*'s name is Caitanya.

Śrī Śaṅkarācārya established four *maṭhas* — in the east, west, north and south of India — and put four of his disciples at their head. Under these four principal *maṭhas* countless branch *maṭhas* gradually arose. The *maṭhas* are assigned to regions, but in many cases this order has been upset. In the four *maṭhas* there are four *sampradāyas*: Ānandavāra, Bhogavāra, Kīṭavāra and Bhūmivāra. Over time the understanding of these *sampradāyas*, too, has become confused. The four *mahāvākyas*, the great sayings, are also divided among the *maṭhas*. To accept *sannyāsa*, one must first go to a *sannyāsī* guru who heads a *maṭha* and become a *brahmacārī*. Whatever kind of *sannyāsī* that guru is, he gives the

corresponding *brahmacārī* name. This custom is still strictly kept in this *sampradāya* today.

When Śrī Mahāprabhu went to Keśava Bhāratī to accept *sannyāsa*, His name became "Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya." Even after accepting *sannyāsa*, Bhagavān made known only His *brahmacārī* name. None of those who wrote of His pastimes says that He introduced Himself by the title "Bhāratī." In Śaṅkara's *sampradāya* the *sannyāsa* name is bound up with the conceit of being God (*īśvarābhimāna*); this, I think, is why Śrīman Mahāprabhu did not favor that usage. The *brahmacārī* name carries the self-conception of a servant of the guru (*guru-dāsyābhimāna*) and is not unfavorable to devotion. It is recorded, however, that Mahāprabhu accepted the *daṇḍa*, the *kamaṇḍalu* and the other marks of *sannyāsa*.

35 Knowing Him to be the avatāra of the age, the great Garga declared it at Kṛṣṇa's name-giving ceremony.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
Garga Mahāśaya knew that Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya is the avatāra of the age of Kali, and in the following verse he specified His color.

*Avatāras of four colors in the four *yugas* (*Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam*, Canto 10, Chapter 8, verse 13) —*

36 "Your son, who accepts a body in every age, has appeared in three colours — white, red and yellow; now He has become dark (*kṛṣṇa*)." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 10.8.13)[5]

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
"This boy of yours takes on white, red and yellow colors in the other three *yugas*; now, in Dvāpara, He has become black."

Anubhāṣya.
Garga Mahāśaya explains to Nanda Mahārāja why Kṛṣṇa is given this name, and in doing so he speaks of His other avatāras and of His being the source of avatāras:

anu-yugam (as befits each *yuga*) **tanūḥ gṛhṇataḥ asya** (of your son) **śuklaḥ raktaḥ tathā** (these words point to the future: in the first *sandhyā* of the Kali-yuga of the twenty-eighth *mahā-yuga* of the Vaivasvata *manvantara*) **pītaḥ**

(He will be yellow) **trayaḥ varṇāḥ āsan**. **idānīṁ hi kṛṣṇatāṁ gataḥ** (has attained).

37 White, red and yellow — these three lustres the Lord of Śrī assumes in the Satya, Tretā and Kali ages.

38 Now, in Dvāpara, He has become dark. This is the essence of all the scriptures — the Āgamas and the Purāṇas.

*(*Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam*, Canto 11, Chapter 5, verse 27)*

39 "In Dvāpara the Lord is dark, clad in yellow and bearing His own weapons, and He is known by the Śrīvatsa and other marks and characteristics." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 11.5.27)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

In the Dvāpara-yuga Bhagavān is marked in this way: He is dark in color, wears yellow garments, holds His own weapons — the flute and the rest — and bears the Śrīvatsa and other marks.

Anubhāṣya.

Nimi, the king of Videha, asked at what time and in what way the avatāras of Bhagavān descend. In reply, one of the nine Yogendras, Śrī Karabhājana, described the avatāras of Satya and Tretā and then speaks of the avatāra of Dvāpara:

dvāpare bhagavān śyāmaḥ pīta-vāsāḥ (He whose garments are yellow) **nijāyudhaḥ** (He who bears His own weapons — the club, the disc and the rest) **śrī-vatsādibhiḥ aṅkaiḥ** (by marks on His body) **lakṣaṇaiḥ** (and by external signs, such as the Kaustubha) **upalakṣitaḥ**.

The marks of the avatāra of the age of Kali —

40 In the age of Kali the religion of the age is the spreading of the holy name. For this the golden-hued avatāra, Caitanya, has come.

Anubhāṣya.

In his commentary on the *Muṇḍaka Upaniṣad*, Śrī Madhvācārya cites this evidence from the *Śrī Nārāyaṇa-saṁhitā*: "In Dvāpara people worship Viṣṇu by

the *Pañcarātras* alone, but in Kali Bhagavān Hari is worshipped by the name alone." The *Kali-santaraṇa Upaniṣad* also says: "Hare Kṛṣṇa Hare Kṛṣṇa Kṛṣṇa Kṛṣṇa Hare Hare / Hare Rāma Hare Rāma Rāma Rāma Hare Hare — these sixteen names destroy the contamination of the age of Kali. No means higher than this is found in all the Vedas."

41 His lustre is like molten gold, His body tall and mighty, and His deep voice surpasses the thunder of fresh rain-clouds.

42 One whose height and arm-span both measure four of his own cubits is famed as a *mahāpuruṣa*, a great person.

43 Such a person is called *nyagrodha-parimaṇḍala*, and Caitanya, the abode of all virtues, has such a body.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

He whose height equals four of his own cubits, measured by the length and span of his arms, is famed as a *mahāpuruṣa*, and his name is *nyagrodha-parimaṇḍala*.

Anubhāṣya.

Nyagrodha-parimaṇḍala: one who is four of his own cubits tall and as many broad, that is, around, measured by his own arms, is a *mahāpuruṣa*. And He who has subdued (*nyak*) all living beings and holds them in check (*rodha*) by His own *māyā* is Viṣṇu in full, possessed of the *catur-vyūha*.

44 His arms reach down to His knees, His eyes are like lotuses, His nose is finer than a sesame flower, and His face is like the moon.

45 He is peaceful and self-controlled, wholly given to devotion to Kṛṣṇa. He loves His devotees, is gentle by nature and looks on all beings with an equal eye.

46 Adorned with sandal paste and wearing armlets and bracelets of sandalwood, He dances in the saṅkīrtana of Kṛṣṇa's names.

47 Drawing on all these qualities, the sage Vaiśampāyana included His names in the *Thousand Names* of Viṣṇu.

Anubhāṣya.

Sahasra-nāma means the thousand names of Viṣṇu, that is, the *Mahābhārata*, the *Dāna-dharma* section, Chapter 149. Śaṅkarācārya and the Vaiṣṇava ācāryas down to Śrī Baladeva Vidyābhūṣaṇa have written commentaries on this text.

48 Caitanya's pastimes are of two parts, the early and the later, and in each of them He has four special names.

Anubhāṣya.

Ādi, the first: the householder pastimes (the first 24 years); *śeṣa*, the last: the pastimes of *sannyāsa* (the last 24 years). See verses 32–34. "Four names each": these are given in the next verse, 49.

*(*Mahābhārata*, *Dāna-dharma*, Chapter 149, *Sahasra-nāma*, 92 and 75)*

49 "He is of golden colour, His limbs are like gold, His form is beautiful, and He wears armlets of sandal. He has taken sannyāsa, He is self-restrained and tranquil, and His highest refuge is steadfastness and peace." (Mahābhārata, Dāna-dharma, 149; Viṣṇu-sahasra-nāma, 92 and 75)[6]

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

A golden color, a body like molten gold, a form beautiful in every limb, adornment with sandal and garlands — these four marks are seen in His pastimes as a householder. [In His pastimes of *sannyāsa* He is] a *sannyāsī*; He possesses the quality of *śama*, which consists in reflecting on the secrets of Hari; He is firmly fixed in the great sacrifice of *hari-kīrtana*; and He is wholly devoted to *mahābhāva*, attained through *śānti* — the *śānti* that silences the non-devotees who hold to *kevalādvaita*, pure monism.

Anubhāṣya.

suvarṇa-varṇaḥ (He whose color is yellow, like the color of gold) **hemāṅgaḥ** (He whose body is like gold) **varāṅgaḥ** (He whose body bears the marks of a *mahāpuruṣa*) **candanāṅgadī** (He whose armlets are anointed with sandal) (these are four names of Bhagavān Gauracandra in His first pastimes). **sannyāsa-kṛt** (devoted to the duty of a renunciant) **śamaḥ** (free from sense objects) **śāntaḥ** (He

whose mind is fixed on Kṛṣṇa alone) **niṣṭhā-śānti-parāyaṇaḥ** (*niṣṭhā* is one-pointedness of mind, and there is *śānti*; *niṣṭhā* and *śānti* are His highest shelter) (the *Sahasra-nāma* also cites these four names of Bhagavān Gaurahari in His last pastimes).

In Śrī Baladeva Vidyābhūṣaṇa's commentary on the *Viṣṇu-sahasra-nāma*, called *Nāmārtha-sudhā*, it is said: "*Suvarṇa-varṇa*: 'His color, that is, His form, is like gold,' according to the Śruti: 'When the seer sees the golden Creator, the Lord, the Puruṣa, the source of Brahman.'[24] *Hemāṅga*: 'His limbs, the bearers of color, are as desirable as gold.' *Varāṅga*: 'His limbs are excellent, that is, full of beauty.' *Candanāṅgadī*: 'His armlets (*aṅgada*) are *candana*, that is, they gladden the hearts of the devotees.' Some apply these four names, beginning with *suvarṇa-varṇa*, to His form as Kṛṣṇa Caitanya. Now, with six names, the verse points to His being Kṛṣṇa Caitanya. *Sannyāsa-kṛt*: 'He who performs *sannyāsa*, the life of a wandering renunciant.' *Śama*: 'He who reflects (*śamayati*) on the secret of Hari'; the root *śam* in the sense of 'to reflect' belongs to the tenth class. *Śānta*: 'He who has withdrawn (*śāmyati*) from everything other than Kṛṣṇa.' *Niṣṭhā*: 'That in which the sacrifices of devotion abide (*nitiṣṭhanti*), the chief of which is *hari-kīrtana*' — for the *smṛti* says, *kṛṣṇa-varṇaṁ tviṣākṛṣṇam* ("He who utters the name of Kṛṣṇa, yet is not dark").[25] *Śānti*: 'That by which the opponents of devotion, headed by the followers of *kevalādvaita*, are subdued.' *Parāyaṇa*: 'The highest shelter of all kinds of *bhāva*, up to *mahābhāva*.'"

50 The *Bhāgavatam* makes it clear again and again: in the age of Kali the congregational chanting of Kṛṣṇa's name is the essence of all.

*The *saṅkīrtana* of Kṛṣṇa's name is the *dharma* of the age (*Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam*, Canto 11, Chapter 5, verse 32) —*

51 "With sacrifices in which congregational chanting predominates, the wise worship the Lord who ever sings of Kṛṣṇa and whose lustre is not dark. He is always surrounded by His intimate companions (*aṅga*), His devotees (*upāṅga*), His weapons and His associates (*pārṣada*)." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 11.5.32)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Intelligent people worship, with a sacrifice in which *saṅkīrtana* is foremost, the Great Personality (*Mahāpuruṣa*) in whose mouth the syllables “Kṛṣṇa” always dwell, whose luster is *akṛṣṇa*, that is, golden, and who is surrounded by His limbs and subsidiary parts (*aṅgas* and *upāṅgas*), His weapons and His associates.

Śrī Jīva (in the *Krama-sandarbha*): “*Tviṣā*, by His luster: the One who is not black — that is, golden — the intelligent worship Him. That He is golden follows by elimination from the verse: ‘Your son, who accepts a body in every age, has appeared in three colours — white, red and yellow; now He has become dark (*kṛṣṇa*).’ (*Caitanya-caritāmṛta*, Ādi 3.36). It says that ‘now’ — in the Dvāpara famous as the age in which this avatāra descends — ‘He has become black.’ White and red are assigned to Satya and Tretā. Therefore the yellow color is spoken of as past with reference to earlier avatāras. Later it will be said that Śrī Kṛṣṇa is the complete form [of God]. He is called a *yuga-avatāra* because all avatāras are contained within Him, and so all their purposes are fulfilled in Him alone. It is thus naturally understood that whenever Kṛṣṇa descends in Dvāpara, Śrī Gaura too descends in the following Kali. It follows that this Gaura is a special manifestation of Śrī Kṛṣṇa, for this rule admits no exception. The verse itself shows that He is such a manifestation by the qualifier *kṛṣṇa-varṇam*: He in whom are the two syllables ‘Kṛṣ-ṇa’ — that is, in whose name ‘Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanyadeva’ the two syllables ‘Kṛṣ-ṇa’ are used, revealing that He is Kṛṣṇa.

“In the Third Canto, in the words of Śrī Uddhava, in the verse beginning *samāhutāḥ*, there is the phrase *śriyaḥ savarṇena*, and the commentary on it says: ‘He whose name has two syllables the same as [those of the name of] Śrī, that is, Rukmiṇī’; the expression *śriyaḥ savarṇo rukmī* is also found. Or else [*kṛṣṇa-varṇam* means]: He who describes (*varṇayati*) Kṛṣṇa — who Himself sings of Him, exulting in the memory of such pastimes of His own supreme bliss, and out of the greatest compassion teaches [this] to all people. Or else: He Himself is *akṛṣṇa*, golden, by *tviṣā*, His special beauty, and He teaches about Kṛṣṇa; the sense is that the mere sight of Him reveals Śrī Kṛṣṇa to all. Or else: though golden to all people, to special devotees He is, by *tviṣā* — a special manifestation — *kṛṣṇa-varṇa*, dark; that is, He is that very Śyāmasundara.[18] Therefore, since the very form of Śrī Kṛṣṇa is manifest in Him, He is a special manifestation of Kṛṣṇa Himself. That is the sense.

“The verse makes clear that He is Bhagavān with the words *sāṅgopāṅgāstra-pārṣadam*. His limbs (*aṅgas*) are so supremely charming that they themselves serve as *upāṅgas*, ornaments and the like. They are so powerful that they themselves are His weapons. They always dwell with Him alone, and so they themselves are His associates. Many great souls saw Him in just this way, again and again, and this is widely known among the people of Gauḍa, Varendra, Vaṅga, Utkala and other lands. Or else [by the other meaning of the particle *ca*]: His associates — the feet of the great soul Śrīmad Advaita Ācārya and others — are so intensely loved by Him that they are equal to His limbs, and He is present together with them. With what do they worship Him who is such? *Yajñaiḥ*, with the articles of worship, according to the words ‘[where there are no] sacrifices to the Lord of sacrifice, no great festivals.’[19] Among these the verse specially names the *abhidheya* itself, *saṅkīrtana*: when many gather together and sing of Śrī Kṛṣṇa, rejoicing in that singing — [with sacrifices] in which this is foremost. And since the primacy of *saṅkīrtana* is seen only among those who have taken shelter of Him, it is clear that here the *abhidheya* is He Himself. That is why the *Sahasra-nāma* gives names that point to His avatāra: ‘Golden in color, with a body like gold, beautifully formed, wearing armlets of sandal; the renunciant, self-controlled and peaceful’ (see *Caitanya-caritāmṛta*, Ādi 3.49). Śrī Sārvabhauma Bhaṭṭācārya, the crest-jewel of the most learned, also showed this: ‘May the bee of my mind sink ever more deeply into the lotus feet of Him who has appeared under the name Kṛṣṇa Caitanya to reveal again His own *bhakti-yoga*, lost in the course of time.’[20]” So [it is said] in the *Sarva-saṁvādinī*.

Anubhāṣya.

“In which *yuga* and in what way does Bhagavān descend?” In answer to this question of King Nimi, Śrī Karabhājana speaks of the source of avatāras in the age of Kali and of how He is worshipped:

su-medhasaḥ (the intelligent) **tviṣā** (by His luster) **akṛṣṇam** (golden like lightning — the third color, yellow, which remains after white and red) **kṛṣṇa-varṇam** (Him who describes, who sings of Kṛṣṇa; or, Him in whom are these two syllables, “Kṛṣṇa”) **sāṅgopāṅgāstra-pārṣadam** (together with His limbs [*aṅgas*] — Nityānanda and Advaita; His subsidiary parts [*upāṅgas*] — Śrīvāsa and the other devotees; His weapons [*astras*] — the holy name of Hari and so on; and His associates [*pārṣadas*] — Gadādhara, Dāmodara Svarūpa and others) **saṅkīrtana-**

prāyaiḥ (by singing *hari-kathā* and the names when many people gather together) **yajñaiḥ yajanti**.

52 Hear, brothers, of all this glory of Caitanya: this verse speaks of the very height of His greatness.

*Explanation of the verse *kṛṣṇa-varṇam* —*

53 The two syllables ‘Kṛṣ-ṇa’ are always in His mouth; or else, in His own joy He describes Kṛṣṇa.

54 Thus the two meanings of the word *kṛṣṇa-varṇa* are established: nothing but Kṛṣṇa ever comes to His lips.

55 And if anyone should say that He is dark in colour, the next adjective rules this out.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Someone might say, from the word *kṛṣṇa-varṇa* in the original verse, that the One worshipped in the age of Kali is “Kṛṣṇa,” dark. But the other qualifier, *tviṣākṛṣṇam*, does not allow that meaning.

56 By the lustre of His body He is not dark; and by the words “not dark” the verse tells of His yellow colour.[7]

*(*Stava-mālā*, the second prayer to Śrī Caitanyadeva, verse 1)*

57 “May that Lord who has appeared in the form of Caitanya be ever merciful to us! In the age of Kali the learned openly worship Him with sacrifices of loud congregational chanting. He is Kṛṣṇa, yet from the abundance of His lustre His body is not dark, and they declare Him the object of worship for all who have entered the fourth āśrama.” (Stava-mālā, Second Caitanyāṣṭaka, 1)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Śrī Kṛṣṇa has become *akṛṣṇa* — that is, has taken a golden form — because He is overflowing with luster, the *bhāva* of Śrī Rādhikā. In the age of Kali the learned openly worship Him with a sacrifice made of *kīrtana*. He is the only object of worship for those who serve in the fourth *āśrama*, the *paramahaṁsas* within *sannyāsa*. May that Supreme Person in the form of Caitanya bestow His mercy on us in abundance.

Anubhāṣya.

vidvāṁsaḥ (the learned) **sphuṭam** (openly) **dyuti-bharāt** (from the abundance of His luster) **akṛṣṇāṅgam** (golden, of yellow color) **kṛṣṇam utkīrtana-mayaiḥ** (resting on the devotion called loud *kīrtana*) **makha-vidhibhiḥ** (by the rites of the sacrifice of the name) **kalau abhiyajante**, **yaṁ ca akhila-caturthāśrama-juṣām** (of all mendicant monks) **upāsyam** (worthy of worship) **prāhuḥ**, **saḥ caitanyākṛtiḥ devaḥ naḥ** (us) **atitarām** (exceedingly) **kṛpayatu**.

The effulgence of Brahman destroys darkness —

58 His lustre of molten gold is plain to see, and its radiance dispels all the darkness of ignorance.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Tamas-tati: the spreading darkness of ignorance.

59 To destroy the darkness of the living beings' sins, He bears many weapons — His intimate companions (*aṅga*), His devotees (*upāṅga*) and the holy name.

*What is called darkness, or *kalmaṣa* —*

60 Any action opposed to devotion, be it righteous or unrighteous, is called 'sin' (*kalmaṣa*). That is the great darkness.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Be it *dharma* or *adharma*, whenever an action is opposed to devotion, it is called *kalmaṣa* — and that is the great darkness.

61 Raising His arms and calling "Hari!", He casts His loving glance on all; He destroys their sins and floods them with love.

*(*Stava-mālā*, the second prayer to Śrī Caitanyadeva, verse 8)*

62 "His smiling glance wholly takes away the sorrow of the worlds; His very first words make a whole row of blessings burst into leaf; and what flood of love does the touch of His feet not bring? May that Lord who has appeared in the form of Caitanya be ever merciful to us!" (Stava-mālā, Second Caitanyāṣṭaka, 8)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

His smiling glance completely takes away the sorrow of the world. As soon as He begins to speak, the creeper of devotion — the creeper of every blessing — puts forth new leaves. Shelter at His feet reveals all the secrets of *prema*. May that Supreme Person in the form of Caitanya bestow His mercy on us in abundance.

Anubhāṣya.

yasya (of Caitanyadeva) **smitālokaḥ** (the glance with a gentle smile) **jagatām** (of all living beings) **paritaḥ** (completely) **śokam** (sorrow, want) **harati** (destroys), **girāṁ prārambhaḥ** (the beginning of His words) **tu kuśala-paṭalīm** (the series of blessings) **pallavayati** (unfolds), **padālambhaḥ** (shelter at His feet) **kaṁ vā prema-nivaham** (all *prema*) **na hi praṇayati** (does not bestow), **saḥ caitanyākṛtiḥ devaḥ naḥ** (us) **atitarāṁ kṛpayatu**.

*Whoever sees Gaura is freed of sin and attains *prema* —*

63 Whoever sees His beautiful form and face is freed from sin and attains the treasure of love.

*Other avatāras have weapons and armies, but the Gaura-avatāra has devotees and *saṅkīrtana* —*

64 In other avatāras the Lord came with armies and weapons, but the army of Caitanya-Kṛṣṇa is His intimate companions and devotees (*aṅga* and *upāṅga*).

*(*Stava-mālā*, the first *Caitanyāṣṭaka*, verse 1)*

65 "He is ever worshipped by the gods headed by Śiva and Brahmā, who, full of love for Him, have taken human bodies; and He teaches His own

devotees the pure way of worshipping Him. Will that beautiful Caitanya come once again before my eyes?" (Stava-mālā, First Caitanyāṣṭaka, 1)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Śrī Caitanyadeva is lovingly honored by Śiva, Brahmā and the other gods, who have taken human bodies, and all living beings always worship Him. He teaches His devotees the pure way of worshipping Him. Will that Caitanyadeva come before my eyes again?

Anubhāṣya.

praṇayitāṁ vahadbhiḥ (bearing love, that is, intent on nourishing their own attachment) **dhṛta-manuja-kāyaiḥ** (who have taken human bodies) **giriśa-parameṣṭhi-prabhṛtibhiḥ** (Śiva, the four-headed [Brahmā] and others) **gīr-vāṇaiḥ** (by the gods) **sadā** (eternally) **upāsyaḥ** (worshipped) **sva-bhaktebhyaḥ** (to His own intimates — Svarūpa, Rāmānanda and others) **śuddhām** (pure — free of other desires, not covered by *karma*, *jñāna* and the like) **nija-bhajana-mudrām** (the way of worshipping Him) **upadiśan saḥ caitanyaḥ kiṁ punaḥ api me** (my) **dṛśoḥ padaṁ yāsyati** (will reach)?

66 These weapons, His intimate companions and devotees, accomplish His work. Now hear with attention another meaning of the word *aṅga*.

67 The evidence of scripture says that the word *aṅga* means a portion (*aṁśa*), and a part of that portion is called *upāṅga*.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Besides the meaning already explained, the word *aṅga* has another: *aṅga* means *aṁśa*, a part. *Paramāṇa* is the same as *pramāṇa*, evidence. The parts of an *aṅga* are the *upāṅgas*.

*(*Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam*, Canto 10, Chapter 14, verse 14)*

68 "Are You not Nārāyaṇa? For You are the Self of all embodied beings, O Lord, and the witness of all the worlds. Nārāyaṇa is Your portion — so called because His abode is the waters born of Nara; and that too is true, not Your māyā." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 10.14.14)[8]

Anubhāṣya.
See Ādi 2.30.

The meaning of this verse —

69 The Nārāyaṇa who lies on the waters and dwells within every heart is Your portion (*aṁśa*); You are the original Nārāyaṇa.[9]

70 By the word *aṅga* the portions (*aṁśa*) are meant, and They are real. They are not a product of māyā: all of Them are full of consciousness and bliss.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
The word *aṅga* refers to the three *puruṣas*, beginning with Kāraṇābdhiśāyī, who are *aṁśas*. They are full of spirit and bliss, the true Īśvara, the Lord — not *tattvas* created by *māyā*. Therefore Advaita and Nityānanda are the Lord's two *aṅgas*.

Anubhāṣya.
In the realm of *māyā*, *māyā* divides an object and it becomes a part. With *viṣṇu-tattva* it is not so: it cannot come under the control of *māyā*. Therefore, though He is a part, He is not divided either in His nature as Viṣṇu or in His substance. The example of a lamp shows this: another lamp is lit from the original lamp, yet in substance they do not differ. In the same way all the *viṣṇu-tattvas* appear from Baladeva, the *svayaṁ-prakāśa*, or *vilāsa*, of Kṛṣṇa, the original form (*svayaṁ-rūpa*). Their pastimes differ, but in substance they are one. The separated parts (*vibhinnāṁśa*), however — Brahmā and Śiva — can come under the control of *māyā*, and therefore they have acquired a capacity for transformation. All those Viṣṇus are full of spirit and bliss, and all are masters of *māyā*: *māyā* has no power over them. On other *tattvas* *māyā* does act. As curd is a transformation of milk, so are *śambhu-tattva* and the rest.

The two generals —

71 Advaita and Nityānanda are the two *aṅgas* of Caitanya, and the parts of these *aṅgas* I call *upāṅgas*.

72 These *aṅgas* and *upāṅgas*, ever with the Lord, are His sharp weapons for crushing the unbelievers.

Anubhāṣya.

Pāṣaṇḍa: those who imagine that *śiva-tattva* and the like, which are subject to *māyā*, are equal to *viṣṇu-tattva*, the master of *māyā*. They do not realize that Bhagavān's pastimes are eternal, and they regard even the eternal truth of devotion as mere activity, divided by time and impermanent. Viṣṇu and His own associates labor to rid such *pāṣaṇḍīs* of their wicked intelligence.

The two Viṣṇus are the two generals —

73 Nityānanda Gosāñi is Haladhara Himself, the bearer of the plough, and Advaita Ācārya Gosāñi is the Lord (*Īśvara*) Himself.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

That is, He is directly an avatāra of Mahā-Viṣṇu.

*The devotees are the army, and *kīrtana* of Kṛṣṇa is the weapon —*

74 Taking with them the army of associates headed by Śrīvāsa, the two generals go everywhere performing kīrtana.

75 Nityānanda Rāya bears the banner of the crusher of unbelievers, and at the roar of the Ācārya sins and unbelievers flee.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Bānā: a sign; an instrument like the *tūrī* or *bherī* (trumpet or kettledrum), whose sound announces that the *pāṣaṇḍīs*, the godless, will be crushed.

*Gaurasundara is the very father of *kīrtana* of Kṛṣṇa —*

76 Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya is the founder of saṅkīrtana, and blessed is he who worships Him by the sacrifice of saṅkīrtana.

As a father is pleased when his son is honored, so Gaura is pleased by

**kīrtana* of Kṛṣṇa —*

77 He alone is truly intelligent; the rest of the world is foolish. Of all sacrifices the sacrifice of Kṛṣṇa's name is the essence.

To think the Lord in the form of the holy name equal to material activities is godlessness —

78 Whoever says that ten million horse sacrifices (*aśvamedha*) equal one name of Kṛṣṇa is an unbeliever, and Yama punishes him.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

One who worships Kṛṣṇa Caitanya with the sacrifice of *saṅkīrtana* is truly *sumedhā*, that is, intelligent. Those in this world who do not worship Him in this way are utterly foolish. The sacrifice of Kṛṣṇa's name is the essence of all sacrifices. Ten million *aśvamedha* sacrifices cannot be compared with a single name of Kṛṣṇa. One who thinks them equal is a *pāṣaṇḍī*, and Yama punishes him.

Anubhāṣya.

"To consider [the name] equal to all auspicious activities — *dharma*, vows, renunciation, sacrifices and the like — is also a blunder." This eighth offense against the holy name must be avoided in every way. "Giving away ten million cows during a solar eclipse, living for a *kalpa* by the waters of the Gaṅgā at Prayāga, performing ten thousand sacrifices, giving away as much gold as there is in Mount Meru — none of this equals even a hundredth part of glorifying Govinda."

79 Śrī Jīva Gosāñi has explained this verse of the *Bhāgavatam* (3.51) in the auspicious invocation of his book *Bhāgavata-sandarbha*.

*(*Tattva-sandarbha*, verse 2)*

80 "Inwardly He is Kṛṣṇa, outwardly He is golden, and He has displayed the splendour of His *aṅgas* and other associates. In this age of Kali, through saṅkīrtana and the other limbs of devotion, we have taken shelter of Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya." (Tattva-sandarbha, 2)[10]

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

In the age of Kali we take shelter, through *saṅkīrtana* and the other limbs [of devotion], of Kṛṣṇa Caitanya. He is marked by the splendor of His *aṅgas*, *upāṅgas* and the rest; within He is Kṛṣṇa Himself, and without He is Gaura.

Anubhāṣya.

Śrī Jīva Gosvāmī placed the verse *kṛṣṇa-varṇaṁ tviṣākṛṣṇam* in the *maṅgalācaraṇa* of the *Bhāgavata-sandarbha*, or *Ṣaṭ-sandarbha*. Similar to it is his own verse, *antaḥ kṛṣṇaṁ bahir gauram*. This is the second verse of that *maṅgalācaraṇa*, and it merely explains Karabhājana's verse in the *Bhāgavatam*. Its meaning is explained at the beginning of the *Sarva-saṁvādinī*, the supplementary commentary (*anuvyākhyā*) on the *Ṣaṭ-sandarbha*.

antaḥ-kṛṣṇam (Him within whom, in the depth of whose heart, is Kṛṣṇa; Him in whom the mood of the lover [*nāgara*] dwelling in Kṛṣṇa's heart is covered by the mood of Rādhā's heart) **bahir gauram** (Him whose form is yellow with the rays of His bodily luster) **darśitāṅgādi-vaibhavam** (Him who has shown, revealed, the splendor of His limbs, subsidiary parts, weapons and associates) **kṛṣṇa-caitanyam kalau saṅkīrtanādyaiḥ** (by the sacrifice of *nāma-kīrtana* and the rest) **vayam āśritāḥ sma**.

81 In the Upapurāṇas too we hear the words of Śrī Kṛṣṇa, which He mercifully spoke to Vyāsa:

(In an Upapurāṇa)

82 “O brāhmaṇa, at some time in the age of Kali I Myself shall take the order of sannyāsa and lead people stricken by sin to devotion to Hari.” (Upapurāṇa)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

O *brāhmaṇa*, in a certain special Kali-yuga I shall accept the *āśrama* of *sannyāsa* and give *hari-bhakti* to people stricken by sin.

Anubhāṣya.

This verse is found in one of the Upapurāṇas.

he brahman, **aham** (Bhagavān) **eva kvacit kalau** (in the first *sandhyā* of the Kali-yuga of the twenty-eighth *catur-yuga* of the Vaivasvata *manvantara*) **sannyāsāśramam** (the fourth *āśrama*) **āśritaḥ san** (having accepted) **pāpa-hatān narān hari-bhaktiṁ grāhayāmi** (I shall give).

The evidence of scripture that Gaurasundara is Bhagavān Himself —

83 The *Bhāgavatam*, the *Mahābhārata*, the Āgamas and the Purāṇas give clear proof of the descent of Caitanya-Kṛṣṇa.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Many statements prove that Caitanya-Kṛṣṇa is a direct avatāra. In the *Bhāgavatam* there are the words *kṛṣṇa-varṇaṁ tviṣākṛṣṇam* ("He who utters the name of Kṛṣṇa, yet is not dark"), *āsan varṇās trayaḥ* ("there were three colors"), *channaḥ kalau* ("hidden in the age of Kali") and others. In the *Mahābhārata* there are the words *sambhavāmi yuge yuge* ("I appear in every *yuga*"), *sannyāsa-kṛc chamaḥ śāntaḥ* ("the renunciant, self-controlled and peaceful") and others. In the Vedas there are *mahān prabhur vai puruṣaḥ* ("the Puruṣa is indeed the great Lord"), *yadā paśyaḥ paśyate rukma-varṇam* ("when the seer sees the golden One") and others. In the Tantras that follow the Āgamas there are many statements such as *māyāpure bhaviṣyāmi śacī-sutaḥ* ("I shall be the son of Śacī in Māyāpura"). And in the Upapurāṇa there are the words *aham eva* ("I Myself") and what follows.

Anubhāṣya.

See the *Anubhāṣya* on Ādi 2.22.

Direct evidence of this —

84 See for yourselves His many manifest powers — His wondrous deeds and the extraordinary signs of His love.

Anubhāṣya.

Gaura is Kṛṣṇa, and this is the aim of the scriptures. One can understand it directly as well: by seeing with one's own senses what Śrī Mahāprabhu's pastimes can do, His superhuman conduct and the variety of His superhuman glory and power.[26]

*The *adhokṣaja-tattva*, the Truth beyond the senses, cannot be seen with eyes that crave enjoyment —*

85 Yet the non-devotees see without seeing, as the owl does not see the rays of the sun.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Ulūka: a kind of owl that is blind by day. Unable to see the rays of the sun, it cannot admit that the sun exists.

*(Ālavandāru Yāmunācārya, *Stotra-ratna*, verse 15)*

86 "Though You are made known by Your supremely excellent nature, forms and deeds, by Your wondrous power and purity, by the mighty scriptures and by the teachings of the renowned knowers of the divine Truth, those of demonic nature can never understand You." (Stotra-ratna, 15)[11]

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

O Bhagavān, Vyāsa and the other devotees who know the highest truth and the truth of Your avatāras are able to know You: through the powerful *sāttvika* scriptures they discern Your character, Your form, Your deeds and Your supremely *sāttvika* nature. But living beings of demoniac nature, endowed with the qualities of *rajas* and *tamas*, are unable to know You.

Anubhāṣya.

Śrī Yāmunācārya, the guru and *parama-guru* of Śrī Rāmānujācārya, who is also called Ālavandāru, describes Bhagavān's glory and majesty in verses 15 and 18 of his *Stotra-ratna*:

he bhagavan, **parama-prakṛṣṭaiḥ** (most excellent) **śīla-rūpa-caritaiḥ** (by His character, forms and deeds) **sattvena** (by superhuman power) **sāttvikatayā** (by the predominance of *sattva*) **prabalaiḥ śāstraiḥ prakhyāta-daiva-paramārtha-vidām** (of the renowned knowers of the divine and of the highest truth) **mataiḥ ca āsura-prakṛtayaḥ** (the wicked, the enemies of the devotees) **tvāṁ boddhum** (to know) **na samarthāḥ bhavanti**.

But the devotee's love conquers the Unconquerable and makes the Unlimited measurable —

87 Kṛṣṇa tries in many ways to hide Himself, yet His devotee knows Him.

*(Ālavandāru Yāmunācārya, *Stotra-ratna*, verse 18)*

88 "Your sovereign nature transcends the three kinds of limits and admits of no equal or superior. Though You hide it by the power of Your māyā, some who are devoted to You alone see it constantly." (Stotra-ratna, 18)[12]

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

O Bhagavān, everything is confined by three limits — space, time and thought. But Your hidden nature has no equal and none above it, and so it exists beyond those three limits. By the power of Your *māyā* You conceal this nature, yet Your exclusive devotees are always able to see You.

Anubhāṣya.

ullaṅghita-trividha-sīma-samātiśāyi-sambhāvanam (that which oversteps, surpasses, the limits of the three — space, time and substance — and even the possibility of an equal or a superior) **bhavatā māyā-balena** (by the power of Your *yogamāyā*) **nigūhyamānam api tava parivraḍhima-svabhāvam** (the nature, the *svarūpa*, of Your lordship) **kecit tvad-ananya-bhāvāḥ** (those whose feeling is directed to You alone — the *ekāntins*, the exclusive devotees) **aniśam** (unceasingly) **paśyanti**.

*The *adhokṣaja-tattva* is attained through devotion, not reached by knowledge born of the senses —*

89 Those of demonic nature never know Kṛṣṇa, but from His devotees He cannot hide.

*(*Padma Purāṇa*)*

90 "In this world there are two kinds of created beings, the divine and the demonic. The devotee of Viṣṇu is called divine, and his opposite demonic." (Padma Purāṇa)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

In this world living beings are created of two kinds, *daiva*, the godly, and *āsura*, the demoniac. The devotees of Viṣṇu are *daiva*, and those who are not devoted to Viṣṇu are their opposite, that is, demoniac by nature.

Anubhāṣya.

asmin loke daivaḥ āsuraḥ ca eva dvau bhūta-sargau (two kinds of created beings): **viṣṇu-bhaktaḥ** (the servant of Hari) **daivaḥ smṛtaḥ**, **tad-viparyayaḥ** (one absorbed in enjoyment within *māyā*) **āsuraḥ** (a person of material nature) **eva**.

The Ācārya is the avatāra of a devotee, and therefore he has the power to make Gaura descend —

91 Ācārya Gosāñi is the Lord's avatāra as a devotee, and His roar was the cause of Kṛṣṇa's descent.

Before the avatāra of the original form, His servants, the elders, appear —

92 When Kṛṣṇa descends to earth, He first causes His elders to appear.

93 Father, mother, guru and all who are to be honoured — He first has them all take birth on earth.

94 Mādhavendra Purī, Īśvara Purī, Śacī and Jagannātha appeared, and Advaita Ācārya appeared along with them.

The state of society before the Lord's descent —

95 Having appeared, the Ācārya saw the whole world busy with worldly affairs, without even a trace of devotion to Kṛṣṇa.

The pious and the sinner alike enjoy the senses and alike suffer the disease of worldly existence —

96 Some through sin, some through piety, all were enjoying the objects of the senses; there was not even a scent of the devotion that cures the disease of worldly existence.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Before Bhagavān Himself descends, He sends the elders — that is, He has them take birth on earth. Together with other elders appeared Śrī Mādhavendra Purī, Śrī Īśvara Purī, Śrī Śacī, Śrī Jagannātha and Śrī Advaita Ācārya. Having appeared, the Ācārya saw that the whole world was entangled in sin and piety and devoid of devotion to Kṛṣṇa. Living beings were enjoying the objects of the senses, but they did not mix with this the devotion to Kṛṣṇa that cures the disease of worldly existence.

The Ācārya reflects on showing mercy to living beings —

97 Seeing the state of the people, the compassionate Ācārya pondered how they might be helped.

98 He thought: "If Śrī Kṛṣṇa Himself were to descend, He would practise devotion Himself and so spread it.

99 In the age of Kali there is no religion but the holy name. Yet how will Kṛṣṇa descend in the age of Kali?

Kṛṣṇa descends only by the power of pure service —

100 With a pure heart I shall worship Kṛṣṇa, and with humility I shall pray to Him unceasingly.

Only Viṣṇu can bring Viṣṇu down — hence his name, Advaita —

101 Only when I have brought Kṛṣṇa here and spread His kīrtana will My name 'Advaita' bear fruit."

102 As He pondered by what worship Kṛṣṇa could be won over, a verse came to His mind.

*The devotee's self-surrender defeats the Unconquerable (words of the *Viṣṇu-*

dharma and the *Gautamīya-tantra*) —*

103 "For merely a leaf of tulasī or a palmful of water, the Lord who loves His devotees sells Himself to them." (Viṣṇu-dharma; Gautamīya-tantra)[13]

Anubhāṣya.

bhakta-vatsalaḥ (Bhagavān, devoted to His own) **tulasī-dala-mātreṇa** (with merely a *tulasī* leaf, without sandal paste, *mantras* and the like) **jalasya culukena** (with a mouthful of water) **vā bhaktebhyaḥ ātmānaṁ vikrīṇīte** (places Himself in their power).

104–105 The Ācārya pondered the meaning of this verse: "Kṛṣṇa is indebted to the person who offers Him tulasī and water. He considers how to repay him, and finds: 'In all My house there is no wealth equal to water and tulasī.'"[14]

106 So He repays the debt by selling Himself. Thinking thus, the Ācārya began His worship.

107 Meditating on Kṛṣṇa's lotus feet, He constantly offered Him tulasī buds (*mañjarī*) with the water of the Gaṅgā.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

When a *tulasī* leaf and merely a mouthful of water are offered to Śrī Kṛṣṇa with devotion, He sells Himself to the devotee out of love for His devotees.

Some manuscripts contain two more verses: "A *tulasī* leaf with a bud at its tip, double and small, is called a *mañjarī*; it is celebrated in the worship of Kṛṣṇa. As Rādhā is dear to Viṣṇu, so the *mañjarī* is dear to Hari; therefore one should offer it with care, mixed with sandal."

Kṛṣṇa cannot repay His debt to one who offers Him water and *tulasī*, and so He repays it by giving His very self in exchange. Therefore, to make Kṛṣṇa descend in His own true form, Advaita Ācārya kept offering Gaṅgā water with *tulasī-mañjarīs* at Kṛṣṇa's lotus feet.

108 With a mighty roar He called out to Kṛṣṇa, and in this way He brought about Kṛṣṇa's descent.[15]

Kṛṣṇa Himself displays the pastimes of Gaura to fulfill His devotee's desire — the distribution of love for Kṛṣṇa —

109 This is the chief cause of Caitanya's descent: the Lord, the protector of dharma, descends by the desire of His devotee.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Kṛṣṇa, the bridge of *dharma*, descends by the desire of His devotee. Caitanya appeared at the prayer of the great devotee Advaita Ācārya.

*(*Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam*, Canto 3, Chapter 9, verse 11)*

110 "O Lord, the path to You is seen through hearing, and You dwell in the lotus of the heart that devotion has purified. O Urugāya, widely sung One, whatever form of Yours Your devotees contemplate, that very form You reveal to them out of mercy." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 3.9.11)[16]

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Brahmā said: "O Lord, You always move along the paths of Your devotees' hearing and sight. You always dwell in the lotus of their hearts, purified by *bhakti-yoga*. O Urugāya, whatever eternal form of Yours the devotees contemplate in their hearts, out of mercy to them You manifest that very form."

Thus ends the third chapter of the "Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya."

Anubhāṣya.

Having attained the *darśana* and mercy of Bhagavān through austerity, Brahmā, wishing to create, offers Him prayers:

nanu (O) **nātha** (O Lord) **śrutekṣita-pathaḥ** (He whose path is seen through *śruta*, hearing the conclusions of scripture) **tvaṁ puṁsāṁ bhakti-yoga-paribhāvita-hṛt-saroja** (in the lotus of the heart, purified, made fit, by *bhakti-yoga*, that is, by *prema*) **āsse** (You dwell). **dhiyā yad yad vibhāvayanti** (contemplate), **[he] urugāya** (O You who are sung of in many ways — Urukrama), **sad-anugrahāya** (to show mercy to the *sat*, the devotees) **tat tad vapuḥ** (body) **praṇayase** (You bring fully near to them, You manifest).

Thus ends the third chapter of the “Anubhāṣya.”

111 The meaning of this verse, in brief, is this: all Kṛṣṇa’s descents take place by the desire of His devotees.

112 Thus I have made the meaning of the fourth verse clear: Gaura descended to reveal divine love.[17]

113 Praying at the feet of Śrī Rūpa and Śrī Raghunātha, I, Kṛṣṇadāsa, narrate the *Caitanya-caritāmṛta*.

Notes

1. The same verse as Ādi 1.4. ↩
2. As in the Gauḍīya Maṭha edition: «সহিত» (another reading: «সহিতে»). ↩
3. In the edition — “the words of Bilvamaṅgala” (*Laghu-bhāgavatāmṛta*, Pūrva-khaṇḍa, 5.37). ↩
4. In the edition verses 3.32 and 3.34 are headed: the name Viśvambhara is the presiding Deity of *abhidheya* (the means), the name Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya the presiding Deity of *sambandha* (knowledge of the relationship). ↩
5. Garga Muni’s words to Nanda Mahārāja. ↩
6. The source is given as in the edition; the second *Sahasra-nāma* verse is 75 (so the edition gives it at Madhya 6.104; here it misprints “95”). ↩
7. As in the Gauḍīya Maṭha edition: «অকৃষ্ণবরণে তাঁর কহে» (in other copies «তাঁর» is missing). ↩
8. The same verse as Ādi 2.30 (see the note there on the three meanings of the name Nārāyaṇa). Here the author cites it for the word *aṅgam*, “part”: Nārāyaṇa is Your *aṅga*, that is, Your *aṁśa* (3.67, 3.69). ↩
9. In the edition the verse is introduced by the words «অস্যার্থঃ» — “its meaning (of verse 3.68) is this”. ↩
10. The source is given as in the edition: *Tattva-sandarbha*, the first of the six *Sandarbhas*, verse 2. ↩
11. The source is given as in the edition: Śrī Yāmunācārya’s (Ālavandār’s) *Stotra-ratna*, verse 15. ↩
12. The source is given as in the edition: verse 18. ↩

13. The source is given as in the edition («বিষ্ণুধর্ম-বচন ও গৌতমীয়-তন্ত্র-বাক্য»). ↩
14. As in the Gauḍīya Maṭha edition: «এই শ্লোকার্থ» (another reading: «এ শ্লোকার্থ»). In the edition 3.104 and 3.105 are numbered separately. ↩
15. As in the Gauḍīya Maṭha edition: «কৃষ্ণের» (another reading: «কৃষ্ণেরে»); the sense is the same. ↩
16. Brahmā's prayer. ↩
17. As in the Gauḍīya Maṭha edition: «কৈল» ("I have made"; another reading: «হৈল», "has become"). ↩
18. Unclear passage: the edition (scan checked) reads *sarva-loka-draṣṭāraṁ kṛṣṇaṁ gauram api* (literally, "Kṛṣṇa, the seer of all people, though golden"). Translated by the sense, following the parallel with the next phrase, *bhakta-viśeṣa-dṛṣṭau* ("in the eyes of special devotees"): one would expect *sarva-loka-dṛṣṭau gauram api*, "though golden in the eyes of all people." ↩
19. *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 5.19.24. ↩
20. *Caitanya-caritāmṛta*, Madhya 6.255. ↩
21. That is, 4,320,000. ↩
22. So in the edition (৯৭৫৩২০০০০). ↩
23. The edition gives "Bhāg. 9.7.67" — apparently a misprint: the same refusal of the four kinds of liberation by devotees content with service is found in the Lord's words to Durvāsā about His devotees, *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 9.4.67. ↩
24. *Muṇḍaka Upaniṣad* 3.1.3. ↩
25. *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 11.5.32 (*Caitanya-caritāmṛta*, Ādi 3.51). ↩
26. In the edition this section is also numbered 83; by its content it belongs to verse 84. ↩

An Account of the Root Purpose of Caitanya’s Descent

(English translation from the Bengali, following the Gauḍīya Maṭha edition and the «Anubhāṣya», 2026 — draft)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya

Summary. In this fourth chapter the author firmly declares that Śrī Caitanya descended to fulfill three hidden purposes. The first is this: “Rādhikā is the *āśraya*, the abode of My love. I am its *viṣaya*, its object, and so I cannot feel the happiness known to the *āśraya*. Therefore I will take up the *bhāva* of Rādhikā, the very embodiment of the *āśraya*, and relish that happiness.” The second purpose: “Śrīmatī Rādhikā relishes My own sweetness. Though this sweetness attracts the whole world, I Myself cannot relish it. Unless I accept Rādhikā's feelings and radiance, this purpose will not be fulfilled.” The third purpose: “In My company Rādhikā finds greater happiness than I find in Hers. So there must be in Me some unprecedented *rasa*, and by relishing it Rādhikā's happiness has grown greater. From My own, different position (*vijātīya*) I cannot experience that happiness. By accepting Rādhikā's feelings and radiance I will be able to relish it as She does (*sajātīya*).” The wish to fulfill these three hidden desires brought about the avatāra of Caitanya. Establishing the *dharma* of the age and the like, and the worship of Advaita and the other devotees, are only the external causes of this avatāra. Śrī Svarūpa Gosvāmī is the foremost of Mahāprabhu's intimate devotees, and this hidden truth is found in the verses of his diary (*kaḍacā*). Verses composed by Śrī Rūpa Gosvāmī confirm this conclusion. In this chapter the author shows how *kāma* and *prema* differ in their very essence, and he separates the desire to please Śrī Kṛṣṇa from *kāma*.

The nature of Śrī Kṛṣṇa is ascertained by the mercy of Śrī Gaura —

1 By the grace of Śrī Caitanya even a child, looking into the scriptures, can ascertain the true form of Him who sports in Vraja.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
By the mercy of Śrī Caitanya even an ignorant person, having studied the scriptures, is able to ascertain the true nature of Śrī Kṛṣṇa, who enjoys His pastimes in Vraja.

Anubhāṣya.
bālaḥ (a child) **api śrī-caitanya-prasādena** (by the mercy of Gaura) **śāstram dṛṣṭvā vraja-vilāsinaḥ** (of the son of the king of Vraja) **tad-rūpasya** (of the form of Gaura, nondifferent from Rādhā and Kṛṣṇa) **vinirṇayam** (a statement of the truth about Him) **kurute**.

2 Glory, glory to Śrī Caitanya! Glory to Nityānanda! Glory to Advaitacandra! Glory to all the devotees of Gaura!

3 I have explained the meaning of the fourth verse. Now hear with attention the meaning of the fifth.

4 To bring out the meaning of the root verse, I shall first give an outline before applying it.

*The meaning of the fourth of the fourteen opening verses: preaching the name and *prema* is the external cause of the Gaura-avatāra —*

5 The essence of the fourth verse, as I have explained it, is this: the Lord descended to spread divine love and the holy name.

6 This reason is true, but it is external. There is another reason, an inner one — hear it.[1]

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
In the third chapter the essence of the fourth verse was determined as follows: Gaurāṅga descended to preach *prema*, that is, *prema-bhakti*, and the name of

Kṛṣṇa. The reason given in that conclusion is true, yet it too is external (*bahiraṅga*), not hidden. There is also an internal (*antaraṅga*), that is, a hidden reason, and that I shall now describe.

Approaching the hidden cause of the Gaura-avatāra, the author first describes how the pastimes of Kṛṣṇa and Viṣṇu differ —

7 The scriptures proclaim that in the past Kṛṣṇa descended to remove the burden of the earth.[2]

*The work of Viṣṇu is to protect the *sādhus* and destroy the wicked; this is not the work of Kṛṣṇa Himself —*

8 But removing the burden is not the work of Bhagavān Himself. It is Viṣṇu, the maintainer, who protects the world.

When Kṛṣṇa, the source of the avatāras, descends, the avatāra Viṣṇu joins Him —

9 Yet the time of Kṛṣṇa's descent coincided with the time for removing that burden.

10 When the complete Bhagavān descends, all the other avatāras come and meet in Him.

11–12 Nārāyaṇa, the Catur-vyūha, Matsya and the other avatāras, the avatāras of the yugas and the manvantaras, and as many others as there are — all come and descend within the body of Kṛṣṇa. So does Kṛṣṇa, the complete Bhagavān, descend.

Through Viṣṇu, His part present within His body, He removes the world's burden and performs the pastime of maintaining it —

13 Therefore Viṣṇu was then within the body of Kṛṣṇa, and through Viṣṇu Kṛṣṇa slew the demons.

14 The killing of the demons is a secondary work. Now I shall tell the root cause for which He descends.

*Viṣṇu descends to preach *vidhi-bhakti*, devotion by rules; Kṛṣṇa descends as Gaura to preach *rāga-bhakti*, devotion of spontaneous love —*

15–16 To taste the very essence of the rasa of love, and to spread in the world devotion on the path of rāga (*rāga-mārga*) — for these two reasons the desire to descend arose in Kṛṣṇa, the crown of all who relish rasa, the supremely merciful.

17 The whole world is permeated by the awareness of My majesty, and love slackened by awe gives Me no joy.[3]

Anubhāṣya.
For this same verse see Ādi 6.16.

18 One who regards Me as the Lord and himself as lowly — by his love I am not subdued; I do not become dependent on him.

19 In whatever mood a devotee worships Me, in that very mood I reciprocate with him. Such is My nature.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
When Bhagavān Kṛṣṇa Himself descended, the time had also come to remove the world's burden. That task belongs to Viṣṇu, the maintainer of the world; removing the burden is not the work of Bhagavān Himself. But when Kṛṣṇa's time to descend arrived, the time to remove the burden arrived as well. Therefore all of them descended in Kṛṣṇa, the complete Bhagavān, within His body: Nārāyaṇa; the *catur-vyūha*, that is, Vāsudeva, Saṅkarṣaṇa, Pradyumna and Aniruddha; all the *aṁśa-avatāras* beginning with Matsya; the *yuga-avatāras*; and the *manvantara-avatāras*. The avatāras of Bhagavān — His limbs (*aṅgas*), parts (*aṁśas*) and other partial forms — invariably rest in the complete Bhagavān as their shelter. That is why Viṣṇu, the maintainer, was present in Kṛṣṇa's own form. It is through Viṣṇu that Kṛṣṇa slays the *asuras*. Killing the *asuras* is merely a secondary task of Kṛṣṇa's avatāra. Its root cause is this: Kṛṣṇa, the supreme

rasika and supremely compassionate, wished to descend in order to relish the very essence of the *rasa* of *prema* and to spread *rāga* and devotion in the world. This was what Kṛṣṇa felt in His heart: “The world is filled with awareness of My majesty (*aiśvarya-jñāna*). The love that arises from such awareness is slackened, and it gives Me no pleasure. When a devotee thinks himself lowly and regards Me as the Lord (*Īśvara*), his love is bound up with majesty, and to such love I never submit. As anyone worships Me, so I reciprocate with him — that is My nature.”

*(*Śrīmad Bhagavad-gītā*, Chapter 4, verse 11)*

20 “As people surrender to Me, so do I reward them. O Pārtha, all men follow My path in every way.” (Bhagavad-gītā, 4.11)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

O Pārtha, in whatever way someone worships Me, in that way I become attainable to him. All people follow My path, that is, the path I have shown.

Anubhāṣya.

The teaching on *yoga* that Bhagavān once gave to Sūrya came down through the succession and in time became distorted. Then He gave the same teaching again to Arjuna. Bhagavān speaks this verse while explaining the reason for His manifest pastimes:

[he] pārtha (O Arjuna), **ye** (the devotees) **yathā** (with whatever feeling) **mām** (to Me, Kṛṣṇa) **prapadyante** (surrender), **ahaṁ tathaiva tān bhajāmi** (in that very way I show them mercy). **manuṣyāḥ sarvaśaḥ** (people, in every way) **mama vartma** (My path — the path to perfection) **anuvartante** (follow).

21–22 Whoever renders Me pure devotion in the mood “He is my son, my friend, the lord of my life”, considering himself great and Me equal or lower — in that mood I become subject to him.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

“Whoever in pure devotion feels toward Me *vātsalya* — ‘Kṛṣṇa is my son,’ *sakhya* — ‘Kṛṣṇa is my friend,’ or *madhura-bhāva* — ‘Kṛṣṇa is the lord of my life,’ — by the particular nature of his *rasa* regards Me as lower and himself as greater. To that feeling I submit.” Pure devotion (*śuddha-bhakti*) is the

cultivation of service to Kṛṣṇa with a favorable intention, free from all other desires and not covered by *jñāna* and *karma*.

Anubhāṣya.

In the *Śrī Caitanya-caritāmṛta*, alongside the words "*bhakti*" and "*śuddha-bhakti*," we also find the word "*viddha-bhakti*." From this we see that devotion is divided into three kinds. *Viddha-bhakti*, "pierced" or mixed devotion, is the name for service to Hari joined with other desires, covered by *jñāna*, *karma*, *yoga* and the like, and accompanied by the pursuit of enjoying things unrelated to Kṛṣṇa. Covered attempts at service — mixed with *karma*, with *jñāna*, with *yoga*, with vows aimed at enjoyment and so on — belong to *viddha-bhakti*: in them there are endeavors other than pure devotion. When one follows rules that consist of unmixed service, "*bhakti*" arises. This devotion is distinct from *viddha-bhakti* and consists of endeavors favorable to Viṣṇu. But loving service that springs from greed (*lobha*) to follow the causeless, eternal service of Hari rendered by the *rāgātmika* devotees — that is *śuddha-bhakti*. It is not driven by rules alone. "*Vaidhī-bhakti*," or "*bhakti*," or "*aviddha-bhakti*" helps *śuddha-bhakti*, yet the word "*śuddha-bhakti*" points specifically to *rāgānugā* service. Among the stages of devotion *śuddha-bhakti* can be called "the highest limit" (*parākāṣṭhā*). It is devotion full of *rāga*, and it abides in Goloka. *Vaidhī-bhakti*, devotion full of reverence, abides in Paravyoma, or Vaikuṇṭha.

*(*Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam*, Canto 10, Chapter 82, verse 44)*

23 "Devotion to Me brings living beings to immortality. And how fortunate you are to have the love that brings you to Me!" (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 10.82.44)[4]

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Devotion to Me is the nectar of immortality for the *jīva*. O *gopīs*! Your love for Me is the one and only cause of your attaining Me.

Anubhāṣya.

At the time of a solar eclipse the Yādavas came to Samanta-pañcaka from Dvārakā, and Nanda Mahārāja came from Vraja with all his people. When Śrī Kṛṣṇa met the *gopīs* of Vraja, the residents of Gokula, He said to them:

mayi (to Me) **bhūtānām** (of living beings) **bhaktiḥ** (devotion — hearing, chanting and the rest) **amṛtatvāya** (for immortality — for the position of an eternal

associate) **kalpate** (makes fit). **bhavatīnām** (in you, the *gopīs*) **mad-āpanaḥ** (which brings about meeting Me face to face) **mat-snehaḥ** (love for Me) **yad āsīt** (has arisen), **tad diṣṭyā** (that is truly My good fortune).

24 My mother binds Me in the mood of a son; thinking Me utterly helpless, she fondles and cares for Me.

25 My friend, in pure friendship, climbs on My shoulders and says, "What great man are You? You and I are equal!"

26 When My beloved, in her pique (*māna*), rebukes Me, her reproaches steal My heart more than the hymns of the Vedas.

Anubhāṣya.

Sometimes the *āśraya*, under the sway of pure *anurāga* and regarding the *viṣaya* as her very own, speaks harsh words to Him, like a scolding. Such words reveal the utmost and exclusive love (*prīti*). But where the *viṣaya* is regarded as worshipable and as a superior (*guru*), natural love is slackened to a greater or lesser degree. The Vedic scriptures have laid down injunctions and prohibitions for ignorant people devoid of love. Compare the respectful words that befit people bound by rules with words born of love. The latter lack reverential worship, yet in excellence they surpass *vaidhī* hymns of praise. A pure devotee, free from every object other than Kṛṣṇa, is more intimately related to Bhagavān. The eternal function (*nitya-vṛtti*) that awakens with awareness of such a relationship is in every respect more precious than *vaidhī* reverence, in which majesty predominates.

27–28 Taking this pure devotion with Me, I shall descend and perform many kinds of wondrous pastimes, such as are not shown even in Vaikuṇṭha — pastimes that astonish even Me.

29 By her own power Yogamāyā will awaken in the gopīs a love for Me as a lover who is not their husband (*upapati*).

Anubhāṣya.

In the realms beyond *māyā* — Vaikuṇṭha and the others — a variety of Bhagavān's pastimes is manifest. Yet there the wonder of Kṛṣṇa, the original form (*svayaṁ-rūpa*), does not become ever new. Above those realms is Goloka, where pastimes are manifest whose aim is the *svayaṁ-rūpa*'s own happiness. He wished to manifest such pastimes in the material world in order to show their excellence to devotees for whom majesty is foremost. The *āśraya* herself understands that by the rules she owes greater reverence to another than to the *viṣaya*. Yet she deceives and abandons the one to whom her reverence is due by the rules and strives toward Kṛṣṇa — under the sway of *anurāga* for Him, drawn by a sweetness free of any trace of majesty. This urge to serve as *parakīyā* is brought about by *yogamāyā*. Such a working of the spiritual (*cinmayī*) *māyā* is beyond the comprehension even of the *viṣaya*; it is possible only through *yogamāyā*, the embodiment of His mercy.

30 Neither I nor the gopīs will know of it, for each of us will ever steal the other’s heart with beauty and virtues.

Anubhāṣya.

When one experiences the feeling that the Lord (*Īśvara*) has toward those subject to Him, one cannot perceive how the *āśraya* strives to astonish the *viṣaya*. That is why, in describing what is special about *yogamāyā*, the author calls her the helper of those who belong to the *āśraya*. The *viṣaya* and the *āśraya*, each experiencing his or her own feeling, are drawn to each other when they come to perceive the other's feeling. People who wander in the external world cannot enter this variety of pastimes. Until the *jīva* reaches that state, or at least acquires a taste for it, the good fortune of experiencing it does not dawn for him.

31 Leaving dharma behind, the two will meet in love (*rāga*) — sometimes meeting, sometimes not, as destiny arranges.

Anubhāṣya.

Leaving aside the dignified *dharma* of rules, Kṛṣṇa and the *gopīs*, drawn to each other, overcome every obstacle and meet. At that time their duties under the rules fall still, and, kindling each other, they cannot help but meet. To bring their meeting to its fullness it is sometimes nourished by the *rasa* of *vipralambha*, separation. In the material, inert world there are qualities such as undesirability, and therefore *vipralambha* there appears as mere absence. But in the

transcendental realm, in the time of separation, the wonder born of complete absorption (*samāveśa*) increases. In meeting, the sense that the desired one is present slackens somewhat. In separation, however, the longing to be united with those feelings is stronger, and so separation brings forth even greater wonder.

32 I shall taste the essence of all these rasas, and by this means I shall show grace to all My devotees.

33 Hearing of the pure love (*rāga*) of Vraja, the devotees will worship Me on the path of rāga, leaving aside their religious duties (*dharma-karma*).

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

"In Vaikuṇṭha and elsewhere," that is, in Vaikuṇṭha, Goloka and the other abodes, certain pastimes are not manifest. Those pastimes I shall manifest in this avatāra as Kṛṣṇa, and they will astonish even Me. My *yogamāyā*, My *svarūpa-śakti*, will by My will and by her inconceivable power awaken in the hearts of the *gopīs*, My eternal beloveds, the feeling that I am their *upapati* — a lover who is not their husband. For the fullness of *rasa* I Myself will not know this then: My inconceivable *śakti* will cover My omniscience and so produce a wonderful *rasa*. And the *gopīs*, though they are the *svarūpa-śakti* herself, will not know it either. I and My *gopīs* will steal each other's hearts by Our wonderful beauty and qualities. Then We will leave the ordinary path of *dharma*, and on the pure path of *rāga* the joy of Our meeting will dawn. Meeting and separation will come in turn, as if by the will of destiny. I will relish the very essence of all these *rasas* and then, well pleased, give it to the devotees. And this is how I will give that *rasa* to all devotees: hearing of the pure *rāga* I will manifest in Vraja, the devotees will give up *dharma* and *karma* and worship Me on the path of *rāga*.

Anubhāṣya.

Śrī Raghunātha Dāsa Gosvāmī Prabhu in his *Manaḥ-śikṣā* — "Do not perform the *dharma* or the *adharma* spoken of by the Śrutis"[33] — and the emperor Śrī Kulaśekhara in his prayer *Mukunda-mālā* — "I have no attachment to *dharma*, to amassing wealth or to sensual pleasure. Let whatever must be, according to my past deeds, come to pass, O Bhagavān. This alone I pray for, this I prize above all: birth after birth may I have unwavering devotion to Your two lotus feet" — in these

and similar verses have described *rāga-bhakti*, which lies beyond *svadharma*. “Whoever, understanding merits and faults, gives up all his own duties, even those I have taught, and worships Me — he too is the best of the virtuous.” (*Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 11.11.32)

*Only liberated souls who have reached perfection on the path of *rāgānugā sādhana* are entitled to hear of the transcendental *rāsa* pastimes —*

34 “To show favour to His devotees, Kṛṣṇa takes a body like a human one and performs such pastimes that whoever hears of them must become wholly devoted to Him.” (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 10.33.36)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
To show mercy to His devotees Bhagavān manifested a human body and revealed the *rāsa* pastimes. Qualified devotees who hear of them will devote themselves to those pastimes and worship Him in them.

Anubhāṣya.
King Parīkṣit asked Śrī Śukadeva whether Kṛṣṇa's *parakīyā* pastimes were right and why they were needed. Śukadeva answered:

bhaktānām (to the servants of Hari abiding in their various *rasas*) **anugrahāya** (to distribute mercy) **mānuṣaṁ deham** (a body befitting a human being — a supreme transcendental body[34]) **āśritaḥ** (having assumed) **tādṛśīḥ krīḍāḥ bhajate** (performs such pastimes), **yāḥ** (pastimes) **śrutvā** (on hearing [of which] even another person gains faith in Bhagavān and) **tat-paraḥ** (devoted to the service of Kṛṣṇa) **bhavet** (becomes).

35 The verb *bhavet* is in the injunctive mood (*vidhi-liṅ*), and so it says here: this is certainly a duty, and to neglect it is a fault.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
In this verse the verb *bhavet* is in the *vidhi-liṅ*, the injunctive mood. It is therefore established that this is an obligatory duty. Otherwise, that is, if one does not do it, there is *pratyavāya* — a fault.

Anubhāṣya.
Bhagavān, full of endless pastimes, eternally abides in His many forms of manifestation (*prakāśa*). Devī-dhāma, the material world, is a distorted reflection

of Goloka and Vaikuṇṭha. The variety within the material world resembles that of Goloka and Vaikuṇṭha, but it has limitation, inferiority, insignificance or undesirability, and subjection to time. The many manifestations of the *viṣaya-vigraha* abide eternally in relationships of service suited to the different classes of *jīvas* who depend on Him (*āśrita*). In Vaikuṇṭha there is pure *sattva*; in the material world one sees mixed *sattva*, made of the *guṇas*. Because the *viṣaya* and the *āśraya* eternally experience each other, the variety of pastimes is eternal. Judged by what suits the *āśraya*, the saying “The human body is the root of worship” is justified. In the material world the human race stands on a high rung of creation. *Jīvas* belonging to the *āśraya*, while they dwell in the material world, gain the right to serve the *viṣaya-vigraha* suited to them.

Besides His human form, Bhagavān also has many nonhuman forms. The variety of pastimes depends on how the object of worship appears as the *jīva*'s original nature (*svarūpa-vṛtti*) awakens. If one compares these pastimes by what suits [the *āśraya*], the greatest mercy is given to devotees who have taken shelter of the eternal pastimes in human form. When such pastimes descend into the material world, the best of human beings become eager to serve the object of service, each in the way that suits him. Hearing how the object of worship is experienced at the summit of worship gives the *jīva* enormous help in the unfolding of his original nature. Of the five kinds of *rati*, or *sthāyi-bhāva*, the highest is *madhura-rati*. Joined with all the ingredients of *rasa*, it manifests the best of all *rasas*, and only a devotee who has acquired taste (*ruci*) is entitled to it. To make it easier to acquire taste, Bhagavān manifests in the world the pastimes of Rāma and others instead of the pastimes of Matsya, Kūrma, Varāha and others. Yet in the human pastimes of Rāma and the rest the wonder of *rasa* does not reach its full strength. That wonder is not wholly within the reach of the *jīva*'s intellect and is extremely rare; still, *parakīyā madhura-rati*, when the degrees of majesty and sweetness are compared, manifests it as incomparable and ever new.

The *sahajikas*, whose intelligence is worldly, cannot understand the teaching of the transcendental *sahaja-dharma* and bring licentiousness into it. By this they do not point to the variety of Goloka, which consists of pure *sattva*; they only drag an impure heart down into sense gratification. In the transcendental pastimes there is service to Adhokṣaja. The *prākṛta-sahajikas* do not understand this, and in their error they take service to Kṛṣṇa for sense gratification aimed at enjoyment. Bhagavān's pastimes that have descended into the material world are by no means a playground for the *prākṛta-sahajikas*. Kṛṣṇa's *rāsa* and His other pastimes are

created by *yogamāyā*, and worldly reasoning cannot see them properly. The Sahajiyā sect regards Kṛṣṇa's pastimes as one more perishable enjoyment. They distort the meaning of the words *tat-paratvena nirmalam*[35] and *tat-paro bhavet* and merely throw the rubbish of the mundane onto the transcendental. Mistaking the meaning of the words *tādṛśīḥ krīḍāḥ* (“such pastimes”), they sink into sense gratification. In truth, however, the primary meaning of the word *tādṛśī* is transcendental *rati*. The *jīva* seized by ignorance (*avidyā*) and turned away from Hari rejects the transcendental pastimes and, intoxicated with material enjoyment through knowledge gained by the senses, misinterprets this verse. As soon as *vivarta* — taking one thing for another — appears at the stage of *sādhana* or of perfection, the *jīva* becomes a *prākṛta-sahajiyā*.

Seeing the word *bhavet* in the *vidhi-liṅ* form, let no one think that this *rāgānugā* path, attained through taste, is a prescribed (*vaidha*) path for all regardless of qualification, even for a pleasure-seeker full of *anarthas*. In the material world there is consideration of what should and should not be done. In Goloka-Vṛndāvana such rules[36] cannot exist. There, on the path of *anurāga*, all the *āśrita-tattvas*, under the sway of greed (*lobha*), seek only one desirable thing — Kṛṣṇa's pleasure.

The *madhura-bhāva* is the highest [*rati*] in the material world; the *jīva*-soul must eternally and necessarily serve in it. If anyone is indifferent to it, he will certainly abandon service to Bhagavān and fall into perishable worldly debauchery. If the *jīva* does not devote himself to *madhura-rati*, the base doctrine of material enjoyment, the opposite of *madhura-rati*, will prevail in him. In the same way, if in *vātsalya-rati* the *jīva* turns away from serving Kṛṣṇa, the urge to enjoy will drag him down into perishable affection for a son. In the same way, if one does not regard Kṛṣṇa as one's only friend, perishable friends devoted to the senses will come and drag the *jīva* down. In the same way, having turned away from Bhagavān, the *jīva* will become indifferent to serving Kṛṣṇa. He will play the servant to a perishable body that serves the senses for enjoyment, and he will forget his true nature. In the same way, if the mind does not find equanimity (*nirapekṣā*) in Kṛṣṇa, the *jīva* will turn away from Kṛṣṇa and become indifferent to matter. That is, he will become a slave of *mokṣa*, or *nirvāṇa*, which is called “turning to stone,” and become an impersonalist. Whoever is indifferent to entering Kṛṣṇa's pastimes will be dominated by an intelligence devoted to the senses and bent on enjoyment. Because of this his false ego,

founded on designations, will swell in good and bad deeds alike and deprive him of the ultimate good.

*Establishing *dharma* and the like is not the main work of Kṛṣṇa, the original form, or of Gaura —*

36–37 As this desire was the cause of Kṛṣṇa's appearance and the slaying of the demons only a secondary purpose, so too Caitanya-Kṛṣṇa is the complete Bhagavān, and to inaugurate the religion of the age (*yuga-dharma*) is not His own desire.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

In the avatāra as Kṛṣṇa, Kṛṣṇa appeared because of the desire just described, and killing the *asuras* was not His main purpose but only a secondary one. In the same way, in the avatāra as Gaura, Kṛṣṇa Caitanya is the most complete Bhagavān, and establishing the *dharma* of the age, *nāma-kīrtana*, was not His own work. But when the complete Bhagavān resolved for a certain hidden reason to descend, it so happened that the time for the *dharma* of the age arrived at that very moment. So Gaurāṅga descended for two reasons: for His hidden, internal purpose and for the external one, preaching the *dharma* of the age. Having descended, He relished *prema* and *nāma-saṅkīrtana* together with His devotees.

*The source of the avatāras unites with His own part, the *yuga-avatāra* —*

38 When for some reason He resolved to descend, the time of the *yuga-dharma* coincided with it.

Having descended for the hidden and the external reasons, He Himself practices [the teaching] and preaches it —

39 Descending for these two reasons, together with His devotees He Himself tastes prema and the congregational chanting of the name.

40 By this means He spread kīrtana even among the outcastes; weaving a garland of the holy name and divine love, He placed it around the whole world.

41 Thus, accepting the mood of a devotee, He preached devotion by practising it Himself.

Anubhāṣya.

Wishing to manifest His pastimes of magnanimity (*audārya-līlā*), Kṛṣṇa revealed in the material world His eternal pastimes as Gaura. In the eternal pastimes of Gaura, Kṛṣṇa is in the mood of a devotee, and this is the wonder of His eternal pastimes. Kṛṣṇa, the original form, brought the eternal pastimes of Gaura down into the world and made the service of Kṛṣṇa, the object of service, easily accessible to the *jīvas*. The debauched sect of *prākṛta-sahajikas* does not know the true nature of transcendental *vipralambha*. They pervert the meaning of Śrī Gaurasundara's acceptance of the mood of a devotee and wish illegitimately to present Him as a form of *sambhoga* (enjoyment in union). They adorn themselves with invented titles such as “Nadīyā-nāgarī” or “Gaura-nāgarī” and wipe out the mood of the devotee, that is, of the *āśraya*, in the *rasa* of eternal separation. Such outrages do not please Kṛṣṇa, the original form. Śrī Gaura-vigraha, the original form, does not bestow mercy on these *prākṛta-sahajikas* devoted to enjoyment but keeps them far away from Himself. To apply the *sambhoga* considerations of Kṛṣṇa's pastimes to Him whose pastimes are full of the *rasa* of *vipralambha* is an attempt to destroy devotion to Kṛṣṇa. It is nothing but hatred of Śrī Gaura.

*The *āśrayas* of the four *rasas* other than *śānta* desire only Kṛṣṇa's pleasure —*

42 Servitude, friendship, parental love and the love of the beloved (*śṛṅgāra*) — these are the four kinds of prema, and the four kinds of devotees are their vessels.

*Each devotee considers his own *rasa* the best for pleasing Kṛṣṇa —*

43 Each considers his own mood the best, and in that mood he tastes happiness with Kṛṣṇa.

*Judged impartially, the transcendental *madhura-rasa* contains all the other*

**rasas*, and so in it the endeavor to please Kṛṣṇa is greatest —*

44 But if one considers it in one's heart without partiality, the sweetness of *śṛṅgāra* surpasses that of all the other rasas.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Dāsya, *sakhya*, *vātsalya* and *madhura* — each of these four *rasas* seems to its own devotees the best for relishing Kṛṣṇa's happiness. But if one looks *taṭastha*, that is, impartially, it becomes clear that the sweetness of the *madhura*, or *śṛṅgāra*, *rasa* surpasses the other three.

*In *dāsya*, *sakhya*, *vātsalya* and *madhura-rasa*, one after another, the relish of Kṛṣṇa's happiness grows fuller —*

45 "Although love (*rati*), rising from one kind to the next, is ever richer in delight, by the inclination of the heart one particular kind seems sweetest to a particular devotee." (Bhakti-rasāmṛta-sindhu, 2.5.38)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Rati full of delight (*ullāsa*) unfolds in ever more special relish. In particular cases, according to *vāsanā*, this *rati* becomes a special, supreme relish and manifests as *madhura-rasa*.

Anubhāṣya.

asau ratiḥ (this *rati*) **yathottaram** (progressively, one after another) **svādu-viśeṣollāsa-mayī** (ever more full of special sweetness) **api vāsanayā** (according to differences of *vāsanā*) **kā api kasyacit** (to one devotee or another) **svādvī bhāsate** (appears sweet).

**Madhura-rasa* is of two kinds: *svakīyā* and *parakīyā* —*

46 Therefore I call it *madhura-rasa*, the sweet rasa. It exists in two forms: *svakīyā*, conjugal love, and *parakīyā*, love not bound by marriage.

Anubhāṣya.

The *Ujjvala-nīlamaṇi* says of Kṛṣṇa's *svakīyā* beloveds: "The *svakīyās* are those who have been married by rite, who are devoted to their husband's commands and unwavering in fidelity." The *svakīyās* are women who have been taken in marriage according to the rules of scripture; they diligently carry out their

husband's will and are unwavering in the *dharma* of fidelity to him. Of the *parakīyās* (Kṛṣṇa's beloveds): “The *parakīyās* are those who have given themselves out of *rāga* alone, caring neither for this world nor for the next, and whom *dharma* has not accepted [as wives].” The *parakīyās* are women who, drawn by *anurāga* to a man not their husband, surrender themselves to him. They know that the rules of the *dharma-śāstras* do not recognize such a union, and still they pay no heed to any hardship, in this world or the next.

*Of the two, Kṛṣṇa's pleasure is greatest in *parakīyā-bhāva*, and it abides only in Vraja —*

47 In *parakīyā* rasa rises to its highest delight, and nowhere but in Vraja does it dwell.

**Pārakīya-bhāva* abides eternally in the beautiful women of Vraja and reaches its highest limit in Śrī Rādhā —*

48 In the young women of Vraja this mood is boundless, and among them it reaches its summit in Śrī Rādhā.

49 Her love, mature and pure in feeling, is the highest of all; it is through this love that the sweetness of Kṛṣṇa is tasted in its fullness.

*Accepting the *bhāva* of Śrī Rādhā, He fulfills His three desires in the form of Gaura —*

50 Therefore Śrī Hari, appearing as Gaurāṅga, accepted that mood and fulfilled His own desire.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Because the sweetness of *śṛṅgāra-rasa* is greater than that of the other three *rasas*, it is called “*madhura-rasa*,” the sweet *rasa*. This *madhura-rasa* is of two kinds, *svakīya* and *pārakīya*. When *madhura-rasa* arises in the awareness that Kṛṣṇa is one's wedded husband, we call it *svakīya madhura-rasa*. When it arises in the awareness that Kṛṣṇa is an *upapati*, a paramour, we call it *pārakīya madhura-rasa*. Those who have studied *madhura-rasa* have concluded with one voice that in *pārakīya-bhāva* the delight of *madhura-rasa*

is greater, and that this *rasa* abides nowhere but in Vraja. Many think that Śrī Kṛṣṇa, who eternally enjoys His pastimes in Goloka, appeared in Vraja only for a short time and there performed these pastimes in *pārakīya-bhāva*. But this is not the view of the Gosvāmīs. According to the Śrī Gosvāmīs, the pastimes in Vraja are eternal too. "Vraja" is the very name of the most intimate inner chambers of Goloka, the eternal spiritual abode. Whatever pastimes Śrī Kṛṣṇa performed when He descended into the material world, the same pastimes go on eternally in the eternal abode of Vraja. The *pārakīya-rasa* abides eternally in Vraja. Kavirāja Gosvāmī said in the third chapter: "At the end of the Dvāpara of the twenty-eighth cycle, Kṛṣṇa appears in this world together with His Vraja" (*Caitanya-caritāmṛta*, Ādi 3.10). From the words "together with His Vraja" it is clear that in the spiritual realm there is an inconceivable abode (*pīṭha*) called "Vraja." Together with that abode Kṛṣṇa descended into the material world by the power of His spiritual potency (*cit-śakti*). Nowhere except in this eternal Vraja, the inner chambers of Goloka, does the *pārakīya-rasa* abide, for there abides a *rasa* infinitely superior to that of Goloka. It is only that in the manifest Vraja the eyes of the *jīvas* beheld the variety of the unmanifest Vraja. The *bhāva* of the wives of Vraja reaches its limit, its utmost boundary, in Śrī Rādhā. Śrī Rādhā's love in Vraja, a mature and pure *bhāva*, is the highest of all. For through it Kṛṣṇa relishes the *rasa* of His own sweetness as fully as is at all possible. Therefore Gaurāṅga-Śrī Hari accepted that *bhāva* and fulfilled His own desire.

*(*Stava-mālā*, the first *Caitanyāṣṭaka*, verse 2)*

51 "He is the refuge hard to reach even for the lords of the gods, the supreme goal of the Upaniṣads, the all-in-all of the sages, the sweetness of the hosts who bow to Him, and the very essence of the love of the lotus-eyed cowherd girls of Vraja. Will that Caitanya ever again come before my eyes?" (Stava-mālā, the first Caitanyāṣṭaka, 2)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

He whom the gods can hardly approach, the supreme goal of the Upaniṣads, the whole wealth of the sages, the sweetness of the hosts of devotees bowed before Him, the very essence of the love that dwells in the eyes of the young maidens of Vraja — will that Caitanyacandra ever again come before my sight?

Anubhāṣya.

sureśānām (of Mahendra and the others) **durgam** (a shelter hard to approach) **upaniṣadām** (of the Upaniṣads, the crown of the Vedas) **atiśayena gatiḥ** (the supreme goal) **munīnāṁ sarva-svam** (the sole wealth of sages weary of matter) **praṇata-paṭalīnām** (of the hosts of devotees) **madhurimā** (the abode of beauty) **nikhila-paśu-pālāmbuja-dṛśām** (of all the women of Vraja) **premṇaḥ viniryāsaḥ** (the essence of love) **sa caitanyaḥ punaḥ api kiṁ me dṛśoḥ padaṁ yāsyati** (will reach)?

*(*Stava-mālā*, the second *Caitanyāṣṭaka*, verse 3)*

52 "Eager for delight, the Lord stole from one among the host of His beloveds (Śrī Rādhā) Her boundless wealth of rasa, indescribably sweet, that He might relish it Himself. For this He covered His own lustre and revealed here Her radiance. May He, in the form of Caitanya, be boundlessly merciful to us!" (Stava-mālā, the second Caitanyāṣṭaka, 3)[5]

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Kṛṣṇa, who delights in play, relished the *rasas* of the many who love Him and wished to enjoy a certain boundless, special *madhura-rasa*. For that He hid His own complexion, accepted the radiance of Śrī Rādhā and appeared in the form of Caitanya. May He bestow on us His special mercy.

Anubhāṣya.

kutukī (He who delights in relishing *bhāvas*) **yaḥ kasya api praṇayi-jana-vṛndasya** (of a certain host of loving ones — the embodiments of love for Him) **kam api** (indescribable) **apāraṁ madhuraṁ rasa-stomam hṛtvā upabhoktum** (in order to relish it Himself by accepting their *bhāva*) **tadīyām** (belonging to those loving ones) **dyutim** (radiance) **prakaṭayan** (manifesting) **svām** (His own — the radiance of His form, dark as a dense rain cloud) **rucam āvavre** (covered), **saḥ caitanyākṛtiḥ devaḥ** (the beloved of the *gopīs*) **naḥ** (to us) **atitarāṁ kṛpayatu**.

53 It was to accept that mood that He established dharma. Now I shall tell its chief reason — listen, everyone.

54 Up to now I have given an outline of the verse to point to the root reason. Now I shall reveal the meaning of that verse.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Wishing to accept the *bhāva* of Śrī Rādhā, He undertook to establish *dharma*. I shall now tell the main purpose of that undertaking. Until now I have only hinted at the verse, in order to come to the root cause.

Anubhāṣya.

In place of these four lines some manuscripts have six: “To accept that *bhāva*, He established *dharma*. First I shall explain the verse about the root cause. Hear now how He accepted the *bhāva*; for this I shall examine the fifth verse. Thus I have given a hint of the fifth verse; now I shall reveal the meaning of that verse.”

Explanation of the fifth of the fourteen opening verses —

55 “Śrī Rādhā is the transformation of Kṛṣṇa’s love, His pleasure potency, *hlādinī-śakti*. Therefore, though Rādhā and Kṛṣṇa are one in Self, from time without beginning They have appeared in the world in two different forms. Now these Two have become one and are manifest as Śrī Caitanya. I bow to Him, Kṛṣṇa Himself, adorned with the sentiment and the lustre of Śrī Rādhā.” (diary of Svarūpa Dāmodara)[6]

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

The *hlādinī-śakti* is the transformation of the love of Rādhā and Kṛṣṇa; because of it Rādhā and Kṛṣṇa are one in Their own nature. But Their pastimes (*vilāsa-tattva*) are eternal, and so Rādhā and Kṛṣṇa eternally abide in two forms. Now these two *tattvas* have appeared in one form — as the Caitanya-*tattva*. Therefore I bow down to Gaurasundara, Kṛṣṇa Himself, adorned with the *bhāva* and radiance of Rādhā.

Anubhāṣya.

rādhā kṛṣṇa-praṇaya-vikṛtiḥ (the transformation of Kṛṣṇa's love — the *hlādinī-śakti* in the form of the pastimes of love); **ekātmānau** (one in soul) **purā** (since time without beginning) **tau** (They, Rādhā and Kṛṣṇa) **bhuvi deha-bhedam** (the difference of two bodies — the form of the *viṣaya* and the form of the *āśraya*) **gatau** (have assumed). **adhunā** (now) **tad-dvayam** (the two of Them) **aikyam āptam** (have attained oneness). **rādhā-bhāva-dyuti-suvalitam** (*bhāva* and radiance make *bhāva-dyutī*; the *bhāva* and radiance of Rādhā — He who is joined, *suvalita*, with them: Kṛṣṇa within, Gaura without) **kṛṣṇa-svarūpam caitanyākhyam prakaṭam** (the manifest form) **naumi** (I bow down).

The explanation of the fifth verse begins; the hidden cause of the Gaura-avatāra — first, the truth of Rādhā and Kṛṣṇa —

56 Rādhā and Kṛṣṇa are one Self; assuming two bodies, They sport with each other, tasting rasa.

Gaura is the form in which Rādhā and Govinda are united —

57 Now those Two are one — Caitanya Gosāñi; to taste that mood (*bhāva*), They have come together in one form.

To describe the glory of the truth of Gaura, the author explains the love of Rādhā and Govinda —

58 For this reason I shall first describe that truth, for from it comes the telling of Gaura's glory.

The truth of Śrī Rādhā and Her relationship with Kṛṣṇa —

59 Rādhikā is the transformation of Kṛṣṇa's love; She is the potency of His own nature (*svarūpa-śakti*) whose name is Hlādinī.

*The characteristics of the *hlādinī-śakti* —*

60 Hlādinī makes Kṛṣṇa taste bliss, and through Hlādinī He nourishes His devotees.

Anubhāṣya.

Śrī Jīva Prabhu writes in the *Prīti-sandarbha* (section 65): "And in the Śruti it is heard: 'Devotion leads him [to the Lord], devotion shows Him to him, the Puruṣa is subject to devotion, devotion is the greatest of all.' Let us therefore consider: what are the characteristics of that [power] which thus intoxicates Bhagavān with its bliss? It is not the bliss of *māyā*, made of material *sattva*, as with the Sāṅkhyas, for the Śruti says that *māyā* cannot overpower Bhagavān and that He is satisfied in Himself. Nor is it the bliss of Bhagavān's own nature, as the impersonalists hold, for then it could not surpass [His own bliss]. Still less is it the bliss of the *jīva*'s own nature, for the *jīva* is exceedingly small. One possibility remains. According to the *Viṣṇu Purāṇa* — '*Hlādinī*, *sandhinī* and *saṁvit*

are one in You, the support of all; [the potency] that gives joy, pain and a mixture of the two is not in You, who are free from the *guṇas*' — it is the bliss of His *svarūpa-śakti* called *hlādinī*. Through her Bhagavān possesses the special bliss of His own nature, and through her alone He lets others too taste this or that bliss. But *hlādinī* too abides always in Bhagavān, and so she too could not surpass [Him]. Therefore one must reason thus, on the basis of *arthāpatti*, the inference of that without which the meaning of the Śruti cannot be explained. A certain function (*vṛtti*) of that very *hlādinī*, surpassing all bliss, is eternally deposited in the hosts of devotees and abides there under the name 'love for Bhagavān' (*bhagavat-prīti*). Therefore, by experiencing it, Śrī Bhagavān too feels an exceptional love for His devotees."

The Vedas too say that devotion leads the devotee to Bhagavān, that devotion lets the devotee see Bhagavān, that Bhagavān is subject to devotion — and there the supremacy of devotion is declared. Therefore the question is examined: what are the characteristics of that *vastu-śakti*, the potency of the Reality itself, which intoxicates Bhagavān with His own bliss? The Śruti's answer is this. *Māyā* cannot overpower Bhagavān, and Bhagavān is satisfied in Himself. Therefore this *vastu-śakti* cannot be called, as the Sāṅkhyas teach, the bliss of *māyā* endowed with material being. Nor can it be called, as the impersonalists say, the bliss of Bhagavān's own nature: considered from beginning to end, that conclusion is especially untenable. Still less is it the bliss of the *jīva*'s own nature: the *jīva*, though eternal, is exceedingly small. Therefore [it remains to say] that the bliss is His *svarūpa-śakti* named *hlādinī*. Such is the sense of the words of the *Viṣṇu Purāṇa*: "Only in the all-powerful Bhagavān do the three potencies — *hlādinī*, *sandhinī* and *saṁvit* — abide. O Bhagavān, in You, who are free from the *guṇas*, there is no feeling of joy mixed with pain." For only through this potency is a special bliss seen in Bhagavān's own nature, and only through it does Bhagavān bestow this or that bliss on other devotees. This is the final conclusion. Because the *hlādinī-śakti* abides eternally in Bhagavān, the impersonalist's conclusion just mentioned must be firmly rejected — this must be understood. For if the meaning of the Śruti cannot be reconciled otherwise, a different conclusion must be admitted. The testimony of the *Viṣṇu Purāṇa* agrees with the meaning of the Vedas, whereas the impersonalists' claim distorts the meaning of the Vedas and does not belong to what the Vedas intend. Therefore, when the eternal function of that very *hlādinī*, surpassing all bliss, is bestowed

on the hosts of devotees, it receives the name *bhagavat-prīti*, love for Bhagavān. And Śrī Bhagavān, feeling that love in the devotee, accepts the devotee's love.

The *Viṣṇu Purāṇa* speaks of three kinds of potency in Śrī Bhagavān. Therefore the potency that gives bliss to Bhagavān is neither the material bliss of the Sāṅkhya nor mere undifferentiated spiritual bliss (*cid-ekānanda*), as with the impersonalist, who does not know the difference between the potency and its possessor. It is the *hlādinī-śakti* that gives Bhagavān bliss. Through the *hlādinī-śakti* Bhagavān endows the *jīva* with the *dharma* of love for Himself, and then, won over by the devotee's love for Bhagavān, He Himself nourishes that love.

*The one potency of the one possessor of potency has three forms: (1) it gives bliss, that is, the relish of *rasa*; (2) it directs action, that is, makes [Him] the enjoyer; and (3) it manifests being, that is, grants existence —*

61 Kṛṣṇa's nature is eternity, knowledge and bliss; He is complete. And His one spiritual potency (*cit-śakti*) takes three forms:

62 In the aspect of bliss She is Hlādinī, in the aspect of being Sandhinī, and in the aspect of consciousness Samvit, which we know as knowledge.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Anyonye means "with each other." The literal sense of these verses is clear, but their inner meaning is hidden. Rādhā is the *śakti*, Kṛṣṇa the *tattva* who possesses *śakti*. The Vedānta saying *śakti-śaktimator abhedaḥ* ("the potency and its possessor are not different") means that no reasoning can separate the *śakti* from the one in whom it resides. Yet by the power of an inconceivable *śakti*, Rādhā and Kṛṣṇa, in order to relish the *rasa* of Their pastimes with each other, are eternally separate — and at the same time one. Rādhā is truly the *hlādinī*, Kṛṣṇa's *svarūpa-śakti*. She bears that name because She keeps Kṛṣṇa immersed in supreme bliss. She is also recognized by the way She nourishes the *prema* inherent in the very nature of the *jīva*, Kṛṣṇa's separated spiritual part. Śrī Kṛṣṇa, the possessor of *śakti*, is the complete *tattva*; by nature He is *sac-cid-ānanda*. The one and the same spiritual potency (*cit-śakti*), in its aspect of being (*sat*), is the *sandhinī*, that which expands existence. In its aspect of consciousness (*cit*) it is the *saṁvit-tattva*, complete knowledge, that is, the

truth of Kṛṣṇa's own nature. In its aspect of bliss (*ānanda*) it is the *hlādinī*, that which gives joy to that very nature.

Anubhāṣya.

Śrī Jīva Prabhu writes in the *Bhagavat-sandarbha* (section 102): “The potency by which [Bhagavān], being Being itself, holds being and enables others to hold it, is the *sandhinī*; she grants [His] presence in all places, times, substances and so on. Likewise the potency by which He, being Consciousness itself, knows and makes others know, is the *saṁvit*. Likewise the potency by which He, being Bliss itself, knows that bliss through the highest development of *saṁvit* and makes others know it, is to be understood as the *hlādinī*. Thus it is established that the original potency is threefold. A particular function (*vṛtti*) of hers, whose mark is self-manifestation, through which [Bhagavān's] own form manifests — by itself or together with His own potency — is *viśuddha-sattva*. It is His manifestation, dependent on nothing else; and because its function is knowledge that makes known, it is in fact *saṁvit*. Since *māyā* does not touch it, it is pure… And from this *sattva* the world called Vaikuṇṭha becomes manifest. By the word *sattva* a particular function of the *svarūpa-śakti*, whose mark is self-manifestation, is meant here. For impure *sattva* is commonly defined as ‘*sattva* is a quality of *prakṛti*’; on that analogy it is fitting to call such a particular spiritual potency ‘*sattva*.’ Therefore it is said that, being a function of the *svarūpa-śakti*, it is identical with His own form. The Śruti declares that the material qualities, *sattva* and the rest, belong to the *jīva*, not to the Lord. So in the Eleventh [Canto]: ‘*Sattva*, *rajas* and *tamas* are the qualities of the *jīva*, not Mine.’[37] And in the *Viṣṇu Purāṇa*: ‘May that original Person be gracious, purest of all the pure, in whom, the Lord, there are no material qualities such as *sattva*.’ The qualification ‘material’ here shows that other, nonmaterial qualities do exist in Him. So too in the Tenth [Canto] the king of the gods said: ‘Your abode is pure *sattva*, peaceful, full of *tapas*, free from *rajas* and *tamas*. This stream of *guṇas* made of *māyā*, born of ignorance, does not exist in You.’[38] The qualities of *prakṛti* [are these]: *sattva*; when what is perceived is manifold, *rajas*; when the manifold is hidden, *tamas*. Likewise: in mutual indifference, *sattva*; in mutual help, *rajas*; in mutual harm, *tamas*. This *viśuddha-sattva*, when the *sandhinī* portion predominates in it, is the *ādhāra-śakti*, the supporting potency; when the *saṁvit* portion predominates, it is *ātma-vidyā*; when the essence of *hlādinī* predominates, it is *guhya-

vidyā*, the hidden knowledge; when all three potencies predominate together, it is the *mūrti*, the form. By the *ādhāra-śakti* the abode of Bhagavān is manifest."

The potency by which Bhagavān upholds being and enables others to uphold it is the *sandhinī*, which manifests all places, times, substances and so on. The potency by which He Himself can know and make known is the *saṁvit*. And the potency in which *cit* predominates, by which He Himself knows bliss and can make others know bliss, is to be understood as the *hlādinī*.

Thus it is established that the original supreme potency (*parā-śakti*) is threefold. There is a particular function of hers whose mark is self-manifestation; through it Bhagavān Himself, His *svarūpa-śakti* or His spiritual distinctions become manifest. This is *viśuddha-sattva*. It depends on nothing else and is the manifestation of Bhagavān. In it there are two functions — to experience oneself and to let others experience — and so it is also *saṁvit*. *Māyā* does not touch it; that is its purity; and from this *viśuddha-sattva* the abode called Vaikuṇṭha becomes manifest. The word *viśuddha-sattva* denotes a particular function of Bhagavān's *svarūpa-śakti* whose mark is self-manifestation. The common name for the mark of material impurity is here fittingly applied [by analogy], and so *śuddha-sattva*, or *sandhinī*, is a particular spiritual potency. This *śuddha-sattva* is a function of the *svarūpa-śakti*, and so it too consists of the *svarūpa-śakti*. The Śruti and Smṛti say that the material qualities, *sattva* and the rest, belong only to the *jīva*, not to the Lord. Thus in the Eleventh Canto Bhagavān says: "The three qualities — *sattva*, *rajas* and *tamas* — are connected with the *jīva* who has turned away from Me, but never with Me." And the *Viṣṇu Purāṇa* says: "In the Lord, in whom transcendental qualities abide, there are not and cannot be material qualities such as *sattva*. May that original Person, Bhagavān Nārāyaṇa, be gracious — He who is unmixed purity among all pure entities." The qualification "material" here specially shows that other — transcendental — qualities abide in Him, in Bhagavān. In the Tenth Canto Indra, the king of the gods, says: "O Bhagavān, Your abode consists of pure *sattva*. It is peaceful, full of service in the form of austerity, and free from *rajas* and *tamas*. You have nothing of this stream of *guṇas* made of *māyā*; You neither touch the material qualities nor accept them." In the unmanifest state there is the quality of *sattva*; in external manifestation, in manifold display that tends to generate, the quality of *rajas*; where manifold display is absent, the quality of *tamas*. In other words: where the three qualities are slack or indifferent to one another, there

is *sattva*; where there is efficacy and activity, [*rajas*]; where there is destruction and ruin, there is *tamas*.

Here this *viśuddha-sattva* in which the *sandhinī* portion predominates is the *ādhāra-śakti*; that in which the *saṁvit* portion predominates is *ātma-vidyā*; that in which the essence of the *hlādinī-śakti* predominates is *guhya-vidyā* (*prema-bhakti*). Where all three potencies predominate at once, it is the *mūrti*, or *vigraha*, the form. By this *ādhāra-śakti* the abode of Bhagavān becomes manifest.

The Supreme Truth (*para-tattva*) is the true Reality, and It is eternally manifest in three potencies. By a single supreme inconceivable potency consisting of three potencies, It abides eternally in four ways: as the splendor of His own nature (*svarūpa-vaibhava*), Vaikuṇṭha and the rest; as the pure *jīvas*, called *taṭastha*, one with It in spiritual nature; as the external splendor, in which matter predominates; and as the complete Self (*pūrṇa-svarūpa*). His own form and the power that manifests His splendor abide in two ways as the internal potency: as the *svayaṁ-rūpa* and as the manifestation of splendor (*vaibhava-prakāśa*). The potency that abides in the inner limbs of the *aṅgī*, the possessor of the limbs, is the *antaraṅgā*, the internal one. Bhagavān, the *svayaṁ-rūpa*, the possessor of the internal potency, manifests the splendor of His own nature — Vaikuṇṭha and the rest. The external limbs of Bhagavān are *pradhāna* and material substances. This external potency, in the material world, in bodies from Brahmā down to motionless trees and stones, covers the *jīva*, the transformation of the marginal potency, more heavily or more lightly.

The *svarūpa-śakti* is seen in three divisions. They are called parts (*aṁśas*) of the potency as a whole, the *svarūpa-śakti*. The eternal existence of the potency, its *sat* portion — that is, its immunity to being disturbed by time and the like — is known by the name *sandhinī*. The knowing principle, the *cit* portion, distinguished from eternal bliss — nondual knowledge — is known by the name *saṁvit*. In other words, that in which Kṛṣṇa's independent agency is known in the fullness of spiritual nature is called the *saṁvit-śakti*. The part of the whole that keeps its distinction from *sat* and *cit* is the potency full of bliss. When their distinctions are described the three potencies have different characteristics, yet all three parts abide in the *svarūpa-śakti* itself. In the marginal and the external potencies, however, these three abide in different ways. In the external potency there are the three *guṇas*. In the conditioned part of the marginal potency there is the action of those three *guṇas*. And in the liberated part — in

the service proper to the nature of the *āśraya* — there abides that part of the potency of *sac-cid-ānanda* which suits the object of service.

*(Dhruva's words, *Viṣṇu Purāṇa*, Part 1, Chapter 12, verse 69)*

63 "O Lord, You are the basis of all, and in You Hlādinī, Sandhinī and Samvit are one potency. But that which causes joy, pain and a mixture of the two is not in You, for You are beyond the guṇas." (Viṣṇu Purāṇa, 1.12.69)[7]

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

O Bhagavān, shelter of all, free from the *guṇas*! In You all three functions of the *śakti* — *hlādinī*, *sandhinī* and *saṁvit* — are spiritual. The *jīva* is a spiritual particle that *māyā* can subdue. Having fallen under *māyā*'s sway and taken shelter of her three *guṇas*, the *jīva* has come into a condition in which the *śakti* appears to him in three forms — "giving joy," "giving pain" and "mixed." But in You, who are beyond all the *guṇas*, this *śakti* is pure, free from the *guṇas* and one.

Anubhāṣya.

[he bhagavan] (O Bhagavān), **ekā** (the one — the chief, unfailing potency that is Your own nature) **hlādinī** (giving joy) **sandhinī** (being) **saṁvit** (the potency of knowledge) **sarva-saṁsthitau** (in You — since through You everything stands firm; in You, the foundation of all) **tvayi** (in You alone, not in the *jīvas*) [abides]. (But the threefold one made of the *guṇas* does not abide in You): **hlāda-tāpa-karī miśrā** (that which gives joy — the *sāttvika*, born of clarity of mind; that which gives pain — the *tāmasika*, on separation from sense objects and so on; that which is a mixture of both — the *rājasika*, born of sense objects) **guṇa-varjite** (free from *sattva* and the other *guṇas*) **tvayi** (in You, Bhagavān, but not in the *jīvas*) **eva** (here *sandhinī*, *saṁvit* and *hlādinī* are to be understood in ascending order of excellence).

In his commentary on this verse and on *Bhāgavatam* 1.7.6, Śrīdhara Svāmī quotes the following verse of Śrī Viṣṇusvāmī as a saying of the *Sarvajña-sūkta*: "The Lord is *sac-cid-ānanda*, embraced by *hlādinī* and *saṁvit*. The *jīva*, enveloped by his own ignorance, is a mine of countless miseries."

*The service of the *sandhinī*: she enables Bhagavān to become manifest —*

64 The essential part of Sandhinī is called *śuddha-sattva*, pure being; in it the existence of Bhagavān rests.

Anubhāṣya.

Kṛṣṇa's mother and father, His place, His house and the rest are transformations of *śuddha-sattva*. In transformed *śuddha-sattva* the nature of Bhagavān is seen as consisting of *śuddha-sattva*. In the pure *tattva* that is Kṛṣṇa's source, one sees how He takes birth. And yet Kṛṣṇa is not mere *śuddha-sattva* made of Vasudeva: He is the eternal presiding Deity of the knowledge of Bhagavān, which is the essence of *saṁvit* and nondual knowledge. The things that belong to the *āśraya* and are related to Kṛṣṇa consist of *śuddha-sattva*. Therefore [the devotees], with hearts turned toward service, see in them the relationship with Kṛṣṇa. In truth, however, Bhagavān is spiritual by nature.

*Though Kṛṣṇa is the master of the *sandhinī*, everything He enjoys is a transformation of the *sandhinī* —*

65 His mother and father, His abode, His house, His bed and seat and all else — all these are transformations of Kṛṣṇa’s *śuddha-sattva*, pure transcendental being.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

The essence of the *sandhinī-śakti*, which expands existence, is called *śuddha-sattva*. *Sattva* is of two kinds, mixed (*miśra*) and pure (*śuddha*). “*Sattva*” is simply the being of an entity. Without the action of the *sandhinī* no *sattva* is possible. The manifestation of Bhagavān's being is likewise the work of the *sandhinī*. The action of the *sandhinī* in the pure spiritual *tattva* is called *śuddha-sattva*. Bhagavān's mother and father, His place, house, bed, seat and the rest are transformations (*vikāras*), that is, special manifestations, of Kṛṣṇa's *śuddha-sattva*. To understand this truth clearly one should know this as well. The *sandhinī* belonging to His own nature, that is, to the *cit-śakti*, has manifested all the being of the spiritual world — the being of all spiritual forms: Bhagavān's spiritual form and those of His servants, maidservants, companions, father, mother and the rest. The *sandhinī* belonging to the *māyā-śakti* has spread out all the elemental being of the material world. And the *sandhinī* belonging to the *jīva-śakti* has spread out the being of the *jīva*, the spiritual particle.

*(*Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam*, Canto 4, Chapter 3, verse 23)*

66 "Pure being (*viśuddha-sattva*) is called *vasudeva*, for in it the Supreme Person is revealed unveiled. And in that being I worship with my mind Lord Vāsudeva, who is beyond the senses (Adhokṣaja)." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 4.3.23)[8]

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Śrī Mahādeva said: "There is an eternal *tattva*, *śuddha-sattva*; it exists through the power of the *sandhinī* belonging to Bhagavān's *svarūpa-śakti*, and it is called 'Vasudeva.' In this *śuddha-sattva* Bhagavān, whose nature is consciousness, is eternally manifest; His name is 'Vāsudeva.' He is beyond all the senses, material and *māyika* alike. With a heart purified by devotion I bow down to Him." The meaning is this: Kṛṣṇa's form and the rest are the eternal work of the *sandhinī* belonging to His *svarūpa-śakti*.

Anubhāṣya.

Satī was about to go to the house of her father Dakṣa to see the sacrifice. Mahādeva, knowing that Dakṣa, sunk in *karma*, was hostile to Viṣṇu, said to her:

viśuddham (free from all inertness, being a function of the *svarūpa-śakti*) **sattvam** (consisting of the function of the *cit-śakti*, transcendental) **vasudeva-śabditam** (*vasaty asmin*, "He dwells in it" — hence *vasu*; *dīvyati dyotate*, "it shines, it gleams" — hence *deva*; it is both), **yat** (because) **tatra** (in that *sattva*) **pumān** (the Person) **apāvṛtaḥ** (free of any covering) **īyate** (becomes manifest). **tasmin sattve adhokṣajaḥ** (He who has left behind and surpassed the knowledge born of the senses, *akṣaja*) **bhagavān vāsudevaḥ** ("He is, He is perceived, in Vasudeva" — hence Vāsudeva, the well-known Supreme Lord; by etymology, "He who makes God dwell") **me** (by me) **manasā vidhīyate** (is especially meditated upon).

Śrī Jīva Prabhu writes in the *Bhagavat-sandarbha* (section 102): "And in the form (*mūrti*) the Śrī Vigraha, the very Supreme Truth, becomes manifest; this [*viśuddha-sattva*] is what is called Vasudeva." See the conclusion [of that passage] below, and also the *Gauḍīya-bhāṣya* on this verse in the *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam*, pp. 1172–1174.

*Through the *saṁvit-śakti* Bhagavān experiences, that is, knows Himself as the enjoyer of bliss; through it, too, within nondual knowledge there is*

knowledge of Bhagavān —

67 The knowledge that Kṛṣṇa is Bhagavān is the essence of Samvit; the knowledge of Brahman and all the rest are only its retinue.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

The action of *saṁvit* is called “knowledge.” There are two seers: Kṛṣṇa and the *jīva*. Kṛṣṇa's seeing is founded on complete knowledge, and there are no gaps in His knowing; so His knowledge can be called “mere glance” (*īkṣaṇa*). In the *jīva*'s seeing there are many gaps, so we call his seeing “knowledge by cognition” (*saṁvedana-jñāna*). That knowledge is of three kinds: direct (*sākṣāt-jñāna*), by negation (*vyatireka-jñāna*) and distorted (*vikṛta-jñāna*). The knowledge the *jīva* gains of material objects through the material senses is never pure and so is distorted; it is the distorting action of the *saṁvit* that belongs to the *māyā-śakti*. Impersonal knowledge by negation of matter rests on its relation to material knowledge, and so it is petty. It is only the action of the *saṁvit-śakti* that belongs to the *jīva*, and so it is incomplete. Such knowledge is called “knowledge of Brahman,” “knowledge of the self,” “impersonal knowledge,” “knowledge of nondifference” and so on. When the *saṁvit-śakti* that belongs to *cit* joins with the *hlādinī* and bestows mercy on the *jīva*, the knowledge that Kṛṣṇa is Bhagavān is born. That, therefore, is the essence of *saṁvit*. Knowledge of Brahman and knowledge of objects are its “retinue” (*parivāra*), that is, merely coverings that differ from stage to stage.

*The divisions of the *hlādinī* —*

68 The essence of Hlādinī is prema, divine love; the essence of prema is *bhāva*; and the highest limit of *bhāva* is called *mahābhāva*.

Śrī Rādhikā is the embodied highest limit of love for Kṛṣṇa —

69 Śrī Rādhā Ṭhākurāṇī is the embodiment of *mahābhāva*. She is a mine of all virtues and the crest-jewel of Kṛṣṇa’s beloveds.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

The action of the *hlādinī* is called *prema*. This *prema* is of two kinds, pure and mixed. The *hlādinī-śakti* belonging to Kṛṣṇa gives bliss to Kṛṣṇa and, together with pure *saṁvit*, bestows mercy on the *jīva*; then *prema* for Kṛṣṇa

arises in the *jīva*. But when the transformed *hlādinī* belonging to the *jīva* attracts the *jīva* through the *māyā-śakti*, the *jīva*, intoxicated with love for sense objects, is deprived of *prema* for Kṛṣṇa and so falls under the sway of happiness and distress. The ideal of *prema* for the *jīvas* is the circle of the *gopīs* of Vraja, and among them Śrī Rādhā is supreme. The essence of the *hlādinī* belonging to the spiritual nature is *prema*; the essence of *prema* is *bhāva*; the highest limit of *bhāva* is *mahābhāva*. That is Śrīmatī Rādhikā Ṭhākurāṇī. She is the source of all virtues and the crown jewel of Kṛṣṇa's beloveds.

*(*Ujjvala-nīlamaṇi*, the chapter on Śrī Rādhā, verse 2)*

70 "Of the two, Rādhikā is superior in every way. She is the embodiment of *mahābhāva*, and in virtues She surpasses all." (Ujjvala-nīlamaṇi, the chapter on Śrī Rādhā, 2)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Among the *gopīs* who enjoy the pastimes of Vraja, the foremost are Candrāvalī and Rādhikā, and of these two Śrīmatī Rādhikā is better in every respect. She is the embodiment of *mahābhāva*, and no other *gopī* has qualities equal to Hers.

Anubhāṣya.

tayoḥ (of Śrī Rādhā and Candrāvalī) **ubhayor api madhye rādhikā sarvathādhikā** (superior, better in every respect). **iyam** (Śrī Rādhikā) **mahābhāva-svarūpā** (endowed with the *mahābhāva* called *madana*; Her form unites the eight *bhāvas*) **guṇaiḥ** (by the twenty-five qualities) **ati-varīyasī** (best of all).

Within and without, in every one of Her limbs, the form of love for Kṛṣṇa is manifest —

71 Her mind, senses and body are steeped in love for Kṛṣṇa; Rādhā is Kṛṣṇa's own potency, the helper in His play.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Śrīmatī Rādhikā is spiritual. She does not have, like a *jīva* in the material world, material senses, a material body and a mind in the form of the subtle body. In Her spiritual nature there are a pure spiritual mind, spiritual senses and a spiritual body. Her mind, senses and body are steeped in *prema* for Kṛṣṇa. She is Kṛṣṇa's own

potency and therefore the only helper in His pastimes. Kṛṣṇa is the possessor of potency, and apart from His potency He can perform no pastime. The *sandhinī* of the *svarūpa-śakti* has manifested Śrī Kṛṣṇa's spiritual body. When Kṛṣṇa plays in that body, what could He do without Śrīmatī's help? Therefore Rādhikā is Kṛṣṇa's only helper in His pastimes.

*Govinda eternally enjoys the pastimes of *rasa* with the *gopīs* in Goloka —*

72 "I worship Govinda, the original Person, the Soul of all. He dwells eternally in Goloka with the gopīs, His potencies (*kalās*), who are one with Him in nature and imbued with blissful spiritual rasa." (Brahma-saṁhitā, 5.37)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
I worship the original Person, Govinda, the wondrous Soul of all. In His own form He dwells eternally in Goloka together with the *gopīs*, who are imbued with the spiritual *rasa* of bliss.

Anubhāṣya.
akhilātma-bhūtaḥ (dear to all the residents of Gokula, their very soul) **saḥ eva ānanda-cinmaya-rasa-pratibhāvitābhiḥ** (imbued at every moment with the *rasa* made of bliss and spirit) **nija-rūpatayā** (known as His own form) **kalābhiḥ** (with parts — the embodiments of the *hlādinī-śakti*) **tābhiḥ** (with the beautiful women of Vraja) **goloke eva nivasati**; **tam ādi-puruṣaṁ govindam ahaṁ bhajāmi**.

73 Now hear how She makes Kṛṣṇa taste rasa and how She helps Him in His play.

*In *madhura-rati* marked by the mood of majesty or of sweetness, Kṛṣṇa's beloveds are of three kinds —*

74–75 Kṛṣṇa's beloveds are of three kinds: the Lakṣmīs, the queens in His city, and the girls of Vraja, the essence of them all. All of them expand from Śrī Rādhikā.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Āra means “of another kind.” The third kind are the women of Vraja: they are the essence of all kinds of beloveds, that is, the best of them.

*All of Kṛṣṇa's beloveds are parts of Rādhā, the whole (*aṁśinī*) —*

76 As Kṛṣṇa, the source of all avatāras, manifests the avatāras, so the three groups expand from Rādhā, the source of all parts.

77 The Lakṣmīs are, as it were, the splendour of Her body, and the queens are Her reflections (*bimba-pratibimba*).

Anubhāṣya.

In place of *vaibhava-gaṇa yena tāra aṅga-vibhūti* (“the *vaibhavas* are as it were the splendor of Her body”) there is also the reading *lakṣmī-gaṇa hana tāra aṁśa-vibhūti* (“the Lakṣmīs are the splendor of Her parts”).

The queens in Dvārakā and the Lakṣmīs of Nārāyaṇa, Vāsudeva and others —

78 The Lakṣmīs are partial manifestations (*aṁśas*) of Her *vaibhava-vilāsa*, and the queens are Her *prābhava-prakāśas*.[9]

*Lalitā and the other women of Vraja are Her *kāya-vyūha* —*

79 The goddesses of Vraja, differing in form and nature, are expansions of Her own body (*kāya-vyūha*), for the sake of rasa.

Anubhāṣya.

In place of the word *svarūpa* another reading has *svabhāva*.

*For the growth and wonder of *rasa* the one *hlādinī* displays many manifestations —*

80 Without many beloveds rasa does not rejoice; therefore, to help in the play, She has many manifestations.

Of these, the pastimes in Vraja are the highest wonder of Kṛṣṇa's pleasure —

81 Among them the girls of Vraja, differing in moods and rasas, make Kṛṣṇa taste the *rāsa* dance and His other pastimes.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Just as Kṛṣṇa, the source of the avatāras, expands the avatāras — the Puruṣas and the others — so Śrīmatī Rādhikā is the whole (*aṁśinī*) for all the beloveds: from Her parts the Lakṣmīs, the queens and the women of Vraja have expanded. These beloveds are counted among the *vaibhavas* as the splendor of Her body. The queens have expanded as reflections of Her image. The distinction here is this: the Lakṣmīs are Her parts in the form of *vaibhava-vilāsa*, and the queens are Her *prābhava-prakāśa*. The maidens of Vraja are Her own *kāya-vyūha*; differing in form and nature, they have become the cause of *rasa*. Without many beloveds *rasa* does not blossom, and so, to assist in the pastimes, She displays many such "manifestations." Of them the *rasa* of Vraja is the highest. There, through the variety of *bhāvas* and *rasas*, She lets Kṛṣṇa relish the *rāsa* and other pastimes.

The five names of Śrī Rādhikā —

82 Rādhā is the delight of Govinda and the enchantress of Govinda; She is Govinda's all-in-all and the crest-jewel of all His beloveds.

Anubhāṣya.

These are the five names of Śrī Rādhā.

*(Words of the *Bṛhad-gautamīya-tantra*)*

83 "The goddess (*devī*) Rādhikā is declared to be full of Kṛṣṇa (*kṛṣṇa-mayī*). She is the supreme deity; all the Lakṣmīs are within Her; She is the whole of splendour (*sarva-kānti*) and the supreme enchantress." (Bṛhad-gautamīya-tantra)[10]

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

The supreme goddess Rādhikā-devī is called "Kṛṣṇa-mayī Herself," "Sarva-lakṣmī-mayī," "Sarva-kānti," "Kṛṣṇa-sammohinī" and "Parā-śakti," the supreme potency.

Anubhāṣya.

rādhikā (she who worships) **devī** (the radiant one) **kṛṣṇa-mayī** (nondifferent from Kṛṣṇa, Kṛṣṇa's embodied manifestation) **para-devatā** (supremely worshipable) **sarva-lakṣmī-mayī** (the original mistress of all the Lakṣmīs) **sarva-kāntiḥ** (she in whom is all splendor, all beauty) **sammohinī** (whose nature is to enchant Śrī Kṛṣṇa) **parā proktā** (is called).

Meaning of the verse: (1) the abode of beauty and of pastimes —

84 *Devī* means "shining and supremely beautiful", or else "the city where Kṛṣṇa's worship and play abide".

(2) complete absorption in Kṛṣṇa —

85 *Kṛṣṇa-mayī* — Kṛṣṇa is within Her and without; wherever Her eyes fall, there Kṛṣṇa appears.

Oneness with Kṛṣṇa —

86 Or else: Kṛṣṇa's very nature is full of the rasa of love, and His potency is one with Him.

(3) the name "Rādhā" — because She worships Kṛṣṇa by fulfilling His desires —

87 Her worship of Kṛṣṇa consists in fulfilling His desires; therefore the Purāṇas explain Her name as Rādhikā.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

She is called "Devī" because She is radiant and supremely beautiful, or because She is the dwelling place of play, that is, of the worship of Kṛṣṇa. The word "Kṛṣṇa-mayī" has two meanings. The first: within and without She has Kṛṣṇa, and wherever Her glance falls, there He appears. Or else: Kṛṣṇa's own nature is full of the *rasa* of *prema*, and His potency is one *tattva* with Him; this is the second meaning of the word "Kṛṣṇa-mayī." The name "Rādhikā" is given to Her for Her worship (*ārādhana*), which consists in fulfilling Kṛṣṇa's desires.

*A hint of Rādhā's name in the *Bhāgavatam* —*

88 “Surely the Lord, Bhagavān Hari, has been worshipped by Her, for Govinda, pleased, has left us and led Her away to a secluded place.” (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 10.30.28)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

O friend! She whom Śrī Kṛṣṇa, leaving us, has taken to a secluded place has surely worshipped the Lord Hari more than anyone. The hidden meaning is this: She is the crown jewel of Kṛṣṇa's beloveds, and so She is called “Rādhikā.”

Anubhāṣya.

When Śrī Rādhā and Śrī Govinda had gone away together from the place of the *rāsa* dance, the *gopīs* said:

anayā (by Rādhā) **nūnam** (surely) **īśvaraḥ** (who grants His devotees what they desire) **bhagavān hariḥ ārādhitaḥ** (has been won over by worship — and not by us, the wives of Vraja); **yat** (since) **govindaḥ prītaḥ** (full of love) **naḥ** (us) **vihāya** (leaving altogether) **yām** (Rādhā) **rahaḥ** (to a secluded place) **anayat**.

(4) She attracts Kṛṣṇa and so is above all; She nourishes all the devotees and devotion itself and is their original source —

89 Therefore She is worshipped by all; She is the supreme deity, the protectress of all and the mother of the whole world.

(5) The whole of which all of Kṛṣṇa's beloveds are parts —

90 I have already explained the word *sarva-lakṣmī*: She is the abode of all the Lakṣmīs.[11]

The original shelter of all of Kṛṣṇa's potencies of majesty —

91 Or *sarva-lakṣmī* means Kṛṣṇa’s six kinds of opulence, and She is the potency that presides over them, the best of all His potencies.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Rādhikā is the shelter of all the Lakṣmīs. Or else: the word *sarva-lakṣmī* means Kṛṣṇa's six kinds of majesty, and She is Kṛṣṇa's potency that presides over them.

(5) The original source of all beauty[39] *—*

92 In Her dwells the splendour of all beauty, and from Her comes the beauty of all the Lakṣmīs.

She who fulfills Kṛṣṇa's desires —

93 Or the word *kānti* may mean all of Kṛṣṇa's desires, and all of them abide in Rādhā alone.

94 Rādhikā fulfils whatever Kṛṣṇa desires. This is the meaning of the word *sarva-kānti*.

(6) She who enchants the mind of Him who enchants the world —

95 Kṛṣṇa enchants the world, and She enchants Him; therefore She is the supreme Mistress of all.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
Up to the words "and therefore She is the supreme mistress of all," the meaning of each word of the verse beginning *devī kṛṣṇa-mayī* has been examined.

She is the full-moon night of Kṛṣṇa, the full moon —

96 Rādhā is the full potency, and Kṛṣṇa the full possessor of potency. The scriptures bear witness that there is no difference between the two.

Rādhā and Kṛṣṇa are inseparably bound to each other — like musk and the deer, or the flame and the fire —

97 As musk and its fragrance are inseparable, as fire and its heat are never different,

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
Musk and its fragrance are two different things, yet they are inseparable; fire and its heat are different things, yet they too are inseparable. So it is with Rādhā and Kṛṣṇa: to relish the *rasa* of Their pastimes They are eternally separate — and still one in Their own nature.

One in nature, They abide in two bodies — the one who relishes and the one who is relished —

98 so Rādhā and Kṛṣṇa are always one essence; to taste the rasa of Their pastimes They assume two forms.

*To distribute Śrī Rādhā's love for Kṛṣṇa, Kṛṣṇa accepts Rādhā's *bhāva* and form and descends as Gaura —*

99–100 To teach loving devotion, He Himself descended, accepting both the mood and the lustre of Rādhā, and appeared in the form of Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya. This is the explanation of the meaning of the fifth verse.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
Having Himself accepted Rādhikā's *bhāva* and *kānti*, that is, the beauty of Her complexion.

The explanation of the sixth of the fourteen opening verses begins —

101 To bring out the meaning of the sixth verse, I shall first give an outline of it.

*A preliminary hint: establishing *nāma-saṅkīrtana* is the external cause of the Gaura-avatāra —*

102 The Lord descended and preached *saṅkīrtana*; but that, as I have indicated before, is an external reason.

The main and hidden cause: it is the very own work of Kṛṣṇa Himself, and only Śrī Dāmodara Svarūpa, Gaura's second self, knows it —

103 There is another, chief seed of the descent: it is the very own work of Kṛṣṇa, the crown of all who relish rasa.

104 That most hidden reason is threefold, and it was made known by Svarūpa Dāmodara.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

The main cause of the Gaura-avatāra is extremely hidden, and it is threefold. Further on in the text it is stated in the verse beginning *śrī-rādhāyāḥ praṇaya-mahimā*.

105 Svarūpa Gosāñi is the Lord’s most intimate associate, and so he knows all these matters of the Lord.

Anubhāṣya.

Śrī Puruṣottama Bhaṭṭācārya lived in Navadvīpa. Even before Mahāprabhu took *sannyāsa*, he, wishing to take *sannyāsa* himself, went to Vārāṇasī and became a *brahmacārī* among the *daṇḍī-sannyāsīs* of the ten names. Then he came to be called “Śrī Dāmodara Svarūpa.” Afterward, without waiting for his *sannyāsa* to be completed, he came to the lotus feet of Śrī Mahāprabhu and stayed in Nīlācala for the rest of his life. He was always with Śrī Gaurasundara, singing songs of worship and the like that the Lord had taught, and so he constantly gave Him the greatest joy. Only by his mercy were the devotees able to grasp the hidden feelings of Śrī Prabhu's heart. In the pastimes of Vraja this great soul is Lalitā-devī, and therefore Rādhikā's second self. According to Kavi Karṇapūra's *Gaura-gaṇoddeśa-dīpikā*, he is Viśākhā-devī: “Viśākhā, who once taught Rādhā the arts in Vraja, is now Svarūpa Gosvāmī, who delights in her moods.” In the pastimes of Śrī Gaura, the second self of Gaurahari, the embodiment of Rādhā's *bhāva*, is Śrī Dāmodara Svarūpa.

*Gaurasundara is immersed in Rādhā's *mahābhāva* —*

106 The Lord’s heart is the very embodiment of Rādhikā’s mood, and in that mood joy and sorrow arise in Him incessantly.

Anubhāṣya.

The heart of Śrī Gaurasundara has a form full of Śrīmatī Rādhikā's *bhāva*. People of gross intelligence, busy gratifying the material senses, hear the word *bhāva-mūrti*, “embodiment of *bhāva*,” and cannot grasp the nature of a form made of *bhāva*. Devotees free from *anarthas*, in whom *rati* has awakened, are seen to be of five kinds when considered as *āśrita-tattva*. Rādhikā's *bhāva* is the highest and complete state of sweetness. That *bhāva* is of two kinds, *rūḍha* and *adhirūḍha*. The songs of the queens and the songs of the *gopīs* express these two *bhāvas*, *rūḍha* and *adhirūḍha*. What is meant here is Śrī

Gaurasundara's *adhirūḍha mahābhāva*. When rules fall away, then, judged by eagerness (*laulya*), the *adhirūḍha-bhāva* of Dvārakā finds its culmination in the *bhāva* of Gokula. In Śrī Gaurasundara's heart there constantly arise a semblance of sorrow (*duḥkhābhāsa*) in *vipralambha*, separation from Kṛṣṇa, and the happiness of *sambhoga*, attaining Kṛṣṇa. Thus, passing beyond the reach of imagination, *madhura-rasa* is relished. There are people who do not understand how *bhāva* differs from its absence and who set up "*adhirūḍha mahābhāva*" on the ground of gratifying the material senses. They do not realize the *āśrita-tattva* in their own true nature. As long as his original nature has not unfolded, the unfortunate *jīva* does not know that Gaurasundara is maddened by the *bhāva* of the *nāgarī*, the beloved of Vraja. Seeing in Him an object for gratifying his own material senses, he takes Him for a "*nāgara*," a lover, and becomes guilty of the fault of *rasābhāsa*, a distorted *rasa*.

107 In His last pastimes the Lord was mad with separation from Kṛṣṇa: all His actions were bewildered, and He spoke always as in delirium.[12]

Anubhāṣya.

Śrī Gaurahari, through the conduct of a *siddha*, displays the highest pinnacle of *vipralambha-rasa*, the *rasa* of separation. Those who hold to knowledge born of the senses therefore take His direct experiences for raving and for actions full of delusion. Foolish people devoted to the senses are always bound by the troubles of the external world; so the Object of service, in His spiritual form, is not drawn toward them. They think that just as the visible world makes them the center of enjoyment, so the transcendental acts of Śrī Gaurasundara must also belong to that world! Under the pretense of following, the doctrine called "Nadīyā-nāgarī," a perverted and wicked view that seeks to gratify the senses, is not the path shown by Śrī Gaurasundara and His followers. The adherents of this doctrine are materialists in search of enjoyment (*jaḍa-bhoga-vādīs*), and therefore enemies of Viṣṇu.

108 As Rādhikā felt on seeing Uddhava, so the Lord remained, intoxicated with that mood, day and night.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Śrī Kṛṣṇa sent Uddhava from Mathurā to the *gopīs* to bring them news of His well-being. On seeing Uddhava, Śrīmatī Rādhikā displayed a wondrous emotion.

Anubhāṣya.

Śrī Kṛṣṇa sent His friend Uddhava to Gokula, wishing to ease somewhat the longing of the *gopīs* and of His father and mother. On seeing Uddhava, Kṛṣṇa's friend, Śrīmatī Rādhikā expressed in many ways a hidden anger, full of many emotions and revealing Her intense, ultimate longing (*utkaṇṭhā*). Fully absorbed in Śrī Rādhā, Śrī Gaurasundara stayed intoxicated day and night with this *māthura-bhāva*, the mood of separation while Kṛṣṇa is in Mathurā. This is *citra-jalpa-bhāva*, the state of "varied talk." The *Ujjvala-nīlamaṇi* says: "When, on seeing the beloved's friend, [the heroine] utters talk full of many emotions, swelling with hidden anger and ending in intense longing, that is *jalpa*." For one who has taken shelter at the feet of Śrī Gaura, worship of Kṛṣṇa is precisely this long separation (*vipralambha*). Abundant separation is the cause of union (*sambhoga*). Not understanding this, many take union to be the very essence and fail to grasp the one thing needed: in the life of the *sādhaka* and of the *siddha* alike, the *rasa* of separation must be kindled.

The Lord reveals the feelings of His heart, and Svarūpa gives Him joy —

109 At night, holding Svarūpa by the neck, He spoke in delirium, and in His absorption He laid bare His own feelings.

110 Whatever mood arose in the Lord's heart, Dāmodara gave Him joy with a song or a verse that suited it.

111 There is no need to consider all this now; later I shall describe it in detail.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

"Later I shall describe this" — that is, in the Antya-līlā.

The three ages of Kṛṣṇa in Vraja —

112 Formerly in Vraja Kṛṣṇa had three ages — childhood, boyhood and youth — and youth was the most essential of them.

Kṛṣṇa's pastimes differ according to His age —

113 In the absorption of parental love He made His childhood fruitful, and with the host of His friends He made His boyhood fruitful.

*In the pastimes of *kiśora* everything finds its fulfillment —*

114 And with Rādhikā and the other gopīs He performed the *rāsa* dance and other pastimes, and tasted the very essence of rasa to His heart's content.

115 By the *rāsa* dance and other pastimes He made three things fruitful: His youth, Kāma (the god of love), and the whole world.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Up to five years of age is *kaumāra*, up to ten is *paugaṇḍa*, from eleven to sixteen is *kaiśora*, and after that comes *yauvana* (full youth). In *kaumāra* parental love (*vātsalya*) is manifest, in *paugaṇḍa* friendship (*sakhya*), and in *kaiśora* the *rasa* of amorous love (*śṛṅgāra*). *Kāma* is Kṛṣṇa, Manmatha (the god of love) Himself in person, who acts by His own will. In the age of *kaiśora* He performed the *rāsa* dance and other pastimes, and so He made fruitful the whole world and all three ages — *bālya*, *paugaṇḍa* and *kaiśora*.[31]

*(*Viṣṇu Purāṇa* 5.13.59)*

116 "Honouring His youth, Madhusūdana, the destroyer of all that is inauspicious, sported on autumn nights amid a host of jewel-like girls." (Viṣṇu Purāṇa, 5.13.59)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Śrī Kṛṣṇa, free of everything inauspicious, enjoyed pastimes at night in the age of *kaiśora*, staying in the midst of women, and so paid special honor to that age. Śrī Kṛṣṇa, the Supreme Consciousness, abides in the circle of Rādhā, full of *mahābhāva*, and of the *gopīs*, full of *bhāva* — He is the *kūṭastha-tattva*, the unchanging Truth at the center.

Anubhāṣya.

kṣapitāhitaḥ (He by whom everything inauspicious is destroyed, removed) **saḥ api madhusūdanaḥ** (He, Madhusūdana, Śrī Kṛṣṇa) **kaiśoraka-vayaḥ** (the age of *kaiśora*) **mānayan** (honoring, that is, making fruitful) **strī-ratna-kūṭa-sthaḥ** (staying amid the multitude of jewel-like women — the *gopīs*) **kṣapāsu** (on autumn nights) **reme** (enjoyed pastimes).

*(*Bhakti-rasāmṛta-sindhu*, *Dakṣiṇa-vibhāga* 1.231)*

117 "By words that hinted boldly at the arts of love of the night before, He made Rādhikā close Her eyes in shyness before Her friends; then, drawing playful *makarīs* on Her breasts, He showed the utmost skill. So Hari, sporting in the bowers, makes His youth fruitful." (Bhakti-rasāmṛta-sindhu, 2.1.231)[13]

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

This Kṛṣṇa boldly spoke of the art of love of the previous night and so made Śrī Rādhikā all but close Her eyes in shame. Then He drew playful designs — bees and the like — on Her breasts and displayed special skill before Her friends. By such pastimes of *rasa* in the grove Hari makes the age of *kaiśora* fruitful.

Anubhāṣya.

Having described the marks of the *dhīra-lalita* hero, the author shows that Śrī Kṛṣṇacandra is a *dhīra-lalita-nāyaka*, the carefree and playful hero.

sūcita-śarvarī-rati-kalā-prāgalbhyayā (in which the boldness of [His] skill in the art of love that night is disclosed) **vācā** (by speech) **sakhīnām agre** (before Her friends) **rādhikām** (Rādhikā) **vrīḍā-kuñcita-locanām** (so that Her eyes closed in shame) **viracayan** (making) **tad-vakṣo-ruha-citra-keli-makarī-pāṇḍitya-pāraṁ gataḥ** (who has reached the summit of skill in drawing playful *makarī* designs on Śrī Rādhā's breasts; this is said in jest: as He drew, His hand trembled and the picture came out crooked; then, as if to correct the crooked lines and draw them straight, He touched Her breasts again and again; in private this is an occasion for *samprayoga*, one of the two kinds of *sambhoga*) **asau hariḥ** (this Hari, who enjoys pastimes in Vraja) **kuñje vihāraṁ kalayan** (performing pastimes in the grove) **kaiśoram** (the age of *kaiśora*) **saphalī-karoti** (makes fruitful).

*(*Vidagdha-mādhava* 7.3)*

118 “O sweet-eyed one, had this Hari and Rādhikā not descended in Mathurā, all creation would have been in vain — and above all the god of love.” (Vidagdha-mādhava, 7.3)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
“O friend, if Hari and sweet-eyed Rādhikā had not appeared in Mathurā, the whole creation, and especially the creation of Kandarpa (the god of love), would have been fruitless.”

Anubhāṣya.
Śrī Vṛndā-devī says to Paurṇamāsī:

he madhurākṣi (O lovely-eyed one), **mathurāyām eṣaḥ hariḥ rādhikā ca** (this Hari and Rādhikā in Mathurā) **cet** (if) **na avātariṣyat** (had not descended), **tadā atra visṛṣṭiḥ** (then the creation here, the making of the world) **vṛthā abhaviṣyat** (would have been in vain); **viśeṣataḥ makarāṅkasya** (and especially that of Kandarpa, the god of love) **tu** ([creation] would have been in vain)!

Three desires left unfulfilled in Kṛṣṇa's pastimes —

119–120 Thus formerly Kṛṣṇa, the abode of rasa, relished the very essence of rasa; yet three of His desires remained unfulfilled, though He tried to taste them.

(1) His first desire —

121 I shall explain His first desire. Kṛṣṇa says: “I am the source of rasa.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
Rasera nidāna: the root cause of *rasa*. Variant reading: *rasera nidhāna*, the treasury of *rasa*.

An inquiry into the power and depth of Rādhā's love —

122 I am full of complete bliss, the spiritual and complete Truth; yet the love of Rādhikā makes Me mad.

123 I do not know how much strength there is in Rādhā's love, by which She ever overwhelms Me.

124 Rādhikā is My teacher in love, and I am Her disciple, a dancer: She always makes Me dance new and unheard-of dances."

*(*Govinda-līlāmṛta* 8.77)*

125 " 'Where have you come from, Vṛndā, dear friend?' 'From the feet of Hari.' 'And where is He?' 'In the forest by Rādhā-kuṇḍa.' 'What is He doing there?' 'Learning to dance.' 'And who is His teacher?' 'Your own image, Rādhā: appearing in every tree and creeper, in every quarter of the sky, it wanders all around like a skilled dancer and makes Kṛṣṇa dance behind it.' " (Govinda-līlāmṛta, 8.77)[14]

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

"Dear friend Vṛndā, where are you coming from?" — "O Rādhā, I am coming from Kṛṣṇa's feet." — "Where is Kṛṣṇa?" — "In Kuṇḍāraṇya (the forest by Rādhā-kuṇḍa)." — "What is He doing?" — "He is learning to dance." — "Who is His dancing teacher?" — "Your image. It has made every tree and creeper in every direction into Your image and, like a *śailūṣī*, a conjurer, it dances along, drawing Him after itself. Beside it Śrī Kṛṣṇa dances." This verse is made of questions and answers.

Anubhāṣya.

Within the midday pastimes of Śrī Rādhā and Kṛṣṇa, Śrī Rādhā and Vṛndā exchange questions and answers:

he priya-sakhi vṛnde (O dear friend Vṛndā), **tvaṁ kasmāt** (where are you from)? (To Śrī Rādhikā's question where she has come from, Vṛndā replies:) **hareḥ** (of Bhagavān, the son of Yaśodā) **pāda-mūlāt** (from the feet). **asau** (He, Śrī Kṛṣṇa) **kutaḥ** (where)? (When Śrī Rādhā asks again, "Where?", Vṛndā replies:) **kuṇḍāraṇye** (in the grove near Rādhā-kuṇḍa). (Śrī Rādhā asks again:) **iha** ([He] here) **kiṁ kurute** (what is He doing)? (Vṛndā said:) **nṛtya-śikṣām** ([learning] to dance). (Rādhā said:) **guruḥ kaḥ** (who is the teacher)? (Vṛndā said:) **prati-taru-latam** (in every tree and creeper) **dig-vidikṣu** (in all ten directions) **śailūṣī** (a skilled dancer) **iva sphurantī** (appearing like) **tvan-mūrtiḥ** (Your image) **tam**

(Him, Kṛṣṇa) **sva-paścāt paritaḥ** (behind itself, everywhere) **nartayantī** (making Him dance) **bhramati** (moves about).

The love of Kṛṣṇa and Rādhā for each other: comparison and distinctions —

126 "The joy I feel in tasting My own love is great, but Rādhā's joy in tasting Her love is ten million times greater.

An explanation of the love of Rādhā and Kṛṣṇa for each other —

127 As I am the shelter of mutually opposite qualities, so Rādhā's love is always full of opposite qualities.

Examples of the contradictory qualities of Rādhā's love —

128 Rādhā's love is all-pervading, with no room left to grow; yet it grows at every moment.

129 Nothing is greater than this love, and yet it is free of the pride that belongs to greatness.

130 Nothing is purer than this love, and yet its ways are ever contrary and crooked.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

"I, Kṛṣṇa, am the shelter of mutually contradictory qualities. I am changeless yet act by My own will, all-pervading yet possessed of a beautiful form, impartial yet partial to My devotees, self-satisfied (*ātmārāma*) yet longing for My devotees' love, and so on. In the same way Rādhā's love is full of contradictory qualities: it is the highest *mahābhāva* yet always growing, full of the gravity of love yet without any deference, pure yet full of contrariness (*vāmya*) and the like."

*(*Dāna-keli-kaumudī* 2)*

131 "All glory to Rādhikā's love for Kṛṣṇa, the enemy of Mura! All-pervading, it grows at every moment; great, it is free of pride; again and again it grows more crooked, and yet it is pure." (Dāna-keli-kaumudī, 2)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Rādhikā's *anurāga* is *vibhu*, that is, it has reached the furthest limit, yet it is always growing; it is supremely exalted, yet it knows no deference; it is pure and spotless, yet again and again it takes crooked ways. May such *anurāga* of Rādhikā for Kṛṣṇa be glorious!

Anubhāṣya.

vibhuḥ (all-pervading) **api sadā abhivṛddhim** (increase on every side) **kalayan** (bearing), **guruḥ api** (though supreme) **gaurava-caryayā vihīnaḥ** (devoid of service out of deference, *dākṣiṇya*) (for it is born of *madhu-sneha*, affection sweet as honey and full of the feeling "He is mine"), **muhuḥ** (again and again) **upacita-vakrimā** (in which crookedness — cunning, the mark of contrariness — increases) **api śuddhaḥ** (yet pure, free of designations) **rādhikānurāgaḥ** (Śrī Rādhikā's *anurāga*) **mura-dviṣi** (for Murāri, Śrī Kṛṣṇa) **jayati** (stands supreme over all).

*Kṛṣṇa is the *viṣaya* of that love, Rādhikā its *āśraya* —*

132 Rādhikā is the supreme *āśraya* of that love — the one in whom it dwells; and I am only its *viṣaya* — the One toward whom it flows.

*The difference in the happiness of the *viṣaya* and the *āśraya* —*

133 The happiness I taste is that of the *viṣaya*; the joy of the *āśraya* is ten million times greater than Mine.

*Seeing the greater happiness of the *āśraya*, the *viṣaya* longs to become the *āśraya* —*

134 My mind runs after the happiness of the *āśraya*, but try as I may, I cannot taste it. What means can I find?

135 If ever I become the *āśraya* of this love, then I shall know its bliss."

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

One who loves is the *āśraya*, the abode, of love; one who is loved is its *viṣaya*, the object. In the science of *rasa* there are four kinds of ingredients: *vibhāva*, *anubhāva*, *sāttvika* and *vyabhicārī*. *Vibhāva* is of two kinds: *ālambana*,

the support of the emotion, and *uddīpana*, that which awakens it. *Ālambana* in turn is of two kinds: *viṣaya* and *āśraya*. The *āśraya* of Rādhā's love is Rādhikā, and the one and only *viṣaya* of that love is Kṛṣṇa. “The happiness that I, Kṛṣṇa, relish is the happiness of the *viṣaya*. But the delight, or happiness, of the *āśraya* is millions of times greater than My happiness as *viṣaya*. Only Rādhikā relishes the happiness of the *āśraya*; I, as Kṛṣṇa, cannot relish it. Only if one day I become the *āśraya* of this love shall I experience that supreme bliss, the happiness of the *āśraya*. The longing to taste love as the *āśraya* tastes it — that is My desire.”

136 So Kṛṣṇa reflects, ever eager for wonder, and in His heart the longing for that love blazes ever higher.

(2) The second desire —

137 That is one. Now hear of another kind of longing. Seeing His own sweetness, Kṛṣṇa reflects:

Kṛṣṇa Himself is amazed and attracted by His own sweetness —

138 “Wondrous, endless and complete is My sweetness; in the three worlds no one finds its limit.

139 Through this love Rādhikā alone ever tastes all the nectar of My sweetness.

Śrī Rādhā's love is complete, yet it grows at every moment —

140 Though the mirror of Rādhā’s true love is spotless, its clearness grows at every moment.

141 My sweetness has no room to grow, and yet before this mirror it shines in ever new forms.

142 My sweetness and Rādhā’s love vie with each other; at every moment both grow, and neither is defeated.

Anubhāṣya.
Hoḍa kari: rivaling.

143 My sweetness is ever new, and devotees taste it each according to his own love.

144 When I see My own sweetness in a mirror or the like, a longing to taste it arises, but I cannot taste it.

To relish His own sweetness, He longs to take the form of Her who relishes it
—

145 And when I consider how I might taste it, My mind runs to become Rādhikā Herself.”

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
The second desire is this. Kṛṣṇa's sweetness is wondrous, endless and unlimited. Rādhikā alone relishes this sweetness, through the love that fills Her as the *āśraya*. “The mirror of Rādhikā's pure love is spotless, yet its clarity increases at every moment. My sweetness is unlimited and so cannot increase — yet it does increase, and before the clear mirror of Rādhikā's love it shines in ever newer forms. Therefore My sweetness and Rādhā's love rival each other, each striving to surpass the other, and neither wants to yield. Seeing My own sweetness in the mirror of Rādhikā's love and in other such mirrors, I long to relish it. Out of that longing My mind runs to accept the *svarūpa* of Rādhikā.”

*(*Lalita-mādhava* 8.34)*

146 “What wondrous flood of My sweetness, never known before and surpassing all, appears here! Alas, seeing it, even I long with an eager heart to enjoy it, as Rādhikā does.” (Lalita-mādhava, 8.34)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
Kṛṣṇa said: “Ah! Who is this excellent person (*puruṣa*) pictured here, never seen before, whose deep sweetness astonishes? Looking at Him, I am stirred at heart, and like Rādhikā I want to embrace Him impetuously.”

Anubhāṣya.

In Dvārakā, in Nava-Vṛndāvana, Śrī Kṛṣṇa sees His reflection in a wall of jewels and, beholding His own beauty, says:

aparikalita-pūrvaḥ (never experienced before) **camatkāra-kārī** (causing wonder) **eṣaḥ garīyān** (this most exalted) **mama kaḥ** (My indescribable) **mādhurya-pūraḥ** (flood of sweetness, a mass of beauty) **sphurati** (appears). **ayam aham** (I, Kṛṣṇa) **api yam** (it, this image in the reflection) **prekṣya** (seeing) **rādhikā iva** (like Rādhikā) **lubdha-cetāḥ san** (with a mind full of longing) **sarabhasam** (eagerly) **upabhoktum** (to enjoy) **kāmaye** (desire).

The power of Kṛṣṇa's sweetness and His efforts to relish it —

147 Kṛṣṇa's sweetness has a natural power: it makes all men and women restless, beginning with Kṛṣṇa Himself.

Anubhāṣya.

Kṛṣṇa's sweetness by its very nature has the power to stir everyone: Kṛṣṇa Himself, the *gopīs*, Baladeva, Nārāyaṇa, Lakṣmī and all other living beings.

148 Heard of or seen, it draws every heart, and Kṛṣṇa Himself strives to taste it.

Kṛṣṇa's sweetness knows no worldly satiety — longing only grows —

149 Whoever drinks this nectar of sweetness finds his thirst never quenched; the thirst only grows without end.

150 Unsatisfied, he blames the Creator: "The unskilled Creator does not know how to create well!

151 He did not give me ten million eyes — he gave only two, and even those blink. How shall I see Kṛṣṇa?"

*(*Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 10.82.39)*

152 "At last, after long separation, the gopīs found their beloved Kṛṣṇa. Gazing at Him, they cursed the maker of their eyelids; then through their

eyes they took Him into their hearts and embraced Him there to their fill. So they all attained a state that even perfected yogīs can hardly reach." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 10.82.39)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

The *gopīs* attained Śrī Kṛṣṇa, whom they had longed for over many days, and as they gazed at Him they reproached the Creator who made the eyes blink. Through their eyes they all embraced Him to their hearts' content within the heart and attained the highest emotion, unattainable even for *yogīs* who meditate on Brahman.

Anubhāṣya.

After the cowherds met the Vṛṣṇis at Kurukṣetra, Śukadeva describes the feelings of the *gopīs* for Kṛṣṇa:

yat-prekṣaṇe (when seeing Śrī Kṛṣṇa) **dṛśiṣu** (on the eyes) **pakṣma-kṛtam** (the Creator who made the eyelashes, the hairs of the eyelids that obstruct the view) **śapanti** (they curse). ([All]) **gopyaḥ** (the *gopīs*) ([Him]) **abhīṣṭam** (Kṛṣṇa, their desired one) **cirāt** (after a long time, at Kurukṣetra) **upalabhya** (having attained), **dṛgbhiḥ** (through the eyes) **hṛdī-kṛtam** (brought into the heart) **parirabhya** (embracing), **nitya-yujām** (for *yogīs* who have reached the summit of *yoga*) **api durāpam** (hard to attain) **tad-bhāvam** (the state of concentrated supreme bliss) **āpuḥ** (attained).

*(*Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 10.31.15)*

153 "When by day You wander in the forest, a moment without You becomes an age for us. And as we gaze upon Your beautiful face framed in curling locks, we see what a fool was the maker of our eyelids." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 10.31.15)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

The *gopīs* said: "O Kṛṣṇa, when You go to the forest by day, every instant (*truṭi*) in which we do not see Your beautiful face framed by curling locks becomes an entire *yuga* for us. And the Creator who made eyelids on our eyes, which gaze at Your face, we consider a fool."

Anubhāṣya.

When Kṛṣṇa disappeared during the *rāsa* dance, the *gopīs* sang in lament for Him:

yat (when) **ahni** (by day) **bhavān** (You) **kānanam** (to the forest, Vṛndāvana) **aṭati** (go), **tadā tvām apaśyatām** (then for [the living beings] who do not see You) **truṭiḥ** (even half a moment) **yugāyate** (seems to last a *yuga*). **te** (Your) **kuṭila-kuntalam** (framed by curling locks) **śrī-mukham** (beautiful face) **udīkṣatām** (of those looking up [at it]) **ca dṛśām** (of the eyes) **pakṣma-kṛt** (the Creator who made blinking) **jaḍaḥ** (a fool) **eva** (indeed).

The eyes of a fortunate soul find their purpose only in seeing Kṛṣṇa's form —

154 Without seeing Kṛṣṇa the eyes have no other fruit; whoever sees Kṛṣṇa is fortunate indeed.

*(*Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 10.21.7)*

155 "O friends, we know no other fruit for the eyes than this: to drink in the faces of the two sons of Vraja's lord as They drive the cows into the forest with Their friends, playing Their flutes and casting loving glances." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 10.21.7)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

The *gopīs* said: "O friends, when Nanda's two sons enter the forest with the cows, surrounded by Their friends, blessed are those who serve Their faces with their eyes: They play the flute and cast glances at those who love Them. Those who have eyes can gain nothing higher than this."

Anubhāṣya.

At the coming of autumn, the *gopīs* sing with Kṛṣṇa in mind:

he sakhyaḥ (O friends), **vayasyaiḥ** (with Their friends) **paśūn anuviveśayatoḥ** (leading the herds from forest to forest) **vrajeśa-sutayoḥ** (of the sons of the lord of Vraja, Rāma and Kṛṣṇa) **anuveṇu-juṣṭam** (playing the flute) **anurakta-kaṭākṣa-mokṣam** (casting tender sidelong glances) [the face] **yaiḥ nipītam** (by whom it was drunk) — that which they enjoyed — **idam vai** (this indeed) **akṣaṇvatām** (of those who have eyes) **phalam** (the fruit); **param** (anything else) **na vidāmaḥ** (we do not know).

*The women of Mathurā marvel at the good fortune of the *gopīs* —*

156 "What austerities did the gopīs perform, that with their eyes they drink His form — the essence of loveliness, unequalled and unsurpassed, perfect in itself, new at every moment, hard to attain, the sole abode of fame, beauty and majesty?" (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 10.44.14)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

The women of Mathurā said: "Ah, what austerity the *gopīs* must have performed! With their eyes they constantly drink the nectar of Śrī Kṛṣṇa's face. He is the sole abode of beauty, majesty and all fame; He is hard to attain, perfect by Himself, with none equal or superior to Him — the very essence of loveliness."

Anubhāṣya.

In Kaṁsa's arena in Mathurā, Rāma and Kṛṣṇa were wrestling with his wrestlers Muṣṭika and Cāṇūra. Seeing this, the assembled women say:

gopyaḥ kim tapaḥ acaran (what austerity did the *gopīs* perform), **yat** (since) **amuṣya** (of Śrī Kṛṣṇa) **lāvaṇya-sāram** (excelling all in loveliness) **asamordhvam** (that which has no equal or superior) **ananya-siddham** (perfect not through anything else — ornaments and the like — but by itself) **anusavābhinavam** (new at every moment) **durāpam** (hard to attain) **yaśasaḥ śriyaḥ aiśvarasya** (of fame, beauty and majesty) **ekānta-dhāma** (the sole abode) — **rūpam** (the form) — **dṛgbhiḥ pibanti** (they drink with their eyes).

157 Unprecedented is Kṛṣṇa's sweetness, and unprecedented its power: merely hearing of it, the mind trembles.

158 Kṛṣṇa's sweetness awakens longing in Kṛṣṇa Himself; He cannot taste it fully, and sorrow remains in His heart.

(3) The third desire —

159 So I have described the second reason. Now hear the nature of the third.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Kṛṣṇa longed to relish His own sweetness fully, with the love known to the *āśraya*, but He could not and was distressed. This is the second hidden reason why He accepted Rādhikā's emotion.

*Svarūpa Dāmodara alone is the original *mahājana* in the nectar of *bhakti-rasa* —*

160 This conclusion about rasa is most deeply hidden; Svarūpa Gosāñi alone knows it fully.

161 If anyone else knows it, he knows it from him, for he is the very heart of Caitanya Gosāñi.

*The definition of the *gopīs'* love*

162 The love of the gopīs is called *rūḍha-bhāva*. It is pure and spotless prema, never lust (*kāma*).

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

"The love of the *gopīs* is called *rūḍha-bhāva*" — that is, the name of this *prema* is *rūḍha-bhāva*. For spotless *prema* cannot in truth be expressed by the word *kāma* (the desire to please one's own senses).

Anubhāṣya.

In the *mahābhāva* of the *gopīs* all the *sāttvika-bhāvas* blaze forth; therefore their love is called *rūḍha-bhāva*: "When the *sāttvika* [*bhāvas*] blaze forth, it is called *rūḍha*." Their love aims only at Kṛṣṇa's happiness and is therefore spotless. It cannot be called by the contemptible word *kāma*, which means enjoyment for someone other than Kṛṣṇa.

*The *kāma* and the *prema* of the *gopīs* are one and the same —*

163 "It is the prema of the cowherd women that became famed under the name *kāma*; and so even Uddhava and others dear to the Lord long for it." (Bhakti-rasāmṛta-sindhu, 1.2.285)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

It became customary to call the pure love of the cowherd women "*kāma*." Even the devotees of Bhagavān — Uddhava and others — thirst for this love.

Anubhāṣya.

gopa-rāmāṇām (of the young women of Vraja) **premā eva** (the *prema* itself) **kāmaḥ iti** (as *kāma*) **prathām** (fame) **agamat** (attained); **iti** (therefore) **uddhavādayaḥ api bhagavat-priyāḥ** (even Uddhava and others dear to Bhagavān, that is, devotees who relish other *rasas*) **etam** (this *prema*) **vāñchanti** (desire).

*The nature, marks and difference of *kāma* and *prema* —*

164 Lust and love have different characteristics, as iron and gold differ in their very nature.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Iron and gold are entirely different by their very nature. So too *kāma* and *prema*: though they are almost of one kind, their characteristics differ.

*The definition of *kāma* and *prema* —*

165 The desire to please one's own senses is called lust (*kāma*); the wish to please Kṛṣṇa's senses bears the name of prema.

Anubhāṣya.

"When the bond of feeling between a young couple is in no way destroyed, even when there is cause for its destruction, it is called *prema*." When a cause for separation arises and yet the firm bond of feeling between two lovers is destroyed by nothing — that is called *prema*. The *gopīs*, the *āśraya* of love, are bound to Kṛṣṇa by a firm bond of feeling, exclusively and with their whole being. They are the model of renouncing one's own happiness, that is, *kāma*, and are intent only on the service that delights Kṛṣṇa. Thus one sees how, sacrificing their own happiness for Kṛṣṇa, they feel immense joy, and how firm the bond of their feeling is.

*The aim of *kāma* and the aim of *prema* —*

166 The aim of lust is only one's own enjoyment; the aim of love is only Kṛṣṇa's happiness, and so love is mighty.

The marks by which love for Kṛṣṇa is known —

167–169 Social custom and Vedic religion, the needs of the body and their duties, shame and restraint, bodily pleasure and the very core of their own happiness, the path of the noble (*ārya-patha*), so hard to give up, their own families, and all the chastisement and rebukes of their kin — giving up all this, they worship Kṛṣṇa and serve Him with love for His happiness alone.[15]

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

A desire whose aim is one's own enjoyment is called *kāma*. The Vedas speak of such desires with the words *lokaiṣaṇā* (the craving for worldly recognition), *putraiṣaṇā* (the craving for offspring), *vittaiṣaṇā* (the craving for wealth) and the like. These make up the following: *loka-dharma* (social custom), *veda-dharma* (Vedic duty), *deha-dharma* (the needs of the body), *karma*, shame, composure, bodily happiness, one's own happiness in the form of liberation and so on, the path of the Āryans, affection for one's family, and fear of punishment and reproach from one's relatives. All this is *kāma*, the desire to please one's own senses: in all these activities what drives one is the wish to gratify one's own senses. Desires that follow the awareness “I am a servant of Kṛṣṇa” can be the desire to please Kṛṣṇa's senses. But all desires born of the notion “I am the enjoyer of the fruits” are desires of *kāma*.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

The words “giving up everything” do not counsel abandoning the activities of body, mind and so on. If the activities of body and mind too are moved by the awareness “I am a servant of Kṛṣṇa,” that is not *kāma* either.

170 This is called firm attachment (*anurāga*) to Kṛṣṇa: it is as clean as washed cloth without a single stain.

*The difference between *kāma* and *prema* —*

171 Therefore there is a vast difference between lust and love: lust is blind darkness, and love the spotless sun.

**Kāma* — and the *gopīs'* love for Kṛṣṇa —*

172 Therefore in the gopīs there is not even a trace of lust; their bond with Kṛṣṇa is for His happiness alone.

*How the deep love of the *gopīs* for Kṛṣṇa shows itself —*

173 "O dear one, Your tender lotus feet we place gently on our hard breasts, afraid to hurt them — and with those feet You wander through the forest! Are they not hurt by the sharp pebbles? You are our very life, and our minds are reeling." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 10.31.19)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

The *gopīs* said: "O beloved, we gently hold Your tender lotus feet on our hard breasts. With these feet You now wander through the forest, and they must surely hurt, wounded by tiny stones and the like. You are our very life, and so our hearts are anxious for You."

Anubhāṣya.

When Kṛṣṇa disappeared during the *rāsa* dance, the *gopīs* sang in lament for Him:

he priya (O beloved), **te** (Your) **yat sujāta-caraṇāmburuham** (tender lotus feet) **karkaśeṣu** (on hard) **staneṣu** (breasts) **bhītāḥ** (afraid that the touch might hurt them) **satyaḥ** ([we]) **śanaiḥ** (carefully) **dadhīmahi** (hold), **tena** (with those feet) **aṭavīm** (through the forest) **aṭasi** (You wander); **tat** (then [Your lotus feet]) **kūrpādibhiḥ** (by tiny splinters of stone) **kiṁ svit na vyathate** (are they not pained?) — **iti** (so [thinking]) **bhavad-āyuṣām** (of those whose life is You) **naḥ** (our) **dhīḥ** (mind) **bhramati** (loses its calm).

*The pure love of the *gopīs* for Kṛṣṇa —*

174 The gopīs give no thought to their own happiness or sorrow; all they do is for Kṛṣṇa's happiness.

175 For Kṛṣṇa they have given up everything else, and their pure attachment is for His happiness alone.

*Kṛṣṇa, bound by the *gopīs'* love, asks forgiveness for having disappeared —*

176 "O tender ones! For My sake you have abandoned the laws of society and of the Vedas, and even your kinsmen. I disappeared only that your love for Me might grow still stronger — yet even unseen I went on loving you. So, beloved ones, do not be displeased with Him who is dear to you." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 10.32.21)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

"O *gopīs*, for My sake you gave up social custom, Vedic duty and all your relatives. Still, I disappeared so that your attachment to Me might grow even stronger. O beloved ones, I am only trying to please you — do not blame Me."

Anubhāṣya.

Having returned to the place of the *rāsa* dance and heard the *gopīs*, Kṛṣṇa says:

he priyāḥ abalāḥ (O beloved, tender women), **evam** (thus) **mad-arthojjhita-loka-veda-svānām** (who for My sake, to attain Me, have abandoned *loka* — worldly duties and the like — *veda* — duties for the next world — and *sva* — your kin and family; [you] for whom Kṛṣṇa is the only life) **vaḥ** (your) **mayi anuvṛttaye** (so that your attachment to Me might increase, like that of other devotees with the marks described) **parokṣam** (so that you did not see Me) **bhajatā** (by Me, who was doing you good) **mayā** (by Me) **tirohitam hi** ([My presence] was hidden); **tat** (therefore) **priyam** (beloved) **mā** (Me) **asūyitum** (to look on with reproach, finding fault) **na arhatha** (you ought not).

Kṛṣṇa is attained differently according to the kinds of pure devotion —

177 Kṛṣṇa has a promise from of old: as one worships Him, so does He reciprocate.

*(*Bhagavad-gītā* 4.11)*

178 "As people surrender to Me, so do I reward them. O Pārtha, all men follow My path in every way." (Bhagavad-gītā, 4.11)[16]

Anubhāṣya.

See Ādi 4.20.

*Kṛṣṇa's unpayable debt to the *gopīs'* love —*

179 That promise was broken by the gopīs' worship, and the proof is in Kṛṣṇa's own words:

*(*Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 10.32.22)*

180 "O gopīs, your union with Me is faultless. Even in a lifetime of the gods I could not repay you for what you have done: you cut the fetters of home, so hard to break, and came to Me. So let your own good deed be your reward." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 10.32.22)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

"O *gopīs*, your union with Me is spotless. Even in many lifetimes I could not fulfill My duty to you by good deeds of My own, for you completely broke the hardest chains of household life and went in search of Me. I am unable to repay My debt to you. So let your own deeds be your reward."

Anubhāṣya.

Kṛṣṇa had disappeared, and the *gopīs*, unable to see Him, sang in lament at the separation. Hearing their song, Kṛṣṇa appeared and consoles them thus:

niravadya-saṁyujām (whose union [with Me] is faultless — guileless and complete) **vaḥ** (your) **sva-sādhu-kṛtyam** (own extraordinary good deed) **aham** (I) **vibudhāyuṣā api** (even in the lifetime of the gods) **na pāraye** (am unable [to repay]). **yāḥ** (you who) **durjaya-geha-śṛṅkhalāḥ** (the unbreakable chains of home) **saṁvṛścya** (cutting completely) **mā** (Me) **abhajan** (worshiped) — **tāsām vaḥ eva** (by your own) **sādhunā** (good deed) **tat** (that good deed of yours) **pratiyātu** (let it be repaid).

*Even when the *gopīs* bring happiness to themselves, they seek only Kṛṣṇa's happiness —*

181 And if we see that the gopīs care for their own bodies, know for certain that this too is for Kṛṣṇa.

182 "This body I have offered to Kṛṣṇa. It is His property, meant for His delight.

183 Seeing and touching this body gives Kṛṣṇa pleasure.” For this reason they cleanse and adorn their bodies.

*Even in adorning their bodies, the *gopīs* aim only to please Kṛṣṇa —*

184 “O Pārtha, the gopīs tend even their own bodies, for they regard them as Mine. There is no greater vessel of My secret love than they.” (Ādi Purāṇa; Laghu-bhāgavatāmṛta, Uttara-khaṇḍa, 40)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

The *gopīs* take care of their bodies, considering them meant for Kṛṣṇa's enjoyment. “O Pārtha, there is no one who is a greater vessel of My love than these *gopīs*.”

Anubhāṣya.

he pārtha (O Pārtha), **yāḥ gopyaḥ** (those *gopīs* who) **nijāṅgam api** (even their own bodies) **mama iti** (as “Mine,” that is, thinking, “This body has been given to the Beloved; it belongs to Bhagavān”) **samupāsate** (adorn with ornaments and the like) — **tābhyaḥ** (than those *gopīs*) **param** (other) **me** (My) **nigūḍha-prema-bhājanam** (vessel of hidden love) (there is none).

*The *gopīs'* happiness in service is millions of times greater than Kṛṣṇa's —*

185 There is another wondrous trait of the gopīs’ love, whose power lies beyond the reach of the intellect.

186 When the gopīs see Kṛṣṇa, they have no desire for happiness, and yet their happiness grows ten million times.

187 The joy Kṛṣṇa feels on seeing the gopīs — the gopīs taste ten million times more.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

The *gopīs* have no desire for their own happiness. Still, when they see Kṛṣṇa, they relish a happiness millions of times greater than the happiness Kṛṣṇa feels on seeing the *gopīs*.

188 They have no concern for their own happiness, and still their happiness grows — here is a contradiction.

189 I see only one solution to this contradiction: the gopīs' happiness finds its fulfilment in Kṛṣṇa's happiness.[17]

190 On seeing the gopīs Kṛṣṇa's delight grows, and His sweetness, which has no equal, grows too.

191 "On seeing me Kṛṣṇa felt such happiness!" — with this happiness the gopīs' faces and bodies blossom.

192 The more Kṛṣṇa's beauty grows on seeing the gopīs' beauty, the more the gopīs' beauty grows on seeing His.

193 So a contest arises between them; both grow together, and neither turns away.

*The *gopīs* are happy in Kṛṣṇa's happiness —*

194 But Kṛṣṇa's happiness comes from the gopīs' beauty and virtues, and the gopīs' happiness grows by His happiness.

*The *gopīs'* love increases Kṛṣṇa's happiness — therefore it is not *kāma* —*

195 Thus their happiness nourishes Kṛṣṇa's happiness, and for this reason there is no fault of lust in the gopīs' love.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Someone may perhaps reproach the *gopīs* and call "*kāma*" the happiness they feel on seeing Kṛṣṇa. But in the *gopīs'* minds the feeling is this: "If Kṛṣṇa sees that we are happy looking at Him, His happiness will become still fuller." So the ultimate reason the *gopīs* attain happiness is the desire to please Kṛṣṇa's senses. Therefore it has no taint of *kāma*, the desire to please one's own senses.

*(*Stava-mālā*, *Keśavāṣṭaka* 8)*

196 "I worship Keśava, returning victorious from the forest to Vraja. Rows of beautiful girls come out on the road to worship Him with hundreds of dancing side-glances mingled with budding smiles, and the corners of His eyes, like bees, wander over the flower-clusters of their breasts." (Stava-mālā, Keśavāṣṭaka, 8)[18]

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

I worship Keśava, who is returning from the forest to Vraja. The beauties of Vraja honored Him on the road with hundreds of playful glances and gentle smiles. And the corners of His eyes, like bees, flit over the breasts of those *gopīs*, which are like clusters of flowers.

Anubhāṣya.

ābhiḥ sundarī-tatibhiḥ (by these rows of beauties who enjoy pastimes in Vraja) **upetya** (having climbed onto the rooftops) **pathi** (on the road) **smitāṅkura-karambitaiḥ** (mixed with budding gentle smiles) **naṭad-apāṅga-bhaṅgī-śataiḥ** (with hundreds of curves of dancing sidelong glances) **abhyarcitam** (worshiped on every side) **stana-stavaka-sañcaran-nayana-cañcarīkāñcalam** (Him the corners of whose eyes, like bees, flit over breasts that are like clusters of flowers) **vipina-deśataḥ** (from the forest — in the afternoon, returning from the pastures) **vraje** (into Vraja, into Nandīśvara) **vijayinam** (entering in triumph) **keśavam** (Keśava, Kṛṣṇa) **bhaje** (I worship).

*The natural mark of the *gopīs'* love —*

197 There is another natural sign of the gopīs' love, which shows that it has no trace of lust.

*The *gopīs'* love increases Kṛṣṇa's sweetness —*

198 The gopīs' love nourishes Kṛṣṇa's sweetness, and that sweetness in turn makes their love grow, to their great delight.

*The servant, the *āśraya*, finds pure joy only in the joy of the *viṣaya*, the*

One who is served —

199 The bliss of the *āśraya* of love lies in the bliss of its *viṣaya*; there is no connection with the desire for one’s own happiness.

The devotee's joy lies in Bhagavān's joy; such joy is pure and spotless —

200 Wherever love is unconditional, this is the law: the joy of the *āśraya* lies in the happiness of the *viṣaya*.

During service to Kṛṣṇa, gratifying one's own senses is contemptible and must be cast far away —

201 If the bliss of one’s own love hinders the bliss of serving Kṛṣṇa, the devotee is filled with great anger at that bliss.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

The *gopīs*, the *āśraya* of love, delight in the delight of Kṛṣṇa, its *viṣaya*. In this abundance of joy there is no connection at all with a desire for their own happiness. Wherever love is free of all designations, you will see this very law: the *āśraya* of love is happy with the happiness of its *viṣaya*. You may, however, say: where one's own bliss of love arises, there will surely be an obstacle to the bliss of serving Kṛṣṇa. That is why, when a joy arises that hinders the bliss of service, the devotee becomes greatly angry.

*(*Bhakti-rasāmṛta-sindhu*, *Paścima-vibhāga* 2.62)*

202 “Dāruka did not welcome the bliss of love that brought on a stupor of his body, for it put no small obstacle in the way of his fanning Kṛṣṇa, the enemy of Kaṁsa.” (Bhakti-rasāmṛta-sindhu, 3.2.62)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

While fanning Śrī Kṛṣṇa with a *cāmara*, Dāruka understood that the stupor of the body caused by the bliss of love was an obstacle to service, and he did not welcome that bliss.

Anubhāṣya.

yena (by which, that is, by the bliss of love) **kaṁsārāteḥ** (of Kṛṣṇa) **vījane** (in fanning, in the service of the *cāmara*) **sākṣāt akṣodīyān** (directly, no small)

antarāyaḥ (obstacle) **vyadhāyi** (was created) — **dārukaḥ** (Dāruka, Śrī Kṛṣṇa's charioteer) **aṅga-stambhārambham** (the stiffening of the limbs, the stupor of the body) **uttuṅgayantam** (producing) **tam premānandam** (that bliss of love, worthy to be experienced for oneself) **na abhyanandat** (did not welcome: he did not desire it at all, since it was not favorable [to service]).

*(*Bhakti-rasāmṛta-sindhu*, *Dakṣiṇa-vibhāga* 3.54)*

203 "The lotus-eyed Rādhikā loudly condemned the bliss that poured floods of tears from Her eyes and kept Her from seeing Govinda." (Bhakti-rasāmṛta-sindhu, 2.3.54)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Kṛṣṇa's lotus-eyed beloved bitterly reproached the bliss that poured from her eyes as tears and kept her from seeing Kṛṣṇa.

Anubhāṣya.

aravinda-vilocanā (lotus-eyed Rādhikā) **govinda-prekṣaṇākṣepi-bāṣpa-pūrābhivarṣiṇam** (which by its nature pours down floods of tears that hinder the sight of Govinda) **ānandam** (bliss) **uccaiḥ** (strongly) **anindat** (reproached).

Without devotion to Kṛṣṇa, even liberation is repugnant to a pure devotee —

204 And pure devotees, without loving service to Kṛṣṇa, will not accept *sālokya* and the other liberations for their own happiness.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

See this too: without loving service to Kṛṣṇa a pure devotee will never accept even liberation — *sālokya* and the others — if it brings happiness to himself.

*Only devotion to Kṛṣṇa — causeless and uninterrupted — is beyond the *guṇas* —*

205 "Merely by hearing of My qualities the mind flows unbroken toward Me, who dwell in all hearts, as the waters of the Gaṅgā flow into the ocean." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 3.29.11)

206 “Such is the mark of bhakti-yoga beyond the guṇas (*nirguṇa*): devotion to the Supreme Person that is unmotivated and uninterrupted.” (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 3.29.12)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

“Simply by hearing of My qualities, the mind flows toward Me, who dwell in all hearts, unbroken, like the waters of the Gaṅgā flowing into the ocean. This state is the mark of *nirguṇa bhakti-yoga* (*bhakti-yoga* free of the *guṇas*). Such devotion to Me, the Puruṣottama, is causeless and uninterrupted.” Causeless (*ahaitukī*) means it has no cause; it is perfect in itself. Uninterrupted (*avyavahitā*) means it has no obstacles and no search for incidental fruits.

Anubhāṣya.

Śrī Kapiladeva says to His mother Devahūti:

mad-guṇa-śruti-mātreṇa (simply by hearing of My qualities) **sarva-guhāśaye** (who dwell in all hearts) **mayi** (toward Me), **ambudhau** (into the ocean) **gaṅgāmbhasaḥ yathā** (as the waters of the Gaṅgā), **avicchinnā** (unobstructed: such that no other object can break it) **mano-gatiḥ** (the movement of the mind); **puruṣottame** (toward the Puruṣottama) **yā ahaitukī** (devotion free of the search for fruits) **avyavahitā** (free of such obstacles as craving for the body's comforts, for wealth, for popularity, godlessness and the like) **bhaktiḥ** (devotion) — **sā** (that) **nirguṇasya** (beyond the three *guṇas*, directed to Bhagavān) **bhakti-yogasya** (of *bhakti-yoga*) **lakṣaṇam** (the mark) **udāhṛtam hi** (is indeed declared).

207 “My devotees accept nothing but service to Me — not even when they are offered residence in My world, opulence equal to Mine, nearness to Me, a form like Mine, or even oneness with Me.” (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 3.29.13)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

“Even if they are offered *sālokya* (residence in Vaikuṇṭha), *sārṣṭi* (equal majesty and wealth), *sāmīpya* (nearness), *sārūpya* (a four-armed form) and *ekatva* (*sāyujya*, merging), the devotees do not accept them: apart from transcendental service to Me, they have nothing to ask for.”

Anubhāṣya.

janāḥ (the servants of Hari) **mat-sevanam vinā** (without service to Me, that is, giving up worship of Me) **dīyamānam** (offered) **sālokya** (living with Me in the same world) **sārṣṭi** (equal majesty) **sāmīpya** (dwelling nearby) **sārūpya** (the same form) **ekatvam uta** (and even *sāyujya*) **na gṛhṇanti** (do not accept, do not welcome).

Not to speak of perishable enjoyments — a devotee does not desire even liberation and the like —

208 "Fulfilled by serving Me, My devotees do not desire even the four kinds of liberation — *sālokya*, *sārūpya*, *sāmīpya* and *sārṣṭi* — that such service brings them of itself. How then would they seek worldly pleasures, or merging in Brahman? For all that is swept away by time." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 9.4.67)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

"By serving Me they attain the four kinds of liberation — *sālokya* and the rest — of their own accord. Yet the pure devotee, fulfilled by service to Me, does not accept even these. Why then would he desire the enjoyments of *māyā* and *sāyujya-mukti*, which time very quickly destroys?" In *sāyujya-mukti* the very existence of the *jīva* falls into the jaws of time. Therefore neither worldly enjoyment (*bhukti*) nor *sāyujya-mukti* is lasting.

Anubhāṣya.

Describing the qualities of devotees like Ambarīṣa, Śrī Bhagavān says to Durvāsā:

sevayā pūrṇāḥ te (those devotees, fulfilled by service) **mat-sevayā pratītam** (attained by service to Me) **api sālokyādi-catuṣṭayam** (even the four [kinds of liberation] — *sālokya* and the others) **na icchanti** (do not desire); **anyat** (anything else — the heavenly planets and the like) **kāla-viplutam** (which in time is doomed to perish) — **kutaḥ** (what to speak of).

*A description of the *gopīs'* love —*

209 The natural love of the gopīs is free of any trace of lust; it is spotless, radiant and pure, like molten gold.

*The relationship of the *gopīs* with Kṛṣṇa*

210 The gopīs are Kṛṣṇa's helpers, teachers, friends and beloveds; they are His dear disciples, companions and servants.

*Kṛṣṇa Himself describes His bond with the *gopīs* —*

211 "Helpers, teachers, disciples, servants, friends and beloveds — truly I tell you, Pārtha, what are the gopīs not to Me?" (Ādi Purāṇa)[19]

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
"The *gopīs* are everything to Me. They are My helpers, that is, My beloveds; they love Me as a guru does; they serve Me as disciples; they are fit for My enjoyment; they love Me as friends, and they behave toward Me as wives."

Anubhāṣya.
he pārtha (O Pārtha), **te** (to you) **aham satyam** (the truth, on oath) **vadāmi** (I speak): **me** (My) **sahāyāḥ** (helpers in the *rāsa* dance and other pastimes) **guravaḥ** (teachers in the science of love and so on) **śiṣyāḥ** (disciples, always intent on carrying out My orders) **bhujiṣyāḥ** (serving Me like maidservants) **bāndhavāḥ** (loving Me like friends) **striyaḥ** (desired by Me as one's own wives) — ([therefore]) **gopyaḥ me kiṁ na bhavanti** (what are the *gopīs* not to Me)? (That is, they are My all in all.)

212 The gopīs know the desires of Kṛṣṇa's heart, the art of loving service, and all that their Beloved longs for.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
Iṣṭa-samīhita: desired actions.

*(*Laghu-bhāgavatāmṛta*, *Uttara-khaṇḍa* 39; words of the *Ādi Purāṇa*)*

213 "O Pārtha, My greatness, My worship, what I long for and what My mind intends — these the gopīs know in truth; others do not." (Ādi Purāṇa; Laghu-bhāgavatāmṛta, Uttara-khaṇḍa, 39)[20]

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

“My greatness, service to Me, reverence for Me and the feelings of My mind are known only to the *gopīs*. O Pārtha, no one else truly knows all this.”

Anubhāṣya.

he pārtha (O Pārtha), **gopikāḥ** (the *gopīs*) **man-māhātmyam** (My greatness) **mat-saparyām** (service to Me) **mac-chraddhām** (what I desire) **man-mano-gatam** (the intentions of My mind) **tattvataḥ** (in truth, as they are) **jānanti** (know) (, but other devotees do not know).

*Śrī Rādhikā is the best of all the *gopīs* —*

214 Among those gopīs the best is Rādhikā; in beauty, virtues, good fortune and love She surpasses all.

*(*Laghu-bhāgavatāmṛta*, *Uttara-khaṇḍa* 45; words of the *Padma Purāṇa*)*

215 “As Rādhā is dear to Viṣṇu, so is Her pond dear to Him; among all the gopīs She alone is His most beloved.” (Padma Purāṇa; Laghu-bhāgavatāmṛta, Uttara-khaṇḍa, 45)[21]

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

As Rādhā is dear to Śrī Kṛṣṇa, so is Rādhā-kuṇḍa dear to Him. Of all the *gopīs*, Kṛṣṇa loves Rādhā most.

Anubhāṣya.

viṣṇoḥ (to Kṛṣṇa) **rādhā yathā priyā** (as Rādhā is dear), **tasyāḥ** (Rādhā's) **kuṇḍam tathā priyam** (so dear is Her *kuṇḍa*). **sarva-gopīṣu sā** (among all the *gopīs* She, Śrī Rādhikā,) **ekā eva** (alone) **viṣṇoḥ atyanta-vallabhā** (is most beloved of Viṣṇu — the dearest of all).

The best of places is Vṛndāvana, the best of devotees is Śrī Rādhā —

216 “O Pārtha, in the three worlds the earth is blessed, for there is the town of Vṛndāvana; and there the gopīs are blessed, for among them is she who is called Rādhā — My beloved.” (Ādi Purāṇa; Laghu-bhāgavatāmṛta, Uttara-khaṇḍa, 46)

Anubhāṣya.

he pārtha (O Pārtha), **trailokye** (in the three worlds — Bhūr, Bhuvar and Svar) **pṛthivī dhanyā** (blessed is the earth), **yatra** (where, on earth,) **vṛndāvanam purī** (there is the abode called Vṛndāvana). **tatra api** (there, in Vṛndāvana,) **gopikāḥ** ([blessed are] the *gopīs*), **yatra mama rādhābhidhā** (among whom is My [*gopī*] named Rādhā).

*In *madhura-rasa* the principal pastimes are with Śrī Rādhā; everything else only serves them —*

217 It is play with Rādhā that makes rasa grow; all the other gopīs only serve that rasa.

Anubhāṣya.

Śrī Rādhikā is Śrī Kṛṣṇa's all in all. The other *gopīs* are only what serves the *rasa*: they increase the relish of Śrī Kṛṣṇa's pastimes with Rādhā.

"The lovely-browed girls whose playful movements attract Mādhava from every side are the friends of the queen of Vṛndāvana; they are held to be of five kinds: *sakhīs*, *nitya-sakhīs*, *prāṇa-sakhīs*, *priya-sakhīs* and the celebrated *parama-preṣṭha-sakhīs*… Though their love for the Two reaches the highest limit, sometimes it seems greater for the One, sometimes for the Other… A *sakhī* fully unfolds the loving pastimes [of the Divine Couple]."

The lovely *gopīs*, able to attract Śrī Kṛṣṇa completely by actions born of eager loving desire, are the friends of Śrī Rādhikā, the queen of Vṛndāvana, and are of five kinds: *sakhī*, *nitya-sakhī*, *prāṇa-sakhī*, *priya-sakhī* and *parama-preṣṭha-sakhī*. Out of supreme love the eight *parama-preṣṭha-sakhīs* sometimes take Śrī Kṛṣṇa's side during a lovers' quarrel (*māna*), and sometimes, when Rādhā is *khaṇḍitā* (offended), they take Śrī Rādhā's side. Showing affection to one and opposition to the other, they increase the *rasa*.

Rādhā is the dearest to Kṛṣṇa —

218 Rādhā is Kṛṣṇa's beloved, the treasure of His life; without Her the gopīs cannot be the cause of His happiness.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Because Vṛndāvana-dhāma descended to the earth, the three worlds are blessed. Among them the *gopīs* are blessed, for among them is the *gopī* named Rādhā,

who is very dear to Me.[32]

Without Rādhikā the other *gopīs* cannot be the cause of Kṛṣṇa's happiness.

*(*Gīta-govinda* 3.1)*

219 "Placing Rādhā in His heart — the chain that bound His desire for the very essence of the *rāsa* — Kṛṣṇa, the enemy of Kaṁsa, left the other beauties of Vraja." (Gīta-govinda, 3.1)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
Kṛṣṇa, the enemy of Kaṁsa, took into His heart Rādhā, who was bound by the desire for the *rāsa-līlā*, the perfect essence of all, and went away, leaving the other beauties of Vraja.

Anubhāṣya.
Śrī Kṛṣṇa left the place of the *rāsa* and went in search of Rādhā, the chief shelter of the *rāsa*. On this occasion Śrī Jayadeva says:

kaṁsāriḥ (Śrī Kṛṣṇa) **api saṁsāra-vāsanā-baddha-śṛṅkhalām** (Her who, bound by the desire for the *rāsa-līlā* — *saṁ-sāra*, the perfect essence [of all] — became a chain and fetter to bind [Him] more firmly; Rādhā, the supreme shelter of the *rāsa* pastimes) **rādhām** (Rādhā) **hṛdaye ādhāya** (placing in His heart — *ā* means "fully") **vraja-sundarīḥ** (the beauties of Vraja — all the cowherd women) **tatyāja** (left).

*The principal aim — fulfilling the three desires in Rādhā's emotion; the secondary — preaching the holy name and *prema* —*

220 Taking that mood of Rādhā, Caitanya descended and preached the religion of the age — the holy name and divine love.

Anubhāṣya.
"That emotion of Rādhā." Rādhā is Śrīmatī Gāndharvikā, the highest of all, Kṛṣṇa's all in all, the *āśraya* of love. Her *bhāva* is the disposition of the heart given wholly and exclusively to the service of Kṛṣṇa alone.

221 In that mood He fulfilled His own desires; this desire was the root cause of His descent.

*The son of Nanda, the embodiment of the *rasa* of union, is Gaura, the embodiment of the *rasa* of separation —*

222 Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya Gosāñi is the son of the king of Vraja — Kṛṣṇa, a form full of rasa, *śṛṅgāra* in person.

The Relisher descends, taking the emotion and luster of Her whom He relished —

223 He descended to taste that rasa, and along the way He spread all the rasas.

Kṛṣṇa's eternal pastimes with the girls of Vraja —

224 "O friend, see how Hari sports in spring! Delighting all and giving them bliss, with limbs dark and tender as a row of blue lotuses He brings a festival to the god of love; freely embraced on every side by the beauties of Vraja, He is, as it were, *śṛṅgāra* embodied, enchanted Himself." (Gīta-govinda, 1.11)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

O friend, Śrī Kṛṣṇa is *śṛṅgāra* personified. He delights the world with the beauty of His body, and with His hands, feet and other limbs, lovely and tender as blue lotuses, He awakens in the hearts of the girls of Vraja the festival of Kandarpa. In spring He plays freely with the beauties of Vraja, and they embrace Him.

Anubhāṣya.

he sakhi (O friend), **anurañjanena** (by delighting) **viśveṣām** (of all the cowherd women) **ānandam janayan** (producing bliss), **indīvara-śreṇī-śyāmala-komalaiḥ** (dark and tender, like many blue lotuses) **aṅgaiḥ** (with His limbs) **anaṅgotsavam upanayan** (bringing the festival of Anaṅga, the god of love), **svacchandam** (freely, without restraint) **vraja-sundarībhiḥ abhitaḥ pratyaṅgam āliṅgitaḥ** (embraced by the beauties of Vraja on every side, limb by limb) **mugdhaḥ hariḥ** (enchanted Hari) **madhau** (in spring) **mūrtimān śṛṅgāraḥ iva** (like *śṛṅgāra* personified) **krīḍati** (plays).

*In the avatāra of Gaura, Kṛṣṇa, the treasury of *rasa*, relishes in every way*

*the *rasa* of the *gopīs'* love —*

225 Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya Gosāñi is the abode of rasa, and He tasted rasa in countless special ways.

*Only a servant of Caitanya, sheltered by the *cit-śakti*, knows the secret of Gaura's avatāra —*

226 By this means He inaugurated the religion of the age of Kali. Caitanya's servants know the heart of all this.

Obeisance to the devotees of Gaura —

227–228 With devotion I hold on my head the feet of Advaita Ācārya, Nityānanda, Śrīnivāsa, Gadādhara, Dāmodara, Murāri, Haridāsa and all the other devotees of Caitanya-Kṛṣṇa.

So far, a general description of the sixth verse; now, a detailed explanation

229 So I have given an outline of the sixth verse. Now hear the meaning of the root verse; I shall reveal it.

(A verse from the diary of Śrī Svarūpa Gosvāmī)

230 " 'What is the greatness of Śrī Rādhā's love? What is My own wondrous sweetness, which She alone tastes through that love? And what is the happiness She feels in experiencing Me?' Longing to know this, the moon Hari, rich with Her sentiment, was born from the ocean of Śacī's womb." (diary of Svarūpa Dāmodara)[22]

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

"What is the glory of Śrī Rādhā's love? What is My wondrous sweetness that Śrī Rādhā relishes? And what happiness does Śrī Rādhā feel in experiencing My sweetness?" When Śrī Kṛṣṇa was seized by the longing to know these three things, He, like the moon, took birth from the ocean of Śacī's womb.

Anubhāṣya.

śrī-rādhāyāḥ (of Śrī Rādhā, the daughter of Vṛṣabhānu) **praṇaya-mahimā** (the greatness of love) **vā kīdṛśaḥ** (what is it like), **anayā** (by Rādhā) **madīyaḥ adbhuta-madhurimā** (My wondrous sweetness — an unprecedented fullness of sweetness) **yena** (by that love) **kīdṛśaḥ vā āsvādyaḥ** (how is it relished), **mad-anubhavataḥ** (from experiencing Me) **asyāḥ** (Śrī Rādhā's) **saukhyam kīdṛśam vā** (what is the happiness) — **iti lobhāt** (out of longing [to know] this) **tad-bhāvāḍhyaḥ** (rich with Her emotion) **śacī-garbha-sindhau** (in the ocean of mother Śacī's womb) **harīnduḥ** (Kṛṣṇacandra, the moon Hari) **samajani** (appeared).

*Though it is hidden, it is described for the sake of devotees who know the taste of *rasa* —*

231 All these conclusions are hidden, and it is not fitting to speak them; yet if I do not speak, no one will find their end.

Anubhāṣya.

The hidden conclusions about the avatāra of Śrī Gaura are the cherished desire of Śrī Kṛṣṇa's heart. It is not fitting to reveal them to the world, and listeners in this world are not qualified for them. Yet if this is not told, the *jīva* will never grasp their limit by his own efforts.

232 So I shall speak a little, keeping the secret veiled: devotees who relish rasa will understand, and fools will not.

*Only a servant of Śrī Guru and Gaurāṅga is qualified for the conclusions about *rasa**

233 Whoever holds Caitanya and Nityānanda in his heart will find bliss in these conclusions.

234 All these conclusions are like the young shoots of the mango tree, ever dear to the cuckoos — the devotees.

235 The non-devotee camels cannot enter here, and so my heart feels a special joy.

Anubhāṣya.

These words delight only the devotees of Gaura and Nityānanda. The devotees of Gaura are like cuckoos, and the *siddhānta* is like young mango shoots. As the cuckoo prizes mango shoots, so the devotees find the highest joy in these conclusions. The camel, however, does not want mango shoots and the like — it wants thorns that tear its tongue. So too the nonbelieving camels — *jñānīs*, *karmīs* and false devotees with other desires (*anyābhilāṣīs*) — build specious arguments (*kutarka*) against these conclusions.

The ill will of nonbelievers is to be feared, but their ignorance is a joy —

236 If those for whom I fear to speak do not understand — what happiness in the three worlds is greater than this?

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Still, there is joy in my heart: the nonbelievers who are to be feared cannot enter this book. So they will not read it — will not understand it. What happiness could be greater?

237 Therefore, bowing to the devotees, I speak without fear; may they be filled with wonder.

*Before the sweetness of *hlādinī*, Kṛṣṇa's sweetness yields and is defeated —*

238 Once Kṛṣṇa reflected within Himself: “All call Me the embodiment of complete bliss and rasa.[23]

239 The three worlds are gladdened by Me — but who is there to give joy to Me?

240 Only one whose virtues are hundreds upon hundreds of times greater than Mine could gladden My heart.

241 One greater than Me in virtues is impossible in the world — yet in Rādhā alone I find it.

242–243 Though My beauty surpasses ten million Cupids, though My sweetness is unequalled and unsurpassed, and though My form satisfies the three worlds — My eyes find their refreshment in seeing Rādhā.

Anubhāṣya.

Kṛṣṇa is Madana-mohana: Kṛṣṇa's sweetness can eclipse the matchless beauty of millions of Kāmadevas. Nothing has sweetness equal to Kṛṣṇa's form or greater than it. No one of beauty can compare with Kṛṣṇa.

244 The song of My flute attracts the three worlds, but My ears are captured by Rādhā’s words.[24]

245 Though My fragrance perfumes the whole world, the scent of Rādhā’s body steals My heart and My life.[25]

246 Though the world is made sweet by My rasa, the nectar of Rādhā’s lips holds Me in its power.

247 Though My touch is cooler than ten million moons, Rādhikā’s touch cools Me.

Rādhikā's beauty and qualities are Kṛṣṇa's life and all His wealth —

248 So I am the cause of the world’s happiness, but Rādhikā’s beauty and virtues are My very life.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Jīvātu: life.

An inquiry showing that Rādhikā's love for Kṛṣṇa exceeds Kṛṣṇa's love for Rādhā —

249 This is what I feel — but if I consider it, everything is the other way round.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

“I think My love for Rādhikā is exceedingly strong. But on reflection the opposite appears: Rādhikā's love for Me seems greater than Mine.”

250 My eyes are refreshed by the sight of Rādhā, but at the sight of Me Rādhā swoons with happiness.

251 The flute-like sound of bamboos rubbing together steals Her senses, and, mistaking the *tamāla* tree for Me, She embraces it.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
“The sound of My flute steals Rādhikā's consciousness, and Rādhikā's tender song steals Mine. When Rādhikā loses consciousness, She takes a *tamāla* tree for Kṛṣṇa, embraces it and attains great happiness.” There is another explanation too: bamboo stalks rub against one another and give out a sound like the song of the flute. Hearing it, Rādhikā loses consciousness, takes the *tamāla* for Me and embraces it.

Rādhikā is wholly absorbed in Kṛṣṇa: seeing Him everywhere, She is overwhelmed with bliss —

252 “I have found Kṛṣṇa’s embrace — my life is fulfilled!” Immersed in this happiness, She remains holding the tree in Her arms.

253 If a favourable breeze brings Her My fragrance, She longs to fly to Me, blind with love.

Rādhā's happiness in serving Kṛṣṇa is beyond the knowledge even of Kṛṣṇa —

254 When She tastes betel that I have chewed, She drowns in an ocean of bliss and knows nothing else.

255 The bliss Rādhā finds in My company — even speaking with a hundred mouths I could not reach its end.

256 When Our pastimes end, Her body glows with the sweetness of happiness, and seeing it I forget Myself in joy.

*In the material world the *rasa* of lover and beloved are equal, but in the spiritual realm the *rasa* of the beloved is greater*

257 Bharata Muni holds that the rasa of the two lovers is equal, but he does not know the rasa of My Vraja.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
According to Bharata Muni, the *rasa* of the man and the *rasa* of the woman are equal. But though he is a sage, he does not know the truth of the *rasa* of My Vraja: for Rādhikā's *rasa* is by its very nature greater.

With Rādhā Kṛṣṇa is happiest of all —

258 Whatever happiness I find in the company of others, in Rādhā's company it is a hundred times greater.

*(*Lalita-mādhava* 9.9)*

259 "O lovely one, Your bimba-red lips have a fragrance that surpasses the sweetness of nectar; Your face has the fragrance of the lotus; Your words put the cuckoo's song to shame; Your limbs are cool as sandal, and this body of Yours holds all the wealth of beauty. Having found You, O Rādhā, all My senses rejoice again and again." (Lalita-mādhava, 9.9)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
"O auspicious one, Your lips, like the *bimba* fruit, have surpassed the sweetness and fragrance of nectar; Your face is fragrant as a lotus; Your words put to shame the song of the cuckoo; Your limbs are cool as sandal, and Your body is the abode of all beauty. Attaining You, so full of beauty, qualities and pastimes, My senses come to great delight again and again."

Anubhāṣya.
he kalyāṇi (O auspicious one, embodiment of bliss), **te** (Your) **bimbādharaḥ** (red lips) **nirdhūtāmṛta-mādhurī-parimalaḥ** (which have put to shame the sweetness and fragrance of nectar), **vaktram** (face) **paṅkaja-saurabham** (fragrant like a lotus), **giraḥ** (words) **kuharita-ślāghā-bhidaḥ** (which shame the praise given to *kuharita*, the cuckoo's song), **aṅgam** (limbs) **candana-śītalam** (cool as sandal), **iyam tanuḥ** (this body) **saundarya-sarvasva-bhāk** (possessing all the wealth of

beauty). **he rādhe** (O Rādhā), **tvām āsvādya** (relishing You) **mama idam indriya-kulam** (all My senses) **muhuḥ** (again and again) **modate** (are filled with joy).

(Words of Śrī Rūpa Gosvāmī)

260 "Her eyes are greedy for the beauty of Kṛṣṇa, the slayer of Kaṁsa; Her skin thrills at His touch; Her ears are eager for His words, and Her nostrils delight in His fragrance; Her tongue longs for the nectar of His lips. She bows Her lotus face and pretends to great composure, yet even outwardly She is shaken by the surging transformations of love." (Rūpa Gosvāmī)[26]

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

This is what is seen in Śrī Rādhā. Her eyes long for the form of Śrī Kṛṣṇa, the enemy of Kaṁsa; Her skin thrills with joy at Kṛṣṇa's touch; Her ears yearn for His words; Her nostrils open at the fragrance of Kṛṣṇa's body; Her tongue is conquered by the nectar of Kṛṣṇa's lips; Her lotus face, ever blooming, is bowed; and Her limbs are seized by intense transformations — horripilation and the rest — that shatter all composure.

Anubhāṣya.

kaṁsa-harasya (of Śrī Kṛṣṇa, the slayer of Kaṁsa) **rūpe** (on seeing the form) **lubdha-nayanām** (Her whose eyes are full of longing, drawn to Kṛṣṇa's form) **sparśe** (at the touch) **ati-hṛṣyat-tvacam** (Her whose skin thrills with delight — whose body is full of bliss at Kṛṣṇa's touch) **vāṇyām** (at His words) **utkalita-śrutim** (Her whose ears are eager — attentive to Kṛṣṇa's sounds) **parimale** (at the fragrance of His body) **saṁhṛṣṭa-nāsā-puṭām** (Her whose nostrils are thrilled — who has felt wondrous joy breathing Kṛṣṇa's fragrance) **adhara-puṭe** (on tasting the nectar of His lips) **ārajyad-rasanām** (Her whose tongue is full of love — attached to Kṛṣṇa's lips) **nyañcan-mukhāmbhoruhām** (Her whose lotus face is reverently bowed) **bahiḥ api kila dambhodgīrṇa-mahā-dhṛtim** (Her who feigns great composure — outwardly behaving contrarily) **prodyad-vikārākulām** (seized by transformations surging forth — full of inner eagerness for pastimes) **rādhām aham smarāmi** (I remember Rādhā).

Kṛṣṇa considers the power of His own sweetness —

261 From this I know that there is in Me some rasa that holds in its power Rādhā, My enchantress.

Kṛṣṇa longs to relish Rādhā's happiness

262 I am ever eager to taste the kind of happiness Rādhā finds in Me.

263 I make many efforts, but I cannot taste it; and the very scent of that sweet happiness makes the longing in My heart grow.

*The avatāra of Gaura — to relish in every way the *rasa* of Rādhā's love —*

264 To taste rasa I have descended; I shall taste the rasa of love in all its kinds.[27]

*Preaching and practicing the way of *rāga-bhajana* —*

265 And through the conduct of My pastimes I shall teach how devotees worship on the path of rāga.[28]

*Without the emotion of the *āśraya*, in the emotion of the *viṣaya*, the happiness of service cannot be relished —*

266 These three thirsts of Mine have not been quenched, for they cannot be tasted in a mood of another kind.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
Vijātīya: that is, the emotion of the *viṣaya*.

267 Without accepting Rādhikā’s mood and lustre, I can never taste these three kinds of happiness.

268 Accepting Rādhā’s mood and assuming Her colour, I shall descend to taste these three kinds of happiness.”

*When He descended as Gaura, the time of the *yuga-avatāra* and Advaita's call coincided —*

269 With all His heart Kṛṣṇa made this decision, and just then came the time for the avatāra of the age.

270 At that time Śrī Advaita was worshipping the Lord, and with His thunderous call He drew Kṛṣṇa down.[29]

First the elders descend, then Gaura, the original form —

271–272 First causing His father, mother and elders to descend, and accepting Rādhikā's mood and complexion, Kṛṣṇa appeared as the full moon in Navadvīpa, in the pure ocean of milk that was Śacī's womb.

Anubhāṣya.

Avatari: having caused to descend.

Meditating on the lotus feet of Śrī Rūpa Gosvāmī, the author cites his verse to confirm the meaning of the verses —

273 So I have explained the sixth verse, meditating on the lotus feet of Śrī Rūpa Gosāñi.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

"I shall fulfill the three desires described and by My own conduct teach the devotees devotion on the path of *rāga*." When Kṛṣṇa resolved to descend for all these reasons, the time of the *yuga-avatāra* arrived, and at that same time Śrī Advaita Ācārya was worshiping Kṛṣṇa. Therefore Kṛṣṇacandra accepted the emotion and complexion of Rādhikā and rose in Navadvīpa from Śacī's womb in the form of Gaurāṅga. The truth I have explained in the two verses of Svarūpa Gosvāmī I now confirm with a verse of Śrī Rūpa Gosvāmī.

274 For the meaning I have given of these two verses, a verse of Śrī Rūpa Gosāñi is a fitting proof.

*(*Stava-mālā*, second *Caitanyāṣṭaka* 3)*

275 “Eager for delight, the Lord stole from one among the host of His beloveds (Śrī Rādhā) Her boundless wealth of rasa, indescribably sweet, that He might relish it Himself. For this He covered His own lustre and revealed here Her radiance. May He, in the form of Caitanya, be boundlessly merciful to us!” (Stava-mālā, the second Caitanyāṣṭaka, 3)[30]

Anubhāṣya.
See Ādi 4.52.

276 Thus the six verses set forth the auspicious invocation, the characteristic marks of the truth of Kṛṣṇa Caitanya, and the purpose of His descent.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
The six verses set forth three subjects: the *maṅgalācaraṇa*, the marks of the truth of Kṛṣṇa Caitanya, and the purpose of Caitanya's avatāra.

Thus ends the fourth chapter of the “Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.”

Anubhāṣya.
kṛṣṇa-caitanya-tattva-lakṣaṇam (setting forth the truth of Gaura) **maṅgalācaraṇam** (the *maṅgalācaraṇa*), **avatāre** (concerning the avatāra of Gaura) **prayojanam ca** (and the purpose) **śloka-ṣaṭkaiḥ** (by the six verses — from *vande gurūn* to *garbha-sindhau harīnduḥ*) **nirūpitam** (are set forth).

Thus ends the fourth chapter of the “Anubhāṣya.”

277 Praying at the feet of Śrī Rūpa and Śrī Raghunātha, I, Kṛṣṇadāsa, narrate the *Caitanya-caritāmṛta*.

Notes

1. As in the Gauḍīya Maṭha edition: «এতো» (another reading: «এহো», “this too”); the sense is the same. ↩
2. As in the Gauḍīya Maṭha edition: «হেন» (“so”); another reading has «যেন» (“as”); the sense is the same. ↩

3. The same verse as Ādi 3.16 (the *Anubhāṣya* refers to it). ↩
4. Kṛṣṇa's words to the gopīs at Kurukṣetra (Samanta-pañcaka), where, at a solar eclipse, both the Yādavas from Dvārakā and Nanda Mahārāja with all Vraja had come. ↩
5. The same verse recurs as 4.275. ↩
6. The same verse as Ādi 1.5; in the edition, "a verse from the *Kaḍacā* (notes) of Śrī Svarūpa Gosvāmī"; here begins the explanation of the fifth of the fourteen opening verses. ↩
7. In the edition, "the words of Dhruva". ↩
8. The words of Śiva to Satī when she was about to go to the sacrifice of her father Dakṣa, who was hostile to Viṣṇu (*Anubhāṣya*). ↩
9. As in the Gauḍīya Maṭha edition: «প্রাভব» (another reading: «বৈভব»); so too the *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: "the Lakṣmīs are parts of Her *vaibhava-vilāsa*, and the queens are Her *prābhava-prakāśa*". ↩
10. The author explains the words of this verse in what follows: *devī* — 4.84; *kṛṣṇa-mayī* — 4.85–86; *Rādhikā* — 4.87–88; "the supreme deity" — 4.89; *sarva-lakṣmī* — 4.90–91; *sarva-kānti* — 4.92–94; "the enchantress" — 4.95. ↩
11. The source (*aṁśinī*) of all Kṛṣṇa's beloveds." ↩
12. As in the Gauḍīya Maṭha edition: «সদা» ("always"); another reading has «আর» ("and"). ↩
13. The reference follows the edition (*Bhakti-rasāmṛta-sindhu*, Dakṣiṇa-vibhāga, first *laharī*, verse 231). ↩
14. As in the Gauḍīya Maṭha edition: «প্রতিতরুলতাং»; so too the *Anubhāṣya* (another reading: «প্রতিতরুলতং»). The edition's root text here also has the misprints «নিত্যশিক্ষাং» and «ত্বং»; the *Anubhāṣya* reads «নৃত্যশিক্ষাম্» ("the learning of dance") and «তং (কৃষ্ণং)» ("Him, Kṛṣṇa"). ↩
15. As in the Gauḍīya Maṭha edition: «দুস্ত্যজ্য» (another reading: «দুস্ত্যজ»); the sense is the same. ↩
16. The same verse as 4.20 (the *Anubhāṣya* refers to it); the translation is the same. ↩
17. As in the Gauḍīya Maṭha edition: «সুখে কৃষ্ণসুখ» (another reading: «সুখ কৃষ্ণসুখে»); the sense is the same. ↩
18. As in the Gauḍīya Maṭha edition: «ততিভিরাভির» (another reading: «ততিভিরভির»). ↩
19. The source follows the edition ("the words of the *Ādi Purāṇa*"). ↩
20. The source follows the edition (*Laghu-bhāgavatāmṛta*, Uttara-khaṇḍa, 39; "the words of the *Ādi Purāṇa*"). ↩

21. The source follows the edition (*Laghu-bhāgavatāmṛta*, Uttara-khaṇḍa, 45; “the words of the *Padma Purāṇa*”). ↩
22. The same verse as Ādi 1.6; in the edition, “a verse from the *Kaḍacā* of Śrī Svarūpa Gosvāmī”. ↩
23. As in the Gauḍīya Maṭha edition: «সবে কহে» (“all call”); another reading omits «সবে». ↩
24. As in the Gauḍīya Maṭha edition: «গীত» (“the song”); another reading has «গীতে» (“by the song”); the sense is the same. ↩
25. As in the Gauḍīya Maṭha edition: «চিত্ত-প্রাণ» (“heart and life”); another reading has «চিত্ত-ঘ্রাণ» (“heart and sense of smell”). ↩
26. In the edition, “the words of Śrī Rūpa Gosvāmī”. ↩
27. As in the Gauḍīya Maṭha edition: «আস্বাদিব» (“I shall taste”); another reading has «আস্বাদিল» (“I tasted”). ↩
28. As in the Gauḍīya Maṭha edition: «শিখাইব» (“I shall teach”); another reading has «শিখাইল» (“I taught”). ↩
29. As in the Gauḍīya Maṭha edition: «করে» (another reading: «করেন»); the sense is the same. ↩
30. The same verse as 4.52 (the *Anubhāṣya* refers to it); the translation is the same. ↩
31. The verse translation reads differently: *kāma* is taken as Kāma, the god of love, not as a name of Kṛṣṇa. ↩
32. In the edition this paragraph is numbered 218; by its content it belongs to verse 216. ↩
33. *Manaḥ-śikṣā* 2. ↩
34. The edition reads “পরম প্রাকৃতশরীরম্”; by the sense (compare 34–35 on Bhagavān's human form) apparently “পরম অপ্রাকৃতশরীরম্” (“supreme transcendental body”): the printed text (with a space after “পরম”) lacks the “অ”, which probably dropped out in typesetting. ↩
35. *Nārada-pañcarātra* (*Bhakti-rasāmṛta-sindhu* 1.1.12). ↩
36. The edition reads “তাদৃশ অবতারময় বিধি” (literally “such rules full of avatāra”); possibly a misprint for “অবরতাময়” (“inferior”) — compare “অবরতা” earlier in the same section. ↩
37. *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 11.25.12. ↩
38. *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 10.27.4. ↩
39. So in the edition: the number 5 is repeated (compare the subheading to verse 90). ↩

“Śrī Caitanya-caritāmṛta”

Ādi-līlā

Chapter 5

Determining the Truth of Śrī Nityānanda

(English translation from the Bengali, following the Gauḍīya Maṭha edition and the «Anubhāṣya», 2026 — draft)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya

Summary. In the fifth chapter the glory of Śrī Nityānanda is described in five verses, as follows. Śrī Kṛṣṇa is Bhagavān Himself; His *vilāsa-mūrti*, that is, His second body, is Śrī Balarāma. Beyond *prakṛti* there is a spiritual abode called “Paravyoma,” and in its highest part lies “Kṛṣṇaloka.” In Kṛṣṇaloka are Dvārakā, Mathurā and Gokula; there abides the original *catur-vyūha*: Kṛṣṇa, Baladeva, Pradyumna (that is, Kāmadeva) and Aniruddha. The abode in Vṛndāvana within that Kṛṣṇaloka is called “Śvetadvīpa.” Below Kṛṣṇaloka is the Vaikuṇṭha called “Paravyoma,” where four-armed Nārāyaṇa, the *vilāsa-mūrti* of Kṛṣṇa, resides. He who is Baladeva in Kṛṣṇaloka is the original Saṅkarṣaṇa (*mūla-Saṅkarṣaṇa*). His *vilāsa-mūrti* in the Vaikuṇṭha of Paravyoma is Mahā-Saṅkarṣaṇa. By the *cit-śakti* of this Mahā-Saṅkarṣaṇa everything made of *śuddha-sattva* in Paravyoma is manifest, and by His *jīva-śakti* pure *jīvas* dwell there; *māyā-śakti* has no place there. In the abode of Nārāyaṇa is the second *kāya-vyūha*. Beyond Paravyoma lies “Brahmaloka,” the abode of effulgence. Beyond it is the Causal Ocean (*Kāraṇa-samudra*), filled with spiritual water. On the far shore of the Causal Ocean lies *māyā*, untouched by it. In the Causal Ocean is Mahā-Viṣṇu, the original *puruṣa-avatāra*, a part of *mūla-Saṅkarṣaṇa*. From afar He casts His glance (*īkṣaṇa*) upon *māyā*. And by a semblance of His body (*aṅgābhāsa*) — something that appears to be His body but is not — He unites with *māyā* as the material cause. *Māyā* herself, as the material cause (*upādāna-kāraṇa*), is called “*pradhāna*,” and as the efficient cause (*nimitta-kāraṇa*), “*prakṛti*.” The original efficient cause of material *prakṛti* is the

glance of Mahā-Viṣṇu; *prakṛti* is therefore only a secondary efficient cause. This same Mahā-Viṣṇu, lying in the Causal Ocean, enters the aggregate universe as Garbhodaśāyī, and enters each universe and each *jīva* as Kṣīrodaśāyī. The Kṣīrodaśāyī Puruṣa manifests a Vaikuṇṭha in each universe and resides there as Viṣṇu, the Paramātmā, the Īśvara and so on; in the waters of the universe He lies on the bed of Śeṣa. He is the father of Brahmā, and one part of Him is conceived of as the Virāṭ. In each universe a "Śvetadvīpa" is manifest in the Ocean of Milk, and Viṣṇu resides there. Thus two Śvetadvīpas are manifest: one in Kṛṣṇaloka, and the other in the Ocean of Milk of every universe. The "Śvetadvīpa" of Kṛṣṇaloka is nondifferent from the Vṛndāvana there; it is the land of certain supplementary pastimes of Kṛṣṇa. Śeṣa within the universe serves Viṣṇu by becoming His umbrella, sandals, bed, pillow, garments, dwelling, sacred thread, throne and so on. The Baladeva of Kṛṣṇaloka is Prabhu Nityānanda Himself; He is therefore *mūla-Saṅkarṣaṇa*. Hence Mahā-Saṅkarṣaṇa of Paravyoma and His *puruṣa-avatāras* are the parts and portions (*aṁśas* and *kalās*) of Nityānanda Prabhu.

In this chapter the author has included an account of his journey to Vṛndāvana and of how he attained complete perfection there. From it we learn that he formerly lived in the village of Jhāmaṭapura near Naihāṭī, in the region of Kāṭoyā. There were two brothers. Śrī Mīnaketana Rāmadāsa, an associate of Śrī Nityānanda Prabhu, came to his house at his invitation and was displeased with the priest, Guṇārṇava Miśra. The brother of Kavirāja Gosvāmī took the priest's side and did not acknowledge the glory of Śrī Nityānanda. For this Śrīla Kavirāja Gosvāmī rebuked his brother. Rāmadāsa broke his flute and left, and Kavirāja Gosvāmī's brother was at once utterly ruined. That same night, in a dream, Kavirāja Gosvāmī received the grace and the command of Śrī Nityānanda Prabhu, and on the very next day he set out for Vṛndāvana.

By the mercy of Nityānanda one comes to know the true nature of Nityānanda

—

1 I bow to the Lord Śrī Nityānanda, whose divine opulence is endless and wondrous. By His will even a fool can come to know and describe His true nature.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

I bow to the Lord (*Īśvara*) Nityānanda, whose majesty is endless and wondrous. By His will even a fool is able to describe His true nature.

Anubhāṣya.
yasya (Nityānanda's) **icchayā** (by the mercy) **ajñena** (by one unversed in the scriptures) **api** (even [by me]) **tat-svarūpam** (the truth of Nityānanda) **nirūpyate** (is described), **tam anantādbhutaiśvaryam** (Him whose majesty is endless and wondrous, that is, who possesses a majesty beyond place, time and circumstance) **īśvaram** (the God of gods) **śrī-nityānandam ahaṁ vande**.

2 Glory, glory to Śrī Caitanya! Glory to Nityānanda! Glory to Advaitacandra! Glory to all the devotees of Gaura!

In six verses the truth of Gaura, in five verses the truth of Nityānanda —

3 In these six verses I have told of the glory of Kṛṣṇa Caitanya; in five verses I now tell the whole truth of Nityānanda.

The truth of Baladeva —

4 Kṛṣṇa, the source of all avatāras, is Bhagavān Himself, and Śrī Balarāma is His second body.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
His second body: the *vilāsa* body of Śrī Kṛṣṇa.

5 The two are one in nature; only Their bodies differ. Balarāma is the first expansion of Kṛṣṇa's body and His helper in His pastimes.

Kṛṣṇa is Gaura; Balarāma is Nitāi —

6 That Kṛṣṇa is Śrī Caitanyacandra in Navadvīpa, and that Balarāma is Śrī Nityānanda, who is with Him.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
Śrī Baladeva is the first *kāya-vyūha* of Kṛṣṇa, that is, an expansion of His body; He assists Kṛṣṇa in His pastimes. That same Kṛṣṇa descended in Navadvīpa as Śrī

Caitanyacandra, and Śrī Balarāma, the first *kāya-vyūha*, came with Him as Śrī Nityānanda.

Explanation of the seventh of the fourteen opening verses: Nityānanda, or Baladeva, is the whole whose parts are Saṅkarṣaṇa, the Lords who lie in the waters of the Causal, Garbha and Milk Oceans, and Śeṣa — (a verse from the diary of Śrī Svarūpa Gosvāmī)

7 "Saṅkarṣaṇa, the Lord who lies in the Causal Ocean, the Lord who lies in the Garbha Ocean, the Lord who lies in the Ocean of Milk, and Śeṣa are His portions and the parts of His portions: may that Rāma who is called Nityānanda be my refuge." (diary of Svarūpa Dāmodara)[1]

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
May Nityānanda-Rāma be my shelter — He whose parts and portions are Saṅkarṣaṇa, Kāraṇābdhiśāyī, Garbhodaśāyī, Payobdhiśāyī and Śeṣa.

Anubhāṣya.
saṅkarṣaṇaḥ (Mahā-Saṅkarṣaṇa in Paravyoma), **kāraṇa-toya-śāyī** (the original *puruṣa-avatāra*), **garbhoda-śāyī** (the second *puruṣa-avatāra*, Hiraṇyagarbha, the aggregate Viṣṇu), **payo 'bdhi-śāyī** (the third *puruṣa-avatāra*, who lies in the Ocean of Milk, the individual Viṣṇu), **śeṣaḥ** (Anantadeva) — **yasya aṁśa-kalāḥ**, **saḥ nityānandākhya-rāmaḥ** (Baladeva) **mama śaraṇam astu**.

*The *mūla-Saṅkarṣaṇa* Baladeva serves Kṛṣṇa in five forms —*

8 Śrī Balarāma Gosāñi is the original Saṅkarṣaṇa. Assuming five forms, He serves Kṛṣṇa.

9 He Himself assists Kṛṣṇa in His pastimes, and in four other bodies He carries out the work of creation.

In four forms — for creating the spiritual and the material, for maintenance, for entering into creation and so on — and as Śeṣa, in ten bodies, He serves —

10 His work of creation and the rest is service done at Kṛṣṇa's command; and as Śeṣa He serves Kṛṣṇa in many ways.

Anubhāṣya.
The five forms of Śrī Balarāma: 1) Mahā-Saṅkarṣaṇa, 2) Kāraṇodaśāyī, 3) Garbhodaśāyī, 4) Kṣīrodaśāyī and 5) Śeṣa.

11 In all these forms He tastes the bliss of serving Kṛṣṇa. And that same Balarāma is Nityānanda, the companion of Gaura.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
Śrī Balarāma, the first *kāya-vyūha*, may be called the original Saṅkarṣaṇa (*mūla-Saṅkarṣaṇa*). For He assumes five forms and serves Kṛṣṇa in them: as a part (*aṁśa*) belonging to His second form He is "Mahā-Saṅkarṣaṇa," and as portions (*kalās*) He is "Kāraṇābdhiśāyī," "Garbhodaśāyī," "Payobdhiśāyī" and "Śeṣa." He Himself remains Kṛṣṇa's assistant in His pastimes, and in four forms — Mahā-Saṅkarṣaṇa, Kāraṇābdhiśāyī, Garbhodaśāyī and Payobdhiśāyī — He carries out creation and other works. As Ananta, who is called Śeṣa, He serves Kṛṣṇa in many ways. In all these forms Balarāma relishes the bliss of serving Kṛṣṇa.

Describing the truth of Nityānanda, the author explains the seventh verse in four verses —

12 I shall explain the meaning of the seventh verse in four verses, so that all may know the truth of Nityānanda.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
The meaning of the seventh verse: what is said in the seventh verse I explain in verses 8, 9, 10 and 11.

(a verse from the diary of Śrī Svarūpa Gosvāmī)

13 "I take refuge in Śrī Nityānanda Rāma, whose form called Saṅkarṣaṇa shines amid the fourfold expansion (catur-vyūha) in the all-pervading world of Vaikuṇṭha, full of every opulence and beyond māyā." (diary of Svarūpa Dāmodara)[2]

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
I take shelter of Rāma, who is Nityānanda. In Vaikuṇṭha, which lies beyond *māyā* and pervades all, abides the *catur-vyūha* full of complete majesty —

Vāsudeva, Saṅkarṣaṇa, Pradyumna and Aniruddha; among them shines His form named Saṅkarṣaṇa.

Anubhāṣya.

māyātīte (beyond the region made of the *guṇas*) **vyāpi-vaikuṇṭha-loke** (in Vaikuṇṭha, the undivided support, free from *māyā* and unlimited), **pūrṇaiśvarye** (full of the complete range of potencies), **śrī-catur-vyūha-madhye** (among the four Viṣṇus — Vāsudeva, Saṅkarṣaṇa, Pradyumna and Aniruddha) **yasya** (Nityānanda-Rāma's) **saṅkarṣaṇākhyaṁ rūpam udbhāti** (shines), **tam nityānanda-rāmam ahaṁ prapadye**.

"Paravyoma," endowed with six transcendental opulences —

14 Beyond material nature lies the abode called Paravyoma. Like Kṛṣṇa's own form, it is endowed with every opulence and every divine quality.

The world of Brahman and the worlds above it, the abode of Kṛṣṇa and His avatāras —

15 There lie endless, all-pervading abodes — Brahman, Vaikuṇṭha and others — and in them Kṛṣṇa and His avatāras dwell.

Above Paravyoma, Kṛṣṇaloka in three forms —

16 In its highest region is the realm known as Kṛṣṇaloka, which abides in three divisions — Dvārakā, Mathurā and Gokula.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Above the *prakṛti* of twenty-four elements there is a spiritual abode called "Paravyoma." Like the form of Śrī Kṛṣṇa, this abode is endowed with every excellence, such as all-pervading power (*vibhūti*). Within it lie all-pervading, endless abodes — the abode of Brahman, Vaikuṇṭha and others. In all these abodes Kṛṣṇa Himself and all kinds of avatāras of Kṛṣṇa reside. Higher still, in the third part of this abode, is the supreme spiritual world, called "Kṛṣṇaloka." This Kṛṣṇaloka is varied: it exists in three forms — Dvārakā, Mathurā and Gokula.

On the very highest level, Vraja, Goloka and Śvetadvīpa —

17 Above all is Śrī Gokula, the abode of Vraja, which is also called Śrī Goloka, Śvetadvīpa and Vṛndāvana.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Highest of all in the abode of Paravyoma are Śrī Gokula, that is, the abode of Vrajaloka; Śrī Goloka, that is, the abode of Kṛṣṇa where the mood of *svakīyā* prevails; Śvetadvīpa; and Vṛndāvana.

Goloka-Vṛndāvana, an abode wholly nondifferent from Kṛṣṇa —

18 Like Kṛṣṇa's body, it is all-pervading, endless and vast; it extends above and below without any bound.[3]

Anubhāṣya.

Śrī Jīva writes in the *Śrī Kṛṣṇa-sandarbha* (section 106): "What, then, is that abode where He sports? To this it is said. The *Skanda Purāṇa* says: 'As the cities dear to Bhagavān exist on earth, so they exist in Vaikuṇṭha, honored for the sake of those pastimes.' According to these words, the places that exist in Vaikuṇṭha should be understood to be these very places. And they lie above all the Vaikuṇṭhas. * * * The *Svāyambhuva-āgama* also says that this place stands in its own right, above all: in the dialogue of Īśvara and Devī, in the section on meditation on the fourteen-syllable [mantra], in the eighty-fifth chapter (*paṭala*): 'One should remember the all-pervading Vaikuṇṭha, strewn with many wish-fulfilling creepers. Below it is *prakṛti*, the equilibrium of the *guṇas*, the cause of all.' * * * Therefore, by the rule 'as they exist on earth' as well, it is established that Śrī Kṛṣṇaloka, consisting of Dvārakā, Mathurā and Gokula, exists in its own right and, as the place of the pastimes of Bhagavān Himself, lies above all. Hence Vṛndāvana is that very Gokula which shines above all and is renowned as Goloka. In the *Brahma-saṁhitā*: 'The great abode called Gokula is a lotus of a thousand petals. * * * Around it is a wondrous quadrangle called Śvetadvīpa.' * * * The abode of this Śrī Kṛṣṇa, fit for living together with Nanda, Yaśodā and others, is the great inner palace; of its nature it is said that its origin, that is, its eternal manifestation, is from a part of Ananta, Śrī Baladeva. Read in a double sense,[17] the words also convey this: there is the origin, that is, the dwelling, of Śrī Baladeva Himself, whose part is Ananta. * * * Next the coverings of Gokula are described, beginning 'Outside it is a quadrangle.' Outside that Gokula, on every side, a quadrangular, that is, four-

cornered, place is called Śvetadvīpa, since that part has no particular name ‘Gokula.’ But the inner circle of the quadrangle should be known as Vṛndāvana, and the outer circle only as Śvetadvīpa; its other name is ‘Goloka.’ * * * Vaikuṇṭha is called Brahmaloka. * * * In the *Nārada-pañcarātra*, in the *Vijaya-ākhyāna*: ‘There, above all, in Goloka, Śrī Govinda Himself always sports, full of supreme bliss, the Lord of the gopīs and of Gokula.’ Thus it is established that Śrī Kṛṣṇaloka lies above all. It is also determined that this world, divided into parts according to the differences of those pastimes and associates, consists of three places — Dvārakā, Mathurā and Gokula. Elsewhere [in scripture], however, the places of the same names renowned on earth are spoken of as these very places: for of them, as of the other Vaikuṇṭhas, it is said that they lie beyond the material world, are eternal, have an unearthly form and are the eternal abode of Bhagavān.”

In what kind of abode does this Bhagavān move about? On this it is said: “As cities dear to Bhagavān exist in this material world, so three cities abide in Vaikuṇṭha for the sake of His pastimes.” According to these words of the *Skanda Purāṇa*, it should be known that the places existing in Vaikuṇṭha are the very same places that are in the material world. Above the material creation lie all the Vaikuṇṭhas. The *Svāyambhuva-tantra*, too, says that the place of Vaikuṇṭha stands in its own right, above all. In that book, in the section on meditation on the fourteen-syllable [mantra], in the 85th *paṭala*, in the dialogue of Devī and Maheśvara, it is said: “One should remember the all-pervading, undivided Vaikuṇṭha, strewn with many wish-fulfilling creepers. Below it lies *prakṛti* — the equilibrium of the *guṇas*, the cause of all material causes.” Therefore from the rule “as the abodes of Hari exist on earth, so also there” we understand that Kṛṣṇaloka, consisting of Dvārakā, Mathurā and Gokula, exists in its own right. It is the field of the pastimes of Bhagavān Himself, and so it is established that these abodes lie above all. Hence Vṛndāvana-Gokula is renowned as “Goloka,” shining above all. In the *Brahma-saṁhitā*: “The great abode shaped like a lotus of a thousand petals is known as ‘Gokula.’ The wondrous place around it, a quadrangle — that is, bounded by four straight lines — is called ‘Śvetadvīpa.’” In that abode of Kṛṣṇa is His great inner palace, fit for living with Nanda, Yaśodā and others. Its nature is described thus: that abode eternally arises from Ananta, the part of Baladeva Prabhu. The *tantra* scriptures convey the same: the abode of Bhagavān is where Anantadeva, the part of Baladeva, appears and dwells. The coverings of Gokula are described thus. Outside Gokula, on every side, lies a quadrangular place (a four-cornered field) known as “Śvetadvīpa.” The part that is Śvetadvīpa does not bear the name

“Gokula”; but the inner circle of the quadrangle is known by the name “Vṛndāvana,” and only the outer circle should be known as “Śvetadvīpa”; its other name is “Goloka.” The word “Brahmaloka” means “Vaikuṇṭha.” In the *Nārada-pañcarātra*, in the account of the *Vijaya-ākhyāna*, it is said that in that abode, above all, in Goloka, Govindadeva Himself — Gopīnātha, the Lord of Gokula — always sports in supreme bliss. From this it is established that Kṛṣṇaloka lies above all worlds. It is also determined that this very Kṛṣṇaloka, by the differences of pastimes and associates and by the differences of parts, is the three places with many chambers, named “Dvārakā,” “Mathurā” and “Gokula.” Elsewhere [in scripture] we hear that the places of the same names on earth, in the material world, are of the same nature: for of them, as of the other Vaikuṇṭhas, it is said that they lie beyond the material world, are eternal, have an unearthly form and are the eternal abode of Bhagavān. Therefore they too should be known as nondifferent [from the abodes of Kṛṣṇaloka].

It is self-manifest — by Kṛṣṇa's will it descends into the material world —

19 By Kṛṣṇa’s will it is manifest within the universe, yet it remains one and the same: it does not have two bodies.

*To eyes that seek enjoyment it looks like the material world, but to the eyes of devotion it is the field of Kṛṣṇa's pastimes, a spiritual land of *cintāmaṇi* —*

20 Its land is cintāmaṇi, its forests are full of wish-fulfilling trees; yet eyes of flesh see it as no different from the material world.

21 With eyes of love one sees it as it truly is — the place where Kṛṣṇa sports with the cowherd boys and girls.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

This spiritual abode of Vraja, by Kṛṣṇa's will, is manifest within the material universe, yet even here it remains in the very same form. Some think that Goloka and the other abodes in Paravyoma are different from the abode of Vraja manifest in the material world. But that is not so: it is one and the same abode, only manifest at the same time both in Paravyoma and in the material world. Even in the Vraja manifest in the material world the ground is *cintāmaṇi* and the forests consist of

wish-fulfilling trees. The eyes of *prema* see the true form of this abode, while to material eyes it looks like the material world.

*Govinda in Goloka — (*Brahma-saṁhitā*, Chapter 5, verse 29)*

22 "I worship Govinda, the original Person, who tends the surabhi cows in abodes built of cintāmaṇi gems and surrounded by millions of wish-fulfilling trees, and who is served with reverence by hundreds of thousands of Lakṣmīs." (Brahma-saṁhitā, 5.29)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

I worship the original Puruṣa, Śrī Govindacandra. He tends the wish-fulfilling cows in places made of heaps of *cintāmaṇi*, surrounded by hundreds of thousands of wish-fulfilling trees, and hundreds of thousands of Lakṣmīs serve Him with reverence.

Anubhāṣya.

kalpa-vṛkṣa-lakṣāvṛteṣu (surrounded, that is, adorned, by hundreds of thousands — countless — wish-fulfilling trees, trees that give whatever fruit one may fittingly ask for) **cintāmaṇi-prakara-sadmasu** (in abodes, that is, palaces, built of heaps of *cintāmaṇi*, jewels able to grant desired fruits) **surabhīḥ** (the wish-fulfilling cows) **abhipālayantam** (tending in every way — as a cowherd should care for his cows), **lakṣmī-sahasra-śata-sambhrama-sevyamānam** (served with reverence by hundreds of thousands of Lakṣmīs — the beautiful cowherd girls) **tam ādi-puruṣam govindam ahaṁ bhajāmi**.

*"The original *catur-vyūha*" —*

23 In Mathurā and Dvārakā He manifests His own form and, becoming the fourfold expansion (catur-vyūha), sports in many forms.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

In the part of Kṛṣṇa's abode called Mathurā and Dvārakā, Kṛṣṇa manifests the original *catur-vyūha* — Vāsudeva, Saṅkarṣaṇa, Pradyumna and Aniruddha — and sports in various forms. The *catur-vyūha* of Dvārakā is the whole of which all other *catur-vyūhas* are parts; it is pure and spiritual.

*The whole of all the *catur-vyūhas* —*

24 Vāsudeva, Saṅkarṣaṇa, Pradyumna and Aniruddha are the source of every catur-vyūha; They are transcendent (*turīya*) and pure.

In Gokula, Mathurā and Dvārakā — pastimes in the two-armed form —

25 In these three abodes Kṛṣṇa is wholly given to His pastimes; there He plays with His own associates without end.

Anubhāṣya.

In three worlds: in Gokula, in Mathurā and in Dvārakā.

In the Vaikuṇṭha of Paravyoma — pastimes in the form of four-armed Nārāyaṇa —

26 In the midst of Paravyoma He manifests His own form and, as Nārāyaṇa, enjoys pastimes of many kinds.

*Kṛṣṇa, the *svayaṁ-rūpa*, is two-armed; Nārāyaṇa, the manifestation of His majesty, is four-armed —*

27 Kṛṣṇa's own form has only two arms; in the form of Nārāyaṇa that same body has four.

28 He holds the conch, disc, club and lotus and is full of supreme majesty; His feet are served by His potencies Śrī, Bhū and Nīlā.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Kṛṣṇa's *svarūpa-vigraha*, His original form, is always two-armed. His *svarūpa-prakāśa* in Paravyoma is four-armed Nārāyaṇa, served by the potencies Śrī, Bhū and Nīlā. These three potencies are described in detail in the books of the Vaiṣṇavas of the Śrī-sampradāya.

Anubhāṣya.

Śrī, Bhū and Nīlā. Following a Bengali reading, some call Nīlā "Līlā-śakti." These three potencies abide in Vaikuṇṭha beside Nārāyaṇa. Once Bhūta-yogī, Sara-yogī and Bhrānta-yogī (the Āḻvārs) took shelter at night in a brāhmaṇa's house in the

village of Gehalī. Then Nārāyaṇa entered that house and revealed His form to them.

Prapannāmṛta, Chapter 77, verses 61–62: “They saw Viṣṇu, the original Bhagavān. He was mounted on Tārkṣya (Garuḍa) and looked like a cloud with lightning; He bore Lakṣmī on His chest, His eyes were like lotuses, and in two hands shone the conch and the disc. His arms reached to His knees, His body was lovely, and Bhūmi and Nīlā shone at His two sides. He wore yellow garments, His body was adorned with ornaments and anointed with sandal paste, and He had four arms.”

In the *Sītā Upaniṣad*: “Mahālakṣmī of the Lord of the gods is both different and nondifferent from Him; She consists of the conscious and the unconscious. As potency this goddess is of three kinds: *icchā-śakti* (the potency of will), *kriyā-śakti* (the potency of action) and *sākṣāt-śakti* (the direct potency). *Icchā-śakti* is of three kinds: Śrī, Bhūmi and Līlā.”

In his commentary on the *Gītā* (Chapter 4, verse 6) Śrī Madhvācārya cites scripture: “She who is the mother of the *mahat* and the rest, conceived of as Śrī, Bhū and Nīlā, and the bewildering one named Durgā — through them Viṣṇu, though unborn, by the power of His own *cit*[-potency] is renowned as if born among those whose minds are bewildered.” * * * “Mahāmāyā, Vaiṣṇavī, divided as Śrī, Bhū and Durgā, is infinitely below His potency. Yet because she has taken shelter of the Lord, even Ananta, Brahmā, Rudra and others have not a fraction of her power. Without the grace of Viṣṇu even they cannot overcome her.” (*Vyāsa-yoga*, Chapter 7, section 14.)

Madhva's commentary on the *Gītā* (Chapter 14, verse 3): “‘The great Brahman’ is *prakṛti*. She is divided as Śrī, Bhū and Durgā. Umā, Sarasvatī and others are other *jīvas*, possessing a part of her.” So too the *Kārṣāyaṇa-śruti*: “Śrī, Bhū and Durgā are the great *māyā*; she brings forth the worlds and binds the universe. Umā, Vāk and others are other *jīvas*, her parts; in all the Vedas they are sung as one with her in nature.”

Śrī Jīva Prabhu in the *Bhagavat-sandarbha* (section 80): “As the *Padma Purāṇa* says: ‘The eternal, auspicious form of the Lord abides in the supreme abode; He is eternally delighted by the sovereign Śrī and by Bhūmi and is surrounded by them.’ In the *Mahā-saṁhitā* this is distinguished by name and nature as well: ‘His threefold potency — Śrī, Bhū and Durgā — which is divided, is the *jīva-māyā* of the Great Soul. *Ātma-māyā* is His will, and *guṇa-māyā*

is material.'" (Ibid., section 22): "Śrī here is the potency that maintains the world, Bhū the potency of its creation, Durgā the potency of its dissolution. His potency that has become distinct in these forms and is directed toward the *jīvas* is called *jīva-māyā*. In the *Padma Purāṇa*, in the dialogue of Śrī Kṛṣṇa and Satyabhāmā, after the words 'I Myself, dividing threefold, abide through the three kinds of *guṇas*,' it is said: 'Then all the gods, hearing this and urged by those words, full of devotion, bowed down to Gaurī, Lakṣmī and Dharā.'"

*Though Kṛṣṇa is absorbed in pastime alone, He is full of causeless mercy toward the *jīvas* —*

29 Though His nature is simply to play, out of mercy to the jīvas He does one work:

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
Though His nature is pastime alone, out of mercy for the *jīvas* He also performs this pastime: He delivers the *jīvas*.

*By four kinds of liberation He delivers the *jīvas*, that is, brings them to Vaikuṇṭha —*

30 Granting the four kinds of liberation — sālokya, sāmīpya, sārṣṭi and sārūpya — He delivers the jīvas.

Those who know the featureless Brahman remain outside Vaikuṇṭha —

31 Those liberated by merging into Brahman have no access there; they all remain outside it.

Beyond Paravyoma, the spiritual Brahmaloka —

32 Outside Vaikuṇṭha lies a sphere of light — the radiance of Kṛṣṇa's body, supremely bright.

*Though beyond *māyā*, it has no spiritual pastimes — it is spirit alone —*

33 It is called Siddhaloka and lies beyond material nature. It is spiritual, yet the spiritual potency displays no variety there.

An example of the abode of Brahman —

34 It is like the disc of the sun: from outside it is a featureless glow, but within are the sun's chariot and all its variety.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

The word "Vaikuṇṭha" should be understood as "the abode of Kṛṣṇa" and "Paravyoma." Beyond Paravyoma the radiance of Kṛṣṇa's body spreads out and forms a sphere of light. It is called "Siddhaloka," "Brahmaloka" and so on. It is the only place for the liberation of merging into Brahman (*brahma-sāyujya*). This abode is indeed spiritual, but it has no transformations of the *cit-śakti*, that is, no variety. From outside, the disc of the sun is without features (*nirviśeṣa*): it is mere light, without any variety. But within the disc one sees the sun's chariot and the rest — things with features (*saviśeṣa*), that is, rich variety. So it is here: the outer part of the sun's disc is like the abode of Brahman.

*(*Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam*, Canto 7, Chapter 1, verse 29)*[12]

35 "Many have fixed their minds on the Lord — some by devotion, others by loving desire (*kāma*), enmity, fear or affection — and, casting off the sin in those feelings, have attained Him." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 7.1.29)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Many fixed their minds on Him through *kāma*, enmity, fear and affection — just as through devotion — gave up that sin and attained Him. In another reading one more verse is found: "The gopīs through *kāma*, Kaṁsa through fear, Caidya and other kings through enmity, the Vṛṣṇis through kinship, you through affection, and we through devotion, O mighty Lord."[12]

Anubhāṣya.

Dharmarāja Yudhiṣṭhira asked: "Why did Śiśupāla, through his enmity toward Kṛṣṇa, become worthy of *sāyujya-mukti*?" In reply Śrī Nārada said:

yathā ([by prescribed]) **bhaktyā** (service) **īśvare manaḥ āveśya** ([people attain Him]), [so too,] **tad aghaṁ** (the sin caused by *kāma* and the rest) **hitvā**, **kāmāt** — like the gopīs, **dveṣāt** — like Dantavakra, Śiśupāla and others, **bhayāt** — like Kaṁsa and others, **snehāt** — like the Pāṇḍavas — **bahavaḥ** (many [such]) **tad gatiṁ** (one or another kind of liberation) **gatāḥ** (attained).

See Yudhiṣṭhira's question and Śrī Nārada's answer in the first chapter of the seventh canto of the *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* (verses 22–46), and also the various interpretations in the *Gauḍīya-bhāṣya* on verses 3.30, 32 and 34.

*(*Bhakti-rasāmṛta-sindhu*, *Pūrva-vibhāga*, *Sādhana-bhakti-laharī*, verse 278)*

36 "The goal of the Lord's enemies and that of His beloved ones are sometimes spoken of as one, because Brahman and Kṛṣṇa are one, as the rays are one with the sun." (Bhakti-rasāmṛta-sindhu, 1.2.278)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Wherever scripture says that the enemies of Bhagavān and His beloved ones attain the same thing, it speaks only of the oneness of Brahman, which is like the rays, and Kṛṣṇa, who is like the sun. The upshot is this: the beloved ones of Bhagavān attain the variety of Vaikuṇṭha, while the enemies of Bhagavān attain "Siddhaloka," which is without pastimes.

Anubhāṣya.

yat (if in some scripture) **arīṇāṁ** (of the enemies of Bhagavān) **priyāṇāṁ ca** (and of the devotees of Bhagavān) **ekam prāpyam uditam** (is declared), **tat kiraṇārkopamā-juṣoḥ brahma-kṛṣṇayoḥ aikyāt** (because of the oneness — that is, it should be understood that the featureless Brahman, which is like the rays, and Kṛṣṇa, who is like the sun, are in truth nondifferent).

Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam 10.2.32: "Others, O lotus-eyed Lord, think themselves liberated, but their intelligence is impure because they lack devotion to You. Having climbed with difficulty to the highest position, they fall down from there, for they have neglected Your feet."

Śrī Rūpa Prabhu writes in the *Laghu-bhāgavatāmṛta*, describing the glory of Śrī Kṛṣṇa (25–37): "There, in the fourth part [of the *Viṣṇu Purāṇa*] (*Viṣṇu Purāṇa* 4.15.1–10), is Maitreya's question: 'Slain by Viṣṇu as Hiraṇyakaśipu and as Rāvaṇa, he obtained enjoyments unattainable even by the immortals. Yet then he did not attain *sāyujya* with Him. How, then, did he, as Śiśupāla, attain *sāyujya* with the eternal Hari?' Parāśara's answer: 'To slay the lord of the Daityas, He who creates, maintains and destroys all the worlds took an unprecedented body and manifested the form of Nṛsiṁha. But Hiraṇyakaśipu did not think, "This is Viṣṇu." He thought, "This is a being born of an unsurpassed store of merit." His one-

pointed mind, driven by an excess of *rajas*, was absorbed in that thought. Therefore, having died at His hand, he obtained, as the Ten-headed One (Rāvaṇa), an unsurpassed wealth of enjoyment surpassing everything in the three worlds. But his mind did not dissolve into that beginningless and endless Bhagavān, the Supreme Brahman, for he had not made Him his support. As the Ten-headed One, too, subject to Anaṅga (Kāma), he gave his heart to Jānakī and saw only the form of Him who had taken the form of Daśaratha's son. He did not think, "This is Acyuta," and because of his attachment, at the hour of death his heart saw in Him only a man. Then the sole fruit of being felled by Acyuta was birth as Śiśupāla in the line of the kings of Cedi, renowned throughout the earth, and unimpeded wealth. At that time all the names of Bhagavān found their causes [in Kṛṣṇa]. Therefore his mind, bound by an enmity toward Him that had run through many births, endlessly uttered all these names of Acyuta, prompted by those causes — in abuse, threats and the like. And because of his deep-rooted enmity, His form never left his mind — not while he walked, ate, bathed, sat or lay down, nor in any other state. So, uttering His names in his abuse and holding Him alone in his heart, when the hour of his destruction came, freed of faults such as enmity, he saw Bhagavān — shining with the garland of rays of the disc He had hurled, the embodiment of imperishable effulgence, the Supreme Brahman. At that very moment he was slain by Bhagavān's disc; remembrance of Him burned up his entire store of sins; Bhagavān brought him to his end — and he dissolved into Him alone. All this I have told you. For this Bhagavān, even when glorified and remembered with persistent enmity, bestows a fruit that all the gods and *asuras* find hard to attain. What then of those who possess true devotion?'

"Parāśara did not say here that these two were [the Lord's] associates. It is said only that the two of them had three births. Therefore they are not held to be [the Lord's] associates in every *kalpa*; otherwise their fall in every *kalpa* would make no sense.

"When Hari manifested the wondrous form of Nṛsiṁha, Hiraṇyakaśipu had no firm idea that this was Viṣṇu. He concluded, 'This is someone endowed with merit.' His mind was driven by an excess of *rajas*, and, absorbed in that idea, he then obtained as Rāvaṇa the best of all and most rare wealth of enjoyment, whose only cause was his death [at His hand]. Since he was not certain that this was Viṣṇu, there was no unbroken absorption through intense enmity. And without it enmity leads only to hell, as with Vena. Yet he obtained wealth as the fruit of death at His hand. Remembering this good, the sage spoke with the word *eva* ('only'). Since

there was no absorption and his faults were not destroyed, he did not see [the Lord] as pure; and so, although the form of the Supreme Brahman was manifest, he did not dissolve into Him. As Rāvaṇa too, having given himself over to great *kāma*, he likewise saw a man in Śrī Rāma even at the hour of death. Therefore, as king of Cedi, he again obtained the highest wealth. Then in Kṛṣṇa there arose causes for all the names of the Lord of Ramā. From this he concluded that He was Viṣṇu — for He had twice been the cause of his death. Out of intense enmity and great absorption he endlessly uttered all those names, constantly abusing, threatening and so on. And seeing such a form and knowing for certain, 'This is Viṣṇu,' he remembered it everywhere and always, just like the names. His heap of sins born of enmity was burned; when the disc was hurled, its radiance removed his demonic nature, and at the end, his vision purified, he saw the radiant Supreme Brahman in a form like a man's. When the blow of the disc destroyed the body of the Daitya, he dissolved into that very Supreme Brahman. Having said this, [the sage] recalled that Bakī (Pūtanā) and others attained liberation through [Kṛṣṇa's] childhood pastimes, while Kālanemi and others, even by the Lord's will, did not attain liberation in other [avatāras] — and he said again: 'For this Bhagavān …' *Hi* ('for') means 'as is well known': this Kṛṣṇa is Bhagavān Himself. Therefore He quickly draws the hearts both of those who love Him and of those who hate Him. Hence the greatness spoken of in the words 'when glorified …' is no wonder here."

Paraphrase of the meaning: "In the fourth part of the *Viṣṇu Purāṇa* Maitreya asks Parāśara: 'That Daitya who, in the bodies of Hiraṇyakaśipu and Rāvaṇa, obtained enjoyments unattainable even by the immortals, yet did not obtain liberation — how did he, in the body of Śiśupāla, attain *sāyujya* with Śrī Kṛṣṇa?' Parāśara's answer: 'When Śrī Nṛsiṁhadeva appeared, Hiraṇyakaśipu did not think of Him, "This is Viṣṇu," but took Him for some being born of a heap of merit. Because of the predominance of *rajo-guṇa*, at the hour of death he could not think of His form. But because he died at His hand, in the body of Rāvaṇa he obtained boundless wealth of enjoyment that gave him power over the three worlds. He did not regard Bhagavān as his support (*ālambana*), that is, as the *viṣaya-vigraha*, the one to be served — so his mind did not dissolve into Bhagavān. In the body of Rāvaṇa, subject to *kāma*, he set his heart on Jānakī and only saw the form of Bhagavān Śrī Rāmacandra. But at the hour of death he did not understand that Śrī Rāma was Viṣṇu: in his heart there was only the idea that He was a man. Then, because he fell at Śrī Rāma's hand, he was born in the body of Śiśupāla in the renowned line of the kings of Cedi and obtained great wealth. Śrī Kṛṣṇa was called

Vāsudeva, and [Śiśupāla] saw Viṣṇu in Him. For many births he had been hostile to Him; that enmity had grown firmly into his heart, and so even in abuse and threats he uttered the names of Kṛṣṇa. Because of his deep-rooted enmity the beautiful form of Bhagavān never left the mind of Śiśupāla, absorbed in Kṛṣṇa, in any state — not while he walked, ate, bathed, sat, lay down and so on. He uttered that name in anger and the like and held that form in his heart; so at the last hour his offenses — enmity and the rest — went away, and in the radiance of the rays of the Sudarśana disc that had come to destroy him, he saw the true form of Bhagavān, the Supreme Brahman. Remembrance of Bhagavān (though hostile) burned up his heap of sins; slain by Bhagavān's disc, Śiśupāla came near to Bhagavān and dissolved into Him. O Maitreya, this is the answer to your question. If the haters of Kṛṣṇa, by hostile cultivation (*pratikūla-anuśīlana*), even while persisting in enmity, attain a good destination, what doubt can there be that pure devotees, by favorable cultivation, will attain the highest goal of all — the lotus feet of Kṛṣṇa, that is, love for Kṛṣṇa?' Parāśara did not say that these two Daityas had formerly been Bhagavān's associates Jaya and Vijaya; he said only that they took birth three times. Therefore Parāśara did not mean that these two associates of Bhagavān are born as *asuras* in every *kalpa*. Otherwise the associates of Bhagavān would fall in every *kalpa*, and that is entirely incongruous. (That is to say: in Bhagavān Viṣṇu, just as the will to create, the will to fight is also eternally present. A *mahārāja* fond of sport always plays with rivals set against him. When there are no rivals, he makes his own courtiers or servants into opponents and sports with them; and these servants, playing in a hostile mood, give their master delight. So too Bhagavān Viṣṇu: He makes hostile the *jīvas* who have been turned away from Him since time without beginning, or some of His own associates; they take on a hostile mood, and so both sides satisfy their longing for the play of battle. Therefore the fall of Bhagavān's associates in every *kalpa* is incongruous.) When Bhagavān appeared in the unearthly form of Nṛsiṁha, Hiraṇyakaśipu did not see Viṣṇu in Him: He seemed to him merely a being born of a heap of merit. The predominance of *rajo-guṇa* disordered his intelligence: he thought of Nṛsiṁha, 'This is some mighty creature,' and so at the last hour he could not think of His form. Therefore, merely because he died at Nṛsiṁha's hand, he obtained in the body of Rāvaṇa a rare wealth of enjoyment. Since there was no firm conviction that this was Viṣṇu, and no intense enmity, his absorption in Bhagavān did not grow. Enmity without such growing absorption in Bhagavān, as with King Vena, leads only to hell. Without the most intense absorption the offenses born of abuse and the like are not destroyed. There was no absorption, the

offenses did not vanish, and so Hiraṇyakaśipu did not see the pure form of Bhagavān and could not dissolve into Him, though the Supreme Brahman Nṛsiṁhadeva stood manifest before him. In the body of Rāvaṇa, too, his mind was wholly subject to *kāma*, and so, like Hiraṇyakaśipu, he saw a man in Śrī Rāma. Therefore that Daitya, in the form of Śiśupāla, again obtained, as before, a fine wealth of enjoyment. Śrī Kṛṣṇa was called Vāsudeva, and by that name [Śiśupāla] then concluded that He was the cause of his death in his two previous births. Out of intense enmity and great absorption he constantly uttered all those names, even in abuse and threats; seeing in Him the four-armed form and so on, and convinced that this was Viṣṇu, he thought of that form unceasingly, just as he uttered the names. Therefore his heap of sins born of enmity was burned; the radiance of the disc hurled by Śrī Kṛṣṇa destroyed his demonic nature; gaining purified, divine vision, he saw the form of the Supreme Brahman, like that of a man. Then the blow of the Sudarśana disc destroyed his demonic body, and he dissolved into the Supreme Brahman. Having said that Śiśupāla, through the most intense absorption in Śrī Kṛṣṇa by way of enmity, attained merging (*sāyujya-laya*) in Him, and having considered that Pūtanā and others slain in His childhood pastimes attained liberation, while Kālanemi and others slain in other avatāras, by the design of the Lord, did not, [the sage] uttered this prose passage. *Hi* is used in the sense ‘as is well known.’ If one glorifies and remembers the source of the avatāras rather than other avatāras — even with enmity, that is, in a hostile mood — even such *asuras* attain a good destination.” See also the commentary of Śrīpāda Baladeva Vidyābhūṣaṇa.

Śrī Sanātana Prabhu in the *Bṛhad-bhāgavatāmṛta* (second part, called *Goloka-māhātmya*, 30–31): “Ah, how can liberation be praised, when even the Daityas obtain it — those whom the scriptures themselves condemn as killers of cows, brāhmaṇas and others? *Sādhus* and *asuras* are opposites in every way; so it is fitting that their means and their goal be opposite too.”

In the tenth volume of the *Śrī Sajjana-toṣaṇī*, the translation by Śrīmad Bhaktivinoda Ṭhākura: “The scriptures condemn the Daityas — Kaṁsa and others — as killers of cows, brāhmaṇas and others. How then can the *sāyujya* liberation those Daityas obtained be praised? The *sādhus* are the devotees of Bhagavān, and the *asuras* are those who hate Him. Just as *sādhus* and *asuras* are always opposite in nature, so their means and goals must be opposite too. The means of the *asuras* is enmity toward the *sādhus* and the killing of cows and brāhmaṇas, and their goal is liberation. The means of the devotees is devotion, and their goal is

prema. Therefore those who strive for such liberation, like wicked people, take up a wicked means — the mere endeavor of *jñāna*."

Above Brahmaloka, Paravyoma, full of spiritual pastimes —

37 So in Paravyoma there are manifold pastimes of the spiritual potency, while outside it a featureless sphere of light is manifest.

*That sphere of light is the featureless Brahman; those who attain *sāyujya-mukti* reach it —*

38 That featureless Brahman is light alone, and those who are fit for *sāyujya* are absorbed in it.

*The destination of *jñānīs*, *yogīs* and the haters of Hari — (*Bhakti-rasāmṛta-sindhu*, *Pūrva-vibhāga*, verse 280; words of the *Brahmāṇḍa Purāṇa*)*

39 "Beyond darkness lies Siddhaloka, where dwell the siddhas, immersed in the bliss of Brahman, and the demons slain by Hari." (Brahmāṇḍa-purāṇa; Bhakti-rasāmṛta-sindhu, 1.2.280)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Beyond *tamas*, that is, beyond the world of *māyā*, lies "Siddhaloka," the abode of Brahman. There dwell the *māyāvādīs* immersed in the happiness of Brahman, and the *asuras* — Kaṁsa and others — slain by Bhagavān. The *yogīs* of Patañjali's school, even after attaining *kaivalya*, will also reach that world.

Anubhāṣya.

tamasaḥ pāre (in the region beyond the three *guṇas*) **tu siddha-lokaḥ** ([lies]), **yatra siddhāḥ** (those perfected in the knowledge of undifferentiated Brahman and in the *yoga* of *kaivalya*) **hariṇā** (by Kṛṣṇa) **hatāḥ daityāḥ ca brahma-sukhe** (in *sāyujya* with the featureless Brahman) **magnāḥ** ([being] immersed) **vasanti hi**.

See the *Anubhāṣya* to 35–36 above.

*The second *catur-vyūha* in Paravyoma is a manifestation of the original *catur-vyūha* of Dvārakā —*

40 In that Paravyoma, on the four sides of Nārāyaṇa, the catur-vyūha of Dvārakā is present in a second manifestation.

Anubhāṣya.

Śrī Rūpa Prabhu in the *Laghu-bhāgavatāmṛta* (describing the *catur-vyūha*, 83–84): “The *Padma Purāṇa*, however, says that the four *vyūhas* — Vāsudeva and the others — abide in order in the four directions of Paramavyoma, beginning with the east. Likewise in the *pāda-vibhūti* they abide in order: in the city of Vedavatī, in the Vaikuṇṭha within the covering of water; in the world of Viṣṇu above Satya; in the eternal city of Dvārakā; and in Śvetadvīpa, north of the Ocean of Pure Water, in the city of Airāvatī — in the abode that is the couch on Ananta's lap, in the Ocean of Milk.”

The *Padma Purāṇa* says that in the four directions of Paravyoma, beginning with the east, the *catur-vyūha* — Vāsudeva and the others — abides in order. And in the *eka-pāda-vibhūti*, that is, in the material world, these four forms — Vāsudeva and the others — dwell in order in four places. Vāsudeva dwells in the Vaikuṇṭha within the covering of water, in the city of Vedavatī; Saṅkarṣaṇa in Viṣṇuloka above Satyaloka; Pradyumna in the eternal city of Dvārakā; and Aniruddha on the bed of Ananta, in the city of Airāvatī in Śvetadvīpa, in the middle of the Ocean of Milk, on the northern shore of the Ocean of Pure Water.

*They are *turīya*, beyond the Virāṭ, the Garbha and the Kāraṇa —*

41 Vāsudeva, Saṅkarṣaṇa, Pradyumna and Aniruddha — this is the second catur-vyūha, transcendent and pure.

*Mahā-Saṅkarṣaṇa of the second *catur-vyūha* is the original shelter of the *cit-śakti* —*

42 There the form of Rāma is Mahā-Saṅkarṣaṇa. He is the shelter of the spiritual potency, the cause of all causes.

*The splendor of that form is a transformation of the *sandhinī* of the *cit-*

śakti —*

43 One manifestation of the spiritual potency is called *śuddha-sattva*, pure spiritual existence, and of it all the abodes of Vaikuṇṭha are made.

The six opulences and all the rest are the spiritual splendor of Mahā-Saṅkarṣaṇa —

44 The six kinds of opulence there are all spiritual; know for certain that all of them are the splendour of Saṅkarṣaṇa.

*Mahā-Saṅkarṣaṇa is the shelter of the *jīva-śakti* —*

45 There is a potency called *jīva*, known as the marginal (*taṭasthā*) potency; and Mahā-Saṅkarṣaṇa is the shelter of all jīvas.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

The *catur-vyūha* of Dvārakā — Kṛṣṇa, Baladeva and the others — is manifest a second time in Paravyoma. This *catur-vyūha* is called "the second *catur-vyūha*"; it too is spiritual and pure. There the form of Balarāma is Mahā-Saṅkarṣaṇa. In Paravyoma there is a manifestation of the *sandhinī* aspect of the *cit-śakti* called "*śuddha-sattva*"; from it come the abodes of Vaikuṇṭha and the rest, made of *śuddha-sattva*, and the six kinds of majesty. All this is the splendor (*vibhūti*) of Mahā-Saṅkarṣaṇa. Mahā-Saṅkarṣaṇa is the shelter of all *jīvas*, and therefore the shelter of the *jīva-śakti*, called marginal (*taṭastha*). The being of the *jīva*, a particle of spirit, springs from the *jīva-śakti*, yet it is made such that the *māyā-śakti* can overpower it. It therefore stands on the border between two realms — *māyā* and spirit (*cit*) — and so has received the name "marginal" (*taṭastha*).

A part of Saṅkarṣaṇa — Viṣṇu who lies in the Causal Ocean —

46 Saṅkarṣaṇa is the shelter of the Puruṣa from whom the universe arises and into whom it dissolves.

47 He is the shelter of all, wondrous in every way, His opulence boundless; even Ananta cannot describe His glory.

48 The transcendent Saṅkarṣaṇa, pure spiritual existence (*viśuddha-sattva*), is a part of Nityānanda-Rāma.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
Mahā-Saṅkarṣaṇa is spiritual, pure *sattva* (*viśuddha-sattva*); He is a limb (*aṅga*), that is, a manifestation (*prakāśa*), of Nityānanda-Rāma.

Anubhāṣya.
The verse itself reads *aṁśa* (“portion”), the *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya* reads *aṅga* (“body”); both readings convey the same meaning.

Anubhāṣya.
Saṅkarṣaṇa is another name for “Mahā-Saṅkarṣaṇa” (He is described below, in 42–48).

In the second *pāda* of the second chapter of the *Brahma-sūtra*, in the *Utpatty-asambhava-adhikaraṇa*, Śrī Śaṅkarācārya in his commentary put forward a mistaken argument about the *catur-vyūha*. Settling the matter, the author refutes that doctrine in 41–47. Śrīpāda [Śaṅkara] erred in taking Viṣṇu, the nondual Knowledge (*advaya-jñāna*), for one of the objects of the visible world; in the *Pañcarātra* Śrī Nārāyaṇa Himself made this clear to him. Yet to bewilder the conditioned *jīvas* of demoniac nature he had to resort to deception (*vipralipsā*). Because of this the followers of Advaita — Appayya Dīkṣita and others — have reached the utmost limit of error. With the capacities of conditioned *jīvas*, knowledge of the *catur-vyūha* is not possible. The ācārya spoke such ill words to increase their folly. The *catur-vyūha* is made of *śuddha-sattva*, delights in the play of the *cit-śakti* and possesses the six kinds of majesty. To call Them poor and powerless, and to think of Them so, is the trait of deluded *jīvas*. Such *jīvas* are fit only to be bewildered by *māyā*. Whoever cannot understand [the difference between] Vaikuṇṭha and the realm of *māyā* falls into just this kind of error. In his commentary on *sūtras* 42–45 of the second *pāda* of the second chapter of the *Brahma-sūtra*, Śrīpāda Śaṅkara made a vain attempt to refute “the doctrine of the *catur-vyūha*.” Below are quoted from Śrīpāda Śaṅkarācārya's commentary his words on the “*catur-vyūha*,” rooted in his distorted understanding.

Utpatty-asambhavāt (42) (Śaṅkara's commentary): * * * “On this the Bhāgavatas hold: Bhagavān Vāsudeva alone, stainless, whose nature is knowledge, is the highest reality. Dividing Himself fourfold, He abides in the form of the *vyūha* of

Vāsudeva, the *vyūha* of Saṅkarṣaṇa, the *vyūha* of Pradyumna and the *vyūha* of Aniruddha. Vāsudeva is the name for the Supreme Self, Saṅkarṣaṇa for the *jīva*, Pradyumna for the mind, Aniruddha for the ego (*ahaṅkāra*). Of these, Vāsudeva is the highest *prakṛti*, and the others — Saṅkarṣaṇa and the rest — are effects. To this we say: what is asserted — that the supreme Nārāyaṇa, the Supreme Self, the Self of all, by Himself dividing Himself in many ways, abides in the form of *vyūhas* — is not refuted. But what is said further — that from Vāsudeva Saṅkarṣaṇa is born, from Saṅkarṣaṇa Pradyumna, and from Pradyumna Aniruddha — to this we say: the birth of the *jīva* called Saṅkarṣaṇa from the Supreme Self called Vāsudeva is impossible, for then defects such as impermanence would follow. If the *jīva* were born, defects such as impermanence would attach to it, and then liberation — attaining Bhagavān — would be impossible for it, for an effect, on reaching its cause, would dissolve into it. And the Ācārya will reject the birth of the *jīva* [by the *sūtra*] ‘The self [is not born], because *śruti* does not speak [of its birth], and because of eternity [known] from them.’ Therefore their construction is incoherent.”

The meaning of the commentary is this: “The Bhāgavatas hold that Bhagavān Vāsudeva is one, stainless, His body is knowledge, and He is the highest reality. He Himself has divided Himself into four and so abides. These four *vyūhas* are: 1) the *vyūha* of Vāsudeva, 2) the *vyūha* of Saṅkarṣaṇa, 3) the *vyūha* of Pradyumna, 4) the *vyūha* of Aniruddha; these four *vyūhas* are His body. Another name of Vāsudeva is ‘Paramātmā’; of Saṅkarṣaṇa, ‘*jīva*’; of Pradyumna, ‘mind’; and of Aniruddha, ‘*ahaṅkāra*.’ Of the four *vyūhas*, the *vyūha* of Vāsudeva is the highest *prakṛti*, that is, the root cause. Saṅkarṣaṇa and the others have arisen from the *vyūha* of Vāsudeva, and so Saṅkarṣaṇa, Pradyumna and Aniruddha are the effects of that highest *prakṛti*. For a long time the *jīva* goes to the temple of Bhagavān, gathers [the articles of worship], performs worship (*ijyā*), studies [scripture] and practices *yoga*; thus it becomes free from sin, obtains a pure body and attains the highest *prakṛti*, Bhagavān. The great-souled Bhāgavatas say that Nārāyaṇa is beyond *prakṛti*, renowned as the Paramātmā, and is the Self of all — this does not contradict *śruti*. We also accept that He by Himself abides in the form of many *vyūhas*. Therefore this part of the Bhāgavata doctrine is not refuted by this *sūtra*. The Ācārya composed this *sūtra* only to reject the part where the Bhāgavatas say that from Vāsudeva Saṅkarṣaṇa was born, from Saṅkarṣaṇa Pradyumna, and from Pradyumna Aniruddha. The birth of the *jīva* called Saṅkarṣaṇa from the

Paramātmā called Vāsudeva is utterly impossible: the *jīva* would then be subject to defects such as impermanence. If the *jīva* is born, defects such as impermanence are unavoidable for it. And if the *jīva* is perishable by nature, liberation — attaining Bhagavān — is impossible for it altogether. When the cause perishes, the effect must perish too. Ācārya Vedavyāsa rejected the birth of the *jīva* by the *sūtra* of the third *pāda* of the second chapter, ‘The self [is not born], because *śruti* does not speak [of its birth], and because of eternity [known] from them,’ and by rejecting its birth he will prove its eternity. Therefore this construction is incoherent.”

Na ca kartuḥ karaṇam (43) (Śaṅkara's commentary): “For this reason too their construction is incoherent: in the world we do not see an instrument, such as an axe, arising from an agent such as Devadatta. Yet the Bhāgavatas describe that from the agent, the *jīva* called Saṅkarṣaṇa, there arises the instrument, the mind called Pradyumna, and from that, born of the agent, arises the ego called Aniruddha. Without an example we cannot accept this. Nor do we find any such *śruti*.”

The meaning of the commentary is this: “There is a reason why such a construction is incoherent. In the world we do not see an instrument — a sickle and the like — arising from an agent such as Devadatta. Yet the Bhāgavatas describe that from the agent, the *jīva* named Saṅkarṣaṇa, there arose the instrument, the mind named Pradyumna, and from that Pradyumna, born of the agent, arises Aniruddha, the *ahaṅkāra*. If the Bhāgavatas cannot explain this by an example, how can it be accepted? Nor do we hear any words of *śruti* that disclose this truth.”

Vijñānādi-bhāve vā tad-apratiṣedhaḥ (44) (Śaṅkara's commentary): “It may also be said thus: Saṅkarṣaṇa and the others are not meant as the *jīva* and the rest. What, then? All of them are accepted as Lords, endowed with the attributes of the Lord — knowledge, sovereignty, power, strength, valor and splendor; all of them are Vāsudevas, faultless, without [external] support, untainted. Therefore the defect described — the impossibility of origin — does not apply to them. To this it is said: even so, *tad-apratiṣedhaḥ* — the impossibility of origin is still not removed. The point is that this defect, the impossibility of origin, arises in another way. How? If the intention is that these four — Vāsudeva and the others — are Lords distinct from one another, of equal attributes, and have no single self, then positing many Lords is pointless, for the Lord's work is accomplished by one Lord alone. And their own doctrine collapses, since they accept that Bhagavān Vāsudeva alone is the highest reality. If, however, the intention is that these four *vyūhas* of equal

attributes belong to one Bhagavān, the impossibility of origin remains as before. For Saṅkarṣaṇa cannot arise from Vāsudeva, nor Pradyumna from Saṅkarṣaṇa, nor Aniruddha from Pradyumna, since there is no pre-eminence (*atiśaya*) among them. Between effect and cause there must be pre-eminence, as between clay and pot. Without pre-eminence one cannot establish which is the effect and which the cause. And the followers of the *Pañcarātra* doctrine accept no difference — whether in any one of them or in all — arising from greater or lesser knowledge, sovereignty and the like: they hold all the *vyūhas* to be Vāsudeva without distinction. Nor would the *vyūhas* of Bhagavān stop at the number four, for the whole world, from Brahmā down to a blade of grass, is understood to be a *vyūha* of Bhagavān."

The meaning of the commentary is this: "The Bhāgavatas may also intend the following: Saṅkarṣaṇa and the others named are not of the nature of the *jīva*; all of them are Lords, all possess the potency of knowledge and the potency of sovereignty, are endowed with power, valor and splendor, all are Vāsudeva, all are faultless, without [external] support and untainted. So the defect of impossibility of origin does not apply to them. To this we say: even with such an intention the defect of impossibility of origin is not removed — it remains, only in another form. Vāsudeva, Saṅkarṣaṇa, Pradyumna and Aniruddha are different from one another and not of one self, and at the same time all are alike in attributes and all are Lords. If this is meant, one must accept many Lords. But there is no need to accept many Lords: the purpose is served by accepting one Lord. Moreover, since it is asserted that Bhagavān Vāsudeva is one, that is, without a second, and is the highest reality, the defect of contradicting one's own doctrine (*siddhānta-hāni*) also arises. And if this *catur-vyūha* belongs to Bhagavān Himself and They are all alike in attributes, the defect of impossibility of origin still cannot be avoided. For without some pre-eminence (inequality — more or less) Saṅkarṣaṇa cannot be born of Vāsudeva, Pradyumna of Saṅkarṣaṇa, or Aniruddha of Pradyumna. One must accept that there is some distinction between effect and cause, as when a pot comes from clay. Without pre-eminence one cannot point out which is the effect and which the cause. And consider further: the adherents of the *Pañcarātra* doctrine do not accept a difference between Vāsudeva and the others in greater or lesser knowledge and so on; on the contrary, they honor the four *vyūhas* as Vāsudeva without distinction. Are the *vyūhas* of Bhagavān exhausted by the number four? Certainly not. Both *śruti* and *smṛti* prove that the whole world, from Brahmā down to a blade of grass, is a *vyūha* of Bhagavān."

Vipratiṣedhāc ca (45) (Śaṅkara's commentary): “And in this scripture many kinds of contradiction are found, such as the positing of quality and possessor of qualities. For we see [statements such as]: ‘Knowledge, sovereignty, power, strength, valor and splendor are qualities; and they are the Self, the Bhagavāns, the Vāsudevas.’”

The meaning of the commentary is this: “In the *Pañcarātra* and other scriptures of the Bhāgavatas many contradictory constructions are seen — for instance, on the relation of quality and its possessor. It is in no way possible to be at once the quality and the possessor of qualities. Yet the Bhāgavatas say that the potency of knowledge, the potency of sovereignty, power, valor and splendor — these qualities — and Pradyumna and the others, though different, are the Self and Bhagavān Vāsudeva.”

In reply to this doctrine of Śrīpāda Śaṅkarācārya, Śrī Rūpa Prabhu writes in the *Laghu-bhāgavatāmṛta* (describing the *catur-vyūha*, verses 80–83): “Of the four *vyūhas* renowned by the name ‘Mahāvasthā,’ He [Vāsudeva] is the first; He is to be worshipped in the *citta*, for He is its presiding deity (*adhidaivata*). He is also spoken of as the seat of *viśuddha-sattva*. His own part is Bhagavān Śrī Saṅkarṣaṇa. This Saṅkarṣaṇa is regarded as the second *vyūha*; He may also be called the *jīva*, for He is the place from which all *jīvas* become manifest. His luster is sweeter than myriads of full autumn moons. He is worshipped in the *ahaṅkāra*; He has placed His own part in Śeṣa. Becoming the indwelling ruler (*antaryāmī*) of Rudra, the enemy of Smara (Kāma), and of *adharma*, the serpents, Antaka and the enemies of the gods, He brings about the destruction of the world. The third *vyūha* is Pradyumna, renowned as His *vilāsa*. The wise worship this Pradyumna in the *buddhi-tattva*. In Ilāvṛta the goddess Śrī serves Him, singing His praises. His luster is like pure *jāmbūnada* gold, and in places like a dark rain-cloud. He is the source of the creation of the universe; He has placed His own part in Kāma. Becoming the indwelling ruler of Vidhi (Brahmā), the Prajāpatis, the attached and Smara, He properly accomplishes creation. The fourth *vyūha* is Aniruddha, praised as His *vilāsa*. The thoughtful worship this Aniruddha in the *manas-tattva*. Like a dark-blue cloud, He is intent on protecting the universe. Becoming the indwelling ruler of Dharma, the Manus, the gods and kings, He maintains the world. In the *Mokṣa-dharma*, however, it is said that Pradyumna is the presiding deity of the mind and Aniruddha of the *ahaṅkāra*. Yet the order given [above] is accepted in all the *Pañcarātras*. The *Padma Purāṇa*,

however, says that the four *vyūhas* — Vāsudeva and the others — abide in order in the four directions of Paramavyoma, beginning with the east."

Of the four renowned *vyūhas* of Nārāyaṇa, the Lord of Mahā-Vaikuṇṭha in Paravyoma, called "Mahāvasthā," this Vāsudeva is "the first *vyūha*." He is to be worshipped in the *citta*, for He is its presiding deity and abides in *viśuddha-sattva* (*Bhāgavatam* 4.3.23). Śrī Saṅkarṣaṇa is His own part, that is, His *vilāsa*. Saṅkarṣaṇa is called "the second *vyūha*," and since He is the source from which all *jīvas* become manifest, He is also called "*jīva*." The radiance of His body is sweeter than the white rays of countless full autumn moons. He is worshipped in the *ahaṅkāra-tattva*. He has invested His supporting potency (*ādhāra-śakti*) in Anantadeva, and as the *antaryāmī* of Rudra, the enemy of Smara, and of *adharma*, the serpents, Antaka and the *asuras*, He carries out the destruction of the world. The *vilāsa-mūrti* of that Saṅkarṣaṇa is Pradyumna, the third *vyūha*. The wise worship this Pradyumna in the *buddhi-tattva*. The goddess Lakṣmī serves Him in Ilāvṛta-varṣa, singing of His qualities. The radiance of His body is in some places like molten *jāmbūnada* gold, in others like a fresh dark rain-cloud. He is the source of the creation of the universe; He has invested His creative potency in Kandarpa. As the *antaryāmī* of the creator (Vidhātā), of all the Prajāpatis, of beings attached to sense objects — gods, humans and others — and of Kandarpa, He accomplishes creation. His *vilāsa-mūrti* is the fourth *vyūha*, Aniruddha. The thoughtful worship this Aniruddha in the *manas-tattva*. The radiance of His body is like a dark-blue cloud. He is intent on protecting the universe. As the *antaryāmī* of Dharma, the Manus, the gods and kings, He maintains the world. The *Mokṣa-dharma* names Pradyumna the presiding deity of the mind and Aniruddha the presiding deity of the *ahaṅkāra*. The order stated before (that is, that Pradyumna is the presiding deity of *buddhi* and Aniruddha of the mind) is accepted by all kinds of *Pañcarātra*. [The *Padma Purāṇa*, however, describes the four *vyūhas* — Vāsudeva and the others — as abiding in order in the four directions of Paravyoma, beginning with the east.]

On the *vilāsa* of Bhagavān and His inconceivable potency the *Laghu-bhāgavatāmṛta* (44–66) says: "But surely we hear in scripture the words of the *Mahā-varāha Purāṇa*: 'All the bodies of that Supreme Self are eternal and everlasting; they are neither given up nor taken on, and never anywhere born of *prakṛti*. They are masses of supreme bliss, knowledge through and through; all are full of every excellence and free from every fault.' And in the *Śrī Nārada-pañcarātra*: 'As a gem, joined with blue, yellow and other colors, takes on

different appearances, so Acyuta [appears differently] according to the difference of meditation.' How, then, do you explain gradation (*tāratamya*) among Them? To this it is said: oneness and separateness, and likewise being a part and being the whole, are quite fitting in Him, the One, by His inconceivable, unlimited potency. Separate manifestation within oneness — as [in the *Bhāgavatam* 10.69.2]: 'How wonderful! The one [Kṛṣṇa], in one body, at the same time married sixteen thousand women in separate palaces.' Oneness of form within separateness — as in the *Padma Purāṇa*: 'That God, the Supreme Person, beyond the *guṇas*, having become many, again becomes one and lies down — the faultless Hari, the original creator.' That one and the same is both part and whole and has opposing potencies — as [in the *Bhāgavatam* 10.40.7]: 'Those absorbed in You worship You, who have many forms and one form.' And in the *Kūrma Purāṇa*: 'He is neither large nor small, yet in every way large and small; He is said to be colorless in every way, yet He is dark, with eyes reddish at the corners. Because He possesses majesty, Bhagavān is said to have opposing attributes. Yet faults are in no way to be ascribed to the Supreme; these attributes, though opposed, are to be reconciled in Him in every respect.' In the sixth canto — on His inconceivable potency that unites opposites — in prose (*Bhāgavatam* 6.9.34–37): 'This play of Yours seems hard to understand: without needing support, without a body, without waiting for our help, You Yourself, remaining unchanged — beyond the *guṇas* — create, destroy and maintain this world endowed with the *guṇas*. So do You, like a Devadatta here, fallen into the stream of the *guṇas*, out of dependence accept the fruits of Your good and bad deeds? Or, delighting in Yourself, tranquil, seeing all equally, do You remain indifferent? Truly, we do not know. For in You — Bhagavān, the Lord of countless excellences, whose greatness is unfathomable — the two do not contradict each other. You are beyond the reach of the disputes of disputants whose hearts and intentions are shaped by recent fancies, doubts, deliberations, false proofs and scriptures of bad logic, and who cling stubbornly to their views. In You, the One, in whom all that is made of *māyā* has ceased — when Your own *māyā* is set in between — what thing could be hard to accomplish? You have no two natures; yet You follow the opinions of people of even and uneven minds, as a piece of rope [seems] a snake and the like to those who think so.'

"Here are the *kārikās*: 'Without bodily effort, without the support of earth and the like, without helpers — the work of You, the changeless, is very hard to understand. By "the stream of the *guṇas*" the battles of the gods and *asuras*

and so on are meant. “Fallen” means attached to it; that would be dependence — for Your dependence on the gods who have taken shelter of You is born of mercy. Hence: “Your own deeds,” that is, the good and the other, done by Your own [gods], in the form of happiness, suffering and so on — do You accept these as Your fruit? Or, delighting in Yourself, do You remain wholly indifferent to them? We do not know. But in You the two are not contradictory at all. The reason is given by the two words beginning with *bhagavati*, and likewise by the five words beginning with *īśvare*. By the word “Bhagavān” omniscience is clearly indicated, by another word the possession of good qualities, and by the word *kevala* the nature of Brahman. Though by the nature of Brahman there would be indifference everywhere, the first two qualities give partiality toward the devotees. “But how can one nature be twofold at one and the same time?” To this he says, “recent …” and so on — for You are beyond the disputes of such disputants, beyond their range. Therefore, when that inconceivable potency of Your own is set in between, what thing, even a contradictory one, could be hard to accomplish here? For such indeed is its inconceivability. And that it is inconceivable is understood from its being the support of many opposing actions. The author of the *Brahma-sūtra* says: “Because of *śruti*, because the basis is the word.” And the *Skanda Purāṇa*: “What is inconceivable should not be subjected to reasoning.” This is seen even in gems and the like. Without such potency the Supreme Lord's supreme lordship would not be established, for His greatness is spoken of as unfathomable. Ignorance or sorcery (*indra-jāla*) can be seen anywhere; therefore the Lord's supreme lordship is not established by them. That these are not in Him is clearly stated by the words “in whom has ceased ….” Otherwise the six words beginning with *bhagavati* would have been used to no purpose. Therefore, by scripture and by reason, the two do not contradict each other. Yet according to the opinions of people of high and low minds, who do not know the truth, You appear now this way, now that, like the rope. “But surely knowledge alone is Brahman, while Bhagavān has many attributes; so here too two natures are seen.” To this he says, “… no two natures …” — for there is never duality in His nature: these are certainly two attributes of the One. Therefore, if contradiction is seen in the manifestations (*vilāsas*) of His potency, that is His inconceivable majesty: it adorns Him and is no fault. The same statement of contradiction is found in the third canto too (*Bhāgavatam* 3.4.16): “You are free from desire, yet You act; You are unborn, yet You take birth; You are Time itself, yet in fear of an enemy You take refuge in a fortress and flee; You delight in Yourself, yet You live as a householder among many women. Here the intelligence of the wise is bewildered.”

If all this were not real, the intelligence of the wise would not be bewildered. Thus the cause in the pastimes is the inconceivable potency alone: as His will is, so it manifests.'"

Here the following objection may be raised. In the *Mahā-varāha Purāṇa* we hear: "All the bodies of that Supreme Self, Hari, are eternal, and all of them appear in the world again and again. These bodies are neither given up nor taken on, and so they are never products of *prakṛti*. All these bodies are condensed supreme bliss, by nature of the single taste of spirit; they are endowed with every spiritual quality and free from every fault." And the *Nārada-pañcarātra* says: "As a *vaidūrya* gem takes on blue, yellow and other colors in different places, so Bhagavān Acyuta, according to the difference of worship, manifests His form in different ways." Why, then, do you explain a gradation among these avatāras? In answer to this doubt it may be said: by the power of His inconceivable, unlimited potency, in one vessel — in one and the same Puruṣottama — oneness and separateness, being a part and being the whole, are in no way impossible or incongruous. Separate manifestation within oneness — as in the Tenth Canto (the words of Nārada): "How wonderful! One and the same Śrī Kṛṣṇa at one and the same time married sixteen thousand women in separate palaces." Oneness of form within separateness — as in the *Padma Purāṇa*: "That faultless original creator, beyond the *guṇas*, Puruṣottama, the God Hari, having taken many forms, again lies down in one form." That one and the same is both part and whole and has opposing potencies — as in the Tenth Canto: "You, of many forms, are one; the devotees whose minds are absorbed in You worship You." And the *Kūrma Purāṇa* says: "Bhagavān is in every respect not large, yet large; not small, yet small; colorless, yet dark, with eyes reddish at the corners. By the power of His majesty He is called the possessor of opposing forms. Yet faults are in no way to be ascribed to the Supreme Lord; on the contrary, all these mutually opposed qualities are to be reconciled in Him in every respect." And the prose of the Sixth Canto speaks of His inconceivable potency that unites opposites: "O Bhagavān, Your transcendental play, or sport, seems hard to understand; that is, the ordinary relation of cause and effect is not seen in You. For You need no support, make no bodily effort, are Yourself beyond the *guṇas* and do not wait for our help — and by Your own nature alone You create, maintain and destroy this world endowed with the *guṇas*, without undergoing any change at all. O Lord, do You, like an ordinary man named Devadatta, fallen into the stream of the *guṇas* in this world, out of dependence regard as Your own the fruits of action — happiness, suffering and the like? Or,

without losing Your *cit-śakti*, delighting in Yourself and at peace, do You remain indifferent to all this, that is, abide only as a witness? This we do not know. You are full of the six opulences, Your excellences cannot be counted to the end, You are the Lord, the ruler of all, and Your greatness cannot become the object of anyone's intellect. There are disputants whose intelligence is covered and scattered by fancies that claim to reveal the nature of things, by doubts, deliberations, false proofs and scriptures full of bad logic; their disputes cannot touch You. In You, the possessor of inconceivable potency, both of these qualities are not opposed to each other. You are beyond all material knowledge and consist of pure knowledge alone; when Your potency of will is set in between, what work could be hard to accomplish in You? The impersonal and the personal, or that which has spiritual qualities and that which is without qualities, are not two different natures of Yours: they are only two perceptions of Your one nature, according to the difference of conceptions. But just as, for those whose minds are occupied with a snake and the like, one piece of rope appears in different forms — as a snake and so on — so You follow the intentions of those whose minds are even and uneven, that is, unsteady — that is, You manifest different doctrines among them."

Here is the *kārikā* on this passage: "Without bodily effort, without the support of earth and the like, without helpers — the stick, the wheel and so on — Your work, free from change, is very hard to understand. By 'the stream of the *guṇas*' the battles of the gods and *asuras* and the like are meant. 'Fallen' means attached; this is what is called *pāratantrya*, that is, dependence. For Your dependence on the gods who have taken shelter of You is born of mercy (that is, Your independence does not suffer by it). Therefore — do You regard as Your own 'Your own deeds,' that is, 'the deeds of Your own people' — the good and bad fruits in the form of happiness, suffering and the like earned by Your gods? Or, delighting in Yourself, do You remain wholly indifferent to them? This we do not know. But in You (the possessor of opposing qualities) both are possible. The reason is the two epithets beginning with *bhagavati* and the five epithets beginning with *īśvare*. Of these, by the word *bhagavat* omniscience is clearly understood, by the epithet *aparigaṇita* and the others the possession of good qualities, and by the word *kevala* the nature of Brahman. Though by the nature of Brahman one might expect indifference everywhere, the two qualities beginning with *bhagavati* make partiality toward the devotees possible. If you say, 'How can one nature be twofold at the same time?' — in answer to this doubt it is said, '*arvācīna* …' and so on; that is, You are beyond the disputes of those disputants who cannot grasp the

nature of the Truth — You are out of their reach. Therefore, when the inconceivable potency of Your own is set in between, what work, even a contradictory one, could be hard to accomplish in You? Your nature is inconceivable to disputants who lack devotion; Your potency is likewise inconceivable. Only by seeing that it is the support of many opposing actions can one infer that this potency of Yours is inconceivable. The author of the *Brahma-sūtra* has said: ‘The inconceivable object of service is within the reach of *śruti* alone, that is, of the evidence of the word.’ And the *Skanda Purāṇa* says: ‘One should not build inferences about the inconceivable.’ Such inconceivable power can be noticed even in material gems, potent herbs and the like. Without such inconceivable potency the Supreme Lord's supreme lordship could not be established. It is by the power of this inconceivable potency that the Lord's greatness is glorified as unfathomable. Ignorance and the art of sorcery can be seen anywhere; therefore ignorance, sorcery and the like do not prove the Supreme Lord's supreme lordship. For the epithet *uparata* and the others show that neither is present in the Lord. If ignorance and sorcery were accepted in the Lord, the use of the six epithets beginning with *bhagavati* would become pointless. Therefore, by the scripture and reasoning that reveal the inconceivable potency, these two qualities — that He protects the universe and that He is indifferent to it — cannot contradict each other. Just as for those whose minds, through ignorance, are occupied with a snake and the like, a piece of rope appears as a snake and so on, so You, for those whose thoughts are occupied with various conceptions and who therefore lack true knowledge, appear in this or that way according to their opinions. If you say, ‘Knowledge alone is called Brahman, and that which bears many attributes is called “Bhagavān”; so here two different natures are seen,’ — to remove this doubt it is said, ‘for there are not two natures.’ By this no duality at all is asserted of His nature; only two attributes of one and the same nature are determined. Therefore, if contradiction is seen in the manifestations of His potency, that is called inconceivable majesty: it adorns Him and is no fault at all. Such contradiction is mentioned in the Third Canto too: ‘Action in Him who is free from material endeavor; birth in the Unborn; He who is Time itself takes refuge in a fortress out of fear of the enemy and flees from Mathurā; He who delights in Himself enjoys with sixteen thousand women — in all this even the intelligence of the knowers of truth is bewildered.’ If all these deeds were not real, the intelligence of the knowers of truth would never be bewildered. Thus the cause of the pastimes is Bhagavān's inconceivable potency: as His will is, such are the pastimes it manifests.”

The *Pañcarātra* scripture is a book that unfolds the Vedas; it is wholly approved by the Vedas and devoted to the section on worship (*upāsanā-kāṇḍa*). It is not a *rājasic* or *tāmasic* *tantra*: the wise know it as the "*Sātvata-saṁhitā*." Śrī Nārāyaṇa Himself spoke it; this is specially stated in the *Mahābhārata*, in the *Mokṣa-dharma-parva* of the *Śānti-parva*, Chapters 3–9, verse 68. It was propagated by divine sages (*divya-sūris*) — Śrī Nārada and others — free from the four defects beginning with *bhrama*. The book *Śrī Bhāgavatam* is also known as the "*Sātvata-saṁhitā*." Śaṅkara puts forward as a *pūrvapakṣa*, as if it were the *Pañcarātra* doctrine, what is wholly opposed and contrary to that doctrine, and then tries to refute it. This is merely an utter violation of logic and truth, and below it is shown briefly by way of refutation.

(1) In his commentary on *sūtra* 42 Śrīpāda Śaṅkara called Saṅkarṣaṇa "the *jīva*." In fact the Bhāgavatas have never called Saṅkarṣaṇa "the *jīva*." He Himself is Adhokṣaja, Acyuta, *viṣṇu-tattva*, the presiding Lord of the *jīva*, the complete whole (*aṁśī*), all-pervading consciousness (*vibhu-caitanya*), the cause of all material and transcendental creation — not the *jīva*, a part, a minute consciousness (*aṇu-caitanya*). The *jīvātmā* has neither birth nor death — this is accepted by the Bhāgavatas and by any follower of *śruti* who studies and hears the scriptures.

(2) In reply to the commentary on *sūtra* 43: the manifestation of all the other *viṣṇu-tattvas* from *mūla-Saṅkarṣaṇa* is described in the *Brahma-saṁhitā*: "As the flame of a lamp, passing to another [wick], itself shines as a lamp, with the same qualities though its cause is separate, so He who in just this way shines forth as Viṣṇu — Govinda, the original Puruṣa — Him I worship." That is: "As the ray of a lamp on another base acts as a separate lamp — having the same qualities as the first lamp — so the original Puruṣa Govinda manifests Himself by becoming Viṣṇu. Him I worship."

(3) In the commentary on *sūtra* 44 Śrīpāda puts forward the *pūrvapakṣa*: "They are different from one another and not of one self." The followers of the *Pañcarātra* never accept this as their doctrine. In his commentary on *sūtra* 42, as quoted above, Śrīpāda Śaṅkara himself accepted: "that He by Himself, dividing Himself in many ways, abides in the form of *vyūhas* — this is not refuted," that is, "that He by Himself abides in the form of many *vyūhas* we too accept as agreeing with *śruti*." This contradicts the *pūrvapakṣa* objection in this *sūtra*. In other words, his commentaries on *sūtras* 44 and 42 contradict each other: what he accepted before, he now tries to refute as a *pūrvapakṣa*. By accepting

the *catur-vyūha* of Nārāyaṇa the Bhāgavatas do not thereby accept “a doctrine of many Lords.” They know the Truth as Bhagavān, nondual Knowledge, and never preach a plurality of Gods contrary to the Vedas. They firmly believe in the inconceivable great potency of Śrī Nārāyaṇa. See the paraphrase of the *Laghu-bhāgavatāmṛta* given above. Among these four *tattvas* — Vāsudeva, Saṅkarṣaṇa, Pradyumna and Aniruddha — there is no relation of cause and effect: “there is nothing else beyond the existent and the nonexistent”; “this difference between body and the possessor of the body never exists in the Lord” (*Kūrma Purāṇa*). All of Them are the *tattva* that rules over *māyā*, the presiding Lords of *śuddha-sattva*, *turīya*; in Their manifestation there can be no power of *māyā*, no change, no transformation, no fragmentation. They are the one nondual Knowledge, Adhokṣaja, the complete Reality. The evidence of *śruti*: “Oṁ. That is full, this is full; from the full the full comes forth. When the full is taken from the full, the full remains.” (*Bṛhad-āraṇyaka Upaniṣad* 5.1.) The whole world, from Brahmā down to a blade of grass, is the gross, external manifestation of Bhagavān Viṣṇu. Those who teach the merging of spirit and matter (*cid-acit-samanvaya*) vainly try to identify it with, or make it equal to, the Śrī *catur-vyūha*, the Lord of the three potencies. This is mere atheism rooted in extreme enmity toward Bhagavān. The world from Brahmā down to a blade of grass, or the universal form of Viṣṇu, is His external splendor, the *eka-pāda-vibhūti*; it is connected with *māyā*, or *prakṛti*, and is therefore material. To think the *catur-vyūha*, the Lord of spirit and matter, equal to it, or to strive to make it so, is the trait of the *māyāvādīs*.

(4) In reply to the commentary on *sūtra* 45 — a paraphrase of the words quoted in the *Laghu-bhāgavatāmṛta* in describing the transcendence of Bhagavān's qualities (97–99): “If you say, ‘Every quality is a product of *prakṛti* and therefore like a mirage; what wonder, then, that they cannot be counted?’ — you have no right to say so. Bhagavān's qualities can never be material: all His qualities constitute His very nature, and so all of them are certainly, by nature, bliss. As in the *Brahma-tarka*: ‘Bhagavān Hari possesses qualities that constitute His own nature; therefore the qualities of Viṣṇu and of liberated *jīvas* are never separate from their nature.’ In the *Śrī Viṣṇu Purāṇa*: ‘May Hari be gracious — the supreme, utterly pure, original Puruṣa, the Supreme Lord untouched by the material qualities such as *sattva*.’ And in that same *Viṣṇu Purāṇa*: ‘Knowledge, power, strength, sovereignty, valor and splendor in their fullness — without the *heya*, that is, material, qualities — are what the word *bhagavat*

denotes.' And in the *Padma Purāṇa*: 'That the Supreme Lord is glorified in scripture as *nirguṇa* (without qualities) means only that He has no *heya*, that is, material, qualities.' And in the first chapter of the first canto: 'O Dharma, the qualities I have listed, and many other great qualities, abide eternally in Śrī Kṛṣṇa; the qualities sought by those who desire greatness never leave Śrī Kṛṣṇa.'[19] Thus this Śrī Kṛṣṇa possesses countless transcendental qualities and boundless potency, and His form is a mass of complete bliss." See *Bhāgavatam* 3.26.21, 25, 27, 28.

A paraphrase of how Śrī Rāmānujapāda refuted Śaṅkara's arguments in his *Śrī-bhāṣya*:

Śrī Śaṅkara rejected certain parts even of the *Pañcarātra* scripture, spoken by Bhagavān and leading to the highest good: he suspected that, like the scriptures of Kapila and others, they contradict *śruti* and are therefore not authoritative. The *Pañcarātra* scripture says: "From Vāsudeva, the supreme cause, whose nature is Brahman, was born the *jīva* named 'Saṅkarṣaṇa'; from Saṅkarṣaṇa, the mind named 'Pradyumna'; and from the mind, the *ahaṅkāra* named 'Aniruddha.'" [The objection is:] one cannot speak here of the birth of the *jīva*, for that contradicts *śruti*. With the words "The spiritual *jīvātmā* is never born and never dies" (*Kaṭha Upaniṣad* 2.18), all the *śrutis* speak of the *jīva* as beginningless, that is, as unborn. Therefore what is meant here is the appearance of the presiding deities of the *jīva*, the mind and the *ahaṅkāra* (*sūtra* 42).

It is said that from Saṅkarṣaṇa the mind named Pradyumna is born. Here too it is impossible for the instrument, the mind, to be born from the agent, the *jīva*, for *śruti* says that "the vital breath, the mind and all the senses are born from the Paramātmā." If, then, the mind is said to be born from the *jīva*, this contradicts such words of *śruti* as "they are born from the Paramātmā." Therefore, since this statement establishes a meaning contrary to *śruti*, its authority is rejected (*sūtra* 43).

[The answer is:] Saṅkarṣaṇa, Pradyumna and Aniruddha have the nature of the Supreme Brahman, and therefore the authority of the scripture that teaches this can never be rejected. That is, these *vyūhas* — Saṅkarṣaṇa and the others — are by no means meant to be like ordinary *jīvas*, liable to fall under the sway of *māyā*: all of Them are Lords, all possess the six opulences — knowledge, sovereignty, power, strength, valor, splendor and the rest. Therefore the *Pañcarātra* doctrine is not without authority. Only those unversed in the *Pañcarātra*, or the Bhāgavata doctrine, could say such unscriptural things as "it

speaks of the birth of the *jīva*, and that is a contradiction." The Bhāgavata doctrine is this. He who loves the devotees who have taken shelter of Him, and who is called the Supreme Brahman named Vāsudeva, by His own will abides in four ways, so that those who seek His shelter may approach Him. Thus the *Pauṣkara-saṁhitā* says: "The scripture in which *brāhmaṇas*, as is their duty, worship the *cāturātmya* (the *catur-vyūha*), calling It by names handed down in succession — that is the '*āgama*.'" And the *Sātvata-saṁhitā* says that the worship of this *cāturātmya* is worship of the Supreme Brahman named Vāsudeva. The Supreme Brahman named Vāsudeva, whose body is the fullness of the six opulences, is divided [into forms] as *sūkṣma*, *vyūha* and *vibhava*. The devotees, each according to his qualification (*adhikāra*), worship Him by acts informed by knowledge, and so fully attain Him. By worshipping the *vibhavas* — Nṛsiṁha, Raghunātha, or the avatāras Matsya, Kūrma and others — one attains the *vyūhas*, Saṅkarṣaṇa and the others; and by worshipping the *vyūhas* one attains the Supreme Brahman named Vāsudeva. For the *Pauṣkara-saṁhitā* says: "By this scripture, through acts informed by knowledge, one attains the unmanifest Supreme Brahman named Vāsudeva." Hence it is established that Saṅkarṣaṇa and the others too are the Supreme Brahman, for They too have forms by Their own will. The *śrutis* declare: "He, without being born as material things are born, descends, that is, appears, in many forms." Out of love for those who have taken shelter of Him He accepts form by His own will, and so the authority of the *Pañcarātra* scripture, which teaches this, is not rejected. In this scripture Saṅkarṣaṇa, Pradyumna and Aniruddha are the presiding deities of, respectively, the *jīva*, the mind and the *ahaṅkāra*; therefore there is no contradiction in Their being called by the words "*jīva*" and so on. In the same way Brahman is called by the words "*ākāśa*," "*prāṇa*" and so on (*sūtra* 44).

In this scripture the birth of the *jīva* is denied. For the *Parama-saṁhitā* says: "The three *guṇas* — unconscious, serving another's purpose, always subject to change — are the field of those who perform *karma*: such is the form of *prakṛti*. The Puruṣa's connection with it is by way of pervasion, and that this connection is beginningless is also true." Thus in all the *saṁhitās* the "*jīva*" is eternal, and therefore the *Pañcarātra* doctrine denies its birth. Whatever is born must perish: accepting the birth of the *jīva*, one would have to accept its destruction as well. But since the *jīva* is eternal, its birth is excluded of itself, by its eternity. Above, the *Parama-saṁhitā* said: "the form of *prakṛti* is always subject to change"; so birth, destruction and the like should be understood as

included in this “constant change.” Thus Śaṅkarācārya's charge that Saṅkarṣaṇa and the others are born as *jīvas* has been refuted (*sūtra* 45). See Śrīdhara [Svāmī]'s commentary on *Bhāgavatam* 3.1.34.

49 Thus I have briefly explained the eighth verse. Now hear attentively the meaning of the ninth.

The meaning of the ninth of the fourteen opening verses —

50 “I take refuge in Śrī Nityānanda Rāma. A part of Him is the original Lord, the Puruṣa, the master of māyā, who lies in person in the midst of the Causal Ocean, His body the shelter of countless universes.” (diary of Svarūpa Dāmodara)[4]

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

I bow down to Nityānanda-Rāma, one part of whom is the master of *māyā*, Kāraṇābdhiśāyī, the shelter of the host of universes, the first deity, the Puruṣa-avatāra.

Anubhāṣya.

sākṣāt māyā-bhartā (the very master of *māyā*, her Lord) **ajāṇḍa-saṅghāśrayāṅgaḥ** (He whose body is the shelter of the host of universes: *ajāṇḍa*, universes; *saṅgha*, host) **kāraṇāmbhodhi-madhye** (upon the waters of the Causal Ocean) **śete** (lies) (He) — **śrī-pumān ādi-devaḥ** (the first Puruṣa-avatāra), **yasya** (of Śrī Nityānanda) **ekāṁśaḥ** (one part); **taṁ śrī-nityānanda-rāmaṁ** (to that Śrī Nityānanda-Rāma) (I) **prapadye** (surrender).

Description of the Causal Waters —

51 Outside Vaikuṇṭha is the luminous abode, and beyond it lies what is called the Kāraṇārṇava, the Causal Ocean.

The Causal Ocean at the border of Paravyoma —

52 Encircling Vaikuṇṭha is an ocean, endless and shoreless; it has no bound.

Anubhāṣya.

Jalanidhi (ocean): the "Virajā," or the "Causal Waters" (see Madhya 15.175–176; Madhya 20.268–269; and Madhya 21.52).

*The great elements and all else in Vaikuṇṭha are beyond *māyā* —*

53 In Vaikuṇṭha earth and all the elements are spiritual; material elements never arise there.

Anubhāṣya.
Māyika bhūta (the elements of *māyā*): the five great elements, earth and the rest.

The spiritual nature of the Causal Waters —

54 That spiritual water is the supreme cause; a single drop of it is the Gaṅgā, purifier of the fallen.

Anubhāṣya.
Kāraṇa (cause): although it is a designation (*upādhi*) connected with *māyā*, in reality it is free of *rajas* and *tamas* mixed with *sattva*; that is, it consists of *sattva*. See Ādi 2.53.

Saṅkarṣaṇa of Paravyoma, in one part of Himself, is Kāraṇārṇavaśāyī —

55 In that Causal Ocean the same Saṅkarṣaṇa lies in the form of one of His parts.

*He is the first Puruṣa-avatāra, the one who glances at *māyā* —*

56 He is the Puruṣa, creator of the *mahat-tattva*, the cause of the world. This first avatāra casts His glance upon māyā.

**Māyā* does not touch the Causal Ocean —*

57 The potency māyā stays outside the Causal Ocean; māyā cannot touch its waters.

*The two forms of *māyā*, "*pradhāna*" and "*prakṛti*" —*

58 That māyā exists in two ways; as the material cause of the world it is called *pradhāna* or *prakṛti*.

Anubhāṣya.

"*Pradhāna*" and "*prakṛti*": see Madhya 20.271. Śrī Jīva Prabhu writes in the *Paramātma-sandarbha* (section 49):

"This *māyā* has two portions. One is the efficient portion (*nimitta*): it consists of the *guṇas* and is called *māyā*. The other is the material portion (*upādāna*): it is substance and is called *pradhāna*. The difference between them is described in four verses (*Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 11.24.1–4). … (section 53) Elsewhere (*Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 10.63.26) the differences between these two, the material and the efficient, are also stated according to the difference in their functions: 'Time, destiny, *karma*, the *jīva*, his nature, the subtle elements, the field, the vital air, the ego, the transformations, their aggregate, and the flow like seed and sprout — this is Your *māyā*. I take shelter of You, the limit of its negation.' Here time, destiny, *karma* and nature are efficient portions; the rest are material portions. The *jīva*, who possesses them, is of a dual nature: thus a particle of the efficient potency is present within the material class as well. … (section 55) The potency well known by the name *māyā*, as the efficient portion, is seen to be threefold: knowledge, desire and action. … Now the characteristic of *pradhāna*, the material portion (*Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 3.26.10): 'That which is made of the three *guṇas*, unmanifest, eternal, consisting of cause and effect, without distinctions and yet containing distinctions, they call *pradhāna* and *prakṛti*.' That which is made of the three *guṇas* — the combination of the three *guṇas*, *sattva* and the others — is what they call the unmanifest, *pradhāna* and *prakṛti*. Why is it called unmanifest? It is 'without distinctions': the three *guṇas* are in balance in it, so its distinctions are not manifest; hence one understands why it is also called *avyākṛta*, the undeveloped. Why is it called *pradhāna*? It 'contains distinctions': the *mahat* and the other distinctions are effects of its own portions, and it is their shelter and therefore superior (*śreṣṭha*) to them. … The efficient portion is *māyā*; the material portion is *pradhāna*."

Bhagavān's external potency, *māyā*, has two portions: the efficient portion, "*māyā* made of the *guṇas*," and the material portion, "*pradhāna* made of substance." The mutual difference between these two names is described in four verses of the twenty-fourth chapter of the eleventh canto of the *Bhāgavatam*.

Elsewhere, in the twenty-sixth verse of the sixty-third chapter of the tenth canto, the two portions — material and efficient — are divided according to the difference in their functions: “O Bhagavān! Agitating ‘time,’ efficient ‘*karma*,’ ‘destiny,’ which brings forth the fruits, and its impression, ‘nature’ (*svabhāva*) — this is the conditioned *jīva*, marked by these four efficient portions of *māyā*. The subtle elements are ‘substance’; *prakṛti* is the ‘field’; the *sūtra* is the ‘vital air’; *ahaṅkāra* is the ‘self’; and the eleven senses and earth, water, fire, air and ether are the sixteen transformations; their total aggregate is the ‘body.’ From the body comes *karma* as a seed, and from *karma* the body as a sprout: this endless flow is ‘*māyā*.’ O Prabhu, You are the Truth at which all this is negated; You I worship.” “Although the *jīva* is a particle of the efficient potency, he possesses portions of both natures and so follows the material class as well.” The potency known by the word “*māyā*,” the efficient portion, has three divisions: “knowledge,” “desire” and “action.” The characteristic of “*pradhāna*,” the material portion: “That in which the three *guṇas* — *sattva*, *rajas* and *tamas* — are combined is called ‘the unmanifest,’ ‘*pradhāna*’ and ‘*prakṛti*.’ The reason for the name ‘unmanifest’ is this: it is without distinctions — the three *guṇas* are in balance in it — so its distinctive qualities are not manifest; therefore *pradhāna* also received the name *avyākṛta*. The reason for the name ‘*pradhāna*’: the *mahat-tattva* and the other distinctions are *māyā*'s own effects, and she, like a distinct object, is their shelter and is therefore superior to them.” … In the efficient portion, “*māyā*”; in the material portion, “*pradhāna*.”

**Māyā*, made of the *guṇas*, is never the chief cause of the world —*

59 Inert prakṛti is not the cause of the world; Kṛṣṇa shows her mercy by infusing her with His potency.

*By the power of Bhagavān's glance *prakṛti* becomes the secondary cause of the world —*

60 By Kṛṣṇa’s potency prakṛti becomes a secondary cause, just as iron burns by the power of fire.

Bhagavān is the original cause of the world —

61 Therefore Kṛṣṇa is the original cause of the world. To call prakṛti the cause is like taking the teats on a goat's neck for an udder.

Anubhāṣya.

See Madhya 20.259–261. The external potency, *māyā*, is known in the material portion of the world by the names "*pradhāna*" and "*prakṛti*," and in the efficient portion of the world by the name "*māyā*." Inert *prakṛti* is not the cause of the world. For Kṛṣṇa, as Kāraṇārṇavaśāyī Mahā-Viṣṇu, grants *prakṛti* the material, substantial potency and so infuses her with power. The example is red-hot iron. Iron has no "power" to burn or give heat, but touched by fire, red-hot iron can burn and heat other things. In the same way inert *prakṛti*, which is like iron, has no independent capacity to be the substance or the material cause. Only when the glance-potency of Kāraṇodakaśāyī, who is like fire, is infused into her does iron-like *prakṛti*, a mere likeness of the material cause, acquire the power to burn and give heat. To regard *prakṛti*, known as the material, as the material cause of the world is therefore sheer delusion. Śrī Kapiladeva also says: "As the firebrand, the sparks and the smoke are born of the fire itself and are thought of as one with it, yet the fire is distinct from the firebrand…" (*Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 3.28.40) Smoke, the burning log and the sparks contain the substance of fire, and so they are spoken of as one with fire; nevertheless fire is something distinct from the firebrand. "The elements," like the smoke, "the *jīva*," like the sparks, and "*pradhāna*," like the firebrand — all of them receive their powers from Bhagavān, who is like the fire, the substance of everything, and so each displays its own separate identity. Even so, the substance of them all is Bhagavān. "*Pradhāna*" is held to be the material of the world, but it appears as such only through the substance Bhagavān has placed in it. "*Pradhāna*" cannot be an independent material cause separate from Bhagavān. To forget Kṛṣṇa, the root shelter of all material causes, and to ascribe that role to the *prakṛti* of Sāṅkhya is as fruitless as expecting milk from the teat-like lumps of flesh on a goat's neck.

Śrī Nārāyaṇa is the efficient cause —

62 In her aspect as māyā I call her the efficient cause of the world; but even that is not so, for the true maker and cause is Nārāyaṇa.

The original Director is Bhagavān, the all-pervading Consciousness —

63 As the potter is the efficient cause of the pot, so the Puruṣa-avatāra is the maker of the world.

*Kṛṣṇa creates the world through *māyā* —*

64 Kṛṣṇa is the maker, and māyā only helps Him, as the wheel, the stick and other tools are causes of the pot.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Beyond the abode of Paravyoma lies the effulgent "abode of Brahman," and beyond that the "Causal Ocean" (*Kāraṇa-samudra*). The spiritual world is free of causes, while *māyā* is full of them. The region between the two is called the "Causal Ocean," an ocean of spiritual water. For the glance of Bhagavān, who lies upon that water, is directed toward *māyā* beyond it, and it carries out creation and the other acts. Kṛṣṇa and the Lord of Paravyoma are Themselves free of creation and such acts, and no act connected with *māyā* takes place in Their *svarūpa*. Mahā-Saṅkarṣaṇa, by a portion of Himself — His glance (*īkṣaṇa*) — lies in that ocean and creates the *mahat-tattva*; He is the first avatāra. *Māyā-śakti* stays outside the Causal Ocean, and Bhagavān casts His glance upon her. *Māyā* cannot touch the Causal Ocean. Bhagavān's glance enters *māyā* and makes her active. *Māyā* exists in two forms: as "*pradhāna*," the material cause of the world, and as "*māyā*," its efficient cause. *Prakṛti* is in truth inert. But when the power of Bhagavān's glance is infused into her, by that power *prakṛti* becomes the "secondary cause" of creating the world — just as fire, entering iron, gives it the power to burn. Kṛṣṇa, therefore, is the original cause of the world, and *prakṛti*'s being its substantial cause is like the nipples on a goat's neck. *Māyā* in her portion — that is, the portion made of the *guṇas* — is called the efficient cause; yet even then the efficient cause is Nārāyaṇa. When a pot is made, the wheel, the rod and the like, as well as the potter, are its efficient causes. Nārāyaṇa is the efficient cause in the potter's place (the chief one), and *māyā* the efficient cause in the place of the wheel and rod (the secondary one). So, just as without a potter there is no pot, without Nārāyaṇa there is no world. The efficient cause made of the *guṇas*, in the place of the wheel and rod, works as the helper of Nārāyaṇa, the root efficient cause.

*Kāraṇābdhiśāyī glances at *māyā* and brings the *jīvas* into manifestation —*

65 From afar the Puruṣa glances upon māyā and places in her the seed — the jīvas.

*By a semblance of His body He touches *māyā*, and so Bhagavān Himself is the material cause —*

66 By a mere semblance of His body He unites with māyā, and from māyā the hosts of universes are then born.

Anubhāṣya.

In the Vedic view, the world is created only by the joining of potency that comes from the Reality itself, and in that form it appears before the conditioned *jīva*. In the non-Vedic view, the visible world is born of *prakṛti*. The potency of the Reality works in three ways: as *cit*, as *acit*, and as a potency that partakes of both. Some, following a path foreign to the Śrutis, think that the world arose from inert *prakṛti*; the Vedas do not accept that view. The Reality, Bhagavān, is nondifferent from His spiritual potency. When the *cit-śakti* is infused into the *acit* potency, a temporary, perishable semblance of spiritual being appears. Bhagavān's *jīva-śakti*, called *taṭasthā*, combines *cit* and *acit*. It is eternally subordinate to the spiritual potency, yet from time without beginning it is liable to wander in the visible world, the transformation of the *acit* potency. Cut off from the Reality, the *jīva* misuses pure spirit, and this gradually becomes his experience of bondage. In truth, once the *jīva* knows his own *svarūpa*, he can understand that readiness to serve is the ground of his eternal highest good. When he turns away from service, this potency called *taṭasthā* imagines itself the possessor of potency and sets out to enjoy. To become masters of *acit*, his senses begin to act against the purely spiritual potency. Only Kṛṣṇa's own potency gives power to His *acit* potency, which is of a different nature (*vijātīya*). An example: fire and its power to burn, infused into iron that has no fire, display the iron as fire. In truth the *acit* potency gains its activity only from Kṛṣṇa's *cit-śakti*. The *taṭasthā jīva*, driven by the *acit* potency, thinks that the visible material world is born of *prakṛti*. But the liberated *jīva*, situated in pure spirit, can understand that the *cit-śakti* of the Possessor of potency imparts a share of strength to the *acit* potency and so makes it active. *Prakṛti*, the root cause of

the *acit* potency, brings with it every kind of undesirability, limitation and inferiority. A *jīva* who follows reasoning in the conceit of his bondage sees the goat's milk-giving udder and yet vainly seeks milk from the teat-like growths on her neck. Equally foolish is it to call *prakṛti*, whose root is *acit*, the cause of the material world. Bhagavān's *acit* potency, "*māyā*," appears before the *jīva* who is averse to Hari as the "efficient" and the "material" cause and turns him away from accepting the true Reality. When knowledge of his *svarūpa* dawns, the *jīva* notices the twofold action of the *acit* potency: "covering" (*āvaraṇī*) and "projecting" (*vikṣepātmikā*). A thing such as a pot has a twofold cause: the potter is the efficient cause, while the clay, the wheel, the rod and the like are the material cause and the instruments. In the same way, when one considers the Reality, the controller of the visible world and its elements is shown to be the Possessor of potency (*śaktimat-tattva*). If, however, one considers the potencies separately, *māyā*, made of the three *guṇas*, governs the elements — the material portion — through the *guṇas*. The *taṭasthā-śakti*, the *jīva*, turning away from Hari in this visible world, takes on the role of enjoyer. That the Reality is perceived in the visible world as *acit* is merely the fruit of aversion to Kṛṣṇa. The perception of *acit* displays enjoyment, that is, devotion to the senses. But in perceiving Bhagavān with readiness to serve, the *jīva* sees his own relationship with Him. Kṛṣṇa is the cause of the eternal spiritual world. He is also the cause of the world of *acit*, whose truth is covered, and He is the root cause and ordainer of the *jīva* called *taṭasthā*. The perception of *acit* is the work of Bhagavān's external potency, and the perception of *cit* is the work of His internal potency. From the word born of spiritual perception we can learn that every attribute of independent agency and of being the source of all is established in the Reality, Bhagavān. That Reality is the Great (*Bṛhat*), and His minute fragments are what the word "*jīva*" denotes. The Reality, Bhagavān, though divided, does not display the quality of fragmentation; and fragmented perception is never identical with undivided perception. In terms of pervaded and pervader, Brahman and the *jīva* are of the same kind. Yet the Lord is the master of *māyā*, while the dependent is subject to *māyā*. But when one who is subject to *māyā* becomes subject to the Lord of *māyā*, his subjection to *māyā* can no longer remain.

Anubhāṣya.

See Madhya 20.271–273 and *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 3.5.26 and 3.26.18.

The fruit of Kāraṇārṇavaśāyī's glance —

67 Into all those countless, endless universes the Puruṣa enters, taking as many forms.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
The Kāraṇābdhiśāyī Puruṣa casts His glance upon *māyā* from afar. That glance, by nature a fruit of *cit*, acts in two ways. As particles of His rays He places countless *jīvas* within *māyā*, and Himself, uniting with *māyā* by a semblance of His body (*aṅgābhāsa*), creates countless universes. He enters each of them in the form of a Puruṣa. "*Aṅgābhāsa*" means a mere semblance of bodily contact; in truth there is no contact of His body.

With His exhalation and inhalation the universes are created and dissolved —

68 When the breath goes out of the Puruṣa's nostrils, the universes become manifest with His exhalation.

69 And when the breath enters again, the universes enter the Puruṣa's body with it.

In His bodily pores are countless universes —

70 As specks of dust move through the holes of a lattice window, so hosts of universes move through the pores of the Puruṣa's skin.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
Trasareṇu: six *paramāṇus* (the finest particles) make one *trasareṇu*.

Anubhāṣya.
See Madhya 20.277–280.

*(*Brahma-saṁhitā*, Chapter 5, verse 48) —*

71 "The lords of the universes, born from His pores, abide for the span of one of His breaths. That Mahā-Viṣṇu is a particular kalā of Govinda, the original Person, whom I worship." (Brahma-saṁhitā, 5.48)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

I worship the original Person Govinda, whose *kalā* is that Mahā-Viṣṇu from whose bodily pores all the lords of the universes are born and live for the span of one of His exhalations.

Anubhāṣya.

atha yasya loma-vila-jāḥ (born from the bodily pores) **jagad-aṇḍa-nāthāḥ** (the lords of the universes — the aggregate Viṣṇu and others) **eka-niśvasita-kālam** (a time equal to one exhalation) **avalambya** (resorting to) **iha jīvanti** (remain manifest), **saḥ mahān viṣṇuḥ** (that Mahā-Viṣṇu) is **yasya** (Govinda's) **kalā-viśeṣaḥ** (particular *kalā*); **tam ādi-puruṣaṁ govindam ahaṁ bhajāmi** (that original Person, Govinda, I worship).

*(*Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam*, Canto 10, Chapter 14, verse 11)*

72 "Where am I, a creature with a body seven spans tall, enclosed in the pot of a universe wrapped in prakṛti, the mahat, false ego, ether, air, fire, water and earth? And where is Your greatness, when countless such universes drift like atoms through the pores of Your skin, as through the openings of a lattice?" (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 10.14.11)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Where am I, enclosed in this body made of *prakṛti*, the *mahat-tattva*, *ahaṅkāra* and the five elements and measuring seven spans? And where is Your greatness, such that all the universes, like the finest particles, wander through the openings of Your bodily pores? That is, my body — the universe — is nothing compared with Your greatness.

Anubhāṣya.

After stealing the calves, Brahmā prayed to atone for his offense. This is one of those prayers:

tamo-mahad-ahaṁ-kha-carāgni-vār-bhū-saṁveṣṭitāṇḍa-ghaṭa-sapta-vitasti-kāyaḥ (*tamaḥ*, the unmanifest; *mahat*, the *mahat-tattva*; *aham*, *ahaṅkāra*; *kha*, ether; *cara*, air; *agni*, fire; *vāḥ*, water; *bhū*, earth; the *aṇḍa-ghaṭa*, the pot of the universe, enclosed by all these from *pradhāna* to earth, is the body, and within it is one whose body, by his own measure, is seven spans) **ahaṁ kva** (where am I?) **īdṛg-vidhāvigaṇitāṇḍa-parāṇu-caryā-vātādhva-roma-vivarasya** (of Him whose bodily pores are like windows [*vātādhva*, window] through which wander countless universes like this one, which are

themselves the finest particles) **te** (Your) **mahitvaṁ ca kva** (and where is the greatness?).

*The relationship of *mūla-Saṅkarṣaṇa*, Mahā-Saṅkarṣaṇa and the three Puruṣas —*

73 A part of a part is called a *kalā*. Śrī Balarāma is Govinda's second body.

Anubhāṣya.
Pratimūrti (image): the second body (Ādi 5.4–5; Madhya 20.174).

74 One of His forms is Śrī Mahā-Saṅkarṣaṇa, and Mahā-Saṅkarṣaṇa's part, the Puruṣa, is counted as a *kalā*.

75 He whom I call a kalā is Mahā-Viṣṇu. He is the source of the Puruṣa-avatāras, ever victorious.

Anubhāṣya.
The words "Mahā-Viṣṇu" and "Mahāpuruṣāvatārī" (the source of the Puruṣa-avatāras) refer to Kāraṇārṇavaśāyī.

76 The Lords who lie in the Garbha and Kṣīra oceans are both called Puruṣas, and He whose parts They are is Viṣṇu, the abode of all the universes.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
Balarāma, the *vilāsa-mūrti* of Kṛṣṇa, is *mūla-Saṅkarṣaṇa*, the original Saṅkarṣaṇa. A portion of His *svarūpa* in Paravyoma is Saṅkarṣaṇa. His portion is Kāraṇābdhiśāyī Mahā-Viṣṇu; He is a portion of a portion and is therefore called a "*kalā*." The two Puruṣas, Garbhodaśāyī and Kṣīrodaśāyī, are portions of Mahā-Viṣṇu.

Anubhāṣya.
The characteristic of the Puruṣa: the *Laghu-bhāgavatāmṛta*, in describing the avatāras (section 4), paraphrases a verse of the *Viṣṇu Purāṇa* (6.8.59) quoted there: "I always bow down to that imperishable Puruṣa. He is a portion of Kṛṣṇa, Puruṣottama, who is free from the six kinds of change. He has contact with the

guṇas, that is, He glances at *prakṛti*, the *mahat* and the other material things. In truth He never gives up His one *svarūpa*, yet He divides into many portions of Himself and expands all living beings. He is pure, that is, free from contact with *māyā*, and yet He appears impure, as if in contact with *māyā*. And He is eternally spiritual." Śrī Rūpa's *kārikā* on this verse: "That portion of the Supreme Lord who seems to partake of the *guṇas* of *pradhāna*, who casts His glance upon it and performs the other acts, and who has many avatāras, is known as the Puruṣa." That is, the portion of the Supreme Lord who, as if in contact with the *guṇas* of *pradhāna*, glances at *prakṛti*, the *mahat-tattva* and the rest, and who manifests the various avatāras — that portion the scriptures call the "Puruṣa."

*(*Laghu-bhāgavatāmṛta*, *Pūrva-khaṇḍa*, Chapter 2, verse 9; words of the *Sātvata-tantra*)*

77 "Viṣṇu has three forms called Puruṣas: the first creates the mahat, the second abides within the universe, and the third dwells in all beings. Knowing Them, one is set free." (Sātvata-tantra; Laghu-bhāgavatāmṛta, Pūrva-khaṇḍa, 2.9)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

In the eternal abode Viṣṇu has three forms. The first is Kāraṇābdhiśāyī Mahā-Viṣṇu, the creator of the *mahat-tattva*. The second is Garbhodaśāyī, the Puruṣa within the aggregate universe. The third is Kṣīrodaśāyī, the Puruṣa within each individual universe; He is the indwelling Lord (*antaryāmī*) and the Paramātmā of every *jīva*. Whoever can know the truth of these three is freed from material intelligence.

Anubhāṣya.

viṣṇoḥ tu puruṣākhyāni trīṇi rūpāṇi viduḥ (Viṣṇu is known to have three forms called Puruṣas). Of them, **ekam** (the first) **tu mahataḥ** (of the *mahat-tattva*) **sraṣṭṛ** (the creator — the indwelling Lord of *prakṛti*), **dvitīyaṁ tu aṇḍa-saṁsthitam** (the second, who dwells in the universe, its indwelling Lord), **tṛtīyaṁ sarva-bhūta-stham** (the third, who dwells in all beings, the indwelling Lord of the *jīvas*). **tāni rūpāṇi jñātvā vimucyate** (knowing these forms, the knower is freed from the bonds of *māyā*).

Kāraṇārṇavaśāyī is the source of all the avatāras, beginning with Matsya —

78 Though I call Him a kalā of Kṛṣṇa, He is the source of Matsya, Kūrma and the other avatāras.

*(*Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam*, Canto 1, Chapter 3, verse 28)*

79 "All these (avatāras) are portions (*aṁśa*) and parts of portions (*kalā*) of the Puruṣa, but Kṛṣṇa is Bhagavān Himself. Age after age They bring happiness to the world when it is troubled by the enemies of Indra." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 1.3.28)[5]

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
See Ādi 2.67.

The work of the three Puruṣa-avatāras —

80 That Puruṣa creates, maintains and dissolves the world; He sends forth many avatāras and sustains the world.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
That Puruṣa-avatāra (as the protector of the world) is Kṣīrodaśāyī.

Anubhāṣya.
"He is the storehouse and the imperishable seed of the many avatāras; by portions of His portions the gods, animals, humans and others are created." (*Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 1.3.5) As Kāraṇābdhiśāyī He is the cause of creation, maintenance and dissolution; as Garbhodaśāyī, the abode where the many avatāras are born; and as Kṣīrodaśāyī, the Lord of the earth.

The avatāras are only portions —

81 The part that descends for creation and the rest I call by the name *avatāra*.

Anubhāṣya.
The *Laghu-bhāgavatāmṛta*, describing the characteristics of the avatāras (section 1), says: "When the forms mentioned before appear for the work of the universe, as if for the first time, either themselves or through another medium, they are then

called avatāras. That medium is either a *tad-ekātma-rūpa* or His devotee — like Śeṣaśāyī and others, or like Vasudeva and others." That is, when the original form mentioned before, Śrī Kṛṣṇa, appears for the work of the universe either Himself or through a medium, He is called an "avatāra." The medium is of two kinds: a *tad-ekātma-rūpa* and a devotee. Śeṣaśāyī is a *tad-ekātma-rūpa*, while Vasudeva and others are devotees. Śrī Baladeva's commentary: "'Themselves' means without a medium; 'through another medium' — if they appear in the world in either way, they are then called avatāras. Descent from what lies beyond the world into the world is indeed avatāra. Through a medium: as Garbhodakaśāyī from Śeṣaśāyī Kāraṇārṇavaśāyī, Kṛṣṇa from Vasudeva, Rāma from Daśaratha. 'The work': agitating *prakṛti* and producing the *mahat* and the rest; increasing the happiness of the gods and others by crushing the wicked; distributing the bliss of *prema* to *sādhakas* who long for Him by appearing before them Himself; and spreading pure devotion — such is the meaning of 'for the work.'"

In the realm of *māyā* everything is fragmented by differences of place, time and person, and actions there are fragmented. In those actions, in their efficient or material portion, one sees the causality of Bhagavān's *svarūpa*. The Godhood in the form of Mahā-Viṣṇu, the cause of those actions, is a portion of Kṛṣṇa. It is this portion that is called an "avatāra." Ordinarily, by gross vision and on the maxim of the lame and the blind, inert *prakṛti* is called the "material" cause and the enjoyer, the *puruṣa-jīva* made of the three *guṇas*, the "efficient" cause. But *prakṛti* is neither the "material" nor the "efficient" cause of the world; this the devotees (*bhāgavatas*) have subtly realized. By the power of His glance *prakṛti* is known as the "material" of the world, and *māyā* is famed as its "efficient agent"; both these potencies are given by Bhagavān Himself. Those manifestations of Bhagavān in which He displays the pastime of empowering *māyā* — to create the universe or for its welfare — those manifest forms are called "portions" or "avatāras." In truth the avatāras, who are likened to lamps, are Viṣṇu. But because they exercise authority over *māyā*, in the language of *māyā* they are merely called "portions" or "avatāras." See Madhya 20.263–264.

82 He is the first avatāra, the Mahā-Puruṣa, Bhagavān — the seed of all avatāras, the abode and shelter of all.

Anubhāṣya.

On Garbhodaśāyī, the seed of all avatāras, see *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 1.3.5.

83 "The Puruṣa is the first avatāra of the Supreme. Time, nature, prakṛti as cause and effect, the mind, the elements, false ego, the guṇas, the senses, the universal body (*virāṭ*) and the Vairāja (*svarāṭ*), and all beings, moving and unmoving — all these are the splendour of the Great One." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 2.6.42)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

The Kāraṇābdhiśāyī Puruṣa is the first avatāra of Bhagavān. Time, nature (*svabhāva*), *prakṛti* as cause and effect, the *mahat-tattva* — the mind and the rest, *ahaṅkāra* — the great elements and the rest, the *guṇas* — *sattva* and the others, the senses, the Virāṭ, the Svarāṭ, the unmoving and the moving — all these are His opulence (*vibhūti*).

In another reading these verses are also found[13]: "I [Brahmā], Bhava, Yajña, these lords of progeny headed by Dakṣa, you [Nārada] and others; the guardians of the heavenly worlds, of the worlds of birds, of the human world and of the lower worlds; the lords of the Gandharvas, Vidyādharas and Cāraṇas; the masters of the Yakṣas, Rākṣasas, serpents and Nāgas; the best of the sages and of the Pitṛs; the kings of the Daityas, the lords of the Siddhas and the kings of the Dānavas; and the others — the rulers of the *pretas*, *piśācas*, *bhūtas* and *kūṣmāṇḍas*, of aquatic creatures, beasts and birds; whatever in the world has greatness, splendor, strength of the senses, endurance, bodily might, forbearance, beauty, modesty, wealth, intelligence or wondrous color — whether it has form or is formless — [all this is] the supreme Truth."

Anubhāṣya.

Śrī Brahmā describes to Nārada the opulence of Bhagavān Kāraṇārṇavaśāyī:

parasya bhūmnaḥ (of Bhagavān) **puruṣaḥ** (Kāraṇārṇavaśāyī) is **ādyaḥ avatāraḥ** (the first avatāra). **kālaḥ** (time, the agitator of the *guṇas*), **svabhāvaḥ** (its impression), **sad-asat** (*prakṛti*, effect and cause), **manaḥ** (the *mahat-tattva*), **dravyam** (the subtle elements, the five great elements), **vikāraḥ** (*ahaṅkāra*), **guṇaḥ** (*sattva* and the others), **indriyāṇi** (the eleven), **virāṭ** (the aggregate body), **svarāṭ** (the Vairāja), **sthāsnu** (the unmoving), **cariṣṇu** (the moving, the individual body) **ca** (all are forms of His opulence).

*The creator of the *mahat-tattva*, the first Puruṣa-avatāra —*

84 "In the beginning, desiring to create the worlds, Bhagavān accepted the form of the Puruṣa, joined with the mahat and the other principles and possessed of sixteen potencies (*kalā*)." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 1.3.1)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Bhagavān, wishing to create the worlds, assumed the form called the Puruṣa, composed of the *mahat-tattva* and the rest and endowed with sixteen *kalās*.

Anubhāṣya.

Answering the five questions of the sages headed by Śaunaka, Sūta describes the avatāras of Bhagavān:

ādau (at the beginning of creation) **bhagavān** (Mahā-Saṅkarṣaṇa) **loka-sisṛkṣayā** (wishing to create the worlds) **mahad-ādibhiḥ** (with the *mahat-tattva*, *ahaṅkāra*, the five great elements, the eleven senses and the five *tanmātras*) **sambhūtam** (composed) **ṣoḍaśa-kalam** (endowed with the full complement of potencies needed for that creation) **pauruṣaṁ rūpaṁ jagṛhe** (manifested the form of the Puruṣa).

Ṣoḍaśa-kalam (endowed with sixteen *kalās*): the *Laghu-bhāgavatāmṛta*, describing the Puruṣa (section 68), says: "Śrī, Bhū, Kīrti, Ilā, Līlā, Kānti and Vidyā — these seven — and the nine headed by Vimalā: these are the sixteen chief potencies." Śrī Baladeva comments on this: "Vimalā, Utkarṣiṇī, Jñānā, Kriyā, Yogā, and also Prahvī, Satyā, Īśānā and Anugrahā — these are known as the nine." In the *Bhagavat-sandarbha* (section 102): "He is served by Śrī, Puṣṭi, Gīr, Kānti, Kīrti, Tuṣṭi, Ilā, Ūrjā, Vidyā, Avidyā, Śakti and Māyā."[20] "One should also know Sandhinī, Saṁvit, Hlādinī, Bhakti, Ādhāra-śakti, Mūrti, Vimalā, Jayā, Yogā, Prahvī, Īśā, Anugraha and others. Therefore in the verse '*Śriyā*…' and the like one should everywhere understand two kinds of powers: some are functions of the *śakti*, others are functions of *māyā*. The varieties of the first are the opulence of Bhagavān; the varieties of the second are the opulence of the world. … Here Ilā indicates Bhū, and through her Līlā as well. Sandhinī is Satyā, Jayā is Utkarṣiṇī, Yogā is *yogamāyā*, and Saṁvit is the Jñānājñāna-śakti and *śuddha-sattva*; so it should be understood. The difference between Prahvī and Īśānā is this: Prahvī is the source of wondrous, unlimited capacity, and Īśānā the source of the power of sovereignty over all."

1) Śrī, 2) Bhū, 3) Līlā, 4) Kānti, 5) Kīrti, 6) Tuṣṭi, 7) Gīḥ, 8) Puṣṭi, 9) Satyā, 10) Jñānājñānā, 11) Jayā-Utkarṣiṇī, 12) Vimalā, 13) Yogamāyā, 14) Prahvī, 15) Īśānā and 16) Anugrahā — these sixteen potencies are present in Vaikuṇṭha. See the *Bhāgavata-tātparya* of Śrī Madhva, included in the *Gauḍīya-bhāṣya* on *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam*, and the *Tathya* section there.

The shelter of all and the indwelling Lord —

85 He is the shelter of all, and the world rests in Him; as the Supersoul He is the support of the world.

Anubhāṣya.
See Madhya 20.282.

*Though related to *māyā* in His glance and other acts, He is in truth beyond *māyā* —*

86 He has a twofold relation with prakṛti, and yet there is not even a trace of contact between Him and prakṛti.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
He is the shelter of all, and *saṁsāra* abides in Him; yet as the indwelling Self (*antarātmā*) He is the support of the world. Although He has these two kinds of relation with *prakṛti*, He accepts no fault from contact with *prakṛti*.

Anubhāṣya.
In the *Laghu-bhāgavatāmṛta*, where Viṣṇu's freedom from the *guṇas* is described, Śrī Rūpa's *kārikā* is given: “Relation with the *guṇas* as their controller is called *yoga*. Therefore He who is the Supreme's own portion is not bound up with them.” That is, Viṣṇu's relation with the *guṇas* as their controller is called *yoga*. That Puruṣa, therefore, is never bound by the *guṇas*. Still less is any of the Viṣṇus — His own portions, in truth nondifferent from the Supreme Person — ever in any way joined with the *guṇas*. Śrī Baladeva's commentary: “But how can the Supreme Person have a relation with the *guṇas*? That contradicts such statements as ‘*māyā*, abashed, withdraws from His sight’ (*Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 2.7.47). To this the word *yoga* replies. The *guṇas* are the controlled, and the Puruṣa who appears in three ways is the controller: such is the relation, and here it is called *yoga*, not bondage. And He is not joined with

them, for in the words of Drumila, lord of *yogīs* (*Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 11.4.5), no relation with the *guṇas* is mentioned."

"If you say: is not a relation of Mahā-Viṣṇu with the *guṇas* established? For then it would contradict the words '*māyā*, abashed, stands turned away from Bhagavān.' The answer is this: the word '*guṇa*' means 'the controlled.' The Puruṣa who appears in three forms — Viṣṇu, Brahmā and Śiva — is related to *prakṛti* as her controller. In the world this is called *yoga*; it is never denoted by the word 'bondage' by those three *guṇas*. That Viṣṇu is never joined with the *guṇas*, for in the words of Drumila, one of the nine Yogendras, no relation of the three *guṇas* with Viṣṇu is mentioned at all."

With both kinds of cause — material and efficient — He is related as the one who glances; yet *māyā* can in no way overpower Him. The world with all its transformations is a transformation of Bhagavān's potency of desire (*icchā-śakti*), but in Him no material transformation is possible. See Ādi 2.52, 54.

*(*Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam*, Canto 1, Chapter 11, verse 38)*

87 "This is the lordship of the Lord: though He abides within material nature, He is never affected by its qualities — just as the intelligence of those who have taken shelter of Him is not affected." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 1.11.38)[6]

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
See Ādi 2.55.

*The Lord (*Īśvara*) possesses inconceivable potency —*

88 So the Gītā too declares again and again that the truth of the Lord is always endowed with inconceivable potency:

The world's relation with the Lord — difference and nondifference —

89 "I abide in the world, and the world is in Me; and yet I do not abide in the world, nor is the world in Me.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

I abide in the world, and the world abides in Me; and yet I am not in the world, and the world is not in Me. This is called the “inconceivable meaning.”

Anubhāṣya.

Without Bhagavān's existence the visible world can have no foundation at all. The world rests in Bhagavān; but one must not therefore take the external perception — the vision of *acit*, full of enjoyment — to be Bhagavān, nor regard the world of enjoyment as Godhood. Enjoyment, that is, aversion to Bhagavān — in other words, *māyā* — does not rest in Bhagavān: in the Reality, Bhagavān, aversion to Bhagavān can have no place. Bhagavān Adhokṣaja descends into the world, into the phenomenal realm (*prapañca*), and yet He does not become, and cannot become, a fragmented and perishable thing of this world. In both His manifest and unmanifest pastimes He is eternally beyond *māyā* and eternally her master — that is, His nature as the *nirguṇa* Vaikuṇṭha is eternally present. Through various pastimes He descends into the world and remains the original presiding deity of everything that exists in the world.

Nor can the world exist as a second reality, with a being separate from Him. Viṣṇu Himself never comes into contact with the material world or with *māyā*. Neither His own *svarūpa* nor His opulence of the same nature (*tad-rūpa-vaibhava*) belongs in the least to the measurable world of enjoyment or to *prakṛti*, which is turned away from Him. This is the independent sovereignty and the Godhood of Bhagavān, who acts by His own will and is full of inconceivable majesty.

See the *Gauḍīya-bhāṣya*, with its various commentaries, on the verse “*yathā mahānti*” (34), one of the *catuḥ-ślokī* in the ninth chapter of the second canto of *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam*, and also *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 11.15.36.

90 Know this to be My inconceivable power.” Such is the meaning the Gītā proclaims.

Anubhāṣya.

The *Gītā* (9.4–5) says: “By Me, in My unmanifest form, this whole world is pervaded. All beings rest in Me, but I do not rest in them. And yet beings do not rest in Me — behold My divine *yoga*! My Self sustains beings and brings them into being, yet does not abide in beings.”

91 He of whom that Puruṣa is called a part is Nityānanda-Rāma, the companion of Caitanya.

92 Such is the explanation of the ninth verse. Now hear attentively the meaning of the tenth.

The meaning of the tenth of the fourteen opening verses —

93 "I take refuge in Śrī Nityānanda Rāma. A part of His part is the blessed Garbhodakaśāyī, whose navel-lotus, with all the worlds as its stem, is the birthplace of Brahmā, the creator of the worlds." (diary of Svarūpa Dāmodara)[7]

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
I bow down to Nityānanda-Rāma, a portion of whose portion is Garbhodaśāyī. The stem of the lotus that grows from Garbhodaśāyī's navel is the birthplace of Vidhātā, who beholds the worlds[14], and the resting place of all the worlds.

Anubhāṣya.
yan-nābhy-abjam (the lotus that grows from whose navel), **loka-saṅghāta-nālam** (whose stem, that is, support, is the host of worlds, the fourteen worlds), is **loka-sraṣṭuḥ** (Brahmā's) **sūtikā-dhāma** (birthplace); **śrīla-garbhoda-śāyī** (the second Puruṣa-avatāra) is **yasya** (Nityānanda-Rāma's) **aṁśāṁśaḥ** (portion of a portion, *kalā*); **taṁ śrī-nityānanda-rāmam ahaṁ prapadye** (to that Śrī Nityānanda-Rāma I surrender).

Description of Garbhodaśāyī —

94 Having created endless universes, that Puruṣa entered them all, becoming many forms.

95 Entering, He saw only darkness everywhere, and finding no place to stay, He reflected.

96 From the perspiration of His own body He created water and with it filled half the universe.

Anubhāṣya.
See *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 2.10.10.

97 The universe measures fifty crores of yojanas, equal in length and breadth.

The origin of the fourteen worlds —

98 Filling half with water, He made His dwelling there; in the other half He manifested the fourteen worlds.

Anubhāṣya.
Caudda bhuvana (the fourteen worlds): Bhū, Bhuvaḥ, Svaḥ, Mahaḥ, Jana, Tapaḥ and Satya — these seven higher worlds; and Tala, Atala, Vitala, Nitala, Talātala, Mahātala and Sutala — these seven *pātālas* (lower worlds). See *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 2.5.38–42 and 11.4.3.

In the Garbha Ocean He manifests His own abode, Vaikuṇṭha —

99 There He manifested Vaikuṇṭha, His own abode, and rested on the water with Śeṣa as His bed.

*He whom the hymn of the *Ṛg-veda* praises —*

100–101 There He lay on Ananta as His bed. He has a thousand heads and a thousand faces, a thousand hands and feet and a thousand eyes. He is the seed of all avatāras and the cause of the world.

Anubhāṣya.
See *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 1.3.2, 4, 5.

Anubhāṣya.
(*Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 1.3.4): “With flawless eyes the devotees behold His wondrous form with thousands of feet, thighs, arms and faces, with thousands of heads, ears, eyes and noses, shining with thousands of crowns, garments and earrings.” (*Ṛg-veda-saṁhitā* 8.4.17; *Sāma-veda* 6.4.4.3; *Śukla Yajur-veda* 31.1; *Atharva-veda* 19.6.1): “The Puruṣa has a thousand heads, a thousand eyes, a thousand feet. Enveloping the earth on every side, He extends beyond it by ten

fingers' breadth." See *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 11.4.4–5 and *Brahma-saṁhitā* 5.10–11.

From Him come Viṣṇu, Brahmā and Rudra —

102 From His navel-lotus a lotus arose, and that lotus became the birthplace of Brahmā.

103 In the stem of that lotus the fourteen worlds came to be, and He, becoming Brahmā, brought forth the creation.

Anubhāṣya.

In the *Mahābhārata*, in the *Mokṣa-dharma*, in the narrative of Nārāyaṇa (*Śānti-parva*, Chapter 339, verses 70–72, and Chapter 340, verses 27–28), it is said: "He who is Pradyumna is also Aniruddha; He is also the father of Brahmā." Here it must be understood that He who is Garbhodaśāyī is also Kṣīrodaśāyī. The two are nondifferent, and therefore in truth Pradyumna is the controller — that is, the indwelling Lord (*antaryāmī*) — and the father of Hiraṇyagarbha, who was born from the lotus. See *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 3.1.2.

104 Taking the form of Viṣṇu, He maintains the world. Viṣṇu is beyond the guṇas; the guṇas of māyā never touch Him.

Anubhāṣya.

See *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 3.8.16. The *Laghu-bhāgavatāmṛta*, describing the three Puruṣas (sections 137–139), says: "The four-armed *vilāsa* of this Garbhodaśāyī enters the lotus of the worlds and, called Viṣṇu, lies in the Ocean of Milk. He becomes the indwelling Lord in the hearts of all embodied beings, from the gods down to the unmoving, and abides as if in many forms. The form of Viṣṇu of whom the *Sātvata-tantra* says, 'The third abides in all beings,' is accepted as His *vilāsa*." The four-armed form, the *vilāsa* of Garbhodaśāyī, enters the lotus of the worlds, is called "Viṣṇu" and lies in the Ocean of Milk. As the indwelling Lord, this Viṣṇu abides in the hearts of all living beings, from the gods down to the unmoving, as if in many forms. The form of Viṣṇu called in the *Sātvata-tantra* "the third Puruṣa, who abides in all beings" is the *vilāsa-mūrti* of Garbhodaśāyī Viṣṇu.

The *Laghu-bhāgavatāmṛta*, describing the Puruṣa (section 12), gives Śrī Baladeva's commentary: “Viṣṇu is not joined even with *sattva*; by His will alone He merely controls it. That is why it is said: ‘The highest good comes from Him.’ So the *Vāmana Purāṇa* says: ‘Brahmā, Viṣṇu and Īśa are the three forms of the great-souled Viṣṇu. In Brahmā He is in the form of Brahmā, in Śiva in the form of Śiva, but the god Janārdana, in the form of Viṣṇu, remains apart.’” Viṣṇu is the presiding deity of the *guṇa* of *sattva*, yet He is never bound by *sattva-guṇa*: by His will alone He merely controls it. That is why it is said, “From Him alone comes the welfare of the *jīva*.” So the *Vāmana Purāṇa* says that one and the same Viṣṇu exists in the forms of Brahmā, Viṣṇu and Śiva: in Brahmā He is in the form of Brahmā, in Śiva in the form of Śiva, and Janārdana in the form of Viṣṇu remains separate from them both.

And where Viṣṇu is described (sections 29–30): “Viṣṇu extends (*tanoti*) *sattva*, and so in the scriptures He is known as *sattva-tanu*. His avatāras, likewise, are *sattva-tanu*. Or else *sattva* is His ‘body’ (*tanu*) in the sense of an external seat. That He is *nirguṇa*, beyond the *guṇas*, is therefore fully established in all the scriptures. So it is said (*Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 10.88.5): ‘Hari is indeed *nirguṇa*, the Puruṣa Himself, beyond *prakṛti*.’”

He extends *sattva-guṇa*, and so in the scriptures Viṣṇu has received the name *sattva-tanu*. The avatāras of Kṣīrābdhiśāyī Viṣṇu are likewise called *sattva-tanu*; or He is called *sattva-tanu* because that body, *sattva*, is merely His external seat. That is why all the scriptures call Viṣṇu *nirguṇa*. So too in the tenth canto: “Hari is *nirguṇa*, the Supreme Lord Himself, beyond *prakṛti*, the giver of knowledge to Brahmā and the other gods, the witness of all; whoever worships Him attains freedom from the *guṇas*.” This is why the verse of the *Bhāgavatam* says: “From this *sattva-tanu* comes every kind of good.”

105 Assuming the form of Rudra, He destroys the world. Creation, maintenance and dissolution all take place by His will.

Anubhāṣya.

The Puruṣa of the verse *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 1.2.23 is this very Garbhodaśāyī!

106 He is Hiraṇyagarbha, the Indweller, the cause of the world; and it is a part of Him that is conceived as the universal form (*virāṭ*).

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
Garbhodaśāyī Viṣṇu Himself is Hiraṇyagarbha, the indwelling Lord (*antaryāmī*) and the cause of the world. His portion is conceived of as the "Virāṭ."

107 Great as Nārāyaṇa is, He is only a part of a part of Lord Nityānanda, the crown of all avatāras.

Anubhāṣya.
Brahma-saṁhitā (5.14): "Thus by a single portion He Himself enters each one." Madhya 20.283–293.

108 I have explained the meaning of the tenth verse; now hear attentively the meaning of the eleventh.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
"The meaning of the tenth verse": the tenth verse and the verses that follow it describe Garbhodaśāyī Viṣṇu.

Explanation of the eleventh of the fourteen opening verses —

109 "I take refuge in Śrī Nityānanda Rāma. A part of a part of His part is Viṣṇu who lies on the Ocean of Milk, the Supersoul and maintainer of all beings; and Ananta, who upholds the earth, is a portion of that Viṣṇu." (diary of Svarūpa Dāmodara)[8]

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
I bow down to Nityānanda-Rāma. A portion of a portion of His portion is Kṣīrodaśāyī, the Paramātmā of all, Viṣṇu the maintainer; and His *kalā* is "Ananta," who holds up the earth.

Anubhāṣya.
akhilānām (of the *jīvas*) **parātmā** (the Paramātmā), **poṣṭā** (the maintainer), **dugdhābdhi-śāyī** (the third Puruṣa-avatāra, Kṣīrodaśāyī) **viṣṇuḥ bhāti** (Viṣṇu shines); **saḥ api** (He too) is **yasya aṁśāṁśāṁśaḥ** (a portion of a portion of the portion of Nityānanda-Rāma: a portion of a portion is a *kalā*, and its portion a *vikalā*); **kṣauṇī-bhartā** (the maintainer of the world) **anantaḥ** (Ananta) is **yat** (Kṣīrodaśāyī's) **kalā** (portion of a portion); **taṁ śrī-nityānanda-rāmam ahaṁ prapadye** (to that Śrī Nityānanda-Rāma I surrender).

Description of the abode of Kṣīrodaśāyī Viṣṇu —

110 Within the stem of Nārāyaṇa's navel-lotus is the earth, and within the earth are counted seven oceans.

"Śvetadvīpa" —

111 There, in the midst of the Ocean of Milk, is the island called Śvetadvīpa, the abode of Viṣṇu the maintainer.

Anubhāṣya.

The *Siddhānta-śiromaṇi* says: "The best of teachers say that the half of the earth lying north of the Salt Ocean is Jambudvīpa. In the other, southern half lie the six other *dvīpas* and the oceans of salt, milk and the rest. First comes the ocean of salt water, then the ocean of milk, from which nectar, the moon and Śrī appeared; there dwells Vāsudeva, the shelter of all, whose lotus feet are honored by lotus-born Brahmā and the other gods. Then come the oceans of yogurt, of ghee and of sugarcane juice, then of wine, and the last is of fresh water. Within the ocean of fresh water is the submarine fire, Vaḍavānala, and the *pātāla* worlds are layers within the earth." That is: 1) the Salt Ocean, 2) the Milk Ocean, 3) the ocean of yogurt, 4) the ocean of ghee, 5) the ocean of sugarcane juice, 6) the ocean of wine, 7) the ocean of fresh water. South of the Salt Ocean is the Kṣīroda, the Milk Ocean; there Vāsudeva, the shelter of all, dwells, and Brahmā and the other gods worship His feet.

*The indwelling Lord of each individual *jīva* —*

112 He is the Indweller of all beings, the maintainer of the world and its master.

Anubhāṣya.

The *Laghu-bhāgavatāmṛta*, describing Śrī Viṣṇu — the gist of verses 26–28: "I shall briefly point out all the abodes mentioned in the *Viṣṇu-dharmottara* and other books among the manifestations of Viṣṇu within the universe. Namely: 'Above Rudraloka there is another world, "Viṣṇuloka," fifty thousand *yojanas* in size and inaccessible to every other world. Above it, east of Sumeru, in the middle of the Salt Ocean, within the waters, there is said to be a huge golden "Mahā-Viṣṇuloka"; Brahmā goes there from time to time to see it. In that world Janārdana

Viṣṇu sleeps with Lakṣmī on the couch of Śeṣa during the four months of the rainy season. East of Meru, in the middle of the Milk Ocean, amid its waters, there is another abode, “Śubhravarṇā” (the white); in it Lord Viṣṇu sits with Lakṣmī on the throne of Śeṣa. There too the Lord enjoys the bliss of sleep during the four months of the rains. South of it, in the Milk Ocean, is a most beautiful island, twenty-five thousand *yojanas* in size, known as “Śvetadvīpa.”’”

The *Brahmāṇḍa Purāṇa* also says: “The island surrounded by the Milk Ocean, a hundred thousand *yojanas* in extent, … — that very great, beautiful golden island is called ‘Śvetadvīpa.’” Further, the *Viṣṇu Purāṇa* and other books, and the *Mokṣa-dharma* of the *Mahābhārata* as well, describe it: “Śvetadvīpa lies on the northern shore of the Milk Ocean,” and so on. The *Padma Purāṇa* says that Śvetadvīpa shines on the northern shore of the Ocean of Water. On Śvetadvīpa see *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 11.15.18.

The *Śrī Laghu-bhāgavatāmṛta*, describing the Puruṣa (section 10), says: “The third form, too, is seen from the verse of the second canto (*Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 2.2.8): ‘Some [meditate on Him] in the space of the heart within their own body.’” Śrī Baladeva's commentary: “So too Aniruddha, the lord of the Milk Ocean, the third Puruṣa, in a form the size of a span, dwelling in the hearts of all *jīvas*, is the object of meditation.” That is, the third Puruṣa, Kṣīraśāyī, in a form the size of a span, is to be meditated upon as the indwelling Lord of all *jīvas*. Where Viṣṇu is described (section 25): “He who is called ‘Viṣṇu’ is considered to be Kṣīrāmbudhiśaya. He is the *vilāsa* of Garbhodaśāyī, and so the lords of the sages call Him Nārāyaṇa and the indwelling Lord of the Virāṭ.” That is, He who is called “Viṣṇu” is Kṣīrodaśāyī. He is the *vilāsa* of Garbhodaśāyī, and so the sages call Viṣṇu “Nārāyaṇa” and also the indwelling Lord of the Virāṭ.

*The avatāras of the *yugas* and *manvantaras* come from Kṣīrodakaśāyī —*

113 In each yuga and manvantara He takes many avatāras, establishing dharma and destroying adharma.

114 Even the gods cannot see Him; they go to the shore of the Ocean of Milk and offer Him prayers.

Kṣīrodaśāyī Viṣṇu is the maintainer of the world —

115 Then He descends and protects the world. His splendour is endless, beyond all counting.

116 And that Viṣṇu is a part of a part of a part of Lord Nityānanda, the crown of all avatāras.

His form as the great serpent called "Śeṣa" —

117 That Viṣṇu, in the form of Śeṣa, holds the earth, and does not even know where on His heads it lies.

118 On the circle of His thousand broad hoods hosts of gems glitter, outshining the sun.

119 The earth, fifty crores of yojanas wide, rests on one of His hoods like a mustard seed.

Anubhāṣya.
See *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 5.17.21 and 5.25.2.

Viṣṇu in the form of Śeṣa, the devotee of Kṛṣṇa —

120 That Ananta Śeṣa is an avatāra in the form of a devotee; He knows nothing but service to the Lord.

Anubhāṣya.
Śrī Jīva Prabhu writes in the *Śrī Kṛṣṇa-sandarbha* (section 86): "'Ananta, the *kalā* of Vāsudeva, thousand-mouthed, self-effulgent (*svarāṭ*), the god, will appear first, wishing to please Hari.'[21] The *kalā* of Vāsudeva, the son of Śrī Vasudeva, is His first portion, Śrī Saṅkarṣaṇa. *Svarāṭ*: He who shines by His own [glory] alone. Therefore He is Ananta, unlimited by time or place; He, called Śeṣa, is also the thousand-mouthed one. By one portion of Himself He is the one called Śeṣa. In the *Skanda Purāṇa*, in the *Ayodhyā-māhātmya*: 'Then, as all looked on, Śakra spoke sweetly to Lakṣmaṇa, true to his word, who had become Śeṣa: "Attain Your own eternal supreme abode of Viṣṇu. Your form has come too — Śeṣa

with his shining hoods." Having said this to Lakṣmaṇa, the king of the gods, together with the gods, sent Śeṣa, who is able to bear the burden of the earth, to Pātāla.' Therefore both in the words 'My abode called Śeṣa' (*Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 10.2.8) and here, in the words 'remains, called Śeṣa' (*Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 10.3.25), He is called an unfailing portion. Or else [Śeṣa is He] from whom the name and fame of Śeṣa come."

The *kalā* of Bhagavān (the portion of His portion) is Śrī Anantadeva, thousand-mouthed and *svarāṭ*. Wishing to do what pleases Śrī Hari, He is always present before Him. The first portion of Vāsudeva, the son of Vasudeva, is Saṅkarṣaṇa. He is self-manifest and is therefore *svarāṭ*; and so He is Ananta, that is, free from the limits of time and place. He is present also in the form of the thousand-mouthed "Śeṣa." "By one portion" means in the form of the avatāra called Śeṣa. In the *Skanda Purāṇa*, in the *Ayodhyā-māhātmya*: "As all looked on, Indra, the king of the gods, began to speak to Lakṣmaṇa, true to his vow, who bore the form of Śeṣa: 'Go to Your own eternal abode of Viṣṇu — Your form, Śeṣa adorned with hoods, has come as well.' Having said this, the king of the gods sent Lakṣmaṇa in the form of Śeṣa, able to bear the burden of the earth, to Pātāla and went to the abode of the gods." (That is, when Lakṣmaṇa, the *vyūha* Saṅkarṣaṇa, descended with Śrī Rāma, Śeṣa, the bearer of the earth who lives in Pātāla, came and merged with him. Later, when the time of disappearance came (*aprakaṭa*: the Lord and His eternal associates do not die as ordinary beings do, but only become invisible to this world), "Śeṣa" separated from Lakṣmaṇa and went to his own abode, Pātāla, and Lakṣmaṇa went to Vaikuṇṭha, the abode of Viṣṇu.) Therefore in the words "My abode called Śeṣa" too, "Śeṣa" means that by which the end (*śeṣa*) is reached — that which remains at the very end. Just as the remainder is nondifferent from the original thing, so Śeṣa is spoken of as a nondifferent portion of Vāsudeva. Or else "Śeṣa" is He from whom comes His fame by the name of Śeṣa.

The *Laghu-bhāgavatāmṛta*, describing the truth of Rudra (section 19), gives Śrī Baladeva's commentary: "'Like Śeṣa': Śeṣa who is the bed of Śārṅgī (Viṣṇu), His supporting potency, belongs to the category of the Lord; but the Śeṣa who bears the earth is a *jīva* whom He has entered." That is, Śeṣa in the form of the bed of Viṣṇu, the wielder of the bow Śārṅga — the supporting potency — belongs to the category of the Lord, while the earth-bearing "Śeṣa" belongs to the category of empowered (*śaktyāviṣṭa*) *jīvas*. And again, where the truth of Śrī Rāma is described (section 28): "Saṅkarṣaṇa, the second *vyūha*, is Rāma Himself. Uniting with Śeṣa, the bearer of the earth, He became manifest. Śeṣa is twofold:

one bears the earth, the other is the bed of Śārṅgī. Of them, the one who bears the earth is considered Saṅkarṣaṇa, because Saṅkarṣaṇa has entered him. But the one who is the bed thinks of Himself as His friend and servant." That is, Saṅkarṣaṇa of the second *catur-vyūha*, uniting with the earth-bearing "Śeṣa," descended in the form of Rāma. "Śeṣa" is twofold: the bearer of the earth and Bhagavān's bed. The earth-bearing "Śeṣa" is an *āveśa-avatāra* of Saṅkarṣaṇa; that is why he too is called "Saṅkarṣaṇa." The one who is the bed thinks of Himself as the servant and friend of the wielder of Śārṅga.

He is always absorbed in glorifying Kṛṣṇa and instructs the four Sanas —

121 With His thousand mouths He sings of Kṛṣṇa's qualities; He sings without cease and never reaches their end.

122 From His mouth Sanaka and the other Kumāras hear the *Bhāgavatam*, while He, awash in the joy of love, tells of the qualities of Bhagavān.

Serving Kṛṣṇa in ten forms —

123 He becomes umbrella, sandals, bed, pillow, garments, resting place, dwelling, sacred thread and throne.

Why He is called Śeṣa —

124 Assuming all these different forms He serves Kṛṣṇa; and because He has reached the utmost limit of service to Kṛṣṇa, He bears the name Śeṣa.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
Śeṣatā means ultimate servitude (*dāsya*).

Anubhāṣya.
"You alone remain, and so You are called Śeṣa." (*Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 10.3.25)

125 That Ananta I call but one kalā of Him. Such is Lord Nityānanda — who can know His play?

All the avatāras of Viṣṇu are parts of Kṛṣṇa and in truth nondifferent from Him; therefore calling Kṛṣṇa by the name of Viṣṇu is no fault —

126 By all these proofs I know the full truth of Nityānanda. If I call Him Ananta, what glory is that to Him?

127 Or else, accepting the words of the devotees as true, I say: everything is possible in Him, for He is the source of the avatāras.

128 One who knows that the avatāras and their source are non-different speaks in this way — just as in the past people saw in Kṛṣṇa this or that avatāra:

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

One who does not know how an avatāra differs from the source of the avatāras once equated Kṛṣṇa with Vāmana and the other avatāras. In the same way, a person who sees no difference calls Nityānanda "Ananta" and so on. But since devotees have said so, it is not false: in the highest Truth everything is possible.[15]

The source of the avatāras is called by the names of various avatāras —

129 some said that Kṛṣṇa was Nara-Nārāyaṇa Himself, others that He was Vāmana Himself,

130 and still others that He was an avatāra of Kṣīrodaśāyī. None of this is impossible: the words of all are true.

131 When Kṛṣṇa, the shelter of all portions, descends, all His portions come and unite in Him.

132 So each speaks of Him in the form in which he knows Him. Everything is possible in Kṛṣṇa; none of it is false.

Anubhāṣya.

In the *Laghu-bhāgavatāmṛta*, Śrī Rūpa Prabhu first refutes the opponent's views (*pūrvapakṣa*): "Kṛṣṇa is an avatāra of Kṣīraśāyī," "Kṛṣṇa is an avatāra of

Vāsudeva, the first *vyūha* of Nārāyaṇa, the Lord of Paravyoma," "Kṛṣṇa is a *vilāsa* of Nārāyaṇa," and so on. Then (in sections 136, 137, and 139) he quotes *Bhāgavatam* 3.2.15 and says: "When His own peaceful forms — Vasudeva and the other devotees — were being oppressed by distorted forms, that is, by fearsome-looking demons led by Kaṁsa, then Śrī Kṛṣṇa, the Lord of spirit and matter, supremely merciful and though unborn, joined and merged with His *vilāsas* — the Lord of Vaikuṇṭha and others — and descended from Kṛṣṇaloka into the material world, just as fire appears from the wooden *araṇi* when it is churned." The *vyūha* of Śrī Kṛṣṇa became one with His own *vilāsa*, the *vyūha* of the Lord of Paravyoma, came into the material world, and appeared there. He always remains united with His famous avatāras: the Puruṣas and others, Śrī Rāma, Nṛsiṁha, Varāha, Vāmana, Nara-Nārāyaṇa, Hayagrīva, Ajita, and the rest. That is why in Vṛndāvana too the pastimes of all these avatāras are seen in Śrī Kṛṣṇa. And so the *Brahmāṇḍa Purāṇa* says: "He who is four-armed in Vaikuṇṭha, who is the Lord of Śvetadvīpa, who is Nārāyaṇa, the friend of Nara — He is Puruṣottama, the son of Nanda. As hundreds and thousands of sparks fly out of a great fire and vanish back into it, so all the other countless charming avatāras of this Kṛṣṇa become one with Him again." Therefore, in the Purāṇas and other scriptures, some have glorified Śrī Kṛṣṇa as Nārāyaṇa, the friend of Nara, some as Upendra, that is, Vāmana, some as Kṣīrodaśāyī, some as the thousand-headed Garbhodaśāyī, and some as the Lord of Vaikuṇṭha. For the original Saṅkarṣaṇa abides in Śrī Kṛṣṇa, and from Him Badarīnātha and other forms are manifested (that is, they appear by His mere wish). The sages saw only the pastimes of one or another of these forms. They followed the accounts of Viṣṇu with those different pastimes, and so they called Śrī Kṛṣṇa by the names of those forms of Viṣṇu. Therefore, even if the original source of the avatāras is called an "avatāra," in truth there is no fault in it. See Ādi 2.110–115.

Through Nityānanda, Gaurasundara manifests all the avatāras —

133 Therefore Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya Gosāñi performed the pastimes of all the avatāras and showed them to everyone.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Therefore Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya, the highest Truth, showed everyone the pastimes of Varāha, Nṛsiṁha, and the other avatāras.

134 In this way Nityānanda is manifest as Ananta, and in that same mood He says, “I am Caitanya’s servant.”

Nityānanda-Rāma serves Gaura-Kṛṣṇa in different forms and different moods —

135 Sometimes He plays the guru, sometimes the friend, sometimes the servant — just as He once played in Vraja in these three moods.

136 Becoming a bull, He would fight with Kṛṣṇa head to head; and sometimes Kṛṣṇa would massage His feet.

Nityānanda-Rāma always considers Himself the servant of Gaura-Kṛṣṇa —

137 He thinks of Himself as a servant and knows Kṛṣṇa as His Master; He considers Himself but a kalā of Kṛṣṇa’s kalā.

The play of Rāma and Kṛṣṇa —

138 “Pretending to be bulls, the two would bellow and fight with each other; imitating the cries of animals, They roamed about like ordinary children.” (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 10.11.40)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
Sometimes, like ordinary people, the two brothers become bulls and butt each other, bellowing. And sometimes they imitate swans, peacocks, and other creatures and make their sounds.

Anubhāṣya.
These two verses are spoken where the childhood play of Kṛṣṇa and Rāma is described.

vṛṣāyamāṇau (acting like bulls) **nardantau** (making their sounds, bellowing) **kṛṣṇa-baladevau** (Kṛṣṇa and Baladeva) **parasparam yuyudhāte** (butted each other). **rutaiḥ** (with imitative sounds) **jantūn anukṛtya** (imitating the animals), **prākṛtau** (ordinary) **bālakau yathā** (like boys), **tathā ceratuḥ** (so They played).

Kṛṣṇa serves Rāma, massaging His feet and so on —

139 "Sometimes, when His elder brother lay tired from play with His head on a cowherd boy's lap, Kṛṣṇa Himself would give Him rest by massaging His feet and serving Him in other ways." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 10.15.14)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
Sometimes, tired from play, Kṛṣṇa Himself lies down with His head on the lap of the cowherd boys, and He has Baladeva lie down and massages His feet.

Anubhāṣya.
kvacit (sometimes) **krīḍā-pariśrāntam** (tired from play) **gopotsaṅgopabarhaṇam** (Him whose pillow was the lap of a cowherd boy) **āryam** (the elder brother, Baladeva) **pāda-saṁvāhanādibhiḥ** (by massaging His feet and other service) **svayam** (Kṛṣṇa Himself) **viśrāmayati** (relieved of fatigue).

*Baladeva's amazement at seeing Kṛṣṇa's *yogamāyā* —*

140 (Baladeva said in wonder:) "Who is she, and where has she come from? Is she divine, human or demonic? Most likely she is the māyā of My Master, for no other can bewilder even Me." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 10.13.37)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
"Who is this *māyā*? Where has she come from? Is she divine, human, or demoniac? No *māyā* can bewilder me except the *māyā* of my Lord Kṛṣṇa."

Anubhāṣya.
When Brahmā stole the calves, Śrī Kṛṣṇa created the calves and the rest anew and went on with His pastimes as usual. One day Śrī Baladeva saw how the cows were behaving, understood what had happened, and was amazed:

iyam (this [*māyā*]) **kā** (who)? **kutaḥ vā āyātā** (where has she come from)? **kim daivī** (is she related to the gods), **nārī** (to humans), **vā** (or — *uta*) **āsurī** (to the demons)? **prāyaḥ** (most likely) **māyā me bhartuḥ** (it is the *māyā* of my Master, Bhagavān Himself) **astu** (it must be); **anyā** (another [*māyā*]) **na** (it cannot be), ([for]) **iyam me api** (even me) **vimohinī** (she bewilders).

The six opulences eternally abide in Kṛṣṇa's lotus feet —

141 (Baladeva said:) "The guardians of all the worlds bear on their crowned heads the dust of His lotus feet, the holiest of holy places; and Brahmā, Śiva, Lakṣmī and I Myself, mere parts of His part, carry it on our heads forever. What then is a king's throne to Him?" (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 10.68.37)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

The dust of His feet is the holy place of all holy places. The guardians of the worlds carry it on their heads. Brahmā, Śiva, I, Baladeva, and Lakṣmī — some of us are His parts, others parts of parts — forever carry the dust of His feet. What does an ordinary royal throne mean to Him?

Anubhāṣya.

The Kauravas spoke ill of Śrī Kṛṣṇa and tried to win Baladeva over to their side. Then Baladeva grew angry and said to them:

yasya (Kṛṣṇa's) **aṅghri-paṅkaja-rajaḥ** (the dust of the lotus feet) **akhila-loka-pālaiḥ** (by the rulers of all the worlds) **mauly-uttamaiḥ** (on their heads adorned with crowns) **dhṛtam** (borne, held in the mind by concentration), **upāsita-tīrtha-tīrtham** (the holy place even for the yogīs who honor holy places); **yasya kalāyāḥ kalāḥ** (parts [*vikalās*] of whose part) — **brahmā**, **bhavaḥ** (Śiva), **aham** (I, Baladeva), **śrīḥ ca** (and Lakṣmī) — **api ciram** (forever) **udvahema** (we pray to carry it on our heads), — **asya** (for Him, Bhagavān Kṛṣṇa) **nṛpāsanam** (a royal throne) **kva** (where; what does it mean)?

*Kṛṣṇa alone, the original form (*svayaṁ-rūpa*), is the Lord of all —*

142 Kṛṣṇa alone is the Lord; all others are His servants. As He makes each one dance, so each one dances.

Gaurasundara is the Supreme Lord, and His associates are His servants —

143 In the same way Caitanya Gosāñi alone is the Lord; all the rest are His associates or His servants.

144–145 Nityānanda, Advaita Ācārya, Śrīvāsa and others play the part of His elders and gurus, and all the rest are His juniors, equals and seniors. All are His associates and helpers in His pastimes, and with them all Gaura-rāya accomplishes His purpose.

*Gaura's two limbs (*aṅgas*): Nitāi and Advaita —*

146 Advaita Ācārya and Nityānanda are His two limbs (*aṅga*); with these two the Lord performs all His pastimes.

Anubhāṣya.
See Ādi 3.71.

Though Advaita Prabhu is an avatāra of Mahā-Viṣṇu, He considers Himself a servant of Gaura —

147 Advaita Ācārya Gosāñi is the Lord Himself. The Lord honours Him as a guru, yet He is His servant.

Anubhāṣya.
Śrī Mahāprabhu honored Advaita Ācārya, regarding Him as one of His elders (*guru-varga*). Yet Śrī Advaita Prabhu considered Himself a servant of Śrī Caitanya. He was a contemporary and friend of Śrī Mahāprabhu's father. Śrī Īśvara Purī and Śrī Advaita Prabhu were disciples of Śrī Mādhavendra Purī. Mahāprabhu accepted Śrī Īśvara Purī as His *dīkṣā-guru*, and so Advaita Prabhu was a godbrother of Mahāprabhu's guru and worthy of respect.

*Proof of the Ācārya's mercy to the *jīvas* —*

148 The truth of Ācārya Gosāñi cannot be told: it was He who brought Kṛṣṇa down and delivered the world.

Because Lakṣmaṇa, the younger brother, served the elder, Rāmacandra, in the avatāra of Kṛṣṇa Balarāma is the elder brother and Kṛṣṇa the younger —

149 Nityānanda Svarūpa, appearing before as Lakṣmaṇa, served Rāma as His younger brother.

Anubhāṣya.
Among the *daṇḍī-sannyāsīs* of the ten names, a *brahmacārī* bears one of four titles: “Svarūpa,” “Ānanda,” “Prakāśa,” and “Caitanya.” While traveling to the holy places, Nityānanda Prabhu stayed with a *sannyāsī* whose title was “Tīrtha” or “Āśrama.” Therefore His *brahmacārī* name became “Nityānanda-svarūpa.”

150 Everything Rāma did brought Him suffering, and Lakṣmaṇa, of His own free will, bore that suffering with Him.

151 Being the younger brother, He could not object; so Lakṣmaṇa kept silent and grieved within.

152 In Kṛṣṇa’s descent He became the elder brother for the sake of service, and He gave Kṛṣṇa many joys to taste.

153 Rāma and Lakṣmaṇa are particular portions of Kṛṣṇa and Balarāma, and when Kṛṣṇa and Balarāma descend, Rāma and Lakṣmaṇa enter into Them.

Anubhāṣya.
In the *Laghu-bhāgavatāmṛta*, where the truth of Śrī Rāghavendra is described, section 20 says (in substance): “The *Viṣṇu-dharmottara* glorifies Rāma, Lakṣmaṇa, Bharata, and Śatrughna as avatāras of Vāsudeva, Saṅkarṣaṇa, Pradyumna, and Aniruddha respectively. And the *Padma Purāṇa* glorifies Rāmacandra as Nārāyaṇa, and Lakṣmaṇa, Bharata, and Śatrughna respectively as Śeṣa, the Cakra, and the Śaṅkha (conch).”

154 Together with those portions They take the roles of elder and younger brother, and the scriptures describe Them as the whole and His portion.

Anubhāṣya.
In the *Laghu-bhāgavatāmṛta*, where the *līlā-avatāras* are described, section 79 says (in translation): “The *Rāma-gītā* of the *Skanda Purāṇa* says that Lakṣmaṇa, Bharata, and Śatrughna are the three *vyūhas* of Śrī Rāma.”

*Kṛṣṇa alone is the original form (*svayaṁ-rūpa*); all the other avatāras are His parts (*aṁśas*) or *kalās* —*

155 "I worship Govinda, the original Person, who, abiding through His kalās in Rāma and other forms, manifested many avatāras in the worlds, but who Himself, the Supreme Person, appeared as Kṛṣṇa." (Brahma-saṁhitā, 5.39)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Dividing Himself into parts (*kalās*), Bhagavān manifested various avatāras in the world in the forms of Rāma and others. But I worship Govinda, the original Person: this Supreme Person Himself appears in the form of Kṛṣṇa.

Anubhāṣya.

yaḥ (He who), **paramaḥ pumān** (the Supreme Person) **kṛṣṇaḥ** (Kṛṣṇa), **kalā-niyamena** (as parts, parts of parts, and so on) **rāmādi-mūrtiṣu tiṣṭhan** (abiding in the forms of Rāma and others — manifesting the forms of the various *naimittika* avatāras, who descend for a particular occasion) **nānāvatāram akarot** (manifested many avatāras), **kintu svayam samabhavat** (but appeared Himself [as Kṛṣṇa]) — **tam govindam ādi-puruṣam** (that Govinda, the original Person) **ahaṁ bhajāmi** (I worship).

*Gaura's desire — to spread the holy name and *prema* — is fulfilled through Nityānanda alone —*

156 Śrī Caitanya is that Kṛṣṇa, and Nityānanda is Rāma. Nityānanda fulfils all of Caitanya's desires.

Nityānanda's glory is boundless —

157 The ocean of Nityānanda's glory is endless and shoreless. I touch but a single drop of it — and that only by His mercy.

From his own experience, the author describes the greatness of Nityānanda's mercy —

158 Hear one more glory of His mercy: He raised a fallen soul to the very highest.[9]

159 This story is as secret as the Vedas and not fit to be told; still I tell it to reveal His mercy.

160 In overflowing joy I write of Your grace. O Nityānanda Prabhu, forgive my offence!

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Ullāsa-upari means: "I rejoice so much that I cannot keep it hidden, and so I am writing the account of Your favor."

The greatness of a servant: Mīnaketana Rāmadāsa —

161 Avadhūta Gosāñi had a servant who was an abode of love; his name was Mīnaketana Rāmadāsa.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Avadhūta Gosāñi is Nityānanda Prabhu. *Prema-dhāma* means the abode of *prema*.

Anubhāṣya.

In his commentary on *Bhāgavatam* 3.1.19, Śrīdhara Svāmipāda explains the word *avadhūta* as *asaṁskṛta-deha*, one who does not care for his body. The disciple of the *avadhūta* Śrī Nityānanda was also a *mahā-bhāgavata*, a *paramahaṁsa*, eternally perfect and beyond *varṇāśrama*. Therefore his body bore no marks of *varṇāśrama*, and, careless of his body, he remained intoxicated with the moods of Vraja.

Mīnaketana Rāmadāsa: see the *Anubhāṣya* on Ādi 11.53.

162 In my house there was saṅkīrtana day and night, and he came there by invitation.

Anubhāṣya.

Ahorātra means eight *praharas*, that is, the whole day and night. In those days pure devotees had the custom of sending one another letters of invitation to *kīrtana* festivals.

*The state of a *mahā-bhāgavata*, or *paramahaṁsa* —*

163 Full of great love, he sat down in the courtyard, and all the Vaiṣṇavas bowed at his feet.

164 As they bowed, he would climb on the back of one, and in his love strike another with his flute or slap yet another.

165 From those eyes, the very sight of which brings tears to one's heart, flowed an unbroken stream of tears.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Whenever anyone looked into the eyes of Mīnaketana Rāmadāsa, tears welled up from the depths of his heart into his own eyes. And from the eyes of Rāmadāsa himself streams of tears flowed without pause. By another reading, *ye nayane dekhite*, the sense is this: in whatever eyes a person wished to see tears, from those eyes the tears flowed.

166 At times I saw the hair on some limb stand on end like kadamba blossoms; one limb would stiffen while another trembled.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Kadamba means a multitude. *Jāḍya* means stupor (*stambha*).[16]

167 When he roared out "Nityānanda!", all who saw it were filled with wonder.

*A worldly devotee of the lowest level (*kaniṣṭha*), lacking faith, offends the feet of a Vaiṣṇava —*

168 A respectable brāhmaṇa named Guṇārṇava Miśra was serving the Deity there.

169 Rāmadāsa sat in the courtyard, but the brāhmaṇa did not greet him; seeing this, Mīnaketana said angrily:[10]

170 “Here is a second Romaharṣaṇa Sūta, who did not rise to greet Baladeva when he saw Him!”

Anubhāṣya.

Bhāgavatam 10.78.22–28 tells how, in Naimiṣāraṇya, Baladeva killed Romaharṣaṇa, the disciple of Vyāsa.

Even when insulted, a Vaiṣṇava does not look for faults in others —

171 Having said this, he danced and sang and rejoiced; but the brāhmaṇa went on with his service to Kṛṣṇa and showed no anger.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Guṇārṇava Miśra, the servant of the Deity, sat in the courtyard and did not greet the servant of Śrī Nityānanda. So Mīnaketana Rāmadāsa grew angry and said, “This Guṇārṇava Miśra is a second Romaharṣaṇa Sūta.” The meaning is this. In Naimiṣāraṇya, Romaharṣaṇa Sūta saw Baladeva but did not leave the seat of Vyāsa and did not greet Him. Guṇārṇava Miśra behaved just as improperly. In Guṇārṇava Miśra's heart there was no special faith in Śrī Nityānanda. Śrī Mīnaketana understood this and lost respect for him. The devotees do not fault Śrī Mīnaketana for this act or call him proud.

172 At the end of the festival he was leaving, having given his blessings, when a dispute arose between him and my brother.

Kavirāja Gosvāmī's brother is devoted to Gaura but does not honor Nityānanda and the Vaiṣṇavas —

173 My brother had firm faith in Caitanya Prabhu, but towards Nityānanda only a semblance of faith.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Seeing this behavior, my brother got into an argument with Mīnaketana. My brother had firm faith in Śrī Caitanya Prabhu, but he did not have the same faith in Nityānanda Prabhu.

Anubhāṣya.

Viśvāsa-ābhāsa means very slight faith.

Kavirāja Gosvāmī rebukes his brother —

174 Knowing this, Rāmadāsa was grieved at heart, and so I rebuked my brother:

Disrespect that comes from taking the undivided Truth as divided is nothing but godlessness —

175 "The two brothers are one body, equally manifest. If you do not accept Nityānanda, you will be utterly ruined.

176 You have faith in one but show the other no respect: your standard is the logic of half a hen.

*Faith in Nitāi without Gaura, or in Gaura without Nitāi, is also nothing but opposition to *bhakti* —*

177 If you accept neither, you are an atheist; and to accept one and not the other is hypocrisy."

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Ardha-kukkuṭī-nyāya, "the logic of half a hen," is the same as *ardha-jaratīya-nyāya*: as if half of a hen were old and half young. As an argument this is utterly unacceptable. In the same way, holding to the logic of half a hen, you accept one of Caitanya and Nityānanda, the one undivided Lord, and reject the other. This is your godlessness and hypocrisy.

For insulting a devotee, the brother devoted to Gaura is ruined and falls —

178 In anger Rāmadāsa broke his flute and went away, and at that very moment my brother was ruined.

179 Thus I have told of the power of His servant. Now I tell of something more — the nature of His mercy.

Proof of Nityānanda's mercy —

180 Because I had rebuked my brother — and He counted this as a virtue — that night the Lord appeared to me.

The author sees Nityānanda in a dream —

181 In a village called Jhāmaṭapura, near Naihāṭi, Nityānanda-Rāma appeared to me in a dream.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
Kavirāja Gosvāmī lived in the village of Jhāmaṭapura, near the village of Naihāṭī, two *krośas* north of Kāṭoyā. Now a Deity of Śrī Mahāprabhu is there.

Anubhāṣya.
To reach Jhāmaṭapura, one takes the small train on the Kāṭoyā line and gets off at Sālār station.

The author attains the lotus feet of Nityānanda Himself —

182 I fell flat like a rod at His feet, and the Lord placed His lotus foot upon my head.

183 Again and again He said to me, “Rise, rise!” I rose, and seeing His form I was struck with wonder.

Nityānanda's form, and the expert service rendered to Him by His associates dressed as cowherd boys —

184 His huge body had a glossy dark lustre. He was as beautiful as Kandarpa, the god of love, in person, and had the bearing of a great champion wrestler.

185 His hands and feet were finely shaped, His eyes like lotuses; He wore silk on His head and silk as His garment.

186 Golden earrings hung in His ears, golden armlets and bracelets adorned His arms; ankle-bells rang on His feet, and a garland of flowers lay on His neck.

187 His body was anointed with sandal and graced with a lovely tilaka; His slow, intoxicated gait surpassed that of a maddened elephant.

188 His bright face outshone millions of moons; as He chewed betel, His teeth looked like pomegranate seeds.[11]

189 Intoxicated with love, His body swayed to right and left, and in a deep voice He called, "Kṛṣṇa! Kṛṣṇa!"

190 With a red staff in His hand He swayed like a maddened lion, and bees hovered all around His feet.

191 I saw His associates, all dressed as cowherds, all calling "Kṛṣṇa! Kṛṣṇa!" in loving rapture.

192 Some played horns and flutes, some danced and sang; one servant offered betel, another waved a cāmara.

On seeing Nityānanda, the author is immersed in bliss —

193 I beheld the splendour of Nityānanda Svarūpa — what form, what qualities, what pastimes, all beyond this world!

194 Overwhelmed with bliss, I knew nothing at all. Then, smiling, the Lord spoke to me:

Nityānanda orders the author to go to Vṛndāvana —

195 "O Kṛṣṇadāsa, Kṛṣṇadāsa, do not be afraid! Go to Vṛndāvana: there everything can be attained."

Nitāi disappears —

196 Saying this, He touched me with His hand and sent me forth; and the Lord disappeared with His associates.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
Hātasāna means a touch of the hand.

197 I fell senseless to the ground; my dream broke, and I saw that morning had come.

198 I reflected on what I had seen and heard: the Lord had ordered me to go to Vṛndāvana.

Kavirāja Gosvāmī goes to Vṛndāvana —

199 At that very moment I set out, and by the Lord's mercy I reached Vṛndāvana in happiness.

A prayer to Śrī Nityānanda —

200 Glory, glory to Nityānanda, to Nityānanda-Rāma, by whose mercy I attained the abode of Vṛndāvana!

201 Glory, glory to Nityānanda! Glory to Him who is full of mercy, through whom I attained the shelter of Rūpa and Sanātana!

202 Through Him I attained the great soul Raghunātha; through Him I attained the shelter of Śrī Svarūpa.

Anubhāṣya.
For one who longs to serve Śrī Rādhā-Govinda, the one desirable goal of life is to gain the shelter and grace of Śrī Svarūpa, Rūpa, Sanātana, and Raghunātha Gosvāmī Prabhus. These two *payāras* show that this can be gained only by the power of Nityānanda's mercy. On Śrī Dāmodara Svarūpa Gosvāmī Prabhu, see Ādi 4.160–161.

203 By Sanātana's mercy I came to know the conclusions of bhakti; by Śrī Rūpa's mercy I came near to bhakti-rasa.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Bhakti-rasa-prānta means only nearness to *bhakti-rasa*.

Anubhāṣya.

Śrī Sanātana Gosvāmī Prabhu is the ācārya of the conclusions of *bhakti* (*bhakti-siddhānta-ācārya*). At the end of the fourth chapter of the Antya-līlā of this book, the author writes: "Sanātana wrote the book *Bhāgavatāmṛta*, from which we learn the truth about the devotee, devotion, and Kṛṣṇa. He wrote the *Daśama-ṭippanī*, a book that is the essence of conclusions, from which we learn Kṛṣṇa's pastimes, *rasa*, and *prema*. He wrote the book *Hari-bhakti-vilāsa* on Vaiṣṇava conduct, in which we find the full extent of a Vaiṣṇava's duties."[22] Śrī Raghunātha dāsa Gosvāmīpāda writes of Śrī Sanātana in his prayer *Vilāpa-kusumāñjali*: "I was blind and had no wish to drink, yet with great effort he made me drink the nectar of devotion joined with renunciation. He is an ocean of mercy, and he suffers at the suffering of others. I take shelter of that master, Sanātana."[23] Śrī Kavirāja Gosvāmī (Antya 4.236) first names Śrī Rūpa, Śrī Sanātana, and Śrī Jīva, and then writes: "These three gurus and Raghunātha dāsa — I bow to the feet of them all, for I am their servant." Śrī Raghunātha dāsa, too, calls Śrī Sanātana Prabhu the ācārya of the conclusions of *bhakti*.

Śrī Rūpa Gosvāmī Prabhu is the ācārya of *bhakti-rasa* (*bhakti-rasa-ācārya*). (Antya 4.224): "Rūpa Gosāñi wrote the *Rasāmṛta-sindhu*, the essence, in which we find the full expanse of the *rasa* of devotion to Kṛṣṇa; and another book named *Ujjvala-nīlamaṇi*, in which we find the full extent of the *rasa* of Rādhā and Kṛṣṇa's pastimes."[24]

204 Glory, glory to the lotus feet of Nityānanda, through which I attained Śrī Rādhā-Govinda!

Anubhāṣya.

Śrīla Narottama Ṭhākura sings in his *Prārthanā*: "When will Nitāi-cāṅd be merciful to me? When will worldly desires become trifling to me? When will my mind give up the objects of the senses and become pure? When will I see Śrī Vṛndāvana? When will an ardent longing for the feet of Rūpa and Raghunātha awaken in me? When will I understand the love of the Divine Couple?" And again:

“Without such a Nitāi, brothers, Rādhā and Kṛṣṇa cannot be attained. Hold fast to the feet of Nitāi.”

The author's words of humility —

205 I am more sinful than Jagāi and Mādhāi, lower than a worm in excrement.

206 Whoever hears my name loses his piety; whoever utters my name commits sin.

207 Who in all the world but Nityānanda alone would show mercy to one as despicable as I?

The author tells of Nityānanda's mercy to himself —

208 Intoxicated with love, Nityānanda is the avatāra of mercy; He makes no distinction between the high and the low.

209 He delivers whoever falls before Him; and so He delivered even a sinner like me.

210 He brought me, the most sinful, to Śrī Vṛndāvana, and to one as low as I He gave the feet of Śrī Rūpa.

By Nityānanda's mercy the author attains the service of Śrī Madana-mohana —

211 The sight of Śrī Madana-Gopāla and Śrī Govinda — all this is not fit to be told.

Śrī Madana-Gopāla, the companion of Śrī Rādhā —

212 Śrī Madana-Gopāla is the lord of Vṛndāvana, the enjoyer of the rāsa dance, the son of the king of Vraja Himself.

213 With Śrī Rādhā and Lalitā He dances the rāsa, appearing in a form that enchants even Cupid.

*(*Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam*, Canto 10, Chapter 32, verse 2)*

214 "Among them appeared Śauri (Kṛṣṇa), His lotus face smiling, wearing yellow garments and a garland — the very enchanter of Cupid." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 10.32.2)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

In the *rāsa* pastime the *gopīs* bitterly lamented in separation. Suddenly Madana-mohana Himself appeared among them — in yellow garments, with a garland of forest flowers, and with a smile on His face.

Anubhāṣya.

During the *rāsa* dance Kṛṣṇa disappeared. The *gopīs*, longing to see Śrī Kṛṣṇa, lost all composure and wept. Then Govindadeva appeared before the cowherd women.

tāsām (among those *gopīs*, worn out with sorrow) **smayamāna-mukhāmbujaḥ** (He whose lotus face was smiling), **pītāmbara-dharaḥ** (wearing yellow garments), **sragvī** (wearing a garland), **sākṣāt manmatha-manmathaḥ** (He whose form enchants Kāmadeva himself) — **śauriḥ** (Kṛṣṇa) **āvirabhūt** (appeared).

215 By His own sweetness He draws the minds of all, and on either side Rādhā and Lalitā serve Him.

216 Nityānanda's mercy showed Him to me and gave me Śrī Rādhā and Madanamohana as my Lady and Lord.

By Nityānanda's mercy the author attains the service of Śrī Govinda —

217 To me, so lowly, He gave the sight of Śrī Govinda. It is not a thing to be told; it is beyond all telling.

*Śrī Rādhā-Govinda beneath the desire tree, served by the *sakhīs* —*

218–219 In Vṛndāvana, at Yogapīṭha, in a grove of wish-fulfilling trees, there is a pavilion of jewels, and there on a jewelled throne sits Śrī Govinda, the son of the king of Vraja. Revealing His sweetness, He enchants the whole world.

220 On His left is Śrī Rādhikā with Her friends, and with them the Lord delights in the rāsa and so many other pastimes.

The one Brahmā worships — the Deity to whom the eighteen-syllable mantra is addressed —

221 In his own world Brahmā, who sits on the lotus, meditates on Him and worships Him with the eighteen-syllable mantra.

Anubhāṣya.

Brahmā, who sits on the lotus, together with the residents of his own world, Brahmaloka, meditates on the form of Govinda, the Deity to whom the mantra is addressed (*abhidheya-vigraha*). This Govinda, on whom the residents of the fourteen worlds meditate, is worshipped with the eighteen-syllable mantra.

222 All the fourteen worlds meditate on Him, and in Vaikuṇṭha and the other abodes they sing of His pastimes and qualities.

223 His sweetness attracts even Lakṣmī. Rūpa Gosāñi has described that form:

Anubhāṣya.

Ādi 4.147: “Kṛṣṇa’s sweetness has a natural power: it makes all men and women restless, beginning with Kṛṣṇa Himself.”

In Śrī Rūpa Prabhu's *Laghu-bhāgavatāmṛta*, where the supremacy of Kṛṣṇa's sweetness is described (sections 351–352), a story from the *Padma Purāṇa* is retold: “Lakṣmī-devī saw the sweetness of Śrī Kṛṣṇa, longed for it, and began to perform austerities. Śrī Kṛṣṇa asked her, ‘Why are you performing austerities?’ Lakṣmī replied, ‘I wish to enjoy pastimes with You in Vṛndāvana in the form of a *gopī*.’ Śrī Kṛṣṇa said, ‘That is very hard to attain.’ Lakṣmī spoke again: ‘O Lord,

then I wish to stay on Your chest like a golden line.' And Śrī Kṛṣṇa said, 'So be it.' Since then Lakṣmī has remained on Kṛṣṇa's chest as a golden line." In the *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* (10.16.36) the wives of the serpent say: "Lakṣmī is the most beautiful of all, and yet she longed for the dust of Your feet. For its sake she gave up all desires, took vows, and performed austerities for a long time."

*(*Bhakti-rasāmṛta-sindhu*, Eastern Division, second wave — *sādhana-bhakti*, verse 239)*

224 "O friend, if you still care for the company of your relatives, do not look at that form of Hari called Govinda, standing here by Keśī-tīrtha: He smiles, His body bends in three places, His wide glance falls sidelong, His lips, tender as new shoots, rest upon the flute, and a peacock feather makes Him radiant." (Bhakti-rasāmṛta-sindhu, 1.2.239)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

O friend, if you cherish the company of your relatives, do not look at the form of Govinda near Keśī-ghāṭa. He is gently smiling, His body is bent in three places, and He casts sidelong glances to the left. The flute rests on His lips, tender as young lotus shoots, and a peacock feather lends Him wondrous beauty. The meaning is this: whoever sees the form of Śrī Govinda will lose all attraction for anything else.

Anubhāṣya.

sakhe (O friend), **yadi tava bandhu-saṅge** (in the company of those attached to sons, wife, and other worldly things) **raṅgaḥ** (interest) **asti** (there is), [then] **itaḥ** (here) **keśi-tīrthopakaṇṭhe** (near Keśī-tīrtha on the bank of the Yamunā) **smerām** (smiling), **bhaṅgī-traya-paricitām** (bent in three places — at the neck, the waist, and the knees), **sāci-vistīrṇa-dṛṣṭim** (casting wide sidelong glances), **vaṁśī-nyastādhara-kiśalayām** (whose lips, tender as young shoots, are placed on the flute), **candrakeṇa** (with a peacock feather) **ujjvalām** (shining, full of supreme beauty) **govindākhyām** (named Govinda) **hari-tanum** (the form of Hari, the son of Nanda) **mā prekṣiṣṭhāḥ** (do not look at). (Under the guise of a prohibition, it is said here that this form, the abode of supreme beauty, must certainly be seen. Once you taste His sweetness, you will think everything else worthless. Therefore look at Him alone — that is the intent.)

To see mundane stone, wood, or metal in the transcendental Deity is a grave offense —

225 He is the son of the king of Vraja Himself — of this there is no doubt. The fool who thinks of Him as a mere image

226 has no deliverance for that offence; he falls into a terrible hell. What more can I say?

Anubhāṣya.

The *Bhakti-sandarbha* (section 286) says: "The highest worshippers see the Deity as none other than the Supreme Lord Himself. For as soon as the idea of difference arises, *bhakti* is broken; therefore only this is proper."

The highest worshippers see the Deity (*śrī-mūrti*) as the Supreme Lord Himself. If one considers Bhagavān's Deity different from Bhagavān, *bhakti* is broken. Therefore one must regard the Deity as Bhagavān Himself. Once fallen from *bhakti*, the *jīva* becomes a nondevotee and falls into offenses. A verse of the *Padma Purāṇa* says: "One who sees stone in the worshipable Viṣṇu … is a dweller in hell." By its meaning, a *jīva* who thinks that the form of Śrī Viṣṇu is made of material substance, or is only a symbol (*pratīka*), earns the name *nārakī*, a dweller in hell. The impersonalists are deprived of seeing the Deity with eyes of love, and their vision is mundane. Therefore Vaiṣṇavas call them "offensive Māyāvādīs." And the *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam*, in the verse *yasyātma-buddhiḥ* ("one who takes [the body] as the self…"),[25] says that a person with such notions as *bhauma ijya-dhīḥ* ("regarding earthly things as worshipable") does not gain eligibility for service, because of his ignorance.

227 Through Him I attained such a Lord as Govinda — who can describe the mercy of His feet?

To be a Vaiṣṇava is to worship Rādhā-Govinda under the shelter of Nityānanda and Gaura —

228 All the circles of Vaiṣṇavas who dwell in Vṛndāvana are devoted to the name of Kṛṣṇa and are supremely auspicious.

229 Nityānanda and Śrī Caitanya are the treasure of their lives; they know nothing but devotion to Rādhā and Kṛṣṇa.

Anubhāṣya.

All the Vaiṣṇavas who live in Śrī Vṛndāvana bring supreme good. They are devoted to Kṛṣṇa's name and have taken shelter of the *bhakti* called *kīrtana*. The treasure of their lives is Śrī Gaura-Nityānanda. Apart from the eternal service of Rādhā-Kṛṣṇa, they know no other, invented *bhakti*. But nowadays some abandon the worship of the pure devotees of old and devise new paths! Some say, "Whether Śrī Gaurāṅga is Rādhā-Kṛṣṇa or not, we like His name Gaura; the name Rādhā-Kṛṣṇa does not give us as much taste." Others hold that "Gaura-bhakti" is worshipping Gaura in *madhura-rasa* (*sambhoga*) in the mood of "Nadīyā-nāgarī"! If, they say, Gaura is not worshipped in the mood of a *nāgarī*, what is the point of Śrī Gaurāṅga's separate avatāra? Such wicked views did not exist before. But as Kali grows, such grotesque ideas are spreading under the garb of Vaiṣṇavas, and the pure devotees grieve to see it. These people have become playthings of insurmountable *māyā* and consider Śrī Gaurāṅga a little greater than Śrī Rādhā-Kṛṣṇa. They reason: "Gaurāṅga is the united body of Rādhā and Kṛṣṇa, and so He is greater than Kṛṣṇa alone." Others again bow at the feet of the mundane *smārtas* and the society of *pañcopāsakas*; they oppose Gaura, Gaura's abode, Gaura's *śakti*, and devotion to Gaura, and they invent the worship of Rādhā-Kṛṣṇa by the power of knowledge born of the material senses. Both these groups oppose the pure teaching of the six Gosvāmīs. They therefore lack devotion to Bhagavān; they are given to the senses, godless, and servants of Kali. Śrī Kavirāja Gosvāmī, all-seeing and all-knowing, foresaw this: in the future, proud people averse to Hari will try by force of imagination to pass themselves off as most dear to Śrī Gaurasundara. They will forget the real Gaura, abandon devotion to Rādhā-Kṛṣṇa, and extol a Gaura of their own invention, born from the womb of their wicked desires, to deceive unfortunate *jīvas*. Needless to say, in truth the only object of worship for those who have taken shelter at the feet of Śrī Gaurāṅga is the two feet of Śrī Gāndharvikā-Giridhārī.

Only by Nityānanda's mercy does one attain the lotus feet of the Vaiṣṇavas —

230 The dust of those Vaiṣṇavas' feet and the shelter of their shade — this the mercy of Lord Nityānanda gave to me, the lowly one.

231 “There everything can be attained” — these words of the Lord are the sūtra, and this is my explanation of it.

Anubhāṣya.

In Vṛndāvana the author wrote *Śrī Caitanya-caritāmṛta* at the order of the Vaiṣṇavas, but the root and source of this work is Nitāi's merciful order. See Ādi 5.196.[26]

By Nityānanda's mercy all desires are fulfilled —

232 All this I attained when I came to Vṛndāvana, and all of it I attained by the mercy of this Lord.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Āya means having come.

Thus ends the fifth chapter of the “Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.”

233 Shamelessly I write my own story: Nityānanda’s qualities have made me mad and make me write.

234 The glory of Nityānanda Prabhu’s qualities is boundless: even Śeṣa with His thousand mouths cannot reach its end.

Anubhāṣya.

See Madhya 21.10 and 12, and *Bhāgavatam* 2.7.41 and 10.14.7.

Thus ends the fifth chapter of the “Anubhāṣya.”

235 Praying at the feet of Śrī Rūpa and Śrī Raghunātha, I, Kṛṣṇadāsa, narrate the *Caitanya-caritāmṛta*.

Notes

1. The same verse as Ādi 1.7. ↩
2. The same verse as Ādi 1.8. ↩

3. As in the Gauḍīya Maṭha edition: «নাহিক নিয়ম» (another reading: «নাহি তাঁর সীমা»). ↩
4. The same verse as Ādi 1.9. ↩
5. The same verse as Ādi 2.67. ↩
6. The same verse as Ādi 2.55. ↩
7. The same verse as Ādi 1.10. ↩
8. The same verse as Ādi 1.11. ↩
9. The Gauḍīya Maṭha edition reads «অধম জীবেরে চড়াইল ঊর্দ্ধ সীমা» (“He raised a fallen soul to the highest limit”), with the heading “The greatness of Nityānanda’s mercy shown by the author’s own story.” Other editions read «যৈছে চড়াইল» (“how He raised…”). ↩
10. As in the Gauḍīya Maṭha edition: «বসিয়া» (“sitting”; another reading: «আসিয়া», “having come”). ↩
11. As in the Gauḍīya Maṭha edition: «দন্তে» (“in the teeth”; another reading: «দন্ত»). ↩
12. *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 7.1.31. ↩
13. *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 2.6.43–45. ↩
14. The edition reads *loka-draṣṭā* (“who beholds the worlds”); the verse has *loka-sraṣṭuḥ* (“of the creator of the worlds”). Possibly a misprint. ↩
15. The verse translation reads differently: the knowledge that the avatāra and the source of the avatāras are nondifferent is ascribed to those who know the truth; Bhaktivinoda calls “one who sees no difference” the person who confuses them. ↩
16. The verse translation reads differently: it takes *kadamba* as the *kadamba* flower (“like kadamba blossoms”). ↩
17. Skt. *tantreṇa*, a grammatical term: one and the same word read in two senses at once. The edition's Bengali paraphrase below takes it as “in the *tantra* scriptures.” ↩
18. *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 7.1.31. ↩
19. The words of the Earth to Dharma: *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 1.16.30 (the edition has “the first chapter of the first canto”). ↩
20. *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 10.39.55. ↩
21. *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 10.1.24. ↩
22. Caitanya-caritāmṛta, Antya 4.219–221 (in the verse numbering of the translation used in this edition). ↩
23. *Vilāpa-kusumāñjali* 6. ↩
24. The edition cites Antya 4.224; in the verse numbering of the translation used here the passage is verses 223–224. ↩

25. *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 10.84.13. ↩
26. Cf. verses 195–196: in 195 Nityānanda tells the author to go to Vṛndāvana; in 196 He sends him off with a gesture of His hand and disappears. ↩

“Śrī Caitanya-caritāmṛta”

Ādi-līlā

Chapter 6

Determining the Truth of Śrī Advaita

(English translation from the Bengali, following the Gauḍīya Maṭha edition and the «Anubhāṣya», 2026 — draft)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya

Summary. Here the true nature and the glory of Śrīmad Advaita Ācārya Prabhu are established by examining two verses. *Māyā* has two functions (*vṛttis*): *nimitta* and *upādāna*. The *puruṣa-avatāra* seen in *prakṛti* as the efficient cause is called “Mahā-Viṣṇu.” And Mahā-Viṣṇu's second form, present in *pradhāna*, the material cause, is “Advaita.” This Advaita took on a special role as agent in the creation of the world and so on; He also accepted the mood of a devotee and taught *bhakti* to the world. To say that He is Caitanya's servant only adds to His glory, for in no *rasa* can one taste Kṛṣṇa's sweetness without the mood of a servant (*dāsya-bhāva*) contained within each of them.

By the mercy of Advaitācārya one becomes able to describe His true nature —

1 I bow to Śrī Advaita Ācārya, whose deeds are wondrous. By His grace even an ignorant person may describe His true nature.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

I bow down to Śrīmad Advaitācārya, whose deeds are wondrous; by His mercy even an ignorant person can describe His true nature.

Anubhāṣya.

yasya (Advaita Prabhu's) **prasādāt** (by the mercy) **ajñaḥ api** (even an ignorant person) **tat-svarūpaṁ** (the truth about Him) **nirūpayet** (can describe), **tam**

adbhuta-ceṣṭitam (Him whose deeds are wondrous) **śrīmad-advaitācāryam** (I) **vande**.

2 Glory, glory to Śrī Caitanya! Glory to Nityānanda! Glory to Advaitacandra! Glory to all the devotees of Gaura!

3 In five verses I have set out the truth of Śrī Nityānanda; now in two I speak of the greatness of Advaita Ācārya.

Explanation of the twelfth and thirteenth of the fourteen opening verses — (a verse from the diary of Śrī Svarūpa Gosvāmī)

4 Mahā-Viṣṇu is the maker of the world, who creates it through māyā; and this Lord Advaita Ācārya is His avatāra.[1]

Anubhāṣya.

yaḥ jagat-kartā mahā-viṣṇuḥ (the shelter of the efficient cause) **māyayā adaḥ** (this world) **sṛjati**, **tasya avatāraḥ eva ayam īśvaraḥ** (the shelter of the material cause) **advaitācāryaḥ**.

5 He is called Advaita because He is non-different from Hari, and Ācārya because He teaches bhakti. I take shelter of Him, the Lord Advaita Ācārya, who has descended as a devotee.[2]

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Mahā-Viṣṇu, who creates this world by *māyā*, is the Creator of the world; the Lord Advaitācārya is His avatāra. He is called "Advaita" because He is a *tattva* nondifferent from Hari, and "Ācārya" because He teaches *bhakti*. I take shelter of this Lord Advaitācārya, the avatāra in the form of a devotee.

Anubhāṣya.

hariṇā (with the Viṣṇu-*tattva*) (in nonduality) **advaitāt** (because there is no difference) — "**advaitam**"; **bhakti-śaṁsanāt** (because He instructs in *bhajana*) — "**ācāryam**"; **bhaktāvatāram īśam tam advaitācāryam āśraye** (I surrender).

The truth of Śrī Advaita and His greatness —

6 Advaita Ācārya Gosāñi is the Lord Himself; His greatness lies beyond the reach of the jīva.

The avatāra of Mahā-Viṣṇu —

7 Mahā-Viṣṇu carries out the creation of the world and all that goes with it, and Advaita Ācārya is His direct avatāra.

A part nondifferent from Kāraṇārṇavaśāyī —

8 That Puruṣa creates and maintains the world through māyā, and in play He brings forth endless universes.

9 By His will He manifests endless forms, and in one of them He enters each universe.

10 Advaita is a part (*aṁśa*) of that Puruṣa, and there is no difference between Them at all: He is a particular body of the Puruṣa, and the two are never apart.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
One and the same *māyā* is called "*pradhāna*" in its material portion (*upādāna*) and "*māyā*" in its efficient portion (*nimitta*). In keeping with these two functions of *māyā*, Mahā-Viṣṇu abides in two forms. In one form Mahā-Viṣṇu abides in *prakṛti* as the efficient cause of the world — this is the form of "Viṣṇu." In His second form He abides in *pradhāna* and, in the form of Rudra, is called "Advaita." Advaita is therefore not in the least different from the Puruṣa; only Their bodies differ.

*The presiding Lord of *pradhāna*, the material cause of the world —*

11 Taking pradhāna, the material basis of the world, Advaita assists the Puruṣa, and by His will He fashions millions of universes.

Śrī Advaita, full of auspiciousness —

12 Advaita is the good of the whole world and the abode of all auspicious qualities. His conduct is ever auspicious, and His name is Maṅgala, “the Auspicious”.

Anubhāṣya.

Śrī Advaita Prabhu is Mahā-Viṣṇu. He is the ācārya. Viṣṇu's conduct is auspicious in His very nature as the agent. When the *jīva* sees the auspiciousness in His auspicious pastimes and in His very being, good comes to the *jīva*. He is the source of all auspiciousness. His conduct, turned toward service, brings good to everyone in the world. The worthless people of the world (“the world's encumbrance”) cannot understand this pure, eternal, complete and free auspiciousness, and so they fall away from *bhakti*, the natural function of the soul. Acts rooted in the wish to enjoy, the attainment of featureless liberation and every other inauspicious thing find no place in Śrī Advaita, who possesses spiritual qualities. Certain *jīvas* of demoniac nature, bewildered by *māyā*, failed to understand that He is the nondual Viṣṇu-*tattva*; holding to the devotionless doctrine of *kevalādvaita*, they only pretended to follow Him. The Ācārya punished these nondevotees under the guise of nourishing their self-conceit through His own *māyā*. Yet even this punishment is only an auspicious act. The Viṣṇu-*vastu*, by both the direct and the indirect way (*anvaya* and *vyatireka*), brings the *jīva* nothing but good. One who passes off the inauspicious as auspicious cannot grasp the Source of Viṣṇu's *māyā* in its material aspect. Some say that Advaita Prabhu had another name, “Maṅgala.” As a *naimittika-avatāra* (one who descends for a particular occasion), He instills into *prakṛti* the power of the material cause. He is not an inauspicious material object, nor is He the abode of inauspicious material qualities. By following His example the *jīva* attains good. When the *jīva* hears and chants His name, all that is inauspicious in it is destroyed. One must not attribute to the Viṣṇu-*vastu* any quality that is undesirable, inferior, limited or featureless. Only by gaining transcendental knowledge of His real being does the *jīva* attain the highest good (*niḥśreyasa*).

The Puruṣa creates, taking with Him countless opulences —

13 Taking millions of parts, millions of potencies and millions of avatāras, the Puruṣa creates the whole world.

*The two forms of *māyā* —*

14 Māyā has two aspects, the efficient cause (*nimitta*) and the material cause (*upādāna*): as the efficient cause it is called māyā, and as the material cause, pradhāna.

Anubhāṣya.
See Madhya 20.271.

Kāraṇaśāyī creates in two forms —

15 In the same way the Lord, the Puruṣa, assumes two forms and creates the universe with these two causes, the efficient and the material.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
Prakṛti has two divisions, "*nimitta*" and "*upādāna*." In the same way the Puruṣa creates the universe by taking two forms: as the *nimitta*, the form of "Mahā-Viṣṇu," and as the *upādāna*, the form of "Advaita."

Anubhāṣya.
When people try to determine the source of the visible world, two different methods of reasoning appear. According to one view, the world is created from the Reality full of being, consciousness and bliss (*sac-cid-ānanda*), but only secondarily; primarily, that Reality manifests Goloka, Vaikuṇṭha and the other abodes together with their associates. According to the other view, the source is the source of the unreal, the unconscious and the joyless: it is unknowable, unmanifest and material. The former view is upheld by Vedānta, the purpose of the Vedas and their final fruit. Sāṅkhya and other *smṛtis* put forward the opposite, latter view in order to oppose the teaching of the true Reality. The visible world is perceived, for the most part, as unconscious. In living beings there is a semblance of consciousness (*cid-ābhāsa*) bound up with the universe fashioned by *guṇa-māyā*. Some hold that even this conscious principle is produced from *prakṛti* by the *guṇas*, and on this ground they set their teaching on the material cause apart from Vedānta. But the source, the cause of all causes, is the Possessor of potency (*śaktimat-tattva*), and the potency abides in the Possessor of potency. Besides the potency from which the visible world arose, other potencies also abide eternally in that great, all-sustaining Reality. Those bound to serving the objects of the visible world perceive the worldly potency and think Bhagavān merely its possessor. They

reach a false conclusion (*apasiddhānta*): that the Possessor of potency was born of a single potency, and that, since with mundane minds they see partial possessors of potency, the undivided Possessor of potency was also born of *prakṛti*. If one takes as the “source” what mundane sense-knowledge defines as knowable being and non-being, one will of course conclude that consciousness arises from the unconscious. But the actual truth rests in the true Reality, who possesses potency. There is a method that does not accept as the root cause the Reality who creates place, time and circumstance; it first takes up countless objects in all their variety and from them, relying on inference, ascends toward the One. This method is called *adhiroha-vāda*, the ascending method. In the descending (*avaroha*) method of reasoning, the Reality is the cause of all causes. Since infinite potency abides in Him, He is the Truth possessed of features (*saviśeṣa-tattva*). Even His featurelessness is but one among countless ways of considering His features. When people start from notions of unconscious objects, take Him to be an effect and search for His cause, there arises a mind like that of one who has kept company with intoxicants. In fact, the idea that inert *prakṛti* is the root cause is far from the real truth. The world, unmanifest and evolved from the unconscious potency (*acit-śakti*), comes from the power of glance (*īkṣaṇa*) of the Supreme Lord, the Possessor of infinite potencies. Only by receiving power from the All-powerful does *prakṛti* build the world, which lies in time and space and is accessible to the *jīva*'s material senses. The true Reality, who possesses infinite potencies, is perceived by the conditioned *jīva* only through the potency that builds the world. Such errors of reasoning arise from failing to discern how the Reality is related to His potency; they give rise in the *jīva* to *vivarta*, taking one thing for another. Until the truth is revealed, the *jīva* turned away from Bhagavān wanders in the world fit for enjoyment and does not find the true Reality.

Śrīla Baladeva Vidyābhūṣaṇa writes in the *Govinda-bhāṣya* (*Brahma-sūtra*, Chapter 2, *pāda* 2): “Kapila, the teacher of Sāṅkhya, gathered the *tattvas* as follows. *Prakṛti* is the state of equilibrium of *sattva*, *rajas* and *tamas*. From *prakṛti* comes the *mahat*; from the *mahat*, *ahaṅkāra*; from *ahaṅkāra*, the five *tanmātras*, both kinds of senses and the gross elements; and there is the *puruṣa*. Such is the set of twenty-five. *Sattva* and the other *guṇas*, abiding in equilibrium, are *prakṛti*. They are to be understood as happiness, sorrow and delusion respectively, for in the world, their effect, everything is seen to take the form of happiness and the rest. Thus a young woman who gives her husband happiness by love is *sāttvikī*; when she gives him sorrow

by her pique (*māna*) she is *rājasī*; when she bewilders him by separation she is *tāmasī*. All states are to be viewed in this way. ‘Both kinds of senses’ means the ten external senses and the one internal sense, the mind — eleven in all. *Prakṛti* is eternal and all-pervading. The root has no root; therefore the root is rootless. The material cause of all is not limited: ‘All-pervading, because effects are seen everywhere,’ say the *sūtras*. The *mahat*, *ahaṅkāra* and the five *tanmātras* are the seven *prakṛti-vikṛtis*: they are *prakṛti* (that which produces) for *ahaṅkāra* and the rest, and *vikṛti* (that which is produced) for *pradhāna* and the rest. The eleven senses and the five elements are sixteen, and they are only *vikṛtis*. The *puruṣa* does not change; therefore he is neither *prakṛti* nor *vikṛti* of anything. *Prakṛti*, however, is ever transforming. Though itself unconscious, it is the cause of the enjoyment and the liberation (*apavarga*) of many conscious beings. Though utterly beyond the senses, it is inferred from its effects. It is one, yet its *guṇas* are unequal, and by its power of transformation it gives birth to the world with its varied design, beginning with the *mahat*. Thus it is both the efficient and the material cause of the world. The *puruṣa* is inactive and without *guṇas*, an all-pervading spirit; he is distinct in each body and is inferred from the fact that composite things exist for the sake of another. Because the *puruṣa* neither changes nor acts, he is neither agent nor enjoyer. Given this nature of *prakṛti* and *puruṣa*, their mere proximity leads to an exchange of properties: consciousness is superimposed on *prakṛti*, and agency and enjoyment on the *puruṣa*. Thus from non-discrimination comes enjoyment, and from discrimination, liberation. When *prakṛti* becomes indifferent, that is [liberation]. Kapila set out such points in *sūtras* with arguments. In this system he accepted perception, inference and scriptural testimony as the means of valid knowledge (*pramāṇas*): ‘The *pramāṇas* are three; when a thing is established by them, all is established; there is no further means of establishing.’ Among these, there is no great dispute about matters established by perception and scripture. But *pradhāna*, which he infers to be the cause of the world by *sūtras* such as ‘From limitation,’ ‘From uniformity,’ ‘From potency’ and others, must be refuted: by refuting it one refutes his whole doctrine. Here a doubt arises: is *pradhāna* the efficient and material cause of the world or not? [The opponent says:] *Pradhāna* is exactly that. The world is *sāttvika* and so on; therefore *pradhāna*, which consists of *sattva* and the other *guṇas*, must be inferred to be its material cause. We see that the material cause of effects like a pot is homogeneous with them — clay and the like. And just as we say ‘the tree bears fruit’ or ‘the water flows,’ so inert *pradhāna* too has the capacity to act. Therefore *pradhāna* alone

is the material cause of the world and its maker. When this is proposed, [it is said] (*Brahma-sūtra*, Chapter 2, *pāda* 2):

"'And because design is impossible, not that which is inferred' (1).

"'That which is inferred' is what is inferred to be the cause of the world, namely inert *pradhāna*. It is neither the material cause of the world nor its efficient cause. Why? 'Because design is impossible': inert *pradhāna*, unless a conscious being directs it, cannot build the varied world. In our world, bricks and the like do not assemble into palaces and other buildings unless a conscious being directs them. The word 'and' adds the impossibility of concomitance (*anvaya*): external things such as pots are not endowed with the nature of happiness and the rest. Happiness and the rest are internal; pots and the like merely cause happiness and so on, and no one perceives them to be happiness themselves.

"'And because of activity' (2).

"Supply: 'when the inert is directed by a conscious being.' Clearly the activity belongs to the controller in whose presence the inert acts — as with a chariot and its driver. This also refutes 'it bears fruit' and the like: there too a conscious being is in control — this is known from the *Antaryāmi-brāhmaṇa*, and it will become clear later. 'And' here has a restrictive sense. Or else: activity is seen only in a conscious being — 'I do' — therefore the inert cannot be an agent. One may object: the mere proximity of *prakṛti* and *puruṣa* leads to a mutual superimposition of properties, and this explains the design of the world. We reply: is the proximity that causes superimposition simply their coexistence, or some change in *prakṛti* or in the *puruṣa*? Not the first, for then superimposition would occur even in the liberated. Not the second: a change in *prakṛti* is held to be an effect of superimposition and cannot be its cause, and a change in the *puruṣa* is not accepted at all.

"One may object: milk turns into curd by itself, and rainwater from a cloud, though it has a single taste, takes on varied tastes — sweet, sour and others — in the palm, the mango and other trees. In the same way *pradhāna*, because of the variety of the *puruṣas*' *karma*, takes the form of bodies, worlds and the rest. To this it is said:

"'If [it is said:] like milk and water — there too' (3).

"Milk and water, too, become active only when a conscious being directs them, and not by themselves: so we infer from the example of the chariot and the like. And

that He directs them is established by the *Antaryāmi-brāhmaṇa*.

“‘And because there is nothing apart [from *pradhāna*], [there can be no talk of] independence’ (4).

“‘And’ has the sense of ‘also.’ Before creation, they say, there was no other cause apart from *pradhāna*, and *pradhāna* depended on nothing. Yet even then *pradhāna* alone cannot bring about its own transformation. They accepted that before the first creation there was no cause apart from *pradhāna* to impel it or to restrain it. But then they again needed such a cause: they accepted another cause, the proximity of consciousness. Thus the doctrine that the inert alone can be an agent collapses. Moreover, if there is no separate cause and proximity is always present, effects would arise even during the dissolution of the world (*pralaya*). Nor can one say that there are no effects then because the fruits of past deeds (*adṛṣṭa*) have not awakened, for their awakening would also have to be ascribed to that very time.

“One may object: grass, creepers, leaves and the like turn into milk by their own nature, without any other cause; so too *pradhāna* turns into the *mahat* and the rest. To this it is said:

“‘And not like grass and the like, because it does not happen elsewhere’ (5).

“‘And’ is for emphasis. This argument is not clever. Why? ‘It does not happen elsewhere’: grass and the like, when eaten by a bull or a similar animal, do not turn into milk. If grass and the like turned into milk by their own nature, the same would happen to grass fallen in a courtyard; but it does not. Therefore nature alone is not enough. This happens by the will of the Lord of all, through a connection with a particular being.

“It has been shown that *pradhāna* is inert and therefore does not act by itself. Now, to make you happy, let us grant that it does; even then nothing you wish for will follow. So it is said:

“‘And even if granted — because there is no purpose’ (6).

“‘Not’ is understood in the four [*sūtras*]. [Sāṅkhya] holds that *pradhāna* acts for the enjoyment and the liberation of the *puruṣa*: ‘The *puruṣa* will enjoy me, experience my faults and attain liberation, which is my indifference to him.’ The activity of *pradhāna* is for another's sake, since it does not enjoy anything itself, like a camel carrying saffron. And [Sāṅkhya] holds that the *puruṣa*, though not an agent, is an enjoyer: even one who does not cook enjoys the fruit, like an eater

of food. But such activity is unreasonable. Why? If it is granted, it will bear no fruit. Its fruit would be the *puruṣa*'s enjoyment, that is, his beholding *prakṛti*, and his liberation, that is, the indifference of *prakṛti*. Enjoyment is impossible: before the activity begins, the *puruṣa* is pure consciousness, changeless and not an agent, and cannot undergo the change of beginning to behold *prakṛti*. Liberation is also impossible: he had it even before *prakṛti* became active, and so the activity would be pointless. And if mere proximity is the cause of enjoyment, then even the liberated will enjoy, for proximity is eternal.

“One may object: a blind man who can walk but cannot see moves through the proximity of a lame man who cannot walk but can see. Iron, though inert, moves in the presence of a magnet. So too *prakṛti*, though unconscious, in the presence of the *puruṣa*, who is pure spirit, becomes as if conscious through his reflection and acts in creation for his sake. To this it is said:

“‘If [it is said:] like a man and a stone — even then [the argument fails]’ (7).

“Even in this way one cannot prove that the inert acts by itself. The lame man, though he cannot walk, has his own capacities: he sees the road and points it out. The blind man, though he cannot see, also has capacities: he accepts directions. The magnet has nearness to the iron and so on. But the *puruṣa*, eternally inactive and without properties, undergoes no change at all. If creation is held to come from mere proximity, then, since proximity is eternal, creation would be eternal and there would be no liberation at all. Moreover, the lame man and the blind man are both conscious, while the magnet and the iron are both inert; the examples are plainly dissimilar.

“Some hold that the universe is created when one *guṇa* rises and the others decline, so that a relation of principal and subordinate arises among them. This is refuted as follows:

“‘And because principal status is impossible’ (8).

“The state of *pradhāna* is the equilibrium of *sattva* and the other *guṇas*. In that state none of them, independent by nature, can become principal: the other two are equal to it and cannot become subordinate. Thus no relation of principal and subordinate arises among the *guṇas*. Nor can its cause be Īśvara or time, for [Sāṅkhya] does not accept them. As Kapila says: ‘Because Īśvara is not proved’; ‘He would be neither liberated nor bound; therefore He is not proved’; and ‘Space and time come from ether and the rest.’ Nor can the *puruṣa* be that cause, for he is indifferent here. Therefore a creation caused by the imbalance of the *guṇas*

does not take place. Furthermore, since there is no cause, the *guṇas* might lose their balance even at the dissolution of the world, and not lose it at the first creation.

“One may object: we should infer that the *guṇas* have different natures, according to their effects; then there is no room for the fault mentioned. To this it is said:

“‘And if inferred otherwise — because they lack the power of knowing’ (9).

“Even if one infers that the *guṇas* have various powers, there is no escape from the fault. Why? ‘Because they lack the power of knowing,’ that is, because the *guṇas* do not know: they have no thought ‘I create this, and in this way.’ From the inert, devoid of knowledge, there is no creation — just as with bricks — unless a conscious being directs it.”

Kapila, the teacher of Sāṅkhya, gathered the *tattvas* as follows. In his view, “*prakṛti*” is the state of equilibrium of the three *guṇas*: *sattva*, *rajas* and *tamas*. From *prakṛti* comes the *mahat-tattva*; from it, *ahaṅkāra*; from *ahaṅkāra*, the five *tanmātras*; from them, the senses of knowledge and the senses of action, and also the gross elements; and there is the “*puruṣa*.” These are the twenty-five *tattvas* in all. The three *guṇas*, *sattva* and the others, abiding in equilibrium, are *prakṛti*. These three *guṇas* are to be understood as happiness, sorrow and delusion respectively, for in the world, the effect of *prakṛti*, only states such as happiness are seen. An example: a young woman who gives her husband happiness by love displays a “*sāttvika*” mood; the same woman becomes “*rājasī*” when she causes sorrow, and “*tāmasī*” when she bewilders. The words “both kinds of senses” mean the ten external senses and the one internal sense, the mind — eleven senses in all. *Prakṛti* is eternal and all-pervading. At the root there is no root (no conscious principle); therefore the root (*pradhāna*) has no root, that is, it has no other cause. This *pradhāna* is unlimited and is the material cause of everything; this follows from *sūtras* such as “All-pervading, because effects are seen everywhere.” The *mahat-tattva*, the *ahaṅkāra-tattva* and the five *tanmātras* are the seven *prakṛti-vikṛtis*: they are *prakṛti* for *ahaṅkāra* and the rest, and at the same time transformations of *pradhāna*. The eleven senses and the five great elements are the sixteen transformations. The *puruṣa* does not change, and therefore he is neither *prakṛti* nor a transformation of anything. *Prakṛti* is ever transforming; though itself unconscious, it is the cause of the enjoyment and the liberation (*apavarga*)

of many conscious *jīvas*; though beyond the senses, it is inferred from its effects. *Prakṛti* is one, but its *guṇas* are unequal, and so by its power of transformation it gives birth to a world full of varied creations, beginning with the *mahat*. Thus *prakṛti* is both the efficient and the material cause of the world. The *puruṣa* is inactive, without *guṇas* and all-pervading. He is spiritual by nature and distinct in each body; he is inferred from the way *pradhāna* is set in motion. Because the *puruṣa* neither changes nor acts, he is neither agent nor enjoyer. Such is the truth of *prakṛti* and *puruṣa*, and therefore their mere proximity leads to an exchange of properties: consciousness is superimposed on *prakṛti*, and agency and enjoyment on the *puruṣa*. While there is no such discrimination, there is enjoyment; with discrimination comes *apavarga*, that is, liberation. These and other points — for example, the *puruṣa*'s indifference toward *prakṛti* — are set out in *sūtras* with arguments. In his system the author of Sāṅkhya accepted three means of knowledge (*pramāṇas*): “perception,” “inference” and “scripture” (*āgama*). When something is established by them, all is established. (Comparison and the other *pramāṇas* are included in these three and are not separate *pramāṇas*.) There is no great dispute about matters established by perception and scripture. But now we must refute the claim that *pradhāna* is the cause of the world, which is inferred by *sūtras* such as “From limitation,” “From uniformity,” “From potency” and others; for by refuting this view one refutes all the other views of Sāṅkhya. The doubt here is this: is “*pradhāna*” the efficient and the material cause of the world or not? The *pūrvapakṣa* grants *pradhāna* both. The *pūrvapakṣa* says: *pradhāna*, consisting of *sattva* and the rest, is inferred precisely as the material cause of the world. The material cause is always homogeneous with the effect: thus for a pot and similar things the material cause is clay and the like, which is homogeneous with them. An inert tree bears fruit; equally inert water flows; seeing this, one concludes that inert, unconscious *pradhāna* too is able to create the world. So: “*pradhāna* is both the material and the efficient cause of the world.” To refute this conclusion of the *pūrvapakṣa*, the author introduces the first *sūtra*.

Pradhāna is unconscious; therefore inert *pradhāna* cannot be either the material or the efficient cause of the world. Looking at the varied design of this world, it is clear that inert *pradhāna* cannot build the visible world without the direction of a conscious being, and that it is unreasonable to infer so. In this world, bricks and the like have never yet assembled into palaces and similar buildings unless a conscious being directed them. The word “and” in the *sūtra* adds the

impossibility of concomitance (*anvaya*). External objects such as pots are never endowed with the nature of happiness and the like. For happiness and the rest are internal properties, and therefore they cannot accompany external things. Above all, a pot and the like merely cause happiness and so on; they themselves are not perceived as happiness.

The second *sūtra*. Even if we look at activity, *pradhāna* cannot be the cause. Activity is seen only in what is inert and directed by a conscious being. Clearly that activity belongs to the one under whose direction the inert is set in motion. The best example is a chariot and its driver. The same holds for the example “the tree bears fruit” and similar ones offered in support of *pradhāna* as the cause. There too the direction of a conscious being is accepted, for the *Antaryāmi-brāhmaṇa* speaks of it; this will be explained later in this commentary. The word “and” in the *sūtra* has a restrictive sense. In the example “I am doing,” activity is seen only in a conscious being; therefore the inert cannot be an agent. You may say: the world is designed because, through the mere proximity of *prakṛti* and *puruṣa*, their properties are superimposed on each other. The answer: this cannot be said either. Very well — is the proximity that causes the mutual superimposition of properties the coexistence of *prakṛti* and *puruṣa*, or some change in *prakṛti* or in the *puruṣa*? The answer: it can by no means be their coexistence, for if we accept that, we must accept superimposition in all liberated *puruṣas* as well. Nor can this proximity be a change in *prakṛti*: a change in *prakṛti* is considered an effect of superimposition and so cannot be its cause. Nor can it be a change in the *puruṣa*: a change in the *puruṣa* cannot be accepted either. Therefore “*pradhāna*” cannot be the cause of the world.

You may say: as milk turns into curd by itself, and as the water from a single cloud, though it has one taste, becomes sweet, sour and of many tastes in the fruits of the palm, the mango and other trees, so the one *pradhāna*, according to the variety of the *puruṣas*' *karma*, transforms into bodies, worlds and the rest. In reply the author says:

The third *sūtra*. Unconscious things such as milk and water also act in their effects only when a conscious being directs them; they are not set in motion by themselves: so it is inferred from the example of the chariot and the like. And from the *Antaryāmi-brāhmaṇa* it is established that these two inert things are directed by consciousness.

The fourth *sūtra*. The claim that there is no cause apart from *pradhāna* had to be abandoned; therefore the claim that *pradhāna* alone is the agent is also untenable. The word *api* means the same as *ca*, that is, “and” (conjunction). The view that before creation there was no cause apart from *pradhāna* has been given up; therefore the view that *pradhāna* alone transforms itself is also refuted. The view that “before the first creation there is no other cause apart from *pradhāna* to impel it or restrain it” has been set aside, for at that point another cause is accepted — the proximity of the conscious principle. Therefore the doctrine that the inert alone is the agent is refuted. Moreover, under such a *pūrvapakṣa* effects would arise even during the dissolution of the world: since there is no cause apart from *pradhāna* and proximity to it remains, effects would arise at *pralaya* just as at creation. Nor can one say that there are no effects at *pralaya* because the *adṛṣṭa* has not awakened, for the awakening of that *adṛṣṭa* might also come at that very time.

You may say: as grass, leaves and the like, eaten by a cow or another animal, turn into milk by themselves, so *pradhāna* transforms into the *tattvas* beginning with the *mahat*. In reply the author says:

The fifth *sūtra*. Elsewhere grass does not turn into milk; therefore one cannot say that *pradhāna*, like grass, transforms by its own nature (by itself). The word “and” here is for affirmation. Such a *pūrvapakṣa* is untenable, for this is not seen elsewhere: grass eaten by a bull or a similar animal does not turn into milk, and so the transformation is not natural. Besides, if grass and the like turned into milk by their own nature, this would be seen in a courtyard too. Since it is not seen, nature alone cannot be called the cause of the transformation; its cause is the will of the Lord of all: “Let grass, in connection with particular living beings, turn into milk.”

It has been proved that *pradhāna* is inert and therefore does not come into action by itself. Next the author says: even if, to please you, I grant it, nothing you desire will follow.

The sixth *sūtra*. Even if one grants that *pradhāna* acts by its own nature, there is no purpose in it. In four *sūtras* the sense “not” is understood. It seems that *pradhāna* acts for the sake of enjoyment and liberation: “The *puruṣa* will enjoy me, feel my faults and attain liberation, that is, indifference toward me.” As a camel carries a load of saffron only for others and does not enjoy it itself, so *pradhāna* acts only for the sake of others. And the *puruṣa*, it seems, though not an agent, is an enjoyer. As an eater enjoys food though he has not cooked it, so the

puruṣa tastes the fruits. But to hold, with the *pūrvapakṣa*, that *pradhāna* acts in this way is unreasonable: even if it is granted, no fruit is seen. The fruit of the activity is the *puruṣa*'s enjoyment, that is, beholding *prakṛti*, and liberation, that is, indifference toward *prakṛti*. Enjoyment from the activity of *pradhāna* is impossible, for then the *puruṣa* — pure consciousness, changeless and not an agent — would enjoy only because, by beholding *prakṛti*, he came into contact with it and underwent change. *Apavarga* from the activity of *pradhāna* is also impossible: *apavarga* existed even before the activity arose, and so the activity is useless. And if mere proximity is called the cause of enjoyment, then, since proximity is eternal, even the liberated will have to enjoy.

You may say: a blind man who can walk but cannot see begins to move near a lame man who cannot walk but can see; and inert iron also moves near a magnet. So too *prakṛti*, though unconscious, near the *puruṣa*, who is pure consciousness, under the influence of his reflection sets about creation and the rest for the *puruṣa*'s enjoyment, as if it were a conscious being. In reply the author says:

The seventh *sūtra*. Even if the *puruṣa* is like a magnet, inert *pradhāna* does not act by itself. Even so, one cannot prove that the inert acts by itself. The lame man cannot walk, yet he has his own capacities — to point out the road and to give directions. The blind man cannot see, yet he too has a capacity — to accept the lame man's directions. And a magnet can come near iron. But the eternally inactive *puruṣa*, devoid of properties, undergoes no change whatever. If proximity itself is accepted as change, then, since proximity is eternal, one must accept eternal creation and the absence of liberation. Above all, the lame man and the blind man are both conscious, while the magnet and the iron are both inert; the examples are plainly dissimilar.

Next the author refutes the view that the universe is created because the *guṇas* rise and decline and a relation of principal and subordinate arises among them:

The eighth *sūtra*. The principal status of a *guṇa* is impossible in itself; therefore this view is untenable. The abiding of the *guṇas* — *sattva* and the rest — in equilibrium is called “the state of *pradhāna*.” In that state the *guṇas* are independent by nature, and so none of them proves to be principal over another. For if one of the three *guṇas* is accepted as principal, the other two, being equal to it, cannot become subordinate. A relation of principal and subordinate among the *guṇas* never arises. Nor can Īśvara or time be called its maker, for no one [among them] accepts this. Kapila himself said: “Since [Īśvara] could be neither

liberated nor bound — that is, since there is no proof — Īśvara is not proved." Space and time arise from ether and the rest; the *puruṣa* is not their maker, for he is entirely indifferent to activity. Nor is an imbalance of the *guṇas* the cause of creation. Moreover, since there is no cause, the *guṇas* might lose their balance at every later creation, but not at the first.

You may say: one can infer that the *guṇas*, according to their effects, are of different natures; then there is no room for the fault mentioned. In reply the author says:

The ninth *sūtra*. Even if one infers otherwise, the inert does not act by itself. That is, even if one infers that the *guṇas* are endowed with such varied powers, there is no escaping the fault: the *guṇas* lack the capacity to know (consciousness); evidently they do not have even the thought "Here I am, and this is how I create." Creation from inert matter devoid of knowledge is never possible. As bricks, wood and other unconscious things can do nothing unless a conscious being directs them, so the unconscious *guṇas* can do nothing unless the potency of the conscious Supreme Lord directs them.

(Chapter 2, *pāda* 1.) "The great sage Kapila, desiring liberation, composed the *smṛti* [Sāṅkhya] to elaborate the meaning of the *jñāna-kāṇḍa*. He duly accepted the *agnihotra* and the other rites enjoined by the *karma-kāṇḍa*, and the Śrutis recognize him as trustworthy: 'the sage Kapila, born [in the beginning],' and so on. By his *sūtras* 'Now, the complete cessation of the threefold misery is the highest goal of man,' 'Not by visible means, for even after cessation [misery] returns' and others, it is established there that the cause of the world is unconscious, independent *pradhāna* alone; [this is also said in the *sūtras*] 'For the liberation of the liberated,' 'Or for its own sake — of *pradhāna*,' 'Though *pradhāna* is unconscious, its activity is like that of milk' and others. If Brahman is accepted as the cause, this *smṛti* will be left without a subject, for the whole of it speaks of nothing but *pradhāna*. Therefore Vedānta should be interpreted so as not to contradict the *smṛti* of Kapila, who is entirely trustworthy. The *smṛtis* of Manu and others will not be left without a subject, for by setting forth *dharma* they elaborate the meaning of the *karma-kāṇḍa* and so have their own subject. When this is proposed, it is said:

"'If [it is said:] there follows the fault that the *smṛti* has no room — no, for there follows the fault that other *smṛtis* have no room' (1).

"'Has no room' means is left without a subject. If Vedānta is interpreted according to its single import (*samanvaya*), the Sāṅkhya *smṛti* incurs the fault of being left without a subject; so must [the texts of Vedānta] be interpreted in a sense contrary to the Śruti? If that is said — no. Why? 'Other' and so on. For then a great fault would arise: other *smṛtis* would be left without a subject — the *smṛtis* of Manu and others, which follow Vedānta and teach that Brahman alone is the cause. In them the Lord of all is shown to be the cause of the origin of the world and the rest, and by no means some other principle named by Kapila. Thus Śrīman Manu says: 'This [world] was darkness — unknown, without marks, beyond reasoning, unknowable, as if wholly asleep. Then the self-born Bhagavān, unmanifest, manifesting this [world] — the great elements and the rest — appeared in full power, dispelling the darkness. He who is beyond the senses, imperceptible, subtle, unmanifest, eternal, containing all beings and inconceivable — He Himself appeared. Wishing to create various beings from His own body, He reflected and first created the waters, and placed a seed in them. It became a golden egg, shining like the sun; in it Brahmā himself was born, the grandfather of all the worlds,'[11] and so on. Śrī Parāśara says: 'From Viṣṇu the world arose, and in Him it abides; He is the one who maintains and dissolves this world, and He is the world';[12] 'As a spider draws a thread from its heart through its mouth, plays with it and swallows it again, so does Janārdana,' and so on. Others speak in the same way. Nor can one say that these *smṛtis* have their subject in elaborating the meaning of the *karma-kāṇḍa*. They enjoin *dharmas* for purifying the mind, so that knowledge of Brahman may dawn, and therefore their purpose is only to elaborate the meaning of the *jñāna-kāṇḍa*. That they purify the mind is seen from the Śruti: 'Him [the *brāhmaṇas* seek to know] by the study of the Vedas,'[13] and so on. Here and there one sees and experiences that they bring such fruits as rain, sons, heaven and the like. But this too, by creating trust in the scriptures, finally leads to Him, for it is said: 'The goal that all the Vedas proclaim'[14] and 'The Vedas are devoted to Nārāyaṇa.'[15] The Sāṅkhya *smṛti* cannot elaborate the meaning of Vedānta, for it teaches what contradicts the Śruti. Elaboration (*upabṛṁhaṇa*) is the clarifying of a meaning that agrees with the Śruti, and in it there is no such thing. Therefore the Sāṅkhya *smṛti*, which contradicts the Śruti, is invented out of its author's own head and is not trustworthy; and we do not fear the charge that it will prove useless. Nor is it right to favor that *smṛti* on the pretext that it is trustworthy. Many interpreters are declared trustworthy, and their *smṛtis* differ in meaning; if one favors one of them, the real meaning will never be settled. When *smṛtis*

contradict one another, there is no other way to decide than to rely on the Śruti; therefore one should honor only the *smṛti* that follows the Śruti. You object by the strength of *smṛti* — by the strength of *smṛti* we shall refute you: thus the fault ‘other *smṛtis* have no room’ is pointed out. Some cite the *Śvetāśvatara-śruti* as proof that Kapila is trustworthy: ‘He who in the beginning endowed the born sage Kapila with knowledge.’[16] But this is not so: those words speak of someone else, and one whose words contradict the meaning of the Śruti cannot be trustworthy. As for Manu's trustworthiness, the Taittirīyas recite: ‘Whatever Manu said is medicine.’ And of Śrī Parāśara tradition says that he understood the highest truth about the Deity by the grace of Pulastya and Vasiṣṭha. Kapila, the founder of the *smṛti* opposed to the Vedas, is a particular *jīva* of the line of Agni, deluded by *māyā*, and not Vāsudeva born of Kardama. For tradition says: ‘Kapila, called Vāsudeva, taught the doctrine of Sāṅkhya to Brahmā and the other gods, to Bhṛgu and others, and likewise to Āsuri; all of it was elaborated by the meaning of the Vedas. But another Kapila taught a doctrine opposed to all the Vedas’; ‘[he taught] Sāṅkhya to another Āsuri, elaborated with false arguments.’ Therefore, if the Sāṅkhya *smṛti*, untrustworthy because it contradicts the Vedas, proves useless, there is no fault in that.

“‘And because the rest is not found’ (2).

“‘And the rest,’ that is, what the Sāṅkhya *smṛti* speaks of, is not found in the Vedas; therefore it is not trustworthy. These are its tenets: the *puruṣas* are all-pervading and are consciousness alone; *prakṛti* alone binds and liberates them, and bondage and liberation belong to *prakṛti* alone; there is no Lord of all, a special Puruṣa; time is not a *tattva*; the five *prāṇas* and the rest are merely functions of the senses. Such tenets and others like them are to be seen in it.”

1. The Śruti mentions a trustworthy sage named “Kapila.” He duly accepted the *karma-kāṇḍa* enjoined by the Vedas. This same sage Kapila composed the Sāṅkhya *smṛti* in order to elaborate the *jñāna-kāṇḍa*. In *sūtras* such as “Now, the complete cessation of the threefold misery is the highest goal of man,” the Sāṅkhya *smṛti* calls the complete cessation of the threefold misery — *ādhyātmika* and the rest — “the highest goal of man,” or liberation. In it unconscious *pradhāna* alone is established as the independent cause of the world. If Brahman alone is called the sole cause of the world, this Sāṅkhya *smṛti* will be left without a subject, for from beginning to end it speaks of nothing else. Therefore the texts of Vedānta should be interpreted so as not to contradict the

views of the entirely trustworthy sage Kapila. Then the *smṛtis* proclaimed by Manu and others will not be left without a subject either: by setting forth *dharma* they elaborate the *karma-kāṇḍa* and so have a subject. To refute this, the author introduces the first *sūtra*, “If [it is said:] there follows the fault that the *smṛti* has no room…”.

Absence of room is *anavakāśa*; the word *anavakāśa* means being left without a subject. If Vedānta is interpreted according to its single import (*samanvaya*), the Sāṅkhya *smṛti* incurs the fault of being left without a subject. So should the texts of Vedānta be interpreted in a sense opposite to what one hears in them? The answer: that is impossible. If they are interpreted so, a great calamity follows: other *smṛtis* — those of Manu and others, which follow Vedānta and teach that Brahman alone is the cause — will be left without a subject. In these *smṛtis* only the Lord of all is shown to be the cause of the origin of the world and the rest. The *tattvas* are not described in them as the sage Kapila describes them. Thus Śrī Manu says: “Before creation the whole universe was darkness — unknown, without marks, beyond reasoning, unknowable — and lay as if asleep. Then the self-born Bhagavān, though Himself unmanifest, appeared endowed with the potencies of the great elements and the rest in order to manifest this world, and dispelled that darkness. He is beyond the senses, imperceptible, subtle, unmanifest, eternal, containing all beings and inconceivable by nature. Having appeared Himself, He desired in His mind to create various beings from His own body, and first of all He created water. Then the Supreme Lord placed His seed in that water. From the seed arose a golden egg, shining like a thousand suns. In that egg Brahmā himself, the grandfather of all the worlds, was born.” And the sage Parāśara says: “The visible world arose from Bhagavān Viṣṇu and abides resting on Him. He maintains it and He destroys it. This world is a particular potency of His. As a spider draws threads out of its own body and later swallows them itself, so Bhagavān Viṣṇu creates the universe from His potency and later dissolves it again in His potency.” Other sages say the same. Nor can one say that the Sāṅkhya *smṛti*[17] will have a subject by elaborating the *karma-kāṇḍa*: [these *smṛtis*] enjoin *dharma* for the purification of the mind, so that knowledge of Brahman may dawn. Therefore the purpose of these *smṛtis* is to elaborate the *jñāna-kāṇḍa*. It is also seen that these *dharmas* purify the mind: the words of the Śruti “Him [the *brāhmaṇas* seek to know] by the study of the Vedas” and so on are the proof. Here and there it is seen and confirmed that these *dharmas* (their performance) bring such fruits as rain, sons, heaven and the like. But this too is

only to purify the mind by creating faith in the scriptures. The Śrutis “The goal that all the Vedas proclaim” and “The Vedas are devoted to Nārāyaṇa” express the same intention. Even if the purpose of the Sāṅkhya *smṛti* is to elaborate the *jñāna-kāṇḍa*, one still cannot accept that it elaborates the meaning of Vedānta, for the Sāṅkhya *smṛti* teaches what contradicts the Śruti. To clarify the meaning of the statements of the Śruti — that is what “elaboration” (*upabṛṁhaṇa*) means. No such clarification of the meaning of the Śruti is seen in the Sāṅkhya *smṛti*. It must therefore be judged contrary to the Śruti. And what contradicts the Śruti is invented out of one's own head and is therefore untrustworthy. So the uselessness of this untrustworthy Sāṅkhya *smṛti* is inevitable. Nor is it right to favor one *smṛti* while waiting for the untrustworthiness of another to be established. If one favors *smṛtis* that differ in meaning, then, faced with the many opinions of Gautama and many others who interpret in different ways, one will never settle the real meaning. When two *smṛtis* contradict each other, one cannot resort to any deciding proof other than the Śruti. Whatever one relies on must certainly follow the Śruti; if it does not follow the Śruti, it cannot be honored. Those who raise censure by the strength of *smṛti* will be refuted by the strength of that same *smṛti*; therefore pointing out the fault “other *smṛtis* will be left without a subject” is unavoidable. In the *Śvetāśvatara Upaniṣad* the words “the sage Kapila, born…” and so on do speak of a trustworthy sage Kapila. But that Kapila is not this one; he is another sage Kapila. Therefore, in calling Kapila, the author of Sāṅkhya, untrustworthy, we show no disrespect to the Śruti. The trustworthiness of Manu and Parāśara is well known from the Śruti and the *smṛti*. Thus with the words “Whatever Manu said is medicine” the Taittirīyas affirm Manu's trustworthiness. And the *smṛti* says that Śrī Parāśara understood the highest truth about the Deity by the grace of Pulastya and Vasiṣṭha. Kapila, the founder of the Sāṅkhya *smṛti* opposed to the Vedas, and Bhagavān Kapila, the son of Kardama, are not the same person. The first Kapila is a particular *jīva* of the line of Agni, deluded by *māyā*; the second, the son of Kardama, is an avatāra of Vāsudeva Himself. The *Padma Purāṇa* says: “Bhagavān Vāsudeva descended from the sage Kardama as Kapila and taught the doctrine of Sāṅkhya to the gods headed by Brahmā, to the sages headed by Bhṛgu and to a *brāhmaṇa* named Āsuri; the Sāṅkhya *smṛti* He taught is elaborated by the meaning of the Vedas. But another Kapila taught another Āsuri a different Sāṅkhya — opposed to all the Vedas, elaborated with false arguments and invented out of his own head.” Therefore there is no fault whatever in calling this latter Sāṅkhya *smṛti*, opposed to the Vedas and untrustworthy, useless.

2. Moreover, this Sāṅkhya *smṛti* speaks of certain matters that are not found in the Vedas. For this reason too it can be called "untrustworthy." These are the matters: "The *puruṣas*, that is, the individual souls, are consciousness alone and all-pervading; *prakṛti* alone binds and liberates them. Both 'bondage' and 'liberation' are material. There is no *puruṣa* called 'the Lord of all.' 'Time' is not a *tattva* at all. The five *prāṇas* and the rest are merely functions of the senses." These and certain other tenets opposed to Vedānta are seen in this Sāṅkhya *smṛti*.

He Himself is the "efficient" cause, and Advaita Prabhu the "material" cause —

16 The Puruṣa Himself is the efficient cause of the world, and in the form of Advaita, Nārāyaṇa becomes its material cause.

As the one who casts the glance He is the efficient cause, and as Advaita He is the Creator in the form of the material cause —

17 As the efficient cause He casts His glance upon māyā; as the material cause, Advaita creates the universe.

Refutation of the Sāṅkhya doctrine —

18 Although Sāṅkhya holds pradhāna to be the cause, the world can never come into being from inert matter.

**Prakṛti* acts only by the potency of Bhagavān —*

19 The Lord infuses His own creative power into pradhāna, and by that power the world is fashioned.

Anubhāṣya.
See Ādi 5.58–66; Madhya 20.259–261, 271, 276.

The two forms of Advaita Prabhu —

20 Advaita Ācārya creates millions of universes, and in each of them He dwells in one of His forms as its sustainer.

*Advaita Prabhu, a limb (*aṅga*) or part (*aṁśa*) of Bhagavān —*

21 Advaita is the principal limb (*aṅga*) of Śrī Nārāyaṇa; and in the *Bhāgavatam* the word ‘aṅga’ means ‘aṁśa’, a partial manifestation.

Anubhāṣya.
See Ādi 3.67.

*(*Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam*, Canto 10, Chapter 14, verse 14)*

22 “Are You not Nārāyaṇa? For You are the Self of all embodied beings, O Lord, and the witness of all the worlds. Nārāyaṇa is Your portion — so called because His abode is the waters born of Nara; and that too is true, not Your māyā.” (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 10.14.14)[3]

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
See Ādi 2.30.

*Though a limb or a part, He is beyond *māyā* —*

23 This verse says that the Lord’s aṅga, His aṁśa, is full of consciousness and bliss and has no connection with māyā.

Anubhāṣya.
See Ādi 3.69–70.

*Why He is called a limb (*aṅga*) and not a part (*aṁśa*) —*

24 Why call Him ‘aṅga’ and not ‘aṁśa’? Because ‘aṅga’, a limb, is closer and more intimate than ‘aṁśa’, a part.

Why the name “Advaita” is fitting —

25 Advaita, the abode of all good qualities, is a part of Mahā-Viṣṇu. He is non-different from the Lord, and so the name Advaita, “Non-dual”, fits Him in full.

Why the name "Ācārya" is fitting —

26 As once He created the whole universe, so now, having descended, He has established bhakti.

In His descent as Advaita, His one work is to preach devotion to Kṛṣṇa —

27 He delivered the jīvas by giving them devotion to Kṛṣṇa, and He explained the *Gītā* and the *Bhāgavatam* in the light of bhakti.

28 He has no work but teaching bhakti; therefore His name became Advaita Ācārya.

Anubhāṣya.

Although Advaita Prabhu is the Viṣṇu-*tattva*, the one who is served, He has no other duty and no other conduct than this: to awaken in the *jīvas* the inclination to serve, for that is what securing their good means. Bhagavān Viṣṇu saw that if He displayed His pastimes only as the one who is served, the pleasure-seeking people of the world would imitate Him and become godless *kevalādvaita-vādīs* or *ahaṅgrahopāsakas*, who worship themselves as God. Therefore He manifested the pastimes of a servant; displaying this kind of ācāryaship is also one of His works. The Ācārya has no work other than conduct turned toward the service of Kṛṣṇa. He behaves as the servant of the One who is served — that is why He is the ācārya; this is a particular pastime of a *naimittika-avatāra*. Wicked people try to defile the Ācārya's holy place and His dress and, instead of serving Bhagavān, launch into a wild dance (*tāṇḍava*) of gratifying their own senses. The Ācārya condemns this utterly.

29 He is the guru of the Vaiṣṇavas, honoured by the whole world. Joined together, these two names became Advaita Ācārya.

Anubhāṣya.

Śrī Advaita Ācārya is the guru of the whole Vaiṣṇava world, and everyone honors Him. Following His lotus feet, the Vaiṣṇavas devoted to Bhagavān adopt His conduct and serve Hari.

Why the name "Kamalākṣa" is fitting —

30 Because He is the limb and the part of the Lotus-eyed Lord, He bears the beautiful name Kamalākṣa, "Lotus-eyed".

In Vaikuṇṭha the Vaiṣṇavas attain a form like that of Viṣṇu —

31 The Lord's associates attain a form like His (*sārūpya*): like Nārāyaṇa, they are four-armed and clad in yellow.

The glory of Advaita Prabhu's qualities —

32 Advaita Ācārya is the foremost part of the Lord; His truth, His name and His qualities are all wondrous.

Advaita Prabhu calls Mahāprabhu down into the world —

33 It was His offering of tulasī leaves and His roar that brought Caitanya into the world together with His associates.[4]

34 Through Him the Lord spread the kīrtana, and through Him the Lord delivered the world.

Anubhāṣya.
See Ādi 3.91, 95–108.

35 The glory of Ācārya Gosāñi's qualities is boundless. Where can the jīva, a mere worm, find its end?

One limb of Gaura is Advaita, another is Nitāi —

36 Ācārya Gosāñi is the principal limb (*aṅga*) of Caitanya, and His other limb is Nityānanda Prabhu.

*The subsidiary limbs (*upāṅgas*) and weapons — the devotees headed by Śrīvāsa —*

37 The Lord's lesser limbs (*upāṅga*) are Śrīvāsa and the other devotees; they are like His hands, face and eyes, and like His disc and other weapons.

*With His limbs and subsidiary limbs Gaura preaches the holy name and *prema* —*

38 With them Caitanya Prabhu performs His pastimes, and with them He spreads what He desires.

Anubhāṣya.
See Ādi 3.71–74.

Gaura regards Advaita Prabhu as His guru —

39 Knowing that He is a disciple of Mādhavendra Purī, the Lord regards Ācārya Gosāñi as His guru.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
Advaita Prabhu was a disciple of Mādhavendra Purī, and His godbrother Īśvara Purī was Mahāprabhu's guru. Because of this relationship Mahāprabhu regards Ācārya Gosāñi as His "guru." In truth Śrī Caitanya Gosāñi is the Lord of all, and Advaita Ācārya Prabhu is His servant. In this relationship Advaita Prabhu regarded Himself as a "servant."

Anubhāṣya.
Śrī Mādhavendra Purī is one of the gurus of the Śrī Madhvācārya-sampradāya. His disciples are Īśvara Purī and Śrī Advaita Prabhu. The branch of the Śrī Gauḍīya Vaiṣṇavas in the succession of Śrī Madhva is cited in the *Śrī Gaura-gaṇoddeśa-dīpikā*, in the *Prameya-ratnāvalī* and in the book of Śrī Gopāla-guru Gosvāmī; it is also mentioned in the *Śrī Bhakti-ratnākara*. In the *Śrī Gaura-gaṇoddeśa-dīpikā* the branch of Śrī Madhva is described as follows: "The disciple of the Lord of Paravyoma was Brahmā, the master of the universe. His disciple became Nārada, and Nārada's disciple was Vyāsa. Śuka, having given up the path of (dry) knowledge, became the disciple of Vyāsa.[18] From Vyāsa the renowned Madhvācārya received initiation into the mantra of Kṛṣṇa. His disciple was the

great-hearted Padmanābhācārya. His disciple was Narahari, and his disciple the *brāhmaṇa* Mādhava. His disciple was Akṣobhya, and his disciple Jayatīrtha. His disciple was Jñānasindhu, and his disciple Mahānidhi. His disciple was Vidyānidhi, and his servant Rājendra. His disciple was the sage Jayadharma; from among his followers came Śrīmad Viṣṇu Purī, the author of the *Bhakti-ratnāvalī*. The disciple of Jayadharma was Brahmaṇya Puruṣottama. His disciple was Vyāsatīrtha, who composed the *Viṣṇu-saṁhitā*. His disciple was the glorious Lakṣmīpati, the abode of *bhakti-rasa*. His disciple was Mādhavendra, who inaugurated this *dharma*. His disciple was the glorious *sannyāsī* Īśvara Purī. He whose very nature is the fruit of *śṛṅgāra* cultivated *śṛṅgāra*; Advaita cultivated both fruits, *dāsya* and *sakhya*. Gaura respectfully accepted Īśvara Purī [as guru] and flooded the whole world, both material and transcendental [with *prema*].”

Following worldly custom, Gaura treats Advaita like a guru —

40 In His worldly pastimes the Lord keeps the bounds of dharma: with praise and devotion He bows at the Ācārya’s feet.

Advaita Prabhu regards Mahāprabhu as His Lord —

41 The Ācārya knows Caitanya Gosāñi as His Master, and He thinks of Himself as His servant.

*Thinking of Himself as Kṛṣṇa's servant, He preaches *bhakti* —*

42 In the happiness of that feeling He forgets Himself, and He teaches the jīvas, “Become servants of Kṛṣṇa!”

Anubhāṣya.

Accepting the mood of a devotee, Mahā-Viṣṇu sets aside the awareness of His own true nature (*svarūpa*) and joyfully regards service to Bhagavān as His own duty to perform. That very joy of service loosens Mahā-Viṣṇu's awareness of His own nature (His sense of Himself as the enjoyer). By His own example He constantly inspires the *jīvas* to serve Kṛṣṇa. See verses 27–28.

In service to Kṛṣṇa lies the bliss of Vaikuṇṭha —

43 Such is the ocean of bliss in feeling oneself Kṛṣṇa's servant that the happiness of Brahman, multiplied ten million times, is not equal to a single drop of it.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Brahma-sukha (the happiness of Brahman) is the happiness that comes with the thought of nondifference: "I am Brahman."

Advaita and Nityānanda find happiness only in serving Gaura —

44 "I and Nityānanda are servants of Caitanya. Nowhere is there bliss equal to the mood of a servant."

Anubhāṣya.

See Ādi 7.85, 97–98. In the *Bhakti-rasāmṛta-sindhu* (*Pūrva-vibhāga*, First Wave): "Even if the bliss of Brahman were multiplied a *parārdha* times, it would not equal even an atom of the ocean of the happiness of *bhakti*."[19] In the *Bhāvārtha-dīpikā*: "A fortunate few, sporting in great joy in the ocean of nectar of topics about You, hold the four goals of life no higher than a blade of grass. And those among them who do not desire even the subtle goal [of liberation] — *bhakti*, through *prema*, makes them people whose minds and very lives have been stolen. Devotees whose hearts have found bliss in serving the lotus feet of Śrī Kṛṣṇa never desire liberation." In the *Padma Purāṇa*, in the *Kārtika-māhātmya*: "O Lord, though You are the master of all who grant boons, I ask of You neither liberation, nor the highest limit of liberation, nor any other boon. O Lord, may only this form of Yours as a cowherd boy always appear in my mind! What do I want with anything else? As You, while bound, freed the two sons of Kuvera and made them devotees, so grant me too Your own *prema-bhakti*. O Dāmodara, I have no craving for liberation."[20] In the *Śrī Nārāyaṇa-vyūha-stava* of the *Hayaśīrṣa-pañcarātra*: "O Lord of those who grant boons, I pray for neither *dharma*, nor *kāma*, nor *artha*, nor *mokṣa*. At Your lotus feet I desire only service." "Viṣṇu wished again and again to grant him boons, yet he did not ask for liberation and chose *bhakti* alone — I bow to that Prahlāda." "Though liberation came to him unsought from Viṣṇu, the son of Daśaratha, he did not want liberation without service — obeisances to that Hanumān." In the words of Śrī Hanumān: "I do not long for the liberation that cuts the bonds of worldly

existence, for in it [the awareness] 'You are the Lord and I am the servant' disappears." In the *Nārada-pañcarātra*, in the *Jitante-stotra*: "I never have any desire for *dharma*, *artha*, *kāma* or *mokṣa*. Grant that I may live at the foot of Your lotus feet. O upholder of the earth, I do not pray for *mokṣa*, *sālokya* or *sārūpya*. O most blessed one, true to Your vows, I desire only Your mercy." In the hymn *Mukunda-mālā* of the emperor Kulaśekhara: "O Hari, I worship Your lotus feet not to be free of duality, not to escape the dreadful hell of Kumbhīpāka, and not to enjoy, in the garden of Nandana, beautiful women whose soft bodies are like creepers. I wish only, in whatever birth I take, to contemplate You in the chamber of my heart." In the *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam*, see many verses: 3.25.36, 3.4.15, 3.25.34, 4.1.22, 4.9.10, 4.20.24, 5.14.43, 6.11.25, 6.17.28, 6.18.74, 7.6.25, 7.8.42, 8.3.20, 9.4.49, 9.21.12, 10.16.37, 10.87.21, 11.14.14, 11.20.34, 12.3.6 and others.

Examples showing that service to Kṛṣṇa is supreme: (1) Lakṣmī begs for service to Kṛṣṇa —

45 Lakṣmī, His dearest beloved, dwells upon His heart, yet she too humbly begs for the happiness of service.

(2) Viṣṇu's associates, and Brahmā, Śiva, the four Sanas, Nārada, Śuka and others also serve Kṛṣṇa —

46 In the mood of service His associates rejoice — Brahmā, Śiva, Nārada and others, Śuka, and Sanātana with his brothers.[5]

(3) Nitāi, mad in the service of Gaura —

47 Nityānanda Avadhūta is the foremost of all; in His love of serving Caitanya He became mad.[6]

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Āgala means foremost, the first.

*(4) Śrīvāsa and the other great souls (*mahājanas*) — all serve Gaura —*

48–49 Śrīvāsa, Haridāsa, Rāmadāsa, Gadādhara, Murāri, Mukunda, Candraśekhara and Vakreśvara — all these are learned men of the highest greatness, and service to Caitanya makes every one of them mad.

Being servants of Gaura themselves, they teach only service to Gaura —

50 So they sing, dance and laugh aloud, and they teach everyone: "Become servants of Caitanya!"

51 "Caitanya Gosāñi regards Me as His guru, yet I feel Myself His servant."

The power of love for Kṛṣṇa —

52 This is one wondrous power of love for Kṛṣṇa: it gives elders, equals and juniors alike the mood of a servant.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Guru: the elders, who abide in the *rasa* of parental love (*vātsalya*); *sama*: the equals (who abide in the *rasa* of friendship, *sakhya*); *laghu*: the younger ones. Love for Kṛṣṇa gives the mood of a servant to all three. Therefore all of Kṛṣṇa Caitanya's elders, equals and juniors are His servants.

Anubhāṣya.

The Lord's elders in this world serve Him without knowing it. A mind dominated by majesty, or the path of reverent propriety (*maryādā-mārga*), often cannot grasp this. That is why service to Nārāyaṇa lacks the wonder found in love for Kṛṣṇa. Kṛṣṇa's elders accept the position of elders only to become established in the highest service — and so they serve Him. Service by those related to the Lord as equals or juniors can be grasped even by a mind dominated by majesty; but the strength of a servant's mood in one who regards himself as an elder exists only in service to Kṛṣṇa. To be inclined to serve with one's whole being and to long for service without measure is possible only toward Kṛṣṇa, whom all serve. Nārāyaṇa has many servants, equals and juniors; but Kṛṣṇa's elders, displaying a wondrous power, serve Him wholly. Kṛṣṇa's elders, His equals and those He embraces with

tender affection — all three kinds of [associates], filled with love for Him, serve Kṛṣṇa. This is the wondrous power of *prema*.

Evidence from the experience of perfected souls —

53 Hear the proof of this in the explanations of scripture, firmly confirmed by the experience of great souls.

*(5) Service to Kṛṣṇa — even in the parental love (*vātsalya-rasa*) of Nanda Mahārāja —*

54–55 What to speak of others? In Vraja Kṛṣṇa has no elder equal to Nanda Mahāśaya. In his pure parental love he has no thought that Kṛṣṇa is God; yet love makes even him feel something like a servant.

56 He too begs at Kṛṣṇa's feet for attachment and devotion; his own words are the proof of it.

57–58 "Listen, Uddhava: Kṛṣṇa is truly my son. But if it seems to you that He is God, still let all the workings of my mind rest in Him; let my thoughts be fixed on your God, Kṛṣṇa."

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
O Uddhava, even if Kṛṣṇa is regarded as Īśvara, let my mind still rest in that Kṛṣṇa.

*(*Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 10.47.66–67)*

59 "May the workings of our minds take shelter at Kṛṣṇa's lotus feet, may our words utter His names, and may our bodies be given to bowing down to Him and serving Him." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 10.47.66)

Anubhāṣya.
After meeting the residents of Vraja, Uddhava took leave of them and was about to return to Dvārakā.[21] Then Nanda and the other cowherd men, full of love for Śrī Kṛṣṇa, speak to Uddhava:

naḥ (our) **manasaḥ vṛttayaḥ** (workings of the mind) **kṛṣṇa-pādāmbujāśrayāḥ** (taking shelter of Kṛṣṇa's lotus feet) **syuḥ** (may be). [Our] **vācaḥ** (words) **tu**

nāmnām (His names) **abhidhāyinīḥ** (uttering — may they be devoted to *kīrtana*), **kāyaḥ** (the body) **tat-prahvaṇādiṣu** (in bowing to Him, Kṛṣṇa, and so on) **astu** (may be engaged).

60 "Wherever we may wander, driven by our karma and the Lord's will, by our good deeds and gifts may we have love for Kṛṣṇa, the Lord." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 10.47.67)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
Nanda said: "O Uddhava, may all the workings of our minds take shelter of Śrī Kṛṣṇa's lotus feet, may our words sing His names, and may our bodies bow down to Him. Whatever our condition may be by the will of Īśvara, according to the fruits of our karma, may charity and other auspicious deeds increase our love (*rati*) for Kṛṣṇa, the Supreme Person."

Anubhāṣya.
karmabhiḥ (by deeds — sinful, pious and others that bear fruit) **īśvarecchayā** (by the will of Īśvara) **yatra kvāpi** (wherever it may be) **bhrāmyamāṇānām** (wandering — being born among the eighty-four [lakhs of] species) **naḥ** (our) **maṅgalācaritaiḥ dānaiḥ** (by the auspicious deeds that arise from them) **īśvare** (for Bhagavān) **kṛṣṇe** (Kṛṣṇa) **ratiḥ** (attachment) **astu** (may there be).

*(6) Service to Kṛṣṇa — even in the friendship (*sakhya-rasa*) of the friends of Vraja —*

61 All the host of Kṛṣṇa's friends in Vraja, led by Śrīdāmā, know nothing of His majesty: their love is pure friendship.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
Sakhya is of two kinds: "with awareness of majesty" and *kevala*, that is, "unmixed," *sakhya*. Śrīdāmā and the other friends in Vraja have *kevala sakhya*: they do not know Kṛṣṇa's majesty.

62 They wrestle with Kṛṣṇa and climb on His shoulders, and yet, in the mood of servants, they tend His feet.[7]

*(*Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 10.15.17)*

63 "Some of them massaged the feet of that great soul, while others, their sins destroyed, fanned Him with fans." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 10.15.17)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

When Kṛṣṇa lay down, one friend began to massage His feet, and another, in a mood of pure friendship, to fan Him with a fan made of leaves.

Anubhāṣya.

Before the demon Dhenuka was killed in Tālavana, the cowherd boys played with one another in this way, together with Rāma and Kṛṣṇa:

hata-pāpmānaḥ (freed of impurity) **kecit** (some cowherd boys) **mahātmanaḥ** (of Bhagavān) **tasya** (of Him, Kṛṣṇa) **pāda-saṁvāhanam** (massaging of the feet) **cakruḥ** (did); **apare** (other cowherd boys) **vyajanaiḥ** (with fans) **samavījayan** (fanned properly).

*(7) Service to Kṛṣṇa — even in the conjugal love (*madhura-rasa*) of the gopīs of Vraja —*

64–65 Even the beloved gopīs of Vraja, dearer to Kṛṣṇa than anyone else, whose foot-dust Uddhava prays for, think of themselves as His maidservants.

*(*Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 10.31.6)*

66 "O You who take away the distress of the people of Vraja! O Hero, whose smile destroys the pride of Your own! O friend, we are Your maidservants: be kind to us, and show us women Your beautiful lotus face." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 10.31.6)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

O You who destroy the sorrows of Vraja! O supreme hero among women! O You whose gentle smile dispels the pride of Your own people![10] O friend, we are Your maidservants: show us Your lotus face.

Anubhāṣya.

When Kṛṣṇa disappeared during the *rāsa* dance, the gopīs, searching for Him, sang:

he vraja-janārti-han (O You who destroy the pain of separation of those full of love for Kṛṣṇa), **vīra** (O You whose form is magnanimous), **nija-jana-smaya-dhvaṁsana-smita** (O You whose smile destroys the *smaya*, that is, the pride, of Your own people, the embodiments of *rasa*), **sakhe** (O friend), **sma** (surely) **bhavat-kiṅkarīḥ naḥ** (us, Your maidservants) **bhaja** (stay with us); **cāru** (enchanting) **jala-ruhānanam** (lotus face) **ca yoṣitām** (to us women, the gopīs) **darśaya** (show).

*(*Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 10.47.21)*

67 "O gentle one! Alas, Nanda's son now lives in Mathurā. Does He remember His father's house, His kinsmen and the cowherd boys? Does He ever speak of us, His maidservants? When will He place on our heads His arm, fragrant as aguru?" (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 10.47.21)[8]

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

How sad that our *ārya-putra* now lives in the city of Mathurā! O Uddhava, does He remember the home of His father Nanda and His cowherd friends? Does He ever speak of us, His maidservants? Ah, will He ever again place on our heads His hand, fragrant like *aguru*?

Anubhāṣya.

When Uddhava came to Vraja, Śrīmatī, addressing a bee, speaks *citra-jalpa* (varied talk):

he saumya (O gentle one), **api bata ārya-putraḥ** (the son of Nanda) **adhunā** (now) **madhu-puryām** (in Mathurā) **āste** (does He live happily)? **saḥ pitṛ-gehān** (together with His parents, Nanda and Yaśodā, and with the homes) **bandhūn** (the relatives — Parjanya, Varīyasī, Upananda, Abhinanda, Sannanda, Nandana, Rohiṇī, Sānandā, Nandinī, Kaṇḍava, Daṇḍava and others), **gopān** (the cowherd boys — Subala, Arjuna, Gandharva, Vasanta, Śrīdāmā, Sudāmā, Ujjvala, Kokila, Sanandana, Vidagdha and others) **ca kiṁ smarati** (does He remember)? **kvacit** (ever) **api kiṅkarīṇām** (of the maidservants — Lalitā, Viśākhā, Citrā, Campakalatā, Tuṅgavidyā, Indulekhā, Raṅgadevī, Sudevī, Kalāvatī, Śubhāṅgadā, Hiraṇyāṅgī, Ratnalekhā, Śikhāvatī, Kandarpa-mañjarī, Phullakalikā, Anaṅga-mañjarī, Puṇḍarīkā, Sītākhaṇḍī, Cārucaṇḍī, Sadaṇḍikā, Kuṇṭhitā, Kalakaṇṭhī,

Romaci, Mecakā, Haridrābhā, Haricchelā, Vitaṇḍikā, Līlāvatī, Sādhikā, Candrikā, Mādhavī, Vijayā, Nandā, Gaurī, Sudhāmukhī, Vṛndā, Kaumudī, Ratnabhavā, Ratnaprabhā and others) **naḥ** (of us — Śrīmatī, the daughter of Vṛṣabhānu, Gāndharvikā) **kathām** (talk) **saḥ gṛṇīte** (does He speak with His own lips)? **kadā nu** (when) **aguru-sugandham** (more fragrant even than *aguru*) **bhujam** (His arm) **mūrdhni** (on our heads) **adhāsyat** (will He place)?

(8) More than that, even Śrī Rādhā Herself serves Kṛṣṇa —

68–69 Let alone them: Śrīmatī Rādhikā, who surpasses them all in every respect and by whose love Kṛṣṇa is bound at every moment — even She has become His maidservant and serves His feet.

*(*Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 10.30.39)*

70 "O Master, O Beloved, O dearest one! Where are You, where are You, O mighty-armed? O friend, show Yourself to Me, Your wretched maidservant!" (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 10.30.39)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

O Lord! O lover! O dearest! O mighty-armed one! I am Your most wretched maidservant: bring me near to You!

Anubhāṣya.

During the *rāsa* dance Kṛṣṇa left the other gopīs and disappeared with Śrīmatī Rādhikā alone. Seeing the other gopīs lament in separation from Kṛṣṇa, Śrīmatī, in a fit of pride, said that She could walk no further and told Kṛṣṇa to carry Her. Then Kṛṣṇa disappeared, and Śrīmatī lamented:

hā nātha, **ramaṇa**, **preṣṭha** (the best of all), **kvāsi** ([where are] You), **kvāsi**? **he sakhe**, **kṛpaṇāyāḥ** (tormented by separation from You) **dīnāyāḥ te** (Your) **dāsyāḥ** (to the maidservant, that is, to me) **sannidhim** (Your nearness) **darśaya** (reveal).

71 In Dvārakā all the queens, led by Rukmiṇī, also think of themselves as Kṛṣṇa's maidservants.

*(*Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 10.83.11)*

72 "Knowing that I was performing austerities in the hope of touching His feet, He came with His friend and took my hand. And so I am the sweeper of His house." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 10.83.11)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

I was performing austerities, longing to touch Śrī Kṛṣṇa's feet. In His mercy Kṛṣṇa came with His friend and took my hand in marriage. Since then I have been His maidservant who sweeps His house.

Anubhāṣya.

When the women of the Yadu and Kuru dynasties gathered together at Samanta-pañcaka, Kṛṣṇa's queen Kālindī, in a conversation about Kṛṣṇa, said to Draupadī:

sva-pāda-sparśanāśayā (with the hope of touching the feet of Him, Śrī Kṛṣṇa) **tapaś carantīm mā** (me), who was performing austerities, **ājñāya** (knowing), **saḥ kṛṣṇaḥ sakhyā** (with Arjuna) **saha upetya** (coming near) **pāṇim agrahīt**; **sā** (I) am **tat** (His) **gṛha-mārjanī** (maidservant).

*(*Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 10.83.39)*

73 "By austerity and by turning away from every attachment, we have become, in truth, maidservants in the house of Him who delights in Himself." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 10.83.39)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Through many austerities, giving up all attachment, we have attained the position of maidservants in the house of this Person, who delights in Himself (*ātmārāma*).

Anubhāṣya.

At the same time, in the same conversation, Kṛṣṇa's queen Lakṣmaṇā says to Draupadī:

imāḥ vayam (we, the queens) **sarva-saṅga-nivṛttyā** (by withdrawing, through indifference, from attachment to everything — happiness, wealth, sons and so on, or the four goals of life including *mokṣa*) **tapasā** (by the service of maidservants) **ātmārāmasya tasya** (of Him, Kṛṣṇa) **addhā** (directly) **gṛha-dāsikāḥ babhūvima** (have become).

*(10) Service to Kṛṣṇa — even by Balarāma, the *svayaṁ-prakāśa* —*

74 What to speak of others? Consider Baladeva Mahāśaya, whose mood is full of pure friendship, parental love and the rest.

Anubhāṣya.

Baladeva is the elder brother and so worthy of honor, yet He knows Himself only as the servant of His younger brother Kṛṣṇa. In Mahā-Vaikuṇṭha the *catur-vyūha* is only a chamber (*prakoṣṭha*) of this same Baladeva, the *svayaṁ-prakāśa*: this is the supreme majesty of the all-powerful Parameśvara. On the path of reverence (*maryādā-mārga*) even such an exalted, supreme position is established in service to Kṛṣṇa. Therefore no being — neither in Goloka and Vaikuṇṭha, nor in the countless universes, nor within them — is able to enjoy Kṛṣṇa or make Him its servant. Everyone other than Kṛṣṇa excels others exactly to the degree that he is inclined to serve Kṛṣṇa. And to the degree that a being has given up service to Kṛṣṇa and turned away from Him, to that degree he has invited misfortune. In the material world the urge to enjoy Kṛṣṇa, or to think oneself Kṛṣṇa's equal and enjoy as He does, is the root mantra of the nondevotees; yet by their true nature all who take shelter of Kṛṣṇa are eternally engaged in serving Bhagavān. It is aversion to serving Kṛṣṇa that makes the *jīva* like one dead. When knowledge of Kṛṣṇa awakens, the inclination to serve Kṛṣṇa is seen in every *jīva*, to a greater or lesser degree.

75 Even He thinks of Himself as a servant. Is there anyone without the mood of a servant of Kṛṣṇa?

(11) Ananta in the form of Śeṣa serves Kṛṣṇa in ten bodies —

76 Śeṣa-Saṅkarṣaṇa, with His thousand mouths, assumes ten bodies and serves Kṛṣṇa.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

The ten bodies are the umbrella, sandals, bed, pillow, garments, ornaments, pleasure garden, dwelling, sacred thread and throne.

(12) Śiva's service to Kṛṣṇa —

77 In the endless universes Rudra is a part of Sadāśiva; he is a guṇa-avatāra, the crown of all the gods.

78 He longs for the service of Kṛṣṇa; Śiva says at every moment, "I am Kṛṣṇa's servant."

Anubhāṣya.

Rudra and Sadāśiva. In the *Laghu-bhāgavatāmṛta*, in the description of the *guṇa-avatāras* (verses 18–24), it is said of Rudra: "He is said to be eleven *vyūhas* and eight bodies; usually he has five faces, three eyes and ten arms. Sometimes Hara, like Brahmā (Vidhi), is said to be a particular *jīva*. But this should be understood as in the case of Śeṣa, for he is glorified as a part [of the Lord]. Hara is the abode of the Puruṣa and so is in essence almost *nirguṇa*; but because of his connection with *tamas* everyone sees him here as subject to change. As the Tenth Canto says (10.88.3): 'Śiva is always joined with his potency, has three marks and is covered by the *guṇas*.' As the *Brahma-saṁhitā* says (5.45): 'As milk, joined with a particular transforming agent, becomes yogurt, yet [the yogurt] is not different from its cause, so He who for a particular task takes the form of Śambhu — Govinda, the original Person, Him I worship.' Sometimes he is born from the forehead of Brahmā (Vidhi), sometimes from the forehead of the Lord of Kamalā; and at the end of a *kalpa* Kālāgni-Rudra appears from Saṅkarṣaṇa as well. His form called Sadāśiva is free from even a trace of *tamas*. He is the cause of all and a part of the Lord Himself. It is he who is described in the *Vāyu Purāṇa* and others as [dwelling] in Śivaloka. So too in the *Brahma-saṁhitā*, where the original Śiva is spoken of (5.8): 'Niyati is Ramā-devī, His beloved, obedient to Him. His *liṅga* is the eternal Bhagavān Śambhu, whose form is light. And she who is the *yoni* is the *aparā śakti*,' and so on."

Śrī Rudra has eleven *vyūhas*: Ajaikapāt, Ahirbudhnya, Virūpākṣa, Raivata, Hara, Bahurūpa, Tryambaka the best of the gods, Sāvitra, Jayanta, Pinākī and Aparājita; and eight forms (*mūrtis*): earth, water, fire, air, ether, the sun, the moon and the performer of the *soma* sacrifice. Among them Rudra is usually five-faced, three-eyed and ten-armed. In some places Rudra, like Vidhi (Brahmā), is glorified as "a particular *jīva*." But since he is also glorified as a part of Bhagavān, this must be reconciled as in the case of "Śeṣa": Śiva, the *svāṁśa* (the Lord's own part), belongs to the category of Īśvara, while Rudra the destroyer is a *vibhinnāṁśa*, a

jīva. Hara is an avatāra of Bhagavān and by nature the Puruṣa, so in truth he is *nirguṇa*; but because of his connection with the mode of darkness, to ordinary people who do not know the truth he seems at first sight to be subject to change. As the Tenth Canto says: “Rudra is always joined with *prakṛti*, the state of equilibrium of the *guṇas*; when the *guṇas* are agitated, he is joined with the three *guṇas* and covered by them from afar.” As the *Brahma-saṁhitā* says: “Milk, joined with a particular transforming agent, turns into yogurt, yet that yogurt is never a thing separate from its cause, the milk. So too He who descends in the form of Rudra for the sake of destruction — the original Person Govinda, Him I worship.” In one *kalpa* Rudra is born from the forehead of Brahmā (Vidhi), in another from the forehead of Viṣṇu. At the end of a *kalpa* Kālāgni-Rudra is born from Saṅkarṣaṇa as well. The *Vāyu Purāṇa* and others describe a form of Śiva named Sadāśiva in Śivaloka, which lies within Vaikuṇṭha: He is the cause of all and has no connection with the mode of darkness. This Sadāśiva is a *vilāsa* of Bhagavān Śrī Kṛṣṇa Himself. As the *Brahma-saṁhitā* says of the original Śiva: “The unfailing Ramā-devī, inseparable from Bhagavān, part of His own nature and obedient to Him, is His beloved; the eternal Bhagavān Śambhu, whose form is light, is a particular part of that *svayaṁ-rūpa*. She who is the *yoni*, the part that serves as the womb — Mahāmāyā, the source of the *mahat-tattva* and the other [elements] — is the *aparā*, the lower potency made of the three *guṇas*, called *pradhāna*,” and so on.

Śrī Baladeva Vidyābhūṣaṇa [comments as follows]. Because particular statements [of scripture] are found, [the author] speaks [this verse] to show that Rudra too is of two kinds.[22] First he speaks of the one who in the verse beginning *sattvaṁ rajaḥ* (*Bhāgavatam* 1.2.23) is named as belonging to the category of Īśvara: “Rudra is eleven *vyūhas*.” Here [are meant] the words of the *Mahābhārata*: “Ajaikapāt, Ahirbudhnya, Virūpākṣa, then Raivata, Hara, Bahurūpa, Tryambaka the lord of the gods, Sāvitra, Jayanta, Pinākī and Aparājita.” Likewise “eight bodies”: “Earth, water, fire, air and ether, the sun and the moon, and the performer of the *soma* sacrifice — these are the eight forms,” says Yādava. “Usually” — because the Rudra who dwells in the covering of water [around the universe] is seen to have one face.

Next [the author] speaks of his belonging to the category of *jīvas*: “Sometimes….” In the *Ṛg-veda*: “Whom I wish, him I make fierce, him a Brahmā, him a sage, him wise,” and so on. In the *Nārāyaṇa Upaniṣad*, beginning with the words “Then the Person Nārāyaṇa desired, ‘Let Me create beings’”:

“From Nārāyaṇa Brahmā is born, from Nārāyaṇa Rudra is born, from Nārāyaṇa Prajāpati is born, from Nārāyaṇa Indra is born, from Nārāyaṇa the eight Vasus (are born), from Nārāyaṇa the eleven Rudras (are born), from Nārāyaṇa the twelve Ādityas” (*Nārāyaṇa Upaniṣad* 1), and so on. In the *Mahā Upaniṣad*, beginning with the words “There was only Nārāyaṇa; there was neither Brahmā nor Īśāna”: “From the forehead of Him, absorbed in meditation, was born a three-eyed Person holding a trident, endowed with beauty, truth, celibacy, austerity and renunciation” (*Mahā Upaniṣad* 1–2), and so on. And in the *Mokṣa-dharma*: “Prajāpati and Rudra too I Myself create. But they do not know Me, bewildered by My *māyā*.” These statements speak of his birth — so here Hara is a *jīva*. Hence for him there is also destruction. In the *Viṣṇu-dharma*: “Brahmā, Śambhu, and likewise the Sun, the Moon, Śatakratu and others, as well as the rest, are endowed with the potency of Viṣṇu. But when their work in the world is over, they are deprived of that potency; and, deprived of potency, they all die.” The *śruti* “There was only one…” says the same. Otherwise these [statements] would be contradicted. The example here is “as of Brahmā (Vidhi).” “As in the case of Śeṣa”: Śeṣa, who serves as the bed of the Lord of the Śārṅga bow — His supporting potency — belongs to the category of Īśvara, while [the Śeṣa] who holds up the earth is a *jīva* empowered by Him. “For he is glorified as a part [of the Lord]” means that in the Purāṇas he is called both His *svāṁśa* and His *vibhinnāṁśa*.

But that Hara who in the verse *sattvaṁ rajas tamaḥ* is named as a manifestation of the Supreme Person — “being the abode of the Puruṣa,” that is, being He Himself — is indeed *nirguṇa*. “Almost” — because he is covered by *tamas*, which he accepted by his own will. Therefore “everyone,” that is, those who do not know the truth, “sees him here as subject to change,” among the *guṇa-avatāras*; in reality he is changeless — that is the meaning. To prove that “because of his connection with *tamas* he is seen as subject to change,” [the author] cites “Śiva … with his potency….” Śiva is Rudra; “always” — at all times; “with his potency” — with *prakṛti*, the state of equilibrium of the *guṇas*, which he accepted by his own will; “joined.” When the *guṇas* are agitated, he “has three marks,” that is, the three *guṇas*; and when they are manifest, he is “covered” by them from afar. If one asks, “It is well known that he is covered by *tamas*; why then is he said here to have three marks?” — we answer: the three *guṇas* are mixed with one another, so *sattva* and *rajas* are also present there; there is no contradiction. And this statement itself should be understood as a restatement (*anuvāda*) of how people see him.

The proof that [Hara] is *nirguṇa* as the abode of the Puruṣa, and is called changing because of his connection with *tamas*, is “As milk….” As milk, joined with a particular transforming agent, becomes yogurt, and the yogurt is not separate, not different, from its cause, the milk, so “He” — Govinda — joined with the *tamas* He accepts by His own will, becomes Śambhu; that is, Śambhu is not other than Govinda. And since the change comes from outside, it does not touch His own nature (*svarūpa*).

[The author] names the sources from which Rudra appears: “of Brahmā….” “From the forehead of Brahmā” is found in the *Śatapatha-brāhmaṇa* and others; “from the forehead of the Lord of Kamalā” — in the *Mahā Upaniṣad* (2) and in the Purāṇas; this is possible because the *kalpas* differ. “Kālāgni-Rudra” should be understood from the words of the Eleventh Canto: “Beginning from Pātāla-tala, the fire from Saṅkarṣaṇa's mouth…” (*Bhāgavatam* 11.3.10).

One may object: “The author of the scripture, having found [such] statements, decided that Kṛṣṇa is the Lord Himself (*svayaṁ-prabhu*), that Nārāyaṇa and others are His *vilāsas* and *svāṁśas* and some are *āveśas*; that from His *svāṁśa* Garbhodaśāyī [come] Brahmā, Viṣṇu and Rudra; that they are Īśvaras, while Brahmā and Rudra are sometimes *jīvas*. But this is not skillful. The original Truth is Sadāśiva: He is meant by the word ‘Himself,’ and He also takes the forms of Nārāyaṇa and others. Therefore the three — Brahmā and the rest — are His effects; for the *Kaivalya Upaniṣad* (6–9) says: ‘Meditating on Him who is inconceivable, unmanifest, infinite in forms, auspicious (*śiva*), serene, immortal, the womb of Brahman; without beginning, middle or end, one, all-pervading, consciousness and bliss, formless, wondrous; the companion of Umā, the Supreme Lord, the master, three-eyed, blue-throated, serene — the sage reaches the Source of all beings, the Witness of all, Him who is beyond darkness. He is Brahmā, He is Śiva, He is Indra, He is the Imperishable, the Supreme, the self-ruling Lord. He is Viṣṇu, He is *prāṇa*, He is the fire of time, He is the moon. He is all that was and that will be, the moving and the unmoving. Knowing Him, one passes beyond death; there is no other path to liberation.’ So this view is better, being based on *śruti*.” To this [the author] answers: “Sadāśiva….” That form is a part of the Lord Himself, Kṛṣṇa; Nārāyaṇa is His *vilāsa* — that is the meaning. That is why the Taittirīyas read “Śiva,” “Acyuta” and “Nārāyaṇa” in one sense. In the [cited] *śruti*, “Umā” means glory, and “the companion of Umā” is one accompanied by glory; “three-eyed” means knowing the three times; “blue-throated” means one whose throat is adorned with a blue gem (*nīla*). So it should

be explained, for the ordinary meanings do not apply to that Śiva. “In the *Vāyu Purāṇa* and others”: “in Śivaloka” means in the abode of Vaikuṇṭha. This Sadāśiva and His world were described by the author of the *Sandarbhas* with the words of the *Vāyu Purāṇa* that begin “All around the waters….”

[The author] cites the decisive statement that Sadāśiva is a form of Kṛṣṇa Himself, the *svayaṁ-rūpa*: “Niyati….” The words “and so on” include the following: “The desire of Hari is the great seed. These progeny of Maheśvara were born having the nature of *liṅga* and *yoni*. This Puruṣa, the possessor of potency, is Maheśvara in the form of the *liṅga*. In that *liṅga* appeared Mahā-Viṣṇu, the Lord of the world” (*Brahma-saṁhitā* 5.8–10). The meaning is as follows. Earlier His sport with Ramā was mentioned. What is that Ramā like? It is said: “*niyati*” — she who is held, fixed in Him, the lover; that is, she is inseparable from Him and part of His own nature. Hence it is said: “His beloved, obedient to Him.” For the *Hayaśīrṣa-pañcarātra* says: “There is no Devī without Viṣṇu, and no Viṣṇu without the lotus-born one,” and the *Viṣṇu Purāṇa*: “Eternal indeed is she, Śrī, the mother of the world, inseparable from Viṣṇu” (*Viṣṇu Purāṇa* 1.8.15). Bhagavān Śambhu is the “*liṅga*” of that *svayaṁ-rūpa*, that is, His sign: “*Liṅga* — in the sense of sign and of inference,” says the *Viśva* [lexicon]. Bhagavān is the Lord of Paravyoma, possessed of the six opulences. “Śambhu” is He who, as His second *vyūha* Saṅkarṣaṇa, brings welfare (*śam*) to the *jīvas* dissolved in *prakṛti* by creating their respective *upādhis*; “whose form is light” — whose form is consciousness. Kṛṣṇa's being Lord over Him reveals that Kṛṣṇa is the *svayaṁ-rūpa*, as a cow is recognized by its dewlap and other marks: He of whom this [Śambhu] is the *vilāsa* is [Bhagavān] Himself; that is why [Śambhu] is called His *liṅga*. “She who is the *yoni*” — the material cause of the *mahat* and the rest — “is the *aparā śakti*,” that is, consisting of the three *guṇas*. “Of Hari” — of His part, Saṅkarṣaṇa; “desire” — His desire to glance [at her] — bears fruit in the creation of the *mahat* and the rest; hence “the great seed.” “Great” — the immeasurable *jīva-tattva* — is placed in her. Therefore “these progeny of Maheśvara, having the nature of *liṅga* and *yoni*,” are said to be born from the Puruṣa and *prakṛti* as their causes. Since *prakṛti* is secondary and depends on Him, the progeny are called “of Maheśvara”: this he establishes with the words “the possessor of potency….” Then he clarifies what was said: “In that….” “In the *liṅga*” — in her Lord, in His presence. Mahā-Viṣṇu is Saṅkarṣaṇa.

79 Mad with love for Kṛṣṇa, overwhelmed and naked, he sings of Kṛṣṇa's qualities and pastimes and dances without end.

*(13) Service to Kṛṣṇa runs through all four *rasas* — conjugal, parental, friendly and servile —*

80 Whatever the mood — of father, mother, elder or friend — by the very nature of love for Kṛṣṇa it brings forth the mood of service.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Whatever mood [toward Kṛṣṇa] one may take up, one must certainly acknowledge the mood of a servant (*dāsya*) contained within every mood.

Kṛṣṇa Himself is the Lord of all —

81 Kṛṣṇa alone is served by all; He is the Lord of the world. All others are His servants and followers.

Anubhāṣya.

See Ādi 2.70, 83, 88, 102, 106; 3.5; 4.11–12; 5.131; 7.7–8; Madhya 6.147; 8.133–135; 10.15; 15.139; 18.190–191; 20.152–155, 240, 400; 21.3, 92; 22.7; 24.71 and others.

82 That Kṛṣṇa has descended as the Lord Caitanya; therefore all others are His servants.

(14) Everything spiritual other than He is His servant —

83 Some accept Him and some do not, yet all are His servants. One who does not accept Him is destroyed by that very sin.

Anubhāṣya.

Forgetting his true nature, the *jīva* puts on the costume of an enjoyer and turns away from serving Kṛṣṇa. And some, out of ignorance, at times think that service to Bhagavān is not their only duty. But in fact every living being eternally abides in His service. If the *jīva* does not serve Bhagavān, his nature is overturned and misfortune arrives. Service to Śrī Caitanya is the intrinsic duty (*svarūpa-dharma*) of the *jīva*, an atomic particle of spirit. When the conditioned *jīva* forgets the

function of his true nature and strives for something else, it is only the pull of enjoying matter. When consciousness (*caitanya*) awakens in him, service to Caitanya naturally manifests in his heart. Deprived of service to Caitanya, the conditioned *jīva* in his undertakings comes to lord it over other things; but even then he is only an unworthy servant of Caitanya.

84 "I am Caitanya's servant, Caitanya's servant! I am Caitanya's servant, the servant of His servants!"

85 Saying this, He danced and sang with deep roars, and a moment later the Ācārya sat down, grown calm.

*Baladeva and all His *aṁśa-avatāras* regard Themselves as servants of Kṛṣṇa —*

86 The conception of oneself as a devotee has its root in Śrī Balarāma, and all His parts follow Him in that mood.

(1) His avatāra Saṅkarṣaṇa regards Himself as a servant —

87 One avatāra of His is Śrī Saṅkarṣaṇa, who at every moment thinks of Himself as a devotee.

(2) His avatāra Lakṣmaṇa regards Himself as a servant —

88 Another avatāra of His is the glorious Lakṣmaṇa, who served Śrī Rāma at every moment.

(3) His avatāra the original Puruṣa also regards Himself as a devotee —

89 The avatāra of Saṅkarṣaṇa who lies in the Causal Ocean likewise bears the mood of a devotee in His heart.

(4) His avatāra Advaita also regards Himself as a devotee —

90 A distinct manifestation of His is Advaita Ācārya, whose work at every moment is devotion to the Lord in body, mind and speech.

91 In words He says, “I am Caitanya’s attendant,” and in His mind He thinks at every moment, “I am His devotee.”

92 With His body He serves, offering water and tulasī, and by spreading bhakti He has delivered the whole world.

(5) His avatāra Śeṣa also regards Himself as a servant —

93 Śeṣa-Saṅkarṣaṇa, who holds up the earth, expands Himself into many bodies to serve Kṛṣṇa.

Anubhāṣya.

Kāya-vyūha means the ten bodies. See verse 76.

*All of Kṛṣṇa's *aṁśa-avatāras* are His devotees —*

94 All these are avatāras of Śrī Kṛṣṇa, yet we always see Them conduct Themselves as devotees.

*The supreme dignity of the *bhakta-avatāra* —*

95 The scriptures call all of Them devotee-avatāras, and the position of a devotee-avatāra is above all others.

Anubhāṣya.

Bhagavān descends into the material world to display His majesty. But for the welfare of the *jīva*, higher and more needful than all the pastimes of these Īśvara-avatāras is the exemplary *bhakta-avatāra*, who awakens in the *jīva* an understanding of how to serve [the Lord]. Trying to see the avatāras in whom majesty predominates through knowledge born of the senses, the *jīva* often comes to grief; but when he sees an avatāra of Bhagavān in the form of a devotee, his false ego cannot draw bad fruit from such an example. Many ignorant people, while being *jīvas*, call themselves “Vāsudeva” and the like, and after death take birth as jackals. Such a fate befalls precisely those who are bewildered and do not see the true nature of the *bhakta-avatāras*. False ego intoxicates the conditioned *jīva* with a craving for the majesty of Bhagavān and turns him into a Māyāvādī.

*The behavior of elder and younger between the *aṁśa-avatāras* and Kṛṣṇa, the whole (*aṁśī*) —*

96 Kṛṣṇa alone is the whole (*aṁśī*); the avatāras are His parts (*aṁśa*). And between the whole and the part we see the conduct of elder and younger.

*An elder *aṁśa-avatāra* sees the younger *aṁśī* as master, and a younger *aṁśa-avatāra* regards himself as servant of the elder *aṁśī* —*

97 In the mood of the elder, the whole is conscious of being the Master; in the mood of the younger, the part thinks of Himself as a devotee.

Anubhāṣya.

A separated portion of a thing is called *aṁśa*, and that of which it is a portion is the *aṁśī*. The part of the *aṁśī*, the portion of the undivided, is contained within the *aṁśī*, within the undivided. The *aṁśī* is the master (*prabhu*), the *aṁśa* is the devotee (*bhakta*). The relationship of "master" and "devotee" includes the distinction of elder and younger, greater and lesser: the greater is called "*prabhu*," the lesser "*bhakta*." The *aṁśī* is Kṛṣṇa; the *aṁśas* are Baladeva and the manifestations of Mahā-Viṣṇu who share His nature. Kṛṣṇa regards Himself as the Lord, and Baladeva and the others regard Themselves as devotees.

With Kṛṣṇa the devotee receives the highest honor —

98 Greater than equality with Kṛṣṇa is the position of a devotee, for Kṛṣṇa's devotee is dearer to Him than His own self.

Anubhāṣya.

The position of Kṛṣṇa's devotee, that is, the devotee's service to Kṛṣṇa, is higher than the idea of equality with Kṛṣṇa: for Kṛṣṇa loves His servant more than He loves His own interests. The best evidence of this is the verse of the *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* (9.4.68): "The sādhus are My heart, and I am the heart of the sādhus. They know nothing but Me, and I know nothing but them."

99 Kṛṣṇa regards His devotee as greater than Himself, and many words of scripture prove it.

*(*Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 11.14.15)*

100 "Neither Brahmā, born of Me, nor Śaṅkara, nor Saṅkarṣaṇa, nor Śrī, nor even My own self is as dear to Me as you are." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 11.14.15)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
O Uddhava! Neither Brahmā, nor Saṅkarṣaṇa, nor Lakṣmī, nor even I Myself am as dear to Me as you, My devotee, are dear to Me.

Anubhāṣya.
Śrī Kṛṣṇa's words to Uddhava, the best of His devotees:

me (to Me) **yathā bhavān** (you, Uddhava) **priyatamaḥ** (the devotee), [so] **ātma-yoniḥ** (Brahmā) **tathā na**; **śaṅkaraḥ tathā na**; **saṅkarṣaṇaḥ ca na tathā priyatamaḥ**; **śrīḥ** (Lakṣmī) **tathā na**, **ātmā tathā na eva** (not even I Myself, My divine form, am so dear).

Only in the mood of a devotee does Kṛṣṇa taste His own sweetness —

101 In equality with Kṛṣṇa there is no tasting of His sweetness; it is in the mood of a devotee that one relishes it.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
One who regards himself as Kṛṣṇa's equal does not taste His sweetness.

Thus ends the sixth chapter of the "Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya."

102 This is the conclusion of the scriptures and the experience of the wise; foolish people do not know the glory of this mood.

Anubhāṣya.
In *sārūpya* and the other kinds of liberation, and in *viṣṇu-tattva*, there is [a sense of] equality with Kṛṣṇa, so the sweetness of service to Kṛṣṇa is not tasted so [fully]. In the mood of a devotee there is no equality with Kṛṣṇa (no position of enjoyer), and so Kṛṣṇa's sweetness is fully realized, like the taste of food that is chewed. Ordinary people, out of foolishness and greed for mastery, are by their very nature unable to experience the highest limit of the servant's mood. Only those who are highly experienced and have entered deeply into the scriptures can understand this subtle subject.

Nityānanda, Rāma and the other Viṣṇus taste Kṛṣṇa's sweetness only in the mood of devotees —

103–104 Accepting the mood of devotees, Balarāma, Lakṣmaṇa, Advaita, Nityānanda, Śeṣa and Saṅkarṣaṇa drink the nectar of Kṛṣṇa's sweetness; intoxicated with that happiness, They know nothing else.

To taste His own sweetness, Kṛṣṇa Himself descends in the mood of a devotee as Gaura —

105 Let alone others: Śrī Kṛṣṇa Himself became thirsty to drink His own sweetness.

106 He strives to taste His own sweetness, but without the mood of a devotee it cannot be tasted.

Anubhāṣya.
Kṛṣṇa, the object of the devotees' worship, wished to know how the devotees taste His sweetness. Understanding that it cannot be tasted without accepting the mood of a devotee, He Himself became a devotee.

Anubhāṣya.
See Ādi 4.137–158.

Tasting His own sweetness in the mood of a devotee —

107 So, accepting the mood of a devotee, He descended in the form of Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya, full of every mood (*bhāva*).

108 In the moods of various devotees He drinks His own sweetness. I have explained this conclusion before.[9]

Anubhāṣya.
To taste the five different *rasas* — *śānta*, *dāsya*, *sakhya*, *vātsalya* and *madhura* — Śrī Gaurahari accepted the mood of each, and so He is full of every mood. Accepting the moods of devotees who take shelter of different *bhāvas*, Gauracandra, full of every mood, drinks His own sweetness.

The mood of a devotee belongs to all the avatāras of Viṣṇu —

109 All the avatāras have a claim to the mood of a devotee; there is no happiness greater than that of the devotee's mood.

Anubhāṣya.

All the avatāras of Viṣṇu are entitled to descend in the mood of a devotee for the sake of serving Kṛṣṇa. One who tastes [*rasa*] feels more happiness in serving the One who is served in the mood of a devotee than in the mood of Īśvara.

*Śrī Saṅkarṣaṇa is the original *bhakta-avatāra* —*

110 The original devotee-avatāra is Śrī Saṅkarṣaṇa, and among the devotee-avatāras Advaita too is counted.

Anubhāṣya.

Advaita Prabhu is *viṣṇu-tattva*, yet He displayed the pastimes of a servant befitting an associate of Śrī Caitanya. Regarding Himself as a servant is precisely what makes a *viṣṇu-tattva* a *bhakta-avatāra*. Śrī Saṅkarṣaṇa in Mahā-Vaikuṇṭha, though He abides as the Īśvara of the *catur-vyūha*, is the original *bhakta-avatāra*. From Him [comes] Mahā-Viṣṇu in the Causal Waters, and through the differences of His manifestations we learn of [His] glance (*īkṣaṇa*) in the efficient and material [causes]. Therefore Śrī Advaitācārya, the avatāra of Mahā-Viṣṇu, is Śrī *viṣṇu-tattva*. All the manifestations of Saṅkarṣaṇa are engaged in the service of Kṛṣṇa, the *svayaṁ-rūpa* — therefore Advaita Prabhu too is a servant of Gaura-Kṛṣṇa, that is, a *bhakta-avatāra*.

The glory of Advaita Prabhu —

111 The glory of Advaita Ācārya Gosāñi is boundless: it was by His roar that Caitanya descended.

112 By spreading saṅkīrtana He delivered the whole world; by Advaita's grace people obtained the treasure of prema.

113 Who can tell the endless glory of Advaita? I write only what I have heard from great souls.

Homage to Ācārya Prabhu —

114 Millions of times I bow at the Ācārya's feet. May He not count any offence of mine in this.

Anubhāṣya.
Thus ends the sixth chapter of the "Anubhāṣya."

115 Your glory is as fathomless as millions of oceans; to speak of its measure is a great offence.

116 Glory, glory, glory to Śrī Advaita Ācārya! Glory, glory to Śrī Caitanya and to the venerable Nityānanda!

117 In two verses I have set out the truth of Advaita. Now, O devotees, hear something of the Pañca-tattva.

118 Praying at the feet of Śrī Rūpa and Śrī Raghunātha, I, Kṛṣṇadāsa, narrate the *Caitanya-caritāmṛta*.

Notes

1. The same verse as Ādi 1.12. The edition ascribes verses 6.4–6.5 to the diary of Svarūpa Dāmodara («শ্রীস্বরূপগোস্বামি-কড়চায় শ্লোক»; heading: "explanation of the twelfth and thirteenth of the first fourteen verses of the Ādi"). ↩
2. The same verse as Ādi 1.13. ↩
3. The same verse as Ādi 2.30 and 3.68 (*Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: "see Ādi 2.30", where the *Anubhāṣya* explains the three meanings of the name Nārāyaṇa). Here the author cites it for the word *aṅgam*, "part": Nārāyaṇa is Your *aṅga*, that is, Your *aṁśa* (6.21). ↩
4. As in the Gauḍīya Maṭha edition: «তুলসীদলে» ("with tulasī leaves"; another reading: «তুলসীজলে», "with tulasī and water"). ↩
5. As in the Gauḍīya Maṭha edition: «নারদাদি» ("Nārada and others"; another reading: «নারদার»). ↩
6. As in the Gauḍīya Maṭha edition: «হইল» (another reading: «হইলা»); the sense is the same. ↩

7. As in the Gauḍīya Maṭha edition: «তাঁরা» (another reading: «তারা»); the sense is the same. ↩
8. As in the Gauḍīya Maṭha edition: «কিঙ্করীণাং» (another reading: «কিঙ্করিণাং»). ↩
9. Before — in Ādi 4: on 6.105–6.106 the *Anubhāṣya* refers to Ādi 4.137–4.158. ↩
10. The edition reads *nija-jana-sandoha (garva)* (“of the multitude of His own people (pride)”); the verse has *smaya* (pride). Translated according to the verse. ↩
11. *Manu-saṁhitā* 1.5–9. ↩
12. *Viṣṇu Purāṇa* 1.1.31. ↩
13. *Bṛhad-āraṇyaka Upaniṣad* 4.4.22. ↩
14. *Kaṭha Upaniṣad* 1.2.15. ↩
15. *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 2.5.15. ↩
16. *Śvetāśvatara Upaniṣad* 5.2. ↩
17. So in the edition; in the Sanskrit text of the *Govinda-bhāṣya* this point concerns the *smṛtis* of Manu and others. ↩
18. In Sanskrit, *jñānāvarodhanāt*, “because of an obstruction (checking) of knowledge”; the passage is understood in the same way in the translation of the *Gaura-gaṇoddeśa-dīpikā* (22): “having given up the path of (dry) knowledge.” ↩
19. *Bhakti-rasāmṛta-sindhu* 1.1.38. ↩
20. *Dāmodarāṣṭaka* 4 and 7. ↩
21. So in the edition; according to the *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* (10.46–47), Uddhava came to Vraja from Mathurā and returned there. ↩
22. Unclear place in the scan: after “speaks” the edition has *śrīti* (apparently a garbled pratīka of the verse). ↩

“Śrī Caitanya-caritāmṛta”

Ādi-līlā

Chapter 7

Setting Forth the Account of the Pañca-tattva

(English translation from the Bengali, following the Gauḍīya Maṭha edition and the «Anubhāṣya», 2026 — draft)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya

Summary. This seventh chapter describes the glory of the Pañca-tattva. Kṛṣṇa Caitanya, who comprises the five *tattvas*, descended and gave the world the holy name and *prema*, and a great flood of *prema* arose. Several kinds of sophists (*kutārkikas*) — the Māyāvādīs, the blasphemers and others — fled from that flood. Wishing to deliver them, Mahāprabhu accepted *sannyāsa* and, by preaching pure devotion, drew all those people to His feet. He also wished to deliver the Māyāvādī *sannyāsīs* living in Kāśī. At the entreaty of the devotees He met all those *sannyāsīs* together in the house of a certain brāhmaṇa in Vārāṇasī-dhāma. First He showed them the majesty of His own true nature (*svarūpa*) and so won their faith. Then, answering their questions, He showed that the doctrine of Māyāvāda has no foundation and pointed out every kind of fault in the views of Śrī Śaṅkarācārya. By the strength of the *sukṛti* they gained by seeing Bhagavān, He brought them onto the path of *bhakti* and bestowed His mercy on them.

A description of the great magnanimity of Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya —

1 I bow to Śrī Caitanya, the only refuge of those who have no other refuge, who gives the highest treasure to those bereft of every good. Now I write of the magnanimity with which He bestows love and devotion for Kṛṣṇa.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

I bow down to Śrī Caitanya, the refuge of those who have no other refuge — that is, of the *akiñcanas* — who grants the greatest goal to people bereft of the

highest goal (*paramārtha*). And I describe the magnanimity with which He gives *prema-bhakti*.

Anubhāṣya.

agaty-eka-gatiṁ (the one, incomparable refuge of the *agati*, those who have no other refuge), **hīnārthādhika-** (to those who are *hīna-artha* — bereft of *artha*, that is, of the highest goal, deprived of it — that which is beyond all [*adhika*], the greatest: love for Kṛṣṇa, the fifth goal of human life) **sādhakam** (the giver) **śrī-caitanyaṁ natvā** (having bowed down), **asya** (of this Bhagavān, Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya) **prema-bhakti-vadānyatā** (the great compassion of granting *prema-bhakti* for Kṛṣṇa) **likhyate** (is described).

2 Glory, glory to Mahāprabhu Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya! Whoever takes shelter at His feet is truly blessed.

*Of the six *tattvas* in the verse "*vande gurūn*…," apart from *guru-tattva*, the examination of the Pañca-tattva begins; though without difference, it is fivefold for the tasting of *rasa* —*

3 At the beginning I offered obeisance to the six truths, headed by the guru. I have spoken of the truth of the guru; now I shall consider the other five.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

In the first chapter I described *guru-tattva*, dividing it into the *dīkṣā-guru* and the *śikṣā-guru*. The six *tattvas* are those named in the verse "*vande gurūn īśa-bhaktān*…." Now, in this verse, setting *guru-tattva* aside, I examine the remaining five *tattvas*.

4 The five truths descended together with Śrī Caitanya, and with them He delights in saṅkīrtana.

5 The five truths are one substance; there is no difference between them at all. Yet to taste rasa, the one truth appears in different forms.

Anubhāṣya.

The Reality possessed of potency (*śaktimān vastu*) is manifest as the Pañca-tattva, recognized through five different kinds of pastimes. In substance it has no

duality and so is one, yet it is full of fivefold variety. This variety is a distinctive feature of the pastimes: unlike a dry existence without taste, it serves the sweetness of *rasa*. The *śruti* says: “His supreme potency is heard to be manifold indeed.”[6] From these words it follows that the distinctions of the many potencies of the Reality, the nondual Knowledge (*advaya-jñāna*), exist eternally.

In the Pañca-tattva — Śrī Gaurāṅga, Nityānanda, Advaita, Gadādhara, Śrīvāsa and the others — there is no difference whatsoever in substance. But for the tasting of *rasa* this *tattva*, full of varied pastimes, is distinguished in five ways: “*bhakta-rūpa*,” “*bhakta-svarūpa*,” “*bhaktāvatāra*,” “*bhakta-śakti*” and “*śuddha-bhakta*.” Of these five *tattvas*, the “*bhakta-rūpa*,” the “*bhakta-svarūpa*” and the “*bhaktāvatāra*” are the Prabhu, the Viṣṇu-*tattva*, in the forms of “*svayam*,” “*prakāśa*” and “*aṁśa*.” The “*bhakta-śakti*” and the “*śuddha-bhakta*” are the *tattva* of potency: it is included within the Viṣṇu-*tattva*, rests on Him as its shelter and is nondifferent from Him. Therefore everything that serves *rasa* (*rasopakaraṇa*) is nondifferent from the Reality and intimately united with the Form full of *rasa*; in substance they cannot differ from one another. If, of the two — the “worshipper” and the “One who is worshipped” — one is separated or absent, there can be no pastimes of tasting *rasa*.

Explanation of the last of the fourteen opening verses of Ādi — (a verse from the diary of Śrī Rūpa Gosvāmī)[7]

6 “I bow to Kṛṣṇa, who is manifest as five truths — the Pañca-tattva: as a devotee in form and a devotee in essence, as the incarnation of a devotee, as the one called a devotee, and as the potency of devotion.” (Śrī Rūpa Gosvāmī)[1]

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

I bow down to Śrī Kṛṣṇa, who comprises the five *tattvas*: Kṛṣṇa's *bhakta-rūpa*, *bhakta-svarūpa*, *bhakta-avatāra*, *bhakta* and *bhakta-śakti*.

Anubhāṣya.

bhakta-rūpa-svarūpakam (Him whose form [*rūpa*] is Śrī Gaura, full of a devotee's feelings, with a pure body, intent on tasting Himself, and whose *svarūpa* is Nityānanda, who has taken the form of a brother), **bhaktāvatāraṁ** (Advaita), **bhaktākhyaṁ** (Śrīvāsa and others, who abide in *śānta*, *dāsya* and the other *rasas*), **bhakta-śaktikam** (Śrī Gadādhara, Dāmodara, Rāmānanda and

others), **pañca-tattvātmakaṁ** (Him whose very self, the *svarūpa*, is the five *tattvas*) **kṛṣṇaṁ** (Kṛṣṇa Caitanya-deva) **namāmi**.

*Only Śrī Nanda-nandana, the *svayaṁ-rūpa*, is the Lord of all —*

7 Kṛṣṇa is Bhagavān Himself, the one Lord of all. He has no equal; He is the son of Nanda and the crown of all who relish rasa.

*All the Viṣṇus, the Vaiṣṇavas and everything that serves in the *dhāma*, the *jīvas* and *pradhāna* — all are Kṛṣṇa's servants —*

8 He enjoys the rāsa dance and His other pastimes and is the beloved of the maidens of Vraja; all the others you see are His associates.

That same Kṛṣṇa is Gaura —

9 That same Kṛṣṇa has descended as Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya, and with Him have come all those associates, every one of them blessed.

Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya is the Lord of all, and yet He is full of the mood of being subordinate —

10 Lord Caitanya alone is the Supreme Lord, yet His pure, spiritual body is filled with the sentiment of a devotee.

Anubhāṣya.

The *śruti* mantra "The eternal among the eternals, the conscious among the conscious"[8] points to countless spiritual entities, and their one Supreme Lord is Śrī Caitanya-deva. The Māyāvādīs try to merge the atomic particles of spiritual potency with the all-pervading Spirit (*vibhu-cit*), and so they fall into error; this verse is presented to dispel it. Śrī Caitanya-deva is nondifferent from Vrajendranandana, yet, regarding Him (Kṛṣṇa) as the One to be worshipped, He assumes a form full of the mood of serving Him. Let no one, then, consider this form of Bhagavān an object of material enjoyment, or count it among the *jīvas* within the material world. That is why Śrī Caitanya's form has not been called merely the form of a *sādhaka* within the material world. It is manifest in *viśuddha-sattva*, and so this form of *rasa* is recognized only in a heart made bright by *sattva*. Śrī Caitanya-deva is the Supreme Lord Himself, and yet He

displays pastimes befitting a servant, not the pastimes of an enjoyer. To see His holy form, with a vision darkened by *tamas*, as some instrument engaged in gratifying the senses is forbidden.

Kṛṣṇa descends as Gaura "in the form of a devotee" only to taste His own sweetness —

11 Kṛṣṇa's sweetness has one wondrous property: to taste Himself, He takes on the sentiment of His own devotee.

Anubhāṣya.

Kṛṣṇa, the shelter of all sweetness, has one unprecedented disposition of heart: though He Himself is the *viṣaya-vigraha*, He accepts the mood of the *āśraya*, the worshipper, and becomes absorbed in tasting service to the *viṣaya*. Yet Śrī Caitanya-deva is not merely a form full of the mood of the *āśraya*: He is the *svayaṁ-rūpa*, the Reality Himself.

*Nitāi is the "*bhakta-svarūpa*," Advaita the "*bhaktāvatāra*" —*

12 That is why Caitanya Gosāñi appears in the mood of a devotee, and His brother Nityānanda is the devotee in essence (*bhakta-svarūpa*).

13 Advaita Ācārya is His incarnation as a devotee (*bhakta-avatāra*). These three truths we all glorify as the Lord — as Prabhu.

Nitāi and Advaita — Gaura is the Lord even of these two Lords —

14 One is Mahāprabhu, and the other two are Prabhus; the two Prabhus serve the feet of Mahāprabhu.

*Three *tattvas* are the worshipped, and the fourth and fifth *tattvas* are the worshippers —*

15 These three truths we accept as worshipable by all; the fourth, the truth of the devotee, we know as the worshipper.

Anubhāṣya.

From the description of the true nature of the Pañca-tattva we can understand that Śrī Mahāprabhu alone is the highest Truth (*para-tattva*), and that Śrī Nityānanda and Advaita Prabhu are the "Īśvara-*tattva*" subordinate to Him. The Supreme Lord and the two manifestations of the Lord are all *para-tattva*, and all of Them are worshipped by every other *tattva*. The fourth, the *tattva* of the pure devotee (*śuddha-bhakta*), and the fifth, the *tattva* of the intimate devotee (*antaraṅga-bhakta*), are both *tattvas* of "worshippers." The two *tattvas* who are "worshipped" appear in the form of servants: though the two *tattvas* of "worshippers" revere Them, They Themselves abide in the service of Śrī Gaurāṅga, the One who is served.

*Śrīvāsa and others — the *tattva* of the devotee —*

16 The countless millions of devotees headed by Śrīvāsa are all counted among the pure devotees (*śuddha-bhakta*).

*Gadādhara and others — the *tattva* of potency —*

17 Gadādhara Paṇḍita and others are incarnations of the Lord's potency (*śakti*); they are counted as His intimate devotees.

Anubhāṣya.

The *tattvas* of the intimate devotee and of the pure devotee differ in this way: the *tattva* of potency abides in *madhura-rasa*, and in *vātsalya*, *sakhya* and *dāsya-rasa*. If one compares them impartially, the potencies are higher than the devotees, and therefore Śrī Gaurasundara's intimate servants are the devotees eternally sheltered in *madhura-rasa*. The servants of Śrī Nityānanda and Śrī Advaita generally abide in *vātsalya*, *sakhya*, *dāsya* and *śānta-rasa*. But when these pure devotees come to feel intense love for Śrī Gaurasundara, they take shelter of *madhura-rasa* under the guidance of the intimate devotees. This is made clear at the beginning of Śrī Ṭhākura Mahāśaya's *Prārthanā*: "When will my body thrill as I say 'Gaurāṅga'? When will tears flow from my eyes as I say 'Hari, Hari'? When will Nitāicānd be merciful to me? When will my desire for worldly life become insignificant? When will my mind become pure, giving up the objects of the senses? When will I see Śrī Vṛndāvana? When will I yearn for the feet of Rūpa and Raghunātha? When will I understand the love of the Divine Couple?"

Describing how the "*śuddha-bhakta*" and the "*antaraṅga-bhakta*" differ, Śrī Rūpapāda in his book *Upadeśāmṛta* depicted the steps by which the practicing *jīva* rises higher and higher: "Of all who perform karma, the knowers (*jñānīs*) are dearer to Hari — so it is said everywhere. Dearer than they are those who have left knowledge behind and are wholly given to *bhakti*. Dearer than these are those fixed in *prema* alone. Dearer than they are the lotus-eyed cowherd girls, and dearer even than they is Rādhikā, the most beloved. And just as dear to Him is this pond of Hers. What wise person would not take shelter of it?" (*Upadeśāmṛta* 10)

Of the five *tattvas* of the Pañca-tattva, two are potency (*śakti*) and three are the possessor of potency (*śaktimān*). The pure devotees and the intimate devotees are the two kinds of potency. Those who are free of other desires and do not cover their pure inclination to serve Kṛṣṇa with the covering of karma or *jñāna* are *śuddha-bhaktas*. The devotees wholly devoted to Kṛṣṇa (*aikāntika*) who have taken shelter in *madhura-rasa* alone are the *antaraṅga-bhaktas*. *Madhura-rasa* includes *vātsalya*, *sakhya* and *dāsya*. The *antaraṅga-bhakta* is a special kind of *śuddha-bhakta*.

*With the four *tattvas* the Lord plays, preaches, tastes and gives —*

18–19 With them the Lord enjoys His eternal pastimes, with them He spreads the kīrtana, with them He tastes prema, and with them He gives away the treasure of prema.

Anubhāṣya.

Śrī Mahāprabhu, together with all of them — His *prakāśa*, the avatāra of His *puruṣa-avatāra*, the intimate devotees and the pure devotees — Himself eternally plays by tasting *prema*, and gives *prema* to the world by preaching *kīrtana*.

*The five *tattvas* together eternally taste and distribute the *rasa* of love for Kṛṣṇa —*

20–21 Coming to earth together, the five truths broke the seal of the ancient storehouse of prema. Together they plunder that love and taste it, and the more they drink, the more their thirst grows at every moment.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Śrī Kṛṣṇa's own pastimes are the storehouse of *prema*. That storehouse had indeed come into the world, but its doors were locked and sealed. In the avatāra of Śrī Caitanya the five *tattvas* together broke that seal, opened the doors and, plundering *prema*, tasted it.

22 Again and again they give it to others to drink and grow wild with love; they dance, weep, laugh and sing as though intoxicated.

In distributing love for Kṛṣṇa there is no considering who is fit and who is unfit —

23 They make no distinction between the fit and the unfit, nor between a proper place and an improper one: wherever they find anyone, there they give prema.

*Distributing *prema* makes it increase rather than diminish —*

24 Plundering, tasting and giving, they empty the storehouse; yet so wondrous is this storehouse that the prema in it grows a hundredfold.

*The world drowns in the flood of *prema* —*

25 The flood of prema surged and spread on every side, drowning everyone — women and old men, boys and youths.

26 The good and the wicked, the lame, the dull and the blind — the flood of prema engulfed all the people of the world.

*Immersed in the *rasa* of love for Kṛṣṇa, the *jīva* is rid of the seed of karma —*

27 The world was drowned, and the seed of the jīvas' bondage was destroyed. Seeing this, the five felt the highest joy.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

When the storehouse of *prema* was thrown open, the flood of the *rasa* of *prema* drowned the whole world with tremendous force. In it perished the seed

from which the bondage of ignorance (*avidyā*) grows in the conditioned *jīvas* — their forgetfulness that they are Kṛṣṇa's servants.

Anubhāṣya.

In the Lord's marginal potency, called the *jīva-śakti*, together with the endeavor turned toward Kṛṣṇa there also lies, in unmanifest form, the seed of the desire to enjoy — aversion to Kṛṣṇa. This seed of desire, born of the tree of *saṁsāra*, is watered by the flow of time, and day after day it binds the conditioned *jīva* with all kinds of bonds of enjoyment and torments him with the threefold miseries. A seed buried in the soil will not sprout if water submerges it. Just so, in the flood of *prema* — the bottomless waters of the ocean of service to Bhagavān — the seeds of the desire to enjoy anything other than service to Kṛṣṇa were drowned and destroyed, and no sprouts of desire could arise from them any longer. Śrī Caitanyacandra descended in the form of the Pañca-tattva, and the purpose of His descent was fulfilled; seeing this, all were filled with joy. Śrīmat Prabodhānanda Sarasvatī, the *tridaṇḍipāda*, described this in his book *Śrī Caitanya-candrāmṛta*: “When Caitanyacandra revealed the supreme path of *bhakti-yoga*, the worldly gave up talk of wives, sons and the like; the learned gave up disputes over the *śāstras*; the kings of *yogīs* gave up the hardship of restraining the breath; ascetics gave up their austerities; and *sannyāsīs* gave up the practice of knowledge. No other *rasa* remained.”

*The rain of *prema* increases the *rasa* of *prema* —*

28 The more the five pour down the rain of prema, the higher the waters rise, until they fill the three worlds.

*Those deprived of the *rasa* of love for Kṛṣṇa —*

29–30 But the Māyāvādīs, those devoted to fruitive work, the false logicians, the blasphemers, the pāṣaṇḍīs and the lowest of students — all these, being very clever, ran away, and the flood could not touch them.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

The Māyāvādīs are Prakāśānanda and the other *sannyāsīs*. In every matter that is real they raise disputes about “*māyā*”! They call Brahman “beyond *māyā*,” yet they make Īśvara “an associate of *māyā*” and call the bodies of all Īśvara's avatāras “made of *māyā*.” They say that *māyā* takes part in the very

constitution of the *jīva*, that is, that every notion of “I” in the *jīva* is made by *māyā*. From this they conclude that once the *jīva* is liberated, no state that could be called “the pure *jīva*” remains. In other words, they teach that the liberated *jīva* becomes nondifferent from Brahman.

Those devoted to karma (*karma-niṣṭha*) are Devānanda and other *karmīs* devoid of *bhakti*, and the *smārtas* dulled by karma — that is, those who declare karma and its fruits to be the chief aim of the *jīva*.

The sophists are Sārvabhauma and other logicians who deny Īśvara.

The blasphemers are the man whom the Lord chased with a stick, and Gopāla Cāpāla and others who blasphemed the Lord and His devotees.

The *pāṣaṇḍīs* are those who explain other gods as equal to Bhagavān.

The lowly students are those who take learning to be a cause for argument and do not know that learning is the means to attain Īśvara.

The ocean of causeless mercy thinks how to deliver them —

31–32 Seeing this, Mahāprabhu reflected: “I tried to drown the whole world, but some have escaped, and My vow has been broken. To drown them too, I shall devise a playful ruse.”

*To deliver the fallen *jīvas* deprived of *prema*, He accepts *sannyāsa* —*

33 Saying this and deliberating within Himself, the Lord accepted the order of sannyāsa.

Anubhāṣya.

One who mistakenly believes that “*māyā*” is present in Bhagavān's being, in His abode, in devotion to Him and in His devotee — though all of these are beyond *māyā* — is a “Māyāvādī.” One who mistakenly believes that these four truths are subject to karma and to enjoying its fruits is “devoted to karma” (*karma-niṣṭha*). People who mistakenly think that in these four truths there is room for argument born of ignorance are “sophists.” One who mistakenly thinks that these four truths deserve censure is a “blasphemer.” One who mistakenly thinks that other things of *māyā* are equal to these four truths is a “*pāṣaṇḍī*.” And those fond of study who mistakenly think that these four truths are on a par with other objects of material enjoyment are “lowly students.” All of them fled, driven by one aim: that

the waters of the flood of *prema* given by Gaurasundara, who is full of love, should in no way touch them. Seeing this, Śrī Mahāprabhu wished to accept the ornament of the fourth *āśrama*. It is highly revered by those people of material nature already mentioned, who turn away from love for Kṛṣṇa and long for the four goals of life (*catur-varga*). He reasoned that in the eyes of these worldly people, bewitched by *māyā*, the fourth *āśrama* is the desirable ideal.

34 For twenty-four years He lived as a householder; in His twenty-fifth year He took up the dharma of a renunciant.

Anubhāṣya.

There are four kinds of *āśramas*: *brahmacārī*, *gṛhastha*, *vānaprastha* and *yati*. Each *āśrama* in turn has four divisions. The *Bhāgavatam* says: "*Sāvitrya*, *prājāpatya*, *brāhma* and *bṛhat* [for the *brahmacārīs*]; *vārtā*, *sañcaya*, *śālīna* and *śiloñcha* for the householder; the *vaikhānasas*, *vālakhilyas*, *audumbaras* and *phenapas* in the forest; and for the *sannyāsīs*, first the *kuṭīcaka*, then the *bahūdaka*, the *haṁsa* and the *niṣkriya*." (*Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 3.12.42–43) That is, *brahmacarya* is of four kinds: (1) *sāvitrya*, a *brahmacarya* of three nights, from the *upanayana* until the study of the Gāyatrī; (2) *prājāpatya*, a *brahmacarya* in which one keeps vows for a year after the *upanayana*; (3) *brāhma*, a *brahmacarya* from the *upanayana* until the three Vedas have been learned; (4) *bṛhat*, a *brahmacarya* from the *upanayana* until death. The first three are known as "*upakurvāṇa*" and the last as "*naiṣṭhika*." Householders are of four kinds: (1) *vārtā*, who lives by agriculture and other occupations that are not forbidden; (2) *sañcaya*, who lives by performing sacrifices for others and the like; (3) *śālīna*, who lives on what comes unasked; (4) *śiloñchana*, who lives on grains gleaned from the ground. *Vānaprasthas* are of four kinds: (1) the *vaikhānasa*, who lives on what grows without plowing; (2) the *vālikhilya*, who, on obtaining new grain, gives up what he had stored before; (3) the *auḍumbara*, who, on rising from bed, accepts food brought from whatever direction he first looks; (4) the *phenapa*, who sustains life on fruits that have fallen by themselves. *Sannyāsīs* are of four kinds: (1) the *kuṭīcaka*, chiefly devoted to the duties of his own *āśrama*; (2) the *bahūdaka*, who has given up karma and is chiefly devoted to cultivating knowledge; (3) the *haṁsa*, fixed in the cultivation of knowledge; (4) the *niṣkriya*, a *paramahaṁsa*, or one who has realized the truth.

Sannyāsa is of two kinds, "*dhīra*" and "*narottama*": "One who, detached and freed from bonds, gives up this body, which no longer serves any purpose, without anyone knowing where he has gone, is called '*dhīra*.' And one who, self-possessed, has become disgusted with the world by himself or through another's instruction and, placing Hari in his heart, leaves home, is '*narottama*.'" (*Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 1.13.26–27) Śrī Mahāprabhu accepted *sannyāsa* in the bright fortnight of the month of Māgha in the Śaka year 1432 from Śrī Keśava Bhāratī, a *daṇḍi-svāmī* of the *sampradāya* of Śrī Śaṅkara, who lived in Kāṭoyā. These *sannyāsīs* are under the Śṛṅgerī *maṭha* in the south.

*The deliverance of those deprived of *prema* — the *karmīs*, students, *pāṣaṇḍīs*, logicians, blasphemers and the rest —*

35 Having taken sannyāsa, the Lord drew to Himself all who had fled — the logicians and the rest.

36 Students, pāṣaṇḍīs, karmīs, blasphemers and all the others came and bowed down at the Lord's feet.

Anubhāṣya.

See the last part of the *Anubhāṣya* on Ādi 7.33.

*They are freed from their offenses and gain *bhakti* —*

37 He forgave their offences, and they sank into the waters of prema. Who can escape the Lord's great net of love?

*The Lord devises a means to deliver all *jīvas* —*

38 The Lord is the avatāra of mercy who came to deliver everyone, and to that end He devises countless stratagems.

All people are delivered except the Māyāvādīs of Kāśī —

39 He made His devotees of all — even the mlecchas and others; only the Māyāvādīs of Kāśī escaped.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

As soon as the Lord accepted *sannyāsa*, the sophists, those devoted to karma, the blasphemers, the *pāṣaṇḍīs* and the lowly students one after another took shelter at His feet, and even many *mlecchas* accepted His guidance. Only the Māyāvādīs of Vārāṇasī-dhāma, having fled from the flood of *prema*, remained apart!

Anubhāṣya.

"The Māyāvādīs of Kāśī." People bewildered by knowledge born of the senses say that the world they see with their senses is "created by *māyā*," since it can be measured by sensory knowledge. There are people skilled in this kind of reasoning: "The Truth (*tattva-vastu*) is beyond *māyā*, yet in it there is no eternal spiritual variety and no spiritual pastime; it is pure consciousness alone (*cin-mātra*)." They are the "Māyāvādīs of Kāśī." The "Māyāvādīs of Sārnāth," or the "Māyāvādīs of Bodh Gayā," do not accept the *māyā* of Brahman: in their reasoning, the doctrine that there is nothing but non-spirit (*acin-mātra-vāda*) is established. The "Māyāvādīs of Kāśī" and the Māyāvādīs of other places are all *prakṛti-vādīs*; none of them is a "*brahma-vādī* or *tattva-vādī*." The Māyāvādīs of Kāśī call themselves "*brahma-vādīs*" with their lips, but they do not accept the distinction between Brahman and *prakṛti*: following their doctrine of merging (*samanvaya-vāda*), they hold Brahman and *māyā* to be one and the same. The Māyāvādīs know nothing of *bhakti* and Yogamāyā, and that is why they are nondevotees, averse to devotion to Kṛṣṇa. In their hearts the Māyāvādīs are convinced that everything said about eternal *bhakti*, the One who is worshipped and the devotee — all of it is subject to their sense-born knowledge. But in fact, judged by the real truth, such words are worth nothing. However many sophistries and disputes the Māyāvādīs put forward among themselves, they never approach the real truth, and so the Truth and His spiritual variety are not subject to their imaginary reasonings.

40 On His way to Vṛndāvana the Lord stayed in Kāśī, and the Māyāvādīs began to blaspheme Him:

The Māyāvādīs blaspheme the Lord —

41 "Though a sannyāsī, He sings and dances. He does not hear Vedānta, but performs saṅkīrtana.

Anubhāṣya.

The *smṛti* enjoins: “The *sannyāsī* should give up the *tauryatrika* — singing, dancing and playing instruments — and should always study Vedānta.” The *sannyāsīs* of Kāśī saw that Śrī Mahāprabhu did not listen to Śaṅkara's Māyāvāda but, on the contrary, was absorbed in singing of Kṛṣṇa and so on, and danced overwhelmed with love. Measuring Him by this injunction, they concluded that He did not know the *dharma* of *sannyāsa*. Śaṅkara says: “Fortunate indeed are those who wear only a loincloth and always delight in the words of Vedānta.”[9] Not seeing this mark in Śrī Mahāprabhu, the Māyāvādī *sannyāsīs* and the home-bound householders (*gṛhavratas*) blasphemed Him. On the deliverance of the Māyāvādī *sannyāsīs* of Kāśī, see especially Madhya 25.5–169.

42 This foolish sannyāsī does not know His own dharma; a sentimentalist Himself, He wanders about with sentimentalists.”

43 Hearing all this, the Lord smiled within, and, paying no heed, He spoke with none of them.

The Lord disregards them and goes to Mathurā —

44 Disregarding them, He went on to Mathurā, and after seeing it He came back again.

The Lord stays in Candraśekhara's house —

45 In Kāśī lived the scribe Śrī Candraśekhara, a śūdra, and the Lord, supremely independent, stayed in his house.

Anubhāṣya.

In the *Śrī Caitanya-candrodaya-nāṭaka* Śrī Candraśekhara is called a “*śaukra-vaidya*” (a Vaidya by birth). In those days the Vaidyas by birth, and every *varṇa* other than the brāhmaṇas by birth, were called “*śūdras*.” Later, in the present century, the Kāyasthas, resorting to the purificatory rite for the *vrātyas* (those who have lost the right to initiation), took and are taking the *saṁskāras* of *kṣatriyas*, and the Vaidyas those of *vaiśyas*. In the families of the Śrī Gauḍīya Vaiṣṇava ācāryas who follow the Vaiṣṇava faith — in the line of Ṭhākura Raghunandana, in the line of Ṭhākura Kṛṣṇadāsa and Navanī Hoḍa, and in the line

of Śrī Rasikānanda-deva, the disciple of Śyāmānanda Prabhu — the *upanayana-saṁskāra*, the ideal of brahminhood, has continued for three or four centuries now. To this day they act as *dīkṣā-gurus* for all *varṇas*, brāhmaṇas included, and worship *śālagrāmas* and other Deities.

*Leaving the Māyāvādī *sannyāsīs*, the Lord accepts *bhikṣā* in the house of Tapana Miśra —*

46 He took His meals at the house of Tapana Miśra and accepted no invitation in the company of the sannyāsīs.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

The Vaidya Candraśekhara was a *śūdra* by *varṇa*. It is not proper for *sannyāsīs* to spend the night in a *śūdra*'s house, but Mahāprabhu, out of mercy to him, stayed in his house: for He is the independent Īśvara, and before His mercy all are equal, brāhmaṇa and *śūdra* alike. He accepted *bhikṣā*, that is, His meals, in the house of Tapana Miśra. And nowhere did He accept invitations together with other *sannyāsīs*.

Instructions to Śrī Sanātana —

47 Sanātana Gosāñi came and met Him there, and to instruct him the Lord stayed two months.

48 He taught him the whole dharma of the Vaiṣṇavas and all the hidden heart of the *Bhāgavata* and the other scriptures.

The appeal of Candraśekhara and Tapana Miśra —

49 Meanwhile Candraśekhara and Tapana Miśra, deeply grieved, came to the Lord’s feet with a petition:

50 “How much longer must we hear You blasphemed, O Lord? We cannot bear it; we would rather give up our lives.

51 All the sannyāsīs revile You, and we cannot listen to it: our hearts and ears are bursting.”

52 Hearing this, the Lord only smiled a little. Just then a brāhmaṇa came to meet Him.

The brāhmaṇa's request —

53 He came and, clasping the Lord’s feet, made his petition: “I beg one thing of You; be pleased and grant it.

54 I have invited all the sannyāsīs; if You come too, my heart’s desire will be fulfilled.

55 I know that You do not go to gatherings of sannyāsīs; yet be merciful to me and accept my invitation.”

The Lord accepts the invitation —

56 Smiling, the Lord accepted the invitation; He made this gesture to show mercy to the sannyāsīs.

57 The brāhmaṇa knew that the Lord does not go to anyone’s house, but, inspired by the Lord Himself, he pressed Him with great insistence.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
Even so, the Lord, wishing to bestow mercy on the *sannyāsīs*, inspired the brāhmaṇa from within his heart, and that is why he made such an insistent request.

*The Lord enters the assembly of *sannyāsīs* —*

58 The next day the Lord went to the brāhmaṇa’s house and saw the sannyāsīs all seated there.

The Lord's humility —

59 Bowing to them all, He went to wash His feet, and when He had washed them He sat down in that very place.

*The Lord displays His majesty and bewilders the *pāṣaṇḍīs* —*

60 As He sat there, He revealed a little of His majesty: His body shone with great effulgence, with the splendour of millions of suns.[2]

61 That splendour drew the minds of all the sannyāsīs, and they all rose from their seats.

The words of Prakāśānanda Sarasvatī —

62 The chief among the sannyāsīs, Prakāśānanda by name, addressed the Lord with respect:

63 "Come here, Gosāñi; listen, Śrīpāda. You are sitting in an impure place — why are You so downcast?"

The Lord's humble words —

64 The Lord replied, "I belong to a lower sampradāya; it is not fitting for Me to sit in your assembly."

Anubhāṣya.

Among the *daṇḍīs* of the ten names, whose order Śrī Śaṅkarācārya founded, three *sampradāyas* — "Tīrtha," "Āśrama" and "Sarasvatī" — rank above the *sannyāsīs* of the other *sampradāyas* in good conduct and in honor. Śrī Mahāprabhu had accepted *sannyāsa* in the "Bhāratī" *sampradāya*, and so He regarded Prakāśānanda Sarasvatī as belonging to a higher *sampradāya*. Or else: the *brahma-sannyāsīs* themselves consider their social standing high, and so Śrī Mahāprabhu, wishing to show the *dharma* of a Vaiṣṇava *sannyāsī* — to seek no honor for oneself (*amānī*) and to give honor to others (*mānada*) — spoke of Himself as belonging to a lower *sampradāya*. Even today the *sannyāsīs* of Śaṅkara's *sampradāya* are unwilling to call other *sannyāsīs* "*sannyāsīs*": they give them only the title "*brahmacārī*" and fancy themselves "gurus."

Prakāśānanda's question —

65 Then Prakāśānanda himself took Him by the hand and, with respect, seated Him in the midst of the assembly.

66 He asked, “Your name is Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya, is it not? You are a disciple of Keśava Bhāratī, and so You are worthy of glory.

Anubhāṣya.
Keśava Bhāratī — see the *Vaiṣṇava-mañjuṣā-samāhṛti* (part 2).

67 You are a sannyāsī of our own sampradāya and You live in this town; why then do You not come to see us?

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
“A *sannyāsī* of the *sampradāya*”: according to the teaching of Śrī Śaṅkarācārya, the brāhmaṇas who accept *sannyāsa* in the order of the ten names are the world-honored “Vedic *sannyāsīs*,” that is, genuine *sannyāsīs* sanctioned by the *śāstras*.

68 Though You are a sannyāsī, You dance and sing, and You take all these sentimentalists with You and perform kīrtana.

69 The study of Vedānta and meditation are the dharma of a sannyāsī; why do You abandon them and do the work of sentimentalists?

Anubhāṣya.
See the *Anubhāṣya* on Ādi 7.41.

70 From Your splendour we see that You are Nārāyaṇa Himself; why then do You behave so lowly? What is the reason?”

The Lord describes the glory of the holy name —

71 The Lord said, “Listen, Śrīpāda, to the reason for this. My guru saw that I was a fool, and he chastised Me:

Anubhāṣya.

Śrī Caitanya-deva is the Form of the real Reality, the one thing Vedānta establishes. Determining who is qualified to study Vedānta, He proclaimed that the right to the path of *śruti* belongs to those who are “humbler than a blade of grass,” tolerant like a tree, who seek no honor for themselves and give honor to others.[10] The guru chants the words of *śruti* with his holy mouth, and the listener chants them after him; only this *kīrtana* — the *abhidheya*, that is, the *sādhana* — brings forth the fruit, the *prayojana*. That part of the words of *śruti* in which realized knowledge (*vijñāna*) of the real Reality, the object of worship, is glorified is the all-embracing whole (*aṁśī*), the root and source of the *śruti-śāstras*. Within that whole lie both the perception and the non-perception of all its parts. The devotee who serves the Reality that is worshipped is, by his own worship, connected with It. But where the inclination to serve grows slack, the Reality is grasped only in part instead of as the whole. As the inclination to serve slackens, the potency that rests on the worshipped Reality as its shelter becomes separated from It; this is forgetfulness of one's own true nature, or aversion to serving Hari.

Śrī Caitanya-deva, in teaching the devotee's pure conduct, independent of the world, showed the highest ideal of where Vedānta ultimately leads. And the best example of it is what the Lord of the fourteen worlds, free of all pride, says here: He speaks as a disciple. People intoxicated by the brilliance of their learning are not fit to serve the lotus feet of the guru — nor fit to study the *Brahma-sūtra*. The nondevotee absorbed in a “second” (in something other than the Lord), while trying to serve the Reality that is worshipped, abandons service to the guru who himself worships It. To prevent any error in understanding the servant's own true nature in such a case, Bhagavān in the form of the guru, describing the pure nature of the disciple, speaks of his “foolishness.” Śrī Gurudeva, for the disciple's good, says in simple words that the disciple lacks the qualification. In doing so he ascribes no relative fault to the disciple. The disciple's “foolishness” lies in not knowing the truth about Bhagavān. The modesty that befits a “fool” is eternally present in the disciple. We, however, not knowing our own true nature, often hypocritically pose as disciples and deceive those who are really our disciples by calling them “guru” with our lips; this brings us no good. All the Vedas constantly serve the feet of the Puruṣa who is known through Vedānta; one who judges Him by knowledge born of the senses is a “fool” indeed. Whatever a person bewildered by sensory knowledge takes to be the real foundation of the Vedic *śāstras* is guided by external intelligence and belongs to the lower knowledge (*aparā

vidyā*). Until the *jīva* loses the conceit, born of the *guṇas*, that the world is subject to him, all his limited, undesirable, changing knowledge born of the senses is that same “foolishness.”

One who is qualified for Vedānta is a servant of the Viṣṇu-*vastu* alone, the Great One and the Maintainer. Unless one goes beyond serving limited things and the like, one cannot become a knower of Brahman. Being qualified to read and teach the *Brahma-sūtra* on the level of karma or on the level of knowledge does not make one qualified for the name of Kṛṣṇa — the eternal, pure, complete, free Form of the *rasa* of consciousness, the transcendental *cintāmaṇi*. And one who is qualified for the name need not again acquire a qualification for Vedānta through knowledge born of the senses.

People who are not qualified to serve the name do not understand that the name and the One who bears the name are nondifferent, and they try to become Māyāvādī Vedāntists. By transcendental judgment they are, in the words of Śrī Gurudeva, the greatest “fools.” Whoever studies Vedānta by relying on the ascending method (*adhiroha-vāda*) is overtaken by “foolishness,” or dullness. But the one who is truly qualified for the name abides eternally on the far shore of Vedānta. In this connection one should reflect on the *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* verse “Oh, how great is even a dog-eater on the tip of whose tongue Your name abides! Those who chant Your name have already performed austerities and fire sacrifices, bathed at the holy places; they are true Āryans and have studied the Vedas,”[11] and others like it, and also on the verse “One who has uttered the two syllables ‘Ha-ri’ has studied the *Ṛg-veda*, the *Yajur-veda*, the *Sāma-veda* and the *Atharva-veda*,” and others.

The foolish sect of the *sāhajikas*, fancying themselves Vaiṣṇavas while being Vaiṣṇavas in name only, consider Vedānta the playground of the *ahaṅgrahopāsakas* — the *kevalādvaita-vādīs* who worship themselves as God. But “Vedānta” is the playground only of Hari's servants from Vaikuṇṭha. The Vaiṣṇava ācāryas of the four *sampradāyas*, following *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* — the commentary on the *Brahma-sūtra*, Vedānta — composed works on Vedānta, and these are not to be shunned as bad association. This simple point the *prākṛta-sahajiyās* cannot grasp. So they imagine the genuine pure Vaiṣṇavas and Vaiṣṇava ācāryas to be *viddha-bhaktas*, whose devotion is mixed with knowledge and karma; thus they head for hell and themselves become Māyāvādīs devoid of service to Viṣṇu. If one seeks the qualification for Vedānta through knowledge born

of the senses, the meaning of chanting the Kṛṣṇa mantra cannot be realized. Those enchanted by sensory knowledge are bound in *saṁsāra* on every side. The two *tattvas* — the enjoyer and the enjoyed — have the power to hold them in *saṁsāra* and do not let them turn the mind away from external objects.

72 ‘You are a fool; You are not qualified for Vedānta. Always chant the Kṛṣṇa-mantra — it is the essence of all mantras.

*The mantra and the *mahā-mantra*, the holy name: a variety of pastimes —*

73 From the Kṛṣṇa-mantra will come release from saṁsāra, and by Kṛṣṇa’s name You will attain Kṛṣṇa’s feet.

Anubhāṣya.

When the *jīva* attains divine knowledge (*divya-jñāna*), he is freed from absorption in the “second” and takes up the service of Adhokṣaja. Service to Mukunda is the only means (*upāya*) of ending one's endeavors in the external world, and it is also the goal (*upeya*). Chanting the mantra, the devotee gains transcendental experience step by step and ceases to perceive the external world as an object of enjoyment. Under the shelter of one of the five kinds of *rati*, when all the ingredients of *rasa* (*sāmagrī*) come together, by the power of serving *rasa* he tastes the One he worships in a heart made bright by *viśuddha-sattva*. Such practice is not mere enjoyment for the two *upādhis*. When the chanter of the name becomes truly established, in his very practice, in the divine knowledge that the name and the One who bears the name are nondifferent, he attains direct service to Kṛṣṇa. Then words in the dative case — the grammarians' language that defines relations — lose their hold on him. The real Reality addressed by the vocative word is at once captured in the heart made bright by *sattva*. And then he becomes able to serve Him without hindrance, addressing Him with vocative words. All the *śāstras* and all mantras consisting of divine knowledge free the *jīva* completely and engage him directly in the service of Kṛṣṇa.

All this I, a fool, have heard from Śrī Gurudeva. Śrī Vyāsa says: “For the sake of people who do not know [this], the learned sage compiled the *Sātvata-saṁhitā*.”[12] *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* and similar books are the rungs of the ladder that leads to serving the name. Gurudeva taught that studying them, teaching them and discussing them all culminate in the service of the name. The name and the

One who bears the name are one nondifferent Reality, knowable only to those free of the endeavors of *māyā*: this is the divine knowledge received at the guru's lotus feet. Until I took shelter at Śrī Guru's lotus feet I was a fool in my understanding of *sambandha*; but now that I have turned toward service, I see in myself the endeavors of one who knows what bondage and liberation are. The word “Kṛṣṇa's name” here does not mean *nāmābhāsa* or *nāmāparādha*.

In Kali-yuga the name of Kṛṣṇa alone is to be worshipped —

74 In the age of Kali there is no dharma other than the name; the name is the essence of all mantras — this is the heart of the scriptures.’

Anubhāṣya.

In the three ages — Satya, Tretā and Dvāpara — the path of *śruti* was honored; with the coming of Kali-yuga there arose a path alien to *śruti*, the path of argument. It is born when people doubt the descent of the real truth and when knowledge born of the senses prevails; this path opposes *śruti*. Kṛṣṇa's name is a Reality of Vaikuṇṭha, and so it is completely nondifferent from Kṛṣṇa, the real Reality. Because the name and the One who bears the name are nondifferent, the name of Vaikuṇṭha is just what Kṛṣṇa, the real Reality, is: the eternal, pure, complete, free Form of the *rasa* of consciousness and the transcendental *cintāmaṇi*. The name is distinct from the material names of everything other than Kṛṣṇa, and is Itself a Reality of Vaikuṇṭha. Followers of the path of argument have no access to this name. Only the worship of the name removes both *dharmas* of the *upādhis*, the gross and the subtle. That is why, in days when the path of argument prevails, all other limited (*kuṇṭha*) *dharmas* are hampered by it. Only the name Itself is the One who bears the name, the Reality beyond the arguments of the disputers. Only the name of the Reality of Vaikuṇṭha can deliver (*trāṇa*) the *jīva* from a mind (*manana*) intent on thoughts of material enjoyment, and therefore it is the essence of all mantras. The name, form, qualities, nature and actions of material things are subject to the path of argument; the Reality of Vaikuṇṭha is not. The transcendental name, form, qualities, distinctive associates and pastimes of this name of Vaikuṇṭha abide in nondual knowledge (*advaya-jñāna*). The Māyāvādīs, relying on knowledge born of the senses, posit a difference between the Reality's name, form and qualities, and so fall into the baseness of dualistic reasoning. That is why their teacher frees them from material reasoning with great sayings (*mahā-vākyas*) such as “In the beginning, my dear,

there was Being alone"[13] and "All this is indeed Brahman."[14] Without taking shelter of the holy name, while committing offenses against the name, one never gets free from the path of argument, born of the senses and full of enjoyment.

The glory of the mantra is stated in the *Nārada-pañcarātra*: "The three Vedas, the six *vedāṅgas*, the meters, the many gods — all of these, and whatever else is expressed in words, are contained within the eight-syllable mantra. It is the essential meaning of all Vedānta and carries one across the ocean of *saṁsāra*." In the *Kali-santaraṇa Upaniṣad*: "'Hare Kṛṣṇa Hare Kṛṣṇa Kṛṣṇa Kṛṣṇa Hare Hare / Hare Rāma Hare Rāma Rāma Rāma Hare Hare' — these sixteen names destroy the contamination of Kali. No means higher than this is to be found in all the Vedas." The words that Śrī Madhva cites in his commentary on the *Muṇḍaka Upaniṣad*: "The people of Dvāpara worship Viṣṇu by the *Pañcarātra* alone, but in Kali the Lord Hari is worshipped by the name alone."

On the "Kṛṣṇa mantra" and the "name of Kṛṣṇa," Śrī Jīva Prabhu says in the *Bhakti-sandarbha* (section 284): "One may object: mantras consist of the names of Bhagavān; moreover, they are specially adorned with the word *namaḥ* and the like, Śrī Bhagavān and the venerable *ṛṣis* have invested them with special potencies, and they establish a special personal relationship [of the chanter] with Śrī Bhagavān. Yet the names of Śrī Bhagavān alone, depending on nothing else, are able to grant the fruit up to the highest goal of human life. That being so, since mantras do not gain greater power than the name, why is there need for *dīkṣā* and the like? The answer: intrinsically there is no such need. But people are mostly, by their very nature, through their connection with the body and so on, of base character and distracted mind. To curb this, the venerable *ṛṣis* and others have established certain rules here and there on the path of *arcana*."

You may say: mantras consist of the name of Bhagavān; what distinguishes a mantra is that, together with Bhagavān's name, it is adorned with the word *namaḥ* and the like — that is, it carries the mood of subordination to the name; by Bhagavān's will the *ṛṣis*, Śrī Nārada and others, invested the mantras with special potency; the mantras establish a special relationship between the one who utters the mantra and Śrī Bhagavān; and the names of Bhagavān contained in the mantra, depending on nothing else, are themselves able to grant the fruit up to the highest goal of human life. If so, then, since the mantra does not gain greater power than the name,[15] why does one who chants the name need *dīkṣā* into that mantra? To this Śrī Jīva replies: intrinsically, the one who chants the name has no

need of *dīkṣā*. But people mostly have a connection with a body and so on that is by nature bent on enjoyment; their character is base and their minds distracted. To curb that base nature and restlessness of mind, the *ṛṣis*, Śrī Nārada and others, have established certain rules in the mantra here and there on the path of *arcana*.

For the conditioned *jīva* to cease from enjoyment, that is, to be rid of the material ego, perfection in the mantra (*mantra-siddhi*) is necessary. In the word *namaḥ* the syllable "*ma*" means the ego and the syllable "*na*" its cessation; that is, the fruit of *mantra-siddhi* is the *jīva*'s transcendental experience. And Śrī Rūpa Gosvāmī Prabhu in the *Nāmāṣṭaka* invokes the name of Hari with the words "O You, who are worshipped by hosts of the liberated!"[16]

*The verse "*harer nāma*" —*

75 Saying this, he taught Me a verse: 'Keep this verse on Your lips and reflect on it.'

*(*Bṛhan-nāradīya Purāṇa* 38.126)*

76 "The name of Hari, the name of Hari, the name of Hari alone! In the age of Kali there is no other way, there is no other way, there is no other way." (Bṛhan-nāradīya Purāṇa, 38.126)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
In Kali there is no way other than the name of Hari; the name of Hari is the only way.

Anubhāṣya.
(In Satya-yuga the way is meditation), **kalau nāsty eva** (only **harer nāma eva** [the name of Hari alone]); (in Tretā-yuga the way is worship of the Lord of sacrifice through *yajña*), **kalau nāsty eva** (only the name of Hari); (in Dvāpara-yuga the way is *arcana*), **kalau nāsty eva** (the way is only the name of Hari). (Especially) **kalau anyathā gatiḥ nāsty eva** (for all other *sādhanas* are fruitless).

The fruit of chanting the name —

77 Receiving this order, I took the name constantly, and as I chanted on and on, My mind grew bewildered.

78 I could no longer keep My composure; I became mad. I laughed and wept, I danced and sang like one intoxicated.

79 Then, gathering My composure, I reflected: ‘Kṛṣṇa’s name has covered all My knowledge.

Amazement at seeing one's own state brought on by chanting the name —

80 I have gone mad; there is no composure left in My mind.’ Thinking this, I came to the feet of My guru and said:

81 ‘What mantra have you given Me, Gosāñi? What power it has! Chanting it again and again, I have gone mad.

82 It makes Me laugh, it makes Me dance, it makes Me weep.’ Hearing this, My guru spoke these words to Me:

The nature of Kṛṣṇa's name —

83 ‘Such is the nature of the great mantra, Kṛṣṇa’s name: it awakens bhāva for Kṛṣṇa in whoever chants it.

Anubhāṣya.

When Śrī Gurudeva sings the name, that holy name enters the ears of the disciple. Following Śrī Gurudeva, the disciple places the holy name he has heard in his heart with faith and worships it by repeating it (*japa*). When the holy name is worshipped, He Himself unfolds His nature as the independent Agent and grants the chanter the right to *kīrtana*. It is then that, by singing the name, he becomes able to make the whole world his disciple. Under the instructing power of the name's *kīrtana*, the world begins to chant the name of Kṛṣṇa. As one goes on chanting, the way of serving the name becomes manifest in him — laughing, weeping, dancing, *kīrtana* and the rest. Some people, out of foolishness, do not know that the sixteen names “Hare Kṛṣṇa” — thirty-two syllables — are the *mahā-mantra*. Regarding it as merely a mantra for *japa*, they artificially obstruct the *kīrtana* of this *mahā-mantra*. Therefore one who has attained *prema* sings the name of Kṛṣṇa and, together with the devotees, performs the full

kīrtana of Kṛṣṇa's name; through such *kīrtana* the people of the world receive instruction in Kṛṣṇa's name. Along with hearing and chanting the name comes remembrance of the name. Because the name and the One who bears the name are nondifferent, the power of chanting Kṛṣṇa's name awakens the inclination to serve Kṛṣṇa, the Reality — and this is called "*bhāva*." Those in whom *bhāva* has been born are not bound by the fetters of *avidyā* and are free of *anarthas*. *Rati* has been born in them, and so they taste the *rasa* that arises when its four ingredients (*sāmagrī*) come together. *Bhāva* in its condensed state is "*prema*."

Kṛṣṇa's name is the *mahā-mantra*. The mantras of the *Pañcarātra* are known by the name "mantra," while the name of Bhagavān is renowned as the "*mahā-mantra*."

The four goals of life and love for Kṛṣṇa —

84 Prema for Kṛṣṇa is the supreme aim of human life; before it the four other goals are like straw.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

"*Dharma*," "*artha*," "*kāma*" and "*mokṣa*" are the four goals of human life (*puruṣārthas*). Love for Kṛṣṇa is the fifth goal. The bliss of Brahman and the like — the first stage of *mokṣa* — cannot be compared even with a single drop of it. *Dharma*, *artha*, *kāma* and *mokṣa* are not the "fruit" of Kṛṣṇa's name. All the *śāstras* agree that love for Kṛṣṇa is the one and only fruit of Kṛṣṇa's name.

Anubhāṣya.

Love for Kṛṣṇa is the highest of all the goals of the *jīva*. If one compares the fifth goal, *prema*, with the *jīva*'s goals — *dharma*, *artha*, *kāma* and *mokṣa* — the gradation makes it clear that what those who hunger for enjoyment (*bubhukṣus*) and those who hunger for liberation (*mumukṣus*) attain is perishable and worthless. The hunger for enjoyment and the hunger for liberation are rooted in identifying oneself (*asmitā*) with the perishable *upādhis*. Love for Bhagavān is the eternal, unchanging *dharma* of the soul, and therefore all reasoning about the goals of the *catur-varga* — *bhukti* and *mukti* — is worth nothing compared with *prema*.

**Prema*, which puts *mokṣa* and the rest to shame, is the fifth goal of human life —*

85 The fifth goal of life is prema, a boundless ocean of nectarean bliss; the bliss of Brahman and all the rest is not equal to a single drop of it.[3]

The fruit of Kṛṣṇa's name —

86 All the scriptures say that the fruit of Kṛṣṇa's name is prema, and by good fortune that prema has dawned in You.

The nature of love for Kṛṣṇa —

87 It is the nature of prema to stir both mind and body and to awaken a burning longing to attain Kṛṣṇa's feet.

88 Moved by prema, the devotee laughs, weeps and sings; as if mad, he dances and runs here and there.

Anubhāṣya.

Nondevotees devoid of love for Kṛṣṇa make a show of restless senses and, as if mad, laugh, weep, dance, sing and so on; but this is only a sign that misfortune awaits them. One engaged in *bhajana* must avoid in every way any artificial agitation of the body and senses. When the natural function of the soul awakens, *bhāva* and *prema* appear, and in them arise laughing, weeping, singing, dancing and longing (*utkaṇṭhā*). All of these are the genuine expressions of one who is turned toward service. But when a person in whom *prema* has not arisen audaciously claims the high position of a devotee, he brings calamity (*anartha*), that is, turmoil, into the world.

Śrī Jīva Prabhu says in the *Prīti-sandarbha* (section 66): "The function that is love for Bhagavān is not made of *māyā* or the like; it is the bliss of the *svarūpa-śakti*, on which even Śrī Bhagavān Himself depends." (Ibid., section 69):[17] "Thus the sign of *prīti* is the melting of the heart, and the signs of that are horripilation and the like. It has also been shown that if the melting of the heart, horripilation and the rest somehow arise but there is no purity of intention (*āśaya-śuddhi*), then even so *bhakti* has not fully appeared. Purity of intention means giving up

every other aim and aiming at *prīti* alone. Hence its qualifiers: ‘causeless’ and ‘natural.’”

The function that is love for Bhagavān is never made of *māyā*: it is the *svarūpa-śakti*, whose essence is bliss, for even Śrī Bhagavān is subject to that bliss. The sign of such *prīti* is the melting of the heart, and its result is horripilation and the like. But if, despite some melting of the heart or horripilation, there is no purity of intention, one must understand that *bhakti* has not fully appeared. “Purity of intention” means giving up other aims and aiming at *prīti* alone. Hence its qualifiers: “*ahaitukī*” (causeless) and “*svābhāvikī*” (natural).

*The *sāttvika* and *vyabhicārī bhāvas* —*

89–90 Perspiration, trembling, hair standing on end, tears, a faltering voice and change of colour; madness, despondency, steadiness, pride, joy and humility — with all these feelings prema makes the devotees dance and sets them afloat on the ocean of the nectar of Kṛṣṇa’s bliss.

The guru instructs the disciple in his duty —

91 It is good that You have attained the supreme goal of life; by Your prema my own life has been fulfilled.

92 Dance, sing and perform saṅkīrtana with the devotees; teach Kṛṣṇa’s name and deliver all people.’

Anubhāṣya.

Those who have become qualified in the eyes of Śrī Gurudeva are granted by Śrī Gurudeva the right to dance, sing, perform *saṅkīrtana* and so on together with Hari's servants who are devoted to *bhajana*, like-minded and affectionate (*sajātīyāśaya-snigdha*). Only they, following in the footsteps of Śrī Gurudeva, take up the work of delivering the world with the knowledge of their own *bhajana*. Those who are not qualified should chant the name of Kṛṣṇa in solitude. In such worship there is no association with others. But once the qualification is attained, association with people can no longer bring an evil result; on the contrary, even people averse to the Lord then become able to receive the mercy of the name. In this connection one should reflect on such verses as “One who is not a controller

should never do this, even in his mind”[18] or “When one is not attached to the objects of the senses, uses them as is fitting and firmly connects everything with Kṛṣṇa, that is called proper renunciation (*yukta-vairāgya*).”[19]

93 Saying this, he taught Me a verse and told Me again and again: ‘This is the essence of the *Bhāgavata*.’

*The state of a *mahā-bhāgavata* —*

94 “One who has taken this vow, chanting the names of his beloved Lord, finds love awakening within him; his heart melts, and, heedless of the world, he laughs aloud, weeps, cries out, sings and dances like a madman.” (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 11.2.40)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

A person whose vow is service to Kṛṣṇa loses control of his heart: as he chants the name of his most beloved Śrī Kṛṣṇa, attachment (*anurāga*) awakens in him, and his heart melts. Like a madman he becomes *loka-bāhya*, that is, he no longer looks to anyone: now he laughs, now he weeps, now he cries out, now he sings, dances and does much else.

Anubhāṣya.

Vasudeva wished to hear from Śrī Nārada about *bhāgavata-dharma*. Śrī Nārada then told the story of the nine Yogendras, the sons of Ṛṣabha, and of Nimi, the king of Videha. In that story Kavi, one of the nine Yogendras, said to King Nimi:

evaṁ-vrataḥ (one whose vow is service in the form of hearing, chanting and so on) **sva-priya-nāma-kīrtyā** (by chanting and so on the name of his own dear Bhagavān) **jātānurāgaḥ** (one in whom attachment has been born — in whom *rati* has awakened; therefore) **druta-cittaḥ** (with a longing heart) **unmāda-vat loka-bāhyaḥ** (outside people: unconcerned with their laughter, blame, praise and so on) **uccaiḥ hasati atho roditi**, **rauti** (cries out), **gāyati**, **nṛtyati ca**.

*Firm endeavor in *bhajana* at the guru's command —*

95 With firm faith in these words of his, I constantly perform the saṅkīrtana of Kṛṣṇa’s name.

*The fruit of *bhajana* — the mercy of Śrī Nāma-Prabhu, who acts by His own will —*

96 That name of Kṛṣṇa sometimes makes Me sing and dance; I do not sing and dance of My own will.

Anubhāṣya.

Those who cannot believe the words of Śrī Gurudeva and pervert their own qualification (*adhikāra*) do not obtain the right to the *saṅkīrtana* of Kṛṣṇa's name. Śrī Gaurasundara upheld the words of the *śruti*: "To those great souls who have supreme devotion to God, and the same devotion to the guru, the whole meaning of what has been said is revealed"[20] — and He began the *saṅkīrtana* of Kṛṣṇa's name. Following His guru (*ānugatya*), He did not disobey his order and never stopped the unbroken *nāma-saṅkīrtana*. The *kīrtana* of such a Kṛṣṇa-nāma-Prabhu, by His own power of will (*icchā-śakti*), moved Śrī Gaurasundara to dance and sing. Śrī Gaurasundara did not chant the holy name condescendingly, as if it were a material object. But those driven by the restlessness of the senses take Kṛṣṇa's name for their plaything: instead of serving the holy name, they try to become its masters and command it. Instead of *bhajana* they reap the fruits of *karma* — they merely aggravate their bile (*pitta*) and ruin their bodily health.

"I am a fool who cannot tell good from harm. I feared that if I went searching for the pure meaning of Vedānta, the false arguments of Māyāvāda spoken by Śrī Śaṅkarācārya would come and destroy My natural inclination to *bhajana*. So, knowing that I have no right to Vedānta as Śaṅkara explains it, I am freed from the *anarthas* of worldly existence simply by chanting the mantra of Kṛṣṇa. I take up the name of Kṛṣṇa, whom the liberated worship, and thereby attain Kṛṣṇa's lotus feet. In the quarrelsome age of Kali there is no *dharma* other than taking the name. I received all these instructions from Śrī Gurudeva, and by taking the name I became almost mad. Later I asked him again and learned that when the *jīva* attains the right to *prema*, an incomparable good comes to him. *Prema* is the highest goal of life (*parama-puruṣārtha*), desirable above all, and the petty hopes of those who crave the fruits of the four goals of life cannot be compared with it. A person in whom *prema* has awakened naturally disregards public shame and chants Kṛṣṇa's glories loudly — laughing, weeping, singing, dancing and so on. I learned that this is what is called 'the life of a *bhāgavata*.' I have done nothing artificially, hiding behind deceit. I chant Kṛṣṇa's glories because I firmly believe My Gurudeva's words. The holy name Himself has made Me a singer and a dancer,

in defiance of the grave dignity of the *kaupīna*-clad Vedāntists. My own part in this — My own will or initiative — is very small: it is all the mercy of Śrī Nāma-Prabhu."

The difference between the bliss of Brahman and the bliss of love for Kṛṣṇa —

97 Before the ocean of bliss tasted in Kṛṣṇa's name, the bliss of Brahman is like water in a ditch.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
Khātodaka: a little water in a ditch.

Anubhāṣya.
See Ādi 6.43–44.

A comparison of the ocean and a cow's hoofprint —

98 "O Guru of the world, now that I am immersed in the pure ocean of joy that comes from seeing You face to face, all other joys — even the bliss of Brahman — seem to me like the water in a calf's hoofprint." (Hari-bhakti-sudhodaya, 14.36)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
O Teacher of the world! I have seen You Yourself (Your *svarūpa*), and now I abide in a pure ocean of joy. All other happiness seems to me like a cow's hoofprint; even the happiness the *jīva* finds in dissolving into Brahman is only a hoofprint. Where a cow steps, a hollow is left; the water in it is tiny compared with the ocean.

Anubhāṣya.
he jagad-guro (O Teacher of the world) **tvat-sākṣāt-karaṇāhlāda-viśuddhābdhi-sthitasya** (abiding in the pure — that is, unmixed — ocean of the joy born from directly seeing You, from Your *darśana*) **me** (my) **brāhmāṇi** (born of realizing Brahman) **sukhāni api goṣ-padāyante** (seem like the water in the hollow of a cow's hoofprint).

*The gradual change in the minds of the *sannyāsīs*, and their question —*

99 Hearing the Lord's sweet words, the sannyāsīs had a change of heart, and they answered Him with gentle words:

*Still, their faith in *bhakti* is slight, but their faith in Māyāvāda is firm —*

100 "All that You have said is true: love for Kṛṣṇa is attained only by one whose good fortune has dawned.

101 You have devotion for Kṛṣṇa, and we are all pleased with that. But why do You not hear Vedānta? What fault is there in it?"

Anubhāṣya.

The Māyāvādīs call "Vedānta" only the scripture that Śrī Śaṅkarapāda's *Śārīraka-bhāṣya* has in view. In other words, when the followers of Śaṅkara's doctrine say "Vedānta," they mean the Upaniṣads and the *Brahma-sūtra* as read through their ācārya's commentary, which is built on the doctrine of *kevalādvaita*. The *Vedānta-sāra* of Sadānanda Yogīndra says: "Vedānta is the evidence of the Upaniṣads, together with the *Śārīraka-sūtras* and other works that assist it." In truth, however, the word "Vedānta" does not mean the doctrine of *kevalādvaita*. All four Vaiṣṇava ācāryas are ācāryas of Vedānta, yet they are not Māyāvādīs and do not follow Śaṅkara's doctrine. The followers of Māyāvāda see no difference at all; starting from *kevalādvaita*, they worship themselves as God (*ahaṅgrahopāsanā*). They accept neither *śuddhādvaita*, nor *śuddha-dvaita*, nor *viśiṣṭādvaita*, nor *dvaitādvaita*, nor *acintya-bhedābheda*; they believe that *kevalādvaita* alone is the faultless doctrine of Vedānta. The Māyāvādīs are pleased with the impermanent service that is rendered to Kṛṣṇa with a material body and mind. That is, they regard devotion to Kṛṣṇa as merely a special kind of ritual work (*karma*); so for them it too is "non-devotion" (*abhakti*), and with this they are content.

The Lord's words —

102 Hearing this, the Lord smiled and said, "If you will not take offence, I shall explain."

*The humility of the Māyāvādī *sannyāsīs* —*

103 At this all the sannyāsīs said, “We see You as Nārāyaṇa Himself.

104 Your words soothe our ears, and the sight of Your sweetness soothes our eyes.

105 Your presence has filled all our hearts with joy, and Your words are never unfitting.”

The Lord's view and explanation of Vedānta —

106 The Lord said, “The *Vedānta-sūtra* is the word of the Lord: Śrī Nārāyaṇa Himself composed it in the form of Vyāsa.[4]

Anubhāṣya.

Sūtra: “Knowers of *sūtras* know a *sūtra* to be brief, unambiguous, full of essence, facing every side, free of superfluous words, and faultless.” (*Skanda Purāṇa* and *Vāyu Purāṇa*) The *Vedānta-sūtra* is known by various names: (1) *Brahma-sūtra*, (2) *Śārīraka*, (3) *Vyāsa-sūtra*, (4) *Bādarāyaṇa-sūtra*, (5) *Uttara-mīmāṁsā* and (6) *Vedānta-darśana*. It is a book composed of *sūtras*, with four chapters (*adhyāyas*) and sixteen quarters (*pādas*). Each *pāda* contains several topics (*adhikaraṇas*). Each topic contains the five-membered argument (*pañcāvayava-nyāya*): the proposition (*pratijñā*), the reason (*hetu*), the example (*udāharaṇa*), the application (*upanaya*) and the conclusion (*nigamana*). In other words: “One verse [states] the subject and the doubt and sets out the *pūrvapakṣa*; the other verse establishes the *siddhānta*; the connections between them are clear.”

According to the different commentaries, it has from 162 to 223 topics (*adhikaraṇas*) and from 520 to 560 *sūtras*.

On the word “Vedānta” the lexicographer Hemacandra says: “Vedānta is the Upaniṣads together with the Brāhmaṇas — the remainder of the Vedas, their last portion, that is, the end of the Vedas.” A scripture that shows the ultimate purpose of the Vedas is also “Vedānta.” A scripture that uses the Upaniṣads as its evidence, and the *sūtras* and other works that assist it, are also “Vedānta.” The *Vedānta-sūtra* is called the *nyāya-prasthāna*, one of the three *prasthānas* (foundations

of doctrine). The Upaniṣads are the *śruti-prasthāna*, and the *Gītā*, the *Mahābhārata*, the Purāṇas and so on are the *smṛti-prasthāna*.

The Vedas came into the material world from the breath of Śrī Nārāyaṇa. The scripture spoken by Śrī Nārāyaṇa that unfolds the Vedas is called the *Sātvata-pañcarātra*. The *Vedānta-sūtra* was compiled by Śrī Vyāsa, the *āveśa-avatāra* of Śrī Nārāyaṇa — or, in the opinion of some (Śaṅkara's commentary 3.3.32),[21] by the sage Apāntaratamā. Śrī Gaurasundara says that the *Pañcarātra* and the Vedānta express one and the same teaching. Since Śrī Vyāsa composed the *sūtras*, they too must be known as the word of Śrī Nārāyaṇa Himself.

While composing the *sūtras*, Śrī Vyāsadeva examined the Vedānta doctrines set forth by seven other sages: Ātreya, Āśmarathya, Auḍulomi, Kārṣṇājini, Kāśakṛtsna, Jaimini and Bādari. Besides these, two more collections — the *sūtras* of Pārāśarī and of Karmandī-bhikṣu — also preceded the *sūtras* of Śrī Vyāsa.

The first two chapters of the *Vedānta-darśana* describe knowledge of *sambandha*; the third chapter, *abhidheya*, the practice of devotion (*sādhana-bhakti*); and the fourth, *prayojana*, the fruit: love for Bhagavān. The genuine commentary on Vedānta, written by Vyāsa, the author of the *sūtras* himself, is the *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam*. Besides it, the commentaries of the four Vaiṣṇava ācāryas, who follow the *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* to a greater or lesser degree, and the many glosses written by their successors in their *sampradāyas*, declare that Vedānta aims at the worship of Bhagavān. This *Vedānta-sūtra* is honored even in the *sampradāya* that lacks devotion to Viṣṇu and holds to the doctrine of the featureless. The commentaries on this Vedānta written from the standpoint of *māyā*, and the glosses, treatises and other works that follow them, are devoid of service to Viṣṇu, and their reasoning departs from the real truth.

(1) The word of the Lord is free from the four defects —

107 Error, inattention, the wish to deceive and the imperfection of the senses — none of these faults is found in the words of the Lord.

Anubhāṣya.
See Ādi 2.86.

*(2) By the direct (primary) meaning (*abhidhā-vṛtti*), what Vedānta makes*

known is Bhagavān, the Truth possessed of features —

108 The truth that the sūtras declare together with the Upaniṣads is of supreme greatness when taken in its primary sense.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

The Upaniṣads are the Īśa, Kena, Kaṭha, Praśna, Muṇḍaka, Māṇḍūkya, Taittirīya, Aitareya, Chāndogya, Bṛhad-āraṇyaka and Śvetāśvatara: eleven Upaniṣads, the crown of the Vedas.

The *sūtra* is the *Brahma-sūtra*: four chapters, sixteen *pādas*. These two are the chief among the scriptures.

*Śaṅkara's commentary was written in the secondary meaning to bewilder the *asuras*; to hear it is to lose everything —*

109 But to hear the commentary that the Ācārya wrote in the secondary sense is to lose every spiritual gain.

Anubhāṣya.

The *Muktikā Upaniṣad* (30–39)[22] lists: "Īśa, Kena, Kaṭha, Praśna, Muṇḍa, Māṇḍūkya, Tittiri, Aitareya, Chāndogya and Bṛhad-āraṇyaka; Brahma, Kaivalya, Jābāla, Śvetāśva, Haṁsa, Āruṇi, Garbha, Nārāyaṇa, Haṁsa, Bindu, Nāda, Śiraḥ, Śikhā; Maitrāyaṇī, Kauṣītakī, Bṛhaj-jābāla, Tāpanī, Kālāgni-rudra, Maitreyī, Subāla, Kṣuri, Mantrikā; Sarvasāra, Nirālamba, Rahasya, Vajrasūcikā; Tejo, Nāda, Dhyāna, Vidyā, Yoga-tattva, Ātma-bodha; Parivrāṭ, Triśikhī, Sītā, Cūḍā, Nirvāṇa, Maṇḍala; Dakṣiṇā, Śarabha, Skanda, the one called Mahānārāyaṇa; Rahasya, Rāma-tapana, Vāsudeva and Mudgala; Śāṇḍilya, Paiṅgala, Bhikṣu, Mahat, Śārīraka, Śikhā; Turīyātīta, Sannyāsa, Parivrāja, Akṣamālikā; Avyakta, Ekākṣara, Pūrṇā, Sūrya, Akṣi, Adhyātma, Kuṇḍikā; Sāvitrī, Ātmā, Pāśupata, Parabrahma, Avadhūta; Tripurā-tapana, Devī, Tripurā, Kaṭha, Bhāvanā; Hṛdaya, Kuṇḍalī, Bhasma, Rudrākṣa, Gaṇa, Darśana; Tāra-sāra, Mahā-vākya, Pañca-brahma, Agnihotra; Gopāla-tapana, Kṛṣṇa, Yājñavalkya, Varāha; Śāṭyāyanī, Hayagrīva, Dattātreya and Gāruḍa; Kali, Jābāli, Saubhāgya, Rahasya and Muktikā." These are the one hundred and eight Upaniṣads.

The word *mukhya-vṛtti* means *abhidhā-vṛtti*. *Abhidhā* is the power [of a word] by which one understands the meaning known from dictionaries, grammar and so on. The word *gauṇa-vṛtti* means *lakṣaṇā-vṛtti*. *Lakṣaṇā* is the power

by which, for some purpose or through frequent usage, one understands another meaning connected with the actual sense.

Bhāṣya — as it is said: “Knowers of *bhāṣya* know that a *bhāṣya* takes up the words of the *sūtra*, explains them in sentences that follow the *sūtra*, and also explains its own words.”

The highest is the Truth possessed of features (*saviśeṣa-tattva*): it is what the Upaniṣads and the *sūtras* establish, and it is shown through the direct (*abhidhā*) meaning. The *nirviśeṣa-vādīs*, however, rely on the secondary (*lakṣaṇā*) meaning and show only a semblance of truth (*tattvābhāsa*); it is known not as “Tattvavāda” but as “Māyāvāda.” Śrī Viṣṇusvāmī's *śuddhādvaita* was obstructed by the doctrine of *kevalādvaita*. Only after this did *viśiṣṭādvaita* and the “Tattvavāda” of Śrī Madhvācārya, following the path of the *śruti*, refute the conclusions of those ignorant of the truth, which rested on logic alone. Śrī Mahāprabhu relied on *abhidhā-vṛtti* and honored the meaning of Vedānta. But the meaning of Vedānta that Śrī Śaṅkarācārya set down in his commentary, relying on *lakṣaṇā-vṛtti*, ruins everything. Thus in the *Padma Purāṇa*: “Hear, O Devī, I shall tell you in order of the *tāmasa* [scriptures], by merely hearing which even the learned fall. [In Māyāvāda] the words of the *śruti* are given a false meaning, which people condemn; in it, it is taught that action must be given up by its very nature. There, freedom from action (*naiṣkarmya*) is said to be the abandonment of all action. And in it I establish the oneness of the Supreme Soul and the *jīva*.”

See Antya 2.94–99.

110 The fault is not his: he received the Lord’s order and so gave the secondary meaning, covering the primary.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

The truth that these chief scriptures teach by their primary meaning (*mukhya-vṛtti*), that is, by *abhidhā-vṛtti*, is supremely great. Śrī Śaṅkarācārya abandoned the primary meaning of these scriptures, established the conclusion of *kevalādvaita* by their secondary meaning (*gauṇa-vṛtti*), that is, by *lakṣaṇā-vṛtti*, and wrote his commentary. Whoever hears it loses every spiritual endeavor. You may ask: why did Śaṅkara Svāmī, a direct *avatāra* of Śiva, do such an improper thing? Then listen: he undertook this work at the Lord's command, and so he bears no fault. Thus in the *Padma Purāṇa* Śrī Mahādeva says: “Māyāvāda is a

false doctrine; it is called covert Buddhism. O Devī, in the age of Kali I Myself devised it in the form of a *brāhmaṇa*. To bewilder all the people of this world in the age of Kali, I shall describe Brahman in another form — as devoid of qualities (*nirguṇa*). O Devī, in the great scripture, the Vedānta, I Myself shall expound the non-Vedic Māyāvāda, to bring the world to ruin." And in the *Śiva Purāṇa* Bhagavān says: "At the beginning of Dvāpara and the other ages, appear by your partial power among humans and others, and by *āgamas* of your own invention turn people away from Me."

*(3) The *śrutis* establish Bhagavān alone, full of spiritual pastimes and opulence —*

111 In its primary sense the word "Brahman" means Bhagavān, full of spiritual majesty, with none above Him or equal to Him.

(4) He possesses a form full of eternal being, knowledge and bliss, and is not formless —

112 His opulence and His body are all spiritual in form; but, covering His spiritual opulence, the Ācārya calls Him "formless".

*To call the Truth formless, and the body of Viṣṇu and so on a transformation of *māyā* — this is "Māyāvāda" —*

113 His body, His abode and His retinue are spiritual bliss, yet they say that He is a transformation of material *sattva*.

Anubhāṣya.

The *Vedānta-sāra* of Sadānanda Yogīndra says: "The real (*vastu*) is Brahman — being, consciousness and bliss, nondual. The whole mass of inert things, beginning with ignorance (*ajñāna*), is the unreal (*avastu*). Ignorance, they say, cannot be described as either existent or nonexistent; it consists of the three *guṇas*, is opposed to knowledge, is of a positive nature, and is 'something.' This ignorance is spoken of as one or as many, depending on whether one means the aggregate or the individual. This aggregate, because its *upādhi* is excellent, is one in which pure *sattva* predominates. Consciousness conditioned by it, possessing qualities such as omniscience, lordship over all and control over all, is

sad-asad-avyakta, unmanifest as either the existent or the nonexistent; it is the inner ruler, the cause of the world, and it is called Īśvara. Because it illumines all ignorance, it is omniscient."

The Śaṅkarite Vedāntist Sadānanda summarized the purport of Śaṅkara's doctrine in the book *Vedānta-sāra*. Today this book is a highly respected, authoritative foundation of Śaṅkara's *sampradāya*.

"Brahman is the nondual Reality, being, consciousness and bliss; the whole mass of inert things, beginning with ignorance, is unreal. 'Ignorance' means everything that is distinct from both the existent and the nonexistent, indescribable, made of the three *guṇas*, opposed to knowledge and of a positive nature. This ignorance is spoken of both as one and as many, depending on whether it is the aggregate or the individual. When this aggregate is endowed with an excellent *upādhi*, it receives the name 'that in which pure *sattva* predominates.' When this [aggregate ignorance], in which pure *sattva* predominates, is reflected in consciousness, [consciousness] receives the name 'Īśvara' — omniscient, lord of all, ruler of all, unmanifest as either the existent or the nonexistent (*sad-asad-avyakta*), the inner ruler of the *jīvas*, the cause of the world. Īśvara is 'omniscient' because He illumines all ignorance. In their view, being Īśvara is merely a transformation of material *sattva* born of ignorance. The *jīva*, in turn, is one in whom impure *sattva* predominates, and he is endowed with an individual *upādhi*."

Anubhāṣya.
See Madhya 25.33–34.

*Though Śaṅkara, who carried out the order, is not at fault, the *jīva* who hears his commentary loses everything —*

114 The fault is not his, for he is a servant who carries out orders; but whoever listens to him meets with utter ruin.

Anubhāṣya.
See Madhya 6.169.

*To regard Viṣṇu, the Master of *māyā*, as a product of *māyā* — this is*

*godlessness (*pāṣaṇḍatā*) —*

115 One who regards the body of Viṣṇu as material commits the gravest blasphemy against Viṣṇu; there is none greater than this.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

The meaning that appears clearly, that is, directly, as soon as one reads a text is called the primary meaning (*mukhyārtha*). The *Bṛhad-āraṇyaka* says: “That is full, this is full; from the full the full comes forth” (5.1). The *Śvetāśvatara* says: “The ancient Puruṣa, possessed of wondrous potencies”; “He is beyond the tree [of worldly existence], time and forms, and other than them; from Him this world revolves; He brings *dharma*, removes sin, and is the Lord of all opulence” (6.6); “I know this great Puruṣa, radiant like the sun, beyond darkness” (3.8); “the supreme Master of masters, higher than the highest” (6.7); “the Puruṣa is the great Lord” (3.12); “His supreme potency is heard to be manifold” (6.8), and so on. The *Ṛg-veda* says: “The sages always see that supreme abode of Viṣṇu.” The *Praśna* says: “He glanced” (6.3). The *Aitareya* says: “He glanced” (1.1.1) and “He created these worlds” (1.1.2). The *Talavakāra* says: “Brahman knew [their pride] and appeared before them” (3.2). As soon as one reads many such statements of the Vedas, it becomes clear that [they speak] only of Bhagavān, the one Supreme Truth, full of the six opulences, who has none equal to Him or above Him. There are, of course, statements that deny form, such as *apāṇi-pādaḥ* (“without hands and feet”) (*Śvetāśvatara* 3.19). They must be understood only to mean that this Bhagavān's form is spiritual, and that His body and His opulence are spiritual opulence. The Māyāvādīs, headed by the ācārya, cover His spiritual opulence and declare Him “formless,” a transformation of the quality of *sattva*. But He Himself, His abode and His associates are all, by nature, spiritual bliss beyond *prakṛti*. How, then, can He be called a transformation of material *sattva*? In truth His form too, full of transcendental spiritual opulence, is real. Is the ācārya at fault for describing Him as formless? No — he is a servant carrying out an order. As the *Nārada-pañcarātra* says: “And conceal Me, so that this creation may keep on increasing.” But anyone else who hears such an explanation loses everything. There can be no worse blasphemy of Viṣṇu than to consider Viṣṇu's body “material.”

Anubhāṣya.

The Truth possessed of features is Viṣṇu. Viṣṇu's *prakṛti* is the root of the material, inert world. In the reasoning of *vivarta-vāda*, the *prakṛti*, or *māyā-

śakti*, of the featureless Brahman has no real existence. The scriptures have described Viṣṇu's *māyā* at length. Viṣṇu is not some god born of *māyā*. Those who think so have a distorted idea of Viṣṇu. Viṣṇu can never be counted among the material gods. Only those deluded in this way regard Viṣṇu as a material deity. To free them from the bondage of worldly existence, Śrī Bhagavān said in the *Gītā*:

"This divine *māyā* of Mine, made of the *guṇas*, is hard to overcome. But those who surrender to Me cross over this *māyā*."[23] Viṣṇu is the Reality of Vaikuṇṭha. To regard Him as a deity born of *prakṛti* is to do violence to what is said about the Reality; this is blasphemy. Viṣṇu is the Reality beyond the senses (*adhokṣaja*): He cannot be perceived by the material senses, as material objects are. Between His body and the possessor of that body there is nonduality (*advaya-jñāna*). In material things, the body and its possessor are different. Material things are objects of enjoyment, but Viṣṇu is eternally the enjoyer. To regard the "enjoyer" as the "enjoyed" is an offense. And to present the One whom the *jīva* eternally serves as a servant on a level with the *jīva* is to blaspheme Him.

See the *Anubhāṣya* on Ādi 7.112–113 and Madhya 25.35–39.

116 The truth of the Lord is like a blazing fire, and the jīva in its true nature is like a particle of a spark.

117 The jīva is a potency (*śakti*); Kṛṣṇa is the possessor of all potency (*śaktimān*). The *Gītā*, the *Viṣṇu Purāṇa* and other scriptures bear witness to this.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

If the truth of the Lord is compared to a blazing fire, the countless *jīvas* can be compared to tiny sparks of that fire. The point is this: the Lord is a special fire — spiritual, unlimited and blazing. The countless *jīvas* have come forth from Him like tiny sparks and become separate *tattvas*. Here *māyā* plays no part in forming the *jīva*'s *svarūpa*; that is, nothing material takes place. You may ask: why form such particles of spirit at all? Then listen: the Lord's wondrous *svarūpa-śakti* has two kinds of tendencies — toward unlimited action and toward minute action. From the tendency toward unlimited action come the Lord's own form and the Vaikuṇṭha-*tattva*, the spiritual world; this tendency is called *cit-śakti*. From the tendency toward minute action come the countless *jīvas*, atomic

consciousness; this tendency is called *jīva-śakti*. If the *svarūpa-śakti* did not have both these functions, His fullness would be impaired. Bhagavān is full of all opulence, and so the *jīva* — the minute action of His potency — must exist inevitably and necessarily. Therefore it is through the *jīva-tattva* that Kṛṣṇa's possession of potency (*vilāsa*) [is manifest] in the Kṛṣṇa-*tattva*. Without the *jīva-tattva*, Kṛṣṇa's full possession of potency could not be admitted. Where there are none to be ruled, there is no Ruler.

*(*Bhagavad-gītā* 7.5)*

118 "This nature is inferior. But know, O mighty-armed, that I have another, superior nature, consisting of the jīvas, who take up this world for their own enjoyment." (Bhagavad-gītā, 7.5)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Earth, water, fire, air and ether — this is the gross world of the five elements; mind, intelligence and *ahaṅkāra* — the subtle (*liṅga*) world. *Prakṛti*, divided in these eight ways, is "inferior" (*aparā*), or "inert" (*jaḍā*); it is called *māyā-prakṛti*. Apart from it I have another, "superior *prakṛti*" (*parā-prakṛti*). This *prakṛti*, whose nature is the *jīva*, fills this world. The point is this: Bhagavān is the one Reality; He has a potency called *svarūpa*, or *ātma*. There is a potency that appears almost separate from this *svarūpa-śakti*, yet shows itself as its shadow; it is called *māyā-śakti*. The material universe, gross and subtle, is born of that *māyā*. Beyond it is the *jīva-tattva*. The *jīva*'s pure being, pure *ahaṅkāra* and mental functions are all formed by a certain superior potency (*parā-śakti*) beyond *māyā*. So *māyā* had no authority at all in the making of the "*jīva*." When the *jīva* has entered *māyā*, a minute intelligence and *ahaṅkāra* tinged with materiality appear in him — that alone is *māyā*'s work. When the *jīva* is cleansed of this connection with *māyā* and abides in his own *svarūpa*, this is called *mukti*. In *mukti* not even the *ahaṅkāra* made by *māyā* remains; but all the spiritual faculties natural to the *jīva* will be able to act in their pure form. Therefore the *jīva* is a particular potency of Bhagavān.

Anubhāṣya.

iyam aparā (insentient *prakṛti*, inferior because it is inert). **itaḥ** (than inert *prakṛti*) **anyām parām** (spiritual) **jīva-bhūtām** (whose nature is the *jīva*) **me** (My) **prakṛtim viddhi** (know). **he mahā-bāho**, **yayā** (by the conscious potency

called the *jīva*) **idam** (inert) **jagat dhāryate** (is taken up as the object of its own enjoyment).

**Cit*, *jīva* and *māyā* — the three kinds of Viṣṇu's potency —*

119 "The potency of Viṣṇu is declared to be superior; the potency called the knower of the field (*kṣetrajña*) is likewise superior; and the other, called ignorance and karma, is held to be a third potency." (Viṣṇu Purāṇa, 6.7.61)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Viṣṇu's potency is of three kinds: the superior (*parā*), the *kṣetrajñā*, and the one called ignorance (*avidyā*). Viṣṇu's superior potency is *cit-śakti*; the *kṣetrajñā* potency is *jīva-śakti* (it is said to be "other" [distinct] from *māyā*, that is, *avidyā*); and the potency of *avidyā*, which is called *karma*, is named *māyā*.

Anubhāṣya.

viṣṇu-śaktiḥ (Viṣṇu's *svarūpa-śakti*) **parā** (spiritual by nature) **proktā**; **tathā aparā** (a certain other potency) **kṣetrajñākhyā** (is called *jīva-śakti*); **anyā tṛtīyā śaktiḥ avidyā-karma-saṁjñā** (the one called both *avidyā* and *karma* — the *māyā-śakti*) **iṣyate**.

*To consider the Lord, like the *jīva*, to be full of ignorance — this too is Māyāvāda —*

120 Yet the Ācārya took such a jīva and declared it to be the Supreme Truth, and so he hid the supreme greatness of the Lord.

*The *Brahma-sūtra* accepts only the doctrine of the transformation of potency (*śakti-pariṇāma-vāda*) —*

121 In Vyāsa's sūtras the doctrine of transformation (*pariṇāma-vāda*) is taught; but Śaṅkara said that Vyāsa was mistaken and raised a dispute.

Anubhāṣya.

Setting out to describe the nature of the Lord, the *jīva* and *prakṛti* as indescribable and to explain it in terms of ignorance, Śaṅkara concealed the transcendent supremacy of the Lord.

Śrī Rāmānujapāda writes in the *Vedānta-sāra*: “Objection: the statement ‘In the beginning all this was the Ātmā alone’ establishes oneness before creation. How, then, can Nārāyaṇa, qualified by subtle spirit and matter, be the cause? Answer: [it is said:] ‘That from which these beings are born, by which, once born, they live, and into which, departing, they enter.’ What is taught here is that beings, having given up their gross forms and taken on subtle ones, abide in Brahman — not that their own nature ceases. For [in the *śruti*] we hear: ‘The *akṣara* dissolves into darkness (*tamas*); darkness becomes one with the supreme Deity’ — that is, *prakṛti*, called by the word *tamas*, becomes one with the Paramātmā. To become one is to exist without being perceived separately; and that is the meaning of the word *laya* (dissolution): as birds dissolve into a tree, and deer into a forest.”

You may ask: “Before the creation of the world only the Ātmā existed (*Bṛhad-āraṇyaka* 1.4.1); how then can Nārāyaṇa, possessed of subtle spiritual and material potencies, be the root cause of the world?” The answer can be given thus. The statement of the *Taittirīya*, “He from whom these beings were born, by whom they are sustained, and into whom they enter” (*Taittirīya*, *Bhṛgu-vallī* 1), shows that beings give up their gross material forms, are released from them, take on subtle forms and [so] abide in Brahman, but their *svarūpa* is not destroyed. For when the imperishable soul dissolves into *prakṛti*, called by the word *tamas*, *prakṛti* becomes nondifferent (one) with Brahman. At that time *prakṛti* is not perceived separately from Brahman, and so the existence of *prakṛti* abides in Brahman itself. This is what the word *laya* means. An example: just as birds in a tree or animals in a forest dissolve into the tree or the forest, that is, are hidden within it.

Śrī Vedavyāsa, the author of the *Brahma-sūtra*, says: “The *ānandamaya* [is Brahman], because [this] is repeated” (*Brahma-sūtra* 1.1.12). In connection with this *sūtra*, while explaining the *sūtra* “And [scripture] teaches its union with that in it” (*Brahma-sūtra* 1.1.19), Śrī Śaṅkara wrote what may be paraphrased thus: “The statement about the *ānandamaya* lacks the word ‘Brahman,’ so the *ānandamaya* cannot be called the principal Brahman. If the *ānandamaya* were called ‘Brahman,’ then, since it has parts, one would have to speak of a Brahman possessed of features. Yet at the end of the statement about the *ānandamaya* the featureless Brahman is spoken of. If one says that in the word *ānandamaya* the suffix *mayaṭ* means abundance — ‘abounding in bliss’ (the sense in which the *bhāgavatas*, who teach spiritual variety, have used it) — then it follows that

suffering also exists in it. For the word ‘abundant’ is used according to predominance, not according to scarcity. The *śruti* does not repeat (*abhyāsa*, repeated mention) the ‘*ānandamaya*’ but repeats ‘*ānanda*’ alone — precisely because the *ānandamaya* is not ‘pure Brahman.’ Had it been established that the *ānandamaya* is Brahman, then perhaps the repetition of ‘*ānanda*’ alone might have been taken as a repetition of the *ānandamaya*. But since the *ānandamaya* is connected with parts, it is certain that it is not Brahman. For all these reasons, and because in *śrutis* such as ‘Brahman is *ānanda*’ the word *ānanda* is used of the Supreme Brahman, it is clear that in other *śrutis* too what is repeated is ‘*ānanda* alone, Brahman,’ not ‘*ānandamaya*.’ True, in the *śruti* ‘*ānandamayam ātmānam*’ we see the *ānandamaya* itself repeated; but it stands in the series with the *annamaya* and the rest, and so the *ānandamaya* cannot denote pure Brahman. Near the statement about the *ānandamaya* there are the words ‘He desired: may I become many’; but the *ānandamaya* has no close connection with pure Brahman, and so it does not denote pure Brahman. The statement that follows, ‘He is *rasa*,’ and the rest depends on that [pure Brahman] and so does not point to the *ānandamaya*. Since there are no words indicating parts, such as ‘joy is His head,’ it is certain that the principal Brahman is ‘*ānanda*,’ not ‘*ānandamaya*.’ You may say: does not that *śruti* intend the Brahman possessed of features? The answer: you cannot say so — that is refuted by the *śrutis* which say He is ‘beyond speech and mind.’ Therefore the suffix *mayaṭ* in the word *ānandamaya* indicates transformation (*vikāra*), not abundance.”

Thus Śrīpāda Śaṅkara, in explaining these *sūtras*, wanted to remove the suffix *mayaṭ*, that is, to show that it is useless or superfluous — and what effort he made to repeat one and the same point again and again in *sūtras* 12–19! On this Śrīmad Jīva Prabhu says in his *Sarva-saṁvādinī*: “If one secretly intends [to show] that the author of the *sūtras* did not know the meaning of Vedānta, and, with an artfulness that betrays one's own cleverness in correcting his mistake, explains that *sūtra* on the *ānandamaya* thus — ‘In [the passage] “*ānandamaya*” and so on, Brahman, principal in its own right, is taught [by the words] “Brahman is the tail, the foundation”’ — and in the *sūtra* on *vikāra* (1.1.13) explains the word *vikāra* as ‘part’ and the word *prācurya* as ‘similarity,’ then it would follow that the author of the *sūtras* did not know the meaning of words, since by those words he would not be expressing those

meanings. That the words — the suffix *mayaṭ*, *vikāra* and *prācurya*, stated one after another — have some other sense would not occur even to a child.”

Reading Śaṅkara's commentary, one gets the impression that his hidden aim is, as it were, [to show] that Śrī Vedavyāsa, the author of the *sūtras*, could not understand the meaning of Vedānta. So Śrī Śaṅkara, on the pretext of correcting the mistake of the ācārya Śrī Vedavyāsa, the author of the *sūtras*, used his own cleverness and artfully explained the *sūtra* on the *ānandamaya* thus: “Among the statements of the *śruti* beginning with ‘*ānandamaya*,’ the principal Brahman is ‘taught’ in the statement ‘Brahman is the tail, the foundation’; and in *sūtra* 1.1.13 I shall explain the word *vikāra* as ‘part’ and the word *prācurya* as ‘similarity.’” Explained this way, it follows that the author of the *sūtras* (Vyāsa) had no knowledge of words, since the words he used do not yield those meanings of Vedānta. What other meaning could the words *vikāra*, *prācurya* and the rest, derived from the suffix *mayaṭ* and stated one after another, possibly have? Even a child can see this! In other words, it is easy to understand that to give the suffix *mayaṭ* any meaning other than “transformation” and “abundance” is a plain error.

See Madhya 6.170–175 and Madhya 25.40–41.

*The “*vivarta-vāda*” of the Māyāvādī, who considers his guru mistaken —*

122 He argued that under the doctrine of transformation the Lord would be subject to change, and on that ground he established *vivarta-vāda*, the doctrine of illusion.

*The basis of *vivarta* —*

123 In truth the doctrine of transformation alone is authoritative; illusion lies in taking the body for the self.

*Refutation of *vivarta-vāda*: (1) Bhagavān possesses inconceivable potency —*

124 Śrī Bhagavān possesses inconceivable potency, and by His own will He is transformed into the world.

*(2) The example of the material *cintāmaṇi* stone —*

125 Yet by that same inconceivable potency He remains unchanged. We find an example of this even in this world — the *cintāmaṇi* stone.

*The *cintāmaṇi*, which produces heaps of jewels, remains unchanged —*

126 Heaps of various jewels come from the *cintāmaṇi*, yet the gem itself remains unchanged in its nature.

Anubhāṣya.

Śrī Jīva Prabhu writes in the *Paramātma-sandarbha* (section 58): “For in that doctrine the view is that all duality, beginning with the *jīvas*, is imagined through ignorance alone in Brahman, which is one's own nature. But Brahman — pure consciousness, without ego, free of any other attribute, distinct from everything — can be neither the shelter of ignorance, nor its object, nor the cause of error. Yet inconceivable potency is possible in Him, since He is a supreme and transcendent Reality. This is seen even in the *cintāmaṇi* and the like. [Brahman's potency], like a medicine that cures disorders of all three humors, holds even mutually contradictory qualities in Him; by it, although He is without parts and so on, He is acknowledged to have parts and so on. For this, the word [of scripture] is the evidence. It is: ‘The ancient Puruṣa has wondrous potencies, and others have no such potencies,’ and so on, in the *Śvetāśvatara Upaniṣad* and elsewhere; ‘the Self, the Lord, possessed of thousands of potencies beyond reasoning’ (*Bhāgavatam* 3.33.3), and so on, in the *Śrī Bhāgavatam* and elsewhere. So too the *Brahma-sūtra* (2.1.28): ‘For in the Self too it is so, since [in Him] there is variety.’ Therefore, even on the plea that duality cannot otherwise be explained, ignorance and the like cannot be imagined in Brahman — simply because it is impossible. And since inconceivable potency in Brahman is grasped by reason and heard in the *śruti*, the plea ‘duality cannot otherwise be explained’ falls away. In the end, then, inconceivable potency alone remains as what explains duality. Therefore, although the Paramātmā is by nature changeless and so on, by His inconceivable potency transformation and the like take place — into the shape of the universe and so on — just as the *cintāmaṇi* yields every desired object and the magnet moves iron. Śrī Bādarāyaṇa accepted this: ‘But on the basis of *śruti*, for [this] rests on the word’ (*Brahma-sūtra* 2.1.27). Hence, since He has such potency, it is also wrong to take the word *māyā*, as in worldly usage, to mean the art of sorcery (*indra-jāla*). It means the potency that creates wondrous variety:

‘that by which the manifold is measured out, that is, fashioned.’ Therefore the conclusion of scripture is the transformation of the Paramātmā Himself. *** Here He, remaining untransformed, is transformed by inconceivable potency; and it is understood that He is transformed only in the form of the potency called *dravya* (substance) — an expansion (*vyūha*) of His *svarūpa*, which appears as pure being alone — and not in His *svarūpa*. Just like the *cintāmaṇi*.** * That is why we sometimes hear that the material cause [of the world] is Brahman, and sometimes that it is *pradhāna*. *** Earlier, when one saw water, a mental image in the form of water arose. While there is no occasion for it, it lies asleep, but it awakens on seeing something similar; and then, without examining the difference, [the mind] arbitrarily imposes [water] on it, taking them as one. So it is not the water that is false, nor the image in the form of water made of its memory, nor the similar thing such as a mirage: only the imposition that identifies them is false, since it does not accord with reality. And in a dream — by the rule ‘But [the dream] is mere *māyā*, since its nature is not fully manifest’ (*Brahma-sūtra* 3.2.3) — the Paramātmā's *māyā* imposes the separate things on a state of mind shaped like things seen in waking, just as before. So in reality nothing anywhere is false. Only such an imposition of that [world] on the pure self or on the Paramātmā is false — not that the universe is false.** Moreover, *vivarta* is mentioned in the sections on knowledge and the like, and so is secondary; whereas *pariṇāma* is mentioned in its own section and so is primary; and since it is mentioned in both — in the sections on knowledge and the like as well — its strength is established by the maxim of the tongs (*sandaṁśa-nyāya*). Therefore it is understood that the purport of the *Śrī Bhāgavatam* is *pariṇāma* itself.”

In the *Paramātma-sandarbha* [it is said]: relying on *vivarta*, that is, on the doctrine of falsity, they claim that all *tattvas* that have a second existence — the *jīva* and the rest — are imagined through ignorance in Brahman's own *svarūpa*. But Brahman is devoid of any other attribute, distinct from everything, free of ego, pure consciousness; so He can never be the shelter of ignorance, nor that toward which ignorance is directed, nor the cause of error. Brahman is a supreme and transcendent Reality, and so He can have a potency inconceivable to puny human beings. If transcendent power is seen even in material things such as the *cintāmaṇi*, then such power certainly exists in Brahman. When the three humors — *vāta*, *kapha* and *pitta* — afflict a patient all at once, a medicine is prescribed to correct the mutually opposed elements of the body. In the same way

the potency that holds three mutually opposed qualities [allows us to accept] that Brahman, though formless and so on, possesses limbs and so on. There is Vedic evidence for this: “The eternal Puruṣa possesses wondrous potencies; others have no such potencies” — so says the *Śvetāśvatara*. And the *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* and other works say: “The Self is the Lord, possessed of thousands of inconceivable potencies.” And the *Brahma-sūtra*: “In the Self there is such variety.” Even though duality may find no explanation in Brahman, ignorance and the like still cannot be imagined in Brahman, since that is impossible. “Inconceivable potency in Brahman agrees with reason and is confirmed by the *śruti*, so the plea ‘duality cannot otherwise be explained’ has fallen away; what remains to explain duality is inconceivable potency alone. Therefore, although the Paramātmā is changeless by nature, by the power of His inconceivable potency transformation and the like take place into the shape of the universe. The *cintāmaṇi* does not change, yet it can yield every desired object; the magnet does not change, yet it can attract and move iron and so on. In the same way Brahman does not change: only Brahman's potency, which is capable of change, changes and is transformed into the shape of the universe. Śrī Bādarāyaṇa accepted this in the *Brahma-sūtra*. And since Brahman has such potency, it is wrong to take the word *māyā*, as in worldly usage, to mean the art of sorcery. This *māyā* creates variety, and so it is established that the word means the potency that produces wondrous variety. Therefore the conclusion of scripture is that this universe is the transformation of the Paramātmā Himself. *** Here what is transformed is the untransformed real Entity — by the power of inconceivable potency. So what is transformed is only the potency called *dravya*, an unfolding of the *svarūpa* of that Entity, which appears as pure being alone; the *svarūpa* itself is not transformed. So the *cintāmaṇi* exerts its power, yet itself undergoes no change at all.** * That is why, as we hear, some say that the material cause of this world is ‘Brahman,’ while others say it is ‘*pradhāna*.’ *** Earlier, when one saw water, a notion of it arose. While there is no occasion for it, that notion sleeps, but on seeing something similar it awakens. If, without examining that thing, one arbitrarily imposes on it identity with the earlier thing, then it is not the water that becomes false, nor the image in the form of water made of its memory, nor the water-like thing such as a mirage — only the imposition of identity with water is untrue, that is, false. And in a dream too, by the rule ‘[the dream] is mere *māyā*; its nature is not fully manifest,’ the Paramātmā's *māyā*, just as before, imposes identity with things on a state of mind shaped like things perceived (seen) in waking. Therefore in**

reality nothing is false. Only such an imposition on the pure self or on the Paramātmā is false; the universe is not false. * Further, the examples of *vivarta* are mentioned among the sections on knowledge and the like, and so are secondary; *pariṇāma-vāda* is set forth in its own section, and so is primary; and since it is set forth in both — in the sections on knowledge and the like as well — its strength is established by the maxim of the tongs. Therefore it is known that the purport of the *Śrī Bhāgavatam* is the transformation of potency (*śakti-pariṇāma*).”

(3) Even when His potency is transformed, He Himself remains unchanged —

127 If even a material thing possesses inconceivable power, what wonder is there in the inconceivable potency of the Lord?

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

The *jīva-tattva* is a particular potency. If one tries to establish the *jīva-tattva* not as atomic consciousness (*aṇu-caitanya*) but as “Brahman,” the conclusion will certainly be mistaken. Śrī Śaṅkarācārya, carrying out the Lord's order, intended to conceal the Lord's sovereignty; so he established the oneness of the *jīva-tattva* with the Supreme Truth (*para-tattva*) and preached a mistaken conclusion. In fact, Vyāsa's *sūtras* accept the doctrine of the transformation (of potency) — (*śakti-*)*pariṇāma-vāda*. The ācārya raised the argument: “If *pariṇāma-vāda* is accepted, the Lord must be said to undergo change.” He reasoned: “If *pariṇāma-vāda* is admitted, Vyāsa will have to be admitted to have ‘erred,’” and so he established *vivarta-vāda*. In his commentary on the fourteenth *sūtra* of the first *pāda* of the second chapter of the *Brahma-sūtra* — “It is not other [than the cause], according to the word *ārambhaṇa* and the rest” — he cited such Vedic statements as “Change is only a verbal designation, a name” (*Chāndogya* 6.1.4) and argued that *pariṇāma-vāda* is a faulty doctrine of change (*vikāra-vāda*). In reality, the *Brahma-sūtra* presents *pariṇāma-vāda* thus: by the mere will of the Lord, His inconceivable potency is transformed into effects. The definition of *pariṇāma* is: “*Vikāra* is said to be the perception [of a thing] as other while it is real.” When from one real *tattva* another real *tattva* arises, and it is perceived as a different thing, that is *vikāra*, that is, *pariṇāma*. “Brahman” is a real Entity; from Him there have arisen separately a real entity, the “*jīva*,” and a real entity, the “material universe of *māyā*.” This understanding is called the *vikāra*, or *pariṇāma*, of Brahman. An example of *pariṇāma*:

“milk” is a real substance, and it changes into another real substance, “curd.” Vedic statements such as “All this has That as its soul” (*Chāndogya* 6.8.7) leave no doubt that the world is Brahman. Brahman has an inconceivable potency; this is established by the Vedic statement “His supreme potency is heard to be manifold” (*Śvetāśvatara* 6.8). By that potency Brahman's real nature is transformed into the world — and no fault can attach to such a conclusion. From the statements of the *Chāndogya* — “In the beginning, my dear, all this was Being alone, one without a second” (6.2.1), “It glanced: may I become many, may I be born” (6.2.3), “All these creatures, my dear, are rooted in Being, abide in Being, are established in Being” (6.8.4), “All this has That as its soul” (6.8.7) — it is well known that this Brahman, by His own superior potency, is transformed into this world of spirit and matter. The world and the *jīva* are *upādeya* (what is made from the material), and Brahman is the *upādāna* (the material cause). The Vedic statement “That from which these beings are born” (*Taittirīya*, *Bhṛgu-vallī* 1) accepts that Brahman is the material cause and that the *jīva* and matter are made from Him. One who has not grasped the true essence of *pariṇāma-vāda* does not understand that this “world” and the “*jīva*” are separate real *tattvas*. From such statements as “All these creatures, my dear, are rooted in Being, abide in Being” (*Chāndogya* 6.8.4), it is clear that the “*jīva*” and the “material world,” the *jīva*'s dwelling, are indeed real. To imagine the *jīva* and the world as false, like a snake in a rope or silver in a shell, out of a groundless fear that Brahman would then turn out to be subject to change — this is mere deception. True, the *Māṇḍūkya* and other Vedas give the examples of “a snake in a rope” and “silver in a shell,” but these have their own particular fields of application. The *jīva* is a pure particle of spirit. The *jīva* in a human body identifies himself with this material body — that is the place of *vivarta*. *Vivarta* is explained thus: “*Vivarta* is said to be the perception [of a thing] as other when it is not so in reality.” To take a thing for what it is not — that is *vivarta*. For the *jīva*, *vivarta* is a great defect: the conditioned *jīva* is stained by this fault of false perception (*vivarta-buddhi*). To impose such a fault of *vivarta* on the original *tattva* of the universe and on the *jīva-tattva* is utterly worthless. Such an error arises only when one forgets the inconceivable potency. How Bhagavān has transformed into the world can be illustrated by a simple example. Many say that in the material world there is a treasure, the stone *cintāmaṇi*: it produces heaps of various jewels, yet itself remains unchanged. If a material thing has such an inconceivable power, what is surprising in the Lord's having an inconceivable potency that surpasses it infinitely in its qualities?

*The *praṇava*, seed of the tree of the Vedas, is the great statement (*mahā-vākya*) and the very form of the Lord —*

128 The *praṇava* (oṁ) is the great utterance, the source of the Vedas; the *praṇava* is the Lord Himself in sound, the abode of all the universes.

Anubhāṣya.

In the *Gītā*: "Whoever departs, leaving the body, uttering the single syllable *Om* — Brahman — and remembering Me, attains the supreme goal" (8.13); "[I am] what is to be known, the purifier, the syllable *Om*" (9.17); "*Om tat sat* — this is remembered as the threefold designation of Brahman" (17.23). In the *Chāndogya Upaniṣad* (1.1.1, 1.4.1): "One should worship the syllable *Om* as the *udgītha*, for one sings the *udgītha* beginning with *Om*. Here is its explanation"; (*Chāndogya* 1.5.1): "What is the *udgītha* is the *praṇava*; what is the *praṇava* is the *udgītha*"; (*Atharva-śikhā* 2): "It makes all the life-breaths bow (*praṇāvayati*) to the Paramātmā; therefore it is the *praṇava*. The *praṇava* abides in four forms; it is the source of the Vedas and of the gods, the object of meditation; it holds all together and carries one across all sorrows and fears, because it delivers; [pervading] all, it is Viṣṇu; it conquers all";[5] (*Māṇḍūkya* 1): "The syllable *Om* is all this. Here is its explanation: past, present and future — all this is *Om* alone; and whatever else lies beyond the three times is also *Om* alone"; (*Taittirīya*, *Śikṣā*, ch. 8): "*Om* is Brahman. *Om* is all this. With *Om* they sing the Sāmans. With *Om* a *brāhmaṇa*, about to recite [the Veda], says, 'May I attain Brahman' — and he attains Brahman."

In the *Śrī Bhagavat-sandarbha* (section 48): "The *śruti* says of the *praṇava*: '*Om* is the nearest name of Brahman: as soon as it is uttered, it carries one across the fear of worldly existence; therefore it is called *tāra*, the deliverer.' *** Therefore the name is the very *svarūpa* of Bhagavān. It is also clearly said in the *Śrī Nārada-pañcarātra* about the eight-syllable [mantra]: 'Clearly, Bhagavān Himself — Nārāyaṇa directly — abides in [people's] mouths in the form of the eight syllables.' And in the *Māṇḍūkya Upaniṣad* (4.4–7) about the *praṇava*: '*Om* is all this. The syllable *Om* is all this.' 'The *praṇava* is indeed the Supreme Brahman, and the *praṇava* is held to be the Supreme. The *praṇava* has nothing before it, nothing within, nothing without, nothing after; it is imperishable. The *praṇava* is the beginning, the middle and the end of all. Knowing the *praṇava* thus, one attains it at once. Know the *praṇava* to be the

Lord, abiding in the heart of everyone. One who understands *Oṁkāra* as all-pervading is wise and does not grieve. It is without measure and of infinite measure; in it duality comes to rest; it is auspicious. One who has known *Oṁkāra* is a sage, not an ordinary person.' One should not think that, since such things are possible only for the Supreme Lord, the words about a mere letter are only praise. For the same *śruti* accepts the sense that, like the other *avatāras*, this is an *avatāra* of the Supreme Lord Himself in the form of sound; and this is possible because the sound is nondifferent from Him. Therefore the name and the Bearer of the name are nondifferent."

The *Śrī Bhagavat-sandarbha* [says]: the *śruti* says of the *praṇava* that *Om* is the nearest (the sweetest) of all the names of the Supreme Brahman: from the moment one begins to utter it, it saves the *jīva* from the fear of worldly existence; therefore He is also called "Tāra." [Śrīdhara Svāmipāda, at the beginning of his own commentary on the *Bhāgavatam*, called the *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* *tārāṅkura*, "the sprout of Tāra," because it begins with *Om*.] So the holy name is directly the *svarūpa* of Bhagavān. About the eight-syllable mantra the *Śrī Nārada-pañcarātra* says clearly: "It is well known that Bhagavān Śrī Nārāyaṇa Himself directly appears in the mouth of the *jīva* in the form of the eight syllables." And about the *praṇava* the *Māṇḍūkya Upaniṣad* says: "All that is seen by spiritual vision is *Oṁkāra*, the syllable *Om*." "The *praṇava* is another appearance of Brahman; He is called the Supreme Reality. He has nothing before Him, is unbounded, has nothing outside Him, is supreme and imperishable; He is the beginning, the middle and the end of all. Knowing the *praṇava* thus, one tastes immortality. Know that the *praṇava*, abiding in the heart of everyone, is the *svarūpa* of the Lord. As soon as a wise person understands *Oṁkāra* as all-pervading — *vibhu*, that is, the *svarūpa* of Viṣṇu — he no longer needs to grieve; that is, he is no longer a *śūdra*.[25] He is without material measure, yet possesses infinite measure; through Him the material knowledge of duality subsides and nondual knowledge is attained; therefore He is the supreme good itself." One should not think that such auspicious works are possible only for the Supreme Lord as an *avatāra*, and that therefore such statements about a material sound or letter contain no real truth and are mere praise. In fact, like the other *avatāras* of the Supreme Lord, this *praṇava* too is His *avatāra* in the form of sound. This sense is accepted on the very strength of the *śruti* statements quoted above, and since the *praṇava* is nondifferent from Him, this is possible; so this

sense alone is correct. Therefore there is no doubt that the name of Bhagavān and the Bearer of the name, Bhagavān, are nondifferent.

Om, or the *praṇava*, is the *mahā-vākya*, the root of the Vedas. The *praṇava* is placed at the beginning and at the end of every Vedic mantra. The *praṇava* is the very form of the Lord. “By the sound *a* Kṛṣṇa is denoted, the sole Master of all the worlds; by the sound *u* Rādhā is denoted; *m* denotes the *jīva*.”

*The Lord is what is denoted (*vācya*), the *praṇava* is what denotes (*vācaka*); “You are That” and similar statements only illumine one part of the Vedas —*

129 The *praṇava* points to the Lord, the shelter of all, whereas the utterance *tat tvam asi* is one particular statement of the Veda.

Anubhāṣya.

The *śruti* “You are That” (*tat tvam asi*) is found in the *Chāndogya Upaniṣad*, in the sixth *prapāṭhaka*, in the eighth to the sixteenth *khaṇḍas*: “He is the Self; you are That, Śvetaketu.” “You are That” is one of the four Vedic “great statements” (*mahā-vākyas*) introduced by Śaṅkara.

130 The *praṇava* is the great utterance; but he covered this and set up *tat tvam asi* as the great utterance instead.

*The Vedas and other scriptures, in their direct meaning (*abhidhā-vṛtti*), acknowledge Kṛṣṇa alone —*

131 All the Vedas and sūtras name Kṛṣṇa in their primary sense; but he abandoned the primary sense and explained them by the secondary one (*lakṣaṇā*).

Anubhāṣya.

“In the Vedas, in the *Rāmāyaṇa*, in the Purāṇas and in the *Mahābhārata* — in the beginning, at the end and in the middle — Hari is sung everywhere.”

The evidence of the word, dependent on nothing else, is supreme —

132 The Veda is self-evident, the crest-jewel of all proofs; interpreted by the secondary sense, it loses that self-evidence.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

The root statement of the Vedas is the *praṇava*; therefore it alone is the great statement (*mahā-vākya*) that denotes Brahman. The *praṇava* is the word that reveals the *svarūpa* of the Lord; therefore it is the Lord's eternal name and points to the Lord — *sarva-viśva-dhāma*, the shelter of all. To call "*mahā-vākyas*" such statements as "You are That" (*Chāndogya* 6.8.7), "All this is what this Self is," "All this is Brahman" (*Bṛhad-āraṇyaka* 2.5.1), "All this is the Self" (*Chāndogya* 7.25.2) and "There is no diversity here" (*Kaṭha* 2.1.11; *Bṛhad-āraṇyaka* 4.4.19) is a grave error. For the chief among them, "You are That," is only a partial statement: what the words "You are That" teach covers only one part of the Vedas. A *mahā-vākya* is what covers the Vedas as a whole; therefore nothing but the *praṇava* can be a "*mahā-vākya*."[5] Concealing this truth, Śrī Śaṅkarācārya called "You are That" a *mahā-vākya*. Relying on this invented *mahā-vākya*, he everywhere in the Vedas abandoned the primary meaning, that is, *abhidhā-vṛtti*, and explained them by *lakṣaṇā*, the secondary meaning. In this way he rejected without any reason the way all the Vedas and *sūtras* reveal the Kṛṣṇa-*tattva*. The Vedas are their own evidence (*svataḥ-pramāṇa*); so to impose a figurative sense (*lakṣaṇā*) on their words is merely to destroy the authority of evidence that is self-established.

Anubhāṣya.

See the *Anubhāṣya* on Ādi 7.107.

*Śaṅkara's explanation rests on *lakṣaṇā-vṛtti* and is therefore invented —*

133 So in every sūtra he abandoned the natural meaning and explained it by a secondary one, inventing it all himself."

*The Lord refutes Śaṅkara's commentary on each *sūtra* —*

134 In this way He showed the faults in the commentary on every sūtra, and the sannyāsīs were astonished to hear it.

*The *sannyāsīs*' astonishment, their admission, and their loyalty to their *sampradāya* —*

135 All the sannyāsīs said, “Listen, Śrīpāda: the meaning You have refuted is beyond dispute.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
O Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya! You presented these arguments and refuted Śaṅkara's interpretation; this is no empty dispute (*vivāda*) — that is, a fortunate person accepts it as “the truth.”

136 We all know that the meaning is the Ācārya’s own invention; yet out of deference to our sampradāya we accept it as the truth.

Anubhāṣya.
See Madhya 25.46–48.

*The Lord is asked to explain by the direct meaning (*abhidhā-vṛtti*) —*

137 Explain the primary meaning; let us see Your power.” And the Lord set about explaining all the sūtras in their primary meaning:

*The Lord's explanation: (1) Bhagavān Kṛṣṇa is the *sambandha* —*

138 “The great reality called Brahman is Śrī Bhagavān, full of the six kinds of majesty, the abode of the Supreme Truth.

139 In His own form and majesty there is not a trace of *māyā*; in all the Vedas Bhagavān is the *sambandha* — the One to whom everything is related.

140 To call Him featureless (*nirviśeṣa*) is to deny His spiritual potency; and one who does not accept half of His being diminishes His fullness.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
In the *Bṛhad-āraṇyaka* (5.1), in the statement “That is full…” and so on, the Supreme Truth, full of the six opulences, is called *bṛhad-vastu*, the great Reality. In the Purāṇas these characteristics are described by the word “Bhagavān”;

therefore wherever the Vedas say “Brahman,” the word fulfills its purpose only when “Śrī Bhagavān” is put in its place. So in all the Vedas the one *sambandha* is Bhagavān. Bhagavān embraces even the quality of featurelessness, yet He is eternally possessed of features. To call Him “featureless” is to deny His *cit-śakti*. Brahman possesses *cit-śakti* — that is, possesses features; so if one does not accept half of His *svarūpa*, His fullness is impaired.

Anubhāṣya.

Śrī Rāmānujapāda writes in the *Vedārtha-saṅgraha*: “If it is asked, ‘How is it known that the very nature [of Brahman] is defined by knowledge as an attribute, and not that Brahman is mere knowledge?’ — [the answer is:] this is understood from the *śrutis* that speak of Him as the knower, such as ‘He who is all-knowing, all-wise’; from hundreds of *śrutis* such as ‘His supreme potency is heard to be manifold’ and ‘By what, my dear, should one know the knower?’; and also because knowledge is only an attribute, and a mere attribute without a substrate cannot be accepted as an independent entity. Therefore words such as ‘truth,’ ‘knowledge’ and so on establish Brahman as possessed of knowledge and so on — the very things that are their own meanings. And if in ‘*tat tvam*’ both words abandon their own meanings in order to point to the nature of an entity without features, that is an abandonment of the primary meaning. [It may be said:] ‘Since the purport [of the statement] is established to be oneness, there is no fault of *lakṣaṇā*, as in the words “This is that very Devadatta.”’[26] *** Moreover, a word gains its force as evidence because, by its very nature as words and sentences, it conveys differences of meaning and their particular relations; therefore it is incapable of conveying an entity without features, and for such an entity the word is not evidence. Words such as ‘featureless’ convey [meaning] in another way: of an entity known as possessed of some feature, they deny a feature known from some other thing.”

*(2) The means, or *abhidheya*, is *sādhana-bhakti*, beginning with hearing*

—

141 The means by which one attains Bhagavān is devotion beginning with hearing; it is what brings one to Kṛṣṇa.

142 All the Vedas call this the *abhidheya*, the means to be practised; from devotion in practice (*sādhana-bhakti*) prema springs up.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

To attain shelter at the feet of that Bhagavat-*tattva*, all the Vedas have determined *sādhana-bhakti* to be the *abhidheya*. It is from the ninefold *sādhana-bhakti*, beginning with hearing, that love for Kṛṣṇa awakens.

*(3) The goal to be attained — the *prayojana*, or fifth goal of life — is love for Kṛṣṇa —*

143 When deep attachment for Kṛṣṇa's feet arises, no attachment to anything other than Kṛṣṇa remains.

144 That great treasure of prema is the fifth goal of life; it lets one taste the rasa of Kṛṣṇa's sweetness.

145 By prema Kṛṣṇa comes under the control of His devotee, and by prema one tastes the joy of serving Kṛṣṇa.

*The *Brahma-sūtra* establishes *sambandha*, *abhidheya* and *prayojana* —*

146 *Sambandha*, *abhidheya* and *prayojana* — relationship, means and goal: in these three meanings all the sūtras find their conclusion."

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

"Who am I? What is this material universe? What is Bhagavān? And what is our relationship with one another?" When one finds the true answer to these four questions, one has "knowledge of *sambandha*." What is the duty of one who has gained knowledge of *sambandha*? One must understand this, and taking up that duty is to be known as the *abhidheya* of all the scriptures. The fruit one attains by carrying out that duty is called the *prayojana*. The *Brahma-sūtra* teaches precisely these three meanings.

*Having heard the explanation of all the *sūtras*, the *sannyāsīs* offer praise —*

147 Hearing all the sūtras explained in this way, all the sannyāsīs humbly said:

148 “You are the Vedas embodied — Nārāyaṇa Himself. Forgive us for having blasphemed You before.”

They constantly take the name of Kṛṣṇa —

149 From that time the sannyāsīs’ hearts were changed, and they always took the name “Kṛṣṇa, Kṛṣṇa”.

Anubhāṣya.

The leader at that time of the *ekadaṇḍī sannyāsīs* of Śaṅkara's *sampradāya* living in Kāśī was Śrī Prakāśānanda Sarasvatī. Some mistakenly try to identify him with Śrī Prabodhānanda Sarasvatī, who lived in Śrī Raṅga-kṣetra and later in Kāmyavana. Needless to say, Prabodhānanda was a *tridaṇḍī* of Rāmānuja's line, a *jīyar svāmī*, who had come from the land of Mysore and lived in Raṅga-kṣetra. He is the author of such books as *Śrī Caitanya-candrāmṛta*, *Rādhā-rasa-sudhā-nidhi*, *Saṅgīta-mādhava*, *Vṛndāvana-śataka* and *Navadvīpa-śataka*. Veṅkaṭa Bhaṭṭa, Tirumalaya Bhaṭṭa and Prabodhānanda were three brothers. Mahāprabhu saw him in Śaka 1433, during the *cāturmāsya*, as a member of Rāmānuja's *sampradāya*; so it is unreasonable to think that in Śaka 1435 He saw him in Kāśī as a member of Śaṅkara's *sampradāya*. See the book *Śrī Bhakti-ratnākara*.

The Lord forgives their offenses and bestows mercy —

150 So He forgave their offences and graced them all with Kṛṣṇa’s name.

*Together they honor the *mahā-prasāda* —*

151 Then all the sannyāsīs took their meal together with Mahāprabhu, seating Him in their midst.

152 After the meal Mahāprabhu returned to His lodging. Such are the wonderful pastimes of the beautiful Gaurāṅga.

The devotees rejoice at the Lord's magnanimous pastimes —

153 Candraśekhara, Tapana Miśra and Sanātana rejoiced at heart to hear and see all this.

154 All the sannyāsīs came to see the Lord, and all Vārāṇasī sang His praises.

Kāśī is blessed, for the Lord set foot there —

155 Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya had come to Vārāṇasī, and the city and all its people were greatly blessed.

Countless people come to see the Lord —

156 People came in their hundreds of thousands to see the Lord; there was such a crowd at the door that no one could get in.

157 Whenever the Lord went to see Viśveśvara, hundreds of thousands of people gathered there.

158 When He went to bathe on the bank of the Gaṅgā, there too all the people thronged in a great crowd.

The Lord delivers the people by making them chant the names of Hari —

159 Raising His arms, the Lord would say, “Chant ‘Hari! Hari!’”, and the people’s cry of “Hari!” filled heaven and earth.

The Lord leaves Kāśī and sends Śrī Sanātana to Vṛndāvana —

160 Having delivered the people, the Lord decided to leave, and He sent Śrī Sanātana to Vṛndāvana.

161 Hearing the clamour of the crowds night and day, the Lord left Vārāṇasī and returned to Nīlācala.

162 I shall tell these pastimes in detail later; here I have told them briefly, as the occasion arose.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

"Later": see Madhya, Chapter 25.

Thus ends the seventh chapter of the "Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya."

The Lord, in the form of the Pañca-tattva, delivers the world —

163 Thus, in the form of the Pañca-tattva, Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya blessed the whole world, giving everyone Kṛṣṇa's name and love for Him.

*The Lord, Himself and through His preachers, spreads the name and *prema* throughout India and delivers the people —*

164 He sent Rūpa and Sanātana to Mathurā, and these two commanders spread bhakti there.

165 He sent Nityānanda Gosāñi to the land of Gauḍa, and there He preached bhakti in every possible way.

166 He Himself went to the south and spread Kṛṣṇa's name from village to village.

167 As far as Setubandha He preached bhakti, and, giving Kṛṣṇa-prema, He delivered everyone.

Anubhāṣya.

To deliver everyone throughout India through love for Kṛṣṇa, [Mahāprabhu] spread the name of Kṛṣṇa: in the northwest, in the Māthura-maṇḍala, through Śrī Rūpa and Sanātana; in Gauḍa and Bengal through Śrī Nityānanda; and Himself in the south, village after village, as far as Setubandha.

*By hearing the explanation of the Pañca-tattva one gains knowledge of the Gaura-*tattva* —*

168 Thus I have given the explanation of the Pañca-tattva; by hearing it one comes to know the truth of Caitanya.

Anubhāṣya.
Thus ends the seventh chapter of the “Anubhāṣya.”

169 Śrī Caitanya, Nityānanda and Advaita — the three; Śrīvāsa, Gadādhara and all the other devotees —

170 at the lotus feet of all of them I bow millions of times, and as best I can I tell something of Caitanya’s pastimes.

171 Praying at the feet of Śrī Rūpa and Śrī Raghunātha, I, Kṛṣṇadāsa, narrate the *Caitanya-caritāmṛta*.

Notes

1. According to the *Anubhāṣya*: the devotee in form is Śrī Gaurāṅga, who tastes His own sweetness; the devotee in essence (in the form of His brother) is Śrī Nityānanda; the devotee-avatāra is Śrī Advaita; the one called a devotee is Śrīvāsa and others, established in *śānta*, *dāsya* and the other rasas; the potency is Gadādhara, Svarūpa Dāmodara, Rāmānanda and others. The same verse as Ādi 1.14; ascribed in the edition to Śrī Rūpa Gosvāmī. ↩
2. As in the Gauḍīya Maṭha edition: «কোটীসূর্য্যাভাস» (another reading: «কোটিসূর্য্যাভাস»); the sense is the same. ↩
3. As in the Gauḍīya Maṭha edition: «ব্রহ্মাদি আনন্দ» (“the bliss of Brahman and the rest”; the heading: “Prema, which puts liberation and the rest to shame, is the fifth goal of life”). Other editions read «মোক্ষাদি» (“liberation and the rest”). ↩
4. As in the Gauḍīya Maṭha edition: «তাহা» (“it”; another reading «যাহা», “which”); the sense is the same. ↩
5. From these words on, the edition prints the heading *Anubhāṣya* above the continuation — apparently a typesetting error, since the text continues the sentence of the *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*. ↩

6. *Śvetāśvatara Upaniṣad* 6.8. ↩
7. So in the edition. In Ādi 6.4 the subheading attributes the neighboring verses (12–13) to the diary of Śrī Svarūpa Gosvāmī. ↩
8. *Kaṭha Upaniṣad* 2.2.13; *Śvetāśvatara Upaniṣad* 6.13. ↩
9. Śaṅkara, *Kaupīna-pañcaka* 1. ↩
10. *Śrī Śikṣāṣṭaka* 3. ↩
11. *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 3.33.7. ↩
12. *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 1.7.6. ↩
13. *Chāndogya Upaniṣad* 6.2.1. ↩
14. *Chāndogya Upaniṣad* 3.14.1. ↩
15. So in the edition's Bengali paraphrase, and also in the Sanskrit text of the quotation above (*adhika-sāmarthye 'labdhe*, with an avagraha — the same sign as in *nāmato 'pi* beside it). The other reading (*labdhe*, “since mantras obtain greater power”) is also possible in sense, but the edition does not have it. ↩
16. *Śrī Nāmāṣṭaka* 1. ↩
17. Unclear place in the scan: instead of the book's title the edition has “***”; apparently the same *Prīti-sandarbha*. ↩
18. *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 10.33.30. ↩
19. *Bhakti-rasāmṛta-sindhu* 1.2.255. ↩
20. *Śvetāśvatara Upaniṣad* 6.23. ↩
21. The edition reads *śaḥ bhāḥ* 3.3.32; apparently Śaṅkara's commentary on *Brahma-sūtra* 3.3.32, which mentions Apāntaratamā, the ancient teacher of the Vedas. ↩
22. *Muktikā Upaniṣad* 1.30–39. Many names in the verse are abbreviated (e.g., “Tāpanī” for the *Nṛsiṁha-tāpanī*); they are given as in the edition. ↩
23. *Bhagavad-gītā* 7.14. ↩
24. From these words on, the edition prints the heading *Anubhāṣya* above the continuation — apparently a typesetting error, since the text continues the sentence of the *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*. ↩
25. A play on words: *śūdra* is explained as “one who grieves” (from the root *śuc*, to grieve). ↩
26. Apparently this is an opponent's objection; the reply to it is omitted in the edition (***). ↩

“Śrī Caitanya-caritāmṛta”

Ādi-līlā

Chapter 8

An Account of the Vaiṣṇavas’ Command to Compose the Book

(English translation from the Bengali, following the Gauḍīya Maṭha edition and the «Anubhāṣya», 2026 — draft)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya

Summary. In the eighth chapter the greatness of Śrī Caitanya and Nityānanda is described in this way: even if a person chants the name of Kṛṣṇa birth after birth, he does not obtain the treasure of *prema* as long as offenses against the holy name remain in him. From this one must understand that the *sāttvika-vikāras* (spiritual transformations) and other signs shown by one who offends the name are mere pretense. But whoever takes the names of Caitanya and Nityānanda without duplicity and expresses joy — the two Lords directly free his heart from offenses, and then, when he chants Kṛṣṇa's name, love awakens in him. Śrī Vṛndāvana dāsa Ṭhākura had noted the final pastimes of Mahāprabhu only briefly in his *Śrī Caitanya-bhāgavata*, and they remained to be described. Therefore, at the order of the Vaiṣṇavas living in Śrī Vṛndāvana, and after receiving the garland of command from Śrīla Madana-mohana, Kavirāja Gosvāmī composed this book.

By Gaura's will even a wholly unfit person becomes fit —

1 I worship Lord Caitanya-deva, by whose will even this dull fool has suddenly been set to dance so wondrously on the stage of writing.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

I bow down to Bhagavān Caitanyadeva. By His will I, a fool like a painted puppet, have suddenly begun the dance of writing this book.

Anubhāṣya.

yad-icchayā (by whose [*yat* = *yasya*] will, that is, Caitanyadeva's) **ayam** (this one, I, Kṛṣṇadāsa) **jaḍo 'pi** (though like one who is dull and insensible) **lekha-raṅge** (in the play of composing a book) **prasabham** (suddenly) **citram** (wonderfully) **nartyate** (is made to dance), **taṁ kṛpāmayaṁ bhagavantam caitanya-devam ahaṁ vande** (I bow down).

2 Glory, glory to Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya Gauracandra! Glory, glory to Nityānanda, full of the highest bliss!

3 Glory, glory to Advaita Ācārya, glory to the all-merciful! Glory, glory to the noble-hearted Gadādhara Paṇḍita!

4 Glory, glory to Śrīvāsa and to all the devotees! Bowing low, I worship the feet of them all.

5 By remembering them the mute become poets, the lame cross mountains and the blind see the stars.

To disregard the greatness of the Pañca-tattva and worship Gaura or Kṛṣṇa while seeing Them as separate is a grave offense —

6 The learning of scholars who do not accept all this is no more than the croaking of frogs.

7 Whoever practises devotion to Kṛṣṇa yet does not accept all this receives no mercy from Kṛṣṇa and reaches no goal.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

“All this”: one who serves Kṛṣṇa without accepting this Pañca-tattva does not receive Kṛṣṇa's mercy.

Anubhāṣya.

“*Tāre*”: to him.

8 Long ago Jarāsandha and other kings followed the Vedic dharma and worshipped Viṣṇu.

*Devotion to Gaura without devotion to Kṛṣṇa, and devotion to Kṛṣṇa without devotion to Gaura, are non-devotion (*abhakti*) —*

9 But they did not accept Kṛṣṇa, and so we regard them as demons; and whoever does not accept Caitanya, we know, is a demon just the same.

Anubhāṣya.

Jarāsandha and others abandoned the worship of Śrī Kṛṣṇa — the Supreme Truth, Viṣṇu, the original form (*svayaṁ-rūpa*) — out of hatred or indifference toward Him. They worshipped Viṣṇu with Vedic mantras, but even that worship ended in nothing but demoniac *dharma*. In the same way, when the *jīva* forgets his nature as a minute particle of spirit (*aṇu-cid-dharma*), that is, his servitude to Caitanya, his attempt to worship Viṣṇu is also nothing but a calamitous, demoniac *dharma* — that is, non-Vaiṣṇavism.

*The reason for the Lord's pastime of *sannyāsa* —*

10 "If they do not accept Me, all people will be lost." For this reason the Lord, His heart melting with mercy, accepted sannyāsa.

11 "Even if they bow to Me thinking Me an ordinary sannyāsī, their misery will be cut away and they will find deliverance."

Anubhāṣya.

Śrī Caitanyacandra is a Reality nondifferent from the truth of Śrī Rādhā and Kṛṣṇa. Out of ignorance some people equated the pastimes of Śrī Gaurasundara with their own material attachments, full of the desire for enjoyment, and so they could not understand Him. Considering their predicament, Śrī Gaurahari Himself, before the eyes of the world, accepted the *dharma* of a renunciant (*yati-dharma*) and thus showed mercy to foolish people.

To lack devotion to the supremely magnanimous Gaura is a demoniac disposition —

12 Whoever does not worship Caitanya, so full of mercy, is counted among the asuras, even if he is the greatest of men.

Anubhāṣya.

"O *jīva*, worship Kṛṣṇa alone!" — such is the mercy of Śrī Caitanyacandra. Whoever cannot even perceive it is certainly an *asura*, a non-Vaiṣṇava devoid of devotion to Viṣṇu, however much worldly people may honor him as the best in the world. And if one abandons the worship of Kṛṣṇa and worships Caitanya, Śrī Caitanya's mercy is not upon him: such worship is imaginary, born of Kali. The same holds for one who follows the godless *smārtas* or the society of *pañcopāsakas* (worshippers of five deities) and strives to worship Viṣṇu for some petty, perishable self-interest. He may reject one of the six *tattvas* whose very self is Kṛṣṇa Caitanya and show faith or worship to another. Or he may consider Kṛṣṇa Caitanya Prabhu merely the best of mortal beings, separate from Kṛṣṇa, and so have no faith in Gaura's name, Gaura's mantra and Gaura's *śakti*. This too is demoniac *dharma* — imagination born of Kali and opposed to the truth.

Kavirāja Gosvāmī's earnest appeal to all to worship Gaura and Nityānanda —

13 Therefore, with arms upraised, I say again: give up false argument and worship Caitanya and Nityānanda!

Instruction even to the logician who holds to direct perception and inference —

14 But a logician may say: "Logic is the proof. Whatever the science of logic establishes is what deserves worship."

Gaura's mercy is more wonderful than any other mercy —

15 Then weigh the mercy of Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya; weigh it well, and your heart will be struck with wonder.

Anubhāṣya.

By the power of their own narrow, pleasure-seeking intelligence, people imagine one ideal of mercy or another. But the mercy of Śrī Caitanyacandra is not of that

kind.

After studying the science of logic (*tarka-śāstra*), a person comes to think that no other faculty equals reasoning (*tarka*) in the power to determine the nature of a thing and to uncover the truth. So, falling into the hands of reasoning, the *jīva* gives it the place of his sole patron and protector. But if an intelligent *jīva* carefully examines the foundation on which reasoning stands, he can understand how weak, how incapable and how deficient his worldly senses of knowledge are when it comes to grasping the subject of Bhagavān. Often reasoning merely settles on untruth as a truth established by argument; and so, as the fruit of false argument (*kutarka*), one obtains birth as a jackal.

Even so, there are people ready to determine the true nature of things relying chiefly on direct perception (*pratyakṣa*) and inference (*anumāna*). Kavirāja Gosvāmī addresses them too. He says: let those who have sight and the power of judgment, who have experienced every picture of every kind of mercy or have gained the ability and the opportunity to see them, make a list of all kinds of mercy and compare them with the mercy of Śrī Gaurahari. Then they will know that a mercy like that of Śrī Gaurahari is found in no created thing, nor in the creator, nor in the series of avatāras, nor even in the source of the avatāras — in Kṛṣṇa. The mercy of Gaurahari, the embodiment of magnanimity (*udāra-vigraha*), certainly brings more wonder and amazement than any other.

As long as offenses remain, hearing and chanting about Kṛṣṇa countless times is in vain —

16 One may hear and chant for many births, and still not obtain the treasure of love for Kṛṣṇa’s feet.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

A person burdened with the ten kinds of offenses against the holy name may hear and chant for many births, yet he never obtains the treasure of *prema* at Kṛṣṇa's feet.

Anubhāṣya.

If someone takes up the devotion called hearing and chanting without taking shelter of Śrī Caitanya's feet, he has no prospect of attaining love for Kṛṣṇa even in many births. According to the teaching of Śrī Caitanyacandra, devotees are lower than a blade of grass and more tolerant than a tree; free from pride themselves, they

honor others and are not occupied with any worldly conceit. Such persons become free from the grip of the ten offenses, are able to take Kṛṣṇa's name constantly, and attain *prema*.

The meaning is this. The *jīva* who has turned away from the service of Kṛṣṇa seeks to gratify the material senses or to achieve some perishable self-interest. He imagines a difference between Kṛṣṇa's name and Kṛṣṇa, the possessor of the name — between the word that designates (*vācaka*) and the One designated (*vācya*) — as if it were the label of some object perceptible to the material senses, or ordinary material letters. He does not know himself to be the eternal servant of Śrī Nāma-Prabhu. Such a *jīva* may utter the name and so forth with offenses countless times, yet he will not be able to attain *kṛṣṇa-prema*, which is attained through pure *sādhana-bhakti*. The words of the *Padma Purāṇa* quoted in the *Hari-bhakti-vilāsa* (11.289): “If even one name [of the Lord] is on a person's tongue, or has entered the path of his memory, or has reached his ears — whether pronounced correctly or incorrectly, so long as it is not broken — it certainly delivers him. But if, O brāhmaṇa, it is cast amid [concern for] body, wealth, followers, greed and godlessness, it does not quickly bear fruit here.” And further: “Therefore the name of Śrī Kṛṣṇa and all that is His cannot be grasped by the senses. Only when the tongue and the other senses are turned toward service does it reveal itself upon them.” (*Bhakti-rasāmṛta-sindhu*, *Pūrva-vibhāga* 2.234)

**Prema-bhakti* for Kṛṣṇa is extremely rare (words of the Tantra quoted in the *Bhakti-rasāmṛta-sindhu* 1.1.36) —*

17 “Liberation is easily won through knowledge, and enjoyment through the merit of sacrifices and other pious works; but devotion to Hari is hard to attain even by thousands of spiritual practices.” (Tantra; also Bhakti-rasāmṛta-sindhu, 1.1.36)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

By the endeavor of knowledge one easily attains liberation, and by the merit of sacrifices and the like one easily gains the enjoyments of heaven; but even by thousands of practices one does not easily attain *hari-bhakti*. The meaning is this: besides practice there is something more — service to the pure devotee and knowledge of one's relationship with the Supreme Truth (*sambandha-jñāna*). By taking shelter of this one attains *hari-bhakti*.

*Until the *jīva* has *bhāva*, or *rati*, Kṛṣṇa grants only liberation; when He sees *rati*, He grants *prema-bhakti* —*

18 Kṛṣṇa may slip away from a devotee by giving him enjoyment or liberation, but devotion He never gives: He keeps it hidden.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

If the devotees hope for worldly enjoyment (*bhukti*) and liberation (*mukti*), Kṛṣṇa keeps the truth of pure devotion hidden from them; He gives them *bhukti* and *mukti* and so is free of them.

"*Chuṭe*": leaves, goes away.

*Without a relationship of *rasa* with Kṛṣṇa, one obtains liberation alone (*Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam*, Canto 5, Chapter 6, verse 18) —*

19 (Śukadeva said:) "O King, Mukunda is the master and guru of you Pāṇḍavas and of the Yadus; He is your worshipped Deity, your dearest friend and the head of your family, and at times He even becomes your servant. So it is, dear one; yet to those who worship Him the Lord gives liberation, but bhakti-yoga He never gives." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 5.6.18)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Nārada said: "O child Yudhiṣṭhira! For you and for the Yadus, Bhagavān Kṛṣṇacandra is sometimes master, guru, worshipable Deity, dear friend, head of the family, and at times even a servant." Here one should understand this: to those who worship Him, Mukunda easily grants "liberation"; but when He sees that a devotee has some firm skill in worship (*niṣṭhā-cāturya*), He gives that devotee "*bhakti-yoga*."[2]

Anubhāṣya.

The words of Śukadeva to Parīkṣit, spoken while describing the life of Ṛṣabhadeva:

rājan (O king), **bhagavān mukundaḥ** (Śrī Kṛṣṇa) **bhavatām** (of you, the Pāṇḍavas) **yadūnāṁ ca patiḥ** (the supreme master and protector), **guruḥ** (the instructor), **daivam** (the worshipable Deity), **priyaḥ** (dear as one's very self), **kula-patiḥ**; **kva ca** (and at times — in embassies and other errands) **vaḥ** (of you, the Pāṇḍavas) **kiṅkaraḥ** (one who carries out orders) **ca**. **aṅga** (O dear one), **evam**

astu (let it be so; [yet this Bhagavān]) **bhajatām** (to people who worship Him, that is, to devotees with selfish desires) **muktiṁ dadāti**, **karhicit** (ever) ([to them]) **bhakti-yogaṁ na dadāti sma**.

*But in the pastime of Gaurasundara, the embodiment of magnanimity, *prema-bhakti* is given to all, down to the most fallen —*

20 Such love Śrī Caitanya gave everywhere, even to Jagāi and Mādhāi — what then of others?

Anubhāṣya.

Even sinful and wicked people like Jagāi and Mādhāi, once they receive Gaura's mercy, will give up sin and wickedness and one day attain *prema* for Śrī Kṛṣṇa.

*The pastime in which Mahāprabhu, without discrimination, anywhere at all, distributes His causeless, hidden *prema* —*

21 The independent Lord gave away prema, that hidden storehouse, to anyone at all, and made no distinctions.

Love for Kṛṣṇa awakens only through service to Gaura and Nitāi —

22 See it even today: whoever takes the name of Caitanya is overwhelmed with love for Kṛṣṇa, his body thrilling and his eyes streaming with tears.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

There is one wonderful feature of the avatāra of Śrī Caitanya. To anyone who comes near Him He gives the hidden storehouse of *prema*, without considering whether that person is worthy or not, for He is the independent Lord. Consider also that Caitanyacandra has descended as the guru of the whole world. Whether one is an offender or free from offense, if he surrenders and calls out to Him, "O Gaurāṅga! O Kṛṣṇa Caitanya!" he is overwhelmed by the thrill and the tears of love for Kṛṣṇa.

23 At the name "Nityānanda" love for Kṛṣṇa awakens; every limb is shaken, and a Ganges of tears flows.

While offenses remain, the holy name of Kṛṣṇa, worshipped by the liberated, does not arise —

24 The name of Kṛṣṇa takes account of offences: an offender may say "Kṛṣṇa", but love works no change in him.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Offenses against the holy name are listed in the *Padma Purāṇa*: (1) blasphemy of the saints; (2) thinking that the names and so on of Śiva are independent of Śrī Viṣṇu; (3) disregard for the guru; (4) blasphemy of the *śruti* and of the scriptures that follow it; (5) thinking that the glorification of Hari's name is mere exaggeration (*arthavāda*); (6) interpreting the name in some other way; (7) inclining to sin on the strength of the name; (8) thinking the name equal to other auspicious acts; (9) instructing the name to those who are faithless and have turned away from the Lord; (10) having no love for the name even after hearing of its glory. (For a detailed explanation see the *Anubhāṣya*.) As long as these ten offenses remain, Kṛṣṇa does not show mercy. In an offender, Kṛṣṇa's name does not produce genuine *sāttvika-vikāras* and the other signs.

Anubhāṣya.

The original verses on the ten offenses against the holy name: "(1) Blasphemy of the saints is the greatest offense against the name: how can it tolerate the reviling of those through whom it has gained fame? (2) Whoever here sees with his mind all the qualities, names and so on of the auspicious (*śiva*) Śrī Viṣṇu as separate, truly harms himself with Hari's name.[3] (3) Disregard for the guru; (4) blasphemy of the *śruti* and the *śāstras*; (5) the view that [the praise of the name] is *arthavāda*; (6) imagined interpretations of Hari's name. (7) One who, relying on the strength of the name, is inclined to sin is not purified by any *yamas* (restraints). (8) To consider [the name] equal to all auspicious acts — *dharma*, vows, renunciation, fire sacrifices and the rest — is also negligence. (9) Instruction given to one who lacks faith, has turned away [from the Lord] and does not wish to hear is an offense against the auspicious name. (10) And a man who, even after hearing of the glory of the name, has no love for it, absorbed in 'I' and 'mine,' also commits an offense."

(1) Blasphemy of the saints is the greatest offense before Śrī Nāma. Through the saints wholly devoted to the name, the glory of Kṛṣṇa's name becomes known in the world, that is, it is preached. How then will Śrī Nāma-Prabhu tolerate

blasphemy of these saints? Therefore blasphemy of sādhus is an offense against the name. (2) Someone in this world sees with his intellect a difference among the name, form, qualities, pastimes and so on of the all-auspicious Śrī Viṣṇu. That is, he thinks that the name, form, qualities and pastimes of Śrī Viṣṇu are different from Śrī Viṣṇu, the possessor of the name, as is the case with material things. Or he regards Śiva and the other gods as rivals and sees them as independent of Śrī Viṣṇu or different from Him. Such an offense against the name, committed under the guise of the name, certainly does him harm. (3) Envy (*asūyā*) toward the guru, the knower of the truth of the name, from regarding him as material and mortal; (4) blasphemy of the Vedas, the Sātvata Purāṇas and the other scriptures; (5) considering the glory of Hari's name to be exaggerated praise, and (6) thinking the names of Bhagavān to be imagination — these are offenses against the name. (7) If someone, relying on the strength of the name, is inclined to sinful conduct, that offender is certainly not purified by many *yamas*, many *niyamas*, or by the artificial methods of yoga — *dhyāna*, *dhāraṇā* and the rest. (8) To consider the chanting of the transcendental name equal or similar to material auspicious acts — *dharma*, vows, renunciation, fire sacrifices and the like — is also inattention, or negligence (*pramāda*); this too is an offense against the name. (9) To instruct one who lacks faith or is unwilling to hear the name is an offense before the all-auspicious Śrī Nāma. (10) Whoever, even after hearing the wonderful glory of the name, thinks in bodily terms of “I” and “mine” and shows no love or regard for chanting and hearing Śrī Nāma is also an offender against the name.

*Without the desire to please Kṛṣṇa, the emotion in an offender's stony heart is not pure — it is merely feigned (*Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam*, Canto 2, Chapter 3, verse 24) —*

25 “Alas, that heart is hard as stone which does not change when the names of Hari are chanted; for when the heart is changed, tears fill the eyes and the hairs of the body stand on end in joy.” (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 2.3.24)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

If, when a person takes Hari's name, his heart does not change, his eyes do not fill with tears and his hair does not stand on end, his heart is made of stone. That is, grave offenses have hardened his heart, and it does not melt at the name.

Anubhāṣya.

The sages were hearing from the lips of Śrī Sūta the conversation between Śrī Śuka and Parīkṣit and wanted to hear more and more. Condemning people unwilling to hear *hari-kathā*, Śaunaka said to Śrī Sūta:

yat hṛdayaṁ gṛhyamāṇaiḥ (even while they are being chanted) **hari-nāma-dheyaiḥ na vikriyeta**, **bata** (alas!) **tat idaṁ hṛdayam aśma-sāram** (that whose substance [*sāra*], because of offenses against the name, is like stone, like a piece of rock — that is, it is hard). **atha yadā vikāro** (occurs), ([then]) **netre jalaṁ** (tears) [and] **gātra-ruheṣu harṣaḥ** (the hair stands on end) (occurs). (In deeply grave *mahā-bhāgavatas* the heart melts at the names of Hari, yet outward tears, thrills and so on are not seen. But in those whose hearts are slippery (*picchila-citta*), who merely imitate by artificial practice and long for material prestige, feigned tears, thrills and the like are seen outwardly, though there is not even a semblance of *sattva* (*sattvābhāsa*). Therefore in *kaniṣṭha-adhikārīs*, even when they chant the name many times, the artificial melting of the heart, owing to their inclination toward sense enjoyment, is merely a sign of offense against the name. So says the *Sandarbha*.[4])

See the *Gauḍīya-bhāṣya* on the *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam*: the commentary of Śrīla Viśvanātha Cakravartī, the *Tathya* and the *Vivṛti*.

The self-manifest Nāma-Prabhu rises on the tongue and bestows love for Kṛṣṇa —

26 A single name of Kṛṣṇa destroys all sins and reveals devotion, from which love is born.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
He reveals the *sādhana-bhakti* that awakens *prema*.

*The signs of *kṛṣṇa-prema*, the fruit of the pure name —*

27 When love dawns, its transformations appear: sweat and trembling, the hairs standing on end, a faltering voice and flowing tears.

28 Worldly existence ends without effort, and one is given the service of Kṛṣṇa: such is the wealth that a single name of Kṛṣṇa brings.

For an offender against the name, countless hearing and chanting is fruitless —

29–30 If one takes such a name of Kṛṣṇa again and again, and still no love comes and no tears flow, then I know that his offences are many: the seed of Kṛṣṇa's name does not sprout in him.

Gaura and Nitāi, and Their names, do not judge offenses —

31 With Caitanya and Nityānanda there is no such reckoning of offences: as soon as one takes Their names They give love, and streams of tears flow.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

If someone takes shelter of Caitanya and Nityānanda with faith, all his past offenses are washed away in a moment; and as soon as Kṛṣṇa's name rises on his lips, the Lord gives him *prema*.

Anubhāṣya.

Those who have taken shelter of Śrī Caitanya and Nityānanda chant the pure name without duplicity, as the verse "*tṛṇād api*" teaches, and tears of love are seen to flow from them.

The name of Kṛṣṇa judges offenses; the name of Gaura and Nityānanda does not. If an offender chants Kṛṣṇa's name, he never obtains the fruit of the name, *kṛṣṇa-prema*. But one who chants the name of Gaura and Nityānanda, even while he remains an offender, is freed from his offenses as he goes on chanting and obtains the fruit of the name. The reasoning and conclusion here are as follows. A *sādhaka* who has turned away from Kṛṣṇa goes to Gaura and Nityānanda in order to turn toward Kṛṣṇa. The name of Kṛṣṇa is uttered by one who has attained perfection through practice, is free from *anarthas* and is turned toward Kṛṣṇa; as long as *anarthas* remain, it never gives its fruit, *kṛṣṇa-prema*. Gaura and Nityānanda can be served even by *jīvas* who have *anarthas*. Therefore, for an unfortunate *jīva*, serving Them is more necessary than serving Kṛṣṇa. If a *sādhaka* who has not received instruction thinks himself perfected and sets out to serve Kṛṣṇa's name, only *anarthas* come to him. But if, in the worship of Nitāi-Gaura, he does not pretend to be perfected and approaches the two Teachers, the gurus of the world, even while burdened with *anarthas*, They free such persons from *anarthas* and let them realize the true nature of Their *svayaṁ-rūpa* and

svayaṁ-prakāśa. Then knowledge of the *jīva*'s own true nature (*svarūpa*) dawns in him.

The name of Kṛṣṇa and the name of Gaura are both nondifferent from the possessor of the name. If someone considers Kṛṣṇa lesser or narrower than Gaura, that must be understood as the work of ignorance (*avidyā*). In truth, judged by what the *jīva* needs, chanting the names of Śrī Gaura and Nityānanda is more beneficial for him. Śrī Gaura and Nityānanda are magnanimous, and within that magnanimity They are sweet. Kṛṣṇa's magnanimity extends only to the liberated, the perfected and those surrendered to Him. But in the stream of Gaura-Nityānanda's magnanimity even an offending *jīva* with *anarthas* is freed from the grip of offenses born of the desire for enjoyment and attains the lotus feet of Gaura-Kṛṣṇa.

There is no other path than the worship of the supremely magnanimous Gaura

—

32 The Lord is independent and supremely magnanimous; without worshipping Him there is never any deliverance.

Anubhāṣya.

“The worship of Śrī Caitanya” does not mean the worship of a Gaura other than Rādhā and Kṛṣṇa, giving up Kṛṣṇa. In such imagined worship, which is service to *māyā*, the sweetness of *kṛṣṇa-prema* is not present. There are people who override the ācāryas — Śrī Svarūpa, Rūpa, Raghunātha and the others, Śrī Caitanya's dearest intimate associates — and think that by their invented efforts they have worshipped Gaura. Such people are never delivered. When their outrages, conceived by *māyā*, are directed at the form of Śrī Gaurāṅga, nondifferent from Rādhā and Kṛṣṇa, great offense, and with it their descent toward hell, quickly increase. Then, trying to find fault with the devotees devoted to the service of Rādhā and Kṛṣṇa, they offend the feet of the ācāryas headed by Śrī Rūpa. Thus they reveal that, though with their lips they call Śrī Gaurāṅga “the source of the avatāras” (*avatārī*), in their minds they regard Him merely as a sādhu, like other preachers of passing, mind-made religions (*mano-dharma*).

*The *jīva*'s highest good lies in hearing the *Caitanya-bhāgavata* of*

Ṭhākura Vṛndāvana dāsa, the avatāra of Vyāsa —

33 O foolish people, hear the *Caitanya-maṅgala*, and from it you will know all the glory of Caitanya!

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

"*Caitanya-maṅgala*" is the *Caitanya-bhāgavata* of Śrī Vṛndāvana dāsa Ṭhākura, who lived in the village of Denuḍa (Mantreśvara police station, Barddhamāna district). Earlier that book was called *Caitanya-maṅgala*. There is a tradition that when Locana dāsa Ṭhākura began to sing his own *Caitanya-maṅgala*, Vṛndāvana dāsa Ṭhākura changed the name of his book.

34 Veda-vyāsa told the pastimes of Kṛṣṇa in the *Bhāgavata*; the Vyāsa of Caitanya's pastimes is Vṛndāvana dāsa.

Anubhāṣya.

Śrī Vṛndāvana dāsa: see "The Life of the Ṭhākura" in the introduction to the *Śrī Caitanya-bhāgavata* edited by the author of this commentary.

35 Vṛndāvana dāsa composed the *Caitanya-maṅgala*, and by hearing it all that is inauspicious is destroyed.

*The *Caitanya-bhāgavata* is a mine of the glory of Gaura and Nitāi and of the conclusions of devotion —*

36 In it one comes to know the glory of Caitanya and Nitāi, and in it I come to know the conclusions of devotion to Kṛṣṇa to their farthest limit.

Anubhāṣya.

The *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* is the original source of the conclusions of devotion (*bhakti-siddhānta*). But it is very extensive, and many are unable to grasp its essence. Śrī Vṛndāvana dāsa Ṭhākura recorded that essence in his own *Śrī Caitanya-bhāgavata*. Only those who know the conclusions of devotion to Kṛṣṇa are able to understand properly the glory of Śrī Nitāi-Gaura. All books of devotion declare at the top of their voice that without *bhakti-siddhānta* Bhakti-devī cannot be served.

37 He understood the essence of all the conclusions of devotion in the *Bhāgavata*, drew it out and set it down in his book.

*Hearing the *Caitanya-bhāgavata* makes even the wicked good —*

38 If even an unbeliever or a yavana hears the *Caitanya-maṅgala*, he becomes a great Vaiṣṇava at that very moment.

Its unearthly composition —

39 No human being could compose so blessed a book: it is Śrī Caitanya who speaks through the mouth of Vṛndāvana dāsa.

By a single book he delivered the world —

40 Millions of obeisances at the feet of Vṛndāvana dāsa! By writing such a book he delivered the world.

Śrī Vṛndāvana dāsa, the son of Nārāyaṇī, the recipient of the Lord's mercy —

41 Nārāyaṇī partook of Caitanya's remnants, and from her womb Śrī Vṛndāvana dāsa was born.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Nārāyaṇī was the daughter of Śrīvāsa Paṇḍita's brother. As a child she used to receive the remnants of Mahāprabhu's meal at the end of *kīrtana*.

Anubhāṣya.

Śrī Kavi-karṇapūra writes about Śrī Nārāyaṇī Devī in the *Śrī Gaura-gaṇoddeśa-dīpikā*: "The sister of Ambikā, named Śrīla Kilimbikā, who ate the remnants of Kṛṣṇa's food, is considered to be this Nārāyaṇī." Ambikā is Śrī Kṛṣṇa's nurse, and her sister is Kilimbikā. She used to eat Kṛṣṇa's remnants. She herself, in the avatāra of Śrī Gaura, is "Nārāyaṇī Devī."

Ṭhākura Śrī Vṛndāvana is the son born of Nārāyaṇī, the niece of Śrīvāsa. His mother, the Ṭhākurāṇī, ate the remnants of Śrī Gaurasundara's meals (*vighasāśī*), that is, she received His mercy. The Ṭhākura Mahāśaya is known through her. And since naming one's forefathers is not needed to introduce a Vaiṣṇava, they have been left out here.

By describing the life of Gaura he delivered the world —

42 How wonderful is his description of Caitanya's deeds! By hearing it the three worlds were purified.

*Auspiciousness lies only in worshipping Nitāi-Gaura; hence the appeal to the *jīvas* —*

43 Therefore, O people, worship Caitanya and Nityānanda! The misery of worldly life will be cut away, and you will attain the bliss of love.

*Ṭhākura Vṛndāvana described Gaura's pastimes first briefly, as *sūtras*, and then in detail —*

44 Vṛndāvana dāsa composed the *Caitanya-maṅgala*, and in it he told all the pastimes of Caitanya.

45 First he set down all the pastimes in a brief summary, and afterwards described them at length.

46 The pastimes of Caitanya-candra are endless and boundless, and as he went on describing them the book grew long.

*But fearing the book would grow too large, he did not wish to expand the *sūtras* —*

47 Seeing its length, he grew somewhat hesitant, and some of the pastimes held in the summary he did not describe.

Absorbed in describing Nitāi's pastimes, he left the description of Gaura's final pastimes incomplete —

48 He became absorbed in describing the pastimes of Nityānanda, and Caitanya's final pastimes were left untold.

The residents of Vṛndāvana wish to hear of Gaura's final pastimes —

49 The devotees of Vṛndāvana longed to hear the account of all those pastimes.

A description of the service of Śrī Govinda on a jeweled throne beneath the wish-fulfilling tree —

50 In Vṛndāvana, beneath a wish-fulfilling tree, stands a golden temple; there is the great Yogapīṭha, and in it a jewelled throne.

51 On it the son of the king of Vraja is ever seated: His name is Śrī Govinda-deva, the very God of love.

52 There He is served like a king in many wonderful ways, with divine offerings, divine garments and ornaments.

53 A thousand servants attend Him constantly; that service could not be described even with a thousand mouths.

A description of the virtues of Śrī Haridāsa Paṇḍita, the superintendent of His service —

54 The superintendent of that service is Śrī Haridāsa Paṇḍita, whose fame and virtues are known throughout the world.

Anubhāṣya.

Paṇḍita Haridāsa: his gurudeva was Śrī Ananta Ācārya, a disciple of Śrī Gadādhara Paṇḍita Gosvāmī. See verses 59–65 below and the *Anubhāṣya* on them.

55 He is gentle, patient, serene, generous and grave, sweet in speech and sweet in conduct, and steady beyond measure.

56 He honours everyone and works for the good of all; his heart is free of crookedness, envy and malice.

57 The fifty good qualities of Kṛṣṇa that are shared in part by others all dwell in his person.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Kṛṣṇa's general good qualities are fifty. These fifty qualities are described in the verse "*ayaṁ netā suramyāṅgaḥ*…" ("This Hero has a most beautiful body…") and following (*Bhakti-rasāmṛta-sindhu*, *Dakṣiṇa-vibhāga*, First Wave).

*(*Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam*, Canto 5, Chapter 18, verse 12)*

58 "In one whose devotion to the Lord is free of desire all the gods dwell, and with them every virtue. But how can great qualities be found in one who is not devoted to Hari? Driven by his desires, his mind is forever running outward after what is passing." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 5.18.12)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

In one who has exclusive devotion (*kevalā bhakti*) to Śrī Kṛṣṇa, all the gods reside with all good qualities. But the mind of one devoid of devotion to Hari always runs toward false, external objects. Great qualities are impossible for him.

Anubhāṣya.

Describing the qualities of the great devotee Prahlāda, Śrī Śukadeva says to Mahārāja Parīkṣit:

yasya (of which devotee) **bhagavati** (for Śrī Viṣṇu) **akiñcanā** (free from selfish desire) **bhaktiḥ** (the inclination to serve in a way favorable to Him) **asti** (there is), **tatra** (in that devotee) **surāḥ** (all the gods) **sarvaiḥ guṇaiḥ** (with the whole multitude of good qualities) **samāsate** (fully reside, dwell eternally). **asati** (in the transient happiness of sense objects) **mano-rathena** (by the mind's desires) **bahiḥ dhāvataḥ** (of one bent on enjoyment) **harau abhaktasya** (of one not devoted to Hari — one who follows the path of other desires, karma, *jñāna* or yoga; and so of a person attached to home and the like, since for him devotion to Hari is impossible) **kutaḥ mahad-guṇāḥ** (the qualities of the great — knowledge, renunciation and the rest, or the multitudes of excellent virtues; supply "can arise").

Who Paṇḍita Haridāsa was, and his guru-paramparā —

59 Ananta Ācārya was the disciple of Paṇḍita Gosāñi; his very body was made of love for Kṛṣṇa, and he was generous and noble in every way.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
"Paṇḍita Gosāñi" is Śrī Gadādhara Paṇḍita.

60 Who could recount his endless virtues? And this Haridāsa Paṇḍita is his dear disciple.

Anubhāṣya.
Sudevī-sakhī, one of the eight *sakhīs*, is in the avatāra of Gaura (1) Śrī Ananta Ācārya, as stated in the *Gaura-gaṇoddeśa* (verse 165): "Ananta Ācārya Gosvāmī was formerly Sudevī in Vraja." The famous "Gaṅgāmātā Maṭha" in Śrī Puruṣottama is one branch of his line. In the guru-paramparā of that *maṭha* he is called "Vinoda Mañjarī." (2) His disciple is Śrī Haridāsa Paṇḍita Gosvāmī, also called "Śrī Raghu Gopāla" — Śrī Rāsa Mañjarī. His disciple was (3) Śrī Lakṣmīpriyā (the aunt of Gaṅgāmātā, the wife of her maternal uncle). (4) Śrī Gaṅgāmātā was the daughter of the king of Puṭiyā. She brought the Deity "Śrī Rasika-rāya" from Kṛṣṇa Miśra of Jaipur and established His service in Puruṣottama, in the house of Sārvabhauma. (5) Śrī Vanamālī, (6) Śrī Bhagavān dāsa (of Bengal), (7) Śrī Madhusūdana dāsa (of Orissa), (8) Śrī Nīlāmbara dāsa, (9) Śrī Narottama dāsa, (10) Śrī Pītāmbara dāsa, (11) Śrī Mādhava dāsa, (12) his disciple — at present the *mahānta* of the Gaṅgāmātā Maṭha.

His attachment to Nitāi and Gaura —

61 His faith in Caitanya and Nityānanda is boundless, and the deeds of Caitanya fill him with the greatest joy.

Deep love for the Vaiṣṇavas —

62 He takes in the virtues of the Vaiṣṇavas and never sees their faults; with body, mind and words he seeks to please them.

*He reads the *Caitanya-bhāgavata* in the assembly of Vaiṣṇavas —*

63 He listens constantly to the *Caitanya-maṅgala*, and by his grace all the Vaiṣṇavas hear it too.

64 Like the full moon he lights up the assembly with his words, and with the nectar of his virtues he increases the joy of the Vaiṣṇavas.

The order to the author to describe Gaura's final pastimes —

65 Out of his great mercy he gave me the order to describe Gaurāṅga's final pastimes.

Separate introductions of the devotees who gave the same order —

66 Govinda Gosāñi, the disciple of Kāśīśvara Gosāñi, is the dear servant of Govinda, and there is none to equal him.

Anubhāṣya.

Śrī Kāśīśvara (Paṇḍita) Gosvāmī was a disciple of Śrī Īśvara Purī and the son of Vāsudeva Bhaṭṭācārya of the Vātsya *gotra*, of the Kāñjilāla Kānu family. His family title was Caudhurī. His nephew, his sister's son, was Śrī Rudra Paṇḍita of Vallabhapura (see verse 106).[5] In the village of Cātarā, one mile from Śrīrāmapura station, there are Deities of Śrī Rādhā-Govinda and Śrī Gaurāṅga established by him. He was very strong: every day, when Śrīman Mahāprabhu went to see Jagannātha, Kāśīśvara walked ahead, pushed the crowd aside and cleared the way for Him (see Ādi 10.138–142; Madhya 12.207; 13.89). In Puruṣottama he distributed *prasāda* to the devotees after *kīrtana*. On his meeting with Mahāprabhu see Madhya 10.134, 185.

The present superintendent of the service is Śrī Śivacandra Caudhurī, of the line of Kāśīśvara Gosvāmī Prabhu's brother. Here nine seers of rice are allotted daily for the service. From of old there were lands near the village set aside for the service of the Deity, but the descendants of his brother lost all that property in the courts, and the service is now poorly provided for. In the *Śrī Gaura-gaṇoddeśa* (verses 137 and 166) it is said that he who in Vṛndāvana was Kṛṣṇa's servant "Bhṛṅgāra," or she who was "Śaśirekhā," is Kāśīśvara in the avatāra of Gaura (?).

67 Yādavācārya Gosāñi, the companion of Śrī Rūpa, takes the greatest delight in Caitanya's deeds.

68 Bhūgarbha Gosāñi, the disciple of Paṇḍita Gosāñi, has nothing on his lips but talk of Gaura.

69 His disciples are Caitanya-dāsa, the priest of Govinda, Mukundānanda Cakravartī and Kṛṣṇadāsa, full of love.

Anubhāṣya.
The disciples of Bhūgarbha (Ādi 12.81) were Caitanya dāsa, Mukundānanda and Kṛṣṇadāsa. On Śivānanda see Ādi 12.87.

70 Śivānanda Cakravartī, the disciple of Ācārya Gosāñi, holds Śrī Caitanya and Nityānanda ever in his heart.[1]

71 And all the other devotees who live in Vṛndāvana wished to hear the final pastimes.

72 In their compassion they all gave me the order, and at their word I write, casting off all shame.

At the order of the Vaiṣṇavas he reverently asks permission of Śrī Madana-Gopāla —

73 Having received the Vaiṣṇavas' order, I went with an anxious heart to Madana-gopāla to beg for His order too.

As soon as he made his request through the priest Gosāñi dāsa, the garland of command fell from Madana-Gopāla before all the Vaiṣṇavas —

74 When I had seen Him, I bowed at His feet; the pūjārī Gosāñi-dāsa was serving His feet.

75 When I begged at the Lord's feet for His order, the garland slipped from His neck and fell.

76 All the Vaiṣṇavas cried out "Hari!", and Gosāñi-dāsa brought the garland and placed it around my neck.

Receiving the garland of command, he set out to write this book —

77 Receiving the garland of His order, I was filled with joy, and then and there I began this book.

Madana-mohana Himself is wholly the doer and inspirer of the book's composition —

78 It is Madana-mohana who makes me write this book; my writing is like the recitation of a parrot.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

That I have written this *Caitanya-caritāmṛta* is by the inspiration of Śrī Madana-mohana. Therefore, like a parrot reciting what it was taught, I have no merit of my own.

Thus ends the eighth chapter of the "Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya."

79 I write what Madana-gopāla makes me write, as a magician makes a wooden doll dance.

The service of Madana-mohana in the author's guru-paramparā —

80 My family Deity is Madana-mohana, whose servants are Raghunātha, Rūpa and Sanātana.

As befits a Vaiṣṇava, the author regards Ṭhākura Vṛndāvana dāsa as his guru and bows to him —

81 Meditating on the lotus feet of Vṛndāvana dāsa and taking his permission, I write what brings blessing.

82 In the pastimes of Caitanya, Vṛndāvana dāsa is Vyāsa; without his mercy no one else can reveal them.

Words of humility —

83 I am foolish, low and insignificant, greedy for the objects of the senses; it is by the strength of the Vaiṣṇavas' order that I make so bold.

Anubhāṣya.
Thus ends the eighth chapter of the "Anubhāṣya."

84 This is the strength of the feet of Śrī Rūpa and Raghunātha, by remembering whom every desire is fulfilled.

85 Praying at the feet of Śrī Rūpa and Śrī Raghunātha, I, Kṛṣṇadāsa, narrate the *Caitanya-caritāmṛta*.

Notes

1. *Ācārya Gosāñi* — by the context (8.59–60), Ananta Ācārya; in Ādi 12.87 Śivānanda Cakravartī is counted in the branch of Gadādhara Paṇḍita. ↩
2. The verse translation reads differently: the verse is given there as the words of Śukadeva Gosvāmī to Mahārāja Parīkṣit (*Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 5.6.18; so also in the *Anubhāṣya*), and it says that the Lord gives *bhakti-yoga* to no one. ↩
3. *Śivasya* can also be read as "of Śiva"; it then refers to one who sees the names and qualities of Śiva as different from Śrī Viṣṇu, that is, as independent. In the explanation below Bhaktisiddhānta gives both readings. ↩
4. Apparently Śrī Jīva Gosvāmī's *Krama-sandarbha* on this verse. ↩
5. The edition does not name the chapter. ↩

“Śrī Caitanya-caritāmṛta”

Ādi-līlā

Chapter 9

The Description of the Wish-fulfilling Tree of Bhakti

(English translation from the Bengali, following the Gauḍīya Maṭha edition and the «Anubhāṣya», 2026 — draft)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya

Summary. In the ninth chapter the author describes devotion as a tree and so reveals a mystery. He makes Viśvambhara Gaurāṅga the main tree and describes Him as the gardener of the tree of devotion and as the giver and enjoyer of its fruit. The planting of this fruit tree began in Śrī Navadvīpa-dhāma; later such gardens of the fruit of *prema* were extended to Puruṣottama, Vṛndāvana and other places. Śrī Mādhavendra Purī is the first sprout of this tree, and his disciple Śrī Īśvara Purī nourished that sprout. Mahāprabhu Caitanyadeva, though He is the gardener, by His inconceivable power also became the trunk of this tree. The nine *sannyāsīs* headed by Paramānanda Purī are its roots. Above the main trunk two more trunks arose, Śrī Advaita and Śrī Nityānanda. From these two trunks came forth branches and sub-branches of every kind, which encircled the world. The fruit of *prema* from this tree was given everywhere to everyone without distinction. Having planted the tree of devotion in this way, the Lord let the world taste its fruit and made the whole world mad. This description is an allegory (*rūpaka*).

By Gaura's mercy the impossible becomes possible —

1 I worship the glorious Lord Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya, the guru of the whole world, by whose mercy even a dog can easily swim across the great ocean.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

I bow down to Kṛṣṇa Caitanyadeva, the guru of the world, by whose mercy even a dog can swim across the great ocean.

Anubhāṣya.

yasya (of Caitanyadeva) **anukampayā** (by the mercy) **śvā** (a dog) **api mahābdhiṁ** (the great ocean) **sukhaṁ santaret** (may swim across, reaching the other shore), **taṁ jagad-gurum** (the guru of the whole world, worthy of worship) **śrīmat-kṛṣṇa-caitanya-devam** (I) **vande**.

2 Glory, glory to Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya Gauracandra! Glory, glory to Advaita, and glory, glory to Nityānanda!

3 Glory, glory to Śrīvāsa and all the devotees of Gaura, whose remembrance fulfils every desire!

4 I remember also Śrī Rūpa, Sanātana, Raghunātha Bhaṭṭa, Śrī Jīva, Gopāla Bhaṭṭa and Raghunātha Dāsa.

5 By the mercy of them all I write of the pastimes and qualities of Śrī Caitanya. Whether I understand them or not, I do it for my own purification.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

"*Āpana-śodhana*": for one's own purification.

The gardener is Mahāprabhu Himself —

6 I take shelter of Śrī Caitanya, who is Himself the gardener and Himself the immortal tree of love for Kṛṣṇa, and who both gives away its fruits and enjoys them.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Śrī Caitanya Himself is the divine tree of *prema*, and He Himself is its gardener. I take shelter of Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya, who gives and enjoys the fruits of that tree.

Anubhāṣya.

yaḥ (Caitanyadeva) **svayaṁ mālākāraḥ** (the keeper of the garden), **svayaṁ kṛṣṇa-premāmara-taruḥ** (love for Kṛṣṇa itself, the immortal, imperishable tree, that is, the wish-fulfilling tree), **tat-phalānāṁ** (of the fruits of *prema* of that wish-fulfilling tree) **dātā bhoktā** [**ca**] ([Himself]), **taṁ** (in Caitanya — I) **āśraye** (take refuge).

*Why He became the gardener — to fulfill His position as the Lord of *abhidheya*, the means —*

7 The Lord said to Himself: "I bear the name Viśvambhara, 'He who fills the universe'. My name will be true if I fill the universe with love."

He lays out a garden of the fruits of devotion in Navadvīpa —

8 Thinking thus, the Lord took up the work of a gardener and began to lay out an orchard in Navadvīpa.

9 Bringing it to the earth, the gardener Śrī Caitanya planted the wish-fulfilling tree of bhakti and watered it with the water of His will.

Its first sprout — Śrī Mādhavendra Purī —

10 Glory to Śrī Mādhava Purī, brimming with love for Kṛṣṇa! He is the first sprout of the wish-fulfilling tree of bhakti.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

"Śrī Mādhava Purī" is Mādhavendra Purī. He was a famous *sannyāsī* in the *sampradāya* of Śrī Madhvācārya, and Śrī Caitanyadeva was the disciple of his disciple. Before him there was no sign of *prema-bhakti* in the Śrī Madhva-sampradāya. In his verse "*ayi dīna-dayārdra nātha*…" the teaching that Mahāprabhu later gave was present in seed form.

Growth in Īśvara Purī —

11 In the form of Śrī Īśvara Purī the sprout grew strong, and then the gardener, Śrī Caitanya Himself, became the trunk of the tree.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

"Īśvara Purī": Īśvara Purī, the *mantra-guru* of Mahāprabhu, was born in a brāhmaṇa family in Kumārahaṭṭa, that is, in the village of Hālisahara. He was a disciple of Mādhavendra Purī.

Anubhāṣya.

Śrī Īśvara Purī was born in a brāhmaṇa family in Kumārahaṭṭa (Hālisahara station on the E.B.R. line) and was the dearest disciple of Śrī Mādhavendra Purī. Antya 8.26–29: "Īśvara Purī served his master's feet and with his own hands cleaned away stool and urine. He constantly made him remember Kṛṣṇa's name and made him hear Kṛṣṇa's name and pastimes at every moment. Pleased, Purī embraced him and gave the blessing: 'May you have the treasure of love for Kṛṣṇa.' From then on Īśvara Purī became an ocean of love…"

Before initiating Śrī Mahāprabhu into the ten-syllable mantra at Gayā, Īśvara Purī came to the town of Navadvīpa and stayed several months in the house of Gopīnātha Ācārya. At that time he conversed with Śrī Mahāprabhu and had Him hear his own book, the *Kṛṣṇa-līlāmṛta*. See the *Caitanya-bhāgavata*, Ādi, Chapter 7.

When Śrīman Mahāprabhu came to Kumārahaṭṭa to see the birthplace of Śrīpāda Īśvara Purī, He showed this pastime to teach the *jīvas* devotion to the guru: "The Lord Himself picked up earth from that place, tied it in a bundle in His outer cloth and took it with Him." (*Caitanya-bhāgavata*, Ādi, Chapter 12) Since then everyone who comes to see the place of Īśvara Purī takes earth from there.

By His inconceivable power, though the gardener, He Himself became the trunk and the support of all the branches —

12 By His own inconceivable power the gardener became the trunk, the original support of all the branches.

*The nine *sannyāsīs* — the nine roots —*

13–15 At the base of the tree nine roots sprang up: Paramānanda Purī and Keśava Bhāratī, Brahmānanda Purī and Brahmānanda Bhāratī, Viṣṇu Purī, Keśava Purī, Kṛṣṇānanda Purī, Śrī Nṛsiṁha Tīrtha and Sukhānanda Purī. On them the tree stood immovable.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

All the *sannyāsīs* named “Purī” are related to Śrī Īśvara Purī, and all those named “Bhāratī” are related to Keśava Bhāratī, the guru who gave Mahāprabhu *sannyāsa*.

Anubhāṣya.

Keśava Purī, Kṛṣṇānanda Purī, Nṛsiṁha Tīrtha and Sukhānanda Purī. In the *Gaura-gaṇoddeśa* (verses 97–100): “Kṛṣṇānanda, Keśava, Śrī Dāmodara and Rāghava, Ananta, Sukhānanda, Govinda and Raghunātha — with the title ‘Purī,’ in that order — are to be known as the eight *siddhis* beginning with *aṇimā*. The nine sons of Jayantī, steadfast in celibacy and equal-sighted — the nine *bhāgavatas* who formerly, as the *Śrī Bhāgavata-saṁhitā* relates, answered Janaka — have now become *sannyāsīs* and always sport with the Lord Gaurahari, as before: Śrī Nṛsiṁhānanda Tīrtha, Śrī Satyānanda Bhāratī, Śrī Nṛsiṁha, Cidānanda and Jagannātha — the Tīrthas.”

Anubhāṣya.

Paramānanda Purī was a brāhmaṇa from Trihuta (Tirhut), a disciple of Śrī Mādhavendra Purī and very dear to Śrī Mahāprabhu. *Caitanya-bhāgavata* (Antya, Chapter 11): “Among the *sannyāsīs* the Lord's dear one is he alone, Purī Gosāñi, and no other. Dāmodara-Svarūpa and Paramānanda Purī — these two alone have a place among His *sannyāsī* associates. Both are always near Him, and in the Lord’s *sannyāsa* they take up the *daṇḍa*. Purī is absorbed in meditation, Dāmodara in *kīrtana*. *** As much love as the Lord has for Purī Gosāñi, so much He has for Dāmodara-Svarūpa.”

The Lord's words on seeing Paramānanda Purī (*Caitanya-bhāgavata*, Antya, Chapter 3): “Today My eyes are blessed, today My birth has borne fruit, today all My *dharma* has borne fruit. The Lord said: ‘Today My *sannyāsa* has borne fruit; today Mādhavendra has appeared to Me.’ For a long while they bowed to each other. Paramānanda Purī is Caitanya's beloved abode.”

Paramānanda Purī lived in Puruṣottama, west of the temple, where he made a *maṭha* for himself and dug a well. The water of the well was bad, and Mahāprabhu said (*Caitanya-bhāgavata*, Antya, Chapter 3): “‘Mahāprabhu Jagannātha, give Me this boon: let the Gaṅgā enter this well.’ The Lord said: ‘Listen, all devotees! Whoever bathes in or drinks the water of this well will truly obtain the fruit of bathing in the Gaṅgā and will have the purest devotion to Kṛṣṇa.’ The Lord said: ‘Know for certain that I remain on earth out of love for Purī

Gosāñi.’” In the *Gaura-gaṇoddeśa* (verse 118): “Śrī Paramānanda Purī was formerly Uddhava.”

Keśava Bhāratī belonged to the “Bhāratī” *sampradāya*, one of the *sampradāyas* of the *daṇḍīs* of the ten names founded by Śrī Śaṅkara. Three *sampradāyas* — Sarasvatī, Bhāratī and Purī — are under the Śṛṅgerī *maṭha* in the south. Śrī Keśava Bhāratī was living at that time in a branch *maṭha* at Kāṭoyā. Some say that, although he was a *brahma-sannyāsī*, he received his mantra from Śrī Mādhavendra Purīpāda of the Śrī Mādhva-sampradāya and was a Vaiṣṇava *sannyāsī*. In the village of Khāṭundi (Kāndarā post office, Barddhamāna district) he established the service of a Deity and a *maṭha*. According to the proprietors of the *maṭha*, they are of Keśava Bhāratī's line: Keśava had sons (by another account, disciples) named Niśāpati and Uṣāpati. Of Niśāpati's line, Śrī Nakaṛicandra Vidyāratna is now the custodian of the service, and Uṣāpati's line lives at Rākhāladāsapura near Baiṁci in Hooghly. They may be descendants from Keśava Bhāratī's life before *sannyāsa*. According to some, Keśava Bhāratī's brother — or, by another account, Balabhadra, a disciple of his disciple Mādhava Bhāratī — also became a Bhāratī. From his life before *sannyāsa* he had two sons, Madana and Gopāla. Madana lived in Āuriyā and Gopāla in Denduḍa. Madana's descendants bear the title “Bhāratī,” and Gopāla's the title “Brahmacārī.” Many members of both families are still living. In the *Gaura-gaṇoddeśa* (verse 52): “The sage Sāndīpani, who formerly gave Kṛṣṇa the sacred thread in Mathurā, has now become Keśava Bhāratī.” Verse 117: “Some say that Keśava Bhāratī is Akrūra.” In 1432 of the Śaka era he gave *sannyāsa* to Nimāi Paṇḍita at Kāṭoyā. See the *Vaiṣṇava-mañjuṣā*, issue 2.

Śrī Brahmānanda Purī was Śrī Mahāprabhu's companion in *kīrtana* during His pastimes in Navadvīpa. Before and at the time of His *sannyāsa*, Mahāprabhu especially trusted him. He also came with the Lord to Nīlācala.

Śrī Brahmānanda Bhāratī came to Nīlācala for the Lord's *darśana* dressed in a deerskin. Śrī Mahāprabhu Himself went up to him and, as if He did not recognize him, said that He wished to see Bhāratī. Hearing this, Brahmānanda took off the deerskin and put on a saffron outer cloth. He lived for some time in Nīlācala near Mahāprabhu.

Paramānanda Purī — the central root —

16 The central root is Paramānanda Purī, a man of great steadfastness, and on these nine roots the tree stood secure.[1]

From them, countless branches and sub-branches —

17 From the trunk many branches grew, and as they rose higher and higher, they became countless.

18 The branches grew in circles of twenty, and the mighty boughs covered all the universes.

19 Each branch put out hundreds of smaller ones. Who can count how many sprang up?

20 I shall list the names of the chief branches further on; now hear the description of the tree.[2]

On the two sides of the main trunk, two trunks — Nitāi and Advaita —

21 Higher up, the tree branched into two trunks: one is named Advaita, and the other Nityānanda.[3]

The spread through a succession of branches and sub-branches — disciples and their disciples —

22 Many branches sprang from those two trunks, and their offshoots covered the world.

23 Great branches, smaller branches and their offshoots filled the world. Who could ever write them all down?

24 Disciples, the disciples of disciples and their followers spread over the world beyond all counting.

25 As the udumbara fig bears fruit on all its limbs, so the tree of bhakti bears fruit everywhere.

And so the pastime in which Gaura the gardener distributes the nectarean fruits of love for Kṛṣṇa —

26 On the branches and offshoots of the main trunk grew the fruit of love, sweeter than nectar.

*The fruits of *prema* are given away free —*

27 When the fruit of love ripened, sweet as nectar, the gardener Caitanya gave it away and asked no price.

Anubhāṣya.
"*Mūla*": price (*mūlya*).

28 All the wealth and jewels of the three worlds I would not count as the price of a single fruit.

Distribution without regard to who is worthy or unworthy —

29 Whether one asks or not, whether one is worthy or unworthy, He does not consider; He simply gives.

*The deliverance of poor and suffering *jīvas* —*

30 Filling His hands again and again, He scatters the fruit in all directions; the poor gather it up and eat, and the gardener smiles.

31 The gardener said: "Listen, O family of the tree, all you main branches and offshoots of every kind!

*The whole tree of Caitanya is full of consciousness, and by tasting its conscious fruits the insensible *jīva* gains consciousness —*

32 This wondrous tree is wholly spiritual and does the work of all the senses. Though rooted like any tree, it moves and acts like a living creature.

33 All the limbs of this tree are conscious, and as they grow, they spread through all the worlds.

*Seeing that He alone cannot preach the name and *prema*, He orders everyone to distribute without discrimination —*

34 I am a lone gardener. How many places can I go to? How many fruits can I pick and give away by Myself?

35 It is hard work to pick them and give them out alone, and I am left in doubt: some will receive them, and some will not.

36 Therefore I give this order to all of you: wherever you are, give the fruit of love to anyone and everyone.

37 I am a lone gardener. How many fruits can I eat? And if I do not give this fruit away, what else shall I do with it?

38 I water the tree unceasingly with the nectar of My own desire, and so it bears countless fruits.

*By tasting *prema* the *jīva* attains immortality —*

39 Therefore give all these fruits away to anyone, and let people eat them and be free from old age and death.

*Seeing Gaura's mercy, the *jīva* attains eternal good in chanting Gaura's name —*

40 My holy fame will spread through the world, and people will sing My glory with joy.

Anubhāṣya.

Piety makes people in the world happy, and the spread of sin increases human misery. The pure life of the pious is glorified, while people do not even wish to speak of the outrages of the sinful. In the same way, when the people of the world become happy by obtaining *kṛṣṇa-prema*, the good fame of the One who gives *prema* will grow.

Everyone born as a human being in the land of Bhārata must show people eternal mercy — that is, turn them toward Kṛṣṇa —

41 Let everyone who has taken human birth in the land of Bhārata make that birth fruitful by working for the good of others.

Anubhāṣya.

To be born a human being in holy Bhāratavarṣa and to do the world real, eternal good — this is the fulfillment of having received a body in the holiest land and among the highest of beings.

*To turn the *jīva* toward devotion to Kṛṣṇa by body, mind and words is the highest mercy, the highest auspicious act (*Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam*, Canto 10, Chapter 22, verse 35) —*

42 ‘This alone is the true success of birth for embodied beings in this world: always to do good to others with one’s life, wealth, intelligence and words.’ (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 10.22.35)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

The fulfillment of birth for an embodied *jīva* is always to do good to others with his life, wealth, intelligence and speech.

Anubhāṣya.

After the pastime of stealing the garments, Śrī Kṛṣṇa went far away with His friends, the cowherd boys, and sat down to rest beneath some trees. Seeing how the

trees help others and how compassionate and tolerant they are, He pointed to them and said to His friends:

sadā prāṇaiḥ arthaiḥ dhiyā vācā (by every means) **dehiṣu** (toward the *jīvas*) **śreya ācaraṇam** (doing eternal good — that is, removing their aversion to Bhagavān, turning them toward Him, and so fully showing eternal mercy) — **etāvat eva iha** (in this world) **dehinām** (for the *jīvas*) **janma-sāphalyam** ([is], to be supplied).

*(*Viṣṇu Purāṇa*, Part 3, Chapter 12, verse 45)*

43 'By deeds, thoughts and words the wise should do only that which brings good to living beings, in this world and the next.' (Viṣṇu Purāṇa, 3.12.45)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
An intelligent person does by deed, mind and word whatever benefits living beings in this life and the next.

Anubhāṣya.
mati-mān (an intelligent person) **yat eva karma iha** (in this world) **paratra** (in the next) **ca prāṇinām upakārāya** (for their eternal good) [is], **tat eva** (that is, only what produces the *sukṛti* that turns one toward devotion to Bhagavān) **karmaṇā manasā vācā** (by body, mind and words) **bhajet**.

44 I am a gardener, a man with no kingdom and no riches. By giving away fruits and flowers I earn merit.

Seeing the causeless mercy of the tree, He wishes to become the original wish-fulfilling tree —

45 I am the gardener, and yet I have become the tree, for that was My wish: a tree benefits every living being.

*(*Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam*, Canto 10, Chapter 22, verse 33)*

46 'Ah, how excellent is the birth of these trees, which sustains all living beings! Like a good man, they never let one who asks of them go away

disappointed.’” (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 10.22.33)[4]

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Pointing to the trees, He says: “Oh, all living beings live by them! Their birth is fruitful. Those who ask never leave them empty-handed. They behave like good people.”

Thus ends the ninth chapter of the “Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.”

Anubhāṣya.

After the pastime of stealing the garments, Śrī Kṛṣṇa went far away with His friends, the cowherd boys, and rested beneath the trees. Seeing the trees' tolerance and their constant readiness to help others, He pointed to them and said to His friends:

aho eṣām (of these trees) **sarva-prāṇy-upajīvanam** (that by which all beings live)[5] **janma sujanasya iva varam** (the best), — **yeṣām** (from whom) **arthinaḥ** (those who ask) **vimukhāḥ** (with their wishes unfulfilled) **na yānti** (do not go away).

Hearing this, all the parts of the tree were filled with joy —

47 When the gardener Caitanya gave this order, the whole family of the tree was filled with joy.

*The fruits of *prema* are given without regard to qualification —*

48 Each branch began to give away the fruit of love everywhere, and all the people who tasted it became intoxicated.

49 People ate their fill of this most intoxicating fruit of love, and, maddened by it, they all laughed, danced and sang.

50 Some rolled on the ground, some roared, and seeing this, the gardener smiled with delight.

*By giving the *jīva* love for Kṛṣṇa like His own, He makes him a *mahā-*

bhāgavata —*

51 The gardener Himself eats this fruit of love and remains ever intoxicated, helpless and overwhelmed.

52 He made all people as intoxicated as Himself; I see no one who is not mad with love.

Even lowly blasphemers and others are delivered by obtaining love for Kṛṣṇa —

53 Even those who once reviled Him, calling Him a drunkard, ate that fruit and danced, crying, “Wonderful, wonderful!”

Anubhāṣya.

Thus ends the ninth chapter of the “Anubhāṣya.”

54 Thus I have told of the distribution of the fruit of love. Now hear of the branches that give the fruit.

55 Praying at the feet of Śrī Rūpa and Śrī Raghunātha, I, Kṛṣṇadāsa, narrate the *Caitanya-caritāmṛta*.

Notes

1. The Gauḍīya Maṭha edition reads *ei nava mūle* (“on these nine roots”); some other editions read *aṣṭa dike aṣṭa mūla* (“eight roots in the eight directions”). ↩
2. The Gauḍīya Maṭha edition reads *nāma-gaṇana* (“the counting of the names”); some other editions read *nāma agaṇana* (“the names are countless”). The branches are named in Ādi 10–12. ↩
3. The Gauḍīya Maṭha edition reads *vṛkṣera upare śākhā haila dui skandha* (“above, the branches of the tree became two trunks”); some other editions read *śākhāra upare haila vṛkṣa dui skandha*. ↩
4. The Gauḍīya Maṭha edition reads *sarva-prāṇy-upajīvanam* (“a birth that sustains all living beings”); some other editions read *upajīvinām*. ↩

5. So in the edition; the transliteration of the verse reads *upajīvinām* (“who sustain all beings”). ↩

The Description of the Branches of the Main Trunk

(English translation from the Bengali, following the Gauḍīya Maṭha edition and the «Anubhāṣya», 2026 — draft)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya

Summary. The tenth chapter describes Śrīman Mahāprabhu's own branches.

Obeisances to the devotees of Gaura

1 Again and again I bow to the devotees who, like bees, drink the honey of Śrī Caitanya’s lotus feet. Even one as low as a dog, if he takes shelter of them in any way at all, comes to share in the fragrance of those feet.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
Again and again I bow down to the bees who drink the honey of Śrī Caitanya's lotus feet. If one takes shelter of them in any way at all, even a dog obtains the fragrance of those lotus feet.

Anubhāṣya.
śrī-caitanya-padāmbhoja-madhupebhyaḥ (to the bees who drink the honey — the *rasa* of devotion — of Śrī Caitanya's lotus feet, that is, to the devotees of Gaura) **namo namaḥ**; — **yeṣāṁ kathañcit** (in any way whatever) **āśrayāt śvā** (a dog — one intent on enjoyment, without faith in devotion to Bhagavān) **api tad-gandha-bhāk** (one who partakes of, that is, obtains, the fragrance of those lotus feet of Gaura — a devotee of Gaura) **bhavet**.

2 Glory, glory to Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya and Nityānanda! Glory to Advaitacandra, and glory to all the devotees of Gaura!

Description of the main branches of Gaura, the wish-fulfilling tree —

3 This gardener, this tree, is beyond all telling. Now hear the names of its principal branches.

Among Gaura's devotees there is no distinction of greater and lesser —

4 Caitanya Gosāñi's associates are a vast host, and no one can determine who among them is greater and who is lesser.

5 Many great souls have listed them all, yet none has been able to set them in order of seniority.

6 Therefore, bowing down to them all, I shall simply name them. Please do not count this as a fault in me.

7 Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya is the immortal tree of love. I worship His dear devotees, who are the branches of that tree and give everyone the fruit of love for Kṛṣṇa.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya is the wish-fulfilling tree of *prema*. Its branches are His dear devotees, who give the fruit of love for Kṛṣṇa. I offer my obeisances to them.

Anubhāṣya.

śrī-kṛṣṇa-caitanya-premāmara-taroḥ (of the wish-fulfilling tree, Gaura's *prema*) **kṛṣṇa-prema-phala-pradān śākhā-rūpān priyān bhakta-gaṇān ahaṁ vande**.

(1 — a, b, c, d) The branch of the four brothers, Śrīvāsa, Śrīrāma and the others —

8 Śrīvāsa Paṇḍita and Śrī Rāma Paṇḍita — two brothers, two branches — are renowned throughout the world.[1]

Anubhāṣya.

Śrīvāsa. In the *Gaura-gaṇoddeśa* (verse 90): “Wise Śrīvāsa Paṇḍita is he who was formerly the sage Nārada. The best of sages named Parvata, who was dear to Nārada, is the glorious Śrīrāma Paṇḍita, his younger brother.” “She who was formerly in Vraja the nurse named Ambikā, who suckled [Kṛṣṇa], is considered to be Śrīvāsa's wife, named Mālinī.” The daughter of Śrīvāsa's own brother was Nārāyaṇī Devī, the mother of Ṭhākura Vṛndāvana.

After Śrīman Mahāprabhu accepted *sannyāsa*, Śrīvāsa left his home in Navadvīpa and settled in Kumārahaṭṭa. This is known from the *Caitanya-bhāgavata* (Antya, Chapter 5) and other books.

9 Śrīpati and Śrīnidhi are their two brothers, and the four brothers had menservants, maidservants and a whole household.

Their exclusive devotion to Gaura —

10 All of them are counted among the offshoots of these two branches. In their house Mahāprabhu held saṅkīrtana constantly.

11 With their whole family they served Śrī Caitanya, and apart from Gauracandra they knew no god or goddess.

(2) The branch of Śrī Candraśekhara —

12 Another great branch bears the name Ācāryaratna; his associates are its branches and offshoots.

13 Ācāryaratna’s own name is Śrī Candraśekhara. In his house the Lord danced in the form of the Goddess, the Ādi-śakti.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Śrī Candraśekhara Ācāryaratna, according to some books, was the husband of Śrīman Mahāprabhu's maternal aunt.

Anubhāṣya.

Śrī Candraśekhara is one of the glorious nine *nidhis* (treasures), or else Candra (?). It was in his house that Mahāprabhu danced, enacting the role of the Goddess

(*Caitanya-bhāgavata*, Madhya, Chapter 18). This house of Candraśekhara is now well known by the name “Vrajapattana.” He learned of Śrīman Mahāprabhu's *sannyāsa* beforehand from Śrī Nityānanda's own lips (*Caitanya-bhāgavata*, Madhya, Chapter 26). At the time of the *sannyāsa* he was at Kāṭoyā with Śrī Nityānanda and Mukunda Datta and performed all the duties proper to the occasion. Returning to Navadvīpa, he told everyone that the Lord had accepted *sannyāsa*. On Mahāprabhu's *kīrtana* in his house, see the *Caitanya-bhāgavata*, Madhya, Chapter 8. On his presence in the town *kīrtana* when the Kazi was subdued, and when the Lord showed mercy to Śrīdhara, see Madhya, Chapter 23. He used to travel with the devotees from Gauḍa to Śrī Kṣetra.

(3) The branch of Śrī Puṇḍarīka —

14 Puṇḍarīka Vidyānidhi is a great branch; the Lord Himself would weep as He spoke his name.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Śrī Puṇḍarīka Vidyānidhi was a resident of Caṭṭagrāma.

Anubhāṣya.

Śrī Puṇḍarīka Vidyānidhi. In the *Gaura-gaṇoddeśa* (verse 54): “He who was formerly known in Vraja-maṇḍala as Vṛṣabhānu is now Puṇḍarīkākṣa Vidyānidhi Mahāśaya. Tasting His own mood and tormented by Rādhā's separation, Caitanya Himself called Puṇḍarīkākṣa, ‘O father!’ Wise Gaura gave him the fame of ‘Premanidhi’ (treasury of *prema*), and because he was a disciple of Mādhavendra, He always showed him reverence. His wife Ratnāvatī is declared by the wise to be Kīrtidā.”

His father's name was Bāṇeśvara (by another account, Śuklāmbara Brahmacārī), and his mother's name was Gaṅgādevī. By another account, Bāṇeśvara was born in the line of Śivarāma Gaṅgopādhyāya. Vidyānidhi's father was a brāhmaṇa of the Vārendra class who lived in the village of Bāghiyā in Ḍhākā district, and so the Rāḍhīya brāhmaṇa community there did not accept him. For this reason his descendants[8] became *ekaghare* — outcasts from the community — and since then have served as priests only for the community's other outcasts. One of them, named Sarojānanda Gosvāmī, now lives in Vṛndāvana. Their family has one peculiarity: among brothers only one has a son, while the others have daughters or no children at all. That is why the family has not spread very far.

Six *krośas* north of Caṭṭagrāma there is a police station called Hāṭ-Hājārī. One *krośa* east of it, in the village of Mekhalā, was his family's former home. From the town of Caṭṭagrāma one can go there by land, in a horse-cart or bullock-cart, or by water, by boat or steamer. The steamer stops at Annapūrṇā's *ghāṭa*, and from there the *śrīpāṭa* (holy site) lies two miles to the southwest. Vidyānidhi's temple of worship (*bhajana-mandira*) is now utterly decayed and neglected; unless it is restored, it is likely to vanish soon. Two verses are carved on brick tablets in the temple wall, but the letters are worn away, and they can be neither read nor understood. Some 400–500 cubits southeast of this temple another temple can be seen; the inscriptions on the tablets of its walls cannot be read either. Directly in front of it, 15–20 cubits to the north, there once stood another temple: the many scattered pieces of brick show this. Tradition says it was Mukunda Datta's temple of worship.

Mahāprabhu called Vidyānidhi “Father” and gave him the name “Premanidhi.” He was the guru of Śrīla Gadādhara Paṇḍita Gosvāmī and the friend of Śrī Dāmodara Svarūpa. To warn ignorant *jīvas* and give them auspicious instruction, Paṇḍita Gosvāmī at first acted as if he had mistaken Vidyānidhi for a worldly man, and in the end displayed the pastime of taking initiation from him. On how Śrī Jagannāthadeva slapped him on the cheeks, see the *Caitanya-bhāgavata*, Antya, Chapter 11.

In Puṇḍarīka's family Śrī Harakumāra Smṛtitīrtha and Śrī Kṛṣṇakiṅkara Vidyālaṅkāra are now living (see the *Vaiṣṇava-mañjuṣā*, issue 1).

(4) The branch of Śrī Gadādhara —

15 Another great branch is Gadādhara Paṇḍita Gosāñi. He is the very form of Lakṣmī, and none is his equal.

Anubhāṣya.

Gadādhara Paṇḍita Gosāñi (*Gaura-gaṇoddeśa*, verses 147–153): “She who was formerly the Queen of Vṛndāvana, the embodiment of Śrī Rādhā's *prema*, is now Śrī Gadādhara, the beloved of Gaura, who bears the name ‘Paṇḍita.’ Śrī Svarūpa has determined that he is the Lakṣmī of Vraja: ‘She who formerly in Vṛndāvana was Lakṣmī, the beloved of Śyāmasundara, is now the Lakṣmī of Gaura's *prema*, Śrī Gadādhara Paṇḍita.’ Lalitā follows Rādhā and is therefore also called Anurādhikā; so she too entered him, as described in the *Gauracandrodaya*.”

For the branch of Gadādhara, see the end of Ādi, Chapter 12.

16 His disciples and their disciples are the offshoots of this branch, and so it is with all the other branches and offshoots.

(5) The glory and the branch of Śrī Vakreśvara —

17 Vakreśvara Paṇḍita was a servant very dear to the Lord. In a single unbroken ecstasy he could dance for twenty-four praharas — three days and nights.

Anubhāṣya.

Śrī Vakreśvara Paṇḍita. In the *Gaura-gaṇoddeśa* (verse 71): “He who was Aniruddha, the fourth *vyūha*, is Vakreśvara Paṇḍita. With his dancing, born of absorption in Kṛṣṇa, he gave the Lord joy. ‘O merciful one, give me a thousand singers!’ — these sweet words he spoke at Caitanya's feet. Śaśirekhā entered him as a distinct manifestation of herself.”

Śrī Dhyānacandra Gosvāmī Prabhu writes: “I worship Śrī Vakreśvara Paṇḍita, the best of the twice-born, the devotee of Caitanya. He is devoted to revealing the *rasa* of Rādhā and Kṛṣṇa, adorned with garlands of songs, born to spread the happiness of Vṛndāvana, and endowed with *stambha* and the other *bhāvas*; he is the sprout of the avatāra of dance that merges with the *rasa* of Śrī Gaurāṅga Mahāprabhu. Within him Tuṅgavidyā always dwells, full of eager longing: she has become a *vipralabdhā* (a heroine disappointed in her waiting) and is ever filled with love for Śrī Kṛṣṇa. Her age is the measure (?).[9] In Gaura's *rasa*, in the Kali age, she again became famous as Vakreśvara.”

He used to dance in Mahāprabhu's *kīrtana* in Śrīvāsa's courtyard and in Candraśekhara's house. On how the Lord told Devānanda of Vakreśvara's glory, see the *Caitanya-bhāgavata*, Antya, Chapter 3.

The Utkala poet Śrī Govinda writes of Śrī Vakreśvara in the *Śrī Gaura-kṛṣṇodaya*: “Considering that he was the Lord's first disciple, they settled Vakreśvara in that hermitage and each went to his own dwelling.”

His disciple was Śrī Gopāla-guru, and Gopāla-guru's disciple was Śrī Dhyānacandra. In Utkala most of those in the line of Śrī Vakreśvara's disciples call themselves Gauḍīya Vaiṣṇavas.

18 While he danced, Mahāprabhu Himself would sing, and once Vakreśvara clasped the Lord's feet and said:

19 "O moon-faced Lord, give me ten thousand Gandharvas! Let them sing while I dance — that would be my joy."

20 The Lord replied, "You are one of My wings. If I had another like you, I would fly up into the sky."

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
The Lord says: "You are one of My wings. If I had one more wing like you, I would fly away into the sky."

(6) The greatness of Śrī Jagadānanda —

21 Paṇḍita Jagadānanda is the Lord's very life. He is renowned as a manifestation of Satyabhāmā.

Anubhāṣya.
Jagadānanda. In the *Gaura-gaṇoddeśa* (verse 51): "By a certain inner distinction the Sātvatas set him apart: Jagadānanda Paṇḍita is also a manifestation of Satyabhāmā." He was the Lord's companion in *kīrtana* in Śrīvāsa's courtyard and in Candraśekhara's house. When the Lord went to Orissa after His *sannyāsa*, he carried His *daṇḍa* and begged alms.

22 Out of love he longed to surround the Lord with care and comfort, but the Lord, guarding His renunciation and wary of what people would say, never accepted it.

23 So the two of them would fall into little quarrels. I shall tell the whole story of his love later on.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
See Antya, Chapters 4, 7, 12 and 13.

(7) The branch of Śrī Rāghava Paṇḍita —

24 Rāghava Paṇḍita was one of the Lord's first followers, and his chief branch is Makaradhvaja Kara.

Anubhāṣya.

Rāghava Paṇḍita. In the *Gaura-gaṇoddeśa* (verse 44): "Dhaniṣṭhā, who in Vraja gave Kṛṣṇa countless foodstuffs, is now Rāghava Paṇḍita, dear to Gaurāṅga."

Rāghava's house is in the village of Pāṇihāṭī on the bank of the Gaṅgā: on the E.B.R. line from Śiyāladaha station to Sodapura station, and from there one mile west. Over Rāghava Paṇḍita's *samādhi* a high platform has been built, surrounded by a bower of creepers. North of the *samādhi*, in a nearly ruined, dilapidated house, resides the Deity Śrī Madana-mohana, who is served without proper care. This service is managed under the supervision of the present zamindar of Pāṇihāṭī, Śrī Śivacandra Rāya Caudhurī.

Makaradhvaja. In the *Gaura-gaṇoddeśa* (verse 141): "He who was formerly the actor Candramukha is Makaradhvaja Kara." He lived in the village of Pāṇihāṭī.

The virtues of his sister Damayantī —

25 His sister Damayantī, a dear maidservant of the Lord, prepared provisions for Him all year round.

Anubhāṣya.

Damayantī. In the *Gaura-gaṇoddeśa* (verse 167): "She who in Vraja was Guṇamālā is Damayantī, his sister."

26 Filling bags with all those provisions, Rāghava would carry them secretly to the Lord.

27 All year round the Lord accepted them, and they became famous as "Rāghava's bags."[2]

Anubhāṣya.

For a description of the *jhāli* (bags), see Antya, Chapter 10.

28 I shall describe those provisions in detail later. Hearing of them, the devotees shed streams of tears.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
"*Āge*" (later): see Antya, Chapter 10.

(8) Śrī Gaṅgādāsa —

29 Paṇḍita Gaṅgādāsa was extremely dear to the Lord. Simply to remember him destroys all bondage.

Anubhāṣya.
Gaṅgādāsa Paṇḍita. In the *Gaura-gaṇoddeśa* (verse 53): "He who was formerly the sage Vasiṣṭha, the guru of Raghunātha, [became] by a special manifestation Gaṅgādāsa and Sudarśana." The same, verse 119: "… Gaṅgādāsa, dear to the Lord, was formerly Durvāsā in Nidhuvana, dear to the gopīs."

(9) Śrī Purandara Ācārya —

30 Śrī Purandara Ācārya was an associate of Śrī Caitanya; Gaurāṅgasundara called him Father.

Anubhāṣya.
Purandara Ācārya. *Caitanya-bhāgavata*, Antya, Chapter 5: "As soon as the Lord arrived at the Paṇḍita's house, Ācārya Purandara heard the news and came. Seeing him, the Lord called him 'Father' and, maddened with ecstatic love, took him in His arms. Supremely fortunate is that Ācārya Purandara: seeing the Lord, he wept, unable to restrain himself."

(10) The branch of Śrī Dāmodara Paṇḍita —

31 Dāmodara Paṇḍita, another branch, was so fierce in his love that he even rebuked the Lord.

32 I shall tell the story of that rebuke in detail later. Pleased with it, the Lord sent him to Nadīyā.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
"*Āge*" (later): see Antya, Chapter 3.

Anubhāṣya.

Dāmodara Paṇḍita. In the *Gaura-gaṇoddeśa* (verse 169): “The fierce Śaibyā who was in Vraja is Dāmodara Paṇḍita. For some purpose the goddess Sarasvatī entered him.” By the Lord's order Dāmodara would come to Gauḍa to see Āi (Śacīmātā), and then, before the Ratha-yātrā, go again with the devotees to Puruṣottama (*Caitanya-bhāgavata*, Antya, Chapter 9). For the Lord's question about Śacīdevī's devotion to Kṛṣṇa and Dāmodara Paṇḍita's answer, see the *Caitanya-bhāgavata*, Antya, Chapter 10. For Dāmodara's verbal chastisement of the Lord, see Antya-līlā, Chapter 3.

(11) The greatness and the branch of Śrī Śaṅkara Paṇḍita —

33 His younger brother, Śaṅkara Paṇḍita, is a branch known by the name “the Lord’s footrest.”

Anubhāṣya.

Śaṅkara Paṇḍita. In the *Gaura-gaṇoddeśa* (verse 157): “She on whose breast Kṛṣṇa formerly slept in Vṛndāvana, Śrī Bhadrā, is now Śaṅkara Paṇḍita, dear to Gaurāṅga.” See Antya 19.67–74.

Mahāprabhu's love for Paṇḍita Dāmodara was mixed with reverence, while for his younger brother, Paṇḍita Śaṅkara, He had pure (*kevala*) *prema*: see Madhya 11.146–148.

(12) Śrī Sadāśiva Paṇḍita —

34 Sadāśiva Paṇḍita set all his hope on the Lord’s feet, and at first Nityānanda lived in his house.

Anubhāṣya.

Sadāśiva Paṇḍita. *Caitanya-bhāgavata*, Antya, Chapter 9 (at the time of the Ratha-yātrā): “Sadāśiva Paṇḍita, pure of mind, set out — he in whose house Nityānanda formerly lived.”

He lived in Navadvīpa and was the Lord's companion in *kīrtana*. On returning from Gayā, Mahāprabhu told him and other devotees, in Śuklāmbara's house, of His own worship of Kṛṣṇa. When Mahāprabhu was going to dance in Candraśekhara's house in the guise of Lakṣmī, He told Sadāśiva to prepare the

costumes and everything else for the play (*Caitanya-bhāgavata*, Madhya, Chapter 18).

(13) Śrī Pradyumna Brahmacārī —

35 Pradyumna Brahmacārī was a worshipper of Śrī Nṛsiṁha, and the Lord gave him the name Nṛsiṁhānanda.

Anubhāṣya.

Pradyumna Brahmacārī. Antya, Chapter 2: "His own name was Pradyumna Brahmacārī; Gaura, the abode [of all], named him 'Nṛsiṁhānanda.'" (CC Antya 2.53) Coming from Rāghava's house in Pāṇihāṭī to Śivānanda's house in Kumārahaṭṭa, Mahāprabhu appeared within his heart and accepted the offerings meant for three — Jagannātha, Nṛsiṁha and Himself (CC Antya 2.48–78). When he heard in Kuliyā that Mahāprabhu was going to Vṛndāvana, he became absorbed in meditation and in his mind built a road from Kuliyā to Vṛndāvana. Then his meditation broke, and he told the devotees that this time the Lord would go only as far as Kānāi Nāṭaśālā and would not go to Vṛndāvana (Madhya 1.155–162).[10]

In the *Gaura-gaṇoddeśa* (verse 74): "*Āveśa* should likewise be recognized in the Miśra named Pradyumna." *Caitanya-bhāgavata*, Antya, Chapter 3: "… in whose body Nṛsiṁha is manifest"; and Antya, Chapter 9: "… with whom Nṛsiṁha Himself converses face to face."

(14) Śrī Nārāyaṇa Paṇḍita —

36 Nārāyaṇa Paṇḍita was a most generous soul who knew nothing but the feet of Śrī Caitanya.

Anubhāṣya.

Nārāyaṇa Paṇḍita went to Nīlācala with Śrīrāma Paṇḍita, the brother of Śrīvāsa, to see Śrī Mahāprabhu. See the *Caitanya-bhāgavata*, Antya, Chapter 9, verse 93.

(15) The branch of Śrī Śrīmān Paṇḍita —

37 Śrīmān Paṇḍita, a branch and the Lord's personal servant, held the torch whenever the Lord danced.

Anubhāṣya.

Śrīmān Paṇḍita lived in Śrī Navadvīpa and was the Lord's companion in His first *kīrtana*. On the day of the play, when the Lord danced in the mood of the Goddess, and whenever the Lord danced, he held a lighted torch. *Caitanya-bhāgavata*, Madhya, Chapter 18: “In the guise of Ādyā-śakti the Lord, Gaura the lion, dances, and all the bees at His feet joyfully watch … Paṇḍita Śrīmān holds the torch before Him.”

(16) Śrī Śuklāmbara Brahmacārī —

38 Śuklāmbara Brahmacārī was most fortunate: the Lord Himself would beg his rice, or snatch it from him, and eat it.

Anubhāṣya.

Śuklāmbara Brahmacārī lived in Śrī Navadvīpa and was the Lord's companion in His first *kīrtana*. On returning from Gayā, Mahāprabhu gathered the devotees in his very house and asked to hear the narrations of Kṛṣṇa from him (*Caitanya-bhāgavata*, Madhya, Chapter 1). In His Navadvīpa pastimes Mahāprabhu, in great joy, would snatch and eat the rice cooked from the grain Śuklāmbara had collected as alms (*Caitanya-bhāgavata*, Madhya, Chapters 16 and 25). In the *Gaura-gaṇoddeśa* (verse 191): “Śuklāmbara Brahmacārī was formerly one of the wives of the sacrificing brāhmaṇas; the Lord, Śrī Gaurāṅga, begged his food and ate it. Some say that this *brahmacārī* was formerly a brāhmaṇa who performed sacrifice.”

(17) The branch of Śrī Nandana Ācārya —

39 Nandana Ācārya is a branch renowned throughout the world, for the two Lords hid in his house.

Anubhāṣya.

Nandana Ācārya lived in Navadvīpa and was the Lord's companion in *kīrtana*. After travelling to many holy places in the dress of an *avadhūta*, Śrī Nityānanda Prabhu came first to his house. There Mahāprabhu met Him together with the devotees. On the day of the Mahā-prakāśa, Mahāprabhu sent Rāmāi Paṇḍita to bring Advaita Prabhu. Advaitācārya was hiding in Nandanācārya's house, but Gaurasundara, who knows every heart, came to know of it. Śrī Mahāprabhu too once hid in his house. See the *Caitanya-bhāgavata*, Madhya, Chapters 6 and 17.

(18) The branch of Śrī Mukunda Datta —

40 Śrī Mukunda Datta, another branch, was the Lord's fellow student; when he sang kīrtana, Caitanya Gosāñi danced.

Anubhāṣya.

Śrī Mukunda Datta was born in the village of Chanharā, under the Paṭiyā police station in Caṭṭagrāma district, ten *krośas* from Mekhalā, the village of Vidyānidhi's *śrīpāṭa*. In the *Gaura-gaṇoddeśa* (verse 140): "Madhukaṇṭha and Madhuvrata, the two singers in Vraja, are Mukunda and Vāsudeva, the two Dattas, the singers of Gaurāṅga."

In His student days Nimāi used to argue with His classmate Mukunda, posing trick questions of logic (*nyāya*) (*Caitanya-bhāgavata*, Ādi, Chapters 5 and 8). When the Lord returned from Gayā, mad with love for Kṛṣṇa, Mukunda would delight Him by reciting verses of the *Bhāgavatam*. It was through his efforts that his companion Śrī Gadādhara Paṇḍita Gosvāmī took initiation from Śrī Vidyānidhi (Madhya, Chapter 7). When he sang *kīrtana* in Śrīvāsa's courtyard, Mahāprabhu would dance and sing. During the *bhāva* that lasted seven *praharas* ("*sāt-prahariyā*"), he sang the "Abhiṣeka." For the Lord's punishment of Mukunda and His mercy to him, see the *Caitanya-bhāgavata*, Madhya, Chapter 10. When the Lord danced in Candraśekhara's house in the guise of Lakṣmī, it was he who first began to sing.

After telling Nityānanda Prabhu that He would take *sannyāsa*, the Lord went to Mukunda's house. Hearing everything, Mukunda begged the Lord to continue His *kīrtana* pastimes in Navadvīpa a few days longer (*Caitanya-bhāgavata*, Madhya, Chapter 25). When Mukunda learned of the Lord's *sannyāsa* from Nityānanda's lips, he went to Kāṭoyā with Gadādhara and Candraśekhara. There he sang *kīrtana* and performed everything proper to the Lord's *sannyāsa*. After the *sannyāsa* he followed the Lord together with Nitāi, Gadādhara and Govinda (Madhya, Chapter 26; Antya, Chapter 1), and in this way followed Him all the way to Puruṣottama (see Antya, Chapter 2). On the way to Jaleśvara he was present when Nityānanda broke the Lord's *daṇḍa*, and he reached Jaleśvara shortly after the Lord. Every year he came with the devotees from Gauḍa to Nīlācala to see the Lord.

(19) The virtues of Śrī Vāsudeva Datta Ṭhākura —

41 Vāsudeva Datta was the Lord's great-souled servant; even with a thousand mouths one could not tell his virtues.

Anubhāṣya.

Śrī Vāsudeva Datta was born in Caṭṭagrāma; he was the brother of Mukunda Datta. *Caitanya-bhāgavata*, Antya, Chapter 9: "… to whom Kṛṣṇa Himself is sold." When the Lord was staying at Śrīvāsa's house in Kumārahaṭṭa (*Caitanya-bhāgavata*, Antya, Chapter 5): "Such was the Lord's love for Datta! The Lord says: 'I certainly belong to Vāsudeva … This body of Mine belongs to Vāsudeva Datta. Wherever Datta sells Me, there I am sold. It is true, true — it cannot be otherwise. I speak the truth; hear, O assembly of Vaiṣṇavas: this body of Mine belongs to Vāsudeva alone.'"

Yadunandana Ācārya, who received his mercy, was the *dīkṣā-guru* of Śrī Raghunātha dāsa Gosvāmī (Antya 6.161). Seeing his tendency to spend lavishly, the Lord ordered Śivānanda Sena to become his *sarakhela* (manager) and to manage his expenses (Madhya 15.93–96). For his prayer to Mahāprabhu on seeing the suffering of the *jīvas*, see Madhya 15.159–180.

On the E.I.R. line, one mile from Pūrvasthalī station, in the village of Māmagāchi, the birthplace of Ṭhākura Vṛndāvana, the Śrī Madana-Gopāla he established still resides. His service is very much neglected. It is desirable that His service be made splendid.

42 He wished to take upon himself the sins of every living being in the world and suffer in hell himself, if only they could be set free.[3]

(20) The virtues of Ṭhākura Haridāsa, the Nāmācārya, and his branch —

43 Haridāsa Ṭhākura, another branch, lived a wondrous life: without fail he chanted three hundred thousand names every day.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

"*Apatita*": without breaking the rule.

44 His virtues are endless; I can give only a glimpse of them. It was he whom Advaita Ācārya fed from the plate of the memorial offering, the

śrāddha-pātra.

45 The waves of his virtues were like Prahlāda's: even when the Yavanas beat him, he did not so much as frown.

46 When he attained perfection, Caitanya Prabhu took his body in His arms and danced in great joy.

47 Vṛndāvana dāsa has described his pastimes; what remains I shall tell later.

Anubhāṣya.

Śrī Haridāsa Ṭhākura. *Caitanya-bhāgavata*, Ādi, Chapter 2: "Haridāsa descended in Būṛhana … After staying there some days, he came to the bank of the Gaṅgā and settled in Phuliyā, near Śāntipura." The persecution by the Muslims is described in the *Caitanya-bhāgavata*, Chapter 11. On Haridāsa's humble words and the Lord's mercy, see the *Caitanya-bhāgavata*, Madhya, Chapter 10; on preaching the holy name from door to door, Madhya, Chapter 13; on Haridāsa playing the *koṭāla* (chief of the watch) during the play in Candraśekhara's house, the *Caitanya-bhāgavata*, Madhya, Chapter 18; on his worship of the holy name of Hari at Benāpola and his test, the *Caitanya-caritāmṛta*, Antya, Chapter 3; and on Haridāsa's departure, Antya, Chapter 11.

In the Sātakṣīrā subdivision of the Twenty-four Parganas (now Khulnā district) there is a *paragaṇā* called Būṛhana. Whether the Ṭhākura appeared there is not known.

(20a) Haridāsa's disciples, Satyarāja Khān (Vasu) and others —

48 All the people of Kulīna-grāma are his offshoots; Satyarāja and others received his mercy.

Anubhāṣya.

Satyarāja Khān was the son of Guṇarāja Khān of Kulīnagrāma and the father of Rāmānanda Vasu. Ṭhākura Haridāsa lived in Kulīnagrāma during Cāturmāsya, performing his worship, and bestowed his mercy on the Vasu family. On Mahāprabhu's merciful order to bring silk ropes (*paṭṭa-ḍorī*) for Jagannāthadeva

every year, see Madhya, Chapter 14. On how Satyarāja asked about a householder's duties and heard of the characteristics of a Vaiṣṇava, a better Vaiṣṇava and the best Vaiṣṇava and of the gradation of their qualification, see Madhya 15.102–109 and 16.69–75. At the place where he worshipped there is now a Deity of Śrī Mahāprabhu.

Kulīnagrāma lies within two miles of Jaugrāma station on the Howrah–Barddhamāna New Chord line. For Mahāprabhu's words on the glory of Kulīnagrāma, see Ādi 10.82–83 and Madhya 15.100–101.[11]

(21) The greatness and the branch of Śrī Murāri Gupta —

49 Śrī Murāri Gupta is a branch, a storehouse of love; whenever the Lord heard his humble words, His heart would melt.

Anubhāṣya.

Śrī Murāri Gupta was the author of the book *Śrī Caitanya-carita*. He was born in a Vaidya family of Śrīhaṭṭa and later settled in Navadvīpa. He was older than Mahāprabhu. In his house Mahāprabhu showed the form of Varāha (*Caitanya-bhāgavata*, Madhya, Chapter 3), and in the state of the Mahā-prakāśa He showed him His form as Śrī Rāma (*Caitanya-bhāgavata*, Madhya, Chapter 10).

One day in Śrīvāsa's house Gaurasundara was seated with Nityānanda. Murāri Gupta first bowed down to Gaura and then offered prostrated obeisances to Nityānanda. The Lord said to Murāri, “You have offered obeisances in violation of proper order,” and at night, in a dream, He revealed to him the truth about Nityānanda. The next morning Murāri first worshipped the feet of Nityānanda and then those of Mahāprabhu. The Lord gave Murāri chewed betel. One day Murāri offered rice with ghee to Śrī Mahāprabhu in thought. The next morning Mahāprabhu, suffering indigestion from eating so much rice, came to Murāri for treatment. Saying, “The only medicine for this is the water in Murāri's water pot,” the Lord drank that water. In Śrīvāsa's house Mahāprabhu assumed a four-armed form; Murāri felt himself to be Garuḍa, and the Lord mounted his shoulders. Thinking that he could not bear the separation when the Lord concealed Himself, Murāri resolved to give up his body while the Lord was still manifest, but the Lord, the indweller of the heart, held him back (*Caitanya-bhāgavata*, Madhya, Chapter 20). One day the Lord, absorbed in *bhāva*, manifested the form of Varāha in Murāri Gupta's house, and Murāri, seeing Him, offered prayers (*Caitanya-

bhāgavata*, Antya, Chapter 4). For Murāri Gupta's humble words, see Madhya 11.152–158; for Murāri's steadfast devotion to Śrī Rāma, see Madhya 15.137–157.

50 He accepted no gifts and took no one’s money, but supported his family by his own calling.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
“*Ātma-vṛtti*”: the occupation of one's own *varṇa*; Murāri Gupta's profession as a physician (*kavirāja*).

51 All whom he treated with kindness were freed from both diseases — the disease of the body and the disease of worldly existence.

(22) Śrīmān Sena —

52 Śrīmān Sena was a foremost servant of the Lord and knew nothing but the feet of Śrī Caitanya.

Anubhāṣya.
Śrīmān Sena lived in Navadvīpa and was a companion of the Lord.

(23) The branch of Śrī Gadādhara dāsa —

53 Śrī Gadādhara dāsa is a branch above all others; he made even the Kazis utter the name of Hari.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
Gadādhara dāsa was a resident of Eṅḍiyādaha.

Anubhāṣya.
Śrī Gadādhara dāsa. The village of Eṅḍiyādaha lies on the bank of the Bhāgīrathī, four *krośas* north of Calcutta. After Mahāprabhu withdrew from the world's sight, Dāsa Gadādhara went from Navadvīpa to Kāṭoyā (*Bhakti-ratnākara*, seventh wave), and later came from there to this village and lived there. He is the luster (*kānti*) of Śrī Rādhā: as Śrīla Paṇḍita Gosvāmī is Śrīmatī Vṛṣabhānu-nandinī Herself, so Śrīla Gadādhara dāsa is the beauty of Śrīmatī's body. Gaura is “adorned with the mood and luster of Rādhā,” and Gadādhara dāsa is that very luster of Gaura. In the *Gaura-gaṇoddeśa* he is named the *vibhūti*, the

expansion, of Vṛṣabhānu-nandinī. He is counted among the associates of both Gaura and Nityānanda. Gaura's associates are connoisseurs (*rasikas*) of the *madhura-rasa* of Vraja; Nityānanda's associates are connoisseurs of *sakhya* and the other *rasas* in which pure devotion predominates. Although Śrī Dāsa Gadādhara is among Nityānanda's associates, he is not a *gopāla*, a cowherd boy full of *sakhya-bhāva*: he was a connoisseur of *madhura-rasa*. At Kāṭoyā he had the worship of Gaura.

In 1434 Śaka, when Śrī Mahāprabhu requested Śrī Nityānanda Prabhu to go from Nīlācala to Gauḍa to preach devotion, Gadādhara became one of Nityānanda's chief helpers in the work of preaching (Ādi 11.13–14). Śrī Gadādhara dāsa taught everyone to chant the holy name of Hari. The Kazi of that village opposed *kīrtana*. One night Śrī Dāsa Gadādhara, while performing *kīrtana*, went to the Kazi's house, wishing to deliver him, and asked him to utter the holy name of Hari. The Kazi replied, “I will say ‘Hari’ tomorrow,” and Gadādhara dāsa, filled with the joy of *prema*, said: “… Why tomorrow? You have just said ‘Hari’ with your own mouth.” In the *Gaura-gaṇoddeśa*: “She who was formerly in Vraja Candrakānti, the *vibhūti* of Rādhā, is Gadādhara of the Dāsa family, who is near Śrī Gaurāṅga. She who in Vraja was Pūrṇānandā, the foremost of Baladeva's beloveds, also entered that Gadādhara for some purpose.”

On the way from Nīlācala to Gauḍa, Śrī Dāsa Gadādhara, in the mood of Śrī Rādhā and laughing loudly, became a seller of yogurt and forgot his external identity. Nityānanda Prabhu saw this. Sometimes Gadādhara, absorbed in the mood of a gopī, would carry on his head a pot full of Gaṅgā water and sell it as milk. When Śrīman Mahāprabhu wished to go to Śrī Vṛndāvana by way of Gauḍa-maṇḍala, He came to Rāghava's house in the village of Pāṇihāṭī. Then “hearing that Śrī Gaurasundara was in Rāghava's house, Gadādhara dāsa came running at once. The Lord, seeing pious Gadādhara, raised His feet and placed them on his head” (*Caitanya-bhāgavata*, Antya, Chapter 5). During his manifest presence there was a Deity of Bāla-Gopāla in Gadādhara's house in Eṅḍiyādaha. With the help of Śrī Nityānanda Prabhu and Śrī Dāsa Gadādhara, Śrī Mādhava Ghoṣa sang and danced before the Deity of Śrī Gopāla, enacting the “Dāna-khaṇḍa” (*Caitanya-bhāgavata*, Antya, Chapter 5).

When Śrī Gadādhara disappeared, his *samādhi* was made in that village. The *samādhi* was in the possession of *saṁyogī* Vaiṣṇavas. On the instruction of the perfected Śrī Bhagavān dāsa Bābājī Mahārāja of Kālnā, the late Madhusūdana Mallika of Nārikeladāṅgā in Calcutta founded a *pāṭabāṭī* (holy residence) there

and in the Bengali year 1256 arranged the service of the Deity Śrī Rādhākānta. His son Balāi Mallika in 1312 established a service of Śrī Gaura-Nitāi. On the throne of the temple reside the Deities of Śrī Gaura-Nityānanda and of Śrī Rādhā-Kṛṣṇa; beneath the throne a Sanskrit verse is engraved. A Gopeśvara Śiva-liṅga is also installed there. At the temple entrance all that is stated above is engraved on a stone tablet. See the *Vaiṣṇava-mañjuṣā-samāhṛti* (issue 1).

(24) The branch of Śrī Śivānanda Sena —

54 Śivānanda Sena was an intimate servant of the Lord; all who went to see the Lord went in his company.

55 Every year he took the Lord's devotees with him to Nīlācala, caring for them all along the way.

The Lord bestows mercy by descending in three forms —

56 The Lord shows His mercy to the devotees in three ways: by being with them in person (*sākṣāt*), by entering someone with His power (*āveśa*), and by appearing where He is not present in person (*āvirbhāva*).

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

To all the devotees He gave *darśana* in one and the same form, and so bestowed "*sākṣāt*," direct mercy. But at times He entered (*āviṣṭa*) the body of Nakula or of Pradyumna Brahmacārī; in that *brahmacārī*'s body Śrī Caitanya's "*āvirbhāva*," manifestation, took place.

Anubhāṣya.

"*Sākṣāt*": Gaurasundara in His own form; "*āveśa*": in Nakula or Pradyumna Brahmacārī; *āvirbhāva* (CC Antya 2.34–35): "In Śacī's house, where Nityānanda dances, at Śrīvāsa's *kīrtana* and in Rāghava's house — in these four places the Lord is always manifest (*āvirbhāva*). To be drawn by love is the Lord's natural disposition."

According to the *Gaura-gaṇoddeśa*, the Lord's *āvirbhāva* and *āveśa* took place in Nakula Brahmacārī and Pradyumna Miśra, thus (verse 74): "The *āvirbhāva* of Gaurahari was in Nakula Brahmacārī, and *āveśa* likewise should be recognized in the Miśra named Pradyumna."

57 In His direct presence all the devotees see Him alike; in the body of Nakula Brahmacārī there was the Lord's *āveśa*.

Anubhāṣya.

In the direct manifestation (*sākṣāt*) all the devotees are seen without distinction among themselves — as servants of one kind, not different from one another.[12] But because Śrīman Mahāprabhu entered Nṛsiṁhānanda, Śrī Śivānanda Sena and other devotees saw him exactly like Śrī Gaurasundara: full of love for Kṛṣṇa and performing more superhuman, divine acts than all the other devotees.

58 His earlier name was Pradyumna Brahmacārī; afterwards the Lord gave him the name Nṛsiṁhānanda.

Anubhāṣya.

Pradyumna Brahmacārī formerly lived in the hamlet of Piyārīgañja near Kālnā. He is mentioned in Ādi 10.35 and Antya 2.3–83. See the *Caitanya-bhāgavata*, Antya, Chapters 3 and 9.

59 In him Śrī Caitanya manifested Himself (*āvirbhāva*). The Lord has many such wonderful, unearthly ways.

60 Śivānanda Sena tasted all these rasas; I shall describe this bliss in detail later.

(24a) The branch of Śrī Śivānanda — his sons, servants and others —

61 The offshoots of Śivānanda are his own people — his sons, his servants and others, all devoted to the service of Śrī Caitanya.

Anubhāṣya.

Śivānanda Sena was a resident of Kumārahaṭṭa, or Hālisahara, and a devotee of the Lord. One and a half miles from there, in Kāñcaḍāpāḍā, there is a Deity of Gaura-Gopāla established by him (still present today in the temple of Śrī Kṛṣṇa-rāya). His son Paramānanda (Purīdāsa) writes in the *Gaura-gaṇoddeśa* (verse 176): "She who formerly in Vṛndāvana, as the messenger Vīrā, brought all the gopīs to Kṛṣṇa, is now my father." Every year he guided the devotees from Gauḍa, bore their travel expenses, looked after them and brought them to Mahāprabhu in Nīlācala (Madhya

16.19–26). His three sons were Caitanya dāsa, Rāmadāsa and Paramānanda (Kavikarṇapūra). On Karṇapūra's *dīkṣā-guru* (Śivānanda's guru and family priest) Śrīnātha Paṇḍita, see Ādi 10.107. Seeing Vāsudeva Datta's lavish spending, Mahāprabhu ordered Śivānanda to act as his *sarakhela* (manager) (Madhya 15.93–97).

Śrī Mahāprabhu bestows mercy on the devotees in three ways — "*sākṣāt*," "*āveśa*" and "*āvirbhāva*." Śivānanda Sena experienced and tasted these three *rasas* (Antya, Chapter 2), and the story of his dog, who longed to see Gaura's feet, is told in Antya, Chapter 1. When Raghunātha dāsa Gosvāmī Prabhu fled to Nīlācala to see the Lord, Govardhana sent Śivānanda a letter and learned news of his son. He then sent a cook, a servant and much money for Raghunātha's comfort, and the next year Śivānanda took them to Nīlācala (Antya 6.245–267). Once in Nīlācala Śivānanda invited the Lord and fed Him a very heavy meal. The Lord's mind was not fully pleased, so the next day Śivānanda's son Caitanya dāsa fed the Lord foods that aid digestion and satisfied Him (Antya 10.124–151).

Once, on the way to Nīlācala, while Śivānanda was settling matters at the toll station (*ghāṭi*), Nityānanda and all the others found no lodging and had to stay under a tree in a nearby village. Nitāi, feigning hunger and anger, cursed: "May Śivānanda's three sons die!" Śivānanda's wife, fearing misfortune, began to weep. Śivānanda came from the toll station, heard everything and spoke to his wife in praise of his own good fortune. As soon as he came to Nitāi, he received the good fortune of being kicked by Nitāi. Seeing this, Śivānanda's nephew Śrīkānta took offense and went alone to the Lord. The Lord, the indweller of the heart, forgave and consoled him. On that same visit the Lord put His big toe into Purīdāsa's mouth; at first the boy kept a vow of silence, and later, on another day, by the Lord's order he composed a verse (Antya 16.15–75). At that time the Lord ordered Govinda: "As long as Śivānanda's wife and sons are here, let them receive the plate of My remnants" (Antya 12.15–53).

His three sons —

62 Caitanya dāsa, Rāmadāsa and Karṇapūra, the three sons of Śivānanda, were heroic devotees of the Lord.

Anubhāṣya.

Caitanya dāsa was Śivānanda's eldest son. His commentary on the *Kṛṣṇa-karṇāmṛta*, with a translation by Śrīmad Bhaktivinoda Ṭhākura, was published in

the journal *Śrī Sajjana-toṣaṇī*. In the opinion of those who know, he, and not Kavi-karṇapūra, is the author of the Sanskrit *mahākāvya* (great poem) called *Caitanya-carita*.

Rāmadāsa was the middle son. In the *Gaura-gaṇoddeśa* (verse 145): “The two parrots famous in Vṛndāvana, Dakṣa and Vicakṣaṇa, have now been born as my elder brothers, Caitanya and Rāmadāsa.”

Karṇapūra is Paramānanda dāsa, also called Purīdāsa or Kavi-karṇapūra. He was a disciple of Śrīnātha Paṇḍita of the Advaita branch. He composed the *Ānanda-vṛndāvana-campū*, the *Alaṅkāra-kaustubha*, the *mahākāvya* *Śrī Caitanya-carita* (?), the play *Śrī Caitanya-candrodaya*, the *Gaura-gaṇoddeśa-dīpikā* and other books. He was born in 1448 Śaka and wrote books until 1498 Śaka.

(24b) Śrī Śivānanda's two nephews —

63 Śrī Vallabha Sena and Śrīkānta Sena, related to Śivānanda, were wholly devoted to the Lord.

Anubhāṣya.

Śrī Vallabha Sena and Śrīkānta Sena were the sons of Śivānanda's sister. When they were coming to Purī, Nityānanda Prabhu abused, cursed and kicked their maternal uncle Śivānanda. Śrīkānta took offense, left the party and came to Mahāprabhu ahead of the others. The omniscient Lord knew this and told Govinda to give him His own *prasāda* for as long as he stayed in Nīlācala. At the Ratha-yātrā these two brothers were singers in Mukunda's party, one of the seven *kīrtana* parties (Madhya 13.41). In the *Gaura-gaṇoddeśa* (verse 174): “She who in Vraja was Kātyāyanī is now Śrīkānta Sena.”

(25) Śrī Govindānanda and (26) Śrī Govinda Datta —

64 Govindānanda, dear to the Lord, was a great devotee, and Śrī Govinda Datta was the leading singer in the Lord’s kīrtana.

Anubhāṣya.

Govindānanda was Mahāprabhu's companion in His first *kīrtana* in Navadvīpa. On the day the Lord drank water at Śrīdhara's house, he wept. He went to Puruṣottama for the Ratha-yātrā.

Govinda Datta was the Lord's companion in *kīrtana* in Navadvīpa and sang *kīrtana* with Mahāprabhu as the lead singer (*Caitanya-bhāgavata*, Antya, Chapter 9): "… he who, as lead singer, performs *kīrtana* with the Lord." His *śrīpāṭa* is in the village of Sukhacara on the southern border of Khaḍadaha.

(27) Śrī Vijaya dāsa —

65 Śrī Vijaya dāsa was the Lord's copyist; he wrote out many books for Him.

Anubhāṣya.

Vijaya dāsa was a scribe of Navadvīpa, one of the nine *nidhis*. He copied many books for the Lord, and for this Gaurahari gave him the name "Ratnabāhu." On the mercy Mahāprabhu showed Vijaya in Śuklāmbara's house, see the *Caitanya-bhāgavata*, Madhya, Chapter 25.

(28) Akiñcana Kṛṣṇadāsa —

66 The Lord named him Ratnabāhu, "Jewel-armed." Akiñcana Kṛṣṇadāsa, too, was dear to the Lord.

Anubhāṣya.

Akiñcana Kṛṣṇadāsa lived in Navadvīpa and was the Lord's companion. He came to Puruṣottama for the Ratha-yātrā. See the *Caitanya-bhāgavata*, Antya, Chapter 9.

(29) The virtues of Śrīdhara —

67 Śrīdhara, who sold cups of banana bark, was a dear servant of the Lord, and the Lord was always joking with him.

68 Every day the Lord took banana pith, banana flowers and fruit from him, and once He drank water from his broken iron pot.

Anubhāṣya.

Śrīdhara was a poor brāhmaṇa of Navadvīpa who lived on what the banana groves gave him. On the Lord's snatching from Śrīdhara, see the *Caitanya-bhāgavata*, Ādi, Chapter 8; on the Lord's mercy to Śrīdhara during the *sāt-prahariyā bhāva*,

Madhya, Chapter 9; on Śrīdhara's dancing when he heard the *kīrtana* on the day the Kazi was subdued, the beginning of Madhya, Chapter 23; on the Lord's drinking water in great joy from his old, holed iron pot, the end of Madhya, Chapter 23; and on how, the night before His *sannyāsa*, the Lord had Śacīdevī cook the gourd Śrīdhara had brought and ate it, Madhya, Chapter 16. He used to go to Puruṣottama for the Ratha-yātrā. According to Karṇapūra he is one of the twelve *gopālas*, "Kusumāsava-gopāla." In the *Gaura-gaṇoddeśa* (verse 133): "Paṇḍita Śrīdhara, the brāhmaṇa famed as a seller of *kholā* (banana bark), was in Vraja the jester named Kusumāsava."

(30) Śrī Bhagavān Paṇḍita —

69 Bhagavān Paṇḍita was a servant very dear to the Lord; once Kṛṣṇa had dwelt within his body.

Anubhāṣya.

Bhagavān Paṇḍita. *Caitanya-bhāgavata*, Antya, Chapter 9: "The scribe Paṇḍita Bhagavān set out, in whose body Kṛṣṇa had resided."

(31) Śrī Jagadīśa Paṇḍita and (32) Hiraṇya —

70 Jagadīśa Paṇḍita and Hiraṇya Mahāśaya received the compassionate Lord's mercy when He was still a child.

71 In these two houses, on the day of Ekādaśī, the Lord begged for the food offered to Viṣṇu and ate it Himself.

Anubhāṣya.

Jagadīśa Paṇḍita. In the *Gaura-gaṇoddeśa* (verse 192): "Two other wives of the sacrificing brāhmaṇas are Śrī Jagadīśa and Hiraṇya, whose food the Lord begged and ate on Ekādaśī." Verse 143: "He who in Vraja was Candrahāsa, a dancer expert in *rasa*, is this Śrī Jagadīśa Paṇḍita, who delights in dancing." How on the day of Ekādaśī the Lord ate the food offered to Viṣṇu in the house of Hiraṇya and Jagadīśa is described in CC Ādi 11.30 and 14.39 and in the *Caitanya-bhāgavata*, Ādi, Chapter 4. *Caitanya-bhāgavata*, Antya, Chapter 6: "Jagadīśa Paṇḍita is the abode of supreme effulgence; Nityānanda with His associates is his wealth and life."

Hiraṇya Paṇḍita. *Caitanya-bhāgavata*, Antya, Chapter 5: Nityānanda, alone and wearing very costly ornaments, was staying in Navadvīpa in the house of a good brāhmaṇa named Hiraṇya Paṇḍita. A chief of robbers tried again and again to take those ornaments from His body, but in the end, his plans frustrated, he took shelter at Nitāi's feet.

(33) Śrī Puruṣottama and (34) Śrī Sañjaya —

72 Puruṣottama and Sañjaya, two great souls, were the Lord's pupils in grammar.

Anubhāṣya.

Puruṣottama and Sañjaya. These two *paṇḍitas* lived in Navadvīpa: first they were the Lord's students, and later, when the *kīrtana* began, His companions. *Caitanya-bhāgavata*, Ādi, Chapter 10: "… Mukunda Sañjaya, a servant for many births. Puruṣottama dāsa is his son. Every day Gauracandra goes to teach at that fortunate man's home. The Lord first comes and sits in the Caṇḍī-maṇḍapa, and then the students gather one by one." *Caitanya-bhāgavata*, Antya, Chapter 9: "Puruṣottama Sañjaya set out with a joyful heart, he who was formerly the Lord's chief student." Thus, according to the description in the *Caitanya-bhāgavata*, Puruṣottama Sañjaya is the son of Mukunda Sañjaya. But Kavirāja Gosvāmī, intending to speak of two persons named "Puruṣottama" and "Sañjaya," used these two words three times and so corrected the idea of the *Caitanya-bhāgavata*.

(35) The branch of Śrī Vanamālī Paṇḍita —

73 Vanamālī Paṇḍita is a branch renowned throughout the world; he saw a golden club and plough in the Lord's hands.

Anubhāṣya.

Vanamālī Paṇḍita. "The auspicious Vanamālī Paṇḍita set out, he who saw the golden plough and club." In the *Gaura-gaṇoddeśa* (verse 144): "He who in Vraja, named Mālādhara, held the *veṇu* and the *muralī* (flutes) is now called Vanamālī Paṇḍita and is dear to Gaura." He saw the Lord in the mood of Baladeva. CC Ādi 17.119 and the *Caitanya-bhāgavata*, Antya, Chapter 9: in Śrīvāsa's house the Lord ascended the throne of Viṣṇu, took the plough and club from Nityānanda Prabhu and displayed a pastime; but it is not mentioned there that on that day Vanamālī Paṇḍita saw a golden plough and club in the Lord's hands.

(36) Śrī Buddhimanta Khān —

74 Buddhimanta Khān was very dear to Śrī Caitanya; obedient to Him all his life, he was among His chief servants.

Anubhāṣya.

Buddhimanta Khān was a wealthy devotee of Navadvīpa. He bore all the expenses of the Lord's second marriage, to Viṣṇupriyā Devī, the daughter of the royal *paṇḍita* Sanātana Miśra. When the Lord suffered a disorder of *vāyu* (air in the body), he arranged His treatment. He was the Lord's companion in water sports and in *kīrtana*, and in Candraśekhara's house, when the Lord enacted the play in the guise of Mahā-lakṣmī, he collected the clothes, ornaments and other things. He went to Nīlācala for the Ratha-yātrā.

(37) Śrī Garuḍa Paṇḍita —

75 Garuḍa Paṇḍita constantly chanted the auspicious holy name, and by the power of the name even a snake's poison could not harm him.

Anubhāṣya.

Garuḍa Paṇḍita lived in Navadvīpa and was the Lord's companion. *Caitanya-bhāgavata*, Antya, Chapter 9: "Śrī Garuḍa Paṇḍita set out joyfully, he whom snake poison could not overcome by the power of the holy name." In the *Gaura-gaṇoddeśa* (verse 17): "Garuḍa Paṇḍita is now he who was formerly known as Garuḍa."

(38) Śrī Gopīnātha Siṁha —

76 Gopīnātha Siṁha was a servant of Śrī Caitanya, and the Lord would jokingly call him Akrūra.

Anubhāṣya.

Gopīnātha Siṁha. *Caitanya-bhāgavata*, Antya, Chapter 9 (at the Ratha-yātrā): "Gopīnātha Siṁha Mahāśaya set out, he whom Gauracandra calls 'Akrūra.'" In the *Gaura-gaṇoddeśa* (verse 117): "He who was formerly named Akrūra is this Gopīnātha Siṁha."

(5a) The branch of Devānanda Paṇḍita —

77 Devānanda, the reciter of the *Bhāgavata*, is an offshoot of Vakreśvara's branch. By Vakreśvara's mercy he received from the Lord the devotional meaning of the *Bhāgavata*.

Anubhāṣya.

Devānanda. *Caitanya-bhāgavata*, Madhya, Chapter 21: "The Lord Viśvambhara went to the embankment of Maheśvara Viśārada, the father of Sārvabhauma. There Devānanda Paṇḍita lived." CC Madhya 1.153: "In the village of Kuliyā He bestowed His mercy on Devānanda." He desired liberation (he was a *mumukṣu*) and used to recite the *Bhāgavatam*. One day, during his recitation, Śrīvāsa Paṇḍita began to weep, and Devānanda's godless students drove Śrīvāsa out (*Caitanya-bhāgavata*, Madhya, Chapters 9 and 21). Long afterwards, one day Mahāprabhu came that way and saw Devānanda explaining the *Bhāgavatam*. In anger the Lord sharply rebuked Devānanda, who had no faith in the Vaiṣṇavas. Devānanda had no faith in Mahāprabhu either. But by his great good fortune Vakreśvara Paṇḍita once stayed at his house and sang *kīrtana* of Kṛṣṇa. Then by Vakreśvara's grace Devānanda understood the Lord's greatness, and the Lord told him to explain the *Bhāgavatam* in terms of devotion. He is Bhāguri Muni, the court *paṇḍita* of Nanda in Vraja: see the *Gaura-gaṇoddeśa*, verses 106 and 77.

(39) Mukunda, (40) Narahari, (41) Cirañjīva and (42) Sulocana of Śrī Khaṇḍa —

78–79 Mukunda dāsa, Śrī Raghunandana, Narahari dāsa, Ciranjīva and Sulocana, all of Śrīkhaṇḍa, are great branches, abodes of Śrī Caitanya's mercy. Everywhere they give away the fruits and flowers of love.

Anubhāṣya.

Mukunda dāsa was the son of Nārāyaṇa dāsa and the elder brother of Narahari Sarakāra Ṭhākura; the middle brother's name was Mādhava dāsa. His son was Raghunandana. Raghunandana's descendants still live in the village of Śrīkhaṇḍa, four miles west of Kāṭoyā. Raghunandana's son was Kānāi, and Kānāi had two sons: Madana Rāya (a disciple of Narahari Ṭhākura) and Vaṁśīvadana. In this family somewhat more than four hundred persons have been born up to the present. Their unbroken genealogy is kept at Śrīkhaṇḍa. In the *Gaura-gaṇoddeśa-dīpikā* (verse 170): "She who was formerly the mistress of Vraja, named Vṛndā-devī, is

now Śrī Mukunda dāsa of Khaṇḍa, dear to the Lord." For a description of Mukunda's most wonderful love for Kṛṣṇa, see this book, Madhya 15.113–131.

Raghunandana served the Deity of Śrī Gaura (see the *Bhakti-ratnākara*, eighth wave). In the *Gaura-gaṇoddeśa* (verse 70): "The third *vyūha*, Pradyumna, became the dear confidential friend (*priya-narma-sakha*) who assisted Rādhā and Mādhava in Their pastimes in Vraja." He is the third *vyūha*, Pradyumna Viṣṇu (see "Mukunda dāsa" above). For a description of the great festival at Śrīkhaṇḍa, see the *Bhakti-ratnākara*, ninth wave.

Narahari dāsa Sarakāra Ṭhākura. In the *Gaura-gaṇoddeśa* (verse 177[13]): "She who was formerly Madhumatī in Vṛndāvana, a dearest friend, is now the one called Narahari Sarakāra, dear to the Lord." His disciple was Śrī Locana dāsa Ṭhākura of Kogrāma near Jhāmaṭapura, the author of the *Śrī Caitanya-maṅgala*. In that book Śrī Gadādhara and Śrī Narahari are described as most dear to Śrī Mahāprabhu. In the *Caitanya-bhāgavata*, however, there is hardly any special mention of the residents of Khaṇḍa.

Cirañjīva and Sulocana were both residents of Khaṇḍa. Their homes can still be seen in Śrīkhaṇḍa, and their descendants are living. Cirañjīva Sena had two sons: the elder, Rāmacandra Kavirāja, was a disciple of Śrīnivāsa Ācārya and a companion of Ṭhākura Mahāśaya; the younger was Govinda dāsa Kavirāja, the composer of *padas*. Cirañjīva's wife was Sunandā, and his father-in-law was Dāmodara Sena Kavirāja of Khaṇḍa. Cirañjīva formerly lived in the village of Kumāranagara on the bank of the Bhāgīrathī (*Bhakti-ratnākara*).

Cirañjīva is Candrikā of Vraja. *Gaura-gaṇoddeśa*, verses 197 and 207: "Cirañjīva and Sulocana of Khaṇḍa, great through their association with Narahari, whose only shelter is Gaurāṅga."

Residents of Kulīnagrāma — (20b) Rāmānanda, (20c) Yadunātha, (20d) Puruṣottama, (20e) Śaṅkara, (20f) Vidyānanda —

80 From Kulīna-grāma came Satyarāja, Rāmānanda, Yadunātha, Puruṣottama, Śaṅkara and Vidyānanda.[4]

Anubhāṣya.

Rāmānanda Vasu. In the *Gaura-gaṇoddeśa*: "Kalakaṇṭhī and Sukaṇṭhī, the two singer-actresses in Vraja, are Rāmānanda Vasu and Satyarāja respectively." Yadunātha, Puruṣottama, Śaṅkara, Vidyānanda and the others were all born in the

Vasu family. Everyone in this Vasu family was a devotee of Kṛṣṇa and highly skilled in dramatic performances of Kṛṣṇa's pastimes; the memory of these performances is preserved even today. They were pure devotees, followers of Haridāsa Ṭhākura. See the comment on verse 48 above.

(20g) The glory of the residents of Kulīnagrāma headed by Vāṇīnātha Vasu —

81 Vāṇīnātha Vasu and all the other villagers were servants of Śrī Caitanya, and He was the treasure of their lives.

82 The Lord said, "Even a dog of Kulīna-grāma is dear to Me — what to speak of its people!

83 "The good fortune of the people of Kulīna-grāma is beyond words: even the Ḍoma who herds the pigs there sings of Kṛṣṇa."

(43) The branch of Śrī Sanātana, (44) Śrī Rūpa and (45) Śrī Anupama —

84 Anupama Vallabha, Śrī Rūpa and Sanātana are counted as the three branches on the western side of the tree.

Anubhāṣya.

Anupama was the father of Śrī Jīva Gosvāmī and the younger brother of the two Gosvāmīs, Śrī Sanātana and Śrī Rūpa. His former name was Śrī Vallabha, and the name "Anupama" was given him by Śrī Mahāprabhu. Because the brothers served the Bādaśāha of Gauḍa, they bore the title "Mallika." "Anupama Mallika — his name was Śrī Vallabha; Śrī Rūpa Gosāñi's younger brother, a great Vaiṣṇava." (CC Madhya 19.36)

In the twelfth century of the Śaka era, in the land of Karṇāṭa, in a royal family of brāhmaṇas, there arose a great soul named Sarvajña, a *jagad-guru* of the Bharadvāja *gotra*. His son Aniruddha had two sons, Rūpeśvara and Harihara. Both were deprived of the kingdom, and the elder, Rūpeśvara, settled in Śikharabhūmi. Rūpeśvara's son Padmanābha settled in a village called Naihāṭī on the bank of the Gaṅgā and had five sons. The son of the youngest of them, Mukunda, was Kumāradeva, a man of exemplary conduct, the father of Sanātana, Rūpa and Anupama. Kumāradeva lived in Bākalā-Candradvīpa; his home was in a

place called Phateyābāda, in what was then the province of Yaśohara. Of his several sons, three accepted the Vaiṣṇava *dharma*. Śrī Vallabha, together with his elder brothers Śrī Rūpa and Śrī Sanātana, moved from Candradvīpa for their work to the village of Rāmakeli in Gauḍa. There Śrī Jīva Gosvāmī was born. Because they served in the Nawab's government, all three received the title “Mallika.” When Śrī Mahāprabhu went to Rāmakeli, Anupama met Him for the first time. When Śrī Rūpa Gosvāmī gave up worldly work and set out for Śrī Vṛndāvana, seeking Śrī Mahāprabhu's feet, Vallabha became his companion. For the description of their meeting with Mahāprabhu at Prayāga, see Madhya, Chapter 19.

From Śrī Mahāprabhu, Śrī Rūpa and Anupama went to Vṛndāvana. This is known from Śrī Mahāprabhu's words to Sanātana: “Rūpa and Anupama, both went to Vṛndāvana” (CC Madhya 20.66). At that time Subuddhi Rāya was living in the city of Mathurā, selling dry wood; with this he maintained himself and served other Vaiṣṇavas. When Śrī Rūpa and Anupama reached him, he was especially pleased and took them with him through the twelve forests of Vṛndāvana. The two brothers stayed a month in Vṛndāvana and then came to Prayāga along the Gaṅgā in search of Śrī Sanātana Gosvāmī. But Śrī Sanātana came to Mathurā by the royal road, and the three brothers could not meet. Subuddhi Rāya told Sanātana about Anupama and Rūpa. Anupama and Śrī Rūpa both came to Kāśī, heard everything from Mahāprabhu, and after ten days set out for Gauḍa. Having settled their worldly affairs there, both set out for Nīlācala by Śrī Mahāprabhu's order. In 1436 Śaka, on the way, on the bank of the Gaṅgā, Anupama attained the abode of Śrī Rāmacandra. Śrī Rūpa Gosvāmī informed Śrīman Mahāprabhu in Nīlācala that his younger brother had attained that abode.

Because Vallabha was a worshipper of Śrī Rāma, he could not fully accept the path of worship in Vraja shown by Śrīman Mahāprabhu. He knew Śrīman Mahāprabhu to be Śrī Rāmacandra Himself. In the book *Bhakti-ratnākara* it is written of Anupama: “Śrī Gaurasundara gave him the name Anupama. He was always absorbed in serving the Deity of Raghunātha and knew no one but Raghunātha. Caitanya Gosāñi is Śrī Raghunātha Himself.”

Śrī Rūpa. In the *Gaura-gaṇoddeśa* (verse 180): “She who was formerly known in Vṛndāvana as Śrī Rūpa-mañjarī has now become manifest as the one called Rūpa Gosvāmī.” *Bhakti-ratnākara*, ninth wave: “Śrī Rūpa Gosvāmī wrote sixteen books: (1) the poem *Haṁsadūta* and (2) the *Uddhava-sandeśa*; (3) the *Kṛṣṇa-janma-tithi-vidhi*, with its countless injunctions; (4) the *Gaṇoddeśa-dīpikā*, both the large and the small; (5) the *Stava-mālā*; (6) the *Vidagdha-mādhava*, full of

rasa; (7) the *Lalita-mādhava*, the very limit of *vipralambha*; (8) the *Dāna-līlā-kaumudī*, a great ocean of bliss — (9) known by this name, the *Dāna-keli-kaumudī*; (10) the incomparable book *Bhakti-rasāmṛta-sindhu*; (11) the book *Śrī Ujjvala-nīlamaṇi*, full of *rasa*; the most sweet book (12) *Prayuktākhyāta-candrikā*; (13) the *Mathurā-mahimā*, (14) the well-known *Padyāvalī*; (15) the *Nāṭaka-candrikā*, (16) the *Laghu-bhāgavatāmṛta*. At the Vaiṣṇavas' wish he composed eleven verses and gave them to Kṛṣṇadāsa Kavirāja to elaborate. The Gosvāmī also composed separate prayers (*stavas*); collected by Śrī Jīva, they were named the *Stava-mālā*. Briefly he also set out the characteristics of the *viruda*; the *Govinda-virudāvalī* is its example." See CC Madhya 1.35–44 and Antya 4.219–231.

Śrī Rūpa's giving up worldly affairs — Madhya 19.4; his division of wealth — 7; his coming to Prayāga and meeting the Lord — 37 and 45; his honoring *prasāda* with Anupama in Vallabha Bhaṭṭa's house — 88; the Lord's instruction at Prayāga — 135–233; the Lord's order to go to Vṛndāvana — 237; Rūpa's return to Gauḍa and Anupama's attaining the Gaṅgā (leaving his body on the Gaṅgā) — Antya 1.37; his coming to Ṭhākura Haridāsa's hut in Śrī Kṣetra and meeting the Lord and His associates — 48 and 54; the Lord's praise of Śrī Rūpa's handwriting; the verse in accord with the feelings of the Lord's heart; the beginning of the *Lalita-mādhava* and *Vidagdha-mādhava* and the praise of Śrī Rāma Rāya — 68–192; the Lord's wish to reveal the scriptures of devotion and His order to Śrī Rūpa to go to Vṛndāvana — 202, 216; Rūpa's going to Vṛndāvana — 211; his meeting Sanātana Prabhu when Sanātana came to Vṛndāvana — Antya 4.213; and his carrying out Gaura's order — 217–222.

Sanātana. In the *Gaura-gaṇoddeśa* (verse 181): "She who was formerly Rati-mañjarī, dearest to Rūpa-mañjarī, and whom the wise call by another name, Lavaṅga-mañjarī, is now Sanātana, whose body is non-different from Gaura's and who is worshipped by all. For some purpose Sanātana, the jewel among sages, also entered him." *Bhakti-ratnākara*, first wave: "Śrī Sanātana's guru was Vidyāvācaspati; from time to time he stayed in the village of Rāmakeli. Under him Sanātana studied all the scriptures. I cannot describe how great his devotion to his guru was. His father, on seeing a *yavana*, would perform atonement, yet he himself constantly had to keep company with such *yavanas*. Depending on them, he went to the *yavanas*' houses, and so he considered himself equal to a *mleccha*. Therefore he considered himself utterly low and wretched. Sinking into the ocean of humility, he considered himself lower than the *mlecchas* and others.

With people of low birth he always behaved humbly; that is why he spoke of himself as ‘of low birth and so on.’ Though a king among brāhmaṇas, with deep sorrow in his heart he never thought of himself as a brāhmaṇa.”

Bhakti-ratnākara, first wave: “Sanātana Gosvāmī's four books: the two parts of the *Bhāgavatāmṛta* with commentary; the commentary on the *Hari-bhakti-vilāsa*, the *Dig-darśinī*; the *ṭippanī* on the Tenth Canto named *Vaiṣṇava-toṣaṇī*; and the *Līlā-stava*, which is called the *Daśama-carita*. These are the four books of Sanātana Gosvāmī. In fourteen hundred seventy-six (1476) the *Bṛhat* (that is, the *Vaiṣṇava-toṣaṇī*) was completed, and in fifteen hundred four Śaka (1504) the well-accepted *Laghu-toṣaṇī*. (Mahāprabhu) through Rāmānanda destroyed the pride of Kandarpa, through Dāmodara revealed indifference (*nairapekṣya*), through Haridāsa made tolerance known, and through Sanātana and Rūpa revealed humility.”

Sanātana's pondering how to give up worldly affairs — Madhya 19.13; his study of the *Bhāgavatam* on the pretext of illness — 15; the Bādaśāha's coming to see him — 18; his imprisonment by the Bādaśāha — 27; his refusal to go with the Bādaśāha to war in Orissa — 29; the letter Rūpa sent to Sanātana in prison when leaving home — 32 and 20.3; his release by bribing the jailer — 4; his escape with his only servant Īśāna, saving himself from the clutches of a robber chief by giving eight *mohars*, crossing the mountains with the robber's help, dismissing Īśāna and going on alone — 16–25; his meeting with his sister's husband Śrīkānta at Hājipura, his refusal to stay there, and the Bhoṭa blanket he accepted from him — 38–44; his arrival in Vārāṇasī and meeting the Lord in Candraśekhara's house — 51; how he had himself shaved, changed his dress and made an outer cloth and *kaupīna* from the old cloth given by Tapana Miśra — 68–77; alms in the house of a Mahārāṣṭrian brāhmaṇa — 79; his questions to the Lord about the truth and the Lord's teaching: (1) knowledge of *sambandha* — 20.98 through the whole of Chapter 21; (2) *abhidheya* — the whole of Chapter 22; (3) *prayojana* — 23.3–93; the order to Sanātana to write the conclusions of devotion, restore lost holy places, establish a Vaiṣṇava society by compiling the Vaiṣṇava *smṛti*, and spread the scriptures of devotion — 97; the blessing — 118; the explanation to him of the *ātmārāma* verse, first in eighteen and then in sixty-one ways — 24.4–308; Sanātana's going to Mathurā by the royal road and meeting Subuddhi Rāya — 203–204; Sanātana's coming again to Nīlācala by the Jhārikhaṇḍa route — Antya 4.3; his resolve to give up his body under the wheel of the chariot — 12; meeting Haridāsa and seeing the Lord with His associates — 14–22; hearing of Anupama's

attaining the Gaṅgā and of his glory — 30–47; the Lord's disapproval of Sanātana's resolve to give up his body — 54–65; the Lord's wish to accomplish His own purposes through Sanātana Gosvāmī — 76–88; Sanātana's description of the glory of Haridāsa Ṭhākura — 100–103; his walking to the Lord over hot sand, keeping to propriety for fear of touching the servants of Jagannātha, and the Lord's satisfaction on seeing this — 115–131; his request, on Jagadānanda's words, for permission to go to Vṛndāvana — 141–155; the Lord's praise of Sanātana — 163–170; the Lord's love for Sanātana's transcendental body and His embrace, by which he obtained a divine body — 172–198; the Lord's order to stay a year in Nīlācala — 200; His sending him to Vṛndāvana — 207; his going to Vṛndāvana and meeting Śrī Rūpa after a long time — 213; and his carrying out Gaura's order — 217–222.

The *śrīpāṭa* of Śrī Rūpa and Śrī Sanātana Gosvāmīs is Śrī Rāmakeli ("Gupta Vṛndāvana," the hidden Vṛndāvana), about eight miles south of the present town of Iṁrejabājāra. The following places can be seen there: (1) the Deity Śrī Śrī Madana-mohana, installed by Śrī Sanātana; (2) the *keli-kadamba* tree: tradition says that beneath this tree, at midnight, Śrī Rūpa and Śrī Sanātana Gosvāmīs met Śrīman Mahāprabhu, and Mahāprabhu with His associates gave the devotees the nectar of *prema*; (3) the Rūpa-sāgara, a large pond made by Śrī Rūpa Gosvāmī Prabhu. To dredge this pond and restore the lost glory of the Śrī Rāmakeli *pāṭa*, the "Rāmakeli Restoration Committee" (*Rāmakeli-saṁskāra-samiti*) was founded at Māladaha on 8.6.24 (English calendar).

(44a) Śrī Jīva —

85 Among them Rūpa and Sanātana are the great branch, and Anupama, Jīva, Rājendra and others are its offshoots.

Anubhāṣya.

Of Jīva the *Gaura-gaṇoddeśa* (verse 203) says: "Jīva, the son of Śrī Vallabha, is gentle, learned and handsome." According to verse 195, in the pastimes of Vraja he is Vilāsa-mañjarī. As a boy Śrī Jīva loved the *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam*. Later he came to Navadvīpa and, following Śrī Nityānanda, walked around Śrī Navadvīpa-dhāma and saw its holy places. From there he went to Kāśī and studied all the scriptures under Madhusūdana Vācaspati; then he went to Vṛndāvana and took shelter of Śrī Rūpa and Sanātana. The *Śrī Bhakti-ratnākara* (first wave) says: "Twenty-five books of Śrī Jīva are known: (1) the grammar *Harināmāmṛta*,

wonderful in its design; (2) the *Sūtra-mālikā*; (3) the excellent *Dhātu-saṅgraha*; (4) the most wonderful book *Kṛṣṇārcā-dīpikā*; (5) the *Gopāla-virudāvalī*; (6) the *Rasāmṛta-śeṣa*; (7) the *Śrī Mādhava-mahotsava*, excellent in every part; (8) the book *Śrī Saṅkalpa-kalpavṛkṣa*; (9) the most wonderful *campū Bhāvārtha-sūcaka*; (10) a commentary on the *Gopāla-tāpanī*; (11) a commentary on the *Brahma-saṁhitā*; (12) a commentary on the *Rasāmṛta* (13) and on the *Śrī Ujjvala*; (14) a commentary on the *Yogasāra-stava*, in which everything is well reconciled; (15) a commentary on the Śrī Gāyatrī of the *Agni Purāṇa*; (16) the marks on Śrī Kṛṣṇa's feet according to the *Padma Purāṇa*; (17) separately, the marks on Śrī Rādhikā's hands and feet; (18) the *Gopāla-campū* in two parts, *Pūrva* and *Uttara* — what a wonder he described, the whole world knows; (19–25) the seven famous *Sandarbhas*, which follow the *Bhāgavatam*: the *Krama-*, *Tattva-*, *Bhagavat-*, *Paramātma-*, *Kṛṣṇa-*, *Bhakti-* and *Prīti-sandarbha*."

After Śrī Rūpa, Sanātana and the others withdrew from view, he stood at the head of the Gauḍīya Vaiṣṇava *sampradāya* as its foremost ācārya in Gauḍa, Utkala and Māthura-maṇḍala. He proclaimed to everyone the truth that Śrī Gaurasundara had preached and brought them to the worship of Hari. From time to time he walked around Vraja-dhāma with the devotees and went to Mathurā to see Viṭṭhala-deva. Śrīla Kavirāja Gosvāmī wrote the *Caitanya-caritāmṛta* while Śrī Jīva was still present. Some time later Śrī Jīva gave Śrīnivāsa, Narottama and Duḥkhī Kṛṣṇadāsa, who had come from Gauḍa, the names "Ācārya," "Ṭhākura" and "Śyāmānanda," and sent them to Gauḍa with all the books of the Gosvāmīs to preach the holy name and *prema*. First he heard the news that the books had been stolen, and later the news that they had been recovered. He gave the name "Kavirāja" to Śrīnivāsa's disciple Rāmacandra Sena and to Rāmacandra's younger brother Govinda. While he was still present, Śrīla Jāhnavā Devī came to Vṛndāvana with a few devotees. When devotees arrived from Gauḍa, he arranged *prasāda* for them and showed them where to stay. His disciple Śrī Kṛṣṇadāsa Adhikārī gave a list of the books of Śrī Rūpa, Sanātana and Jīva in his own book.

In the ignorant *sampradāya* of the *prākṛta-sahajiyās* three slanders against Śrī Jīva Gosvāmī Prabhu are current. The *sahajiyās* have turned away from Kṛṣṇa, and these slanders grow from enmity toward Hari, guru and Vaiṣṇavas; by spreading them they only increase their offenses.

(1) A *digvijayī paṇḍita* who hungered for worldly fame obtained from the selfless Śrī Rūpa and Sanātana a written admission of defeat, and so declared Śrī

Jīva's gurus (Śrī Rūpa and Sanātana) to be ignorant; then he demanded the same document from Śrī Jīva. Hearing this, Śrī Jīva Prabhu defeated the *digvijayī* and silenced the tongue of the guru's slanderer. In this way he showed that he honored even the luster of the nails on his Gurudeva's feet, and gave the example of a true disciple, for whom the guru is his deity and his very self[14]. These *sahajiyās* say that such conduct contradicted the humility of one "lower than a blade of grass" and the duty to honor others; therefore Śrī Rūpa Gosvāmī Prabhu rebuked him sharply and sent him away, and later, at a sign from Śrī Sanātana Gosvāmī Prabhu, accepted Śrī Jīva Prabhu again.

On the day when, by Kṛṣṇa's mercy, these opponents of guru and Vaiṣṇavas understand that they are eternal servants of guru and Vaiṣṇavas, they will receive the mercy of Śrī Jīva Prabhu. Then they will truly become "lower than a blade of grass" and "giving honor to others," and will become qualified for the *kīrtana* of the holy name.

(2) Some ignorant people say: Śrī Jīva saw how beautifully Kavirāja Gosvāmī Prabhu had written the *Caritāmṛta* and how it revealed the glory of the transcendental *rasa* of Vraja. He feared for his own fame, envy arose in him, and he threw the original *Caritāmṛta* into a well. Hearing of this, Kavirāja Gosvāmī gave up his body. And the *Caritāmṛta*, they say, came to light again only because his disciple named "Mukunda" had earlier copied the original manuscript; otherwise the book would have vanished from the world.

Such fabrications, born of hatred for Vaiṣṇavas, are utterly false and absurd.

(3) Certain other libertines, devoted to gratifying their senses, say: Śrī Jīva Prabhu did not accept the *parakīyā-rasa* of the *gopīs* of Vraja, which Śrī Rūpa Gosvāmī accepts, and approved the *svakīyā-rasa*; therefore he was not a *rasika* devotee, and his example is not to be followed.

During his lifetime Śrī Jīva saw that some devotees among his followers had a taste for *svakīyā-rasa*. For their good he took their qualification (*adhikāra*) into account. He also feared that unqualified people would fail to grasp the beauty and glory of the transcendental, supreme and most wonderful *parakīyā-rasa* of Vraja, would try to imitate it themselves and so fall into debauchery. For this reason Śrī Jīva Prabhu, the ācārya of the Vaiṣṇavas, accepted the *svakīyā* doctrine. But one must not conclude from this that he opposed the transcendental *parakīyā-rasa* of Vraja, for he himself is the foremost follower of Śrī Rūpa and one of the *śikṣā-gurus* of Śrīla Kavirāja Gosvāmī himself.

The spread of the branch of Śrī Rūpa and Sanātana, and their work —

86 By the gardener's wish these branches grew so vast that they covered all the western lands.

The deliverance of all India —

87 They spread as far as the banks of the Sindhu and the Himālaya, over Vṛndāvana, Mathurā and every holy place.

*Everyone maddened by *prema* —*

88 The fruits of love from these two branches flooded everything, and tasting them the people grew mad with love.

(1) Establishing the conduct of devotion —

89 The people of the west were all foolish and of degraded conduct; there the two brothers taught the good conduct of bhakti.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Through contact with the *yavanas*, the people of the western lands had partly lost the sense of their duty, and compared with the good customs of Bengal they lived largely without proper conduct. At that time, under the influence of the Muslims, they had strayed still further from proper conduct. By the mercy of Śrī Rūpa and Sanātana they became inclined to good conduct (*sadācāra*).

(2) Recovering the lost holy places and (3) spreading the worship of the Deities —

90 Guided by the scriptures they recovered the lost holy places, and in Vṛndāvana they spread the worship of the Deities.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

The lost holy places are Śrī Śrī Rādhā-kuṇḍa and others. The Deities: they spread the worship of seven Deities — Śrī Madana-mohana, Śrī Govinda, Śrī Gopīnātha and others.

(45) Śrī Raghunātha dāsa —

91 Raghunātha dāsa was a dear servant of Mahāprabhu; giving up everything, he made his home at the Lord's feet.

Anubhāṣya.

Raghunātha dāsa was born in about 1416 Śaka in the village of "Śrī Kṛṣṇapura" in Hugalī district, in a family of Kāyasthas (by birth), in the house of Govardhana, the younger brother of Hiraṇya Majumadāra.

Śrī Kṛṣṇapura, where Śrīla Raghunātha dāsa Gosvāmī Prabhu appeared, lies a little more than a mile from Saptagrāma and about one and a half miles from Triśabighā station. There resides the Deity of Śrī Rādhā-Govinda, said to have been installed by Śrī Govardhana dāsa, the father of Śrīla Dāsa Gosvāmī Prabhu in his former *āśrama*. In front of the temple is a wide courtyard; there is no *nāṭya-mandira*, only a *jagamohana*. A year ago Śrīyukta Haricaraṇa Ghoṣa of Simlā, Calcutta, had the temple repaired. The temple courtyard is enclosed by a wall. In a small room next to the one where the Deity resides, a low stone seat (one and a half cubits long, one and a quarter cubits wide and three quarters of a cubit high) is shown as the "seat of worship" (*bhajanāsana*) of Śrīla Dāsa Gosvāmī Prabhu. Tradition says that Śrīla Dāsa Gosvāmī Prabhu sat on it and performed his worship. Beside the temple lies the Sarasvatī river, shallow and without current, thin and faded.

His forefathers were nearly Vaiṣṇavas and very wealthy. His *dīkṣā-guru* was Yadunandana Ācārya. Soon after entering family life he sought the shelter of Śrī Mahāprabhu. A little later, in 1439 Śaka, he seized an opportunity, left home for Puruṣottama, attained the cool lotus feet of Śrī Caitanya-deva and remained under the guidance of Dāmodara Svarūpa. He stayed there sixteen years; after the Lord withdrew from view, he came to Śrī Vṛndāvana and lived near Śrī Rūpa and Sanātana. *Bhakti-ratnākara* (first wave): "The three books of Raghunātha dāsa Gosvāmī: the *Stava-mālā*, which is called the *Stavāvalī*, the *Śrī Dāna-carita* and the sweet *Mukta-carita*."

He lived a very long life. Before Śrīnivāsa Ācārya returned from Vṛndāvana with the books, he received the mercy of Śrī Dāsa Gosvāmī, as the same book says in the sixth wave: "His body was extremely emaciated, weaker at every moment; he ate a little once in two or four days. Day and night he knew nothing but chanting the holy name; there was no sleep in his eyes, and streams of tears flowed from

both. On seeing Śrī Dāsa Gosvāmī, Śrīnivāsa thought himself fortunate and fell at his feet. Śrī Dāsa Gosvāmī embraced Śrīnivāsa. Śrīnivāsa told him that he was going to Śrī Gauḍa. Hearing this, Śrī Gosvāmī gave his permission with his own lips." This took place after 1512 Śaka. The *Gaura-gaṇoddeśa* (verse 186) says: "The former name of Dāsa Śrī Raghunātha is Rasa-mañjarī. Some call him Śrīmatī Rati-mañjarī, and some call him Bhānumatī; the difference is only in the name."

Śrī Raghunātha's service to Gaura under the guidance of Śrī Svarūpa —

92 The Lord placed him in the care of Svarūpa, with whom he rendered the Lord confidential service.

After Śrī Gaura and Svarūpa withdrew from view — coming to Vṛndāvana —

93 For sixteen years he served the Lord intimately, and when Svarūpa departed from this world, he came to Vṛndāvana.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
"Hidden service": those services to which outsiders have no access. The intimate services dear to the Lord, needed when He bathes, eats, rests, sings *kīrtana* and so on, are here also called *antaraṅga-sevā*, intimate service.

94 He thought, "In Vṛndāvana I shall see the feet of the two brothers, and then at Govardhana I shall give up my body by throwing myself from the hill."

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
"Throwing myself down": falling from a high mountain peak.

Meeting with Śrī Rūpa and Sanātana —

95 With this resolve he came to Vṛndāvana and bowed down at the feet of Rūpa and Sanātana.

The third brother of Śrī Rūpa and Sanātana —

96 But the two brothers would not let him die; they kept him close by as their own third brother.

97 From his lips the two brothers constantly heard all the pastimes of Mahāprabhu, both outer and inner.

His daily practices —

98 He gave up food and water, to say nothing of anything else, taking only two or three palas of buttermilk.

Anubhāṣya.
Māṭhā: buttermilk.

99 Every day he offered a thousand prostrations, chanted a hundred thousand names and bowed down to two thousand Vaiṣṇavas.

100 Night and day he served Rādhā and Kṛṣṇa within his mind, and for one prahara he spoke of the life of Mahāprabhu.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
“Day and night he served Rādhā and Kṛṣṇa within his mind”: together with chanting (*kīrtana*) the holy name, he meditated on the service of the eight periods of the day (*aṣṭa-kālīya sevā*).

101 At dawn, noon and evening he bathed in Rādhā-kuṇḍa without fail, and he embraced the Vaiṣṇavas of Vraja.

102 He spent seven and a half praharas a day in the practice of bhakti and slept for four daṇḍas — on some days not even that.

The author's conviction that he is the eternal servant of Rūpa and Raghunātha —

103 His way of practice is wonderful to hear of. These two, Rūpa and Raghunātha, are my masters.

Anubhāṣya.
Śrī Kṛṣṇadāsa Kavirāja Gosvāmī Prabhu regarded Śrīla Dāsa Gosvāmī and Śrī Rūpa Gosvāmī as “my masters,” and at the end of every chapter he wrote: “Praying

at the feet of Śrī Rūpa and Śrī Raghunātha, I, Kṛṣṇadāsa, narrate the *Caitanya-caritāmṛta*.” Some want the word “Raghunātha” to mean Śrī Raghunātha Bhaṭṭa and call Raghunātha Bhaṭṭa the *pāñcarātrika dīkṣā-guru* of Kavirāja Gosvāmī; there is no evidence for this. The guru-succession of Kavirāja's branch does mention Raghunātha Bhaṭṭa as his *dīkṣā-guru*, but this mention does not establish any reliable truth.

104 How each of them met the Lord I shall describe in detail later.[5]

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
“Later”: for the Lord's meeting with Raghunātha see Antya, Chapter 6.

Anubhāṣya.
For the Lord's meeting with Śrī Rūpa see Madhya, Chapter 19, verse 45; for His meeting with Śrī Sanātana, Madhya, Chapter 20, verse 51; and for His meeting with Śrī Raghunātha, Antya, Chapter 6, verse 191.

(46) The branch of Śrī Gopāla Bhaṭṭa —

105 Śrī Gopāla Bhaṭṭa is a branch of the very highest order; he would converse about love with Rūpa and Sanātana.

Anubhāṣya.
Śrī Gopāla Bhaṭṭa was the son of Veṅkaṭa Bhaṭṭa, a resident of Raṅga-kṣetra, and the disciple of Prabodhānanda (formerly a follower of Rāmānuja, later a Gauḍīya). In 1433 Śaka, when Mahāprabhu stayed for the Cāturmāsya vow in Śrī Raṅga-kṣetra in the house of Veṅkaṭa Bhaṭṭa of the Śrī-sampradāya, Gopāla Bhaṭṭa served the Lord with all his heart. He received initiation from his paternal uncle, the *tridaṇḍī* Śrīmat Prabodhānanda Sarasvatī, as the *Hari-bhakti-vilāsa* (first *vilāsa*, verse 2) says: “Gopāla Bhaṭṭa, the disciple of Prabodhānanda, who is dear to the Lord, gathers the pastimes (*vilāsas*) of devotion to please Raghunātha dāsa, Rūpa and Sanātana.” *Bhakti-ratnākara* (first wave): “Gopāla's mother and father were most fortunate: they gave their minds and lives to the feet of Śrī Caitanya. They told their son to go to Vṛndāvana, and both departed remembering the Lord. After some time Gopāla went to Vṛndāvana and met Rūpa and Sanātana. *** (To the Lord in Nīlācala) Śrī Rūpa and Sanātana wrote in a letter that Gopāla Bhaṭṭa had come to Vṛndāvana. (The Lord) rejoiced at Gopāla's coming and writes in a letter to His dear Rūpa and Sanātana: ‘Know Gopāla**

Bhaṭṭa to be your own brother.' * In Gopāla's name Śrī Gosvāmī Sanātana composed the *Śrī Hari-bhakti-vilāsa*. Śrī Rūpa Gosvāmī loved him as his own life and entrusted him with the service of Śrī Rādhā-ramaṇa. *** (To Kavirāja Gosvāmī) Śrī Gopāla Bhaṭṭa gladly gave his order, but forbade him to write about him in the book. Kavirāja could not disobey his order: he writes only his name and makes nothing else known. He always considered himself most lowly." — "All this I heard from the mouths of the elders" (the words of the author, Ghanaśyāma dāsa).

At the beginning of the *Tattva-sandarbha*, the first of the *Ṣaṭ-sandarbha* (after the obeisances to Śrī Rūpa and Sanātana), it is said: "A certain Bhaṭṭa, their friend, born in a family of southern brāhmaṇas, wrote a book after sifting what the elder Vaiṣṇavas had written. His original draft ran in order in some places, out of order in others, and in fragments in yet others. Having examined it and arranged it in order, the insignificant Jīva writes." That is: Śrī Gopāla Bhaṭṭa, the dear friend of the two masters Śrī Rūpa and Sanātana, a southerner born in a twice-born family, gathered arguments and other material from the books of the ancient Vaiṣṇava ācāryas — Śrī Madhva, Śrī Rāmānuja, Śrīdhara Svāmī and others — and wrote a book. What he wrote there in order in some places, out of order — that is, breaking the sequence — in others, and in fragments in yet others, I, a tiny *jīva*, have examined and now set down properly and in order. The same words appear at the beginning of the *Bhagavat-sandarbha* and the other *Sandarbhas*. Gopāla Bhaṭṭa is the author of the *Sat-kriyā-sāra-dīpikā*, the compiler of the *Hari-bhakti-vilāsa* and the first writer of the *Ṣaṭ-sandarbha*. "He wrote a commentary on the *Kṛṣṇa-karṇāmṛta*; hearing it, the Vaiṣṇavas feel the highest joy." He installed the Deity of Śrī Rādhā-ramaṇa. The *Gaura-gaṇoddeśa* (verse 184) says: "She who was Anaṅga-mañjarī is now Gopāla Bhaṭṭa. Some call Bhaṭṭa Gosvāmī Śrī Guṇa-mañjarī." Śrīnivāsa Ācārya and Gopīnātha Pūjārī were his disciples.

(47) The branch of Śaṅkarāraṇya, (47a) Mukunda, (47b) Kāśīnātha, (47c) Rudra —

106 Śaṅkarāraṇya is one branch of the Ācārya's tree, and Mukunda, Kāśīnātha and Rudra are recorded as its offshoots.

Anubhāṣya.

Śaṅkarāraṇya. The *Gaura-gaṇoddeśa* (verse 60) says: "His elder brother did not take a wife. He is Saṅkarṣaṇa, Bhagavān, who appeared on earth as Viśvarūpa. It is said that he passed his own splendor on to Purīśvara and, having taken *sannyāsa*

earlier, withdrew from view." He withdrew from view in 1432 Śaka at the holy place Pāṇḍerapura in Śolāpura district — see Madhya, Chapter 9, verses 299–300.

Mukunda (Mukunda Sañjaya). Viśvambhara kept His school in Mukunda's house, and his son Puruṣottama was a student of the Lord.

Kāśīnātha was the brāhmaṇa *paṇḍita* who arranged Viśvambhara's wedding. He advised Rāja-paṇḍita Sanātana to give his daughter Viṣṇupriyā-devī in marriage to the Lord. The *Gaura-gaṇoddeśa* (verse 50) says: "The brāhmaṇa whom Satrājit sent to Mādhava to arrange the marriage of Satyā — that matchmaker is now Śrī Kāśīnātha."

Rudra. The *Gaura-gaṇoddeśa* (verse 135) says: "Kṛṣṇacandra's friend in Vraja named Varūthapa is now Rudra Paṇḍita, dear to Gaurāṅga."

Vallabhapura lies a mile north of Māheśa, the *śrīpāṭa* of Kamalākara Pippalāi. Here, in a large temple, resides Śrī Rādhā-vallabha Jiu, installed by Śrī Rudrarāma Paṇḍita, the son of Kāśīśvara Gosvāmī's sister. The present servitors of Śrī Rādhā-vallabha Jiu are the "Cakravartīs," descendants of Yadunandana Bandyopādhyāya Mahāśaya, the younger brother of Rudrarāma Paṇḍita. Formerly, at the time of the Ratha-yātrā, Śrī Jagannātha-deva used to come from Māheśa to the temple of Śrī Rādhā-vallabha Jiu at Vallabhapura, but from the (Bengali) year 1262 the custom was discontinued because of quarrels among the servitors of that Deity.

(48) Śrīnātha Paṇḍita, who received the mercy of Śrīman Mahāprabhu, a wonderful example of service to Śrī Kṛṣṇa —

107 Śrīnātha Paṇḍita received the Lord's mercy; seeing his service to Kṛṣṇa, the three worlds were captivated.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

"Śrīnātha Paṇḍita": a resident of Kāṁcaḍāpāḍā.

Anubhāṣya.

Śrīnātha Paṇḍita. The *Gaura-gaṇoddeśa* (verse 211) says: "He who skillfully expounded the *Bhāgavata-saṁhitā*, and whose glory is Kṛṣṇa-deva, who resides in Kumārahaṭṭa."

About one and a half miles from Kumārahaṭṭa, at Kāṁcaḍāpāḍā, is the place of Śivānanda Sena. There, in a very large temple, reside the Deity "Śrī Gaura-Gopāla," installed by Śivānanda, and the Deity of Śrī Rādhā-Kṛṣṇa named "Śrī

Kṛṣṇa-rāya," installed by the brāhmaṇa Śrīnātha. In front of the temple are a large courtyard, a kitchen for cooking the offerings, a guesthouse and so on. The courtyard is enclosed by a high wall. This temple is larger even than the temple at Māheśa. The present temple was built in 1708 Śaka. In front of the temple a verse in the *anuṣṭubh* meter is engraved, giving the names of the temple's founder, his father and his grandfather, and the date. The temple was built by a wealthy man named Nimāi Mallika of Pāthuriyāghāṭā, Calcutta, now deceased. Śrīnātha Paṇḍita was a disciple of Śrī Advaitācārya; Śivānanda's third son, Paramānanda Kavi Karṇapūra, the author of the *Gaura-gaṇoddeśa-dīpikā*, received the mercy of Śrīnātha Paṇḍita. The Deity Śrī Kṛṣṇa-rāya probably manifested in the time of Kavi Karṇapūra. Tradition says that Vīrabhadra Prabhu brought a large and beautiful stone from Murśidābāda, and from it three Deities manifested: Śrī Rādhā-vallabha of Vallabhapura, Śrī Śyāmasundara of Khaḍadaha and Śrī Kṛṣṇa-rāya of Kāṁcaḍāpāḍā.

The old place of Śivānanda Sena is on the bank of the Gaṅgā; a small, almost ruined temple stood there. It is said that Nimāi Mallika was traveling to Kāśī, went ashore at this place, saw with his own eyes the ruined state of Śrī Kṛṣṇa-rāya's temple and built the present large temple.

(49) Śrī Jagannātha Ācārya —

108 Jagannātha Ācārya was a dear servant of the Lord; at the Lord's command he made his home by the Gaṅgā.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

"He lived by the Gaṅgā": he founded a village named "Gaṅgāvāsa" on the bank of the Alakānandā within Śrī Navadvīpa.

Anubhāṣya.

Jagannātha Ācārya. The *Gaura-gaṇoddeśa* (verse 111) says: "Ācārya Śrī Jagannātha, who lived by the Gaṅgā and was dear to the Lord, was formerly, in Nidhuvana, Durvāsā, dear to the *gopīs*."

(50) Kṛṣṇadāsa, (51) Śekhara Paṇḍita, (52) Kavicandra and (53) Ṣaṣṭhīvara —

109 Other branches are Kṛṣṇadāsa Vaidya, Paṇḍita Śekhara, Kavicandra and the kīrtana singer Ṣaṣṭhīvara;

(54) Śrīnātha Miśra, (55) Śubhānanda, (56) Śrīrāma, (57) Īśāna, (58) Śrīnidhi, (59) Gopīkānta, (60) Bhagavān Miśra —

110 Śrīnātha Miśra, Śubhānanda, Śrīrāma, Īśāna, Śrīnidhi, Śrī Gopīkānta, Bhagavān Miśra;

Anubhāṣya.

Kavicandra and Śrīnātha Miśra. The *Gaura-gaṇoddeśa* (verse 171) says: "Śrīnātha Miśra is Citrāṅgī; Kavicandra is Manoharā."

Śubhānanda is Mālatī of Vraja. During the dancing before the chariot he was one of the singers in the party of Śrīvāsa and Nityānanda, one of the seven *kīrtana* parties, and he drank the foam that flowed from the mouth of the Lord when He was overwhelmed by *bhāva* (see Madhya, Chapter 13, verse 110). See the *Gaura-gaṇoddeśa*, verses 197 and 199.

Īśāna. *Caitanya-bhāgavata* (Madhya, Chapter 8): "Īśāna served Āi (Śacī) at all times; in all the fourteen worlds he is most fortunate." In the *Vaiṣṇava-vandanā*: "With folded hands I shall bow to Īśāna dāsa, whom Śacī Ṭhākurāṇī loved so much." *Bhakti-ratnākara* (twelfth wave): "That Īśāna is very dear to Nimāi-cāṁda."

(61) Subuddhi Miśra, (62) Hṛdayānanda, (63) Kamalanayana, (64) Maheśa Paṇḍita, (65) Śrīkara, (66) Madhusūdana —

111 Subuddhi Miśra, Hṛdayānanda, Kamala-nayana, Maheśa Paṇḍita, Śrīkara, Śrī Madhusūdana;

Anubhāṣya.

Subuddhi Miśra is Guṇacūḍā of Vraja (*Gaura-gaṇoddeśa*, verses 194 and 201). His *śrīpāṭa* is "Belagāṁ," three miles west of Śrīkhaṇḍa. The Deities of Śrī Nitāi-Gaura are there. His present descendant is Śrī Govindacandra Gosvāmī.

Kamalanayana is Gandhonmādā of Vraja (*Gaura-gaṇoddeśa*, verses 205 and 196).

Maheśa Paṇḍita: see Ādi, Chapter 11, verse 32.

(67) Puruṣottama, (68) Śrī Galīma, (69) Jagannātha dāsa, (70) Śrī

Candraśekhara, (71) Dvija Haridāsa —

112 Puruṣottama, Śrī Gālīma, Jagannātha dāsa, Śrī Candraśekhara Vaidya, Dvija Haridāsa;

Anubhāṣya.

Candraśekhara Vaidya. When Mahāprabhu stayed in Kāśī, He lived in his house. He earned his living as a scribe. See Ādi, Chapter 7, verse 45 and the *Anubhāṣya* on it; Chapter 10, verses 152 and 154; Madhya, Chapter 17, verse 92; Chapter 19, verses 241–243; Madhya, Chapter 20, verses 46–53 and 67–71; Chapter 25, verses 62 and 172.

Dvija Haridāsa. It is uncertain whether he is the author of the *Aṣṭottara-śata-nāma*. His two sons, Śrīdāma and Gokulānanda, residents of Kāñcanagaḍiyā, were disciples of Śrīnivāsa Ācārya Prabhu. Kāñcanagaḍiyā is in Murśidābāda district, within five miles of "Bājārasāu" station, the fifth station from Ājimagañja.

(72) Rāmadāsa, (73) Kavidatta, (74) Gopāla dāsa, (75) Raghunātha, (76) Śārṅga Ṭhākura —

113 Rāmadāsa, Kavidatta, Śrī Gopāla dāsa, Bhāgavatācārya, Ṭhākura Sāraṅga dāsa;

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

"Bhāgavatācārya" lived in Varāhanagara. Even now his *āśrama* is called "the *pāṭa* of Bhāgavatācārya." "Ṭhākura Sāraṅga dāsa" lived in Māmagāchi.

Anubhāṣya.

Śrī Gopāla dāsa. The *Gaura-gaṇoddeśa* (verse 158) says: "Those who were formerly Śrī Tārakā and Pālī in Vraja-maṇḍala are now Jagannātha and Śrī Gopāla, dear to the Lord."

Bhāgavatācārya. The *Gaura-gaṇoddeśa* (verse 203) says: "Śrīmad Bhāgavatācārya, who wrote the book *Kṛṣṇa-prema-taraṅgiṇī*, is extremely dear to Gaurāṅga." *Caitanya-bhāgavata* (Antya, Chapter 5): "Then the Lord came to Varāhanagara, to the house of a most fortunate brāhmaṇa. That brāhmaṇa was thoroughly learned in the *Bhāgavata*. Seeing the Lord, he began to recite the *Bhāgavata*. Hearing him recite on *bhakti-yoga*, Gauracandra Nārāyaṇa was overwhelmed with ecstasy. The Lord said: 'Never have I heard anyone else recite the *Bhāgavata* like this. Therefore your name is "Bhāgavatācārya." Do no other

work but this.'" His name is said to have been "Raghunātha." His *pāṭa* is at Mālipāḍā in Varāhanagara (about three and a half miles north of Calcutta), on the bank of the Gaṅgā. The present servitor of this dilapidated *pāṭa* is Dhīrendra Gāṅguli, the son of the late Rājacandra Gāṅguli.

Ṭhākura Sāraṅga dāsa: his other name is Śārṅga Ṭhākura. Some also call him Śārṅgapāṇi and Śārṅgadhara. He lived in Modadrumadvīpa within Śrī Navadvīpa and worshipped in solitude on the bank of the Gaṅgā. The Lord urged him again and again to accept a disciple, and at last he resolved: "Whomever I meet tomorrow at dawn, him I will accept as my disciple." The next day at dawn, as he bathed in the Bhāgīrathī, a dead body drifted against his feet; he brought it back to life and accepted it as his disciple. That disciple became famous by the name "Śrī Ṭhākura Murāri." His followers, in the line of descent, now live in a village called "Śar." The story of Murāri is bound up with the name of Śrī Śārṅga: even now the name "Śārṅga-Murāri" is heard everywhere.

Today in the village of Māmagāchi there is an old service of Śārṅga Ṭhākura. Recently a temple of Śrī Ṭhākura was built in front of an old *bakula* tree. One wishes that the service there were arranged even better.

The *Gaura-gaṇoddeśa* (verse 172) says: "She who in Vraja was Nāndīmukhī is now Sāraṅga Ṭhākura. Some consider him to be Prahlāda, but my father does not think so."

(77) Jagannātha Tīrtha, (78) Jānakīnātha, (79) Gopāla Ācārya, (80) Dvija Vāṇīnātha —

114 Jagannātha Tīrtha, the brāhmaṇa Śrī Jānakīnātha, Gopāla Ācārya and the brāhmaṇa Vāṇīnātha.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
"The brāhmaṇa Vāṇīnātha" lived in Campāhāṭī.

Anubhāṣya.
Jagannātha Tīrtha: see Ādi, Chapter 9, verse 14 (*Anubhāṣya*).

Vāṇīnātha. The *Gaura-gaṇoddeśa* (verse 204) says: "The brāhmaṇa Vāṇīnātha, who lived in Campāhaṭṭa, is dear to the Lord." In Vraja he is Kāmalekhā. Campāhaṭṭa, or Cāṁpāhāṭi, is a small, little-known village in Barddhamāna district, under Pūrvasthalī police station and Samudragaḍa post office. The servitors of the

Śrī Caitanya Maṭha at Śrī Māyāpura in ancient Navadvīpa, headed by Śrī Paramānanda Brahmacārī, saw how disordered and neglected the service at this ancient *śrīpāṭa* had become. In the Bengali year 1328 they restored the *pāṭa* and built a new temple. In it the two life-sized Deities installed by Śrī Vāṇīnātha, Śrī Gaura and Gadādhara, delightful to the eyes and the mind, are worshipped according to scripture. The temple of Śrī Gaura-Gadādhara is at Cāṁpāhāṭi, two miles from Samudragaḍa, or Navadvīpa, station on the E.I.R. line.

(81) Govinda, (82) Mādhava, (83) Vāsudeva —

115 Govinda, Mādhava and Vāsudeva were three brothers, and when they sang kīrtana, Caitanya and Nitāi danced.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
"Govinda" installed the Deity of Gopīnātha at Agradvīpa.

Anubhāṣya.
Govinda, Mādhava and Vāsudeva Ghoṣa were three brothers born in a family of Kāyasthas (by birth) of Uttara-Rāḍha. *Caitanya-bhāgavata* (Antya, Chapter 5): "The pious Mādhava Ghoṣa was devoted to *kīrtana*; there is no such *kīrtana* singer anywhere on earth. He is called the singer of Vṛndāvana; he is most dear to Nityānanda-svarūpa. Mādhava, Govinda and Vāsudeva, the three brothers, began to sing, and Lord Nitāi danced." The *Gaura-gaṇoddeśa* (verse 188) says: "Kalāvatī, Rasollāsā and Guṇatuṅgā lived in Vraja and sang the songs composed by Śrī Viśākhā. They are now considered to be Govinda, Mādhavānanda and Vāsudeva, respectively." In Śrī Kṣetra, when the chariot was being pulled, Mahāprabhu formed seven *kīrtana* parties; in one of them these three brothers were the main singers, and Vakreśvara Paṇḍita himself was their chief dancer (Madhya, Chapter 13, verses 42–43).

(84) Ṭhākura Abhirāma —

116 Rāmadāsa Abhirāma was a treasury of loving friendship. He lifted a log that it took sixteen men to carry and made a flute of it.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
"Abhirāma" lived in Khānākula-Kṛṣṇanagara.

Preaching the holy name in Gauḍa: Nitāi with Abhirāma, Mādhava and Vāsu Ghoṣa —

117 At the Lord's command Nityānanda went to Gauḍa, and by the Lord's command three devotees went with Him:

Anubhāṣya.
See Madhya, Chapter 15, verses 42–43.

(81) Śrī Govinda Ghoṣa Ṭhākura —

118 Śrī Rāmadāsa, Mādhava and Vāsudeva Ghoṣa. Govinda stayed with the Lord, and was overjoyed to do so.

Anubhāṣya.
Rāmadāsa: see Ādi, Chapter 11, verses 13–16, and Madhya, Chapter 15, verses 42–43.

(75), (41), (39a), (85) Mādhavācārya, (86) Kamalākānta, (87) Yadunandana —

119 Other branches are Bhāgavatācārya, Ciranjīva, Śrī Raghunandana, Śrī Mādhavācārya, Kamalākānta and Śrī Yadunandana.[6]

Anubhāṣya.
Mādhavācārya is Mādhavī of Vraja (*Gaura-gaṇoddeśa*, verse 169), a branch of Nityānanda and the husband of Śrīmatī Gaṅgā-devī, the daughter of Nityānanda Prabhu. He received initiation from Puruṣottama (Nāgara) of Nityānanda's company. It is said that at Gaṅgā-devī's wedding Nityānanda Prabhu gave Pāṁjinagara to Mādhava. His *śrīpāṭa* is Jīrāṭ (near the station of that name on the E.I.R. line); see Chapter 11, verse 38.

Kamalākānta is Kamalākānta Viśvāsa of Advaita's company.

Yadunandanācārya belongs to Advaita's branch (Antya, Chapter 6, verses 160–169).

(88) Jagāi and (89) Mādhāi —

120 Jagāi and Mādhāi received the Lord's great mercy; these two brothers bear witness to His name "Deliverer of the Fallen."

Anubhāṣya.

Jagāi and Mādhāi. The *Gaura-gaṇoddeśa* (verse 115) says: "Jaya and Vijaya, the doorkeepers of Vaikuṇṭha, have now been born by their own will as Śrī Jagannātha and Mādhava." Both lived in Navadvīpa and, though brāhmaṇas by birth, lived by banditry and indulged in every kind of sin. Later, by the mercy of Śrī Mahāprabhu and Nityānanda Prabhu, they received the holy name, and both became *mahā-bhāgavatas*. Mādhāi has descendants; they are *kulīna* brāhmaṇas. On the road to Ākāihāṭ, a mile south of Kāṭoyā, in the village of "Ghoṣahāṭ," or Mādhāitalā, is the *samāja* (tomb) of Jagāi and Mādhāi. It is said that about two hundred years ago Gopīcaraṇa dāsa Bābājī restored the place and installed the Deities of Śrī Nitāi-Gaura.

Of the countless devotees of Gauḍa only a few Vaiṣṇavas are named —

121 I have given a brief account of the devotees of Gauḍa; Śrī Caitanya's devotees are endless and cannot be counted.

Their service to Gaura both in Gauḍa and in Oḍra —

122 All these devotees were also with the Lord in Nīlācala, and in both places they served Him in many ways.

A list of only those servants who gathered in Nīlācala —

123 Now I shall speak briefly of the Lord's devotees who were with Him only in Nīlācala.

The foremost — (1) Śrī Paramānanda and (2) Śrī Svarūpa —

124–126 Of all the devotees who lived with the Lord in Nīlācala, two were foremost, the Lord's very heart: Paramānanda Purī and Svarūpa Dāmodara. With them were Gadādhara, Jagadānanda, Śaṅkara, Vakreśvara, Dāmodara Paṇḍita, Ṭhākura Haridāsa, Raghunātha Vaidya and Raghunātha dāsa.

Anubhāṣya.

Raghunātha Vaidya. *Caitanya-bhāgavata*, Antya, Chapter 5 (at Pāṇihāṭī): "At that moment Raghunātha Vaidya came, a supreme Vaiṣṇava whose good qualities are endless." When Nityānanda was going to Gauḍa, his companions on the way

displayed the moods of Vraja. *Caitanya-bhāgavata* (Antya, Chapter 5): “Raghunātha Vaidya Upādhyāya, great of mind, became like Revatī in person.” The same book, Antya, Chapter 6: “Whoever receives his glance feels attraction to Kṛṣṇa.” See *Caitanya-caritāmṛta*, Ādi, Chapter 11, verse 22. He lived in Purī by the seashore and wrote a book named *Sthāna-nirūpaṇa*.

127 These and other great devotees, His companions from before, stayed in Nīlācala and served the Lord there.

128 And all the devotees who lived in Gauḍa came every year to Nīlācala to see the Lord.

129 Now I shall list the devotees who first met the Lord in Nīlācala.

(3) The branch of Sārvabhauma, (4) Gopīnāthācārya —

130 One great branch is Sārvabhauma Bhaṭṭācārya, and another is his sister’s husband, Śrī Gopīnātha Ācārya.

Anubhāṣya.

Sārvabhauma Bhaṭṭācārya's name was “Vāsudeva.” He was the son of Maheśvara Viśārada, a well-known resident of the village “Vidyānagara,” two and a half miles from present-day Navadvīpa, or Cāṁpāhāṭī. It is said that he learned the entire *nyāya-śāstra* by heart from Pakṣadhara Miśra, the chief teacher of the famous school of logic in Mithilā and the foremost logician of India in those days; then he founded a school of logic in Navadvīpa and began to teach. In the history of *nyāya-śāstra* this marked a turning of the ages: from then on Navadvīpa eclipsed Mithilā, and even today it is known throughout India as the foremost seat of the study of logic. According to some, the famous logician Raghunātha Śiromaṇi, author of the *Dīdhiti*, was his student. However that may be, Sārvabhauma gained profound learning in logic and Vedānta and, while remaining in the householder *āśrama*, accepted *kṣetra-sannyāsa* and taught Vedānta in Nīlācala. He made Mahāprabhu hear Vedānta as interpreted in Śaṅkara's commentary, and afterwards learned the true meaning of Vedānta from the Lord. He saw the Lord's six-armed form. His *Caitanya-śataka* reveals devotion to Gaura; in particular the two verses beginning *vairāgya-vidyā-nija-bhakti-yoga* are the summit of

Sārvabhauma's learning. For the Lord's meeting with Sārvabhauma, their discussion and his deliverance, see Madhya, Chapter 6. The *Gaura-gaṇoddeśa* (verse 119) says: “Bhaṭṭācārya Sārvabhauma was formerly Gīṣpati (Bṛhaspati) in heaven.”

Gopīnātha Ācārya was a brāhmaṇa of Navadvīpa and a companion of the Lord. He was the husband of Sārvabhauma's sister. The *Gaura-gaṇoddeśa* (verse 178) says: “She who was formerly in Vraja the *prāṇa-sakhī* named Ratnāvalī is now the ācārya named Gopīnātha, renowned for his purity.” According to some, he is Brahmā. The *Gaura-gaṇoddeśa* (verse 75) says: “Brahmā, the lord of the universe, is to be known by the name Gopīnāthācārya; those who know the Tantras count him among the nine *vyūhas* in the Tantra.”

(5) Kāśī Miśra, (6) Pradyumna Miśra, (7) Rāya Bhavānanda —

131 Then come Kāśī Miśra, Pradyumna Miśra and Bhavānanda Rāya, whose company gave the Lord great joy.

Anubhāṣya.

Kāśī Miśra was the royal priest. Mahāprabhu lived in his house in Nīlācala. Later the place passed to Śrī Vakreśvara Paṇḍita, and in the time of his disciple Śrī Gopāla-guru Gosvāmī the Deity “Śrī Rādhākānta” was installed there. The *Gaura-gaṇoddeśa* (verse 193) says: “She who was formerly in Mathurā Sairindhrī, beloved of Kṛṣṇa, is now Kāśī Miśra, a resident of Nīlācala, dear to the Lord.”

Pradyumna Miśra was a resident of Oḍiśā. *Caitanya-bhāgavata* (Antya, Chapter 5): “Śrī Pradyumna Miśra is an ocean of Kṛṣṇa's happiness; Śrī Gaurasundara gave him His own feet.” Antya, Chapter 8: “Śrī Pradyumna Miśra is foremost in *prema-bhakti*.” (*Caitanya-caritāmṛta*, Madhya 10.43): “Pradyumna Miśra is the foremost of the Vaiṣṇavas; he is Jagannātha's *mahāsoyāra*, called by the name ‘Dāsa.’” The Lord showed His mercy by making Pradyumna Miśra, a brāhmaṇa by birth, a disciple of the *mahā-bhāgavata* Śrī Rāmānanda, who was not born in a brāhmaṇa family — a disciple by hearing *hari-kathā* from him. For this see Antya, Chapter 5.

Bhavānanda Rāya was the father of Śrī Rāmānanda Rāya. He lived near Brahmagiri, or Ālālanātha, six *krośas* west of Purī. By caste he was a Karaṇa (by birth). For his five sons see verse 133. He was formerly known as “King Pāṇḍu.”

132 Embracing him, the Lord said, “You are Pāṇḍu, and your sons are the five Pāṇḍavas:

(8) The five brothers headed by Śrī Rāya Rāmānanda —

133 “Rāmānanda Rāya, Gopīnātha Paṭṭanāyaka, Kalānidhi, Sudhānidhi and Vāṇīnātha Nāyaka.

134 “These five sons of yours are dear to Me, and between Rāmānanda and Me there is a difference of body alone.”

Anubhāṣya.

Rāmānanda Rāya. The *Gaura-gaṇoddeśa* (verses 120–124) says: “A certain Arjuna, a *priya-narma-sakha* (an intimate friend of Kṛṣṇa), and Arjuna the Pāṇḍava together became Rāmānanda Rāya, dear to the Lord. Therefore the expert Rāmānanda described to Gauracandra day after day the truths of devotion and love for Rādhā and Kṛṣṇa and so on. Some call him Lalitā, but others do not accept this[15]. Gaura said to Bhavānanda: ‘You are the husband of Pṛthā.’ Therefore the best authorities say that Arjuna the Pāṇḍava, having become one with the *gopī* Arjunīyā, is Rāya Rāmānanda. That both Arjunīyā and Arjuna the Pāṇḍava were fully present in him is clearly stated in the *Uttara-khaṇḍa* of the *Padma Purāṇa*. Therefore Rāmānanda Rāya Mahāśaya is all three.” According to some, he is Viśākhā-devī (see Madhya, Chapter 8, Antya, Chapter 5 and elsewhere). His place among the intimate devotees is very high. The Lord's words: “I am a *sannyāsī* and consider Myself detached. Yet, let alone seeing a woman, if I merely hear a woman's name, My body and mind are disturbed. Who can remain steady on seeing a woman? … His body and mind are unmoved, like wood or stone; how wonderful that his mind stays unmoved at the touch of young women! Only Rāmānanda has this qualification. From this I know that his body is transcendental. Only he knows the state of his mind; there is no one else able to know it. ***” (*Caitanya-caritāmṛta*, Antya 5.35–36, 41–43) “Though a householder, Rāya is not under the sway of the six enemies; though engaged in worldly affairs, he instructs *sannyāsīs*.” (Antya 5.80)

With Śrī Svarūpa and with him, Mahāprabhu in His final pastimes constantly tasted the many varieties of Rādhā's *mahābhāva* in separation from Śrī Kṛṣṇa (Madhya, Chapter 2, verse 77); the Lord was won over by his pure friendship (*sakhya*)

(ibid., 78). Sārvabhauma's words (Madhya, Chapter 7): “Rāmānanda Rāya lives on the bank of the Godāvarī; he is the governor of Vidyānagara. … in all the world there is no devotee who relishes rasa (*rasika*) as he does. In learning and in the rasa of devotion he has reached the limit of both.” (Madhya 7.62, 64–65)

See further: the Lord's meeting with Śrī Rāmānanda Rāya; the Lord has Rāya speak on the truths of the goal and the means (*sādhya* and *sādhana*) and listens to him; the Lord shows Rāya His form as Rasarāja and Mahābhāva; the Lord's words: “I am one madman and you are a second madman; therefore you and I are equal” (Madhya 8.290); the Lord tells Rāma Rāya to give up his government service and go to Śrī Kṣetra (Madhya, Chapter 8). After the Lord's preaching in the South — His second meeting with Rāma Rāya; Rāya sends the Lord on to Nīlācala (Madhya, Chapter 9, verses 319–335) and later meets the Lord in Nīlācala (Madhya, Chapter 11, verse 15). Rāya's efforts to obtain the Lord's mercy for King Pratāparudra (Madhya, Chapter 12, verses 41–57); water sports with Sārvabhauma after the *kīrtana* on the day of the Ratha-yātrā (Madhya, Chapter 14, verse 82). Rāya is unwilling to let the Lord go to Vṛndāvana (Chapter 16, verses 10 and 85) but at last, yielding to the Lord's request, consents; the Lord's meeting with the king at Kaṭaka (ibid., 105); the Lord takes leave of Rāya at Remuṇā (ibid., 153); instead of going to Vṛndāvana the Lord returns to Nīlācala by way of Gauḍa and meets Rāya (ibid., 254). His discussion of *rasa* with Śrī Rūpa and his praise of Rūpa's poetry (Antya, Chapter 1, verses 115–196); Rāma Rāya's renunciation equals Sanātana's (ibid., 201). He is one of the “three and a half” vessels of the *rasa* of love for Śrī Rādhā and Kṛṣṇa (Antya, Chapter 2, verse 106); his meeting with Sanātana (Antya, Chapter 4, verse 110); Rāya speaks about Kṛṣṇa to Pradyumna Miśra, whom the Lord sent to him; the Lord praises Rāya (Antya, Chapter 5, verses 4–85). “As Subala formerly helped Kṛṣṇa's happiness, so Rāma Rāya is there to give happiness to Gaura.” (Antya 6.9) “The power of Rāmānanda cannot be described. By Rāya's grace I came to know the pure mood of Vraja.” (Antya 7.37) “Rāmānanda Rāya is the treasury of the *rasa* of Kṛṣṇa; he made Me understand that Kṛṣṇa is Bhagavān Himself.” (Antya 7.23) In the final pastimes the Lord, with Rāma Rāya and Svarūpa, tasted the *rasa* of songs and laments of separation from Kṛṣṇa (Antya, Chapters 14–20). Rāmānanda Rāya wrote the drama *Śrī Jagannātha-vallabha*.

(13) Bhagavān Ācārya, (14) Brahmānanda Bhāratī, (15) Śikhi and (16) Murāri

135–136 Other branches are King Pratāparudra, Kṛṣṇānanda of Orissa, Paramānanda Mahāpātra, Śivānanda of Orissa, Bhagavān Ācārya, Brahmānanda Bhāratī, Śrī Śikhi Māhiti and Murāri Māhiti.

Anubhāṣya.

Pratāparudra was the emperor of Utkala, of the Gaṅgā dynasty (a Gajapati). His capital was Kaṭaka. Having heard of Mahāprabhu's qualities, he served Him long in humble dress and longed for Him, and then, with the help of Rāma Rāya and Sārvabhauma, received His mercy. The *Gaura-gaṇoddeśa* (verse 118) says: "The great king Indradyumna, who formerly worshipped Jagannātha, has now been born as Pratāparudra, equal to Indra." At his wish Karṇapūra wrote the drama *Caitanya-candrodaya*.

Paramānanda Mahāpātra. *Caitanya-bhāgavata* (Antya, Chapter 5): "All the followers born in Utkala recognized the Lord of their lives. Śrī Paramānanda Mahāpātra Mahāśaya — Śrī Caitanya is his very body and life; he is full of *bhakti-rasa*."

Anubhāṣya.

Bhagavān Ācārya lived in Hālisahara; his son's name was Raghunātha (*Bhakti-ratnākara*). He was lame. Madhya 10.184: "*** and Bhagavān Ācārya: both stayed at the Lord's feet, giving up all their work." Antya, Chapter 2: "In Puruṣottama, near the Lord, was Bhagavān Ācārya, a supreme Vaiṣṇava, very learned and noble. His heart was filled with the mood of friendship; he was an incarnation of a cowherd boy, and he dealt with Svarūpa Gosāñi as a friend. He had taken shelter of Caitanya's feet with exclusive devotion, and from time to time he invited the Lord for a meal." (Antya 2.84–86) It was in his house, when the Lord came for a meal, that it came out that Choṭa Haridāsa had begged fine rice from Mādhavī-devī for the Lord and so had spoken with a woman; for this Mahāprabhu rejected him (see Antya, Chapter 2, verses 101–166). Bhagavān Ācārya was very generous and guileless. His father, Śatānanda Khān, was a thoroughly worldly man, and his younger brother, Gopāla Bhaṭṭācārya, was a Māyāvādī. Gopāla studied the Māyāvāda commentary in Kāśī and came to his elder brother in Purī; out of affection Bhagavān wanted to hear Māyāvāda from him, but Śrī Svarūpa stopped him, saying that it is hostile to devotion (Antya, Chapter 2, verses 89–100). One day a Bengali poet, a mere versifier whom Bhagavān had known before,

composed a drama contrary to the teachings of devotion, brought it, stayed at his lodging and wanted to recite it to the Lord. Śrī Svarūpa had doubts, but Bhagavān begged him to hear the drama. As soon as the poet recited the *nāndī* verse, Śrī Svarūpa showed how much in the drama contradicted the teachings of devotion. In the end the poet took shelter at the feet of the devotees (Antya, Chapter 5, verses 91–166). See *Caitanya-bhāgavata*, Antya, Chapter 3. The *Gaura-gaṇoddeśa* (verse 74) says: “The lame Ācārya Bhagavān is said to be a *kalā* (portion) of Gaura.”

Śikhi Māhiti. The *Gaura-gaṇoddeśa* (verse 189) says: “Rāgalekhā and Kalākeli, maidservants of Rādhā, are now known as Śikhi Māhāti and his sister Mādhavī, respectively.” Both he and his sister were intimate and qualified devotees of the Lord from Utkala. The *Caitanya-carita-mahākāvya* (canto 13, 89–109) tells of them. In Puruṣottama-kṣetra lived a great soul named Śikhi Māhiti (Mahānti), pure-hearted and compassionate. He was a servant of Śrī Jagannātha, the ornament of Nīlācala. His younger brother was named Murāri Māhiti, and his younger sister was the pure-minded Mādhavī-devī. The younger brother and sister were both devoted to Gaurasundara: their inborn, steady and auspicious intelligence never allowed them to forget Śrī Gaurasundara. Now Vṛndāvanacandra Kṛṣṇa has risen on this earth in the form of Gauracandra and constantly showers this brother and sister with Gaura's affection. They tried their utmost to bring their elder brother Śikhi Māhiti, the loving servant of Jagannātha, the Lord of Nīlācala, to the worship of Śrī Gaurasundara, but Śikhi Māhiti would not take up the worship of Gaura at all.

One day, after hearing his siblings' advice and reflecting on it long and hard, he fell asleep, and toward dawn he started up: he had dreamed that his younger siblings, who see Gaura's lotus feet, were waking him. At this wonderful dream his hair stood on end; doubly amazed and overjoyed, he slowly opened his tear-filled eyes and saw his brother and sister. Awake now and seeing those great younger ones beside him, he embraced them with great joy. They were all astonished. Śikhi Māhiti began to tell them: “Brother, listen to the dream I have had — it is most wonderful. Only today have I become convinced that the glory of Śrī Śacī's son is immeasurable. I saw Gaurasundara looking at the Lord of Nīlācala, entering into Him moment after moment, coming out again and again and looking at Him once more — such is the pastime He was displaying. How wonderful! Even now I see the Supreme Lord Gaurasundara in that very state — are my eyes deceiving me? Ah, that ocean of boundless mercy, Gaurasundara, saw me near Jagannātha-deva,

called me by name and, as it were, embraced me with His long, raised, graceful arms." So, with his hair standing on end, tears in his eyes and his voice choked with love, Śikhi spoke these words and went out. Murāri and Mādhavī, hearing their elder brother's words, asked him to go to Jagannātha for the Lord's *darśana*. Then all three agreed and went for the *darśana* of the Lord of Nīlācala. Murāri and Mādhavī saw the Lord in the *jagamohana* and shed tears of joy, but the elder, Śikhi Māhiti, saw Gaurasundara on all sides exactly as he had seen Him in the dream, in the very same mood, and his heart blossomed with love. The supremely magnanimous Mahāprabhu said, "Are you Murāri's elder brother?" and embraced him with both arms; and Śikhi Māhiti, his mind absorbed in service to Gaura, felt immense happiness. From then on Śikhi Māhiti, intoxicated by the fragrance of Gaura's lotus feet, forgot everything else and served Śrī Gaura, the Lord of his heart.

Murāri Māhiti. Madhya 10.44: "This is Murāri Māhiti, the brother of Śikhi Māhiti. He has no refuge but Your feet."

(17) Mādhavī-devī —

137 Mādhavī Devī, the sister of Śikhi Māhiti, is counted among the maidservants of Śrī Rādhā.

Anubhāṣya.

Mādhavī-devī (Antya, Chapter 2, verses 104–106): "She whom the Lord counts among Rādhikā's company. In all the world there are only three and a half such vessels: Svarūpa Gosāñi and Rāya Rāmānanda, Śikhi Māhiti — these three; and his sister is the half." (Antya 2.105–106)

(18) Kāśīśvara, (19) Govinda —

138 Brahmacārī Kāśīśvara was a disciple of Īśvara Purī, and Śrī Govinda was his dear follower.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

"Govinda and Kāśīśvara" were disciples of Īśvara Purī. When Īśvara Purī attained perfection, they came at his command to Mahāprabhu in Nīlācala.

Anubhāṣya.

Govinda was Mahāprabhu's personal servant. The *Gaura-gaṇoddeśa* (verse 137) says: “Those who were formerly the servants Bhṛṅgāra and Bhaṅgura in Vṛndāvana have now been born as Śrī Kāśīśvara and Govinda, the servants of the Lord.” For the Lord's meeting with Govinda, the disciple of Īśvara Purī, see Madhya, Chapter 10, verses 131–148. The Lord was won over “by the pure *dāsya-rasa* of Govinda and others” (Madhya, Chapter 2, verse 78). For the sake of the Lord's service Govinda did not hesitate to step over the Lord's body, but for his own sake he feared the offense in such an act: “Govinda said: ‘My service is my rule. Let there be offense, or even going to hell.’” (Antya 10.95) See Madhya, Chapter 10, verses 82–100[16].

139 At the time of his departure both received his order, came to Nīlācala and met the Lord.

Honoring all that is connected with the guru and reasoning that “the order of the guru is not to be questioned,” He accepts their service —

140 Out of regard for their connection with His Guru, the Lord honoured them both, yet in obedience to the Guru’s order He gave them His service.

The service of Govinda and Kāśīśvara to Gaura —

141 The Lord gave Govinda the service of His person, and when He went to see Jagannātha, Kāśīśvara walked ahead of Him.

142 Through the dense crowd the Lord passed untouched, for the mighty Kāśīśvara pushed the people aside and cleared the way.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

“Without touching”: without making contact.

Thus ends the tenth chapter of the “Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.”

(20) Rāmāi, (21) Nandāi —

143 Rāmāi and Nandāi, both servants of the Lord, served constantly alongside Govinda.

Anubhāṣya.

Rāmāi and Nandāi. The *Gaura-gaṇoddeśa* (verse 139) says: “Payoda and Vārida, who formerly prepared the water, are now the two servants known as Rāmāi and Nandāi.” They served the Lord under Govinda's guidance.

144 Every day Rāmāi filled twenty-two jars of water, and Nandāi served as Govinda directed.

(22) The brāhmaṇa Kālā Kṛṣṇadāsa —

145 A pure Kulīna brāhmaṇa named Kṛṣṇadāsa went with the Lord on His journey to the south.[7]

Anubhāṣya.

Kṛṣṇadāsa: his story is told in Madhya, Chapters 7 and 9. This simple brāhmaṇa went south with the Lord to carry His waterpot. In the land of Malabar the Bhaṭṭathāris tried to entice him with a woman and hold him; seeing this, Gaurahari rescued him, and after returning to Nīlācala He dismissed him.

(23) Balabhadra Bhaṭṭa —

146 Balabhadra Bhaṭṭācārya, a true devotee, served the Lord as His brahmacārī on the journey to Mathurā.

Anubhāṣya.

Balabhadra Bhaṭṭācārya is Madhurekṣaṇā of Vraja. Cooking and other practical work (*karma-kāṇḍa*) are forbidden to *sannyāsīs*; they accept such services from householders. *Sannyāsīs* are gurus, *brahmacārīs* are disciples. Balabhadra performed the duties of a *brahmacārī* for Mahāprabhu when the Lord went to Vṛndāvana.

(24) Baḍa Haridāsa, (25) Choṭa Haridāsa —

147 Baḍa Haridāsa and Choṭa Haridāsa, two kīrtana singers, stayed by Mahāprabhu’s side.

Anubhāṣya.

Choṭa Haridāsa: for his story see Antya, Chapter 2.

(26) Rāmabhadra, (27) Siṁheśvara, (28) Tapana Ācārya, (29) Raghunātha, (30) Nīlāmbara —

148 There were also Rāmabhadra Ācārya, Siṁheśvara of Orissa, Tapana Ācārya, Raghu and Nīlāmbara;

(31) Siṅgābhaṭṭa, (32) Kāmābhaṭṭa, (33) Śivānanda, (34) Kamalānanda —

149 Siṅgābhaṭṭa, Kāmābhaṭṭa, Dantura Śivānanda, and Kamalānanda, who had been a dear servant of the Lord in Gauḍa.

(35) Acyutānanda —

150 Acyutānanda, the son of Advaita Ācārya, stayed in Nīlācala in the shelter of the Lord's feet.

Anubhāṣya.

Acyutānanda: see Ādi, Chapter 12, verse 13.

(36) Gaṅgādāsa, (37) Viṣṇudāsa —

151 Nirloma Gaṅgādāsa and Viṣṇudāsa also lived with the Lord in Nīlācala.

Residents of Kāśī: (1) Candraśekhara, (2) Tapana Miśra, (3) Śrī Raghunātha Bhaṭṭa —

152–153 In Vārāṇasī the Lord had three devotees: Candraśekhara the physician, Tapana Miśra and his son Raghunātha Bhaṭṭācārya. When the Lord came to Kāśī after seeing Vṛndāvana,

Anubhāṣya.

Tapana Miśra. When Mahāprabhu went to Vaṅga (Bengal), Tapana Miśra asked Him about the truths of the means and the goal (*sādhana* and *sādhya*) and received the holy name from the Lord. Later, at the Lord's command, he settled in Kāśī. When the Lord was in Kāśī, He took His meals at Tapana Miśra's house.

154 He stayed for two months in Candraśekhara's house and for two months took His meals in the house of Tapana Miśra.

155 As a boy Raghunātha served the Lord, cleaning up after His meals and massaging His feet.

156 When he grew up he went to the Lord in Nīlācala and stayed for eight months, on some days cooking for Him.

157 Then, at the Lord's command, he went to Vṛndāvana and stayed near Śrī Rūpa Gosvāmī.

158 Rūpa Gosvāmī heard the *Bhāgavatam* from him, and by the Lord's mercy he was mad with love for Kṛṣṇa.

Anubhāṣya.

Raghunātha Bhaṭṭācārya was one of the six Gosvāmīs and the son of Tapana Miśra. He was born in about 1425 Śaka. He was especially expert in the *Bhāgavata-śāstra*. Antya, Chapter 13, verses 107–108: "Raghunātha Bhaṭṭa was very skilled in cooking; whatever he cooked became like nectar. The Lord ate it with great satisfaction, and Bhaṭṭa ate the Lord's remnants. … After eight months the Lord sent Bhaṭṭa home, forbidding him, 'Do not marry.' 'Go and serve your aged mother and father, and study the *Bhāgavata* with a Vaiṣṇava.' … Saying this, He put His own neck-garland around Raghunātha's neck." (Antya 13.107–108, 112–114) "For four years at home he served his father and mother and studied the *Bhāgavata* with a Vaiṣṇava scholar. When his parents passed away in Kāśī, he became indifferent to the world, left his home and other ties, and came to the Lord again." (Antya 13.117–118) "'By My order, Raghunātha, go to Vṛndāvana; there, stay with Rūpa and Sanātana. Read the *Bhāgavata* and always chant Kṛṣṇa's name; soon Kṛṣṇa, Bhagavān, will bestow His mercy.' Saying this, the Lord embraced him, and by the Lord's mercy he became maddened with love for Kṛṣṇa. … a fourteen-cubit *tulasī* garland of Jagannātha — that garland and some betel the Lord gave him." (Antya 13.120–124) "In Rūpa Gosāñi's assembly he recites the *Bhāgavata*; as he reads the *Bhāgavata* his mind is overwhelmed. … His voice is like the cuckoo's,

and in it the *rāgas* are clearly distinguished; in reciting a single verse he changes three or four *rāgas*. … He had his disciple build a temple for Govinda, and he provided ornaments — a flute, *makara* earrings and others." (Antya 13.126, 128, 131) "He does not hear worldly talk nor speak it with his tongue; his eight *praharas* pass in talk of Kṛṣṇa, worship and the like. He does not let blame of Vaiṣṇavas enter his ears; he knows only this: everyone is worshipping Kṛṣṇa." (Antya 13.132–133) The *Gaura-gaṇoddeśa* (verse 185) says: "The Bhaṭṭa named Raghunātha, who was formerly Rāga-mañjarī, lived in a hut at Śrī Rādhikā-kuṇḍa."

The deliverance of the three worlds by countless devotees of Gaura — branches and sub-branches —

159 Thus Śrī Caitanya's devotees are countless; I write of only a few, for they cannot be fully told.

Anubhāṣya.

Thus ends the tenth chapter of the "Anubhāṣya."

160 Millions upon millions of twigs grow on every branch; its disciples and their disciples are its smaller twigs.

161 All of them are laden with the flowers and fruits of love, and they have flooded the three worlds with the waters of love for Kṛṣṇa.

162 The power and glory of each branch are endless; even He who has a thousand mouths cannot find their limit.

163 I have told of Mahāprabhu's devotees only briefly; even the Thousand-mouthed One could not tell of them all.

164 Praying at the feet of Śrī Rūpa and Śrī Raghunātha, I, Kṛṣṇadāsa, narrate the *Caitanya-caritāmṛta*.

Notes

1. In the Gauḍīya Maṭha edition the branches are listed under numbered headings: (1 — a, b, c, d) Śrīvāsa, Śrī Rāma and their two brothers; (2) Candraśekhara; (3) Puṇḍarīka Vidyānidhi, and so on; the offshoots of a branch are marked with letters (20a — Satyarāja, an offshoot of Haridāsa's branch). The ordinal numbers of the branches in the translation follow these headings. ↩
2. The bags are described in Antya 10. ↩
3. His prayer is described in Madhya 15.159–180 (*Anubhāṣya*). ↩
4. In the edition they are offshoots of Haridāsa's branch (20a–20e), like all the people of Kulīna-grāma (10.48). ↩
5. Raghunātha's meeting with the Lord is told in Antya 6 (*Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*). ↩
6. In the edition's heading Bhāgavatācārya, Ciranjīva and Raghunandana are marked with their earlier numbers (75, 41, 39a) — they are the same persons named above; the new branches are (85) Mādhavācārya, (86) Kamalākānta and (87) Yadunandana. ↩
7. In the edition's heading he is "Kālā Kṛṣṇadāsa, the brāhmaṇa"; he is described in Madhya 7 and 9. ↩
8. The edition reads *śakti adhastana*, literally "descendants by *śakti*"; the sense probably requires *śaukra* (শৌক্র), "descendants by birth." ↩
9. An unclear place in the quotation: the words "her age is the measure" are not connected to anything in the extract; perhaps the statement of the age itself has been left out. ↩
10. The edition reads "Madhya, Chapter 1, 55–62"; the episode is in Madhya 1.155–162. ↩
11. The edition reads "Madhya, Chapter 10, 100–101"; these words of the Lord are in Madhya 15.100–101. ↩
12. The verse translation reads it differently: "all the devotees see Him alike" (Bengali *nirviśeṣa*, "without distinction"). ↩
13. An unclear place in the scan: the middle digit of the verse number is damaged; probably 177. ↩
14. The expression *guru-devatātmā* comes from the *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* (11.2.37). ↩
15. The edition prints the words run together, *ekenānumanyante* (একেনানুমন্যন্তে); read as *eke nānumanyante*, "others do not accept this" (the plural verb does not agree with *ekena*). ↩
16. So in the edition; the episode is in Antya, Chapter 10, verses 82–100. ↩

“Śrī Caitanya-caritāmṛta”

Ādi-līlā

Chapter 11

The Description of the Branches of the Nityānanda Trunk

(English translation from the Bengali, following the Gauḍīya Maṭha edition and the «Anubhāṣya», 2026 — draft)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya

Summary. The eleventh chapter describes the associates of Nityānanda Prabhu.

Obeisances to the associates of Nityānanda —

1 I bow to all the devotees who, like bees at the lotus feet of Nityānanda, are maddened by the honey of love, and I shall write of a few, the foremost among them.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
I bow down to all the bees at Nityānanda's lotus feet, who are maddened by drinking the honey of love, and I will name a few of the chief devotees among them.

Anubhāṣya.
prema-madhūnmadān (maddened by honey, and that honey is *prema* itself) **akhilān** (all) **nityānanda-padāmbhoja-bhṛṅgān** (the bees at the Prabhu's lotus feet) **natvā** (having bowed down to) **teṣu katicit mukhyāḥ** (the chief devotees) **mayā likhyante**.

2 Glory, glory to Mahāprabhu Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya! Whoever has taken shelter at His feet is truly blessed.

3 Glory, glory to Śrī Advaita! Glory to Nityānanda! Glory, glory to all the devotees of Mahāprabhu!

Description of the branches of Nityānanda's trunk —

4 Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya is the undying tree of eternal love, and its tall trunk is the Avadhūta, Śrī Nityānanda, beautiful as the moon. I bow to His devotees, the branches of that trunk.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya is the wish-fulfilling tree of *prema*, and Śrī Avadhūta Nityānanda-candra is its high trunk. I bow down to His associates, the branches of that trunk.

Anubhāṣya.
śrī-kṛṣṇa-caitanya-sat-premāmara-śākhinaḥ (Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya is Himself the eternally existing [*sat*] tree of *prema*, the immortal, imperishable tree named Gaura; **tasya**, of Him) **ūrdhva-skandhāvadhūtendoḥ** (the high trunk is Nityānanda Prabhu, and He is also the moon; of Him) **śākhā-rūpān gaṇān numaḥ** (we bow down).

By Mahāprabhu's will, Nityānanda's branch grows and becomes foremost —

5 Śrī Nityānanda is the mighty trunk of the tree, and on it grew branches and offshoots in great number.

6 The branches grow by the water of the gardener’s will. Laden with the flowers and fruits of love, they have covered the world.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
“Of the gardener”: of Śrī Mahāprabhu.

7 The devotees are numberless, without end — who could count them all? For my own purification I shall name only the foremost.

(1) The branch of Śrī Vīracandra Gosāñi —

8 Śrī Vīrabhadra Gosāñi is the great branch of the trunk, and the offshoots that spring from Him are beyond counting.

Anubhāṣya.

Śrī Vīrabhadra Gosāñi was the son of Śrī Nityānanda Prabhu and a disciple of Mother Jāhnavā; He was born of Vasudhā. In the *Gaura-gaṇoddeśa* (verse 67): "That *vyūha* of Saṅkarṣaṇa named Payobdhiśāyī became Vīracandra, who is not different from Caitanya." His disciple was Yadunātha Ācārya of the village of Jhāmaṭapura in Hugalī district. Vīrabhadra married Yadunātha's daughter Śrīmatī, born of Vidyunmālā (Lakṣmī), and also their adopted daughter Nārāyaṇī; see the *Bhakti-ratnākara*, wave 13. Three of His disciples, Gopījana-vallabha, Rāmakṛṣṇa and Rāmacandra, became famous as His sons. The youngest, Rāmacandra, lived in Khaḍadaha; he was a Śuddha-śrotriya of the Śāṇḍilya *gotra* with the surname "Baṭabyāla." The eldest, Gopījana-vallabha, lived in the village of "Latā" near Mānakara in Barddhamāna district, and the middle one, Rāmakṛṣṇa, in Gayeśapura near Māladaha. If all three share the same *gotra* and the same village, no one can doubt that they were Vīrabhadra's sons by birth. Rāmacandra had four sons. The third son of the eldest, Rādhāmādhava, was Yādavendra; his son was Nandakiśora; his son, Nidhikṛṣṇa; his son, Caitanya-cāḍa; his son, Kṛṣṇamohana; his son, Jaganmohana; his son, Vrajanātha; and Vrajanātha's son was the late Śyāmalāla Gosvāmī.

His glory: though Viṣṇu Himself, He behaves as a Vaiṣṇava —

9 Though He is the Lord, He calls Himself a great devotee; though He is beyond the dharma of the Vedas, He keeps faithfully to it.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Vīracandra Prabhu is by nature Payobdhiśāyī, the *vyūha* of Śrī Saṅkarṣaṇa, and so He is the Lord Himself. Yet He thought of Himself as a Vaiṣṇava.

10 Within, He acts as the Lord; outwardly, He shows no pride. He is the main pillar in the hall of devotion to Śrī Caitanya.

11 Even today, through the glory of His mercy, the whole world sings of Caitanya and Nityānanda.

12 The feet of that Vīrabhadra Gosāñi are my shelter, for by His grace every desire is fulfilled.

*(2) Ṭhākura Abhirāma (*gopāla* 1), (3) Dāsa Gadādhara —*

13 Śrī Rāmadāsa and Gadādhara dāsa, devotees of Caitanya Gosāñi, stayed at Nityānanda's side.[1]

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
Rāmadāsa is Abhirāma dāsa.

Anubhāṣya.
Gadādhara dāsa: see Ādi 10.53.

Śrī Rāmadāsa (Abhirāma). Ṭhākura Abhirāma, whose very life was Nityānanda, is one of the twelve *gopālas*; in Vraja he is Śrīdāma, [Kṛṣṇa's] friend. In the *Gaura-gaṇoddeśa* (verse 126): "He who was formerly named Śrīdāma is now the great Abhirāma, who carried a log that only thirty-two men could carry." See Ādi 10.116–118.

The *Bhakti-ratnākara* (wave 4) tells of Śrīla Abhirāma Ṭhākura. By the order of Nityānanda, the crusher of the godless, Abhirāma Ṭhākura was an *ācārya* and a preacher of *bhakti-dharma*. "The might of Abhirāma Gosvāmī is fierce: at the sight of him the unconquerable godless always tremble. He is ever maddened, absorbed in Nityānanda; his enchanting mercy is known throughout the world." A saying is current to this day: if he bowed down to any stone or image other than a Viṣṇu-*śilā* or a Deity of Viṣṇu, it would split and crumble to dust.

Abhirāma Ṭhākura's *śrīpāṭa* is in Khānākula-Kṛṣṇanagara, about ten miles southwest of Cāṗāḍāṅgā station on the Hāoḍā–Āmtā line, past the "Helānāra hāṭ." In the rainy season the road is flooded, so one goes by the B.N.R. line: from Kolāghāṭa by steamer to Rāṇīcaka, and from there Khānākula is 7½ miles to the north. Abhirāma Ṭhākura's *śrīpāṭa* is in Kṛṣṇanagara; because that village lies on the bank of the river Khānā, or Dvārakeśvara, it is called "Khānākula-Kṛṣṇanagara."

Outside the temple, near the gate, stands a *bakula* tree; the spot is called the “Siddha-bakula-kuñja.” It is said that Abhirāma Ṭhākura sat here first when he came.

Inside the temple are Śrī Baladeva and Śrī Madana-mohana (alone, without Rādhā). On a single slab of black touchstone, 1¼ cubits high and nearly a cubit wide, the Deity of Śrī Gopīnātha is carved together with the pastime of stealing the garments: the *kadamba* tree, the Yamunā, and the cows and calves. Such are the *arcā* Deities. Besides these, on the throne are a sacred image of Abhirāma Ṭhākura in the ecstasy of dance (his feet not spread apart) and Śrī Vraja-vallabha (the Divine Couple). There are also a Śrī Śālagrāma and a Deity of Śrī Gopāla. Tradition says that Śrī Abhirāma Ṭhākura found the Gopīnātha Deity while the pond in front of the temple was being dug. Since then the pond has been known as “Abhirāma-kuṇḍa.” Directly south of the temple where the Deities now reside stands an old *nava-ratna* temple. A stone plaque high on that temple bears the inscription that it was built in the year 1181. The builder's name is not given. It is said that the late Nachirāma Siṁha “Gailā” of a neighboring village had the temple built. The Deity resided here even earlier, and before the temple was built He was served on this very spot in a thatched hut.

Directly north of the Śrī Gopīnātha temple is the ancient temple of Śrī Rādhā-vallabha Jīu, founded by the local Kāyastha Caudhurīs.

The stone plaque of the present temple bears the inscription: “Śrī Śrī Gopīnātha Jīu. Temple built in the month of Māgha, year 1219. Repaired in the month of Vaiśākha, year 1308.” It is said that the late Puṇḍarīkākṣa Rāya of Mādhavapura, near Ārāmabāga police station in Hugalī district, built it. In front of the old temple stands a spacious brick *nāṭya-mandira*. The fishermen (*dhīvaras*) of Medinīpura district built it in 1263; when it fell into disrepair, they restored it in 1320.

The servitors say that ever since the time of Śrīla Abhirāma Ṭhākura it has been the custom here to offer *bhoga* of parboiled (*siddha-cāula*) rice; even puffed rice (*muḍi*) is offered. Another unusual custom is that when the Ṭhākura is laid to rest, the temple doors stay open and He is laid to rest in everyone's sight. Nowadays there is no custom of performing *maṅgala-ārati* for the Ṭhākura in the morning.

At present there are thirty-six or thirty-seven families of servitors. It is said that inside the temple, in an iron chest, is kept Śrīla Abhirāma Ṭhākura's famous whip

“Śrī Jayamaṅgala”; the chest is locked with all the keys of these servitors. The whip is two cubits long and wrapped in gold thread; at a festival it is brought out only when all the servitors agree together. The *Bhakti-ratnākara* (wave 4) writes of the whip “Śrī Jayamaṅgala” that love for Kṛṣṇa arose in anyone Abhirāma Ṭhākura struck with it. Once, when Śrīnivāsa Ācārya came to Abhirāma's house, Ṭhākura Abhirāma touched Śrīnivāsa's body three times with that whip. Then Abhirāma's wife, Mālinī Devī, a *brāhmaṇa*'s daughter, laughed, took the Ṭhākura by the hand, and said, “Ṭhākura, restrain yourself! Śrīnivāsa is a boy; at the touch of your whip he will lose all composure.”

His descendants (by birth, or in the line of disciples?) live in Kṛṣṇanagara and Āmtā in Hugalī district, and in Viṣṇupura, Kotalapura and other villages of Bāṅkuḍā district.

A certain “Abhirāmadāsa,” a disciple of Ratneśvara, gives the names and places of “Ṭhākura Abhirāma's” disciples in his book *Śākhā-nirṇaya* as follows: (1) Kṛṣṇadāsa Ṭhākura lived in Khānākula (the line has died out); (2) a devotee named Vedagarbha lived in the village of Kaiyaḍ (about 10 miles southwest of Barddhamāna); his descendants now serve the Deity there; (3) Haridāsa lived in the village of Būṛhana (nothing particular is known of him); (4) Pākhiyā-Gopāladāsa lived in the village of Helāla (?) (about two miles north of Khānākula, on the bank of the river Khānā); a small ruined temple known as his *samāja* stands there now, but there is no Deity; (5) “Gumphanārāyaṇa” lived in the village of Pāikamājiṭā (?) near Rāmajīvanapura in Medinīpura district; his descendants are living; (6) Dāḍiyā Mohana lived in Sītānagara (neither the place nor his line can be traced); (7) Satyarāghava lived in Mayanāmuḍi (Bāṅkuḍā) (where his descendants live is unknown); (8) Rajanī Paṇḍita lived in Sālikhā (near Hāoḍā?) (where his descendants are is also unknown); (9) Sundarānanda lived in Bhāṅgāmoḍā (about 4 miles northwest of Tārakeśvara); he has descendants; (10) Kṛṣṇānanda Avadhūta lived in Dvīpagrāma (its location is unknown); it is doubtful whether he had any descendants; (11) Raṅgaṇa-Kṛṣṇadāsa lived in the village of Sonātalā (-lī) (in Hugalī or Hāoḍā district?) (the line has died out); (12) Murāridāsa lived in Māladaha (where his descendants live is unknown); (13) Mohana Ṭhākura lived in Pāṇihāṭī (nothing is known of his lineage); (14) Yadu Hāladāra lived in Rādhānagara (south of Khānākula-Kṛṣṇanagara); because his line died out, the Deity he established, Śrī Balarāma, is still served together with Śrī Gopīnātha; (15) Harimādhava lived in Anantanagara (near Khānākula) (the line has died out); (16) Gopāladāsa lived in Māheśa (near Śrīrāmapura?) (nothing is known of his

descendants); (17) Acyuta Paṇḍita lived in Koṭarā (near Khānākula police station) (a descendant is living); (18) Lakṣmīnārāyaṇa lived in the village of Pāṭalā (the line has died out); (19) Gopīnāthadāsa lived in Purī (no information); (20) Nandakiśora lived in Cuṇākhāli *parganā* (near Māheśa) (nothing is known of his descendants); (21) Vidura Brahmacārī lived in the village of Pātāgrāma (Pāṭuli in Barddhamāna district?); his descendants are living; (22) Rāmakṛṣṇa lived in Vinupāḍā (nothing is known of either the place or the man); (23) Kamalākara lived in Gaurāṅgapura (about 4 miles north of the *śrīpāṭa*); his *samāja* is nearby, and his descendants serve the Deities of Śrī Nitāi-Gaura; (24) Balarāma Ṭhākura lived in Viśvagrāma (neither the place nor the man can be traced); (24½) Śrīnivāsa Ācārya Prabhu (he was most dear to Abhirāma and received his affection and mercy, but because he had not taken initiation from him he is evidently counted as a “half disciple”). On the lunar day of Kṛṣṇa-saptamī in the month of Caitra a great festival is held here, and many people gather.

The two preach in Gauḍa together with Nitāi —

14 When Mahāprabhu told Nityānanda to go to Gauḍa, He sent these two with Him.

(4) Mādhava and (5) Vāsu Ghoṣa Ṭhākura —

15 Therefore they are counted in both groups, and so it is with Mādhava and Vāsudeva Ghoṣa.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

These two are like Nityānanda's own associates. When Mahāprabhu ordered Nityānanda Prabhu to go to Gauḍa, He sent Rāmadāsa and Gadādhara dāsa with Him. So these two were counted once among Mahāprabhu's associates, and now they are counted among Nityānanda's as well. Mādhava and Vāsu Ghoṣa are likewise counted in both groups.

Anubhāṣya.

Govinda Ghoṣa, Vāsu Ghoṣa. Govinda Ghoṣa Ṭhākura's most beloved Deity, Śrī Gopīnātha, is still present at Agradvīpa, near Dāĩhāṭ and Pāṭuli in Barddhamāna district. On the day of His devotee's disappearance He offers *piṇḍa*, as a son does at his father's *śrāddha*. His service has long been carried on under the supervision of the royal family of Nadīyā-Kṛṣṇanagara. Every year in the month of

Vaiśākha, at the time of the “Bāradola” in Kṛṣṇanagara, He is brought to the capital together with eleven other Deities, and after the Dola festival He is taken back to Agradvīpa.

Many *padas* in the “Gaura-nāgarī” mood, which gratify the senses of the *prākṛta-sahajiyās*, have been interpolated into Vāsu Ghoṣa's collection of *padas*. In truth these are not, and can never be, the *padas* of Vāsu Ghoṣa, a devotee of Gaura who relished the *rasa* of separation (*vipralambha*). *Sādhakas* will reject them. See Ādi 10.115.

Abhirāma's pastimes —

16 Rāmadāsa, a chief branch, was a treasury of loving friendship. He lifted a log that it took sixteen men to carry and made a flute of it.

The extraordinary deeds of Dāsa Gadādhara —

17 Gadādhara dāsa was full of bliss in the mood of a gopī, and in his house Nityānanda revealed the *dāna-keli* pastime.[2]

*Mādhava Ghoṣa's *kīrtana* —*

18 Śrī Mādhava Ghoṣa was foremost among the kīrtana singers, and Nityānanda Prabhu would dance to his singing.

*Vāsu Ghoṣa's *kīrtana* —*

19 When Vāsudeva sang of the Lord, even wood and stone would melt to hear him.

(6) Murāri-Caitanyadāsa —

20 Wondrous were the pastimes of Murāri-caitanya dāsa: he would slap a tiger on the cheek and play with snakes.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
Murāri-Caitanyadāsa was born in the village of Sar-Vṛndāvanapura, one *krośa* from Galaśī station in Barddhamāna district. When he came to the village of

Modadruma, or Māugāchi, in Navadvīpa-dhāma, he came to be called “Śārṅga” (Sāraṅga) Murāri-Caitanyadāsa. His descendants still live at the *pāṭa* of Sar.

Anubhāṣya.

Murāri-Caitanyadāsa. *Caitanya-bhāgavata*, Antya, Chapter 5: “Caitanyadāsa's body has no external consciousness. He drives tigers deep into the forest, and at times he even rides on a tiger. By Kṛṣṇa's grace the tiger cannot harm him. He takes a huge python on his lap, and Caitanyadāsa fearlessly delights in it. He played with tigers without fear — such is the mercy the great Avadhūta bestows. Caitanyadāsa has entirely forgotten himself; in bliss he constantly speaks what is in his heart. For two or three days he stays submerged in water, and his body suffers no harm. In dress and behavior he is almost like an insensible man, and no one notices him. He is wild beyond measure and boundlessly brave, like a lion. How much can I tell of the transformations of *bhakti* in Caitanyadāsa? They are all boundless. Such is the worthy Śrī Caitanyadāsa Murāri Paṇḍita: even by the breeze that has touched him, one surely attains Kṛṣṇa.”

Nitāi's associates are pure devotees, the friends of Vraja —

21 All of Nityānanda’s associates are cowherd friends from Vraja. Each carries a horn and a staff and wears the dress of a cowherd, with a peacock feather on his head.

Anubhāṣya.

All the devotees who took shelter of Śrī Nityānanda Prabhu took shelter of the *sakhya-rasa* of Vraja. All of them wear the dress of cowherd boys. The Prabhu's wife, the queen Mother Jāhnavā, is Anaṅga-mañjarī of Vraja, the younger sister of Śrīmatī Rādhikā. In the *Gaura-gaṇoddeśa* (verse 66): “Some say that in the age of Kali Anaṅga-mañjarī is Śrī Vasudhā-devī, while others declare her to be Jāhnavī. By the earlier principle, the saintly consider both views correct.” The devotees who took shelter of Mother Jāhnavā are also counted among Nityānanda's associates.

(7) Raghunātha Vaidya —

22 Raghunātha Vaidya Upādhyāya was a great soul: the very sight of him awakened loving devotion to Kṛṣṇa.

*(8) Sundarānanda (*gopāla* 2) —*

23 Sundarānanda, a branch of Nityānanda, was His intimate servant, and with him Nityānanda enjoyed the playful pastimes of Vraja.

Anubhāṣya.

Sundarānanda. *Caitanya-bhāgavata*, Antya, Chapter 6: "An ocean of the *rasa* of *prema*, named Sundarānanda, the chief among the associates of Nityānanda-svarūpa." In the *Gaura-gaṇoddeśa* (verse 127): "He who was formerly named Sudāma is now Ṭhākura Sundara." He is one of the twelve *gopālas*, "Sudāma."

His *śrīpāṭa* is the village of Maheśapura, 14 miles east of "Mājadiyā" station (formerly called "Śivanivāsa") on the E.B.R. line; it is now in Yaśohara district. Nothing old remains here as a memorial except the site of Sundarānanda's ancestral home. A Bāul lives at the *śrīpāṭa* on the edge of the village. The temple, the Deities and everything else are recent. At present Śrī Śrī Rādhā-vallabha and Śrī Śrī Rādhā-ramaṇa are served in Maheśapura. The river Vetravatī flows nearby. Sundarānanda Ṭhākura remained a celibate all his life, so he has no descendants. Descendants of his kinsmen and of his servitor-disciples are living. In the village of Maṅgaladihi in Vīrabhūma district there is a family of Sundarānanda's kinsmen; Śrī Śrī Balarāma Jīu is served there. The Deity of Śrī Śrī Rādhā-vallabha established by Sundarānanda Ṭhākura was taken away by the Gosvāmīs of Saidābāda in Baharampura; later the present Deity was installed. Now the zamindars of Maheśapura are His servitors. On the full-moon day of Māgha the festival of Sundarānanda Ṭhākura's disappearance is held.

*(9) Kamalākara Pippalāi (*gopāla* 3) —*

24 Kamalākara Pippalāi was extraordinary in his ways, and his extraordinary love is known throughout the world.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

The descendants of Kamalākara Pippalāi are servants of Śrī Jagannāthadeva at Māheśa.

Anubhāṣya.

Kamalākara Pippalāi. In the *Gaura-gaṇoddeśa* (verse 128): "He who was Mahābala came to be named Kamalākara Pippalāi." He is one of the twelve *gopālas*, "Mahābala." It was he who established the Deity of Śrī Jagannātha at

Māheśa. The temple of Śrī Jagannāthadeva at Māheśa is about 2½ miles from Śrīrāmapura station on the E.I.R. line.

Kamalākara's son was named Caturbhuja. Caturbhuja had two sons, Nārāyaṇa and Jagannātha; Nārāyaṇa's son was Jagadānanda, and his son was Rājīvalocana. In his time the service of Jagannāthadeva fell short of funds. The Nawab of Ḍhākā, Oyālisa Sā (Sujā?), granted Jagannāthadeva 1185 *bighās* of land in the year 1060. The land lies in the village of Jagannāthapura, a *krośa* and a half west of Māheśa. That *mauzā* took the name “Jagannāthapura” from Jagannāthadeva's name.

There is a tradition that Kamalākara's younger brother, Nidhipati Pippalāi, searched for his elder brother, came to Māheśa, and found Kamalākara there. He could in no way persuade him to return home, so in the end he himself came to Māheśa with his own family and his brothers' families and settled there. Even now about thirty households of twice-born descendants of Kamalākara Pippalāi live in the village of Māheśa, among them Śrīyukta Prasādadāsa Adhikārī.

Another story is told. A certain renunciant Vaiṣṇava named “Dhruvānanda” went to Puruṣottama-kṣetra. He strongly desired to cook with his own hands and offer *bhoga* to Śrī Jagannātha. At night he saw in a dream that Śrī Jagannāthadeva appeared to him and told him to go to the village of Māheśa on the bank of the Gaṅgā, install Śrī Jagannātha there, and fulfill his desire by offering Him *bhoga* every day with his own hands. When Dhruvānanda reached Māheśa, he saw Śrī Jagannātha, Balarāma and Subhadrā-devī floating in the waters of the Gaṅgā. He lifted the three Deities out of the water, built a hut on the bank of the Gaṅgā, and began to serve Them. As the time of his disappearance drew near, one thought filled his heart: who would be a fit servitor for Śrī Jagannātha? Then in a dream he received Śrī Jagannāthadeva's order: “Tomorrow morning a resident of the village of Khālijuli near the Sundarbans, named ‘Śrī Kamalākara Pippalāi,’ a supreme devotee of Śrī Jagannāthadeva and a crest jewel of Vaiṣṇavas, will come to Māheśa; entrust the service to him.” The next morning Dhruvānanda met Kamalākara and entrusted him with the service of Śrī Jagannāthadeva. Ever since Kamalākara obtained the right to serve Śrī Jagannāthadeva, [his family] has borne the title “Adhikārī.” Among the fifty-six *grāmīs* (clans named after villages) of *brāhmaṇas* by birth of the Rāḍhīya class, “Pippalāi” is one.

(10) Sūryadāsa and (11) Kṛṣṇadāsa Sarakhela —

25 Sūryadāsa Sarakhela and his brother Kṛṣṇadāsa had firm faith in Nityānanda and were abodes of love.

Anubhāṣya.

Sūryadāsa Sarakhela. *Bhakti-ratnākara*, wave 12: "Not far from Navadvīpa is 'Śāligrāma.' There lives a *paṇḍita* named Sūryadāsa. He is very able in the service of the Yavana king in Gauḍa; he became famous as 'Sarakhela' and earned great wealth. Sūryadāsa is one of four brothers, all of very pure conduct. His two daughters are named Vasudhā and Jāhnavā." In the *Gaura-gaṇoddeśa* (verse 65): "His two beloveds, Vasudhā and Jāhnavī, descend from Śrī Vāruṇī and from the line of Revata.[4] They are the daughters of the great soul Śrī Sūryadāsa, who is Kakudmī, radiant as the sun."

Baḍagāchi. On the E.B.R. line, 2 miles from "Muḍāgāchā" station, lies Baḍagāchi, or Bahiragāchi, on the bank of the "Guḍaguḍe" canal, across from the village of Dharmadaha. Śāligrāma and Rukuṇapura are close by.

Kṛṣṇadāsa Sarakhela was the younger brother of Gaurīdāsa Paṇḍita and Sūryadāsa Sarakhela. For the *adhivāsa* of Nityānanda's wedding he went from Baḍagāchi to Śāligrāma. *Bhakti-ratnākara*, wave 12: "Taking various articles, Kṛṣṇadāsa Paṇḍita came from his home together with the *brāhmaṇas*."

*(12) Gaurīdāsa Paṇḍita (*gopāla* 4) —*

26 Śrī Gaurīdāsa Paṇḍita's devotion soared with prema; he had great power both to give and to receive love for Kṛṣṇa.

Anubhāṣya.

Śrī Gaurīdāsa Paṇḍita. He was patronized by Rājā Kṛṣṇadāsa, the son of Hari Hoḍa. He is one of the twelve *gopālas* of Vraja, "Subala the friend." He lived first in Śāligrāma, not far from Muḍāgāchā station on the E.B.R. line, and later at Ambikā-Kālanā. In the *Gaura-gaṇoddeśa* (verse 128): "He who was Subala, the best of the dear friends, is Gaurīdāsa Paṇḍita." *Caitanya-bhāgavata*, Antya, Chapter 6: "Gaurīdāsa Paṇḍita is supremely fortunate; in body, mind and words Nityānanda is his life." "Sarakhela Sūryadāsa Paṇḍita is generous. His brother Gaurīdāsa Paṇḍita is renowned. Taking leave of his elder brother at Śāligrāma, he came to 'Ambikā' and made his home on the bank of the Gaṅgā."

He had twenty-two and a half branches: (1) Śrī Nṛsiṁha-caitanya, (2) Kṛṣṇadāsa, (3) Viṣṇudāsa, (4) Baḍa Balarāmadāsa, (5) Govinda, (6) Raghunātha, (7) Baḍu Gaṅgādāsa, (8) Āuliyā Gaṅgārāma, (9) Yādavācārya, (10) Hṛdaya-caitanya, (11) Cāḍa Hāladāra, (12) Maheśa Paṇḍita, (13) Mukuṭa Rāya, (14) Bhātuyā Gaṅgārāma, (15) Āuliyā Caitanya, (16) Kāliyā Kṛṣṇadāsa, (17) Pātuyā Gopāla, (18) Baḍa Jagannātha, (19) Nityānanda, (20) Bhāvi, (21) Jagadīśa, (22) Rāiyā Kṛṣṇadāsa, (22½) Annapūrṇā.

Gaurīdāsa Paṇḍita's elder son was (Baḍa) Balarāma and the younger, Raghunātha. Raghunātha's sons were Maheśa Paṇḍita and Govinda, and his daughter was Annapūrṇā. Śrī Kaṁsāri Miśra of Śāligrāma (family title “Ghoṣāla,” “Vātsya” *gotra*) had six sons: (1) Dāmodara, (2) Jagannātha, (3) Sūryadāsa Sarakhela (the father of Vasudhā and Jāhnavā), (4) Gaurīdāsa, (5) Kṛṣṇadāsa Sarakhela, (6) Nṛsiṁha-caitanya. Some descendants of Kaṁsāri Miśra's kinsmen still live in Śāligrāma. Neither Gaurīdāsa Paṇḍita nor Hṛdaya-caitanya has descendants. Some say that those living now are descendants in the disciplic line of Gaurīdāsa Paṇḍita or Hṛdaya-caitanya. When Jāhnavā-devī went to Śrī Vṛndāvana and saw the *samāja* of her uncle Gaurīdāsa Paṇḍita, she wept: “Seeing the *samādhi* of Gaurīdāsa Paṇḍita, she cannot stop the streams of tears flowing from her eyes.” (*Bhakti-ratnākara*, wave 11.)

Gaurīdāsa's disciple was Hṛdaya-caitanya; Hṛdaya-caitanya's disciple was Gopīramaṇa, the son of Annapūrṇā Devī. His descendants are the present *adhikārīs* of Mahāprabhu at Kālnā.

The *śrīpāṭa* of Ambikā-Kālnā is on the bank of the Gaṅgā across from Śāntipura, in Barddhamāna district; it is a subdivision and a small town. The *śrīpāṭa* is about 1 *krośa* east of Kālnā Court station on the Hāoḍā–Byāṇḍel–Bārahāroyā line, right next to the new *samāja-bāṭī* (mausoleum) of the Rājā of Barddhamāna, or the bazaar. At the entrance to Gaurīdāsa's temple stands a wonderful tamarind tree. It is said that Mahāprabhu and Gaurīdāsa Paṇḍita met beneath this tamarind. The temple is paved with white stone, and in the three chambers of the building the sacred forms reside thus: (1) Śrī Gaurīdāsa, (2) Śrī Rādhā-Kṛṣṇa, (3) Śrī Gaura-Nityānanda, (4) Śrī Jagannātha, (5) Śrī Balarāma and (6) Śrī Rāma-Sītā. West of Paṇḍita Gaurīdāsa's house is the temple of Śrī Sūryadāsa Paṇḍita, and a little farther away the *āśrama* of the perfected Śrī Bhagavān dāsa Bābājī.

The place where the present temple stands is called “Ambikā,” and north of it is Kālnā; so together they are called “Ambikā-Kālnā.” It is said that the oar Śrī

Mahāprabhu plied with His own hand and the *Gītā* written in His own hand (see the *Bhakti-ratnākara*, wave 7) are still kept in the temple.

Gaurīdāsa Paṇḍita, whose life is Gaura and Nitāi —

27 Gaurīdāsa surrendered to Nityānanda his caste, his family and his place in his community, and made Śrī Caitanya and Nityānanda the Lords of his life.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

"*Pāṅti*": eating together in one row (*paṅkti-bhojana*).

Thus ends the eleventh chapter of the "Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya."

(13) Purandara Paṇḍita —

28 Purandara Paṇḍita was dear to Nityānanda Prabhu; he moved through the ocean of love like Mount Mandara.

Anubhāṣya.

Purandara Paṇḍita. *Caitanya-bhāgavata*, Antya, Chapter 6: "Purandara Paṇḍita is supremely peaceful and self-controlled; he is exclusively dear to Nityānanda-svarūpa." Antya, Chapter 5: "Then the Prabhu came to the village of Khaḍadaha, to the place of Purandara Paṇḍita's temple. No one can describe all the dancing that Prabhu Nityānanda Rāya did in the village of Khaḍadaha. Purandara Paṇḍita was in supreme madness: climbing a tree, he roared like a lion. Crying, 'I am Aṅgada!' he leaped down."

*(14) Parameśvarī dāsa (*gopāla* 5) —*

29 Parameśvara dāsa took shelter in Nityānanda alone; whoever remembers him attains devotion to Kṛṣṇa.

Anubhāṣya.

Parameśvara, or Parameśvarī dāsa. *Caitanya-bhāgavata*, Antya, Chapter 6: "Parameśvara dāsa, whose life is Nityānanda; in his body Nityānanda sports." Antya, Chapter 5: "Kṛṣṇadāsa and Parameśvara dāsa — these two, in the mood of cowherd boys, shout 'He! He!' all the time. Purandara Paṇḍita and Parameśvarī dāsa, in whose body Gauracandra is manifest, came running at once. Seeing the

Prabhu, both wept, overcome with love." For some time he lived in Khaḍadaha. In the *Gaura-gaṇoddeśa* (verse 132): "He who was formerly the friend named Arjuna is the servant Śrī Parameśvara." He is one of the twelve *gopālas*, the friend "Arjuna." When the queen Śrī Jāhnavā went to the festival at Kheturi, Parameśvara was with her (*Bhakti-ratnākara*, wave 10). By the order of Mother Jāhnavā he installed the Deity "Śrī Rādhā-Gopīnātha" at Āṭapura (see the same, wave 13).

In the *Śrī Vaiṣṇava-vandanā*: "With care I shall honor Parameśvara dāsa Ṭhākura, who made a jackal utter the holy name where *saṅkīrtana* was held." The thirteenth wave of the *Bhakti-ratnākara* tells of Parameśvarī Ṭhākura.

The *śrīpāṭa* of Parameśvarī Ṭhākura is Āṭapura, on the Cāṗāḍāṅgā branch of the Hāoḍā–Āmtā railway, near Āṭapura station and the ancient temple of Śrī Rādhā-Govinda, founded by the late Kṛṣṇakumāra Mitra, *dewan* of the Barddhamāna Rāja Teja Bāhādura. Formerly the place was called "Viśakhālā."

Right in front of the temple grow two *bakula* trees side by side, giving dense shade, and separately a *kadamba* tree; between them is the *samādhi* of Parameśvarī Ṭhākura, beautifully crowned with a *tulasī* platform. It is said that the present two trees grew from branches of the two *bakula* trees that stood in Śrīla Parameśvarī Ṭhākura's time. Every year the *kadamba* tree bears a single flower, and with it the Deity's lotus feet are worshiped.

Parameśvarī Ṭhākura was born in a Vaidya family. His brother's descendants are the present servitors of the *śrīpāṭa*. Some of them also live in the village of Garalagāchā (Caṇḍītalā post office, Hugalī district). Until recently they had many disciples who were *brāhmaṇas* by birth. But in the course of time they took up the Vaidya profession, like ordinary worldly people, and so all their disciples of *brāhmaṇa* families gradually left them. Their title is "Adhikārī." The present servitors of the *śrīpāṭa* are Śrī Rādhikāprasanna Adhikārī Kavirāja Mahāśaya and the widowed, sonless mother-in-law of Naṭavara Adhikārī Mahāśaya. The family name of their caste is "Gupta."

They regard themselves as ordinary "Vaidyas" and have the Ṭhākura worshiped by *devala brāhmaṇas*. There are now eight households of servitors, and the eight households have merged into two. Formerly much land was set aside for the Deity's service, but they have lost all of it. Now the service of the Deity is kept up with great difficulty on a small *debottara* endowment.

In the temple, Śrī Baladeva and Śrī Rādhā-Gopīnātha are seen on a single throne. The Baladeva Deity was probably installed later. To place Śrī Baladeva and Śrī Kṛṣṇa with Śrīmatī on the same throne is contrary to *tattva*. On the full-moon day of Vaiśākha the festival of Parameśvarī Ṭhākura's disappearance is held.

(15) Jagadīśa Paṇḍita —

30 Śrī Jagadīśa Paṇḍita purifies the whole world; like a heavy monsoon rain, he pours down the nectar of love for Kṛṣṇa.

Anubhāṣya.

The *śrīpāṭa* of Śrī Jagadīśa Paṇḍita is the village of Yaśaḍā, within a mile of Cākadaha station (on the E.B.R. line) in Nadīyā district. See the *Caitanya-bhāgavata*, Ādi, Chapter 4, and the *Caitanya-caritāmṛta*, Ādi 14.39. From the account of the Yaśaḍā *śrīpāṭa* we learn that Jagadīśa Bhaṭṭa was born in East Bengal, in the region of Gauhāṭī. His father, Kamalākṣa, was a descendant of Bhaṭṭanārāyaṇa, of the Bandyaghaṭīya family of Gayaghara. Both Jagadīśa's father and his mother were householders devoted to Viṣṇu. After his parents' disappearance, Jagadīśa left his birthplace with his wife “Duḥkhinī” and his brother Maheśa. In order to live on the bank of the Gaṅgā and spend his time with Vaiṣṇavas, he came to Śrī Māyāpura and settled near the house of Śrī Jagannātha Miśra. Gaurasundara ordered Jagadīśa to go to Nīlācala to preach the holy name. By Śrīman Mahāprabhu's order Jagadīśa Paṇḍita preached the name in Nīlācala. There he prayed to Jagannāthadeva, and in answer to his prayer he was allowed to bring back a form of Jagannāthadeva. Jagadīśa installed the Deity in the village of Yaśaḍā on the bank of the Gaṅgā, now within Cākadaha police station. There is a tradition that Jagadīśa Paṇḍita carried this Jagannātha Deity from Puruṣottama to Yaśaḍā on a staff. Even today the servitors at Yaśaḍā display a staff as “Jagadīśa Paṇḍita's staff on which the Jagannātha Deity was brought.”

It is said that Śrī Gaura-Nityānanda Prabhu came to the village of Yaśaḍā twice with Their associates, and here there were *saṅkīrtana* processions, talks about Hari, *kīrtana* and a great festival.

Jagadīśa Paṇḍita enacted the pastime of a householder. His only son was named “Rāmabhadra Gosvāmī.”

Formerly the Jagannātha Deity was installed under a banyan tree on the bank of the Gaṅgā; later Rājā Kṛṣṇacandra of Goyāḍī-Kṛṣṇanagara had a temple built. When

the temple built by the Rājā of Kṛṣṇanagara fell into ruin, Mokṣadā Dāsī, the wife of the local Umeśacandra Majumadāra, in 1324 restored the present temple; this is inscribed on a stone plaque. The temple has no spire and looks like an ordinary house. In front of it is a modest courtyard. In the temple reside Śrī Jagannāthadeva, Śrī Rādhā-vallabha Jīu and the Gaura-Gopāla installed by Jagadīśa's wife, Mother Duḥkhinī.

When Mahāprabhu had sanctified Jagadīśa's house in Yaśaḍā and was about to leave for Nīlācala, Duḥkhinī was deeply grieved at the separation from Gaurasundara. So Mahāprabhu agreed to accept Duḥkhinī's service in the village of Yaśaḍā in the form of the Gaura-Gopāla Deity. Ever since, the Śrī Gaura-Gopāla Deity (a golden-hued wooden form of Gopāla) has been served there.

The Gaṅgā has moved away from this place by nearly a *krośa*. For some time the perfected Bhagavān dāsa Bābājī Mahāśaya of Kālnā performed *bhajana* in the village of Yaśaḍā. Later the Bābājī Mahāśaya left this place and settled in Kālnā, but even from Kālnā he came here from time to time. At that time Vijayacandra Gosvāmī Mahāśaya was the servitor of Śrī Jagannāthadeva. The present servitor of the *śrīpāṭa* is Śrī Lalitamohana Gosvāmī. The family are Bāḍuyyes (Bandyopādhyāyas); their maternal uncles are of the Gāṅgulī family. A *sūcaka-gāna* (introductory song) on Jagadīśa Paṇḍita Gosvāmī, composed by a Vaiṣṇava poet named Gadādhara, is still sung in the village of Yaśaḍā. The song sets out the life of Jagadīśa Paṇḍita in a few words. Raghunāthācārya, the son of Khañja Bhagavān, was a disciple of Jagadīśa Paṇḍita Gosvāmī.

Jagadīśa Paṇḍita's disappearance day is the third lunar day of the bright fortnight of Pauṣa. Every year on the twelfth lunar day of the bright fortnight of Pauṣa the festival of Jagadīśa Paṇḍita's birth is held, and many people gather for the Snāna-yātrā.

*(16) Dhanañjaya Paṇḍita (*gopāla* 6) —*

31 Dhanañjaya Paṇḍita, a dear servant of Nityānanda, was utterly detached and always full of love for Kṛṣṇa.

Anubhāṣya.

Śrī Dhanañjaya Paṇḍita lived in the village of Śītala near Kāṭoyā. He is one of the twelve *gopālas*, the friend “Vasudāma.” In the *Gaura-gaṇoddeśa* (verse 127): “The friend Vasudāma is Paṇḍita Śrī Dhanañjaya.” *Caitanya-bhāgavata*, Antya,

Chapter 6: “Dhanañjaya Paṇḍita is an extraordinary *mahānta*; Nityānanda is in his heart every moment.”

Śītalagrāma lies in Barddhamāna district, within Maṅgalakoṭa police station and Kaicara post office. From Barddhamāna one takes the Kāṭoyā light railway, gets off at Kaicara station, 9 miles from Kāṭoyā, and goes 1 mile to the northeast. The temple is a thatched hut with a mud wall around it. Long ago the Mallika Bābus of the village of “Bājārabana Kābāśī” built a brick house for the Deity. That temple collapsed sixty-four or sixty-five years ago; the foundation of the old temple still remains. To the left of the entrance is a *tulasī* altar: this is the *samādhi* altar of Dhanañjaya Paṇḍita. In the west-facing house are Śrī Gopīnātha, whom Śrī Dhanañjaya served, Śrī Śrī Nitāi-Gaura, and the Deity of Śrī Dāmodara. Every year in the middle of the month of Māgha the Deities are carried to a garden a little way from the temple, and the disappearance festival is held. Some say that Dhanañjaya Paṇḍita's real birthplace is the village of “Jāḍ” in Caṭṭagrāma district. He came from there and established Deity service in Śītalagrāma and in the village of Sāčaḍā-Pāčaḍā.

It is said that he performed *saṅkīrtana* with Mahāprabhu in Navadvīpa for some time, returned to Śītalagrāma, and from there set out to see Śrī Vṛndāvana-dhāma. On the way to Vṛndāvana he stayed for a while in the village of Sāčaḍā-Pāčaḍā, three *krośas* south of present-day Memārī station. There he permitted the disciple traveling with him to establish the service of the Deity, and he himself went on to Vṛndāvana. That is why people also call the village of Sāčaḍā-Pāčaḍā “Dhanañjaya's *pāṭa*.” Now this village holds no trace of Dhanañjaya Paṇḍita; his principal *śrīpāṭa* is Śītalagrāma itself. On returning from Vṛndāvana he served the Deity in the village of Jalandi, and from there he came again to Śītalagrāma and established the service of Śrī Gaurāṅgadeva.

It is said that Dhanañjaya had no descendants. He had a brother named Sañjaya, whose son was named Rāmakānāi Ṭhākura. Sañjaya's *śrīpāṭa* is the village of Jalandi (Lokanagara post office) in Barddhamāna district, four or five *krośas* to the east. Among Sañjaya's descendants, Śrī Nīlamaṇi Ṭhākura, Śrī Rākhālacandra Ṭhākura and others, as well as descendants through a daughter, Śrī Kānāilāla Mukhopādhyāya and others, live in Jalandi itself. Śrī Rādhā-Govinda is served there. The *śrīpāṭa* of that Rāmakānāi is in Mulukagrāma, very close to present-day Bolapura; the servitors, Śrī Yugalakiśora Mukhopādhyāya and Śrī Gaurakiśora Mukhopādhyāya, live there. Some say that Sañjaya was Dhanañjaya's disciple. The present servitors at Śītalagrāma are descendants of a disciple of Dhanañjaya

Paṇḍita. The ancient Deity Śrī Śyāmasundara Jīu, installed by Dhanañjaya's disciple Jīvanakṛṣṇa, is now in the house of Gopāla Rāya Caudhurī.

*(17) Maheśa Paṇḍita (*gopāla* 7) —*

32 Maheśa Paṇḍita is a generous cowherd boy of Vraja; to the beat of the kettledrum he would dance, drunk with love.

Anubhāṣya.

Maheśa Paṇḍita. His *śrīpāṭa* was at Pālapāḍā until the first few months of the Bengali year 1334. It was then moved to the village of Kāṭhāladhuli near Cākadaha. He is one of the twelve *gopālas*, the friend "Mahābāhu." In the *Gaura-gaṇoddeśa* (verse 129): "Maheśa Paṇḍita is the glorious Mahābāhu, a friend in Vraja." *Caitanya-bhāgavata*, Antya, Chapter 6: "Maheśa Paṇḍita is a most exalted *mahānta*."

Pālapāḍā lies in Nadīyā district, in the jungle, a mile south of Cākadaha station on the E.B.R. line. The Gaṅgā is far from here. Formerly Maheśa Paṇḍita lived across from Jirāṭ, on the eastern bank, at a place called Masipura or Yaśīpura (?). But Masīpura was swallowed by the Gaṅgā, and the Deity installed by Maheśa Paṇḍita stayed for some time at Beleḍāṅgā near Sukhasāgara. When the Gaṅgā eroded and destroyed Beleḍāṅgā as well, the zamindar of Pālapāḍā, Navakumāra Caṭṭopādhyāya, prevailed on the servitor of that time, Bābājī Rāmakṛṣṇadāsa, to bring the Deity to Pālapāḍā, and he built a temple there. Navakumāra Bābu's son, Rajanī Bābu, registered the temple lands in the name of Harekṛṣṇadāsa Bābājī in 1883 A.D. Since then the name "Pālapāḍā-pāṭa" has continued. Pālapāḍā is in Pāčanagara *parganā*. Fourteen *mauzās* — Beleḍāṅgā, Berigrāma, Sukhasāgara, Cānduḍe, Manasāpotā, Pālapāḍā and others — lie in Pāčanagara, so some call the area "Nāgaradeśa." Some hold that this Maheśa Paṇḍita was the younger brother of Jagadīśa Paṇḍita of the Yaśaḍā *śrīpāṭa*. They say that Jagadīśa, Hiraṇya and this Maheśa Paṇḍita were three brothers: Jagadīśa the eldest, Hiraṇya the middle, and Maheśa the youngest. But authoritative books do not say whether this Maheśa Paṇḍita was Śrī Jagadīśa's brother, so the claim is doubtful.

Śrī Maheśa Paṇḍita was with Śrī Nityānanda at the festival at Pāṇihāṭī, and after the festival he went with Śrī Nityānanda to Saptagrāma. The eighth wave of the *Bhakti-ratnākara* shows that when Śrī Narottama Ṭhākura came to Khaḍadaha, Śrī Maheśa Paṇḍita was present there.

The temple of the *śrīpāṭa* is a simple house. In the dilapidated temple reside the sacred forms of Śrī Gaura-Nityānanda, Śrī Gopīnātha, Śrī Madana-mohana, Śrī Rādhā-Govinda and a *śālagrāma*. In front of the temple is the altar of Maheśa Paṇḍita's *phula-samāja* (flower tomb). Now the service is maintained only by begging. A local resident, Śrī Kālīkṛṣṇa Cakravartī, contributes 25 rupees a year. Śrī Maheśa Paṇḍita has no descendants. The present servitor is Śrī Sanātana dāsa Bābājī.

*(18) Puruṣottama Paṇḍita (*gopāla* 8) —*

33 Puruṣottama Paṇḍita of Navadvīpa was a great soul; at the very name of Nityānanda he was seized by the great madness of love.

Anubhāṣya.

Puruṣottama Paṇḍita. *Caitanya-bhāgavata*, Antya, Chapter 6: "Paṇḍita Puruṣottama was born in Navadvīpa; he is a great servant of Nityānanda-svarūpa, close to His heart." He is one of the twelve *gopālas*, "Stokakṛṣṇa." In the *Gaura-gaṇoddeśa* (verse 130): "He who was formerly the friend Stokakṛṣṇa is the servant Śrī Puruṣottama." Some say that his *śrīpāṭa* is at Sukhasāgara.

(19) Balarāma dāsa —

34 Balarāma dāsa tasted the rasa of love for Kṛṣṇa, and at the name of Nityānanda he was utterly beside himself.

Anubhāṣya.

Balarāma dāsa. *Caitanya-bhāgavata*, Antya, Chapter 6: "Balarāma dāsa, utterly intoxicated with the *rasa* of *prema*: even by the breeze that has touched him, all sins are destroyed."

(20) Yadunātha Kavicandra —

35 Yadunātha Kavicandra was a great devotee, in whose heart Nityānanda dances.

Anubhāṣya.

Yadunātha Kavicandra. *Caitanya-bhāgavata*, Antya, Chapter 6: "Yadunātha Kavicandra is full of the *rasa* of *prema*; Nityānanda is always in his heart." The same work, Madhya, Chapter 1: "Ratnagarbha Ācārya is his famous name; he

was a companion of Nityānanda Prabhu's father,[5] born in the same village. His three sons are like the honey of Kṛṣṇa's lotus feet: Kṛṣṇānanda, Jīva and Yadunātha Kavicandra."

(21) Dvija Kṛṣṇadāsa —

36 Kṛṣṇadāsa, an excellent brāhmaṇa born in Rāḍha, was a foremost servant of Śrī Nityānanda.

Anubhāṣya.

Kṛṣṇadāsa. *Caitanya-bhāgavata*, Antya, Chapter 6: "The noble *brāhmaṇa* Kṛṣṇadāsa was born in Rāḍha; his pastimes are among Nityānanda's associates."

*(22) Kālā Kṛṣṇadāsa (*gopāla* 9) —*

37 Kālā Kṛṣṇadāsa was a great Vaiṣṇava, among the foremost; he knew no one but the moonlike Nityānanda.

Anubhāṣya.

Kālā Kṛṣṇadāsa. *Caitanya-bhāgavata*, Antya, Chapter 6: "Kāliyā Kṛṣṇadāsa is famous throughout the three worlds; by remembering him one attains Gauracandra." In the *Gaura-gaṇoddeśa* (verse 132): "He who is Lavaṅga, the friend in Vraja, is Kāla Śrī Kṛṣṇadāsa." He is one of the twelve *gopālas*, the friend "Lavaṅga." His *śrīpāṭa* is the village of "Ākāihāṭ" in Barddhamāna district, within Kāṭoyā police station and post office; it lies beside the "Navadvīpa–Kāṭoyā" highway that runs from Kāṭoyā. On the E.I.R. line one goes from Byāṇḍel junction to Kāṭoyā station and walks two miles from there; or one gets off at Dāĩhāṭ, the station before Kāṭoyā, and the way is about a mile. The village of Ākāihāṭ is very small, and few people live there. The *śrīpāṭa* is now in decay. The temple over Kālā Kṛṣṇadāsa Ṭhākura's *samādhi* has collapsed: its beams broke and everything lies buried. Going from the road through a mango grove, one sees ahead a ruined little room. In it is the Deity's empty altar, and in its southeast corner a thatched shed, under which is the *samāja* of the servitors. The present servitor is Hareramadāsa Bābājī. To the south is a pond: this is "Nūpura-kuṇḍa." Tradition says that the anklet (*nūpura*) of Raghunandana Ṭhākura, the son of Mukunda of Śrīkhaṇḍa — or, as some say, of Nityānanda Prabhu — fell into this pond. It is said that this anklet, along with Śrī Rādhā-vallabha and Śrī Gopāla Jīu of the Ākāihāṭ *śrīpāṭa*, is still kept at the *mahānta-bāṭī* in the village of Kaḍui,

three *krośas* from Ākāihāṭ. There is a handwritten *Śrī Caitanya-bhāgavata* of the year 1200 and a *Śrī Caritāmṛta* copied in 1271. In the month of Caitra, on the twelfth lunar day of the dark fortnight — the day of Vāruṇī — the festival of Śrī Kālā Kṛṣṇadāsa Ṭhākura's disappearance is held here.

According to the “Gosvāmīs” of the village of “Sonātalā,” on the north bank of the river Ichāmatī about 3 miles west of the well-known Beḍābandara in Pābanā district, Kālā Kṛṣṇadāsa Ṭhākura was born in a *brāhmaṇa* family of the Varendra class, of the Bharadvāja *gotra*, and a “Bhāduḍa-grāmī.” From Ākāihāṭ, Kālā Kṛṣṇadāsa Ṭhākura, preaching the holy name, came to Pābanā. In the field where he set up his *āśrama*, ruins of buildings can still be seen. Later his kinsmen also came to this place. As there were no Vārendra *brāhmaṇas* at Ākāihāṭ, he married in this region, and after some time he went again to Ākāihāṭ and to Śrī Vṛndāvana. While he was living in the village of Sonātalā, a son named “Śrī Mohanadāsa” was born to him. He left the boy at the home of his maternal uncle in the village of Sonātalā, or Bhāduṭī-Mathurāpura, gave him all his property, and went with his wife to Śrī Vṛndāvana. In Śrī Vṛndāvana another son was born to him, named “Gaurāṅgadāsa.” Because Gaurāṅgadāsa was born in Śrī Vṛndāvana, he was also called Vṛndāvanadāsa. Later the father sent him too to his eldest son, Mohanadāsa, and told him to take a six-*ānā* share (six-sixteenths) of the property. Gaurāṅgadāsa manifested the Deity of Śrī Kālācāḏa, resembling Śrī Govinda Jīu of Śrī Vṛndāvana, and served Him together with his elder brother.

Kālā Kṛṣṇadāsa Ṭhākura's descendants, headed by Śrī Vijayagovinda Gosvāmī, still live today in Sonātalā and other places in Pābanā district.

At Sonātalā one can still see the site of the *āśrama* house, the bricks of the temple, and the *ghāṭa* of the pond. The Deity here, Śrī Kālācāḏa Jīu, is served in turn by Kālā Kṛṣṇadāsa's descendants themselves. Here, in the month of Agrahāyaṇa, on the twelfth lunar day of the dark fortnight, the festival of Kālā Kṛṣṇadāsa Ṭhākura's disappearance is held.

*(23) Sadāśiva Kavirāja, (24) Puruṣottama (*gopāla* 10) —*

38 Śrī Sadāśiva Kavirāja was a great soul, and Śrī Puruṣottama dāsa was his son.

39 From his birth he was absorbed in the feet of Nityānanda, and he ceaselessly played childhood games with Kṛṣṇa.

Anubhāṣya.

Sadāśiva Kavirāja and Nāgara Puruṣottama. *Caitanya-bhāgavata*, Antya, Chapter 6: “Sadāśiva Kavirāja is greatly fortunate; his son is named Śrī Puruṣottama dāsa. Puruṣottama dāsa's body has no external consciousness: Nityānanda-candra sports in his heart.” In the *Gaura-gaṇoddeśa* (verse 156): “She who was formerly Candrāvalī in Vraja, most dear to Kṛṣṇa, is now in Gauḍa the Kavirāja Sadāśiva.” Verse 131: “Sadāśiva's son, named Nāgara Puruṣottama, born in a Vaidya family, is he who in Vraja was the cowherd named Dāma.” Sadāśiva Kavirāja's father, Kaṁsāri Sena, is in Kṛṣṇa's pastimes the *sakhī* “Ratnāvalī” of Vraja. Some say that Kaṁsāri Sena lived at Guptipāḍā on the E.I.R. line, but no trace of him can be found there now. Be that as it may, perfected devotees of Gaura like these, four generations in a row, are rare anywhere else.

Śrī Puruṣottama Ṭhākura's *śrīpāṭa* was formerly at Sukhasāgara, equidistant from Cākadaha and Śimurāli stations. First, when the village of Beleḍāṅgā was destroyed, Śrī Puruṣottama Ṭhākura's Deities were brought to Sukhasāgara. Then Sukhasāgara too was swallowed by the Gaṅgā. So Puruṣottama Ṭhākura's Deity was brought to Sāhebaḍāṅgā-Beḍigrāma together with the Deities of Mother Śrī Jāhnavā's *gādi* (seat), which had been at that place. When Beḍigrāma too was destroyed, Puruṣottama Ṭhākura's Deity, together with the Deities of Mother Jāhnavā's *gādi*, was moved to the village of Cāñduḍe, where He has now resided for about fifty years.

The village of Cāñduḍe on the Bhāgīrathī is in Nadīyā district, within Cākadaha police station, a mile from “Simurāli” station on the E.B.R. line and a mile's walk from “Pālapāḍā.”

Since the old Sukhasāgara was swallowed by the river, the new Sukhasāgara lies 3–4 miles from the village of Cāñduḍe, south of Kālīgañja.

Śrī Nityānanda Prabhu's son-in-law, the husband of Śrīmatī Gaṅgā-devī, was Śrī Mādhavācārya (Mādhava Caṭṭopādhyāya) of Jirāṭ; according to some he was a disciple of Śrī Nityānanda Prabhu, according to others of Śrī Jāhnavā-devī, and according to others of this Śrī Puruṣottama Ṭhākura. The *Vaiṣṇava-vandanā*

states plainly that its author, Śrī Devakīnandana dāsa, was a disciple of this very Puruṣottama.

The present temple is a thatched hut with a mud wall. In the temple reside Śrī Jagannātha, Balarāma and Subhadrā; Nitāi-Gaura, two pairs of Deities; Gopīnātha; Mother Jāhnavā; Bāla-Gopāla; Rādhā-Govinda, five pairs; Revatī and Balarāma; and a *śālagrāma*. Some say that several of these sacred forms were installed by Puruṣottama Ṭhākura and the rest belong to Jāhnavā-devī's *gādi*. This *śrīpāṭa* is also known as "the *pāṭa* of Vasu-Jāhnavā." The names of the following servitor-*mahāntas* of the Cāñduḍe *śrīpāṭa* are known: (1) Gopāladāsa Mahānta, (2) Rāmakṛṣṇa, (3) Vihāridāsa, (4) Rāmadāsa, (5) Gopāladāsa and (6) the present aged servitor, Sītānātha dāsa.

(25) Kānu Ṭhākura —

40 His son was the great soul Śrī Kānu Ṭhākura, whose body overflowed with the nectar of love for Kṛṣṇa.

Anubhāṣya.

Kānu Ṭhākura. Some count him among the twelve *gopālas*. He lived at Bodhakhānā. On the Central Section of the E.B.R. line one gets off at "Jhikaragāchā-ghāṭ" station, and from there, by boat on the river Kapotākṣa or overland, it is 2 or 2½ miles to the *śrīpāṭa* of Bodhakhānā.

Ṭhākura Kānāi's ancestor four generations back, Śrī Kaṁsāri Sena, was also called "Sambarāri." In the *Vaiṣṇava-vandanā* Devakīnandana names four generations of Ṭhākura Kānāi's ancestors: "I honor Śrī Kaṁsāri Sena and Sena Śrīvallabha. With all my heart I honor Sadāśiva Kavirāja, who is ever mad with love and knows nothing external. I honor my chosen lord, named Śrī Puruṣottama. Who can describe his incomparable qualities?"

Puruṣottama Ṭhākura was the son of Sadāśiva, and Kānu Ṭhākura was the son of Puruṣottama Ṭhākura. Kānu Ṭhākura's descendants hold that Puruṣottama Ṭhākura and "Nāgara Puruṣottama" were different persons. They say that Kānu Ṭhākura's father is the one mentioned in the *Gaura-gaṇoddeśa* as "Dāsa Puruṣottama," who is "Stokakṛṣṇa" in the pastimes of Vraja. But in the *Gaura-gaṇoddeśa* it is Puruṣottama, the son of Sadāśiva, born in a Vaidya family, who is called "Nāgara Puruṣottama." This Nāgara Puruṣottama is the friend named "Dāma" in the pastimes of Vraja. Among Kānu Ṭhākura's descendants a tradition is current that

Puruṣottama Ṭhākura lived in the village of “Sukhasāgara” on the east bank of the Gaṅgā. Puruṣottama's wife was named “Jāhnavā.” Soon after Ṭhākura Kānāi's birth, Jāhnavā disappeared from this world. When Nityānanda Prabhu learned that Puruṣottama Ṭhākura had lost his wife, He came to Puruṣottama's house and took the twelve-year-old[6] child to His own home at Khaḍadaha.

According to Kānu Ṭhākura's descendants, Ṭhākura Kānāi appeared in Śaka 1457 (Bengali year 942), on the second lunar day of the bright fortnight of Āṣāḍha, a Thursday, the day of the Ratha-yātrā. Seeing the Ṭhākura's devotion to Kṛṣṇa from infancy, Nityānanda Prabhu named him “Śiśu Kṛṣṇadāsa” (the child Kṛṣṇadāsa).

In his fifth year the child Kṛṣṇadāsa went with the queen Mother Jāhnavā to Śrī Vṛndāvana-dhāma. The Vrajavāsīs headed by Śrī Jīva Gosvāmī, seeing the child Kṛṣṇadāsa's *bhāva* and other signs, gave him the name “Ṭhākura Kānāi.” There is a story that once in Vṛndāvana, as Ṭhākura Kānāi danced, overwhelmed by the bliss of *kīrtana*, an anklet vanished from his right foot. Ṭhākura Kānāi then said, “Wherever this anklet has fallen, there I will live.” It is said that the anklet fell in a village called “Bodhakhānā” in Yaśohara district, and from then on Ṭhākura Kānāi came to live at Bodhakhānā.

Another tradition is handed down in this family: the Deity “Prāṇavallabha” has been served since some ancestor of Sadāśiva several hundred years before the appearance of Śrīman Mahāprabhu. This “Prāṇavallabha” is still served at Bodhakhānā.

At the time of the “Bargī hāṅgāmā” (the Bargī raids), all of Ṭhākura Kānāi's sons, headed by Vaṁśīvadana, except the descendants of his eldest son, fled Bodhakhānā and settled in a village called “Bhājana-ghāṭ” in Nadīyā district. One of the descendants of Ṭhākura Kānāi's younger sons, named “Harikṛṣṇa Gosvāmī,” came back to Bodhakhānā after the Bargī raids had ended. He installed another, new Deity, also named “Prāṇavallabha.” Even now, in the village of Bodhakhānā, the descendants of Ṭhākura Kānāi's eldest son serve the ancient “Śrī Prāṇavallabha,” and the descendants of the younger son serve the newly installed “Prāṇavallabha.” At Bhājana-ghāṭ the Deity “Śrī Rādhā-vallabha” is served. The book *Prema-vilāsa* shows that Kānu Ṭhākura was present at the Kheturi festival together with Jāhnavā-devī and Vīrabhadra Prabhu.

Puruṣottama Ṭhākura and Kānu Ṭhākura had many disciples who were *brāhmaṇas* by birth. The four chief disciples of Puruṣottama Ṭhākura who were *brāhmaṇas* by birth are named thus: “His four dearest disciples, the best of

brāhmaṇas: first Mādhavācārya, then Yādavācārya Paṇḍita, and Daivakīnandana dāsa, famous in Gauḍa-maṇḍala, who composed the book *Śrīmad Vaiṣṇava-vandanā*." This Mādhavācārya is the husband of Gaṅgā-devī, the daughter of Śrī Nityānanda Prabhu. After the village of Sukhasāgara was destroyed, the Deities installed by Puruṣottama were brought to Cānduḍiyā, and they are now served together with his other Deities under the supervision of the descendants of Gaṅgā at Jirāṭ. Puruṣottama Ṭhākura's *śrīpāṭa* is also called the *pāṭa* of "Vasu-Jāhnavā."

Kānu Ṭhākura's disciples live in the village of Gaḍabetā on the bank of the river Śilāvatī in Medinīpura district. A *brāhmaṇa* named "Śrīrāma," of the Rāḍhī class and of the Kauthumī branch of the *Sāma Veda*, was a famous disciple of Kānāi Ṭhākura.

*(26) Uddhāraṇa Ṭhākura (*gopāla* 11) —*

41 Uddhāraṇa Datta, the best of great devotees, served the feet of Nityānanda in every way.

Anubhāṣya.

Uddhāraṇa Datta. In the *Gaura-gaṇoddeśa* (verse 129): "He who in Vraja was the cowherd Subāhu is Datta, named Uddhāraṇa." He lived in Saptagrāma, on the bank of the river Sarasvatī near Triśabighā station in Hugalī district. Formerly "Saptagrāma" meant Vāsudevapura, Bāśaberiyā, Kṛṣṇapura, Nityānandapura, Śivapura, Śaṅkhanagara and Saptagrāma taken together. *Caitanya-bhāgavata*, Antya, Chapter 6: "Uddhāraṇa Datta is a great and generous Vaiṣṇava, who was given the right to serve Nityānanda." Antya, Chapter 5: "After staying some days at Khaḍadaha, Nityānanda came to Saptagrāma with all His associates. The best of lords stayed on the bank of the Triveṇī, in the temple of the fortunate Uddhāraṇa Datta. In body, mind and words Datta Uddhāraṇa served Nityānanda's feet without pretense. Through Uddhāraṇa the whole merchant community was purified — of this there is no doubt." By birth he belonged to a Suvarṇa-vaṇik family.

At Saptagrāma there is a six-armed form of Mahāprabhu, installed by Śrīla Uddhāraṇa Ṭhākura and served by him with his own hands. To His right is Śrī Nityānanda and to His left Śrī Gadādhara. There are also forms of Śrī Rādhā-Govinda and a Śrī Śālagrāma, and beneath the throne-altar a painting of Śrī Uddhāraṇa Ṭhākura Mahāśaya is worshiped. In front of the present temple is a large *nāṭya-mandira*. A memorial stone plaque on a pillar of the *nāṭya-mandira*

bears the names of the builder of the temple and of those who restored the *śrīpāṭa*. Right in front of the *nāṭya-mandira* is a cool, shady *mādhavī* bower. On either side of the bower stand two pillars: on one is a painting of Uddhāraṇa Ṭhākura Mahāśaya, and on the other, on a stone plaque, the four *tāraka-brahma-nāmas* of the four *yugas* are inscribed.

In 1283 a mendicant named Nitāidāsa Bābājī collected 12 *bighās* of land for the *śrīpāṭa*. Then, through the special efforts of certain people, the *śrīpāṭa* kept up for a while, but gradually the service fell into disorder. Later, in 1306, through the combined efforts of Balarāma Mallika, former Sub-judge of Hugalī, and many wealthy Suvarṇa-vaṇiks of Calcutta, some order is now seen again in the service of the *śrīpāṭa*.

Half a century ago a wooden image of Śrīla Uddhāraṇa Ṭhākura, installed by the late Jagamohana Datta of Bāli in Hugalī, resided in a broken-down hut. That image is no longer at the Saptagrāma *śrīpāṭa*, and his painting is worshiped now. On inquiry we heard that Uddhāraṇa Ṭhākura's former image is now in the house of Śrī Madana Datta Mahāśaya of Bāli, Hugalī, and the *śālagrāma* the Ṭhākura served is in the same village, in the house of Śrīnātha Datta.

Ṭhākura Uddhāraṇa was the *dewan* of the Rājā of the village of “Naihāṭī,” 1½ miles north of Kāṭoyā. Near Dāïhāṭ station the ruins of that royal family's palace can still be seen. The place where the Ṭhākura lived while serving the Rājā is still called “Uddhāraṇapura.” It is said that the Śrī Nitāi-Gaura Deity the Ṭhākura installed here was taken to the capital of Banoyārībāda. West of the temple here (or, according to some, in Vṛndāvana) is the Ṭhākura's *samādhi*. According to some, the Ṭhākura's father was named Śrīkara, his mother Bhadrāvatī, and his son Śrīnivāsa.

(27) Vaiṣṇavānanda Ācārya —

42 Ācārya Vaiṣṇavānanda was rich in devotion; his former name was Raghunātha Purī.

Anubhāṣya.

Vaiṣṇavānanda Ācārya. *Caitanya-bhāgavata*: “Ācārya Vaiṣṇavānanda is supremely generous; formerly he was known as ‘Raghunātha Purī.’” The *Gaura-gaṇoddeśa* (verse 97), naming Raghunātha Purī among the eight Purīs, describes him as one of the eight *siddhis*, beginning with *aṇimā*.

(28) Viṣṇudāsa, Nandana, Gaṅgādāsa — three brothers —

43 Viṣṇudāsa, Nandana and Gaṅgādāsa were three brothers, in whose house Ṭhākura Nitāi once stayed.

Anubhāṣya.

Viṣṇudāsa, Nandana and Gaṅgādāsa were three brothers, Bhaṭṭācāryas of Navadvīpa. Viṣṇudāsa and Gaṅgādāsa stayed with Mahāprabhu at Nīlācala for some time (Ādi 10.151). Mahāprabhu and Advaita Prabhu hid in Nandana Ācārya's house. Śrī Nityānanda Prabhu, on coming to Navadvīpa, also stayed there for a few days. *Caitanya-bhāgavata*, Antya, Chapter 6: "Gaṅgādāsa, the son of Caturbhuja Paṇḍita — in his house Nityānanda once sported."

(29) Paramānanda Upādhyāya, (30) Śrī Jīva Paṇḍita —

44 Paramānanda Upādhyāya was a servant of Nityānanda, and Śrī Jīva Paṇḍita sang of Nityānanda's virtues.

Anubhāṣya.

Paramānanda Upādhyāya. *Caitanya-bhāgavata*, Antya, Chapter 6: "Paramānanda Upādhyāya is an exclusively devoted Vaiṣṇava."

Śrī Jīva Paṇḍita was the middle son of Ratnagarbha Ācārya, a childhood friend of Hāḍāi Ojhā, Nityānanda's father. *Caitanya-bhāgavata*, Antya, Chapter 6: "The generous Jīva Paṇḍita is a great devotee; in his house Nityānanda-candra sported." In Vraja he is Indirā (*Gaura-gaṇoddeśa*, verse 169).

(31) Paramānanda Gupta —

45 Paramānanda Gupta was a devotee of Kṛṣṇa, great in wisdom; Nityānanda once lived in his house.

Anubhāṣya.

Paramānanda Gupta. *Caitanya-bhāgavata*, Antya, Chapter 6: "Famous is Paramānanda Gupta Mahāśaya; formerly Nityānanda lived in his house." In the *Gaura-gaṇoddeśa* (verses 194 and 199) he is Mañjumedhā of Vraja: "The *Kṛṣṇa-stavāvalī* composed by Paramānanda Gupta."

(32) Nārāyaṇa, (33) Kṛṣṇadāsa, (34) Manohara, (35) Devānanda —

46 Nārāyaṇa, Kṛṣṇadāsa, Manohara and Devānanda — these four brothers were servants of Nitāi.

Anubhāṣya.

Nārāyaṇa, Kṛṣṇadāsa, Manohara and Devānanda. *Caitanya-bhāgavata*, Antya, Chapter 6: "Kṛṣṇadāsa and Devānanda are two pure-hearted ones. Dear to Nityānanda are these four: 'Manohara,' 'Nārāyaṇa,' 'Kṛṣṇadāsa' and 'Devānanda.'"

(36) Hoḍa Kṛṣṇadāsa —

47 To Hoḍa Kṛṣṇadāsa, Nityānanda Prabhu was life itself; he knew nothing but the feet of Śrī Nityānanda.

Anubhāṣya.

Hoḍa Kṛṣṇadāsa. "Kṛṣṇadāsa of Baḍagāchi, rich in pious merit, in whose temple Nityānanda sported"; the same place tells of the glory of Baḍagāchi (*Caitanya-bhāgavata*, Antya, Chapter 6). See below, "Navanī Hoḍa."

*(37) Nakaḍi, (38) Mukunda, (39) Sūrya, (40) Mādhava, (41) Śrīdhara (*gopāla* 12), (42) Rāmānanda, (43) Jagannātha, (44) Mahīdhara —*

48 Among Nityānanda's devotees were also Nakaḍi, Mukunda, Sūrya, Mādhava, Śrīdhara, Rāmānanda Vasu, Jagannātha and Mahīdhara;

(45) Śrīmanta, (46) Gokuladāsa, (47) Hariharānanda, (48) Śivāi, (49) Nandāi, (50) Paramānanda —

49 Śrīmanta, Gokuladāsa, Hariharānanda, Śivāi, Nandāi and Paramānanda the Avadhūta;

(51) Vasanta, (52) Navanī, (53) Gopāla, (54) Sanātana, (55) Viṣṇāi, (56) Kṛṣṇānanda, (57) Sulocana —

50 Vasanta, Navanī Hoḍa, Gopāla, Sanātana, Viṣṇāi Hājarā, Kṛṣṇānanda and Sulocana;

Anubhāṣya.

Navanī Hoḍa. Rājā Kṛṣṇadāsa Hoḍa, the son of Hari Hoḍa, lived in Baḍagāchi. Baḍagāchi (Bahiragāchi) lies on the Lālagolā-ghāṭ line of the E.B.R., two miles from Muḍāgāchā station, across from Dharmadaha, on the bank of the "Guḍaguḍe" canal. In nearby Śāligrāma, through Rājā Kṛṣṇadāsa's efforts, the wedding of Śrī Nityānanda Prabhu took place (*Bhakti-ratnākara*, wave 12). "Rukuṇapura" is a short distance from Bahiragāchi. Kṛṣṇadāsa's son was Navanī Hoḍa. His descendants now live in Rukuṇapura. By birth they are Dakṣiṇa-Rāḍhīya Kāyasthas; having received brahminical *saṁskāras*, they give initiation to people of all *varṇas*. In former times the Gaṅgā flowed at Baḍagāchi; that channel is now known as the "Kālśira canal."

Kṛṣṇānanda: see section 35.

(58) Kaṁsāri, (59) Rāmasena, (60) Rāmacandra, (61) Govinda, (62) Śrīraṅga, (63) Mukunda —

51 Kaṁsāri Sena, Rāmasena and Rāmacandra Kavirāja, and the three physicians — Govinda, Śrīraṅga and Mukunda;

Anubhāṣya.

Kaṁsāri Sena is "Ratnāvalī" of Vraja. See the *Gaura-gaṇoddeśa*, verses 194 and 200, and "Sadāśiva Kavirāja" above.

Rāmacandra Kavirāja was the son of Cirañjīva and Sunandā of Khaṇḍa, a disciple of Śrīnivāsa Ācārya, and a dear friend of Ṭhākura Narottama. Ṭhākura Narottama prayed for his company birth after birth. His younger brother was Govinda Kavirāja. Seeing his devotion to Kṛṣṇa, Śrī Jīva Gosvāmī Prabhu gave him the name "Kavirāja" in Vṛndāvana. From birth he was detached from worldly life, and he was the chief and dearest companion of Ṭhākura Mahāśaya and Śrīnivāsa Ācārya Prabhu in preaching and in *bhajana*. He lived first in Śrīkhaṇḍa and later came to "Kumāranagara" on the bank of the Bhāgīrathī and settled there (see the *Bhakti-ratnākara*).

Govinda Kavirāja was the younger son of Cirañjīva of Khaṇḍa and the brother of Rāmacandra Kavirāja. At first he was a Śākta; later he was initiated by Śrīnivāsa Ācārya Prabhu. He lived first in Śrīkhaṇḍa, then in Kumāranagara, and later came to the village of "Teliyā Budhari" on the south bank of the Padmā and settled there. Seeing his poetic gift, Śrī Jīva Gosvāmī Prabhu gave him too the name "Kavirāja."

He is the author of the drama *Saṅgīta-mādhava*, the *Gītāmṛta* and other works (see the *Bhakti-ratnākara*, wave 9).

(64) Pītāmbara, (65) Mādhavācārya, (66) Dāmodara, (67) Śaṅkara, (68) Mukunda, (69) Jñānadāsa, (70) Manohara —

52 Pītāmbara, Mādhavācārya, Dāmodara dāsa, Śaṅkara, Mukunda, Jñānadāsa and Manohara;

(71) Gopāla, (72) Rāmabhadra, (73) Gaurāṅgadāsa, (74) Nṛsiṁha-caitanya, (75) Mīnaketana —

53 Gopāla the dancer, Rāmabhadra, Gaurāṅgadāsa, Nṛsiṁha-caitanya and Mīnaketana Rāmadāsa.

Anubhāṣya.

Mīnaketana Rāmadāsa. In the *Gaura-gaṇoddeśa* (verse 68): “For a purpose the two born together, Niśaṭha and Ulmuka, entered him. Mīnaketana Rāma[7] is another *vyūha* of Saṅkarṣaṇa.”

(76) Śrī Ṭhākura Vṛndāvana dāsa —

54 Vṛndāvana dāsa, the son of Nārāyaṇī, composed the *Caitanya-maṅgala*.[3]

Anubhāṣya.

Vṛndāvana dāsa. In the *Gaura-gaṇoddeśa* (verse 109): “He who was Vedavyāsa is now Vṛndāvana dāsa. For a purpose, [Kṛṣṇa's] friend Kusumāpīḍa also entered him.” He is the son of Nārāyaṇī, the daughter of Śrīvāsa's brother, and the author of the *Caitanya-bhāgavata*. See the essay “The Ṭhākura's Life” in the introduction to the *Caitanya-bhāgavata* written by the author of this commentary.

*Vyāsadeva described Kṛṣṇa's pastimes in the *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam*, and [Vṛndāvana dāsa] Gaura's pastimes in the *Caitanya-bhāgavata* —*

55 Veda-vyāsa described the pastimes of Kṛṣṇa in the *Bhāgavata*; the Vyāsa of Caitanya’s pastimes is Vṛndāvana dāsa.

The branch of Vīrabhadra Gosāñi is the best of all —

56 Vīrabhadra Gosāñi is the best of all the branches, and His offshoots are without end.

Nityānanda's associates are countless; [the author] glorifies their qualities to purify himself —

57 Nityānanda's devotees are endless — who could count them? I have written of some of them for my own purification.

They deliver the world by giving love for Kṛṣṇa —

58 All these branches are laden with the ripe fruits of love. They gave them to whomever they met and flooded all with love.

The deeds of their direct love for Kṛṣṇa —

59 Their love knows no bounds, nor does their striving; each of them has great power to give love and to give Kṛṣṇa Himself.

Anubhāṣya.

Thus ends the eleventh chapter of the "Anubhāṣya."

60 Thus I have told in brief of Nityānanda's devotees, whose limit even the thousand-mouthed Ananta cannot reach.

61 Praying at the feet of Śrī Rūpa and Śrī Raghunātha, I, Kṛṣṇadāsa, narrate the *Caitanya-caritāmṛta*.

Notes

1. "His side" is Nityānanda's: by verse 14, Mahāprabhu sent these two to Gauḍa with Him; so too the edition's heading to verse 14: "Together with Nitāi both preach in Gauḍa." ↩

2. *Dāna-keli*, “the toll pastime”: Kṛṣṇa and His friends block the gopīs’ way and demand a “toll” from them. ↩
3. *Caitanya-maṅgala* was the first name of the *Caitanya-bhāgavata* (see Ādi 8.33–35). ↩
4. The edition reads *revata-vaṁśa*, “the line of Revata” (Revata, also called Kakudmī, is Revatī's father). Possibly *revaty-aṁśa* should be read: “born of portions of Vāruṇī and Revatī.” ↩
5. The *Caitanya-bhāgavata* itself (Madhya 1.296) reads “a companion of the Prabhu's father,” that is, from the context, of Jagannātha Miśra. Below (on verse 44) the edition again calls Ratnagarbha a childhood friend of Hāḍāi Ojhā, Nityānanda's father. ↩
6. So in the edition (*dvādaśa varṣera*, “of twelve years”). Yet just below it says that in his fifth year the child had already gone with Mother Jāhnavā to Vṛndāvana. ↩
7. The edition reads *mīnaketana-rāmādir vyūhaḥ*, literally “Mīnaketana Rāma and the others are a *vyūha*”; translated according to the sense. ↩

“Śrī Caitanya-caritāmṛta”

Ādi-līlā

Chapter 12

The Description of the Branches of the Advaita Trunk

(English translation from the Bengali, following the Gauḍīya Maṭha edition and the «Anubhāṣya», 2026 — draft)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya

Summary. In this twelfth chapter the author describes the branches of Advaita Prabhu. Among them he calls the Vaiṣṇavas who follow the teaching (*mata*) of Śrī Acyutānanda *sāra-grāhī*, those who accept the essence, and all the others *asāra*, worthless. At the end he describes the branch of Śrī Gadādhara Paṇḍita Gosvāmī and so concludes the chapter. In between, two stories are told: one about Śrī Advaita's son Gopāla Miśra, the other about Advaita's servant Kamalākānta Viśvāsa. Early in Śrī Gopāla's life, during the cleaning of the Guṇḍicā temple, he fell unconscious in *prema*, and by Śrī Mahāprabhu's mercy he came back to himself. Kamalākānta Viśvāsa, the Ācārya's servant, begged three hundred rupees from King Pratāparudra to pay off Advaita Prabhu's debt. When Mahāprabhu learned of this, He punished that *bāuliyā* Viśvāsa, and at Advaitācārya's request He set him right.

Advaita's followers are of two kinds: those who accept the essence and those who accept what is worthless —

1 Like bees, all the followers of Śrī Advaita hover about His lotus feet, yet some of them hold the essence and others are empty. Rejecting the empty, I bow to those who hold the essence, whose very life is Śrī Caitanya.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

The followers of Śrī Advaita Prabhu are of two kinds: *sāra-grāhī*, those who accept the essence, and *asāra-vāhī*, those who carry what is worthless. Rejecting those who carry the worthless, I bow down to all who carry the essence, the servants of Caitanya.

Anubhāṣya.

sārāsāra-bhṛtaḥ (the essence: Advaita's followers who belong to Gaurahari; the worthless: those who merely fancy themselves His followers but have turned away from Gaurahari; those who carry the one or the other) **akhilān** (all) **advaitāṅghry-abja-bhṛṅgān** (Advaita's feet are lotuses, and the bees at them are Advaita's servants) (considering them so), **asārān** (the Māyāvādīs who only seem to be His followers and lack pure devotion) **hitvā** (leaving aside), **caitanya-jīvanān** (those whose life is Caitanya, for whom Gaura is life itself) **sāra-bhṛtaḥ** (the *bhāgavatas* who accept the essence) **tān** (those devotees of Advaita) **naumi** (I praise).

2 Glory, glory to Mahāprabhu Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya! Glory, glory to Nityānanda, and glory to the blessed Advaita!

Obeisances to Advaita's servants, devotees of Gaura who accept the essence —

3 The glorious Advaitacandra is the second trunk of the immortal tree of Śrī Caitanya, and His followers are the branches of that trunk. To them we bow down.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

I bow down to all the associates of Advaita Prabhu, the branches of the second trunk of the wish-fulfilling tree named Śrī Caitanya.

Anubhāṣya.

śrī-caitanyāmara-taroḥ (of the wish-fulfilling tree, Gaura) **dvitīya-skandha-rūpiṇaḥ śrīmad-advaita-candrasya śākhā-rūpān** (like the branches of a tree) **gaṇān** (the people who have taken shelter of Kṛṣṇa) (we) **numaḥ** (bow down).

4 The second trunk of the tree is Ācārya Gosāñi. So many branches grew from Him that there is no writing them all down.

By Gaura's mercy only the servants of Advaita who accept the essence flourish —

5 Caitanya the gardener waters this trunk with His mercy, and, nourished by that water, it grows day by day.

6 So many fruits of love for Kṛṣṇa ripened on that trunk that they filled the whole world.

7 Through the trunk that water rises into the branches, and they spread far and wide, laden with flowers and fruit.

Two separate teachings among Advaita's servants —

8 At first the Ācārya's followers were all of one mind; but later, as fate would have it, two views arose among them.

Those who accept the essence serve Gaura by following Advaita; the worthless, acting on their own, oppose Gaura —

9 Some kept to the Ācārya's order; others, in the grip of fate, grew self-willed and invented doctrines of their own.

To follow the Ācārya is the essence; anything else is worthless —

10 The Ācārya's teaching is the essence; whoever goes against His order is empty, mere chaff.

Why the nondevotees who fancy themselves Advaita's servants are mentioned, and an example —

11 There is no need here to name the empty ones; I list them together only to make the difference plain.

12 It is like a heap of paddy: one first measures it along with its chaff, and afterwards winnows the chaff away to clean the grain.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

At first all of Advaita Prabhu's followers held one teaching. Later, through an unhappy turn of fate, some of them came to hold separate views. Those who walked by the Ācārya's own teaching are pure Vaiṣṇavas. But those who, subject to fate, invented some view of their own, different from what the Ācārya taught, are worthless. We have no need of the names of worthless people. Still, to keep the Vaiṣṇavas who accept the essence apart from those who carry the worthless, we mention them, counting them all together — as one separates rice by winnowing away the empty husks (*pātnā*). "*Pātnā*" is the name for a worthless grain of rice with no kernel.

(1) The branch of Acyutānanda —

13 Acyutānanda, the Ācārya's son, is a great branch. From his very birth he served the feet of Śrī Caitanya.[1]

A description of Acyuta's qualities —

14 When he heard his father say that Keśava Bhāratī was the guru of Caitanya Gosāñi, he was deeply pained.

15 "How can You teach such a thing about the guru of the world?" he said. "This teaching of Yours will bring ruin on the whole land.

16 Caitanya Gosāñi is the guru of the fourteen worlds; no scripture anywhere says that anyone else is His guru."

17 Hearing a boy of five speak the very essence of the scriptures' conclusions, the Ācārya was boundlessly pleased.

Anubhāṣya.

Acyutānanda. The *Caitanya-bhāgavata* (Antya-khaṇḍa, Chapter 9) records that he was Advaita Prabhu's eldest son: "Advaita's eldest son, Śrī Acyutānanda." The book *Advaita-carita*, written in Sanskrit, says: "Acyuta, Kṛṣṇa Miśra and Gopāla dāsa — these three jewels are said to be born from the ocean of Sītā's womb. These three sons of the Ācārya are known as associates of Gaura. The fourth is called

Balarāma, the fifth Svarūpa, and the sixth is named Jagadīśa: the Ācārya had six sons.”

So of Śrī Advaita Prabhu's three sons who were devotees of Gaura, Acyutānanda was the eldest. Advaita married at the very beginning of the fifteenth century of the Śaka era. In the year when Śrī Mahāprabhu resolved to go from Nīlācala to Vṛndāvana by way of Rāmakeli, that is, in Śaka 1433–34, Acyutānanda was only five years old. The *Caitanya-bhāgavata* (Antya-khaṇḍa, Chapter 4) calls him “five years old, charming, naked.” Acyutānanda was therefore born in Śaka 1428. Even before Acyuta's birth, when Mahāprabhu was born, Advaita's wife Sītā came to see the Lord's birth. So there is nothing impossible in her having three more sons within twenty-one years.

There is a Bengali book in verse called *Sītā-advaita-carita*. It was composed by one Lokanātha dāsa of the *sakhī-bhekī* party of the *prākṛta-sahajiyās*, and it was printed in Śaka 1792 by the journal *Nityānanda-dāyinī*. It describes Acyutānanda as Mahāprabhu's schoolmate; this contradicts the *Caitanya-bhāgavata*. When Mahāprabhu, after taking *sannyāsa*, came to Advaita's house in Śāntipura, the year was Śaka 1431, and Acyutānanda was then a child of three (*Caitanya-bhāgavata*, Antya, Chapter 1): “Advaita's son, a naked little child, came and fell at Gauracandra's feet. The Lord took him on His lap, dust and all. The Lord said: ‘Acyuta, the Ācārya is My father. By that relation you and I are two brothers.’”

Before the great manifestation (*mahā-prakāśa*) in Śrī Navadvīpa, Śrīman Mahāprabhu sent Śrīrāma Paṇḍita to Śāntipura to bring Advaita. Acyutānanda then joined his father and mother in weeping for joy: “Advaita's son, named ‘Acyutānanda,’ just a little boy — he too weeps without stopping.” And when Advaita Prabhu was expounding knowledge (*jñāna*) against devotion and Mahāprabhu was beating Him, Acyutānanda was present there too. All these events must be placed two or three years before the Lord's *sannyāsa*. (*Caitanya-bhāgavata*, Madhya, Chapter 19): “Acyuta, Advaita's son, bows down.”

From childhood Śrī Acyuta was a devotee of Śrīman Mahāprabhu. Nothing is known of his ever taking a wife and living as a householder. In the description of Śrī Advaita's branch his name stands first among the disciples. Śrī Yadunandana dāsa wrote the *Śākhā-nirṇayāmṛta* on the branches of Śrī Gadādhara Paṇḍita Gosvāmī, and from it we learn that Acyutānanda Ṭhākura was a disciple and branch of Gadādhara: “Acyutānanda, the bliss of the nectar of the great *rasa*, the

son of Śrīmad Advaita, most dear to Gadādhara." Acyutānanda performed his worship in Nīlācala, having taken shelter of Mahāprabhu's feet (Ādi, Chapter 10): "Acyutānanda, the son of Advaita Ācārya, who stayed in Nīlācala, taking shelter at the Lord's feet." (CC, Ādi 10.150) At the end of his life Śrī Gadādhara Paṇḍita Gosvāmī lived in Nīlācala near Śrī Mahāprabhu. That is why, as we see, many of Advaita Prabhu's true servants, headed by Acyutānanda, took shelter of Śrī Gadādhara's feet.

From his earliest childhood Acyutānanda showed intense devotion to Śrī Mahāprabhu. In the dancing and *kīrtana* before the chariot, too, we see the Lord's dear Acyutānanda every time (see Ādi, Chapter 13, 452[8]): "There was one party of the Ācārya of Śāntipura; Acyutānanda danced there, and all the rest sang." (CC, Madhya 13.45) The boy was then only six years old. In the *Śrī Gaura-gaṇoddeśa-dīpikā* by Śrī Kavi Karṇapūra, Acyutānanda is glorified as "Gadādhara's disciple, dear to Kṛṣṇa Caitanya." Some identify him with Kārttikeya, others with the *gopī* named "Acyutā." The author has concluded that both views are correct: "His son Acyutānanda, dear to Kṛṣṇa Caitanya, is known to be the beloved disciple of Śrīmat Paṇḍita Gosvāmī. Some say that formerly he was Kārttikeya. Others, knowers of *rasa*, say he is the *gopī* named Acyutā. Both are correct, for the two have come together in one."

Śrī Narahari dāsa's *Narottama-vilāsa* describes in detail how Śrī Acyutānanda came to the festival at Khetari and took part in it. Though he was by then quite infirm, he joined the festival at the request of his mother, Śrī Sītā, and of Śrī Jāhnavā. According to that same Narahari dāsa, at the end of his life he lived in his home in Śāntipura. Yet it is known that while Śrī Mahāprabhu was manifest in this world, Acyutānanda lived with Him in Purī, and afterwards near Śrī Gadādhara. Needless to say, since he never married, Acyutānanda had no children.

(2) Kṛṣṇa Miśra —

18 Another of the Ācārya's sons was named Kṛṣṇa Miśra, and Caitanya Gosāñi dwelt in his heart.

Anubhāṣya.

Kṛṣṇa Miśra. In the Sanskrit book *Advaita-carita*: "Acyuta, Kṛṣṇa Miśra and Gopāla dāsa — these three jewels are said to be born from the ocean of Sītā's womb." Of Śrī Advaita Prabhu's six sons, three brothers — "Acyuta, Kṛṣṇa Miśra

and Gopāla” — were engaged in the service of Śrī Gaurāṅga. *Gaura-gaṇoddeśa*, verse 88: “Some say that Kṛṣṇa Miśra is Kārttikeya, because he is like him.”

Kṛṣṇa Miśra had two sons: (1) Raghunātha Cakravartī and (2) Dolagovinda. Raghunātha's descendants live in Śāntipura, in the Madana-Gopāla quarter, and in Gaṇakara, Mṛjāpura and Kumārakhāli. Dolagovinda had three sons: (1) Cāṅda, (2) Kandarpa, (3) Gopīnātha. Kandarpa's descendants live in Māladaha and Jikābāḍī. Gopīnātha had three sons: (1) Śrīvallabha, (2) Prāṇavallabha and (3) Keśava. Śrīvallabha's descendants live in Maśiyāḍārā (Mahiṣaḍerā?), Dāmukadiyā, Caṇḍīpura and other places. The Maśiyāḍārā line descends from Śrīvallabha's eldest son, Gaṅgānārāyaṇa, and the lines in the villages of Dāmukadiyā, Caṇḍīpura, Śolamāri and others from his youngest son, Rāmagopāla. The descendants of Prāṇavallabha and Keśava live in Uthalī.

Prāṇavallabha's son was Ratneśvara; his son was Kṛṣṇarāma; Kṛṣṇarāma's youngest son was Lakṣmīnārāyaṇa, and his son was Navakiśora. Navakiśora's second son was Rāmamohana. Rāmamohana's eldest son, “Jagabandhu,” and his third son, “Vīracandra,” entered the order of mendicants (*bhikṣu-āśrama*) and installed a Deity of Śrī Mahāprabhu at Kāṭoyā. People called them “Baḍa Prabhu” and “Choṭa Prabhu,” the elder and the younger Prabhu. It was they who started the circumambulation (*parikramā*) of Śrī Dhāma Navadvīpa. For the complete genealogy of Kṛṣṇa Miśra see the article “Advaita-vaṁśa” in the *Vaiṣṇava-mañjuṣā* (issue 4).

(3) The childhood of Gopāla —

19 Śrī Gopāla was yet another son of the Ācārya. Listen to his story, for it is most wonderful.

Anubhāṣya.
Gopāla: one of Advaita Prabhu's three sons who were Vaiṣṇavas. See Madhya, Chapter 12, 143–149.

20 When Mahāprabhu was cleansing the Guṇḍicā temple, Gopāla danced before Him in the kīrtana, filled with the great joy of love.[2]

21 Many ecstasies arose in his body, and his dancing was wondrous; the two Gosāñis, delighted at heart, called out, “Hari!”[3]

22 In the midst of his dancing Gopāla fainted and fell to the ground, with no sign of awareness left in his body.

Anubhāṣya.

"*Sambita*": *saṁvit*, consciousness.

23 The Ācārya was grieved. Taking His son on His lap, He recited the mantra of Nṛsiṁha to protect him.

24 He recited mantra after mantra, but the boy did not come to, and the Vaiṣṇavas wept to see the Ācārya's grief.

25 Then Mahāprabhu placed His hand on the boy's chest and said, "Get up, Gopāla! Say 'Hari! Hari!'"

26 Feeling the Lord's touch and hearing His voice, Gopāla rose, and everyone, overjoyed, raised the cry of "Hari!"

27 The Ācārya had other sons as well: Śrī Balarāma, Svarūpa and one named Jagadīśa.

Anubhāṣya.

Balarāma, Svarūpa and Jagadīśa. In the Sanskrit book *Advaita-carita*: "The fourth is called Balarāma, the fifth Svarūpa, and the sixth is named Jagadīśa: the Ācārya had six sons." All three turned away from Gaura; they are *smārtas*, or Māyāvādīs, and therefore not Vaiṣṇavas.

Balarāma's three wives bore him nine sons. The youngest son of the first wife, Madhusūdana, became known as "Gosāñi Bhaṭṭācārya" and adopted the religion of the *smārtas*. His son Rādhāramaṇa took the name "Gosvāmī Bhaṭṭācārya" and so degraded the word "*gosvāmī*," a title fit only for one who has left home. Following the *smārta* Raghunandana, he burned a *kuśa-puttalikā* (an effigy of *kuśa* grass) of Śrī Advaita Prabhu and performed over it the *śrāddha* rite done for a ghost (*preta*) or a demon (*rākṣasa*). By acting against the *smṛtis* devoted to Viṣṇu-bhakti, such as the *Śrī Hari-bhakti-vilāsa*, he displayed his foolishness and a great offense. Without being a pure devotee, he wrote several

books and commentaries on primary works; pure devotees do not value them. For Balarāma's genealogy see the *Mañjuṣā* (issue 4).

(4) Kamalākānta —

28 The Ācārya had a servant named Kamalākānta Viśvāsa, who knew all His affairs.

Anubhāṣya.

Kamalākānta Viśvāsa. The “Kamalānanda” mentioned in Ādi, Chapter 10, verse 149, and the “Kamalākānta” of Madhya, Chapter 10, verse 94, are probably the same person. And Viśvāsa Kamalākānta is the very man of that name mentioned in Ādi, Chapter 10, verse 119. The brāhmaṇa Kamalākānta is one of the Lord's own associates. Kamalākānta Viśvāsa, being Advaita's servant, is also the Lord's associate. When Śrī Paramānanda Purī came from Navadvīpa to Nīlācala, he brought with him the brāhmaṇa Kamalākānta, or Kamalānanda, a resident of Navadvīpa. Madhya, Chapter 10, 94: “There was a devotee of the Lord, a brāhmaṇa named ‘Kamalākānta’; taking him along, he set out for Nīlācala.” (CC, Madhya 10.94)

The story of Kamalākānta —

29 In Nīlācala he wrote a letter and sent it to King Pratāparudra.

30 The Ācārya knew nothing about the letter, and somehow it found its way to the Lord.

*The *bāul* doctrine in Kamalākānta's letter —*

31 In that letter he had proclaimed the Ācārya to be God Himself.

32 “But by fate,” it went on, “He has fallen into some debt, and to pay it off I ask for three hundred coins.”

33 The Lord read the letter and was pained at heart; yet, smiling outwardly, the moon-faced One said:

34 “He has proclaimed the Ācārya to be God, and in that there is no fault: the Ācārya truly is God.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

“*Daivata īśvara*”: in fact Īśvara, the Lord[7].

*To think Nārāyaṇa, the possessor of the six opulences, poor, as if He were a *jīva*, is Māyāvāda, the *bāul* doctrine —*

35 But he has made God out to be poor and gone begging for Him. So I shall punish him and teach him a lesson.”

Anubhāṣya.

“*Īśvarera dainya kari*”: making the Lord a pauper.

*The punishment of the *bāuliyā* —*

36 He ordered Govinda, “From today on, do not let that madcap Viśvāsa come here.”

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

“*Bāuliyā* Viśvāsa”: Kamalākānta Viśvāsa's conclusions are like the talk of a *bāul*, a madman; that is why he was called “*bāuliyā* Viśvāsa.”

Anubhāṣya.

“*Viśvāse*”: Kamalākānta Viśvāsa.

37 Viśvāsa was deeply distressed to hear of his punishment, but when the Ācārya heard of it, He was delighted.

Advaita Prabhu consoles him —

38 He said to Viśvāsa, “You are most fortunate: the Lord, Bhagavān Himself, has punished you.

39 In the past Mahāprabhu used to honour Me. This pained Me, and I thought of a way to change it.

40 I expounded the *Yoga-vāsiṣṭha*, extolling liberation as the highest goal, and the Lord grew angry and treated Me with dishonour.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

While explaining the *Yoga-vāsiṣṭha*, Advaita Prabhu on some pretext declared liberation (*mukti*) superior to devotion.

Anubhāṣya.

"*Vāśiṣṭha*": the *Yoga-vāsiṣṭha Rāmāyaṇa*. It propounds Māyāvāda, which opposes devotion to Viṣṇu, that is, liberation as extinction (*nirvāṇa-mokṣa*) in the form of merging into Brahman (*brahma-sāyujya*). Pure devotees therefore should not read it.

41 Being punished brought Me the greatest joy; fortunate Śrī Mukunda received the same punishment.

42 So did the fortunate Śrī Śacī. Where else could anyone find such mercy in the guise of punishment?"

Anubhāṣya.

On Advaita's punishment, see the *Caitanya-bhāgavata*, Madhya, Chapter 19; on Mukunda's punishment, the *Caitanya-bhāgavata*, Madhya, Chapter 10; on Śacīmātā's punishment, the *Caitanya-bhāgavata*, Madhya, Chapter 22.

43 With these words the Ācārya comforted him, and then, joyful, He went to Mahāprabhu.

Seeing Kamalākānta punished, Advaita speaks to the Lord —

44 He said to the Lord, "I do not understand this pastime of Yours. You have made Kamalā a greater vessel of Your mercy than Me.

45 Such mercy You have never shown even Me. What offence have I committed at Your feet?"

Mahāprabhu laughs and shows His favor —

46 Hearing this, Mahāprabhu began to laugh; He sent for Kamalākānta and was gracious to him.

Advaita's words —

47 The Ācārya said, “Why have You let him see You again? He makes a mockery of Me in two ways.”

Anubhāṣya.
He calls Me the transcendental Nārāyaṇa, and yet in practice he takes Me for a mundane pauper begging for money.

48 The Lord was pleased at heart to hear this. Only the two of Them knew what lay within each other’s words.

*Mahāprabhu's words to the *bāuliyā* —*

49 The Lord said, “Madcap, why do you behave like this? What you do harms the Ācārya’s honour and His dharma.

The Lord defines the duty of a Vaiṣṇava ācārya —

50 A Vaiṣṇava ācārya must never accept a king’s wealth as a gift. If he eats the food of worldly men, his mind is defiled.

51 When the mind is defiled, one cannot remember Kṛṣṇa, and without remembrance of Kṛṣṇa life bears no fruit.

52 It brings shame before the world and ruins one’s dharma and good name. Know this, and never do such a thing.”

Advaita's joy —

53 This teaching was meant for everyone, and everyone took it to heart, while Ācārya Gosāñi rejoiced within.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Kamalākānta declared Advaita Ācārya to be "Īśvara" and on that basis begged money from the king. Mahāprabhu was greatly displeased by such an act. Even though the Ācārya is Īśvara, His human pastime as the teacher of the world is well known. To fall into debt and beg money from a king is shameless conduct for an ācārya. Greed for money must be avoided in every way; and if one displays that greed before a foreign king in order to pay off a debt, *dharma* suffers. A king is by nature a worldly man (*viṣayī*). Eating a worldly man's food corrupts the heart; and when the heart is corrupted, one does not remember Kṛṣṇa, and life is wasted. This is forbidden to everyone, and to teachers of religion (*dharmācāryas*) above all. To instruct people in the holy name is the duty of an ācārya. But those who instruct in the name for money are unfit for the title of "instructor in the name"; rather, they are offenders against the name. For such people this is forbidden all the more strictly. If an ācārya who instructs in the name accepts gifts, he brings public shame upon himself and gravely damages his religious reputation.

Mahāprabhu and Advaita Prabhu: each knows the heart of the other —

54 Only the Lord understood the Ācārya's intention, and the Ācārya understood the Lord's deep words.

55 There is much to consider in this episode, but I cannot write of it for fear of making the book too long.

(5) The branch of Yadunandanācārya —

56 Śrī Yadunandana Ācārya is a branch of Advaita; his own branches and offshoots are past all writing.

57 He received the mercy of Vāsudeva Datta and with all his heart took shelter of Śrī Caitanya's feet.

Anubhāṣya.

Yadunandanācārya was the guru who gave Śrī Raghunātha dāsa Gosvāmī Prabhu initiation according to the *Pañcarātra*. See Antya, Chapter 6, 160–169.

Vāsudeva Datta is Madhuvrata, the singer of Vraja (*Gaura-gaṇoddeśa*, verse 140). See Ādi, Chapter 10, 41.

(6) Bhāgavatācārya, (7) Viṣṇudāsa, (8) Cakrapāṇi, (9) Ananta Ācārya —

58 Other branches are Bhāgavata Ācārya, Viṣṇudāsa Ācārya, Cakrapāṇi Ācārya and Ananta Ācārya.

Anubhāṣya.

Bhāgavatācārya was at first among Advaita's associates and later joined Gadādhara's associates. In Yadunandana dāsa's *Śākhā-nirṇayāmṛta*, verse 6: "I praise Bhāgavatācārya, dear to Gaurāṅga, who composed the great book named *Prema-taraṅgiṇī*." According to the *Gaura-gaṇoddeśa* (195 and 202), he is Śveta-mañjarī of Vraja. See Ādi, Chapter 10, 113.

Viṣṇudāsācārya went with Acyutānanda Prabhu to the festival at Khetari (see the *Bhakti-ratnākara*, wave 10).

Ananta Ācārya is "Sudevī," one of the eight *sakhīs* of Vraja. He was among Advaita Prabhu's associates but later joined Gadādhara's branch. *Gaura-gaṇoddeśa*, 165: "Ananta Ācārya Gosvāmī is she who formerly in Vraja was 'Sudevī.'" See Ādi, Chapter 8, 59–60. *Śākhā-nirṇayāmṛta*, verse 11: "I praise him who is called Ananta Ācārya, full of endless wonderful *rasa*, full of endless wonderful pastimes, the vessel of Gaura's love." His disciple was Haridāsa Paṇḍita Gosvāmī, superintendent of the service of Śrī Govinda in Vṛndāvana. Haridāsa's disciple was Śrī Rādhā-Kṛṣṇa Gosvāmī, the author of the book *Sādhana-dīpikā* (*Bhakti-ratnākara*, wave 2).

(10) Nandinī, (11) Kāmadeva, (12) Caitanya dāsa, (13) Durlabha Viśvāsa, (14) Vanamālī dāsa —

59 Then come Nandinī, Kāmadeva, Caitanya dāsa, Durlabha Viśvāsa and Vanamāli dāsa.

Anubhāṣya.

Nandinī. *Gaura-gaṇoddeśa*, 89: "Nandinī and Jaṅgalī are to be known as Jayā and Vijayā respectively." A daughter of Advaita born of Sītā (?).

(15) Jagannātha and (16) Bhavanātha Kara, (17) Hṛdayānanda, (18) Bholānātha —

60 Jagannātha Kara, Bhavanātha Kara, Hṛdayānanda Sena and Bholānātha dāsa.

(19) Yādava, (20) Vijaya, (21) Janārdana, (22) Ananta dāsa, (23) Kānu Paṇḍita, (24) Nārāyaṇa —

61 Yādava dāsa, Vijaya dāsa, Janārdana, Ananta dāsa, Kānu Paṇḍita and Nārāyaṇa dāsa.

(25) Śrīvatsa, (26) Haridāsa Brahmacārī, (27) Puruṣottama and (28) Kṛṣṇadāsa Brahmacārī —

62 Śrīvatsa Paṇḍita, Haridāsa Brahmacārī, Puruṣottama Brahmacārī and Kṛṣṇadāsa.

Anubhāṣya.

Haridāsa Brahmacārī is counted among the associates of both Advaita and Gadādhara. *Śākhā-nirṇayāmṛta*, verse 9: “With devotion I praise the glorious Haridāsa Brahmacārī Mahāśaya, a mass of supreme bliss, a mine of joy.”

(29) Puruṣottama Paṇḍita, (30) Raghunātha, (31) Vanamālī, (32) Vaidyanātha —

63 Puruṣottama Paṇḍita, Raghunātha, Vanamālī Kavicandra and Vaidyanātha.

(33) Lokanātha, (34) Murāri Paṇḍita, (35) Haricaraṇa, (36) Mādhava Paṇḍita —

64 Lokanātha Paṇḍita, Murāri Paṇḍita, Śrī Haricaraṇa and Mādhava Paṇḍita.

(37) Vijaya and (38) Śrīrāma Paṇḍita —

65 Vijaya Paṇḍita and Śrī Rāma Paṇḍita. The branches of Advaita are countless, so how many names can I give?

Anubhāṣya.

Śrīrāma Paṇḍita was the younger brother of Śrīvāsa Paṇḍita. *Gaura-gaṇoddeśa*, 91: "The best of sages named Parvata, who was dear to Nārada, is the glorious Śrīrāma Paṇḍita, his younger brother." See Madhya, Chapter 13, 39.

By the power of Gaura's mercy the servants of Advaita who accept the essence flourish —

66 The water of mercy the gardener gives sustains the Advaita trunk, and by it the branches live and bear flowers and fruit.

Only the unfortunate worthless ones who fancy themselves Advaita's servants oppose Gaura and, deprived of His mercy, perish —

67 But when Caitanya the gardener had concluded His manifest pastimes, some of these branches, to their misfortune, turned their backs on Him.

68 He had brought them forth and kept them alive, yet they would not accept Him. They proved ungrateful, and the trunk grew angry with them.

69 In its anger the trunk let no water pass to them, and for want of water the branches withered, dried up and died.

The devotee of Gaura-Kṛṣṇa is Yama's guru; those who turn away from Gaura-Kṛṣṇa are punished by Yama —

70 A body without consciousness (*caitanya*) is like dry wood. So too, one without Caitanya is dead while still alive, and when he dies, Yama punishes him.[4]

Anubhāṣya.

Yama's words to his messengers (*Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 6.3.29): “Bring to me those wicked people whose tongues do not utter the names and qualities of Bhagavān, whose hearts do not remember His lotus feet, whose heads have never once bowed down to Kṛṣṇa — those who have done nothing for Viṣṇu.”

71 This punishment is not for these alone: whoever turns away from Caitanya is a *pāṣaṇḍa*, a godless man.

72 Scholar or ascetic, householder or sannyāsī — whoever turns away from Caitanya meets this fate.

Only the followers of Acyuta are devotees of Gaura who accept the essence and have received Advaita's mercy —

73 Those followers of the Ācārya who accepted the view of Śrī Acyutānanda are *mahā-bhāgavatas*, great devotees.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Advaita Prabhu is one of the trunks of the wish-fulfilling tree of devotion. Śrī Caitanya, like a gardener, waters that trunk and nourishes both it and its branches. Yet by misfortune some branches, after the gardener's disappearance, refused to acknowledge Him and declared the trunk itself to be the cause of the wish-fulfilling tree. In this way they ungratefully rejected the One who created and sustains the trunk — Advaita's tree — that is, Mahāprabhu. So the trunk no longer passed water to those sinful branches (cf. verse 69), and for want of water the lean branches began to dry up and die. This punishment did not fall on those branches alone. In general, anyone — whether a scholar, an ascetic, a householder or a renunciant (*yati*) — who turns away from Caitanya becomes a *pāṣaṇḍī*, a godless man. And the great souls who accepted the teaching of Śrī Acyutānanda are the *mahā-bhāgavatas* among Śrī Advaitācārya Prabhu's associates.

Thus ends the twelfth chapter of the “Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.”

74 It is they who received the Ācārya’s mercy, and without effort they attained the feet of Caitanya.

Obeisances to all these pure devotees —

75 To those followers of the Ācārya who are like Acyutānanda, whose very life is Caitanya, I offer obeisances millions of times.

76 Thus I have told of the followers of Ācārya Gosāñi, and have briefly counted the branches of the three trunks.[5]

77 The offshoots of these branches are past counting; I have told only a little, to give a glimpse of them.

The disciples, or sub-branches, of Śrī Gadādhara —

78 The offshoots of Śrī Gadādhara Paṇḍita are most excellent, and I shall now name some of them.[6]

(1) Dhruvānanda, (2) Śrīdhara, (3) Haridāsa Brahmacārī and (4) Raghunātha Bhāgavatācārya —

79 The finest of them is Dhruvānanda; after him come Śrīdhara Brahmacārī, Bhāgavatācārya and Haridāsa Brahmacārī.

Anubhāṣya.

Dhruvānanda Brahmacārī. *Gaura-gaṇoddeśa*, 152: “Others have said that Dhruvānanda Brahmacārī is Lalitā. That view is correct when one distinguishes her own manifestations (*svaprakāśa*).” *Śākhā-nirṇayāmṛta*, 4: “I praise Dhruvānanda, who always delights in the *ujjvala-rasa*, to whom Śrī Gadādhara in his mercy gave his own nature.”

Śrīdhara Brahmacārī is Candralatikā of Vraja (*Gaura-gaṇoddeśa*, verses 194 and 199). *Śākhā-nirṇayāmṛta*, 5: “[I praise] Śrī Śrīdhara, called Sudāmā, the wonderful *brahmacārī*, wholly full of the nectar of *prema*, who delights in Gaura's pastimes.”

(5) Anantācārya, (6) Kavidatta, (7) Nayana Miśra, (8) Gaṅgāmantrī, (9) Māmu Ṭhākura, (10) Kaṇṭhābharaṇa —

80 Ananta Ācārya, Kavidatta, Nayana Miśra, Gaṅgāmantrī, Māmu Ṭhākura and Kaṇṭhābharaṇa.

Anubhāṣya.

Kavidatta. *Śākhā-nirṇayāmṛta*, 14: “I praise Kavidatta, in whose heart Rādhā and Kṛṣṇa dwell eternally and by nature, the very wonder of *mahābhāva*.” He is Kalakaṇṭhī of Vraja (*Gaura-gaṇoddeśa*, verses 197 and 207).

Nayana Miśra (*Gaura-gaṇoddeśa*, verses 196 and 207) is Nitya-mañjarī of Vraja. *Śākhā-nirṇayāmṛta*, verse 1: “I praise Śrī Nayanānanda Miśra, an ocean of the nectar of *prema*, the one vessel of the jewel of love of Gadādhara and Gaura.”

Gaṅgāmantrī (*Gaura-gaṇoddeśa*, 196 and 205) is Candrikā of Vraja. *Śākhā-nirṇayāmṛta*, 16: “I glorify Gaṅgāmantrī, who delights in the joy of service, with whom the Gaṅgā herself, the Svardhunī, took counsel in order to reveal love for the holy name.”

Māmu Ṭhākura. Śrī Mahāprabhu used to call him “*māmā*” (maternal uncle), and so people called him “Māmu Ṭhākura”: in East Bengal and in Utkala a maternal uncle is called “*māmu*.” His real name was “Jagannātha Cakravartī.” He was the nephew of Śrī Nīlāmbara Cakravartī, his brother's son, and came from the village of Magaḍobā in Pharidapura district. After Śrī Gadādhara's disappearance, Māmu Ṭhākura became the superintendent of the service of Śrī Ṭoṭā-Gopīnātha in Purī. According to the *Gaura-gaṇoddeśa* (verses 196 and 205), he is Kalabhāṣiṇī of Vraja. *Śākhā-nirṇayāmṛta*, 17: “I praise Māmu Ṭhākura, whom Gauracandra and His associates lovingly addressed in Utkala as ‘*māmu*.’”

The guru line of the servitors of Ṭoṭā-Gopīnātha: (1) Śrī Gadādhara Paṇḍita Gosvāmī (Śrīmatī Rādhikā; by another view, Saubhāgya-mañjarī); (2) his follower Śrī Jagannātha Cakravartī, “Māmu” Gosvāmī (Śrī Rūpa-mañjarī?); (3) his follower Raghunātha Gosvāmī; (4) Rāmacandra; (5) Rādhāvallabha; (6) Kṛṣṇajīvana; (7) Śyāmasundara; (8) Śāntāmaṇi; (9) Harinātha; (10) Navīnacandra; (11) Matilāla; (12) Dayāmayī; (13) Kuñjabihārī.

Kaṇṭhābharaṇa. His name was Śrī Ananta Caṭṭarāja. *Gaura-gaṇoddeśa*, 196 and 206: “Ananta, born in the Caṭṭa family, who bore the title Śrī Kaṇṭhābharaṇa.” He is Gopālī of Vraja. *Śākhā-nirṇayāmṛta*, 18: “I praise Śrī Kaṇṭhābharaṇa, full of

pastimes, the very embodiment of the *rasa* of Rādhā and Kṛṣṇa, [the necklace] descended from Their necks."

(11) Bhūgarbha Gosvāmī, (12) Bhāgavata dāsa —

81 Bhūgarbha Gosāñi and Bhāgavata dāsa both came to Vṛndāvana and made their home there.

Anubhāṣya.

Bhūgarbha Gosāñi is "Prema-mañjarī" of Vraja, the intimate friend of Śrī Lokanātha Gosvāmī, one with him in heart. *Gaura-gaṇoddeśa*, 187: "Bhūgarbha Ṭhākura was formerly named Prema-mañjarī." *Śākhā-nirṇayāmṛta*, 24: "I always praise Bhūgarbha Gosvāmī, renowned, born from the womb of the earth, a great soul, the master who bestows love for Kṛṣṇa; who delights in the joy of serving Śrī Govindadeva, merciful, bestowing *prema*, pure, eternally the embodiment of bliss."

Bhāgavata dāsa. *Śākhā-nirṇayāmṛta*, 31: "I praise Śrī Bhāgavata dāsa, Bhūgarbha's companion, whose mind is always adorned with singing of the pastimes of Rādhā and Kṛṣṇa."

(13) Vāṇīnātha Brahmacārī, (14) Vallabha-caitanya —

82 Vāṇīnātha Brahmacārī was a great soul, and Vallabha-caitanya dāsa was full of love for Kṛṣṇa.

Anubhāṣya.

Vāṇīnātha Brahmacārī. *Śākhā-nirṇayāmṛta*, 32: "I glorify the *brahmacārī* Vāṇīnātha Mahāśaya, renowned for his devotion in the assemblies of devotees[9], shining amid the host of devotees." See Ādi, Chapter 10, 114.

Vallabha-caitanya. *Śākhā-nirṇayāmṛta*, 33: "I praise Vallabha-caitanya, full of love for Kṛṣṇa, pure, the giver of supreme bliss, whose heart is absorbed in singing of the pastimes." In this branch Śrīyuta Nalinīmohana Gosvāmī serves Śrī Madana-Gopāla-deva at Gānatalā in Kuliyā-Navadvīpa.

(15) Śrīnātha, (16) Uddhava, (17) Jitāmitra, (18) Jagannātha —

83 Śrīnātha Cakravartī, Uddhava dāsa, Jitāmitra and Jagannātha dāsa of Kāṣṭhakāṭā.

Anubhāṣya.

Śrīnātha Cakravartī. *Śākhā-nirṇayāmṛta*, 13: “I praise the *paṇḍita* named Śrīnātha, the shelter of good qualities, by whom the service of Kṛṣṇa was performed with great care in all its proper order.”

Uddhava dāsa. *Śākhā-nirṇayāmṛta*, 35: “I praise Śrīmad Uddhava dāsa, rich in virtues, who gives the full wealth of *prema* to the most lowly.”

Jitāmitra. *Gaura-gaṇoddeśa*, 202: “He who conquered and subdued the six enemies headed by lust was given by Gaura a name true to its meaning — Jitāmitra, ‘he who has conquered his foes.’” He is Śyāma-mañjarī of Vraja. *Śākhā-nirṇayāmṛta*, 36: “I praise Jitāmitra, the fulfiller of all desires, whose holy book nourishes love for Kṛṣṇa's sweetness.”

Jagannātha dāsa lived in the village of Kāṣṭhakāṭā (Kāṭhādiyā) in Vikramapura, Ḍhākā. His descendants now live in the village of Āḍiyala, in Kāmārapāḍā and in Pāikapāḍā. The Deity he installed, “Yaśomādhava,” is served by the “*gosvāmīs*” of Āḍiyala. In the *Kṛṣṇa-gaṇoddeśa* Śrī Rūpapāda describes sixty-four *sakhīs* of one assembly; Jagannātha dāsa is the twenty-sixth of them, “Tilakinī,” a junior friend of Citrā-devī. Verse 142: “Rasālikā, Tilakinī, Śaurasenī, Sugandhikā.” His line: (2) Rāmanṛsiṁha, (3) Rāmagopāla, (4) Rāmacandra, (5) Sanātana, (6) Muktārāma, (7) Gopīnātha, (8) Goloka, (9) Harimohana Śiromaṇi, (10) Rākhālarāja. Gopīnātha's younger sons were (8) Mādhava and (9) Lakṣmīkānta.

In the *Bhoga-nirṇaya-paddhati* of Sūryadāsa Sarakhela: “Then those who became *mahāntas* in the groups headed by Sucitrā: Jagannātha dāsa and Ṭhākura Jagadīśa.”[10] *Śākhā-nirṇayāmṛta*, 48: “I praise Jagannātha dāsa, known as ‘Kāṣṭhakāṭā,’ who gave the blessing of Śrī Hari's holy name in Tripura as well.” That is, he preached the holy name in the region of Tripura.

(19) Hari Ācārya, (20) Puriyā-Gopāla, (21) Kṛṣṇadāsa Brahmacārī, (22) Puṣpagopāla —

84 Śrī Hari Ācārya, Puriyā Gopāla dāsa, Kṛṣṇadāsa Brahmacārī and Puṣpagopāla.

Anubhāṣya.

Hari Ācārya (*Gaura-gaṇoddeśa*, 196 and 207) is Kālākṣī of Vraja. *Śākhā-nirṇayāmṛta*, 37: “With supreme devotion I praise Haridāsācārya, a resident of Bengal, made radiant by his own *ujjvala-rasa*.”

Puriyā-Gopāla dāsa. *Śākhā-nirṇayāmṛta*, 38: “I praise him who is called Gopāla dāsa, a resident of Sādipura, who flooded the town of Vikrama[pura] with the *rasa* of love for Rādhā and Kṛṣṇa.” That is, he preached the holy name in Vikramapura.

Kṛṣṇadāsa Brahmacārī is Indulekhā, one of the eight *sakhīs* of Vraja. *Gaura-gaṇoddeśa*, 164: “She who formerly in Vraja was Indulekhā, Śrī Rādhā's friend, is Kṛṣṇadāsa Brahmacārī, who made his home in Vṛndāvana.” *Śākhā-nirṇayāmṛta*, 41: “I praise the *brahmacārī* Kṛṣṇadāsa, who reveals love for Kṛṣṇa, bright of mind, a resident of Vṛndāvana.”

Puṣpagopāla. *Śākhā-nirṇayāmṛta*, 39: “I praise him who is called Puṣpagopāla, who delights in *prema*: by his *rasa* the village of Svarṇagrāma blossomed (*puṣpita*), and hence his name.”

(23) Śrīharṣa, (24) Raghu Miśra, (25) Lakṣmīnātha, (26) Caitanya dāsa, (27) Raghunātha —

85 Śrīharṣa, Raghu Miśra, Lakṣmīnātha Paṇḍita, Caitanya dāsa of Baṅgavāṭī and Śrī Raghunātha.

Anubhāṣya.

Śrīharṣa (*Gaura-gaṇoddeśa*, 194 and 201) is Sukeśinī of Vraja. *Śākhā-nirṇayāmṛta*, 40: “I praise him who is called Śrīharṣa Miśra, who delights in love for Kṛṣṇa, whose heart is intoxicated with love for Gaura, a shoot of the *rasa* of great bliss.”

Raghu Miśra (*Gaura-gaṇoddeśa*, 195 and 201) is Karpūra-mañjarī of Vraja.

Lakṣmīnātha Paṇḍita (*Gaura-gaṇoddeśa*, 196, 205) is Rasonmādā of Vraja. *Śākhā-nirṇayāmṛta*, 42: “I praise Vraja-Lakṣmīnātha dāsa, compassion embodied, filled with *mahābhāva*, the bestower of Vraja's good fortune.”

Baṅgavāṭī-Caitanya dāsa (*Gaura-gaṇoddeśa*, 196 and 206) is Kālī of Vraja. *Śākhā-nirṇayāmṛta*, 43: “I praise Śrī Caitanya dāsa of Baṅgavāṭī, the great soul, whose body is always adorned with tears of love and with hair standing on end.”

The succession of his branch: (2) Mathurāprasāda, (3) Rukmiṇīkānta, (4) Jīvanakṛṣṇa, (5) Yugalakiśora, (6) Ratanakṛṣṇa, (7) Rādhāmādhava, (8) Uṣāmaṇi, (9) Vaikuṇṭhanātha, (10) Lālamohana Śāhā Śaṅkhanidhi (a resident of Ḍhākā).

Raghunātha is Varāṅgadā of Vraja. *Gaura-gaṇoddeśa*, 194 and 200: "Raghunātha, a certain brāhmaṇa, an exclusive servant of Gaurāṅga." *Śākhā-nirṇayāmṛta*, 44: "I praise him who is called Śrī Raghunātha, the great soul, the root of *prema*: simply by hearing his name one obtains the *rasa* of Vṛndāvana."

(28) Amogha, (29) Hastigopāla, (30) Caitanya-vallabha, (31) Yadu, (32) Maṅgala Vaiṣṇava —

86 Amogha Paṇḍita, Hastigopāla, Caitanya-vallabha, Yadu Gāṅguli and Maṅgala Vaiṣṇava.

Anubhāṣya.

Amogha Paṇḍita. *Śākhā-nirṇayāmṛta*, 59: "I praise Amogha Paṇḍita, whom Śrī Gaura made His own, whose body is filled with *prema* and whose voice is choked with it, whose body trembles with hair standing on end."

Hastigopāla is Hariṇī of Vraja (*Gaura-gaṇoddeśa*, 196 and 206). "With supreme devotion I bow to him who is called Hastigopāla dāsa, whose body is intoxicated with *prema*, full of the highest love for Gaura." (*Śākhā-nirṇayāmṛta*, 61)

Caitanya-vallabha. *Śākhā-nirṇayāmṛta*, 60: "I praise him who is called Caitanya-vallabha, the abode of the *rasa* of *prema*, who longs to sing of the qualities of Gadādhara and Gaura."

Yadu Gāṅguli. *Śākhā-nirṇayāmṛta*, 34: "With devotion I praise Yadunātha Cakravartī, called Līlā-bhāgavata, the root of *prema*, a great scholar, a great soul." A descendant of this branch is Śrī Nalinākṣa Ṭhākura, a resident of Pāligrāma-Cāṇaka in Barddhamāna district.

Maṅgala Vaiṣṇava. *Śākhā-nirṇayāmṛta*, 47: "I praise Maṅgala Vaiṣṇava, pure in heart and body, whose body is moistened by the nectar of the pastimes of the Lords of Vṛndāvana." He lived in the village of Ṭiṭakaṇā in Murśidābāda. His father's family were servitors of the goddess Kirīṭeśvarī in Murśidābāda. According to tradition, he first took the great vow (*bṛhad-vrata*) and left home, and later, in Mayanāḍāla, married the daughter of his disciple Prāṇanātha Adhikārī. His descendants are now known as "the Ṭhākuras of Kāṅdaḍā." Kāṅdaḍā is a village

near Kāṭoyā in Barddhamāna district. Not long ago thirty-six households of Maṅgala Ṭhākura's line lived there.

Among Ṭhākura Mahāśaya's well-known disciples, Prāṇanātha Adhikārī of Mayanāḍāla, Puruṣottama Cakravartī of Kāṅdaḍā and Nṛsiṁhaprasāda Mitra Ṭhākura of Mayanāḍāla deserve mention. The Adhikārī line of Mayanāḍāla has died out, but descendants through their daughters remain. Of Puruṣottama Cakravartī's line, Śrī Kuñjabihārī Cakravartī and Rādhāvallabha Cakravartī now live in the village of Āṅgaḍā under Sākuleśvara in Bīrabhūma. They sing the *Śrī Caitanya-maṅgala*. In the line of Nṛsiṁhaprasāda Mitra Ṭhākura, Sudhākṛṣṇa Mitra Ṭhākura and Nikuñjabihārī Mitra Ṭhākura are well known; they are masters of the art of the *mṛdaṅga*.

Maṅgala Ṭhākura Mahāśaya obtained the pair of Deities "Śrī Rādhāvallabha" when the king of Gauḍa was building a road from Gauḍa to Kṣetra and digging a pond. At that time he lived in the village of Rāṇīpura, west of Kāṅdaḍā. The Śrī Nṛsiṁha-śilā that Ṭhākura Mahāśaya worshipped is still at Kāṅdaḍā. When the property granted by the king of Gauḍa for the service of the Deities was lost, Maṅgala Ṭhākura maintained the service by begging.

Maṅgala Ṭhākura had three sons: (1) Rādhikāprasāda, (2) Gopīramaṇa, (3) Śyāmakiśora. The lines of these three brothers still exist. Later the service of Śrī Vṛndāvanacandra was established at Kāṅdaḍā.

(33) Śivānanda Cakravartī —

87 Among the branches Śivānanda Cakravartī stood out in his ardour; his heart found its rest at the feet of Madana-gopāla.

Anubhāṣya.

Śivānanda Cakravartī. *Gaura-gaṇoddeśa*, verse 183: "Śivānanda Cakravartī, who made his home in Vṛndāvana, is known as a manifestation of Śrīmatī Lavaṅga-mañjarī." *Śākhā-nirṇayāmṛta*, 10: "I praise Śivānanda, who is called Kumudānanda, endowed with *ujjvala-rasa*, pure, a resident of Vṛndāvana." See Ādi, Chapter 8, 70.

Besides these, Śrī Yadunandana dāsa in his *Śākhā-nirṇaya* mentions several more members of Gadādhara's branch: 1. Mādhavācārya; 2. Gopāla dāsa; 3. Hṛdayānanda; 4. Vallabha Bhaṭṭa (after whose name the "Vallabha," or "Puṣṭi-mārgīya," *sampradāya* is known); 5. Madhu Paṇḍita (his *śrīpāṭa* is in the

village of Sāiṁbonā, two miles east of Khaḍadaha; it was he who installed and served the famous Deity of Gopīnāthadeva in Vṛndāvana); 6. Acyutānanda; 7. Candraśekhara; 8. Vakreśvara Paṇḍita (?); 9. Dāmodara; 10. Bhagavān Ācārya (another); 11. Anantācārya-varya (another); 12. Kṛṣṇadāsa; 13. Paramānanda Bhaṭṭācārya; 14. Bhavānanda Gosvāmī; 15. Caitanya dāsa; 16. Lokanātha Bhaṭṭa (the guru of Śrī Ṭhākura Narottama, a native of Tālakhaḍi in Yaśohara district, who installed Śrī Rādhā-vinoda in Vṛndāvana, a close friend of Bhūgarbha Ṭhākura) (?); 17. Govindācārya; 18. Akrūra Ṭhākura; 19. Saṅketācārya; 20. Pratāpāditya; 21. Kamalākānta Ācārya; 22. Yādavācārya; 23. Nārāyaṇa Paḍihārī (a resident of Kṣetra).

88 Thus I have briefly told of the Paṇḍita's followers; in the same way one could count many other branches and offshoots.

The exclusive devotion to Gaura of Gadādhara's associates —

89 All the Paṇḍita's followers are blessed devotees, and Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya is the beloved of their lives.

The glory of remembering the associates of Nitāi, Advaita and Gadādhara —

90 I have now counted the branches of these three trunks. Whoever remembers them is freed from the bondage of worldly existence.

91 By remembering them one attains the feet of Śrī Caitanya; by remembering them every desire is fulfilled.

92 Therefore I bow down at the feet of them all, and now I shall tell, in due order, the pastimes of Caitanya the gardener.

The author's humble words —

93 The nectar ocean of Gaura's pastimes is shoreless and fathomless. Who could even dream of plunging into it?

Anubhāṣya.

Thus ends the twelfth chapter of the "Anubhāṣya."

94 Yet the fragrance of its sweetness entices my heart, and so, standing on the shore, I taste a single drop.

95 Praying at the feet of Śrī Rūpa and Śrī Raghunātha, I, Kṛṣṇadāsa, narrate the *Caitanya-caritāmṛta*.

Notes

1. In the edition the branches of Śrī Advaita are listed under numbered headings: (1) Acyutānanda, (2) Kṛṣṇa Miśra, (3) Gopāla, (4) Kamalākānta Viśvāsa, (5) Yadunandana Ācārya, (6)–(38) in 12.58–65; the offshoots of Gadādhara Paṇḍita are numbered (1)–(33), 12.79–87. ↩
2. The edition's *Kathāsāra*: this was in Gopāla's youth, at the cleansing of the Guṇḍicā temple. ↩
3. The two Gosāñis are Mahāprabhu and Advaita. ↩
4. A play on words: *caitanya-rahita* means both "without consciousness" and "without Caitanya". ↩
5. The three trunks are the main trunk, Śrī Caitanya Himself (Ādi 9.12; Ādi 10), and the trunks of Śrī Nityānanda (Ādi 11) and Śrī Advaita; the followers of Gadādhara Paṇḍita the author goes on to call offshoots (12.78). ↩
6. Gadādhara Paṇḍita himself is a great branch of the main trunk (Ādi 10.15). Other editions read here *paṇḍita śākhāte mahottama*, "Paṇḍita is the most excellent among the branches". ↩
7. The verse translation reads differently: "the Ācārya truly is God." ↩
8. The edition reads "Ādi, Chapter 13, 452"; the verse quoted is Madhya 13.45. ↩
9. Unclear wording in the quotation: *bhakta-saṁghaṭṭa-bhakty-ākhyam*; the translation is tentative. ↩
10. Unclear quotation: the line is grammatically disconnected; the translation is tentative. ↩

“Śrī Caitanya-caritāmṛta”

Ādi-līlā

Chapter 13

The Description of the Great Festival of the Lord’s Appearance

(English translation from the Bengali, following the Gauḍīya Maṭha edition and the «Anubhāṣya», 2026 — draft)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya

Summary. This thirteenth chapter describes Mahāprabhu's birth. The Ādi-līlā is the Lord's pastimes in household life, and the Antya-līlā His pastimes in *sannyāsa*. The first six years of the Antya-līlā are called the “Madhya-līlā”: the journeys to the south, to Vṛndāvana and to other holy places, the returns, and the preaching of the holy name. Jagannātha Miśra was the son of Upendra Miśra, a resident of Śrīhaṭṭa. He settled in Navadvīpa and married Śacīdevī, the daughter of Nīlāmbara Cakravartī. First eight daughters were born to him. These daughters, once born, left this world, and then, as the ninth child, Viśvarūpa was born. In Śaka 1407, on the evening of the full moon of the month of Phālguna, with Leo rising (*siṁha-lagna*) and the moon in the sign of Leo (*siṁha-rāśi*), at the time of a lunar eclipse, Gauracandra descended amid the chanting of Kṛṣṇa's names. Hearing of the child's birth, the respectable ladies came to see Him with many gifts. Nīlāmbara Cakravartī cast His horoscope, examined the lines of His hand, and found in them the marks of a great personality (*mahāpuruṣa*).

By Gaura's grace even a fallen soul becomes able to describe His pastimes —

1 May Śrī Caitanyadeva be gracious to me, for by His grace even one as fallen as I at once becomes fit to describe His pastimes.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

By His grace even this fallen soul at once becomes able to describe His pastimes. May that Śrī Caitanyadeva be pleased with me.

Anubhāṣya.
yasya (of Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanyadeva) **prasādataḥ** (by the compassion) **ayam** (one like me) **adhamaḥ api tal-līlā-varṇane sadyaḥ yogyaḥ syāt**, **sa caitanya-devaḥ prasīdatu**.

2 Glory, glory to Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya Gauracandra! Glory to Advaitacandra, and glory, glory to Nityānanda!

3 Glory, glory to Gadādhara, and glory to Śrīvāsa! Glory to Mukunda and Vāsudeva, and glory to Haridāsa!

4 Glory to Svarūpa Dāmodara, and glory to Murāri Gupta! These moons have risen and driven all darkness away.

*With the rays of their service to Hari, the moonlike devotees destroy the darkness of the *jīvas'* ignorance —*

5 Glory to the devotees of Śrī Caitanyacandra, who are full moons! The moonlight of their love makes the three worlds shine.

The beginning of the description of Gaura's pastimes —

6 Thus I have given the preface at the beginning of the book. Now I shall tell the pastimes of Śrī Caitanya in their proper order.

*The promise to describe first in brief, as *sūtras*, and later in detail —*

7 First I shall list them briefly, as in sūtras; afterwards I shall describe them in detail.

The 48 years of Mahāprabhu's manifest pastimes —

8 Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya descended in Navadvīpa, and for forty-eight years He enjoyed His pastimes before the eyes of the world.

9 His appearance is recorded in Śaka 1407 (1486), and He disappeared from the world in Śaka 1455 (1533).

*The first 24 years, His household pastimes in Navadvīpa; the last 24 years, His enactment of *sannyāsa* in Nīlācala —*

10 For twenty-four years the Lord lived as a householder, and all that time He delighted in kīrtana.

11 At the end of His twenty-fourth year He accepted sannyāsa, and for another twenty-four years He lived in Nīlācala.

Six of the last 24 years: searching for Kṛṣṇa and preaching in North and South India —

12 Six of those years He spent journeying — now to the south, now to Gauḍa, now to Vṛndāvana.

13 For eighteen years He stayed in Nīlācala, flooding everyone with the nectar of His pastimes of love for Kṛṣṇa.

*The household pastimes are the Ādi-līlā, and the *sannyāsa* pastimes the Madhya- and Antya-līlā —*

14 The Lord's pastimes as a householder are called the Ādi-līlā, and His later pastimes bear two names, Madhya and Antya.

*Murāri compiled the Ādi-līlā in the *Caitanya-carita*, and Svarūpa the last pastimes in the *Kaḍacā* —*

15 Murāri Gupta recorded in sūtras all the Lord's deeds in the Ādi-līlā.

16 Svarūpa Dāmodara set down the Lord's later pastimes in brief notes and gathered them in his book.

*The *sūtras* of these two are the source of every description of the Lord's pastimes —*

17 Reading and hearing the notes of these two, the Vaiṣṇavas describe the Lord’s pastimes in their order.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Śrī Murāri Gupta's *sūtras*, his brief notes, on the Ādi-līlā still exist. The Vaiṣṇavas study them, and they hear the *sūtras* of Śrī Svarūpa Gosvāmī's diary from the lips of Śrī Raghunātha dāsa Gosvāmī — and so they describe the Lord's pastimes.

The four parts of the Ādi-līlā —

18 Childhood (*bālya*), boyhood (*paugaṇḍa*), early youth (*kaiśora*) and youth (*yauvana*) — these are the four ages, and so the Ādi-līlā falls into four divisions.

Homage to the auspicious full moon of Phālguna —

19 I bow to that full moon of Phālguna, rich in every good quality, on which Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya descended together with the names of Kṛṣṇa.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

“In the twenty-eighth *yuga* of Vaivasvata Manu, in the year fourteen hundred and seven, on the lovely bank of the Bhāgīrathī, from the great ocean of Śacī's womb, on the full moon seized by Rāhu, Gaurāṅga appeared.”

I worship that full moon of Phālguna, filled with every good quality, on which Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya descended together with the names of Kṛṣṇa.

Anubhāṣya.

yasyāṁ (on which, on the full moon of Phālguna) **kṛṣṇa-nāmabhiḥ** (together with the names of Kṛṣṇa) **śrī-kṛṣṇa-caitanyaḥ** (the form not different from Rādhā and Kṛṣṇa, the original source of the avatāras, the Lord of Goloka — from His own realm, from the chamber of Gaura, into the manifest world, into the earthly Navadvīpa) **'vatīrṇaḥ** (descended), **tāṁ sarva-sad-guṇa-pūrṇāṁ phālguna-pūrṇimām** (the goddess in the form of a lunar day [*tithi*], descended into worldly time, beyond this world, devoted to service) (I) **vande** (worship).

*Using the lunar eclipse as a pretext, the Lord moves the *jīvas* to chant Hari's name —*

20 The Lord appeared on the evening of the Phālguna full moon, and at that very hour, as providence would have it, the moon was eclipsed.

21 The people were joyfully calling out, “Hari! Hari!” — and Caitanya Prabhu took birth, having first brought the Name to birth.

Throughout the Ādi-līlā the Lord moves everyone to chant Hari's name —

22 At His birth, in childhood, boyhood, early youth and youth, the Lord found one pretext or another to make people take the name of Hari.

To make everyone chant the name He cries, and the name alone stops Him —

23 In the guise of an ordinary infant the Lord would cry, but the moment He heard the names “Kṛṣṇa” and “Hari”, He would fall silent.

Everyone who comes to see Him utters the name —

24 So all the women among His friends and kin who came to see Him would chant, “Hari! Hari!”

The first appearance of the name “Gaurahari” —

25 Laughing, the women all called Him “Gaurahari”, and so Gaurahari became His name.

*As He grows, He moves the *jīvas* to chant the name at all times —*

26 His childhood lasted until the chalk was put in His hand for His first lesson; His boyhood, until He married.

27 With His marriage began the bloom of youth, and everywhere the Lord led people to chant the name together.

In His boyhood, studying and teaching, He explains Kṛṣṇa's name in every subject and moves others to chant it —

28 In His boyhood He studied and also taught pupils, and everywhere He explained the name of Kṛṣṇa.

29 He showed that the purport of every sūtra, gloss and commentary was the name of Kṛṣṇa, and His pupils came to see it plainly — a wonder to all.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

While explaining to His students the *sūtras* of grammar and their commentaries, the *vṛtti* and the *ṭīkā*, the Lord taught them the meaning of Kṛṣṇa's name. Building on that teaching, the venerable Gosvāmīs (Śrī Jīva Prabhu) later wrote two grammars called *Harināmāmṛta-vyākaraṇa*, the "Laghu" (short) and the "Bṛhat" (long). Whoever studies these two grammars gains a knowledge of words, and devotion to Kṛṣṇa awakens in him.

Anubhāṣya.

The *Caitanya-bhāgavata* (Madhya-khaṇḍa, Chapter 1) says: "Absorbed, the Lord explains: in every *sūtra*, *vṛtti* and *ṭīkā* there is only the name of Hari. The Lord says, 'At all times Kṛṣṇa's name is true. All the scriptures speak of Kṛṣṇa and nothing else. Whoever leaves Kṛṣṇa's feet and explains anything else wastes his life in unspeakable talk. Whoever explains the scriptures while giving up the worship of Kṛṣṇa is low and will never know their inner meaning. Not knowing the inner meaning of the scriptures, he takes up teaching them — and, like an ass, he only carries the scriptures about until he dies.'"

He moves everyone without exception to chant Kṛṣṇa's name —

30 Whomever He met He would tell, "Chant the name of Kṛṣṇa!" — and He flooded the town of Navadvīpa with Kṛṣṇa's name.

*In His youth He Himself performs *kīrtana* and so moves everyone to the name —*

31 In His early youth He began the saṅkīrtana, dancing in love night and day together with His devotees.

32 He wandered from town to town singing kīrtana, and flooded the three worlds with loving devotion.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Śrī Navadvīpa-dhāma is encircled by the Jāhnavī (the Gaṅgā) and lies within a circumference of sixteen *krośas*. Nine islands (*dvīpas*) shine within it, the seats of the nine kinds of *bhakti*: Antaḥ, Sīmanta, Godruma, Madhya, Kola, Ṛtu, Jahnu, Modadruma and Rudra. In the middle of Antardvīpa, in the village of Śrī Māyāpura, stands the home of Śrī Jagannātha Miśra. Going with *kīrtana* through all these towns, the Lord flooded the three worlds with *prema-bhakti*.

*For all 24 years in Navadvīpa He moves the *jīvas* to the name —*

33 Thus for twenty-four years in Navadvīpa He led everyone to the name of Kṛṣṇa and to love for Him.

*Six of the last 24 years, spent in Nīlācala: preaching the name and *prema* from the ocean to the Himālayas —*

34 After accepting sannyāsa He remained twenty-four years more, living with His devotees in Nīlācala.

35 Of those years in Nīlācala, He spent six in ceaseless dancing and singing, giving away loving devotion.

36 He journeyed as far as Setubandha in the south, through Gauḍa and on to Vṛndāvana, spreading the holy name and love wherever He went.

These six years are the Madhya-līlā, and it is entirely the preaching of the name —

37 These six years are called the Madhya-līlā, the very heart of His pastimes; the last eighteen years are called the Antya-līlā.

*Of the remaining 18 years, six: preaching *prema* by *kīrtana* and dance*

alone —

38 For six of those years, in the joy of dancing and singing with His devotees, He led people to loving devotion.

*The last 12 years: in separation from Kṛṣṇa He Himself tastes love for Kṛṣṇa at every moment and displays the states of *prema* —*

39 The last twelve years He stayed in Nīlācala, and, tasting love Himself, He taught everyone its highest states.

Anubhāṣya.

One in whom *prema* has awakened abides in the transcendental *vipralambha-rasa*, the *rasa* of separation, which nourishes *sambhoga*, union. Śrī Gaurasundara wished to taste this state of *prema* Himself, and in this way He taught it to the *jīvas* of the world. Unless *vipralambha* arises, *sambhoga* is not nourished.

40 Night and day the pain of separation from Kṛṣṇa welled up in Him; He behaved like one mad and spoke in broken, raving words.

*Like Śrī Rādhā on seeing Uddhava, the Lord is in *mahābhāva* —*

41 Just as Śrī Rādhā raved on seeing Uddhava, so He raved in His madness night and day.

Anubhāṣya.

Śrī Gaurasundara is the living ideal of the long, long *vipralambha-rasa*: He is filled with the mood of *citra-jalpa*, "varied talk," that seized Śrīmatī Vṛṣabhānujā (Rādhā) when She saw Uddhava. With envy (*asūyā*), jealousy (*īrṣyā*) and pride (*mada*), in a manner of open disdain, Rādhikā set out to declare Kṛṣṇa's want of courtesy (*akauśala*) and, addressing the bumblebee, spoke *prajalpa*, words full of reproach. Śrī Gaurasundara was immersed in all those moods (see Ādi 4.107–108).

*With Svarūpa and Rāya He relishes Caṇḍīdāsa, Vidyāpati and the *Gīta-*

govinda —

42 With Rāmānanda and Svarūpa He relished the songs of Vidyāpati, Jayadeva and Caṇḍīdāsa.

Anubhāṣya.

Vidyāpati was a Vaiṣṇava poet who lived in Mithilā. He flourished during the reign of King Śivasiṁha and Queen Lachimādevī; that is, he composed his songs in the first quarter of the fourteenth century of the Śaka era. He appeared about a hundred years before Śrī Mahāprabhu's manifest pastimes. He was a Maithila *brāhmaṇa*, and his descendant in the twelfth generation is alive today. His songs about Kṛṣṇa abound in examples of transcendental *vipralambha-rasa*. Those moods were what Śrī Mahāprabhu relished.

Jayadeva was born, during the reign of Lakṣmaṇasena, the king of Bengal, to Bhojadeva and Vāmādevī. That period, according to some, is the eleventh or the twelfth century of the Śaka era. He lived for a long time in the city of Navadvīpa, the capital of Bengal. Jayadeva's birthplace is the village of Kenduvilva in the district of Birbhum; according to others, Utkala (Orissa); according to still others, the South. He spent the last part of his life at Śrī Jagannātha-kṣetra. His book of poetry is called the *Gīta-govinda*, or *Aṣṭapadī*. It too abounds in transcendental *vipralambha-rasa*. It describes the *vipralambha-rasa* that nourishes the *rasa* of *sambhoga* — the separation that arose when the prince of Vraja left the place of the *rāsa* dance, as the *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* tells. For the commentaries on the *Aṣṭapadī* and the names of the commentators, see the *Vaiṣṇava-mañjuṣā* (issue 1).

Caṇḍīdāsa was born in a *brāhmaṇa* family in the village of Nānnura in the district of Birbhum, at the close of the first quarter of the fourteenth century of the Śaka era. He was probably a friend of Vidyāpati Ṭhākura. His writings abound in transcendental *vipralambha-rasa*.

The moods that blossomed in Caṇḍīdāsa and other devotees were Śrī Mahāprabhu's most beloved delicacy. Steeped in the mood of Śrī Rādhā, Kṛṣṇacandra tasted *vipralambha-rasa* with His two intimate devotees, Śrī Dāmodara Svarūpa and Śrī Rāmānanda Rāya, and so fulfilled His own desire.

Svayaṁ Bhagavān Śrī Gaurasundara, together with unequalled knowers of the truth of spiritual *kṛṣṇa-rasa* — Śrī Dāmodara Svarūpa, the crest jewel of the *paramahaṁsas*, and Śrī Rāya Rāmānanda — relished the transcendental songs

composed by these three devotees. These songs unfold the countless varieties of the *mahābhāva* of Śrī Rādhikā, “full of Kṛṣṇa” (*kṛṣṇamayī*), toward Śrī Nandanandana, the unequalled Enjoyer, whose form is eternity, knowledge and bliss. Only the most fortunate person can always follow them: one who is indifferent both to enjoyment and to renunciation in this perishable gross and subtle world, who is supremely liberated and owns nothing (*niṣkiñcana*), and who eternally longs to serve Śrī Rādhā. People who delight in mundane poetic *rasa*, who love godless literature, who take pleasure in the body — for the sake of research — and the *prākṛta-sahajiyā* sect — to gratify their material senses, fancying themselves *rāgānuga* — show the impudence of discussing the songs of Caṇḍīdāsa, Vidyāpati and Jayadeva. As a result, licentiousness and atheism grow in the world, and this leads them to hell. Unqualified people, who take the body for the self, are full of thirst for what is unworthy and burdened with *anarthas*, may take the supramundane pastimes of Śrī Rādhā and Kṛṣṇa, worshipped by the supremely liberated, to be the tasteless, vile amorous sports of a mundane hero and heroine, or something like them — and end up gratifying their senses. Therefore any kind of discussion of the pastimes of Rādhā and Kṛṣṇa is strictly forbidden to them.

By tasting the love for Kṛṣṇa that arises from Śrī Rādhā's actions in separation from Kṛṣṇa, He fulfills His three desires —

43 Tasting all the ways of love in separation from Kṛṣṇa, He fulfilled His own desire.

44 Śrī Caitanya’s pastimes are endless. How could a tiny soul tell them in full?

Even Anantadeva Himself cannot reach the end of Gaura's pastimes —

45 Even if Ananta Himself were to count them in brief, with all His thousand mouths He would never reach the end.

*Murāri and Śrī Svarūpa compiled the Ādi-līlā and the last pastimes in *sūtras* of their own —*

46 Svarūpa Dāmodara and Murāri Gupta weighed them carefully and wrote down the chief pastimes in brief.

*Relying on those *sūtras*, Ṭhākura Vṛndāvana dāsa describes Gaura's pastimes —*

47 Following them, I write these pastimes in brief, and Vṛndāvana dāsa has described them in detail.

The sweetness of Vṛndāvana dāsa's work —

48 Vṛndāvana dāsa is the Vyāsa of Śrī Caitanya's pastimes, and he set them down with great sweetness.

The author promises to describe what Vṛndāvana dāsa left out —

49 Fearing that his book would grow too long, he left out certain parts, and of these I shall say something.

The author honors Ṭhākura Vṛndāvana —

50 He has tasted the nectar of the Lord's pastimes; I only savour a few morsels of what he has left.

*The *sūtras* of the Ādi-līlā begin —*

51 Listen, O devotees: I write the Ādi-līlā in brief, for it cannot be written in full.

To fulfill three desires, Kṛṣṇa descends in the form of Gaura —

52 To fulfil a certain desire, the son of the king of Vraja resolved in His mind to descend.

The descent of Kṛṣṇa's elders —

53 First He sent down His elders and kin. I shall name them in brief, for they cannot all be told in full.

The names of the elders —

54–55 Śrī Śacī and Jagannātha, Śrī Mādhava Purī, Keśava Bhāratī and Śrī Īśvara Purī, Advaita Ācārya and Śrīvāsa Paṇḍita, Ācāryaratna, Vidyānidhi and Ṭhākura Haridāsa.

56 In Śrīhaṭṭa lived Śrī Upendra Miśra — a Vaiṣṇava, learned and wealthy, and rich in every virtue.

Anubhāṣya.

Upendra Miśra. The *Gaura-gaṇoddeśa* (verse 35) says: "The cowherd named Parjanya, Kṛṣṇa's grandfather, was born in Śrīhaṭṭa as Upendra Miśra, the father of seven sons." He lived in the village of Ḍhākā-dakṣiṇa in the district of Śrīhaṭṭa. Even today several people, headed by Śrī Indrakumāra Miśra, live there and introduce themselves as his descendants.

The seven sons of Upendra Miśra —

57–58 His seven sons, the seven Miśras, were like seven great sages: Kaṁsāri, Paramānanda, Padmanābha, Sarveśvara, Jagannātha, Janārdana and Trailokyanātha. Jagannātha made his home by the Gaṅgā in Nadīyā.

Who Jagannātha was in Kṛṣṇa's avatāra —

59 Jagannātha, the best of the Miśras, bore the title Purandara. This ocean of virtues had once been Nanda and Vasudeva.

Śacī and Nīlāmbara Cakravartī —

60 His wife, named Śacī, was chaste and wholly devoted to her husband; her father was Nīlāmbara Cakravartī.

Anubhāṣya.

Nīlāmbara Cakravartī. The *Gaura-gaṇoddeśa* (verse 104) says: “Nīlāmbara Cakravartī foretold Gaura's future birth in an assembly, and so he is called ‘Garga.’ As the father of Śrī Śacī he is considered the cowherd Sumukha.” His kinsmen live in the village of Magaḍobā in the district of Faridpur. His nephew Jagannātha Cakravartī, or “Māmu Ṭhākura,” a disciple of Paṇḍita Gosvāmī, was the servant of Ṭoṭā-Gopīnātha at Śrī Kṣetra. The *Prema-vilāsa* records that Nīlāmbara's home in Navadvīpa was in Belpukuriyā. On the other hand, he also had a home in Kāzīpāḍā, and so, by village kinship, the Kazi too is spoken of as the Lord's maternal uncle. The Kazi's house, together with his tomb, could not have moved; hence it is known that all those places of the Belpukuriyā quarter mentioned above have become part of the present-day quarter called Bāmanpukur.

Śrī Nityānanda, Gaṅgādāsa, Murāri, Mukunda —

61 In the land of Rāḍha were born Ṭhākura Nityānanda, Gaṅgādāsa Paṇḍita, Murāri Gupta and Mukunda.

Anubhāṣya.

In Rāḍha-deśa: in the village of Ekacakrā in the district of Birbhum. It lies about eight miles east of Mallārpur station on the loop line of the East Indian Railway. From north to south the village of Ekacakrā stretches four *krośas*. Vīracandrapura, or Vīrabhadrapura, lies within the bounds of Ekacakrā. The place got the name Vīracandrapura, or Vīrabhadrapura, from the name of Vīrabhadra Prabhu.

Last year, 1331, in the month of Āṣāḍha, lightning struck the temple and broke its spire, and the temple itself has become badly dilapidated. Never before had such a calamity befallen the temple.

In the temple stands the Deity of Kṛṣṇa installed by Śrīman Nityānanda Prabhu, named “Śrī Baṅkima Rāya,” or “Bāṅkā Rāya.” To the right of Śrī Baṅkima Rāya stands Jāhnavā, and to the left Śrīmatī Rādhikā. The temple servants say that Śrīman Nityānanda Prabhu entered into Śrī Baṅkima Rāya, and that is why Jāhnavā-mātā was later installed on His right. Later still, other Deities were installed in the temple. On another throne in the temple are the Deities “Muralīdhara” and “Rādhā-Mādhava.” And on a third, separate throne, Śrī Manomohana, Śrī Vṛndāvanacandra and Śrī Nitāi-Gaura, brought to Ekacakrā from the *gādi* (seat) of Vipraghāṭī in the district of Murshidabad, have been served for a year now. Only Śrī Baṅkima Rāya is said to be the ancient Deity installed by

Nityānanda Prabhu. Legend has it that the Deity of Śrī Baṅkima Rāya was floating in the waters of the Yamunā at Kadambakhaṇḍī Ghāṭ, east of the temple. Śrīman Nityānanda Prabhu lifted the Deity out of the water and installed Him for service. And Śrīmatī appeared under a *nimba* tree at a place called Bhaḍḍāpura, about half a mile west of Vīracandrapura. That is why many people used to call Baṅkima Rāya's Śrīmatī "the Ṭhākurāṇī of Bhaḍḍāpura." On yet another throne in the temple, to the right of Bāṅkā Rāya, stands "Yogamāyā." The temple and the *jagamohana* stand on a high brick plinth. Directly in front is a modest *nāṭa-mandira*. It is said that in the northern part of Śrī Bāṅkā Rāya's temple there was a Śiva named "Bhāṇḍīśvara," and Hāḍāi Paṇḍita worshipped that Śiva, the king of Vaiṣṇavas. That Śiva-*liṅga* has now disappeared, and in its place a Deity of Śrī Jagannātha is installed.

Śrīman Nityānanda Prabhu built no temples or other buildings. When the temple from Vīrabhadra Prabhu's time collapsed in 1298, a *brahmacārī* named Śivānanda Svāmī restored it. Seventeen seers and ten *chaṭāks* of rice are allotted every day for the Deity's offering (*bhoga*).

The servitors, the "Gosvāmīs," are a branch of the family of Śrī Gopījana-vallabhānanda, a descendant of Nityānanda. An estate (*zamindari*) is settled in the Gosvāmīs' name for the service, and the service is maintained from its income. The "Gosvāmīs" are three shareholders, and they serve by turns. Śrīyukta Goṣṭhavihārī "Gosvāmī" holds a share of eight annas eight *gaṇḍās* in the estate; Śrīyukta Vijayacandra "Gosvāmī" and others, five annas fourteen *gaṇḍās*; and Śrīyukta Prasanna Kumāra Bandyopādhyāya (a daughter's son of the "Gosvāmīs"), one anna eighteen *gaṇḍās*[2].

Not far from the temple is a place called Viśrāmatalā. Legend has it that here, in His childhood, Śrī Nityānanda Prabhu acted out various pastimes of Vraja and the *rāsa* dance with His friends.

At a place called Āmlītalā stands a spreading tamarind tree. The Neḍās and similar sects have invented many fanciful stories about this place. Legend has it that a pond called "Śvetagaṅgā" was dug by Vīrabhadra Prabhu's twelve hundred Neḍās. A little farther on are the memorial pillars over the Gosvāmīs' tombs. Crossing the Yamunā, which flows north from Mauḍeśvara to the river Dvārakeśvara, one comes within half a mile to the temple at Śrī Nityānanda Prabhu's birthplace (*sūtikā-mandira*). In front of it stood an old *nāṭa-mandira*; it is now in ruins and covered by a spreading banyan. Later a temple was built in that courtyard, and

the Deities of Śrī Gaura and Nityānanda reside in it. A stone tablet in the *jagamohana* records that this temple was restored in the month of Vaiśākha, 1323, in memory of the late Prasannakumāra, the steward (*kārpharmā*).

The place where the *sūtikā-mandira* stands is called “Garbhavāsa.” About 43 *bighās* of land are set aside for the service; of these, 20 *bighās* are tax-free — this is land of the Mahārāja of Dinajpur. Near Garbhavāsa stood the school (*ṭol*) of Hāḍāi Paṇḍita.

The servitors of this place: (1) Śrī Rāghavacandra Gosvāmī (in Vraja, Campakalatā, *Gaura-gaṇoddeśa* 162; he lived at Govardhana; the day of his departure, the thirteenth lunar day of the bright fortnight of Jyaiṣṭha); (2) Jagadānanda dāsa (day of departure, Rādhāṣṭamī); (3) Kṛṣṇadāsa (of Ciḍiyā-kuñja; day of departure, Kṛṣṇa-janmāṣṭamī); (4) Nityānanda dāsa; (5) Rāmadāsa; (6) Vrajamohana dāsa; (7) Kānāi dāsa; (8) Gauradāsa; (9) Śivānanda dāsa; (10) Haridāsa (the present servitor).

Not far from Garbhavāsa, the *sūtikā-mandira*, is Bakulatalā. Here Śrī Nityānanda Prabhu played the game of *jhāl-jhapeṭā* with His friends. This *bakula* tree is a great wonder: its branches and twigs look exactly like snakes, with heads and hoods. Probably they appear this way by the will of Anantadeva Himself, Śrī Nityānanda. The tree itself is very old. It is said that two of its branches once grew apart. Nityānanda Prabhu saw that during play His friends found it hard to cross from one branch to the other, and He joined the two branches.

Hāṅṭugāḍā. Tradition says that Śrī Nityānanda Prabhu gathered all the holy places (*tīrthas*) at this spot. To this day the residents of this *dhāma* do not go to the Gaṅgā or other *tīrthas*, but bathe at this *tīrtha*. Śrīman Nityānanda Prabhu held a festival of *dadhi-ciḍā*, yogurt with flat rice, here. Legend has it that He sat here on His knees eating *dadhi-ciḍā*, and the spot sank into a hollow; that is why it is called “Hāṅṭugāḍā” (“knees sunk in”). This pond (*kuṇḍa*) holds water all year round.

In the month of Kārttika, at the time of the Goṣṭha festival, a large fair takes place here. A huge fair is also held at Vīracandrapura for the festival of Śrī Nityānanda Prabhu's birth, on the thirteenth lunar day of the bright fortnight of Māgha. The *Gaura-gaṇoddeśa* (verse 11) says: “Nityānanda, who in Vraja is Śrī Halāyudha, in the form of a devotee”; and (verses 58–59): “Baladeva is Viśvarūpa, considered the *vyūha* Saṅkarṣaṇa. And Nityānanda Avadhūta is also called He, by way of *prakāśa* (manifestation).” He is the Balarāma of Vraja.

Last of all, Kṛṣṇa Himself descends —

62 He sent countless devotees down before Him, and last of all the son of the king of Vraja descended Himself.

Anubhāṣya.
See Ādi 3.93.

Before Mahāprabhu, Śrī Advaita was the head, worshipped by all —

63 Before the Lord appeared, all the Vaiṣṇavas would gather at the home of Advaita Ācārya.

*Advaita explains *bhakti* —*

64 There Ācārya Gosāñi expounded the *Gītā* and the *Bhāgavata*, decrying the paths of knowledge and fruitive work and extolling bhakti.

*He teaches that devotion to Kṛṣṇa alone is the means (*abhidheya*) —*

65 He showed that all the scriptures speak of devotion to Kṛṣṇa, and would accept no other path — not knowledge, yoga, austerity or ritual dharma.

Accepting Him as their head, all the Vaiṣṇavas worship Kṛṣṇa —

66 In His company the Vaiṣṇavas delighted in talks of Kṛṣṇa, worship of Kṛṣṇa and the saṅkīrtana of the holy name.

*Having appeared in the world, the Ācārya sees the *jīvas* bent on sense pleasure and grieves —*

67 But when He saw that all people had turned away from Kṛṣṇa and were sunk in worldly things, He grieved.

The Ācārya thinks deeply how to deliver the people —

68 He pondered how they might be delivered: how could all these people be saved?

Only the descent of Kṛṣṇa Himself will surely deliver the people —

69 "If Kṛṣṇa descends and spreads bhakti, then indeed all people will be delivered."

To bring Kṛṣṇa Himself down, the Ācārya worships Kṛṣṇa —

70 Vowing to bring Kṛṣṇa down, the Ācārya worshipped Him with tulasī and Gaṅgā water.

The Ācārya calls Kṛṣṇa, and Kṛṣṇa is drawn —

71 He called to Kṛṣṇa with roar upon roar, and those roars drew the son of the king of Vraja.

Anubhāṣya.
See Ādi 3.95–109 and the *Caitanya-bhāgavata*, Ādi-khaṇḍa, Chapter 2.

Before Gaura's descent, the eight daughters of Miśra and Śacī pass away —

72 Eight daughters were born one after another to Śacī, the wife of Jagannātha Miśra, and each died soon after her birth.

Miśra's grief and his worship of Viṣṇu for a son —

73 Grieving at the loss of his children, Miśra worshipped the feet of Viṣṇu, praying for a son.

Their ninth child, Viśvarūpa —

74 Then a son was born, named Viśvarūpa. He was rich in great virtues, a manifestation of Baladeva.

Anubhāṣya.
Viśvarūpa was the elder brother of Śrī Gaurahari. Before marrying He took *sannyāsa* and received the name "Śaṅkarāraṇya." In Śaka 1431 He departed from this world at Pāṇḍerapura in the district of Sholapur, in the Bombay Presidency. He is both causes of the universe, the "material" (*upādāna*) and the "efficient" (*nimitta*). The *Gaura-gaṇoddeśa* (verses 58–59) says: "Because the

part and the whole are not different, the son of Śacī is the original *vyūha*; Baladeva is Viśvarūpa, considered the *vyūha* Saṅkarṣaṇa; and Nityānanda Avadhūta is also called He, by way of *prakāśa*." In the *Gauracandrodaya*, Kali says to Dharma: "His elder brother, without ever taking a wife — Saṅkarṣaṇa, that Bhagavān who on earth was Viśvarūpa — gave, it is said, His own effulgence to Purīśvara, took *sannyāsa* before Him and left this world."

And there too: "…Nityānanda Avadhūta, glorified as the Effulgence — indeed, Saṅkarṣaṇa…"[3] And further: "When this eternal Śrī Viśvarūpa left this world, He joined with Nityānanda Avadhūta and remained [in Him]."

Viśvarūpa is the Mahā-Saṅkarṣaṇa of Vaikuṇṭha —

75 Baladeva's manifestation in the spiritual sky is Saṅkarṣaṇa, and He is both the material and the efficient cause of the universe.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
Viśvarūpa is the avatāra of Mahā-Saṅkarṣaṇa, who dwells in Paravyoma.

76 Apart from Him I see nothing in the universe, and so He is called Viśvarūpa, "He whose form is the universe".

77 "O King, this is no wonder for Bhagavān, the unlimited Lord of the universe, in whom this whole world is woven, warp and weft, like cloth upon its threads." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 10.15.35)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
Nothing is astonishing in the unlimited Bhagavān, the Lord of the universe: in Him this whole universe appears woven lengthwise and crosswise, like the threads in a cloth.

Anubhāṣya.
Referring to the pastime in which Baladeva killed the demon Dhenuka, Śukadeva says to Parīkṣit: **aṅga** (O king), **yasmin idaṁ** (this universe) **tantuṣu paṭaḥ** (cloth) **yathā** (as) **otaṁ protam** (woven lengthwise and crosswise), (in that) **anante** (unlimited) **jagad-īśvare bhagavati** (in that Viṣṇu) **etat** (the killing of demons and the like) **citram** (astonishing) **na hi** (not at all) (is).

Why the Lord calls Him "elder brother" —

78 That is why the Lord called Him His elder brother. Kṛṣṇa and Balarāma — these two are Caitanya and Nitāi.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
Mahā-Saṅkarṣaṇa pervades the universe lengthwise and crosswise as its "material" (*upādāna*) and "efficient" (*nimitta*) cause; that is why Mahāprabhu calls Him His "elder brother." But Kṛṣṇa and Balarāma in Kṛṣṇaloka are Caitanya and Nitāi themselves. Therefore Nityānanda Prabhu is the original Saṅkarṣaṇa, that is, Baladeva.

The joy of Miśra and Śacī at having a son —

79 Blessed with a son, the couple rejoiced and served the feet of Govinda with still greater devotion.

Thirteen months before His appearance, Kṛṣṇa enters Śacī's womb —

80 At the end of the month of Māgha in Śaka 1406, Kṛṣṇa entered the bodies of Jagannātha and Śacī.

Miśra is astonished to see Śacī changed in a way not of this world —

81 Miśra said to Śacī, "I see something wonderful. Your body is radiant, and our house has become the abode of Lakṣmī.

82 Wherever I go, people honour me, and they send wealth, clothes and rice to our house."

Śacī is astonished to see the gods offering prayers —

83 Śacī replied, "And I see beings of divine form appear in the sky above and offer prayers."

Kṛṣṇa enters first Miśra's heart, then Śacī's —

84 Jagannātha Miśra said, "I had a dream: a radiant abode entered my heart.

They sense the coming appearance of some great personality —

85 From my heart it passed into yours. So I understand that some great soul is to be born.”

Both serve Nārāyaṇa with special care —

86 Speaking thus, the two were filled with joy, and they served the śālagrāma with special care.

Anubhāṣya.

The conclusion is this. Jagannātha and Śacī are eternally perfect (*nitya-siddha*), and so their hearts and bodies consist of pure goodness (*śuddha-sattva*) and are not at all like those of ordinary mundane *jīvas*. Pure goodness (*viśuddha-sattva*) is called “Vasudeva”; it is in Vasudeva that Vāsudeva, who enjoys spiritual pastimes, becomes manifest (see the *Vivṛti* in the *Gauḍīya-bhāṣya* on *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 4.3.23). The union of Śrī Jagannātha and Śacīdevī and the conception in Śacīdevī were not like the amorous play and the pregnancy of men and women with mundane bodies of blood and flesh, absorbed in gratifying their material senses. Therefore even to think so in one's mind is an offense. One who reflects with a heart turned toward the service of Bhagavān will grasp the glory of the transcendental womb of Śrī Śacīdevī, who is made entirely of pure goodness. The *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* (10.2.16) says: “Bhagavān, the Soul of the universe, who frees His devotees from fear, entered the mind of Ānakadundubhi with His portion.” Śrīdhara Svāmī comments: “‘Entered the mind’ — He became manifest in the mind; the meaning is that He has no connection with bodily elements (*dhātu*), as the *jīvas* do.” In this connection see also *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 10.2.18 and 19.

On the same subject, here is a rendering of the sense of verses 160–165 from the section on the manifestation of the manifest pastimes in Śrī Rūpa Gosvāmī Prabhu's *Laghu-bhāgavatāmṛta*. The words of the *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* (10.2.16), “He entered the mind of Ānakadundubhi with His portion,” mean that Kṛṣṇa first became manifest in the heart of Ānakadundubhi. Then from Ānakadundubhi's heart He became manifest in Devakī's heart. Fondled by the nectar of loving bliss, Devakī's parental love, Śrī Kṛṣṇa grew more and more in her heart, like the waxing moon. Then Śrī Kṛṣṇa vanished from Devakī's heart and appeared on her bed in the birth chamber of Kaṁsa's prison. Devakī and the others,

under the sway of *yogamāyā*, then thought that the child had been born in the ordinary way, easily and happily. Such humanlike yet transcendental feelings of the devotee and Bhagavān, supremely delightful, serve the most wonderful spiritual pastimes. They bewilder even great sages enchanted by *māyā*, and they establish that Mathurā-dhāma is higher even than Paravyoma-Vaikuṇṭha. Thus Śrī Kṛṣṇa eternally remains the eternal son of the eternal Yaśodā, and in the same way He enjoys pastimes in the endless unmanifest *līlā* as well. Śrī Līlā-puruṣottama Śrī Kṛṣṇa eternally sports in Vraja, rejoicing in such pastimes: they give bliss to His dearest devotees and astonish Him as well. Under the sway of the transcendental parental love of the transcendental Nanda and Yaśodā — a love that has no equal and none higher — Bhagavān eternally knows Himself as their eternal son. In the Tenth Canto (10.5.1): “When a son was born to the great-hearted Nanda, he was overjoyed.” In the same Tenth Canto (10.6.43): “Generous-hearted Nanda, returning from abroad, took his son Kṛṣṇa on his lap, smelled His head and was filled with supreme bliss.” And again (10.9.21): “This Bhagavān Śrī Kṛṣṇa, the son of a cowherd woman, so easily reached by devotees, is never easily attained by those who take the body for the self, by ascetics, or by *jñānīs* who contemplate the self.”

Śrīpāda Baladeva Vidyābhūṣaṇa writes: “This [portion], having become one with Kṛṣṇa — Svayaṁ Bhagavān in His form, who dwelt in Ānakadundubhi's heart — becomes manifest in Devakī's heart. For Śrī Śuka says: ‘Then the goddess (“meaning: made of pure goodness,” says Svāmipāda) held in her mind the portion of Acyuta — the auspiciousness of the world, the Soul of all, the Self — placed in her (“properly placed, that is, imparted through initiation according to the rules,” says Svāmipāda) by the son of Śūra, as the east holds the delightful moon’ (*Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 10.2.18). Although it says ‘in Devakī's heart,’ it should be understood that He was in her womb, as the gods' prayer shows: ‘Fortunately, O mother, the Supreme Person is in your womb’ (*Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 10.2.41). *** And in the section on the birth: ‘In Devakī, whose form is divine, Viṣṇu, who dwells in everyone's heart, appeared, like the full moon in the east’ (*Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 10.3.8).”

“Then, as the east reveals the rising moon, so Devakī, made of pure goodness, having received from Śūrasena (Vasudeva) initiation into Kṛṣṇa's *mantra*, held in her heart Śrī Acyuta — the auspiciousness of the world, the Soul of all and the Supreme Soul.” From these words of the *Bhāgavatam* it is known that Svayaṁ Bhagavān became manifest from the heart of Ānakadundubhi (Vasudeva) in the

heart of Devakī. Although “in Devakī's heart” is said here, it must be understood to mean that He was in Devakī's womb, for in the *Bhāgavatam* there is the gods' prayer: “O mother, the Supreme Person resides in your womb.” And in the section on the Lord's birth these words of the *Bhāgavatam* should be especially noted: “As the full moon rises in the east, so Viṣṇu, who dwells in everyone's heart, appeared in Devakī's heart.”

Here, by the words “served the feet of Govinda with still greater devotion” (Ādi 13.79), it should be understood that Śrī Gaurasundara appeared in the very hearts of Miśra and Śacī, which were always immersed in the service of Govinda's feet.

Even after thirteen months there is no sign of His descent —

87 The months went by until the thirteenth had come, yet still the child was not born, and Miśra grew afraid.

Nīlāmbara Cakravartī's calculation —

88 Nīlāmbara Cakravartī made his calculations and said, “A son will be born this month, at an auspicious moment.”

The descent of Gaura Prabhu —

89 In Śaka 1407, in the month of Phālguna, the auspicious moment came on the evening of the full moon.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
The birth horoscope is as follows:

Śaka 1407 | 10 | 22 | 28 | 45 Day (*dinam*)[1]: 7 · 11 · 8 15 · 54 · 38 40 · 37 · 40 13 · 6 · 23

At the hour of the Lord's birth, Venus (*Śukra*) was in Aries (*Meṣa*), in the *nakṣatra* (lunar mansion) Aśvinī; Ketu in Leo (*Siṁha*), in the *nakṣatra* Uttara-phalgunī; the moon (*Candra*) in the *nakṣatra* Pūrva-phalgunī; Saturn (*Śani*) in Scorpio (*Vṛścika*), in the *nakṣatra* Jyeṣṭhā; Jupiter (*Bṛhaspati*) in Sagittarius (*Dhanu*), in the *nakṣatra* Pūrvāṣāḍhā; Mars (*Maṅgala*) in Capricorn (*Makara*), in the *nakṣatra* Śravaṇā; the sun (*Ravi*) in Aquarius (*Kumbha*), in Pūrva-bhādrapadā; Rāhu in the *nakṣatra* Pūrva-bhādrapadā;

Mercury (*Budha*) in Pisces (*Mīna*), in the *nakṣatra* Uttara-bhādrapadā. The ascendant (*lagna*) is Leo.

Mars, the lord of the ninth house, is exalted (*ucca*); Venus and Saturn are nearly exalted. Jupiter, in its own house (*svagṛha*), aspects Venus, which stands in the house of *dharma*. Venus, the lord of the tenth house, aspected by Jupiter (*Guru*), stands in the ninth house.

Anubhāṣya.

At the end of the play *Śrī Caitanya-candrodaya*: "In the Śaka year fourteen hundred joined with the horses of the sun[1], Gaura Hari appeared in the circle of the earth." Many events and known dates do not agree with Śrī Mahāprabhu's appearance in this Śaka year; therefore some think that Śaka 1426 or some other year is correct.

90 The moon was in Leo, Leo was rising and the planets were exalted; the six divisions and the eight divisions all showed auspicious signs.

Anubhāṣya.

The *ṣaḍ-varga*: *kṣetra*, *horā*, *dreṣkāṇa*, *navāṁśa*, *dvādaśāṁśa* and *triṁśāṁśa* — these six are called the *ṣaḍ-varga*, the six divisions of a sign. Nīlāmbara examined the lords of this *ṣaḍ-varga* according to the exact degree (*spaṣṭāṁśa*) of the ascendant and established the auspicious signs.

The *aṣṭa-varga*: the *aṣṭa-varga* is calculated by drawing prescribed lines from the positions of the planets at the moment, as described in the *Bṛhaj-jātaka* and other books. Experts in *horā-śāstra*, astrology, apply the stated results to it and determine what is auspicious and what is not. By this calculation too Cakravartī saw auspicious signs in Mahāprabhu.

Gauracandra rises as if to rebuke the moon —

91 Once the spotless moon Gauracandra had shown Himself, what further need was there of the spotted moon?

*The lunar eclipse, and on that occasion the *jīvas* chant Hari's name —*

92 Knowing this, Rāhu seized the moon, and the three worlds were flooded with the names "Kṛṣṇa! Kṛṣṇa! Hari!"

93 Cries of “Jaya! Jaya!” rang through all the worlds, and the people, amazed, wondered within themselves.

*The Lord descends while the *jīvas* chant Hari's name —*

94 The whole world was filled with people crying, “Hari! Hari!” — and at that very moment Gaura-Kṛṣṇa descended to the earth.

At that time even the Yavanas, mocking, utter Hari's name —

95 Every heart in the world was glad; even the Muslims, mocking the Hindus, cried out, “Hari!”

The joy of the gods in heaven —

96 Calling “Hari!”, the women raised their joyful ululation, while in heaven the gods, full of eager delight, played music and danced.

Joy plays everywhere —

97 The ten directions grew bright, the waters of the rivers grew clear, and all beings, moving and unmoving, were overwhelmed with bliss.

*The *sūtra* of the Lord's birth: Gaurahari appears amid the *kīrtana* of Hari's name —*

98 Over Nadīyā, the eastern mountain, the full moon Gaurahari has risen in His mercy. The darkness of sin is destroyed, the three worlds rejoice, and the sound of “Hari!” fills the world.

Advaita dances, overflowing with joy —

99 At that very time, in His own home, Advaita Rāya rose and began to dance, joyful at heart. With Haridāsa beside Him He roared and sang kīrtana in delight — and no one knew why He was dancing.

Anubhāṣya.

“In His own home”: in His house at Śāntipura. On the day of the Lord's birth Haridāsa Ṭhākura was in Śāntipura.

The lunar eclipse: the people chant Hari's name —

100 Seeing the eclipse, He laughed, hurried to the bathing place on the Gaṅgā and bathed there joyfully. Then, as though for the eclipse, He gave the brāhmaṇas many gifts in His mind.

Anubhāṣya.

Uparāga means an eclipse. *Manobale*: with eagerness of mind; or else, He gave gifts to the *brāhmaṇas* in His mind. The *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* (10.3.11) says: “Then Ānakadundubhi, his eyes wide with wonder, saw that his son was Hari. Stirred by the festival of Kṛṣṇa's descent, he joyfully bathed [in his mind] and [in his mind] gave ten thousand cows to the *brāhmaṇas*.” Seeing Bhagavān Hari as his son, Vasudeva rejoiced at the festival of Kṛṣṇa's birth and in the prison gave ten thousand cows to the *brāhmaṇas* in his mind.

Advaita hints to Haridāsa of the Lord's auspicious appearance —

101 Seeing the whole world full of bliss, Haridāsa was astonished and spoke in hints: “This joyful play of Yours delights my heart. I see that something lies behind it.”

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

“*Dekhi kichu kārye āche bhāsa*” (“I see something is behind this”): in this one seems to sense the manifestation of some special work.

Anubhāṣya.

Ṭhāre-ṭhore: by hints.

Śrīvāsa, overflowing with joy, chants Hari's name —

102 Ācāryaratna and Śrīvāsa were filled with joy. They went and bathed in the Gaṅgā, and, overwhelmed with bliss, sang the saṅkīrtana of Hari and gave many gifts in their minds.

The hearts of all the devotees in the world are gladdened —

103 So too all the devotees, in whatever land they dwelt, danced and sang saṅkīrtana there, overwhelmed with bliss, and, as though for the eclipse, gave gifts in their minds.

Men and women rejoice to see the child shining like gold —

104 Brāhmaṇas, good men and women all came with plates heaped with gifts, and when they saw the child, radiant as molten gold, they blessed Him with delight.

*The goddesses come to the world of mortals dressed as *brāhmaṇa* ladies to see Gaura —*

105 Sāvitrī, Gaurī, Sarasvatī, Śacī, Rambhā, Arundhatī and all the other goddesses came dressed as brāhmaṇa ladies, bearing trays laden with gifts, to see Him.

Anubhāṣya.

Sāvitrī is Brahmā's wife; Gaurī, Śiva's wife; Sarasvatī, Nṛsiṁha's consort, as in Śrīdhara Svāmī's commentary: "I worship Nṛsiṁha, on whose lips is the goddess of speech, on whose chest is Lakṣmī, and in whose heart is knowledge"; Śacī, Indra's wife; Rambhā, a heavenly dancer; Arundhatī, Vasiṣṭha's wife.

The gods and others in the sky rejoice, bow down, offer prayers and dance —

106 In the sky the gods, siddhas, gandharvas and cāraṇas offered praises, danced, played and sang; and the dancers, musicians and bards who performed in Navadvīpa all came and danced with delight.

Anubhāṣya.

Siddhas: beings of divine birth who attained that birth through perfection in *mantras*. Gandharvas: heavenly singers, born from Brahmā's luster; their abode is Guhyaloka. Cāraṇas: "The singers of the gods, the reciters of hymns of praise, are the Cāraṇas"; a particular class of celestial beings.

107 Who was coming, who going, who dancing, who singing — no one could make out anyone's words. Sorrow and grief were cut away, the people were filled with gladness, and Miśra was overwhelmed with bliss.

Anubhāṣya.

Sambhālite: to understand. Gods, humans, Siddhas and the rest belong to different orders of beings, and so they cannot understand one another's words.

*The Lord's birth ceremony (*jātakarma*) —*

108 Ācāryaratna and Śrīvāsa came to Jagannātha Miśra and recalled him to his duty. They had the birth rite performed as the scriptures prescribe, and then Miśra gave many gifts.

Anubhāṣya.

Ācāryaratna is Candraśekhara; Śrīvāsa is Śrīnivāsa Paṇḍita.

Miśra gives gifts on the occasion of the auspicious rite —

109 He gave away to the brāhmaṇas all the gifts he had received and whatever else was in the house, and he honoured all the dancers, singers, bards and the poor with gifts of wealth.

The auspicious rites of Mālinī Ṭhākurāṇī and the Lord's maternal aunt —

110 Śrīvāsa's wife, whose name was Mālinī, came with the wife of Ācāryaratna, and the women joyfully worshipped the child with vermilion, turmeric, oil, puffed rice, bananas and many kinds of fruit.

What Sītā Ṭhākurāṇī did —

111 Advaita Ācārya's wife, the noble lady revered by all the world, was named Sītā Ṭhākurāṇī. With the Ācārya's leave she set out with gifts to see that jewel among children.

Anubhāṣya.

One day after the Lord's birthday, Advaita Prabhu's wife Sītādevī, with His permission, came with gifts from Śāntipura to Navadvīpa to see the child. Although

Advaita Prabhu also had a house in Navadvīpa at that time, the words “in His own home” (Ādi 13.99) show that He was then staying in Śāntipura.

The ornaments of the Lord in the form of a child —

112 She brought a little golden waist-chain and anklets of silver coins, golden armlets and bracelets, fine conch-shell bangles for both arms, silver ankle-rings and necklaces of gold coins.

Anubhāṣya.

Kaḍi-bauli: a golden waist ring; *pāśuli*: a particular silver ornament for the feet; *aṅgada* and *kaṅkaṇa*: golden bracelets — *curi*, *bālā*, *ananta*; *divya śaṅkha*: bangles made of conch shell (*śāṅkhā*); *malabaṅka*: curved anklets (*bāṅkmal*).

113 There was also a tiger’s claw set in gold, a silken waist-cord, every kind of ornament for hands and feet, many-coloured silk saris, a little shirt woven with a silk border, and a wealth of gold and silver coins.

Anubhāṣya.

Hemajaḍi: a jeweled ornament set with a tiger's claw; *kaṭi-paṭṭasūtra-ḍorī*: a *ghunsi*, a waist string; *citravarṇa paṭṭasāḍī*: a colorful silk cloth; *buni photo paṭṭapāḍī*: a *phatuyā* with a woven silk border, that is, a little shirt for a baby.

Auspicious rites —

114 Riding in a curtained palanquin with her maidservants, she came with baskets full of clothes and ornaments, and plates heaped with auspicious things — dūrvā grass, paddy, gorocanā, turmeric, saffron and sandal.

Anubhāṣya.

Gorocana: a bright yellow substance obtained from a cow's head, or dried bile. *Kuṅkuma*: a fragrant substance native to Kashmir. “*Kuṅkuma* from the fields of Kashmir — with fine filaments, reddish, with the fragrance of a lotus — is the best. *Kuṅkuma* from the land of Bāhlīka — pale, with the fragrance of *ketakī*, with fine filaments — is middling. Persian *kuṅkuma* is said to smell of honey; it is slightly pale, with coarse filaments, and is the lowest.”

Vastragupta-dolā: a litter (*ḍuli* or *thāñjām*) covered with cloth; *ceḍī*: a maidservant.

115 Bringing many loads of sweets and other foods, she arrived at Śacī's house. When she saw the child, He was Kāna of Gokula Himself — only His colour was the opposite.

Anubhāṣya.

Ṭhāma: build; *kāna*: Kānu, that is, Kṛṣṇa. Kṛṣṇa's color is dark, like a dense *indranīla* sapphire; Viśvambhara's color is the opposite, golden (*gaura*).

Seeing the child's golden body, the women are filled with parental love —

116 Every limb was finely formed, He seemed an image of gold, and every limb bore auspicious marks. Seeing the child's divine radiance, she was filled with delight, and her heart melted with a mother's love.

Anubhāṣya.

Sunirmāṇa: beautifully formed limbs; *bhāna*: appearance.

The child is blessed and a protective amulet is tied on Him —

117 She placed dūrvā grass and paddy on His head and blessed Him again and again: "May the two brothers live long!" Fearing the witches and evil spirits, she gave Him the name Nimāi.

Anubhāṣya.

The two brothers are Viśvarūpa and Viśvambhara. *Ḍākinīs* and *śākhinīs* are the companions of Pārvatī and Maheśa, a particular class of malevolent ghosts (*preta*) born in female form. These lower deities (*apadevatās*) cannot approach the sacred *nimba* tree or places connected with it.

Śacī and Miśra show honor —

118 On the day the mother and child were bathed, she gave them clothes and ornaments and honoured Miśra together with his son. Then, honoured in turn by Śacī and Miśra, Sītā Ṭhākurāṇī returned home glad at heart.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

"*Putra-mātā-snāna-dine*": that is, on the fifth day, the *pāṅcaṭa*, and on the ninth, the day of the *nattā*.

Anubhāṣya.

"On the day of the mother's bath": that is, on the day of the *niṣkrāmaṇa*, the child's first going out of the house. In Bengal in former times the *brāhmaṇas* and other *varṇas* observed the impurity of childbirth (*jananāśauca*) for four months, followed by the rite of seeing the sun (*sūrya-darśana*). Later, instead of four months, twenty-one days of birth impurity were prescribed for the twice-born *varṇas*, the *brāhmaṇas* and others, while among the *śūdras* and others a month is still observed. Among the Kartābhajās and in the Satīmā group the birth impurity ends at once, with a *harinuṭ* (a scattering of sweets in Hari's name).

This custom at parting is still seen in Bengali social life. When relatives or in-laws visit someone's home, the householder honors them at their departure with cloth and other gifts. Having received such honor from Jagannātha Miśra and Śacīdevī, Sītā Ṭhākurāṇī returned to Śāntipura.

The joy of Śacī and Miśra at having a son —

119 So Śacī and Jagannātha had gained a son who was the Lord of Lakṣmī, and all their desires were fulfilled. Their house was filled with wealth and grain; everyone honoured their child, and day by day their joy grew.

Anubhāṣya.

Lokamānya-kalevara, "a body honored by the world": gods, humans and all others, drawn by the sight of Śrī Mahāprabhu's beauty, majesty and loveliness, showed honor to His body; seeing this, His father and mother rejoiced.

Miśra, a peaceful, self-controlled and generous Vaiṣṇava —

120 Miśra was a Vaiṣṇava — peaceful, free from lust, pure and self-controlled — with no thought of enjoying wealth. Whatever wealth came to him through his son's power, he gave to the brāhmaṇas for the pleasure of Viṣṇu.

Anubhāṣya.

Mundane, worldly people, for the sake of wife, sons and the like, take pride in enjoying wealth and bustle after it. The pure devotee Jagannātha Miśra was not like that. He offered everything he had to Bhagavān and gave the remnants to worthy recipients, *brāhmaṇas* and others. He accepted nothing for the sake of his own enjoyment.

Cakravartī casts the Lord's horoscope —

121 Nīlāmbara Cakravartī cast the horoscope with joy in his heart and told Miśra in secret, "I see many marks of a great person (*mahāpuruṣa*), both in the horoscope and on His body. This child will deliver the world."

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

"*Lagne aṅge bhinna bhinna*" ("separately, in the *lagna* and on the body"): according to *sāmudrika*, the science of bodily marks — in the *lagna*, that is, in the birth chart (*jātaka-kuṇḍalī*), and on the *aṅga*, that is, on the body.

Thus ends the thirteenth chapter of the "Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya."

Anubhāṣya.

Gupte: in private.

The glory of hearing of the Lord's birth —

122 Thus the Lord in His mercy descended in Śacī's house. Whoever hears of this receives the kindness of merciful Gaura Prabhu and attains His feet.

The misfortune of worldly people hostile to Gaura —

123 One who has gained a human birth yet will not hear of Gaura's qualities has wasted that birth. He has found the river of nectar, yet drinks water from a poisoned pit. Why did he not die as soon as he was born?

Anubhāṣya.

Amṛta-dhunī: a river of nectar. Whoever refuses to drink the water of the nectarean stream of devotion to Kṛṣṇa and drinks the water of the poisonous well of sense objects (harmful to the soul) is utterly dead, and should not go on living.

In Śrīmat Prabodhānanda Sarasvatīpāda's *Caitanya-candrāmṛta*: "This world is without consciousness (*acaitanya*) if it does not worship Caitanya, the Lord

whom the best of the immortals worship: death surrounds it on every side." "This world is without consciousness if it does not know Caitanya, the Lord: such people, though they know all the scriptures, wander astray." "Now that the moon of Caitanya has risen and the ocean of the nectarean *rasa* of great *prema* has spread wide, whoever remains poor is poor indeed." "Now that Gauracandra has descended, the ocean of *prema* has spread wide and its heaps of jewels shine brightly, whoever remains poor is poor indeed."

The *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* (2.3.19, 20, 23) says: "A man into whose ears the name of Gadāgraja has never entered is an animal, praised by dogs, dung-eating hogs, camels and asses." "O Sūta, the ears of a man who does not hear of the exploits of Urukrama are mere holes; and the wicked tongue that does not sing the songs of Urugāya is like the tongue of a frog." "A mortal who has never taken on himself the dust of the feet of a *bhāgavata* is a corpse though alive; and a man who has never known the fragrance of the *tulasī* from Śrī Viṣṇu's feet is a breathing corpse." (*Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 10.1.4): "The recounting of Uttamaśloka's qualities is sung by those free of thirst; it is the medicine for the disease of worldly existence and a delight to the ear and the mind. Who, except a killer of animals, would turn away from it?" (*Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 3.23.56): "… whoever does not live for the service of Him whose feet are holy places is dead though alive."

124 Honouring upon my head, as my own treasure, the holy feet of Śrī Caitanya and Nityānanda, Ācārya Advaitacandra, Svarūpa, Rūpa and Raghunātha dāsa, I, Kṛṣṇadāsa, have sung the pastime of His birth.

Anubhāṣya.

The lotus feet of Śrī Mahāprabhu, Nityānanda, Advaita, Dāmodara Svarūpa, Rūpa and Raghunātha dāsa are the very own wealth of Śrī Kṛṣṇadāsa Kavirāja Gosvāmī and of the pure, or intimate, devotees who follow him. The wealth of worldly people is a price set by *māyā*; in truth it deserves the name "debt." The *jīva* who has turned away from Kṛṣṇa does not know that the highest goal is wealth, and takes lust (*kāma*), a debt in the form of material enjoyment, to be "wealth." Worldly *jīvas* bustle after the things they take for wealth, but in these the servants of Hari see only a growth of debt, not a growth of wealth. On the other hand, when Bhagavān makes someone rich by giving him the wealth of His mercy, He takes away his material riches. "Upon whom I bestow My mercy, I gradually take away his wealth"[5]. Ṭhākura Narottama says: "My wealth is Nityānanda";

“The holy feet of Rādhā and Kṛṣṇa are the wealth of my life”; “Glory to You, O purifier of the fallen! Give me this wealth; nothing but You appeals to me”; “The feet of Śrī Rūpa-mañjarī are my treasure, my worship and adoration, the wealth of my life”; “Carelessly I lost the jewel-wealth of *prema*. Striving for what is no wealth, I gave up true wealth” — and so on.

The *smārtas*, guided by the notion of kinship by seed, impute *śūdra*-hood — the lack of *brāhmaṇa* status — to the lotus feet of Śrī Raghunātha dāsa; in their wealth of devotion this is only a debt. But to realize transcendental *brāhmaṇa*-hood in his lotus feet is the devotee's very own wealth.

Thus ends the thirteenth chapter of the “Anubhāṣya.”

Notes

1. The edition gives the table without explanation; the figures have been checked against the scan. The first line apparently gives the elapsed years, months, days, *daṇḍas* and *palas* of the Śaka era. ↩
2. An anna is one sixteenth of the whole, and a *gaṇḍā* one twentieth of an anna; the three shares together make up the whole (16 annas). ↩
3. An incomplete line of the quotation; the translation is tentative. ↩
4. The edition gives the table without explanation; the figures have been checked against the scan. The first line apparently gives the elapsed years, months, days, *daṇḍas* and *palas* of the Śaka era. ↩
5. *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 10.88.8. ↩

“Śrī Caitanya-caritāmṛta”

Ādi-līlā

Chapter 14

A Brief Description of the Childhood Pastimes

(English translation from the Bengali, following the Gauḍīya Maṭha edition and the «Anubhāṣya», 2026 — draft)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya

Summary. The fourteenth chapter describes the Lord's childhood pastimes: He crawls on all fours; on the pretext of crying He spreads the holy name; on the pretext of eating earth He gives knowledge to His mother; He gives *prasāda* to a guest brāhmaṇa and delivers him; He climbs onto a thief's shoulders, bewilders him and brings him back to His own home; on the pretext of illness He eats, on the day of Ekādaśī, the offering (*naivedya*) of Hiraṇya and Jagadīśa; His childhood mischief; seeing His mother unconscious, He brings her coconuts; He jokes with the girls on the bank of the Gaṅgā; He accepts the worship of Lakṣmī-devī; sitting in a pit full of discarded pots, He gives His mother knowledge of Brahman and obeys her order; Miśra's pure parental love (*śuddha-vātsalya*). These are the topics of the childhood pastimes.

*(*Hari-bhakti-vilāsa*, *vilāsa* 20, verse 1)*

1 “I worship Śrī Caitanya. Remember Him in any way at all, and the difficult becomes easy; forget Him, and the easy becomes difficult.” (Hari-bhakti-vilāsa, 20.1)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

He whom one need only remember a little for the difficult to become easy, and whom one need only forget for even the easy to become difficult — that Caitanya I

worship.

Anubhāṣya.
yasmin (in whom — in Gaura-Kṛṣṇa) **kathañcana** (in whatever way) **smṛte** (when He has come to mind) **duṣkaraṁ** (a difficult task) **sukaraṁ** (an easily performed practice) **bhavet**, **yasmin** (in whom — in Gaura-Kṛṣṇa) **vismṛte** (when He is forgotten) **viparītaṁ** (the reverse: an easily performed practice becomes a difficult task) **syāt**, **tam amuṁ śrī-caitanyam bhaje**.

2 Glory, glory to Śrī Caitanya! Glory to Nityānanda! Glory to Advaitacandra! Glory to all the devotees of Gaura!

3 Thus I have given an outline of the Lord's birth, telling how the son of Yaśodā became the son of Śacī.

4 I have told the pastimes of His birth briefly and in order; now I shall name, one by one, the chief events of His childhood.

Gaura's pastimes are transcendental, though they resemble human ones —

5 I worship the enchanting childhood pastimes of Kṛṣṇa, who came as Caitanya. Though they seem like the doings of an ordinary human child, within they are interwoven with the acts of the Lord Himself.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
I bow down to the charming childhood pastimes of Caitanya-Kṛṣṇa. Although these childhood pastimes resemble ordinary, worldly play, the deeds of the Lord are mixed into them.

Anubhāṣya.
caitanya-devasya (of Gaura-Kṛṣṇa) **laukikīm** (resembling the doings of people in this world) **api īśa-ceṣṭayā** (by superhuman endeavor) **valitāntarām** (those whose inner core is *valita*, endowed [with it]), **mano-harām** (attracting the heart) **bālya-līlām** (childhood play) **ahaṁ vande**.

He shows the marks of the conch, disc, flag, thunderbolt and fish on His soles

—

6 At the very start of His childhood pastimes, as Śrī Caitanya lay on His back, He showed His father and mother the divine marks on His feet.

Anubhāṣya.

Uttāna: lying face upward, on the back. There is a variant reading, *utthāna*. In that sense: trying to stand on His feet, He cannot keep His balance for lack of practice, as is natural for an infant, and lies down.

7 In the house the two of them saw the prints of tiny feet, and in them a flag, a thunderbolt, a conch, a disc and a fish.

8 At the sight both were filled with wonder, unable to tell whose footprints these could be.

Miśra's words —

9 Miśra said, “The child Gopāla is present in our *śālagrāma-śilā*. I think He takes on a form and plays about the house for His own delight.”

10 At that moment Nimāi woke and began to cry. Śacī took Him on her lap and nursed Him.

Both Śacī and Miśra see the marks on Nimāi's feet —

11 As she nursed Him, she looked at her son’s feet, and when she saw those same marks on them, she called Miśra.

12 The sight filled Miśra’s heart with joy, and he quietly sent for Nīlāmbara Cakravartī.

Nīlāmbara Cakravartī's words —

13 Seeing the marks, Cakravartī smiled and said, “When I cast His birth chart, I foresaw this and wrote it down.

14 Thirty-two marks adorn a great personality, and I see every one of them on this child's body.

*The thirty-two marks of a *mahāpuruṣa*. So in the *Sāmudrika*, third verse —*

15 "A great personality bears thirty-two marks: five parts of his body are long, five fine, seven reddish and six raised; three are short, three broad and three deep." (Sāmudrika, 3)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

The nose, arms, jaws, eyes and knees — these five are long; the skin, hair, finger joints, teeth and body hair — these five are fine; the eyes, soles, palms, palate, lower lip, upper lip and nails — these seven are red; the chest, shoulders, nails, nose, waist and face — these six are raised; the neck, shanks and generative organ — these three are short; the waist, forehead and chest — these three are broad; the navel, voice and strength of character (*sattva*) — these three are deep. One who has these thirty-two marks is a *mahāpuruṣa*, a great personality.

Anubhāṣya.

pañca-dīrghaḥ (one whose five — nose, arms, jaws, eyes and knees — are long), **pañca-sūkṣmaḥ** (whose five — skin, hair, finger joints, teeth and body hair — are fine), **sapta-raktaḥ** (whose seven — the corners of the eyes, soles, palms, palate, lower lip, upper lip and nails — are red, red in color), **ṣaḍ-unnataḥ** (whose six — chest, shoulders, nails, nose, waist and face — are raised, high), **tri-hrasva-pṛthu-gambhīraḥ** (whose three — neck, shanks and generative organ — are short, small; three — waist, forehead and chest — are broad, wide; three — navel, voice and strength of character — are deep), **dvātriṁśal-lakṣaṇaḥ** (a person who has these thirty-two marks) — **mahān** (a great personality, a *mahāpuruṣa*).

Cakravartī describes the child's greatness and foretells His future —

16 His hands and feet bear the marks of Nārāyaṇa. This child will deliver all people.

17 He will spread the Vaiṣṇava dharma far and wide, and through Him both His families will be delivered.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

"Both families": the father's family and the mother's family.

The name-giving and the festival —

18 Hold a great festival and invite all the brāhmaṇas. Today is an auspicious day; I shall perform the naming ceremony.

The name "Viśvambhara" —

19 He will uphold and nourish all people, and that is why His name is Viśvambhara."

Anubhāṣya.

The *Caitanya-bhāgavata* (Ādi, Chapter 3): "With His birth the world came to well-being — just as, long ago, Nārāyaṇa upheld the earth. Therefore His name is 'Śrī Viśvambhara.'"

"Viśvambhara": the *Atharva-veda-saṁhitā*, *kāṇḍa* 2, *anuvāka* 3, *prapāṭhaka* 3, mantra 16, number 5: "O Viśvambhara, protect me with all Your sustaining support. *Svāhā*!"

20 Hearing this, Śacī and Miśra rejoiced all the more. They invited the brāhmaṇas and their wives and held a great festival.

He displays superhuman deeds —

21 Some days later the Lord began to crawl on His knees, and He showed many wonders.

Anubhāṣya.

Jānu-caṅkramaṇa: crawling on the knees. The *Caitanya-bhāgavata* (Ādi, Chapter 3): "The Lord crawls on His knees — nothing could be more beautiful; little bells jingle at His waist — so charming! One day a snake was moving about the house, and in His childhood play the Lord caught the snake. The snake coiled itself around Him, and the Ṭhākura lay down on top of the snake. Then the snake left the Lord and slithered away."

The name of Hari stops His crying —

22 On the pretext of crying He made everyone chant the name of Hari: all the women would call out “Hari!”, and the golden Lord would laugh.

Anubhāṣya.

The *Caitanya-bhāgavata* (Ādi, Chapter 3): “The lotus-eyed Lord cries only until He hears the name of Hari; then He at once falls quiet. Everyone understood this great sign: whenever He cries, they all chant the name of Hari. As soon as the Lord cries, the women clap their hands and sing *hari-saṅkīrtana*. The name of Hari is constantly on everyone's lips: on this pretext the Lord makes them chant it, for such is His will.”

Play with the children —

23 Later still He began to walk, and He played all sorts of games with the other children.

Anubhāṣya.

The *Caitanya-bhāgavata* (Ādi, Chapter 3): “In this way, day by day, Śrī Śacīnandana, the Lord, began to walk about the courtyard on His feet.”

24 One day Śacī brought puffed rice and sweets, filled a dish, and gave it to Him, saying, “Sit down and eat.”

Anubhāṣya.

Bāṭā: a vessel or stand for keeping food or betel; a dish.

Nimāi eats earth —

25 With that, Śacī went into the house to do her work, and the child began to eat earth on the sly.

Anubhāṣya.

This incident is among those left out of the *Caitanya-bhāgavata* and supplied here, as Ādi 13.49 explains.

Śacī asks the reason —

26 When Śacī saw it, she came running and cried out, “Oh dear, oh dear!” She snatched the earth away and said, “Why are You eating earth?”

Nimāi's philosophical answer —

27 The child wept and said, “Why are you angry? You gave Me earth to eat — how is that My fault?

Everything is a transformation of earth —

28 Puffed rice, sweets and all food are only earth in another form. This is earth and that is earth; why make any distinction?

29 The body is earth, and food is earth — think it over and see. You blame Me without thinking; what can I say?”

Śacī's reply —

30 Inwardly astonished, Śacī said to Him, “Who taught You such *jñāna-yoga*, just so You could eat earth?

The difference between a substance and its transformation, or what distinguishes the favorable from the unfavorable —

31 Food is earth transformed, and when we eat it, it nourishes the body. But eat earth itself, and disease sets in and the body wastes away.

32 In a pot, which is earth transformed, I fetch water; but try to hold it in a lump of earth, and the water soaks away.”

Hearing this, the Lord speaks —

33 To keep Himself hidden, the Lord said to her, “Mother, why did you not teach Me this before?

Anubhāṣya.

To take objects of food for oneself is merely an activity of the material kind; there is no service to Hari in it. The *nirviśeṣa-vādīs* mistakenly regard things favorable to Kṛṣṇa's service as being of the same nature as unfavorable things. Such a notion is an utterly mistaken, immature expression of mundane conclusions. Through His mother's mouth, with the simple example of clay and a pot, Mahāprabhu showed how worthless such foolish impersonal thinking is.

34 Now that I know, I will not eat earth any more. When I am hungry, I will drink at your breast."

35 Saying this, the Lord climbed onto His mother's lap and, with a little smile, began to nurse.

In various ways He manifests pastimes of majesty —

36 Thus, on one pretext or another, He would show His majesty, and afterwards, slipping back into the ways of a child, He would hide it again.

He eats the pilgrim brāhmaṇa's rice and delivers him —

37 Three times He ate the food a brāhmaṇa guest had cooked, and afterwards, in secret, He delivered him.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

A pilgrim (*tairthika*) came as a guest to the house of Śrī Jagannātha Miśra, and Miśra gave him all he needed for cooking and had him cook. When the pilgrim brāhmaṇa was offering the food to Gopāla in meditation, Nimāi came and began to eat his rice. Rejecting the food Nimāi had touched, the guest brāhmaṇa cooked once more; but this time too, as he offered it in meditation, the same thing happened. The food was cooked a third time. By then everyone in the house was asleep. The brāhmaṇa was offering the cooked rice to Gopāla in meditation when Nimāi came and began to eat that rice. Struck by fate, the brāhmaṇa began to cry out in distress. Then Nimāi said: "O brāhmaṇa, when I was Yaśodā's darling in Vraja, the same thing happened to you then. Now too, drawn by your devotion, I have mercifully shown Myself to you." Seeing his own worshipful Deity, the brāhmaṇa was enchanted with great *prema*; he counted himself blessed and

honored the remaining *prasāda*. The Lord forbade him to reveal this hidden pastime.

Anubhāṣya.
See the *Caitanya-bhāgavata*, Ādi, Chapter 3.

He bewilders the thief —

38 Another time some thieves found the Lord outside and carried Him off; but He bewildered them and came home riding on their shoulders.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
In His very early childhood Mahāprabhu, decked with gold ornaments, was playing outside the gate of the house. Two thieves put Him on their shoulders and carried Him off, as if to treat Him to sweets. The thieves thought: “We'll take the boy into the forest, kill him and take all his ornaments.” Spreading His *māyā*, Mahāprabhu made them lose their way, and riding on their shoulders He came back to the gate of His own house. His relatives were running everywhere searching for Him; the thieves set the child down right in front of them and fled. With great care the child was carried into Śacī's courtyard.

Anubhāṣya.
See the *Caitanya-bhāgavata*, Ādi, Chapter 3.

*On Ekādaśī He eats Viṣṇu's *naivedya* from the house of Hiraṇya and Jagadīśa —*

39 On the day of Ekādaśī, pretending to be ill, He ate the food offered to Viṣṇu in the house of Jagadīśa and Hiraṇya.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
At the house of Jagadīśa and Hiraṇya Paṇḍita an offering (*naivedya*) for Viṣṇu was being prepared on the day of Ekādaśī. Mahāprabhu wanted to eat that *naivedya*, and He sent His father to the house of Hiraṇya and Jagadīśa. When Hiraṇya and Jagadīśa heard the boy's request, they were quite astonished and said: “Today is Ekādaśī, and in our house the *naivedya* for Viṣṇu is being prepared. How did such a small child know this? Surely there is some potency of Viṣṇu (*vaiṣṇavī śakti*) in Him.” And they sent Him the *naivedya* to eat. Mahāprabhu had obtained the *naivedya* on this pretext: “My body is ill; if I eat Viṣṇu's

naivedya, the illness will be cured." He fed the *naivedya* that was brought to the boys and ate some Himself, and so His illness was cured. The house of Hiraṇya and Jagadīśa stood some way from the house of Jagannātha Miśra, about one *krośa* to the southeast. For a child it is impossible to know what is happening so far away.

Anubhāṣya.
See the *Caitanya-bhāgavata*, Ādi, Chapter 4.

Pastimes befitting a child: stealing, quarrels and so on —

40 He would take the children into the neighbours' houses and steal food to eat, and He would beat the other boys.

Anubhāṣya.
The *Caitanya-bhāgavata* (Ādi, Chapter 3): "However many friends and relatives live nearby — in their houses He Himself steals every day for fun. In one house He drinks milk, in another He eats rice. Where He finds nothing, He breaks the pots. If there is a child in the house, He makes him cry." Ibid., Chapter 4: "Someone says: 'My son is very small, and He poured water into his ears — now he cries without end.'"

The complaints to Śacī and Śacī's scolding —

41 The children all complained to Śacī, and when she heard them, she scolded her son a little:

Anubhāṣya.
Olāhana: a reproach, a scolding.

42 "Why do You steal? Why do You beat the other children? Why do You go into other people's houses? What do You lack at home?"

The Lord's anger and His rampage at home —

43 Hearing this, the Lord grew angry, went into the house, and smashed every pot in it.

The Lord is consoled, and He feels ashamed —

44 Then Śacī took Him on her lap and comforted Him, and the Lord, knowing He was at fault, felt ashamed.

He strikes His mother and, seeing her faint, brings rare coconuts —

45 Once He struck His mother with His soft little hands, and when He saw her faint, He began to cry.

46 The women said, “Bring her a coconut, and then Your mother will recover.”

Anubhāṣya.

Locana dāsa's *Śrī Caitanya-maṅgala* (Ādi): “Then a divine woman smiled, took Viśvambhara by the chin and said: ‘Bring your mother two coconuts — then Śacī, your mother, will revive.’ Hearing this, Viśvambhara was delighted and at once brought a pair of coconuts.”

47 He went out and brought back two coconuts, and everyone was astonished at the marvel.

Fun with the girls at bathing time —

48 Sometimes He bathed in the Ganges with the other children, and the girls would come there to worship the gods.

49 When they had bathed in the Ganges and begun their worship, the Lord would come and sit down among them.

The Lord's words to the girls —

50 He would say to the girls, “Worship Me, and I will grant you a boon. Gaṅgā and Durgā are My maidservants, and Maheśa is My servant.”[1]

51 He would smear Himself with sandal paste and put on the flower garlands, then snatch the offerings and eat them — sweets, rice and

bananas.

The girls' reply —

52 The girls said angrily, “Listen, Nimāi! By village ties You are a brother to us all.

53 It is not proper for us to say this to You, but do not take the gods’ offerings, and do not misbehave!”

The Lord gives blessings in jest —

54 The Lord said, “I give you all this boon: each of you will have a most handsome husband.

55 He will be learned and refined, young and rich in wealth and grain, and each of you will have seven sons, long-lived and wise.”

56 Hearing this boon, the girls were delighted at heart, but outwardly they scolded Him with feigned anger.

Feigned anger, in the guise of a curse, at a girl who ran away —

57 If some girl ran off with her offering, the Lord would call after her angrily:

58 “If you are stingy and will not give Me your offering, you will get an old husband — and four co-wives!”

Frightened, the girls give their offerings —

59 The girls grew frightened at these words: “Perhaps He knows something, or perhaps some god has entered Him.”

60 So they brought their offerings and held them out before Him, and when He had eaten, He gave them the boon they longed for.

The Lord's sweet mischief delights everyone —

61 In this way He showed His mischief to everyone, yet no one was ever unhappy; it brought them all joy.

The meeting with Lakṣmī-devī, Vallabha's daughter —

62 One day Vallabhācārya's daughter, Lakṣmī by name, bathed in the Ganges and came to worship the gods.

Both rejoice on seeing each other —

63 When the Lord saw her, His heart was drawn to her; and at the sight of the Lord, Lakṣmī felt joy within.

The eternally perfect, natural love of the two and their joy —

64 A natural love awoke in them both, though the mood of childhood still veiled its true form.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
Lakṣmī is Bhagavān's eternal consort, and Bhagavān is Lakṣmī's eternal husband. Therefore the eternal love between Them is *sāhajika*, inborn. That love appeared concealed beneath a childlike mood.

65 Seeing each other, both rejoiced at heart, and on the pretext of worshipping the gods they let their feelings show.

The Lord tells Lakṣmī to worship Him —

66 The Lord said, "Worship Me, for I am Maheśvara, the Supreme Lord. If you worship Me, you will receive the boon you desire."

Lakṣmī carries out the order —

67 Lakṣmī placed sandal paste and flowers on His body, offered Him a garland of mallikā jasmine, and bowed to Him.

The Lord is pleased —

68 Receiving her worship, the Lord began to smile, and by reciting a verse He accepted the sentiment of her heart.

Anubhāṣya.

Vallabhācārya was a royal paṇḍita (*rāja-paṇḍita*) living in Navadvīpa. *Gaura-gaṇoddeśa-dīpikā* (44): "He who formerly was the great King Janaka, lord of Mithilā, is now Vallabhācārya; he is also considered to be Bhīṣmaka." Śrī Gaurahari first accepted the hand of his daughter, Lakṣmīpriyā Devī.

Lakṣmī-devī: *Gaura-gaṇoddeśa-dīpikā* (45): "Śrī Jānakī and Rukmiṇī are his daughter named Lakṣmī. She, named Lakṣmī, is described in the *Caitanya-carita* thus: 'Vallabhācārya's daughter Lakṣmī, who had descended together with Him, was going with her friends to bathe in the river of the gods, and there she came before the Lord's eyes.'"

*(*Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam*, Canto 10, Chapter 22, verse 25)*

69 "O chaste ones, I know your resolve to worship Me. I accept it, and it deserves to come true." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 10.22.25)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

O chaste maidens, I have understood why you worship, and this gives Me special joy. Your intention is indeed worthy of fulfillment.

Anubhāṣya.

Śrī Kṛṣṇa's words. The *gopīs*, who desired Kṛṣṇa, were keeping the Kātyāyanī vow; He stole their clothes, then gave them back, and seeing their desire to attain Kṛṣṇa, He said:

sādhvyaḥ (O chaste ones)! **mad-arcanam** (worship for the sake of attaining Me — just this) **bhavatīnām** (your, the *gopīs'*) **saṅkalpaḥ** (desire, that is, the feeling in your hearts — though out of shyness you did not speak of it) **mayā viditaḥ** (is known to Me) **anumoditaḥ** (and accepted); (therefore) **saḥ asau** (that desire) **satyaḥ** (true, fulfilled) **bhavitum arhati** (deserves to become).

70 After this pastime the two of them went home. Who can fathom the deep pastimes of Caitanya?

Seeing the Lord's mischief, everyone complains —

71 Seeing Caitanya's mischief, everyone, out of love for Him, would come to Śacī and Jagannātha with complaints.

Śacī tries to catch Nimāi —

72 One day Śacī-devī scolded her son and went to catch Him, but He ran away.

Nimāi sits on the discarded pots —

73 Then the Lord Viśvambhara, upholder of the universe, sat down contentedly on the cast-off pots in the refuse pit.

Anubhāṣya.

The *Caitanya-bhāgavata* (Ādi, Chapter 7): "The Lord made all the discarded pots from Viṣṇu's *naivedya* His seat and sat on them. His mother came, saw this and cried: 'Alas, alas! It isn't right, my son, to sit in such a place!' The Lord said: 'Everywhere My knowledge is nondual. In these pots there is, at root, no defilement. Pots in which food is cooked for Viṣṇu are never defiled; touching such pots purifies other places too.'"

Thinking her son defiled, Śacī wants to purify Him —

74 Śacī came and said, "Why have You touched these unclean things? Go and bathe in the Ganges — You have made Yourself impure."

The son instructs His mother in the knowledge of Brahman —

75 In reply He spoke to His mother of *brahma-jñāna*, spiritual knowledge. She was astonished, but still she made Him bathe.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

The Lord said: "Mother, 'defiled by remnants' and 'undefiled' are merely human notions; in reality there is not a grain of truth in them. In these pots you cooked food for Viṣṇu and offered it to Viṣṇu, so these pots can never be defiled. The soul is an eternally pure reality: what have considerations of defilement and the like to

do with it?" Hearing this knowledge of Brahman, His mother was amazed and had Him bathe.

Thus ends the fourteenth chapter of the "Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya."

At bedtime Śacī sees the gods —

76 Once, as Śacī lay resting with her son, she saw that divine beings had come and filled the house.

77 Śacī said, "Go, my son, and call Your father." At His mother's bidding the Lord went outside.

As He goes at His mother's word, ankle bells ring though He wears none —

78 As He walked, anklets jingled on His feet, and His father and mother were startled to hear them.

Miśra's astonishment —

79 Miśra said, "This is a great wonder! Why do we hear anklets on the child's bare feet?"

Śacī's astonishment at seeing the gods —

80 Śacī said, "I saw another wonder too: radiant divine beings came and filled the courtyard.

81 They raised such a clamour that I could not make out what they said; whom they were praising I can only guess."

Both think of Nimāi's welfare —

82 Miśra said, "Whatever it may be, there is nothing to worry about. All I want is for Viśvambhara to be well."

Seeing the Lord's mischief, Miśra scolds Him severely —

83 One day, seeing his son’s mischief, Miśra scolded Him severely and taught Him what dharma requires.

At night a dream: a brāhmaṇa rebukes Miśra —

84 At night he dreamt that a brāhmaṇa came and spoke to him angrily:

85 “Miśra, you know nothing of who your son truly is. You scold and beat Him because you think of Him as merely your son.”

Miśra's transcendental reply, steeped in affection —

86 Miśra said, “Be He a god, a perfected being or a sage — however great He may be, now He is my son.

87 To raise and teach his son is a father’s own dharma. If I do not teach Him, how will He come to know the heart of dharma?”

The brāhmaṇa's words and Miśra's reply —

88 The brāhmaṇa said, “If He is divine and perfect by nature, His knowledge is complete in itself, and teaching Him is in vain.”

Anubhāṣya.

See Antya 4.174–176. The Lord's words to Uddhava (*Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 11.28.4): “What is good and what is bad in duality, which is not reality — and to what extent? Whatever is spoken in words and conceived in the mind is false.” That is, “in the transcendental there is no notion of things as good and bad” (*Caitanya-caritāmṛta*, Antya 4.174). “In duality, every notion of good and bad is a mere product of the mind; ‘this is good, this is bad’ — all this is error” (*Caitanya-caritāmṛta*, Antya 4.176). (*Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 11.19.45): “To see good and bad qualities is itself the fault; the virtue is to be free of both.” And (*Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 11.21.3): “O sinless one, purity and impurity, merit and fault, the auspicious and the inauspicious are prescribed even for things of the same

kind — to discern the nature of a substance, for the sake of *dharma*, for worldly dealings and for the maintenance of life."

Miśra regarded his son Nimāi as untaught and ignorant and wished to teach Him and awaken knowledge in Him. Seeing this, the brāhmaṇa said to Miśra: "Your son is an eternally perfect deity. Yet you take His eternally perfect, natural knowledge for such foolishness, and so your attempt to teach Him proves futile. Therefore it does not become you."

89 Miśra said, "My son may well be Nārāyaṇa; even so, it is a father's dharma to teach his son."

Miśra's pure parental affection for the Lord —

90 So the two of them discussed dharma. Miśra's parental love was pure; he knew nothing else.

Anubhāṣya.

Bhakti-rasāmṛta-sindhu (*Paścima-vibhāga*, fourth wave): "The *sthāyi-bhāva* of *vātsalya*, brought to fullness by *vibhāva* and the rest, is here called '*vatsala*' [*rasa*]." (*Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 10.8.45): "Hari, whose glory is sung by the three Vedas, the Upaniṣads, the Sāṅkhya and Yoga scriptures and the Sātvata scriptures — she regarded Him as her own son."

Waking from the dream, Miśra is astonished and tells his friends —

91 At this the brāhmaṇa went away well pleased, and Miśra awoke in utter astonishment.

92 He told the dream to his friends and kinsmen, and all who heard it marvelled.

93 Thus Gauracandra played His childhood pastimes, and day by day His parents' joy grew.

Nimāi takes the chalk in hand —

94 Some days later Miśra placed chalk in his son's hand, and within a few days He had learnt all the letters with their twelve *phalās*.

Anubhāṣya.

The twelve *phalās* (subscript signs): the *repha*, and the *ṇa*, *na*, *ma*, *ya*, *ra*, *la*, *va*, *ṛ*, *ṝ*, *ḷ* and *ḹ phalās*.

*These childhood pastimes in brief; they are described in the *Caitanya-bhāgavata* —*

95 This, in order, is the outline of His childhood pastimes; Vṛndāvana dāsa has described them at length.

Anubhāṣya.

Thus ends the fourteenth chapter of the "Anubhāṣya."

96 Therefore I have outlined the childhood pastimes briefly and, for fear of repeating him, have not told them in detail.

97 Praying at the feet of Śrī Rūpa and Śrī Raghunātha, I, Kṛṣṇadāsa, narrate the *Caitanya-caritāmṛta*.

Notes

1. *Vara* means both "boon" and "bridegroom"; the girls worshipped the gods to win a good husband (cf. 54–55, 58). ↩

“Śrī Caitanya-caritāmṛta”

Ādi-līlā

Chapter 15

A Brief Description of the Boyhood Pastimes

(English translation from the Bengali, following the Gauḍīya Maṭha edition and the «Anubhāṣya», 2026 — draft)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya

Summary. In the fifteenth chapter the Lord studies grammar with Gaṅgādāsa Paṇḍita, becomes expert in the *Pañjī-ṭīkā* and forbids His mother to eat grains on Ekādaśī. He tells a story: Viśvarūpa, having taken *sannyāsa*, called Him to take *sannyāsa* too, but He did not listen and said He wished to serve His parents — and so Viśvarūpa sent Him back home. The departure of Purandara Miśra[3] from this world, the marriage to Lakṣmī-devī, daughter of Vallabhācārya, and other events are described in brief.

*By worshipping Gaura even the evil-minded gains a good mind — (*Hari-bhakti-vilāsa*, *vilāsa* 7, verse 1)*

1 “I worship Caitanya Prabhu. The mere offering of flowers at His lotus feet turns even an evil mind into a good one.” (Hari-bhakti-vilāsa, 7.1)[1]

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

One need only offer *sumanas* (jasmine flowers) at His lotus feet, and even a person of evil mind (*ku-manāḥ*) gains a good mind (*sumanas*)[4]. That Caitanya Prabhu I worship.

Anubhāṣya.

ku-manāḥ (one whose mind is absorbed in objects other than Kṛṣṇa) **yasya** (of Caitanya-deva) **padābjayoḥ** (at the lotus feet) **su-mano-'rpaṇa-mātreṇa** (merely by offering *sumanas*, flowers, or else one's own mind that is *su*, good, intent

on serving Kṛṣṇa) **su-manastvaṁ** (a nature free of other desires, not covered by *jñāna*, karma and the like, and devoted to serving Kṛṣṇa, *kṛṣṇānuśīlana*) **hi** (certainly) **yāti** (attains), **taṁ caitanya-prabhum ahaṁ vande**.

2 Glory, glory to Śrī Caitanya! Glory to Nityānanda! Glory to Advaitacandra! Glory to all the devotees of Gaura!

*Among the pastimes of the *paugaṇḍa* age, the pastime of study is the chief —*

3 Now I shall give a brief account of the Lord's boyhood pastimes. In those years His chief occupation was study.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
Mukhya adhyayana: His chief activity was the pastime of study.

*The Lord's very extensive pastimes of the *paugaṇḍa* age —*

4 "The boyhood pastimes of Caitanya-Kṛṣṇa are vast and enchanting. They begin with His first lessons and end with His marriage."

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
The charming pastimes of the *paugaṇḍa* age (boyhood) of Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya, from the beginning of His schooling to His marriage, are very extensive.

Anubhāṣya.
caitanya-kṛṣṇasya (of Bhagavān Viśvambhara, whose form is non-different from Rādhā-Kṛṣṇa) **vidyārambha-mukhā** (those whose beginning is the start of schooling) **pāṇi-grahaṇāntā** (and whose end, conclusion, is His marriage) **mano-harā** (captivating all hearts) **paugaṇḍa-līlā** (*paugaṇḍa* is the period from the fifth year to the tenth; the pastimes in that period) **ati-suvistṛtā** (are very extensive).

Studying grammar with Paṇḍita Gaṅgādāsa —

5 He studied grammar with Gaṅgādāsa Paṇḍita, and as soon as He heard the sūtras and their commentaries, He knew them all by heart.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

First He received His elementary education from Viṣṇu and Sudarśana, and then He studied grammar with Gaṅgādāsa Paṇḍita.

Mastery within a short time —

6 Within a short time He mastered the *Pañjī-ṭīkā*, and, young as He was, He defeated students who had studied for years.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Pañjī-ṭīkā: there was a well-known commentary on grammar called the *Pañjī-ṭīkā*, and Mahāprabhu composed glosses (*ṭippanī*) on it.

7 In the *Caitanya-maṅgala* Vṛndāvana dāsa has described in detail the Lord's pastimes as a student.[2]

Anubhāṣya.

See the *Caitanya-bhāgavata*, Ādi, Chapters 4, 6, 7, 8, 9 and 10.

8 One day the Lord bowed at His mother's feet and said, "Mother, grant Me one gift."

He leads Mother Śacī to keep the Ekādaśī vow —

9 "I will give You whatever You ask," said His mother, and the Lord replied, "Do not eat grain on Ekādaśī."

Anubhāṣya.

Śrī Jīva Prabhu in the *Bhakti-sandarbha* (section 299): "In the *Skanda Purāṇa*: 'One who eats on Ekādaśī is a killer of his mother, a killer of his father, a killer of his brother and a killer of his guru; he falls from Viṣṇuloka.' Here fasting (*nirāhāratva*) for Vaiṣṇavas means only giving up the *mahā-prasāda* grain (*anna*), since eating anything else is always forbidden to them. In the *Agni Purāṇa*: 'One should not eat on Ekādaśī; this vow is the great vow of the Vaiṣṇavas.' This shows, first of all, that it is obligatory even for a non-Vaiṣṇava."

Vaiṣṇavas never accept anything but *mahā-prasāda*, on any day or at any time. But on the day of Ekādaśī, giving up *mahā-prasāda* is precisely what is called "fasting" (*upavāsa*).

10 Śacī said, “I will not eat it. You have spoken well.” And from that day on she observed Ekādaśī.

A bride is sought for Viśvarūpa —

11 Then Miśra, seeing that Viśvarūpa had come of age, resolved to find Him a bride and see Him married.

*Viśvarūpa accepts *sannyāsa* —*

12 When Viśvarūpa heard of this, He fled from home. He took sannyāsa and set out on pilgrimage to the holy places.

The grief of Śacī and Miśra; the Lord consoles them —

13 The news filled the hearts of Śacī and Miśra with sorrow, and the Lord set about consoling His mother and father.

*When a son takes *sannyāsa* to serve Kṛṣṇa, the families of his mother and father are delivered —*

14 “It is well that Viśvarūpa has taken sannyāsa: He has delivered both His father’s line and His mother’s.

Consoled by the Lord, His parents are content —

15 “And I Myself will serve you both.” Hearing this, His father and mother were content at heart.

The Lord loses consciousness —

16 One day, after chewing betel that had been offered to the Deity, the Lord fell to the ground unconscious.

*The meeting with Viśvarūpa and their conversation about the Lord's *sannyāsa* —*

17 His father and mother hastily sprinkled water on His face, and when He came to Himself, the Lord told them a wondrous tale.

18 “Viśvarūpa took Me away from here and said to Me, ‘You must take sannyāsa.’

19 “I answered, ‘My father and mother have no one to look after them, and I am still a boy — what do I know of sannyāsa?

20 “ ‘As a householder I shall serve My father and mother, and this will please Lakṣmī-Nārāyaṇa.’

21 “Then Viśvarūpa sent Me back here and asked Me to convey His obeisances to Mother, millions upon millions of them.”

22 Thus Gaurahari revels in many pastimes, and why He does so, I cannot understand.

Miśra's departure —

23 Some time later Miśra left this world, and grief welled up in the hearts of mother and son.

Anubhāṣya.

The *Caitanya-bhāgavata* (Ādi, Chapter 8): “Some days passed in this way, and then the eternally perfect body of the best of Miśras departed from this world. At Miśra's departure the Lord wept bitterly, as the best of the Raghus wept at Daśaratha's departure. All this is full of the *rasa* of sorrow; to tell it in detail is painful, so I have told it briefly.”

The Lord performs the rites for His father —

24 Friends and kinsmen came and consoled them both, and the Lord performed His father's funeral rites as the scriptures enjoin.

The wish to enact the pastimes of household life —

25 After a while the Lord thought to Himself, "I have become a householder; now I must take up the duties of household life.

The wife is the home —

26 "Yet without a wife household life has no grace." Thinking thus, He set His mind on marriage.

*[Words of *smṛti* (of the Lord?)]*

27 "It is not the house that is called the home; the wife is called the home. Together with her one attains all the goals of life."

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
It is not the house that is called "home"; the mistress of the house is called "home." Together with her one will enjoy all the goals of human life (*puruṣārthas*).

Thus ends the fifteenth chapter of the "Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya."

Anubhāṣya.
gṛham (the dwelling building) **gṛhaṁ na**, **gṛhiṇī** (the mistress who presides over the house, one's partner in *dharma*) **eva gṛham ucyate**. **tayā** (with the wife) **sahitaḥ** (united) (a man) **sarvān puruṣārthān** (all the four goals — *dharma*, *artha*, *kāma*, *mokṣa* and the rest) **samaśnute** (attains). See the *Mahābhārata*, *Śānti-parva*, Chapter 144, verse 6.

The meeting with Lakṣmī-devī —

28 One day, by providence, as the Lord was coming home from His studies, He saw the daughter of Vallabhācārya on the way to the Gaṅgā.

Vanamālī Paṇḍita as matchmaker —

29 The love that had been theirs from of old awoke in them both, and, as providence would have it, Vanamālī the matchmaker came to Śacī's house.

Anubhāṣya.

Vanamālī the matchmaker (*ghaṭaka*) was a brāhmaṇa living in Navadvīpa. He arranged Mahāprabhu's marriage. *Gaura-gaṇoddeśa-dīpikā* (49): "Viśvāmitra, who was the matchmaker at Śrī Rāma's wedding, and the brāhmaṇa whom Rukmiṇī sent to Śrī Keśava — both are now this Vanamālī, who by his deed attained the title of ācārya."

The match and the Lord's marriage to Lakṣmī-devī —

30 At a sign from Śacī he arranged the match, and her son married Lakṣmī.

*The *Caitanya-bhāgavata* describes the *paugaṇḍa* pastimes in detail —*

31 Vṛndāvana dāsa has described all this in detail; here I have set out the boyhood pastimes in outline.

Anubhāṣya.

See the *Caitanya-bhāgavata*, Ādi, Chapter 10. The *Caitanya-bhāgavata* (Ādi, Chapter 8) describes in more detail the sacred-thread ceremony (*upanayana*) and the Lord's gift of gold to His mother.

Thus ends the fifteenth chapter of the "Anubhāṣya."

32 The Lord's boyhood holds pastimes of many kinds, and Vṛndāvana dāsa has told them at length.

33 Therefore I have given here no more than a glimpse of them; through the *Caitanya-maṅgala* they have become famous throughout the world.

34 Praying at the feet of Śrī Rūpa and Śrī Raghunātha, I, Kṛṣṇadāsa, narrate the *Caitanya-caritāmṛta*.

Notes

1. A play on words: *sumanas* means both “flower” and “good mind”. ↩
2. *Caitanya-maṅgala* is the original title of the *Caitanya-bhāgavata* (cf. Ādi 8.33–35). ↩
3. Purandara Miśra is another name of Jagannātha Miśra, the Lord's father. ↩
4. A play on words: *sumanas* means both “flower” and “good mind.” ↩

“Śrī Caitanya-caritāmṛta”

Ādi-līlā

Chapter 16

A Brief Description of the Youthful Pastimes

(English translation from the Bengali, following the Gauḍīya Maṭha edition and the «Anubhāṣya», 2026 — draft)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya

Summary. The sixteenth chapter describes Mahāprabhu's pastimes in His youth (*kaiśora*): He teaches, defeats the *paṇḍitas*, sports in the waters of the Jāhnavī, travels to Vaṅga (East Bengal) to gather funds, holds learned debates there and leads *nāma-saṅkīrtana*, meets Tapana Miśra, instructs him about *sādhya* and *sādhana*, and orders him to go to Vārāṇasī. While Mahāprabhu was conquering Vaṅga, Lakṣmī-devī, on the pretext of a snakebite, departed for Vaikuṇṭha. The Lord returned home and consoled Śacīdevī with knowledge of the truth (*tattva-jñāna*). Then He married Viṣṇupriyā. He spoke with the *digvijayī* (conqueror of all directions) Keśava Kāśmīrī, examined his verse on the glory of the Gaṅgā, showed in it five poetic ornaments and excellences and five faults, and crushed his pride. That night the *digvijayī* poet learned from Sarasvatī who the Lord truly is, and the next morning he surrendered to Him.

Gaurahari, ever intent on mercy —

1 I worship Caitanya Prabhu. The river of His nectarean mercy floods the whole universe, and yet, like every river, it always flows downward — to the lowly.[1]

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

The river of the nectar of His mercy floods the whole world, yet it always appears to flow downward (*nīca-gā*). I worship that Lord Caitanya.

Anubhāṣya.

yasya (Caitanyadeva's) **kṛpā-sudhā-sarit** (river of the nectar of mercy) **viśvam** (the world, *saṁsāra*) **āplāvayantī** (submerging) **api**, **sadā nīca-gā** (flowing downward, that is, full of compassion for the humble, who have neither wealth nor anything of their own) **bhāti** (is manifest), **taṁ caitanya-prabhum** (I) **bhaje**.

2 Glory, glory to Śrī Caitanya! Glory to Nityānanda! Glory to Advaitacandra! Glory to all the devotees of Gaura!

Gaurahari, worshipped by Lakṣmī and Sarasvatī —

3 Glory to Caitanya in His youth! When He entered household life, Lakṣmī herself served Him in visible form; and then Sarasvatī, the goddess of speech, worshipped Him as well, taking His victory over the conqueror of all directions as her occasion.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

All glory to the youthful Caitanyadeva! Lakṣmī-devī in person, who had come to His home, worshipped Him, and the goddess of speech worshipped Him on the pretext of the *digvijayī*'s defeat.

Anubhāṣya.

gṛhāśramāt (having entered household life, the *gṛhastha-āśrama*) **mūrti-matyā** (embodied) **lakṣmyā arcitaḥ** (served), **atha diśāṁ jayi-jaya-cchalāt** (on the pretext of the victory over the *digvijayī*, the scholar named Keśava Kāśmīrī) **vāg-devyā** (by Sarasvatī) **arcitaḥ** (honored) **kaiśora-caitanyaḥ** (Caitanya at the age of *kiśora*) **jīyāt**.

*The pastimes of youth (*kaiśora*) —*

4 Here, in outline, are the pastimes of His youth. He began to teach students of His own.

Anubhāṣya.

***Kaiśora*.** The age from eleven to fifteen years is called *kiśora*; *kaiśora* means what belongs to that age.

Nimāi's teaching amazes everyone —

5 He taught constantly, with hundreds of students around Him, and all who heard His explanations were amazed.

*The *paṇḍitas* are pleased even when defeated by Nimāi —*

6 In every branch of learning every paṇḍita met defeat at His hands, yet His manner was so courteous that no one was hurt.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
The Lord defeated the *paṇḍitas* in every *śāstra*, but His humility was so skillful that the *paṇḍitas* were not hurt.

7 With His students He played all kinds of pranks, and they sported merrily in the waters of the Gaṅgā.

*The journey to East Bengal and the launching of *nāma-saṅkīrtana* —*

8 After some time the Lord went to East Bengal, and wherever He went He had the people take up the chanting of the holy name.

Hearing of the Lord's fame for learning, many students come to study —

9 Seeing the power of His learning, hundreds of students came in wonder to study with Him.

*Tapana Miśra meets the Lord and asks about the truth of *sādhya* and *sādhana* —*

10 In that land lived a brāhmaṇa named Tapana Miśra, who could not settle what the goal of life is and how it is reached.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
***Sādhya* and *sādhana*.** What one attains through *sādhana* is called *sādhya*, the goal. The means by which one attains the goal is called *sādhana*.

*The many views of many sages in many *śāstras* bewilder the mind —*

11 Many scriptures and many opinions had confused his mind, and he could not decide which goal is highest and which means is best.

Anubhāṣya.

(*Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 7.13.8): "…He should not study many books… he should not live by expounding [the scriptures]…" That is, one should not master many books and arts, nor make a living by expounding the *śāstras*. Whoever seeks the highest good (whoever wishes to serve the Lord) must first give up this temptation. (*Bhakti-rasāmṛta-sindhu*, Pūrva, second wave.)

(*Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 11.21.30, 36): "People whose minds are bewildered by such flowery speech, who are proud and very greedy, find no taste even in talk about Me. The Veda in sound is very hard to understand; it is manifest in the vital air, the senses and the mind; it is boundless, deep and unfathomable, like the ocean."

This means the following. The merchants of the *śāstras*, who support the *karma-kāṇḍa* and the *jñāna-kāṇḍa*, speak words honey-sweet and flowery (charming), yet hostile to selfless devotion to the Lord, full of envy and aimed at enjoying fruits. Hearing or reading such words, inexperienced and fickle people of weak faith cannot grasp the supreme greatness and beauty of devotion to Kṛṣṇa and love for Kṛṣṇa, the *jīva*'s eternal *sādhana* and eternal *sādhya*. Turned away [from the Lord] since time without beginning, they very easily submit to the *karmīs* and *jñānīs*, and lose the mercy of the pure devotee of Kṛṣṇa, the *jīva*'s well-wisher, who is free from envy. So, lacking the pious merit (*sukṛti*) that turns one toward *bhakti*, they are flung far from pure *bhakti*, the only path to eternal good, and at last reach endless misfortune and the utmost misery. When Śrī Gaurasundara in Vārāṇasī expounded the truth of *sādhya* and *sādhana* in answer to the questions of Śrī Sanātana Gosvāmī Prabhu, Tapana Miśra was present there. He heard the Lord and found the answer to his doubts. For the good of ignorant *jīvas* who follow many *śāstras* and many gurus, Mahāprabhu taught a lesson through the example of His devotee Tapana Miśra (by resolving his doubts).

In a dream a brāhmaṇa advises him to ask Nimāi Paṇḍita about the truth —

12 In a dream a brāhmaṇa said to him, “Listen, Tapana. Go to Nimāi Paṇḍita.

13 He will settle for you the goal and the means. He is the Lord Himself — have no doubt of it.”

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

The *śāstras* are many, and what each of them defines as *sādhya* and as *sādhana* turns out to differ. Whoever sets out to read many *śāstras* cannot decide which *sādhya* is best and which *sādhana* is best, and his mind falls into confusion. Tapana Miśra's mind was confused in just this way, and so in a dream he was told to go to Nimāi Paṇḍita and become certain of *sādhya* and *sādhana* from Him. In the dream Miśra was also told: “Have no doubt: Nimāi Paṇḍita is the Lord (Īśvara) Himself.”

He tells the Lord about his dream —

14 After this dream Miśra came to the Lord’s feet and told Him all that he had dreamt.

*The Lord proclaims Hari's holy name to be both *sādhya* and *sādhana* —*

15 Pleased with him, the Lord explained the goal and the means, and instructed him: “Chant the holy name.”

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

The Lord said: “Neither knowledge of Brahman as undifferentiated oneness nor enjoyment (*bhukti*) in heaven and other worlds is the goal (*sādhya*) of the *jīva*. The *jīva*'s only goal is love for Kṛṣṇa. *Karma* and *jñāna* are not the *sādhana*, the means of attaining that goal. The only means of attaining it is pure *bhakti* that takes shelter of Kṛṣṇa's name.”

The Lord orders him to go to Kāśī —

16 He wished to live with the Lord in Navadvīpa, but the Lord told him, “Go to Vārāṇasī.

17 There we shall meet again.” Receiving this order, Miśra went to Kāśī.

*The good fortune to come: serving the Lord in Kāśī, and hearing from the Lord's own lips, in answer to Śrī Sanātana's questions, the full resolution of the truth of *sādhya* and *sādhana* —*

18 The Lord’s pastimes are endless and beyond my understanding. Why did He send Miśra away from His company to Kāśī?

Good for all the people of East Bengal —

19 In this way the Lord did good to all the people of East Bengal: giving them the holy name He made them devotees, and teaching them He made them paṇḍitas.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

“Giving the name”: that is, by giving Kṛṣṇa's name — “Hare Kṛṣṇa Hare Kṛṣṇa Kṛṣṇa Kṛṣṇa Hare Hare / Hare Rāma Hare Rāma Rāma Rāma Hare Hare” — the Lord made the people of Vaṅga devotees, and by teaching them the *śāstras* He made many of them *paṇḍitas*.

20 While the Lord enjoyed these many pastimes in East Bengal, here in Navadvīpa Lakṣmī grieved in separation from Him.

Bitten by the black snake of separation from the Lord, Lakṣmī departs from the manifest pastimes —

21 The snake of separation from the Lord bit Lakṣmī, and by its poison she passed from this world.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

The pain of separation from the Lord took the form of a snake and bit Lakṣmī. Then she went to the “other world” (*para-loka*), that is, to her own abode Vaikuṇṭha, the best of all worlds.

The Lord, who knows all hearts, returns home —

22 Dwelling in every heart, the Lord knew of it; and, aware of Śacī's grief, He returned home.

Hearing the knowledge of truth from the Lord's lips, Śacī finds her grief eased —

23 He came home with much wealth and many followers, and by speaking of the truth He freed Śacī from her grief.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

"Telling the truth": another reading has "with the net of truth." The Lord cast a net of knowledge of the truth — "'Who is whose husband, whose son…,' that is, who is anyone's husband, who anyone's son, who anyone's wife" — and freed Śacī from her grief.

The Lord delights in learning —

24 Again He gathered His students and delighted in the play of learning; by the power of His knowledge He conquered everyone and showed a proud spirit.

*Marriage to Śrī Viṣṇupriyā, daughter of the royal *paṇḍita* Sanātana, and the defeat of Keśava Kāśmīrī —*

25 Then came His marriage to Viṣṇupriyā Ṭhākurāṇī, and after that the Lord's victory over the *digvijayī*, the conqueror of all directions.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

The *digvijayī* was a *paṇḍita* from Kashmir named Keśava Miśra. After being taught by Mahāprabhu he became an *ācārya* in the sampradāya of Śrī Nimbāditya and wrote a gloss (*ṭippanī*) on the commentaries Nimbāditya composed, the *Vedānta-pārijāta* and others.

Anubhāṣya.

The *digvijayī* was a *paṇḍita* from Kashmir named Keśava. At that time he was traveling through various parts of Bhāratavarṣa, intent on conquering the *paṇḍitas* by his genius, and at last he came to Gauḍa-deśa, to Navadvīpa. After

his defeat by Śrī Gaurasundara he came to know who Śrīman Mahāprabhu truly is, and in order to serve the Lord he entered the Nimbārka sampradāya. He wrote a gloss (*ṭippanī*) called *Kaustubha-prabhā* on the *Vedānta-kaustubha*, Śrīnivāsācārya's commentary on the *Pārijāta-bhāṣya* that Nimbārka composed on the *Vedānta-darśana*. The *Bhakti-ratnākara*, in its twelfth wave, says: "The disciplic succession of Nimbāditya: 1. Śrīnivāsācārya, 2. Viśvācārya, 3. Puruṣottama, 4. Vilāsa, 5. Svarūpa, 6. Mādhava, 7. Balabhadra, 8. Padma, 9. Śyāma, 10. Gopāla, 11. Kṛpā, 12. Devācārya, 13. Sundara Bhaṭṭa, 14. Padmanābha, 15. Upendra, 16. Rāmacandra, 17. Vāmana, 18. Kṛṣṇa, 19. Padmākara, 20. Śravaṇa, 21. Bhūri, 22. Mādhava, 23. Śyāma, 24. Gopāla, 25. Balabhadra, 26. Gopīnātha, 27. Keśava, 28. Gokula, 29. Keśava Kāśmīrī." And again in the *Bhakti-ratnākara*: "He chanted the *mantra* of the goddess Sarasvatī; all learning was revealed to him, and his power grew. Having conquered all directions, he became famous as the '*digvijayī*.' He was from Kashmir, a most cultured brāhmaṇa. Giving up everything, he departed by the Lord's order. Having described *līlā-bhoga* (?), under the name 'Laghu-Keśava.'"[7] See the *Vaiṣṇava-mañjuṣā* (issue 1).

Honor to Ṭhākura Vṛndāvana dāsa —

26 Vṛndāvana dāsa has described all this at length, but he did not set out clearly the merits and faults of the *digvijayī*'s verse.

Examining the merits and faults of Keśava Kāśmīrī's verse —

27 Bowing to him, I shall tell of that analysis; hearing it, the *digvijayī* cursed himself.

*How the *digvijayī* was defeated. The *digvijayī* arrives —*

28 One moonlit night the Lord sat with His students on the bank of the Gaṅgā, discussing points of learning.

29 Just then the *digvijayī* came there and, after offering his prayers to the Gaṅgā, met the Lord.

*The Lord honors others (*mānada-dharma*) —*

30 The Lord received him with respect and gave him a seat, but the *digvijayī* spoke with disdain in his heart:

*Out of pride the *digvijayī* shows contempt for the Lord —*

31 “You teach grammar, and Your name is Nimāi Paṇḍita. People praise Your skill in the science that children learn.

Anubhāṣya.

Bālya-śāstra means grammar, because the accepted rule is to study grammar for a knowledge of the language before studying any other *śāstra*.

32 Of the grammars, I know, You teach the *Kalāpa*, and I have heard of Your students’ debates on its tricky points.”

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

“You teach the grammar called *Kalāpa*. And I have heard that your students hold discussions (*saṁlāpa*), that is, special conversations, about the *phāṅki* of grammar, that is, about intricate questions.”

The Lord's humble words and His request to praise the Gaṅgā —

33 The Lord said, “Yes, I teach grammar — or so I like to think. But My students do not understand, and I cannot explain it to them.

34 “How far above Me you are! You are expert in every śāstra and in poetry, while I am only a child, a new student.

35 “I should like to hear some of your poetry. Be kind enough, if you will, to describe the Gaṅgā.”

*The *digvijayī* praises the Gaṅgā in a hundred verses —*

36 Hearing this, the brāhmaṇa proudly began, and within one *ghaṭī* he described the Gaṅgā in a hundred verses.[2]

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

"*Ghaṭī eke*": within one *ghaṭikā*[6].

The Lord praises him and shows him respect —

37 When He had heard them, the Lord honoured him highly: "There is no other poet in the world like you!

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

"*Karila sat-kāra*": He showed respect.

38 "Who has the power to understand your verses? You alone know their meaning well — you, or Sarasvatī.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

"*Kiṁbā*": that is, *kibā*, "or."

The request to explain one verse of the hymn —

39 "If you would explain the meaning of one verse yourself, everyone here would be delighted to hear it."

*The Lord, whose memory is beyond this world (*śrutidhara*), recites one verse out of the hundred —*

40 The *digvijayī* asked which verse he should explain, and the Lord recited one of the hundred.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

He asked which verse he should explain.

Keśava Kāśmīrī's verse on the glory of the Gaṅgā —

41 "This greatness of the Gaṅgā ever shines beyond compare, for she is blessed by her birth from the lotus feet of Śrī Viṣṇu. Like a second Śrī Lakṣmī, she receives the worship of gods and men; and upon the head of Bhavānī's husband she reigns, endowed with wondrous qualities."

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

The glory of this Gaṅgā-devī always shines, because she is supremely blessed. She was born from the lotus feet of Śrī Viṣṇu, and, like a second form of Lakṣmī-devī, she is the one whose feet gods and men worship. Endowed with wonderful qualities, she has risen above Mahādeva, the husband of Bhavānī.

Anubhāṣya.

gaṅgāyāḥ idam mahattvam satatam (always) **nitarām** (beyond doubt) **ābhāti** (shines); **yat** (because) **eṣā** (the Gaṅgā) **śrī-viṣṇoś caraṇa-kamalotpatti-subhagā** (she was born [*utpatti*, creation] from the lotus feet of Śrī Viṣṇu, that is, from the Lord's lotus feet, and by this her *bhaga*, her majesty, is beautiful; such is she), **dvitīya-śrī-lakṣmīr iva** (like a second Kamalā, endowed with beauty) **sura-naraiḥ** (by gods, men and others) **arcya-caraṇā** (she whose feet are served), **bhavānī-bhartuḥ** (of Bhavānī's *bhartā*, husband, that is, of Giriśa, Bhava) **śirasi** (on the head) **yā** (she who, the Gaṅgā) **vibhavati** (reigns); **ataḥ** (therefore) (she is) **adbhuta-guṇā** (endowed with wonderful qualities).

42 When the Lord said, “Explain this verse,” the *digvijayī* asked Him in astonishment:

*Seeing the Lord's power of memory, the *digvijayī* is amazed and asks —*

43 “I recited those verses like a storm wind. How could You learn one of them by heart?”

The Lord's humble reply —

44 The Lord said, “By the boon of a deity you are the best of poets; and by the boon of a deity another may become a *śruti-dhara*, one who holds all that he hears.”

*The *digvijayī*'s explanation —*

45 Well pleased, the brāhmaṇa explained the verse. Then the Lord said, “Tell Me, what are the merits and faults of this verse?”

At the Lord's request he declares his verse faultless and describes its merits —

46 The brāhmaṇa said, “No fault appears in it. Its merits are the ornament of simile and some alliteration.”

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Upamā-alaṅkāra, the ornament of simile: to display a poetic excellence by giving a comparison (*upamā*). ***Anuprāsa***, alliteration: the art of sound shown in the last line by placing many *bh*'s close together.

The Lord's words and the poet's reply —

47 The Lord said, “May I say something, if you will not be angry? Tell Me what faults there are in this verse of yours.

The Lord praises him and asks him to examine the merits and faults of the verse —

48 “Your words, full of genius, please even the gods; yet if they are examined well, both merits and faults come to light.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

The mental power to arrange speech in ever new ways is called *pratibhā*, poetic genius. By showing such a mind in this verse you have pleased even the gods; that is, your genius is richly displayed in these words. But if the verse is examined well, both its merits and its faults will come to light.

49 “So let us examine the verse carefully.” The poet replied, “The verse You have recited is the very essence of the Vedas.

*Thinking the Lord ignorant of the taste of poetry, the *digvijayī* mocks Him —*

50 “You are only a grammarian; You have not studied poetics. What can You know of the essence of this poetry?”

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

“*Vaiyākaraṇa*”: that is, a grammarian, expert (only) in the learning meant for children and unable to examine poetics (*alaṅkāra*) and other *śāstras*.

The Lord's words —

51 The Lord said, “That is just why I ask you. Examine its merits and faults and explain them to Me.

52 “I have not studied poetics, but I have heard it taught, and so I see many faults and merits in this verse.”

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
“I have not studied poetics, but I have heard about it from the lips of *paṇḍitas*. That is why I see many faults and merits in this verse.”

At the poet's request the Lord examines the merits and faults of the verse —

53 “Come, then,” said the poet, “tell me — what merits and faults?” The Lord replied, “I shall tell you; listen, and do not be angry.

Five faults and five merits —

54 “In this verse there are five faults and five ornaments. I shall name them in order; listen, and judge for yourself.

The five faults of the verse. The first fault explained —

55 “In two places the predicate is badly placed, and there are three more faults: a contradictory sense, a broken order, and a return to a finished sentence.[3]

56 “In this verse the main predicate is ‘the greatness of the Gaṅgā’, while the subject, expressed by the word *idam*, ‘this’, comes after it.[4]

57 “You stated the predicate first and the subject afterwards, and so the meaning of the verse has suffered.

58 ‘One should not state the predicate without first stating the subject; for nothing that has not found its footing can stand anywhere.’ (Ekādaśī-tattva,

13)[5]

Anubhāṣya.
See Ādi 2.74.

The second fault explained —

59 “In *dvitīya-śrī-lakṣmī*, ‘a second Śrī Lakṣmī’, the predicate is ‘being second’; but in the compound it has become secondary, and the meaning of the word is lost.

60 “The word *dvitīya* is the predicate, but it has fallen into a compound, and so the point — that the Gaṅgā is equal to Lakṣmī — is destroyed.

61 “This fault is called *avimṛṣṭa-vidheyāṁśa*. Now listen attentively to another.

The third fault explained —

62 “With great satisfaction you used the words *bhavānī-bhartuḥ*, ‘of Bhavānī’s husband’. But this is a grave fault, called *viruddha-mati-kṛt*: such words suggest a contradictory sense.

63 “The word *Bhavānī* means the wife of Mahādeva. When you name her husband, it sounds as if she had another husband.

64 “‘The husband of Śiva’s wife’ sounds absurd; by the rules of the śāstra, words that suggest a contradictory sense are faulty.

Another example of the same —

65 “If one says, ‘Give the gift into the hand of the brāhmaṇa’s wife’s husband,’ the very words make one think of a second husband.

The fourth fault explained —

66 “The sentence is complete with the verb *vibhavati*, ‘reigns’, and then you add another epithet, *adbhuta-guṇā*, ‘endowed with wondrous qualities’. This return to a finished sentence is the fault called *punar-ātta*.

The fifth fault explained[8] *—*

67 “In three lines I see matchless alliteration, but in one line there is none; this fault is called *bhagna-krama*.

The five faults ruin the glory of the verse —

68 “Though the verse has five ornaments, these five faults have ruined it.

69 “Even if a verse had ten ornaments, a single fault would bring them all to nothing.

A comparison —

70 “It is like a beautiful body adorned with jewels: one spot of white leprosy disgraces it.

Anubhāṣya.
Vigīta: condemned.

71 ‘As a body, though beautiful and adorned, is made unsightly by a single spot of white leprosy, so poetry rich in rasa and ornaments loses all its charm if it has a fault.’ (Bharata Muni)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
A beautiful, adorned body becomes unsightly when it has a patch of white leprosy (*śvitra*). In the same way poetry endowed with *rasa* and ornaments becomes unsightly if it has a fault.

Anubhāṣya.
vibhūṣitam (fully adorned) **sundaram** (charming) **api vapuḥ** (body) **yathā ekena śvitreṇa** (by the disease called white leprosy) **durbhagam** (bereft of beauty,

sullied) **syāt**, **tathā rasālaṅkāra-vat kāvyam** (*rasa*: *śṛṅgāra* and the rest; *alaṅkāra*: *anuprāsa*, *upamā* and the rest; *kāvya* endowed with them, speech whose soul is *rasa*) **cet** (if) **doṣa-yuk bhavati**, **tathā durbhagam** (bereft of beauty) **jñeyam**.

The five merits of the verse —

72 "Now hear the analysis of the five ornaments: two are verbal ornaments and three are ornaments of meaning.

The first and second merits, both ornaments of sound —

73 "The first verbal ornament is the alliteration in three lines; the second is the seeming repetition (*punar-uktavad-ābhāsa*) in the words *śrī-lakṣmī*.

74 "In the first line there is a row of five *ta*s, and in the third, five *ra*s.

75 "In the fourth line four *bha*s appear; this is the verbal ornament of alliteration.

76 "The words *śrī* and *lakṣmī* name one and the same thing; it seems almost a repetition, yet it is not one.

77 "For if *śrī-lakṣmī* is taken as 'Lakṣmī endowed with beauty (*śrī*)', the two words differ in meaning; and this seeming repetition is a kind of verbal ornament.

The third, fourth and fifth merits, all three ornaments of sense —

78 "The words *lakṣmīr iva*, 'like Lakṣmī', are an ornament of meaning: a simile. There is another ornament of meaning, called *virodhābhāsa*, apparent contradiction.

79 "Everyone knows that lotuses are born in the Gaṅgā; but to say that the Gaṅgā is born in a lotus is a flat contradiction.

80 “Yet here the Gaṅgā has her origin in the lotus feet of Viṣṇu, and this ornament of contradiction is wonderful indeed.

81 “The Gaṅgā appears by the inconceivable potency of the Lord, so there is no contradiction here — only the semblance of one.

Evidence of Kṛṣṇa's inconceivable energy (a verse spoken by the Lord Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya Himself) —

82 ‘The lotus is born in water; nowhere is water born from a lotus. But with the slayer of Mura it is the reverse: from His lotus feet the great river was born.’

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

A lotus is born only in water; water is never born from a lotus. But here is the wonder: in Śrī Kṛṣṇa the opposite is seen — from His lotus feet the great river Gaṅgā was born.

Anubhāṣya.

ambuni (in water) **ambujam** (the lotus) **jātam** (is born); **kvacit** (anywhere) **api ambujāt** (from a lotus) **ambu** (water) **na jātam**; (but) **mura-bhidi** (in Murāri, Kṛṣṇa) **tad-viparītam** (the opposite, the reversal of the [usual] relation of cause and effect) (is seen), **yataḥ** (from Kṛṣṇa's lotus feet) **mahā-nadī** (the Gaṅgā) **jātā** (flowed forth).

83 “The greatness of the Gaṅgā is what is to be proved, and the proof of it is her birth from the feet of Viṣṇu; this is the ornament called *anumāna*, inference.

84 “These are the five obvious faults and the five ornaments; examined more finely, they would be countless.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

The verse “*Mahattvaṁ gaṅgāyāḥ*” has five ornaments (*alaṅkāra*), which are its merits, and five faults (*doṣa*). In two places the fault is *avimṛṣṭa-vidheyāṁśa* (the *vidheya*, the new statement, is not properly set apart), and in three more

there are the faults *viruddha-mati* (creating a contradictory idea), *punarukti* (repetition) and *bhagna-krama* (broken order).

The first *avimṛṣṭa-vidheyāṁśa* fault is this. The main *vidheya* of the verse is the glory of the Gaṅgā, and the word *idam*, “this,” is the *anuvāda* (what is being spoken of, the already known). Here “the glory of the Gaṅgā” is written first and the word *idam* after it, and that is against the rules. If the *anuvāda*, the known subject, is not written first, the meaning suffers.

The second *avimṛṣṭa-vidheyāṁśa* fault is this. In the expression *dvitīya-śrī-lakṣmīr iva*, “like a second Śrī Lakṣmī,” the *vidheya*, the unknown, is “secondness” (*dvitīyatva*). It was placed first and made part of a compound (*samāsa*), and so the meaning became subordinate and was lost. For the point of the meaning was to show [the Gaṅgā's] equality with Lakṣmī, and the faulty compound destroyed it.

The third fault, *viruddha-mati-kṛt*, is seen in the word *bhavānī-bhartuḥ*, “of Bhavānī's husband.” In such usage the word *Bhavānī* means Mahādeva's wife, and the word *bhavānī-bhartā* gives rise to another idea, that of a second husband of Bhavānī. Such words taint poetry with the fault *viruddha-mati-kṛt*.

The fourth fault is this. The sentence ended with the verb *vibhavati*, “reigns,” and after it the epithet *adbhuta-guṇā*, “endowed with wonderful qualities,” is given. This is the fault *punar-ātta* (returning to a finished sentence).

The fifth fault is *bhagna-krama*. Three lines, the first, third and fourth, have alliteration on *t*, *r* and *bh*, but the second line has none. That is the fault *bhagna-krama*.

The verse has five ornaments and merits, yet these five faults have ruined it. If a verse has ten ornaments and even one fault, it is condemned (*vigīta*), like a beautiful body adorned with ornaments but marked by a white patch of leprosy.

Now I will speak of the merits. This verse of yours has two ornaments of sound (*śabdālaṅkāra*) and three ornaments of sense (*arthālaṅkāra*). (1) The alliteration in three lines is an ornament of sound. (2) The expression “Śrī Lakṣmī” is not the fault of repetition (*punarukti*): it is the ornament of sound *punarukta-vad-ābhāsa*, apparent repetition. If “Śrī” and “Lakṣmī” are taken as one and the same, there is no fault at all. If the sense is taken as “Lakṣmī endowed with beauty (*śrī*),” the meanings do differ, and there is no repetition: it is a special ornament of sound, *punarukta-vad-ābhāsa*. (3) The expression *lakṣmīr iva*, “like

Lakṣmī," is an ornament of sense, the simile (*upamālaṅkāra*). (4) There is one more ornament of sense, *virodhābhāsa*, apparent contradiction, in what is said of the Gaṅgā's birth from Viṣṇu's lotus feet. A lotus is born from water, but here water is born from a lotus; such contradictory words give rise to the ornament of contradiction (*virodha*). But the Gaṅgā appeared by the inconceivable energy of the Lord, so there is no contradiction here at all, only an "apparent contradiction," and that is the ornament. (5) The words that prove the *sādhya*, the glory of the Gaṅgā, that is, the words about her birth from Viṣṇu's feet, are the ornament *anumāna*, inference.

The Lord, who sees no faults in others, encourages the poet —

85 "Your genius and your poetic gift come by the grace of a deity; but into poetry composed without reflection faults are bound to creep.

Anubhāṣya.

If poetry is not examined, its faults are certainly not easy to see[9].

86 "With reflection, poetry becomes flawless, and when it is adorned with ornaments, its meaning sparkles."

*Amazed, the *digvijayī* reflects —*

87 Hearing the Lord's words, the *digvijayī* was astonished. No word came from his mouth; his genius was struck dumb.

88 He wanted to say something, but no answer would come, and in his perplexity he thought:

89 "A schoolboy has robbed me of my wits! Surely Sarasvatī is angry with me.

He concludes that the goddess of speech gave the Lord's extraordinary explanation —

90 “No human being could give such an explanation. Sarasvatī herself must be speaking through Nimāi’s mouth.”

The poet's words to the Lord —

91 Thinking thus, he said, “Listen, Nimāi Paṇḍita: Your explanation has astonished me.

92 “You have not studied poetics, and You have no training in the śāstras. How could You bring out all these meanings?”

93 Hearing this, Mahāprabhu, who dearly loved a jest, read his heart and answered playfully:

The Lord names Sarasvatī as the cause of His skillful explanation —

94 “Whether My analysis of the śāstras is good or bad, I Myself do not know. I only speak the words that Sarasvatī makes Me speak.”

*The *digvijayī* feels hurt by Sarasvatī —*

95 Hearing this, the *digvijayī* concluded, “The goddess has defeated me through a child.

96 “Today, with japa and meditation, I shall lay this before her: through a child she has humiliated me so!”

The author points out the real cause of what happened —

97 In truth, it was Sarasvatī who had him compose a faulty verse, and when it was examined she clouded his intelligence.

The students laugh at the poet's defeat, and the Lord stops them —

98 Then all the students began to laugh, but the Lord checked them and said to the poet:

The Lord honors the poet —

99 "You are a great paṇḍita, the crest-jewel of poets, for such poetry flows from your lips.

100 "Your poetry is like the stream of the Gaṅgā's waters; nowhere do I see another poet like you.

There are faults even in the poetry of Jayadeva, Kālidāsa and Bhavabhūti —

101 "Even in the poetry of Bhavabhūti, Jayadeva and Kālidāsa faults appear.

Anubhāṣya.

Bhavabhūti, or Śrīkaṇṭha, wrote the Sanskrit plays *Mālatī-mādhava*, *Uttara-carita*, *Vīra-carita* and others. He lived in the reign of King Bhoja. A resident of Padmanagara, he was the son of Nīlakaṇṭha and the grandson of a *śrotriya* brāhmaṇa of the Kāśyapa *gotra* named Bhaṭṭa Gopāla.

Kālidāsa was a great poet, one of the renowned "nine jewels" at the court of Emperor Vikramāditya. He wrote the *Raghu-vaṁśa*, *Kumāra-sambhava*, *Abhijñāna-śakuntala*, *Megha-dūta* and others, some thirty or forty Sanskrit epic poems, plays and works on other subjects.

Jayadeva: see Ādi 13.42.

The true merit is the very gift of composing verse —

102 "I count such analysis of faults and merits a small thing; what I praise is their power to compose poetry.

The Lord's humble words —

103 “Do not take My childish pranks to heart. I am not even fit to be your student.

The Lord courteously takes leave of him —

104 “Go to your lodging today; tomorrow we shall meet again, and I shall hear you expound the śāstras.”

At night the poet worships Sarasvatī —

105 So the two went home, and that night the poet worshipped Sarasvatī.

Instructed by Sarasvatī, he recognizes the Lord as the Supreme Lord Himself —

106 In the night Sarasvatī instructed him, and he came to know that Nimāi was the Lord Himself.

In the morning he takes shelter at the Lord's feet, and the Lord bestows mercy on him —

107 In the morning he came and took shelter at the Lord’s feet, and the Lord showed him mercy and cut his bonds.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Bandhana, bondage: the bondage of *māyā*, that is, pride in learning.

Thus ends the sixteenth chapter of the “Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.”

*The *digvijayī*'s pious merit (*sukṛti*) —*

108 The *digvijayī* was fortunate, and his life bore fruit: through his learning he attained the feet of Mahāprabhu.

Anubhāṣya.

Thus ends the sixteenth chapter of the “Anubhāṣya.”

109 Vṛndāvana dāsa has described all these pastimes; what little I have done here is to set out certain points more fully.

110 The pastimes of Caitanya Gosāñi are a stream of nectar: whoever hears them finds every sense fully satisfied.

111 Praying at the feet of Śrī Rūpa and Śrī Raghunātha, I, Kṛṣṇadāsa, narrate the *Caitanya-caritāmṛta*.

Notes

1. A play on words: *nīca-gā* means both “flowing downward” and “going to the lowly”. ↩
2. A *ghaṭī* (*ghaṭikā*) is a measure of time of twenty-four minutes. ↩
3. The names of the faults (*doṣa*) in the original: *avimṛṣṭa-vidheyāṁśa*, “the predicate not duly considered”, that is, what is asserted about the subject is badly placed (vv. 56–61); *viruddha-mati-kṛt*, “that which suggests a contradictory sense” (vv. 62–65); *punar-ātta*, “taken up again”: a return to a sentence already completed by its verb (v. 66); *bhagna-krama*, “broken order” (v. 67). ↩
4. *Vidheya*, the predicate, is what is asserted about a thing, the new matter for the hearer; *anuvāda*, the subject, is the thing itself, already known. ↩
5. The same verse is quoted in Ādi 2.74 (there *anuktvā tu*, here *anuktvaiva*, with the same meaning). ↩
6. A *ghaṭikā* is twenty-four minutes. ↩
7. Unclear passage: the edition reads “বর্ণি লীলাভোগ ‘লঘুকেশব’ নামেতে” (literally “having described *līlā-bhoga*, under the name ‘Laghu-Keśava’”); the meaning of *līlā-bhoga* and of the construction is unclear, and the translation is tentative. ↩
8. The edition has “পঞ্চ দোষের” (“of the five faults”), apparently for “পঞ্চম দোষের” (“of the fifth fault”). ↩
9. The verse translation reads otherwise: “into poetry composed without reflection faults are bound to creep.” ↩

A Brief Description of the Pastimes of Young Manhood

(English translation from the Bengali, following the Gauḍīya Maṭha edition and the «Anubhāṣya», 2026 — draft)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya

Summary. In the seventeenth chapter all of Mahāprabhu's pastimes, from His sixteenth year until He accepted *sannyāsa*, are written briefly, in the form of *sūtras*. The reason is that Vṛndāvana dāsa Ṭhākura, the incarnation of Vyāsa, has described all these pastimes in detail in the *Śrī Caitanya-bhāgavata*. But wherever Vṛndāvana dāsa Ṭhākura left something out, this chapter describes it more fully. The mango festival and Mahāprabhu's conversation with the Kāzī are told in particular detail. At the end the author shows that the son of Yaśodā, having become the son of Śacī, tasted the four kinds of devotional moods. To taste the sweetness of the *rasa* of Rādhā's *prema*, He accepted Rādhā's *bhāva* and took up the mood of the *gopīs* exclusively. Of all the kinds of devotional moods, the mood of the *gopīs* is the best, because in the mood of the *gopīs* no one but Vrajendranandana appears as worthy of worship. When Śrī Kṛṣṇa playfully became four-armed, the *gopīs* merely offered Him obeisance and withdrew: the ordinary mood of the *gopīs* rejects every form other than Kṛṣṇa's form, and no more. But the *bhāva* of Śrīmatī Rādhikā, the crown jewel of the *gopīs*, is the highest of all. On seeing Rādhā, Śrī Kṛṣṇa could not keep His four-armed form. Nanda, the lord of Vraja, is in this (Gaura) pastime the father, Jagannātha; Yaśodā, the queen of Vraja, is Śacīmātā. Caitanya Gosāñi is the son of Nanda Himself: He is not a *prakāśa* or a *vilāsa* of Nanda's son, but Nanda's son in person. Nityānanda Prabhu has three moods, *vātsalya*, *dāsya* and *sakhya*; Advaita Prabhu has two, *sakhya* and *dāsya*. All the others serve Mahāprabhu each according to his

former position. The Truth is one: now Kṛṣṇa in a dark form, the flute at His lips, sporting among the cowherds; now a brāhmaṇa; now, in the dress of a *sannyāsī*, Kṛṣṇa Caitanya in a golden form. The apparent contradiction is this: He who is Kṛṣṇa becomes a *gopī*. This idea is certainly very hard to grasp, but by Kṛṣṇa's inconceivable potency even this is possible. Arguing about it is futile, for to apply logic to what is inconceivable is the height of foolishness. At the end of this chapter Kavirāja Gosvāmī, following what Vyāsa did in the *Bhāgavata*, has separately recapitulated the seventeen chapters of the Ādi-līlā one by one.

By Gaura's grace even the impure become pure —

1 "I worship Śrī Caitanya, whose deeds are free and wondrous. By His grace even the yavanas, chanting the names of Kṛṣṇa, become saintly."

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

I worship Śrī Caitanyadeva, whose deeds are free and wonderful: by His grace even the *yavanas* become righteous and chant the name of Kṛṣṇa.

Anubhāṣya.

yat (of Caitanyadeva) **prasādataḥ** (by the compassion) **yavanāḥ** (the *mlecchas*) **kṛṣṇa-nāma-prajalpakāḥ** (being firmly devoted to chanting the name) **sumanāyante** (behave like people of good mind, *sumanas*), **taṁ svairādbhutehaṁ** (Him whose deeds are free, independent, and wonderful, beyond this world — Him who has the power to overstep the injunctions of the *smārtas*) **caitanyam ahaṁ vande**.

2 Glory, glory to Śrī Caitanya! Glory to Nityānanda! Glory to Advaitacandra! Glory to all the devotees of Gaura!

3 I have summed up the pastimes of His youth; now I shall outline, in order, those of His young manhood.

Various pastimes in youth —

4 "In His young manhood Gaura shone in His play — in learning and beauty, in fine attire and its enjoyments, in dance and kīrtana, and in the gift of love and the holy name."

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Through learning, beauty, fine dress, enjoyment, dancing, *kīrtana*, and the gift of *prema* and of the holy name, Gauracandra shone in His youth.

Anubhāṣya.

gauraḥ yauvane (when His fifteenth year had passed and youth appeared) **vidyā-saundarya-sad-veśa-sambhoga-nṛtya-kīrtanaiḥ** (with knowledge of the supreme goal, with beauty, with the dress of a sādhu, with the enjoyment of garments, garlands, sandalwood paste and the like, with dancing, *kīrtana* and so on) **prema-nāma-pradānaiḥ** (by distributing Kṛṣṇa's name together with *prema*) **dīvyati** (sports).

The pastimes of youth —

5 As He entered young manhood, ornaments graced every limb of His body, and He wore splendid clothes and finery, garlands and sandal paste.

6 In the pride of His learning He took no account of anyone; He defeated all the paṇḍitas and began to teach.

7 Under the pretext of a disorder of the vital airs (*vāyu*), He revealed His love, and with the devotees He enjoyed many pastimes.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Having finished His studies and His teaching, Gauracandra, to preach pure devotion, pretended for some days to suffer from a disorder of *vāyu* (the air in the body). Everywhere He explained Kṛṣṇa's name to His students and showed the connection with Kṛṣṇa in every *sūtra* of grammar — and in this way He began to turn them away from their studies.

Anubhāṣya.

See the *Caitanya-bhāgavata*, Ādi, Chapter 12.

Meeting Īśvara Purī in Gayā, and the pastime of taking initiation —

8 Then the Lord went to Gayā, and there He met Īśvara Purī.

Anubhāṣya.

See the *Caitanya-bhāgavata*, Ādi, Chapter 17.

9 After His initiation His love was revealed, and when He came home again, He gave Himself to the play of love.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Thinking, “I shall offer *śrāddha* at Gayā for My father, who has departed to the other world,” Mahāprabhu set out for Gayā with many students. On the way He was seized by fever; He drank water that had washed a brāhmaṇa's feet and was freed from the illness. By this pastime He showed that householders must honor brāhmaṇas. On reaching Gayā He accepted initiation into the Kṛṣṇa *mantra* from Śrī Īśvara Purī. From that initiation Mahāprabhu's *prema* began to manifest. Having finished His duties at Gayā, He returned to Śrī Dhāma Navadvīpa and began to preach *prema*.

Anubhāṣya.

See the *Caitanya-bhāgavata*, Ādi, Chapter 17, and Madhya, Chapter 1.

Pastimes in Navadvīpa after initiation; Advaita sees the universal form —

10 He gave love to Śacī; then He met Advaita, and Advaita beheld His universal form.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

One day Mahāprabhu, sitting on Viṣṇu's couch (*viṣṇu-khaṭṭā*) in Śrīvāsa's house, said that His mother had committed an offense against a Vaiṣṇava, Śrī Advaitācārya. Unless she sought forgiveness for that offense and Advaita forgave her, she would not attain loving devotion (*prema-bhakti*). Hearing this, the devotees brought Advaita Prabhu, and Śrī Advaita (as he sang the glories of Āi) was overcome by *prema*. Śacīdevī seized that moment, took the dust of his feet, and was freed from the offense. Then “the Lord, pleased, says to His mother: ‘Now you have devotion to Viṣṇu. There is no more offense against Advaita.’” From then on Śacīdevī had *prema-bhakti*.

One day Advaita, overcome by *prema*, said to the Lord in Śrīvāsa's courtyard, “Show me the universal form You once showed Arjuna.” And the Lord mercifully showed him the universal form.

Anubhāṣya.

The gift of *prema* to Śacī: see the *Caitanya-bhāgavata*, Madhya, Chapter 22; the meeting with Advaita: ibid., Madhya, Chapter 6; Advaita's vision of the universal form: ibid., Madhya, Chapter 24.

11 Then Śrīvāsa performed the Lord’s abhiṣeka, and the Lord, seated on the couch, revealed His majesty.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

One day in Śrīvāsa's house all the devotees together performed Mahāprabhu's *abhiṣeka*. Mahāprabhu sat on Viṣṇu's couch and displayed His majesty as the King of kings. Many devotees sang *kīrtana* at that time. And Advaita and the other devotees began to worship Mahāprabhu with the sixteen articles of worship. To each the Lord granted whatever boon he desired.

Anubhāṣya.

The Lord's *sāt-prahariyā bhāva* (the *bhāva* that lasted seven *praharas*) on Viṣṇu's couch in Śrīvāsa's house: see the *Caitanya-bhāgavata*, Madhya, Chapter 9.

Meeting Śrī Nityānanda —

12 Then Nityānanda Svarūpa came, and when He met the Lord, He was granted the vision of the six-armed form.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Śrī Nityānanda Prabhu was born in the village of “Ekacakrā” in the Birbhum district, as the son of Hāḍāi Paṇḍita, from the womb of Padmāvatī. When Nityānanda had grown a little, a *sannyāsī* came to Hāḍāi Paṇḍita and begged Nityānanda from him as alms. From then on Nityānanda traveled with that *sannyāsī* through many lands, came to the Mathurā-maṇḍala, and lived there a long time. Drawn by Mahāprabhu, Prabhu Nityānanda came to Śrī Navadvīpa and stayed in the house of Nandana Ācārya. Mahāprabhu and the devotees brought Nityānanda from there to His own place.

Anubhāṣya.

The meeting with Nityānanda: see the *Caitanya-bhāgavata*, Madhya, Chapter 3. How, at the Vyāsa-pūjā in Śrīvāsa's house, Nityānanda saw Mahāprabhu six-armed

(holding conch, disc, club, lotus, plough and pestle, *muṣala*): ibid., Madhya, Chapter 5.

The Lord shows Nitāi His six-armed, four-armed and two-armed forms —

13 First the Lord showed Him the six-armed form, holding conch, disc, club and lotus, the Śārṅga bow and the flute.

14 Then He became four-armed, His body bent in three places; with two hands He played the flute, and in the other two He held the conch and disc.

15 And then He was simply two-armed, with the flute at His lips: the son of Vraja's king, dark of body and dressed in yellow.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

One day Mahāprabhu showed Nityānanda Prabhu a six-armed form holding conch, disc, club, lotus, the Śārṅga bow and flute. Then He showed a four-armed form, holding conch and disc in two hands and the flute in the other two. Finally He showed the form of Śrī Kṛṣṇa holding the flute alone. (*Śrī Caitanya-maṅgala*, Madhya.)

Gaura Himself is Nityānanda-Balarāma —

16 Then Nityānanda Gosāñi performed the Vyāsa-pūjā, and the Lord, absorbed in the mood of Nityānanda, took up the club (*muṣala*).

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

By Mahāprabhu's order Śrī Nityānanda Prabhu resolved to perform the Vyāsa-pūjā on the full-moon night and had Śrīvāsa arrange the necessary articles. During the *saṅkīrtana*, Nityānanda Prabhu placed a flower garland around Mahāprabhu's neck. At that moment Nityānanda Prabhu saw the six-armed form. Nothing more of the Vyāsa-pūjā took place.

On the night before the Vyāsa-pūjā, during *saṅkīrtana* in Śrīvāsa's house, Mahāprabhu, in the mood of Balarāma, sat on Viṣṇu's couch and asked Nityānanda for the plough and the pestle (*muṣala*). Nityānanda Prabhu placed his own hand in His hand, and at that moment the devotees saw the plough and the pestle before their eyes.

Anubhāṣya.

Nityānanda's Vyāsa-pūjā and the Lord's taking up the pestle (*muṣala*): see the *Caitanya-bhāgavata*, Madhya, Chapter 5.

Śacī's dream, and the deliverance of Jagāi and Mādhāi —

17 Then Śacī saw the two brothers as Rāma and Kṛṣṇa, and after that the Lord delivered Jagāi and Mādhāi.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

One night Śacīdevī dreamed that Kṛṣṇa and Balarāma, the two Deities of her house, were snatching the offered food (*naivedya*) from each other together with Gaurāṅga and Nityānanda. The next day, by Gaurāṅga's wish, Śacīdevī invited Nityānanda to eat at her house. While Viśvambhara and Nityānanda were eating, Śacīdevī saw Kṛṣṇa and Balarāma Themselves eating, and at that sight she fainted in *prema*.

Jagāi and Mādhāi were born in Navadvīpa and were given to all kinds of sin. When Nityānanda and Haridāsa, by Mahāprabhu's order, went from house to house preaching the holy name, they incurred the anger of these two drunkards. The two, in a frenzy, chased them, and they fled. Another day Mādhāi struck Nityānanda on the head with a shard of a broken pot. Jagāi was somewhat sorry for that deed. Hearing of it, Mahāprabhu came there with His followers, ready to punish Jagāi and Mādhāi. But the merciful Gaurāṅga, hearing of Jagāi's decent conduct, embraced him with love. By seeing and touching the Lord, the two sinners had a change of heart, and the Lord delivered them by giving them the name of Hari.

Anubhāṣya.

Śacī's dream, in which she saw Nitāi and Gaura as Balarāma and Kṛṣṇa: see the *Caitanya-bhāgavata*, Madhya, Chapter 8; the deliverance of Jagāi and Mādhāi: the *Caitanya-bhāgavata*, Madhya, Chapter 13.

*The Lord's *sāt-prahariyā bhāva* —*

18 Then for seven praharas the Lord remained absorbed in ecstasy, and the devotees, wherever they were, beheld Him in a special way.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

One day in Śrīvāsa's house Mahāprabhu sat on Viṣṇu's couch, and the devotees, reciting the *Puruṣa-sūkta* — “The Puruṣa with a thousand heads, a thousand eyes, a thousand feet…” — performed His *abhiṣeka* with Gaṅgā water. They worshiped Him with various articles and gave Him many kinds of food to eat. The Lord began to eat everything the devotees offered. That day He remained in that *bhāva* for a full seven *praharas* and displayed the moods of all the avatāras. He revealed secret events from the devotees' past, dispelled everyone's doubts, and gave boons to all. Some call this *bhāva* the “*sāt-prahariyā bhāva*” (the *bhāva* that lasted seven *praharas*), and some the “*mahā-prakāśa*” (the great manifestation).

Anubhāṣya.

The Lord's seven-*prahara bhāva* in Śrīvāsa's house; how, during the *abhiṣeka* at that time, the Lord gave the name “Sukhī” (Happy) to a fortunate woman called “Duḥkhī” (Unhappy) who carried water; how Śrīdhara, the seller of banana leaves, saw the *mahā-prakāśa*; how Murāri Gupta saw the form of Rāma; the grace shown to Ṭhākura Haridāsa; how the Lord told Advaita the true meaning of the Gītā; the mercy shown to Mukunda, and so on: see the *Caitanya-bhāgavata*, Madhya, Chapter 9.

The mood of Varāha in Murāri's house —

19 In Murāri’s house the Lord became absorbed in the mood of Varāha, and climbing onto Murāri’s shoulders, He danced in the courtyard.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

One day Mahāprabhu, crying “Boar! Boar!”, Himself assumed the form of Varāha and entered Murāri Gupta's house. With His tusks He lifted a vessel full of water (a *gāḍu*), as He once lifted the earth, and drank the water. And another day the Lord climbed onto Murāri's shoulders and danced at length.

Anubhāṣya.

The Lord's absorption in the mood of Varāha in Murāri Gupta's house: see the *Caitanya-bhāgavata*, Madhya, Chapter 3.

*The Lord eats the rice Śuklāmbara gathered as *mādhukarī* alms —*

20 Then He ate the raw rice that Śuklāmbara had begged, and He explained the meaning of the verse *harer nāma*.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
Śuklāmbara Brahmacārī lived on the bank of the Gaṅgā in Śrī Navadvīpa. While Mahāprabhu was dancing, he arrived there with his bag of rice collected as alms. Out of love for His devotee, the Lord took that begged rice from his bag and began to eat it with great *prema*.

Anubhāṣya.
How the Lord ate the rice Śuklāmbara had gathered as alms: see the *Caitanya-bhāgavata*, Madhya, Chapter 16.

*Without the name of Hari the *jīva* has no other way — (*Bṛhan-nāradīya Purāṇa* 38.126)*

21 "The name of Hari, the name of Hari, the name of Hari alone! In the age of Kali there is no other way, there is no other way, there is no other way." (Bṛhan-nāradīya Purāṇa, 38.126)

Anubhāṣya.
See Ādi 7.76.

*Explanation of the verse *harer nāma* —*

22 In the age of Kali, Kṛṣṇa descends in the form of the holy name, and through the name the whole world is delivered.

23 For emphasis the words *harer nāma* are said three times, and the word *eva* is added again to make dull people understand.

24 The word *kevala* ("alone") makes it certain once more, and rules out knowledge, yoga, austerity, karma and all the rest.

25 Whoever thinks otherwise has no deliverance: that is why "there is not" is said three times with *eva*.

How to chant the name —

26 Thinking oneself lower than the grass, one should always chant the name, seeking no honour for oneself and giving honour to others.

27 A Vaiṣṇava should be as tolerant as a tree; scolded or beaten, he should say nothing to anyone.

28 A tree says nothing even when it is cut down; it may wither and die, yet it never asks for water.

29 So a Vaiṣṇava should ask nothing of anyone; he should live on what comes unasked, or eat greens and fruit.

30 He should always chant the name and be content with whatever comes. Such conduct nourishes the dharma of devotion.

Anubhāṣya.
See Antya 20.22–26.

*Words from His own lips — (a verse of the *Śikṣāṣṭaka* spoken by Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanyacandra)*

31 "Lower than a blade of grass, more tolerant than a tree, seeking no honour and offering honour to others, one should always sing the glories of Hari." (Śikṣāṣṭaka, 3)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
One who considers himself lower than grass, who is tolerant like a tree, who seeks no honor himself and gives honor to others — he alone is qualified to chant about Hari always.

Anubhāṣya.
tṛṇād api (than even grass, which all feet trample and which has no importance at all) **su-nīcena** (lower in every way, that is, endowed with a mood free of worldly claims to prestige) **taror api**[7] (than even a tree) **sahiṣṇunā** (by a person endowed with tolerance) **amāninā** (who, though himself worthy of honor, has given up such

worldly claims to prestige) **māna-dena** (giving honor and respect to others — even to those without honor and to the unworthy; by such a person) **sadā** (always) **hariḥ** (Hari alone) **kīrtanīyaḥ** (is to be chanted — uttered with the lips, the tongue and so on).

Kavirāja Gosvāmī earnestly urges everyone to live by this verse —

32 With arms upraised I say: listen, everyone! String this verse on the thread of the holy name and wear it around your neck.

33 Live by this verse, as the Lord has ordered, and you will surely attain the feet of Śrī Kṛṣṇa.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

The author says: "O people! With upraised arms I tell you: listen! String this verse on the garland of Kṛṣṇa's name and wear it around your neck." The meaning is this: if one chants the name without being qualified, the result is *nāmābhāsa* (a mere shadow of the name) or *nāmāparādha* (offense against the name). Then the *jīva* does not attain the fruit of the name, "love for Kṛṣṇa." Chant the name of Hari while acting on the instruction Mahāprabhu gave in the verse *tṛṇād api*; then you will certainly attain the feet of Śrī Kṛṣṇa.

Anubhāṣya.

"Strung on the thread of the name": the thread is Śrī Harināma, and what is strung on it as a garland or protective amulet (*rakṣā-kavaca*) is the four moods free of worldly self-conception: (1) humility (*sunīcatva*), (2) tolerance (*sahiṣṇutva*), (3) freedom from claims to honor (*amānitva*), (4) readiness to give honor (*mānadatva*). With worldly self-conception one cannot chant the name of Hari always: material self-conceptions obstruct the name of Hari. Free of these four kinds of self-conception, the pure *jīva* can chant the name of Hari always. Whoever obeys this command — the instruction of *sādhana-bhakti* — will certainly attain the feet of Śrī Kṛṣṇa as the fruit of chanting the name of Hari.

**Saṅkīrtana* in Śrīvāsa's house for a whole year —*

34 Then for a whole year the Lord held saṅkīrtana every night in Śrīvāsa's house.

Hostile godless people are kept out —

35 They sang with the doors shut, deeply absorbed; the unbelievers came to mock, but could not get in.

Envy and hatred toward Śrīvāsa —

36 Hearing the kīrtana from outside, they burned with envy and devised all kinds of schemes to trouble Śrīvāsa.

The scheme of "Gopāla Cāpāla" against Śrīvāsa —

37–38 There was a brāhmaṇa named Gopāla Cāpāla, a foul-mouthed babbler and the chief of the unbelievers. One night he took all the articles for the worship of Bhavānī and smeared the ground at Śrīvāsa's door to prepare a place for the rite.

Anubhāṣya.
The story of "Gopāla Cāpāla" is not found in the *Caitanya-bhāgavata*.

39 On a banana leaf he set out oḍa flowers, turmeric, vermilion, red sandal paste and rice.

40 He set a pot of wine beside them and went home, and in the morning Śrīvāsa saw it all.

An attempt to make Śrīvāsa out to be a worshiper of Śakti —

41 He called the respectable people of the town and, laughing heartily, said to them all:

Anubhāṣya.
Bolāiyā: having them called.

42 "Every night I worship Bhavānī. See my glory, good brāhmaṇas!"

The distress of the respectable local people, and the purifying of the place —

43 Then all those good people cried out in dismay: “What wicked man has done such a thing here?”

44 They sent for a sweeper to clear it all away, and had the place cleansed with water and cow dung.

Gopāla Cāpāla's leprosy, the fruit of an offense against a Vaiṣṇava —

45 Three days later Gopāla Cāpāla was struck with leprosy all over his body, and blood streamed from his sores.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

While Mahāprabhu, with the doors shut, was tasting the bliss of *kīrtana* in Śrīvāsa's courtyard, many brāhmaṇas of the town who were turned away from God tried in many ways to ridicule the Vaiṣṇavas. A certain garrulous Bhaṭṭācārya nicknamed “Gopāla Cāpāla” left outside the closed door the articles for worshiping the Devī — a banana leaf, a *javā* flower, red sandalwood and so on — together with a pot of wine. In the morning Śrīvāsa Paṇḍita saw it and said to everyone in jest, “Look, look! Every night I worship Bhavānī. Now you have learned how great I am as a ‘*śākta*’!” The respectable people were deeply distressed at the sight. They called a *hāḍi* (a sweeper), had the wine and the other vile things thrown far away, and purified the place with water and cow dung. For that offense against a Vaiṣṇava, Gopāla Cāpāla was stricken with a rotting leprosy.

46 Worms covered his whole body and gnawed at him without rest; the pain was unbearable, and his heart burned with agony.

He stays on the bank of the Gaṅgā and begs the Lord to deliver him —

47 He sat under a tree at a ghāṭa on the Ganges, and one day, seeing the Lord, he spoke to Him:

48 “By village kinship I am Your maternal uncle. See, nephew, how leprosy torments me.

49 You have descended to deliver all people, and I am in great misery. Deliver me!”

Because of his offense against a Vaiṣṇava, the Lord rebukes him angrily and refuses to deliver him —

50 Hearing this, Mahāprabhu grew angry and spoke threatening words to him:

51 “You sinner, you hater of devotees! I will not deliver you. For ten million births I will have the worms devour you like this.

52 You made it look as though Śrīvāsa worshipped Bhavānī; for ten million births you will fall into the hell of Raurava.

Anubhāṣya.
Worship of Bhavānī is the business of a non-Vaiṣṇava, that is, it is not the business of a Vaiṣṇava. By condemning it, the Lord taught people to regard as “bad association” the worldly, mixed Vaiṣṇava (*prākṛta viddha-vaiṣṇava*) who at heart nourishes the doctrine of many gods, that is, who leans toward the worship of many gods and goddesses.

53 I have come to destroy the unbelievers, and when they are gone I shall spread devotion everywhere.”

One who offends a Vaiṣṇava suffers constantly and so cannot easily die —

54 With these words the Lord went to bathe in the Ganges, and the sinner went on suffering, unable to die.

Anubhāṣya.
Bhoge: suffers.

When the Lord came, he surrendered to Him —

55–56 After the Lord had taken sannyāsa and gone to Nīlācala, He once came from there to the village of Kuliyā. Then the sinner took shelter of

Him, and the Lord, moved to compassion, gave him good counsel:

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Kuliyā-grāma: at that time Navadvīpa was on the eastern bank of the Gaṅgā, and on the other bank was the village of Kuliyā — the place now known as "Navadvīpa."

Anubhāṣya.

Kuliyā-grāma: the present town of Navadvīpa. "Between Nadīyā and Kuliyā there is only the Gaṅgā" (*Caitanya-bhāgavata*, Antya 3.380): Kuliyā is on the western bank of the Gaṅgā, and Navadvīpa on the eastern bank. For mentions of Kuliyā on the western bank of the Gaṅgā, see the *Bhakti-ratnākara* (twelfth wave), the *Caitanya-carita* *mahākāvya*, the play *Caitanya-candrodaya*, and the *Caitanya-bhāgavata*. In the village of Kuliyā, which belongs to Koladvīpa, there is to this day a quarter called "Kuliyār Gañj" and a stream called "Kuliyār Daha"; it lies within the present municipal town of Navadvīpa. In Śrī Mahāprabhu's time there were villages called "Kuliyā" and "Pāhāḍapura" on the western bank of the Gaṅgā. They lie among the fields of "Bāhir-dvīpa." But then and ever since, Navadvīpa was in "Antardvīpa," on the eastern bank of the Gaṅgā. In Śrī Māyāpura that place is still known as "Dvīper Māṭh" ("the field of the island"). The village called "Kuliyā" near Kāñcaḍāpāḍā is not the Kuliyā mentioned above, nor the "*pāṭa* of Aparādha-bhañjana" (the place where offenses were forgiven). The false notion about it arose only a few years ago — from fancies born of hostility toward the Dhāma, and from error.

The Lord tells him to beg forgiveness from Śrīvāsa Paṇḍita —

57 "You have offended Śrīvāsa Paṇḍita. Go to him, and if he shows you his grace,

After surrendering, one must not sin again —

58 you will be freed from this sin, if you never act in such a way again."

Gopāla Cāpāla takes shelter at Śrīvāsa's feet and is freed from his offense —

59 So the brāhmaṇa came and took shelter of Śrīvāsa, and by his grace he was freed from his sin.

Another foolish brāhmaṇa curses the Lord —

60 Another brāhmaṇa came to see the kīrtana, but the door was shut and he could not get in.

61 He went home with a heavy heart, and the next day, seeing the Lord at the Ganges, he said to Him:[1]

62 "I will curse You, for You have grieved me!" And tearing his sacred thread, the fierce, foul-mouthed man cursed Him:

63 "May Your worldly happiness be destroyed!" Hearing the curse, Mahāprabhu was filled with delight.

64 Whoever hears with faith the story of the Lord's curse is delivered from the curse of a brāhmaṇa.

Anubhāṣya.

Whoever thinks that the Lord, the master of *māyā*, is subject to curses and the like, or that He is a *jīva* punished by Yama and subject to the fruits of karma, invites godlessness upon himself. But once the *jīva* comes instead to know Him as the Supreme Lord, eternally worthy of service, its beginningless aversion to Kṛṣṇa disappears. This incident is not in the *Caitanya-bhāgavata*.

Mercy through punishment for Mukunda —

65 To Mukunda Datta the Lord gave His grace in the form of punishment, and so dispelled all the dejection of his heart.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

On the day of the Lord's *mahā-prakāśa*, Mukunda Datta stayed lying outside the door. When the Lord had shown His grace to the other devotees one by one, they told the Lord that Mukunda Datta was outside. The Lord replied, "I will not soon be pleased with Mukunda Datta. Before devotees he speaks of 'pure devotion,' but sitting among the Māyāvādīs he accepts the 'Māyāvāda' set out in the *Yoga-vāsiṣṭha*. This always pains Me." Mukunda Datta heard these words from outside and said, "I am fortunate! Though not soon, at some time Mahāprabhu, the

deliverer of the world, will show me mercy." Seeing that Mukunda Datta was firmly resolved to give up the company of Māyāvādīs, the Lord at once had him brought near and showed him His favor. In this way the Lord punished him for the offense of associating with Māyāvādīs and granted him grace as the fruit of associating with pure devotees.

Anubhāṣya.

Mercy through punishment for Mukunda: see the *Caitanya-bhāgavata*, Madhya, Chapter 10.

Mercy through punishment for Advaita —

66 The Lord honoured Ācārya Gosāñi as His guru, and this made the Ācārya very unhappy.

67 So the Ācārya, by design, began to expound the path of knowledge, and the Lord in anger treated Him with disrespect.

68 Then Ācārya Gosāñi was filled with joy, and the Lord, abashed, showed Him His grace.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Advaitācārya was a godbrother of Īśvara Purī, Mahāprabhu's guru. For this reason the Lord, although Advaita was His servant, honored him as a guru. Advaita was pained that Mahāprabhu showed him such honor. To receive Mahāprabhu's grace in the form of punishment, he went to Śāntipura and began to explain the path of *jñāna* to some unfortunate people. Hearing of this, the Lord went to Śāntipura in anger and gave Advaita Prabhu a sound beating. Having received the blows, Advaita Prabhu began to dance, saying, "Look, today my desire is fulfilled! Mahāprabhu was stingy and treated me as His guru; today He saw me as His own servant and disciple and tried to save me from the evil notion of Māyāvāda." Seeing this ploy of Advaitācārya, the Lord was embarrassed and became pleased with him.

Murāri Gupta's exclusive devotion to Śrī Rāma —

69 Hearing from Murāri Gupta the glories of Rāma, the Lord wrote the name “Rāmadāsa” on his forehead.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

One day Mahāprabhu asked Murāri Gupta, who worshiped Śrī Rāma with the Rāma *mantra*, to recite a prayer to Śrī Rāma. Murāri recited the *Rāmāṣṭaka* with great *prema*: “Having thus heard the eight verses about Raghunandana, the lion among kings, Bhagavān placed His foot on the head of Murāri the physician and wrote on his forehead: ‘O, by My grace, become “Rāmadāsa”!’”

Anubhāṣya.

Caitanya-maṅgala, Madhya-khaṇḍa: “I ever worship Rāma, the guru of the three worlds.” “Having thus heard the eight verses about Raghuvīra, He Himself placed His foot on Murāri's head. He wrote the name ‘Rāmadāsa’ on his forehead: ‘By My grace you have become “Rāmadāsa.”’ Saying this, He showed him the form of Rāma. Murāri, falling at His feet, offers prayers.” The Lord's mercy to Murāri Gupta: see the *Caitanya-bhāgavata*, Madhya, Chapter 10.

The Lord drinks water from an iron pot in Śrīdhara's house and gives boons —

70 He drank water from Śrīdhara’s iron pot, and to all the devotees He granted the boons they desired.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

On the night of the first city *kīrtana*, after the Kāzī had been delivered, Chāď Kāzī came along with the *kīrtana* as far as Śrīdhara's courtyard. When the *kīrtana* stopped there to rest, Mahāprabhu mercifully drank the water that was in Śrīdhara's leaky iron pot, calling it “water offered by a devotee.” From that spot the Kāzī turned back. That place, in the northeastern part of Māyāpura, is still called the place where the *kīrtana* rested.

Anubhāṣya.

How the Lord drank water from Śrīdhara's iron pot: see the *Caitanya-bhāgavata*, Madhya, Chapter 23.

Mercy to Ṭhākura Haridāsa; the pastime of freeing Śacī from her offense —

71 He showed His grace to Haridāsa Ṭhākura, and freed His mother from her offence against the Ācārya.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

On the day of the *mahā-prakāśa*, Mahāprabhu embraced Haridāsa, declared him an avatāra of Prahlāda, and gave him a boon.

When Viśvarūpa took *sannyāsa*, Śacīmātā blamed Advaita Ācārya for it. She thus committed an offense against a Vaiṣṇava, and the Lord freed her from that offense by having His mother take the dust of the Ācārya's feet.

Anubhāṣya.

Mercy to Ṭhākura Haridāsa: see the *Caitanya-bhāgavata*, Madhya, Chapter 10; the Lord's mercy to Śacīmātā: the *Caitanya-bhāgavata*, Madhya, Chapter 22.

*A godless student calls the glory of the holy name exaggeration (*arthavāda*) —*

72 The Lord told the devotees of the glory of the holy name, and a student who heard it explained it away as mere praise (*arthavāda*).

Anubhāṣya.

The glory of Śrī Nāma Prabhu is non-different from Kṛṣṇa Himself. To consider it “exaggerated praise,” “not real,” and therefore “untrue” — this divisive mentality is what is called “*arthavāda*,” that is, (false) praise or else defamation. It is outright godlessness, or atheism — nothing but enmity toward God.

73 Hearing the name called an exaggeration, the Lord was pained, and He forbade everyone to look upon that man’s face.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

One day Mahāprabhu was describing to the devotees the boundless glory of the holy name. Hearing it, an unfortunate student said, “All this glory of the name is not real: the scriptures merely praise the name.” To reinterpret the glory of the name like this is the offense against the name called *arthavāda*. No offense is as terrible as an offense against the name. The Lord forbade everyone to look at that offending student's face and, with His associates, bathed in the Gaṅgā *sacele*,

that is, with His clothes on. The meaning is: whoever has seen the face of an offender of the name should bathe with his clothes on — that is the lesson.

*The Lord and His associates bathe in the Gaṅgā with their clothes on, and He glorifies devotion, the one and only means (*abhidheya*) —*

74 Then He went with His companions and bathed in the Ganges in His clothes, and there He explained the glory of devotion.

75 Kṛṣṇa is not brought under control by knowledge, karma, yoga or dharma; the one thing that holds Him is the rasa of love for Him.

*(*Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam*, Canto 11, Chapter 14, Verse 20)*

76 (Śrī Kṛṣṇa said:) "O Uddhava, neither yoga nor sāṅkhya, neither dharma nor study of the Vedas, neither austerity nor renunciation can win Me as intense devotion to Me does." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 11.14.20)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

O Uddhava! As strong devotion to Me can win Me over, so I am not won over by *aṣṭāṅga-yoga*, by *sāṅkhya-jñāna* — the doctrine of non-difference from Brahman, by *svādhyāya* — a brāhmaṇa's study of his own branch of the Veda, by every kind of austerity, or by *sannyāsa* and the like, which is renunciation.

Anubhāṣya.

Śrī Kṛṣṇa said to Uddhava: O **uddhava**, **yogaḥ** (*yama*, *niyama*, *āsana*, *prāṇāyāma* and the rest, born of the restraint of the breath), **sāṅkhyam** (the enumeration of the *tattvas* taught by Kapila), **dharmaḥ** (the *dharma* of *varṇa* and *āśrama*), **svādhyāyaḥ** (study of the Veda), **tapaḥ**, **tyāgaḥ** (*sannyāsa*) **tathā** (so) **mām na sādhayati** (do not win Me over), **yathā** (as) **mama ūrjitā** (intensified) **bhaktiḥ mām** (wins Me over).

Praise of Murāri —

77 The Lord said to Murāri, "You have brought Kṛṣṇa under your control," and hearing this, Murāri began to recite a verse:

*(*Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam*, Canto 10, Chapter 81, Verse 14)*[8]

78 "Who am I, a poor and sinful man, and who is Kṛṣṇa, the abode of the goddess of fortune? Yet because I was born a brāhmaṇa, He embraced me in His arms!" (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 10.81.16)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Where am I, a great sinner and a pauper, and where is Kṛṣṇa, the abode of Śrī! Knowing me to be an unworthy son of a brāhmaṇa, He embraced me. This is truly astonishing.

Anubhāṣya.

Mahāprabhu said to Murāri, "By your *prema* and devotion you have brought Kṛṣṇa under your control." In reply Murāri recited the verse from the *Bhāgavata* spoken by the brāhmaṇa "Sudāmā."

These were the words the brāhmaṇa "Śrīdāmā," or "Sudāmā," spoke to himself as he went home: **daridraḥ** (devoid of wealth) **pāpīyān** (sinful) **aham kva** (where)? **śrī-niketanaḥ** (the form in whom all majesty is rooted, the shelter of all piety) **kṛṣṇaḥ kva** (where)? **aham brahma-bandhuḥ** (the lowest of brāhmaṇas by birth) **iti** — thus (by Kṛṣṇa) **bāhubhyām parirambhitaḥ** (embraced). (The words that Kṛṣṇa could never embrace me, an unworthy *brahma-bandhu*, show only Kṛṣṇa's greatness; the sentence expresses the speaker's humility.)

If Murāri accepted Mahāprabhu's words favorably, he recited the verse with this thought: "Murāri has no power to bring Kṛṣṇa under control; it is Kṛṣṇa who, by His own love for His devotees, on the pretext of something incidental and secondary, makes an unworthy servant the recipient of unimaginable good fortune."

If, however, Murāri recited the verse to set aside Mahāprabhu's words as unfavorable to himself, then he said, "I am wholly unfit to control Kṛṣṇa; I have not been able to control Kṛṣṇa." The brāhmaṇa Śrīdāmā listed his own disqualifications — poverty, a bent toward sin, not being a true brāhmaṇa and so on — and proclaimed his good fortune: Kṛṣṇa embraced him. But Murāri Gupta thinks, "Even in that way I am unworthy."

In the commentary on the tenth canto, the *Vaiṣṇava-toṣaṇī*, the meaning of the verse is explained thus: "*Kva*, and so on. **Pāpīyān**: unfortunate; **kṛṣṇaḥ**: Bhagavān Himself. Thus 'Kṛṣṇa' and 'most sinful' contradict each other, and so do

‘poverty’ and ‘abode of Śrī.’ Nevertheless, **brahma-bandhuḥ**, born in a family of brāhmaṇas, **bāhubhyām**, with both arms, **parirambhitaḥ**, embraced. **Sma** expresses wonder. Thus brāhmaṇa birth alone is named as the cause of the embrace, not friendship, for there he considered himself utterly unworthy. Therefore it is only the Lord's devotion to brāhmaṇas that is praised, not even His love for His devotees.”

In the preceding verse Sudāmā's mood is recorded thus: “With the chest on which Kamalā, dearer to Him than life, resides — with that chest Brahmaṇya-deva, out of love for brāhmaṇas, embraced a pauper like me, bereft of Lakṣmī.” In keeping with the mood of that verse, the commentary on the following verse, quoted here, says: “The cause of the embrace is brāhmaṇa birth alone, not friendship.” And the brāhmaṇa Śrīdāmā in his humility thinks: “I myself am utterly unworthy; I myself do not live as a brāhmaṇa. It is only the Lord, to show the excellence of devotion to brāhmaṇas and His own excellence, who has shown such love even to a *brahma-bandhu* — that is what is astonishing.” The brāhmaṇa Śrīdāmā, wishing to express his humility and his own insignificance, condemned himself as a “*brahma-bandhu*.” And by saying that Kṛṣṇa shows extraordinary grace even to a *brahma-bandhu*, he truly revealed his humility and his brāhmaṇa nature. By this the brāhmaṇa Sudāmā set a shining example of giving up one's own greatness. Being a *brahma-bandhu* is not his own quality or his own achievement; rather, being a *brahma-bandhu* is something extraneous — that which, for the brāhmaṇa Sudāmā, is not his own property, is itself the cause of Kṛṣṇa's love. Neither his own greatness nor his own devotion to Kṛṣṇa compelled Kṛṣṇa to act so.

Murāri Gupta, too, adopted such a mood: covering his own greatness, he displayed humility. In the social view of that time Murāri Gupta was merely a *śūdra* by birth, and the word “*brahma-bandhu*” does not apply to him. But reflecting on the import of the verse “Women, *śūdras* and *dvija-bandhus* have no access to hearing the three Vedas” (*Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 1.4.25), Murāri Gupta likened the position of a *dvija-bandhu* to that of a *śūdra*.

In his commentary on the *Chāndogya Upaniṣad*, Śaṅkarācārya, explaining the word *brahma-bandhu*, says: “He calls the brāhmaṇas his kinsmen, but does not himself live as a brāhmaṇa.” (*Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 1.7.57): “Shaving the head, seizing one's wealth, expelling one from one's dwelling — this is the execution of *brahma-bandhus*; there is no other, bodily execution for them.” In the *Kūrma Purāṇa*: “The servant of a *śūdra*, a servant of the king, a *vṛṣala*, a priest for a whole village, and one who lives by killing and imprisoning — these six are

brahma-bandhus." Being a *brahma-bandhu*, that is, a brāhmaṇa merely by birth, is no proof of one's own qualification; rather, it proves only dependence on something else.

The story of how the Lord planted a mango tree and gave out its fruit —

79 One day, tired after saṅkīrtana with all the devotees, the Lord sat down to rest.

80 He planted a mango seed in the courtyard, and at once a tree sprang up and began to grow.

81 As they watched, the tree began to bear fruit, and many mangoes ripened, to everyone's wonder.

82 The Lord quickly picked two hundred mangoes, washed them and offered them to Kṛṣṇa.

83 They were red and yellow, without stone or skin, and a single fruit was enough to satisfy a man.

84 The son of Śacī was pleased to see them; He tasted them first and then fed everyone.

85 Without stone or skin, they were full of nectarean juice, and one fruit was a meal in itself.

86 So the tree bore fruit every day for twelve months, and the Vaiṣṇavas ate it, to the Lord's delight.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

One day the Lord, tired from the city *kīrtana* with the devotees, came to a certain place and planted a mango seed in the courtyard of the devotee who lived there. At once it bore fruit, and a mango festival took place. That place is now known as "Āmraghaṭṭa" ("Āmaghāṭā").

Anubhāṣya.
This incident is not in the *Śrī Caitanya-bhāgavata*.

87 Such were the pastimes of Śacī's son, and no one but the devotees knew of them.

88 Thus for twelve months, when the kīrtana ended, the Lord held a mango festival day after day.

*During the *kīrtana* the Lord keeps the clouds from raining —*

89 Once, while the Lord was holding kīrtana, clouds gathered, and by His own will He sent them away.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
One day Mahāprabhu was performing *saṅkīrtana* far away, and at that time the sky was massed with clouds. The Lord willed the clouds to go and ordered them away, and they at once dispersed. For this reason that sandbank of the Gaṅgā came to be called "Megher Car" ("the Cloud Sandbank"). Now, because the Gaṅgā has changed its course, that "Megher Car" has shifted to the village of "Belpukhuriyā." And the place where Belpukhuriyā used to be is now called "Tāraṇavāsa" and "Ṭoṭā."

Anubhāṣya.
Caitanya-maṅgala, Madhya-khaṇḍa: "The day was done, evening came, the far horizons grew lovely[9]. Suddenly clouds overspread the vault of the sky; thunder rolls again and again with a deep roar. Seeing this, the Vaiṣṇavas took it for a calamity. Then Mahāprabhu took cymbals in His hands and loudly sang the *saṅkīrtana* of the names and qualities. Thinking, 'I shall bless the world of the gods,' the Lord turned His face up to the sky. The clouds went far away, the sky cleared, and the Vaiṣṇavas' joy grew. The night became pure, tinted by the moon. His followers sing His qualities, and He Himself dances."

*Śrīvāsa reads the *Viṣṇu-sahasra-nāma* —*

90 One day the Lord told Śrīvāsa, "Read the great Thousand Names; I wish to hear them."

The pastime in which the Lord is absorbed in the mood of Nṛsiṁha —

91 As he read, the hymn came to the name of Nṛsiṁha, and hearing it, the Lord, the abode of all virtues, became absorbed in His mood.

Absorbed in the mood of Śrī Nṛsiṁha, the one chastiser of godlessness, the Lord puts the godless to flight —

92 In the mood of Nṛsiṁha, the Lord took a club in His hand and ran into the town to kill the unbelievers.

The people's terror —

93 Seeing Him in the mood of Nṛsiṁha, blazing with power, the people left the road and fled in terror.

Anubhāṣya.

Bhāge: they flee. This incident is not in the *Caitanya-bhāgavata*.

The Lord restrains His anger and shows compassion —

94 Seeing their fear, the Lord came back to outer awareness; He went to Śrīvāsa's house and threw down the club.

The Lord's words to Śrīvāsa —

95 Dejected, the Lord said to Śrīvāsa, "I have frightened the people. The offence is Mine."

Anubhāṣya.

Caitanya-maṅgala, Madhya-khaṇḍa: "Śrīvāsa Paṇḍita was performing the rite for his ancestors. With a very pure heart he hears the 'Sahasra-nāma.' At that time Gaurahari came to that place. He hears the 'Sahasra-nāma' to His heart's content. As He listened, He became absorbed in the mood of Nṛsiṁha. Both His eyes turned red with anger, His hair stood on end. His whole body thrilled, the color of the dawn. Again and again a loud roar — the roar of a lion. Suddenly He seized a club and rushed off. Seeing this, everyone trembled at heart. Restraining it all, the Lord sat on His seat: 'I do not know what offense I have committed.'"

Śrīvāsa's words: Gaura's name destroys offenses —

96 Śrīvāsa said, “Whoever takes Your name is freed from millions of offences.

The sight of Gaura destroys worldly existence —

97 There was no offence: You delivered the people. Whoever has seen You is free from the cycle of birth and death.”

98 With these words Śrīvāsa served Him, and the Lord, pleased, returned home.

The Lord in the mood of Śiva on the shoulders of a most fortunate Śaiva —

99 Another day a devotee of Śiva came singing Śiva’s glories; he danced in the Lord’s courtyard, playing the ḍamaru drum.

100 Śacī’s son was absorbed in the mood of Maheśa, and climbing onto the man’s shoulders He danced for a long time.

Anubhāṣya.
See the *Caitanya-bhāgavata*, Madhya, Chapter 8.

The Lord gives love for Kṛṣṇa to a dancing beggar —

101 Another day a beggar came for alms, and seeing the Lord dance, he began to dance too.

102 He danced with the Lord in great joy, and the Lord gave him love, so that he floated in its rasa.

The Lord asks an astrologer about His own past —

103 Another day an all-knowing astrologer came, and the Lord, receiving him with honour, asked him a question:

Anubhāṣya.

Sarvajña: one who knows the three times — past, future and present.

104 “Calculate and tell Me who I was in My previous birth.” Hearing the Lord’s words, the astrologer began his calculations.

Anubhāṣya.

To this day in East Bengal (especially in the Ḍhākā division), in place of verb forms such as *chila*, *chile*, *chilām*, people use *āchila*, *āchilā* and *āchilām*.

The astrologer realizes that the Lord is the Supreme Lord —

105 Having calculated, he saw in meditation a great effulgence, the shelter of all, of endless Vaikuṇṭhas and universes.

106 Seeing the Lord’s form as the Supreme Truth, the Supreme Brahman, the Supreme Lord, the astrologer was bewildered.

The astrologer is bewildered —

107 He could say nothing and fell silent; but when the Lord asked again, he began to speak:

The astrologer's answer to the Lord's question —

108 “In Your previous birth You were the supreme shelter, the complete Bhagavān, full of all majesty.

109 As You were then, so You are now; Your own nature is eternal bliss, hard to fathom.”

The Lord declares Himself a cowherd —

110 The Lord smiled and said, “You have understood nothing. Before, I was a cowherd by caste.

111 I was born in a cowherd's home and tended the cows, and by that merit I have now become the son of a brāhmaṇa."

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Serving cows brings piety. In My previous birth I was a cowherd and served the cows. The piety I earned in this way was the cause (bore the fruit) of My becoming a "brāhmaṇa" this time.

Anubhāṣya.

The Lord's playful, mysterious words to the all-knowing astrologer.

Seeing the dark form, the astrologer is bewildered and takes shelter of the Lord —

112 The astrologer said, "I saw that in my meditation, but I saw majesty in it and was bewildered.

113 That form and this one I see as one; if at times I see a difference, that is Your māyā.

*The Lord shows mercy to the astrologer and gives him *prema* —*

114 Whoever You may be, I bow to You." And the Lord rewarded him with love.

Anubhāṣya.

The story of the astrologer is not found in the *Caitanya-bhāgavata*.

In the mood of Baladeva, the Lord enacts the pastime of dragging the Yamunā —

115 One day, sitting in the hall of Viṣṇu, the Lord called out, "Bring honey! Bring honey!"

116 Nityānanda Gosāñi understood the Lord's mood; He brought a pot of Ganges water and held it before the Lord.

Anubhāṣya.

See the *Caitanya-bhāgavata*, Madhya, Chapter 25.

117 Drinking the water, the Lord danced, overwhelmed, and everyone saw the pastime in which Balarāma drew the Yamunā to Himself.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

The pastime of dragging the Yamunā: one day Baladeva, angry with the Yamunā, dragged the Yamunā with His plough and pestle. When Mahāprabhu, in the mood of Baladeva, cried, "Bring honey, bring honey!", all the others at that moment were seeing that very pastime of dragging the Yamunā.

Anubhāṣya.

Baladeva went to Gokula and lived there in the months of Caitra and Vaiśākha surrounded by the *gopīs*. Having drunk *vāruṇī*, Baladeva called the Yamunā to come near so that he could sport in the water. (*Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 10.65.25–30, 33): "The Lord called the Yamunā for sport in the water. But the river disregarded his words, thinking him drunk, and did not come. Then Bala, angered, dragged her with the tip of his plough. 'Sinful one! Disregarding me, you do not come when I call. With the tip of my plough I will bring you here, split into a hundred streams, you willful one!' Thus rebuked, the frightened Yamunā, O king, trembling, fell at the feet of the delight of the Yadus and said: 'Rāma, Rāma, mighty-armed one! I did not know your might: by a single portion of it you uphold the earth, O lord of the universe. O Bhagavān, soul of the universe, lover of your devotees! Release me: I did not know the supreme nature of the Lord, and now I have surrendered to you.' Then, being entreated, Lord Bala released the Yamunā and plunged into the water with the women, like the king of elephants with his she-elephants. Even today, O king, the channel along which the Yamunā was dragged can be seen; it seems to proclaim the might of Bala, whose power is unlimited."

Candraśekhara Ācāryaratna sees the Lord in the form of Baladeva —

118 He moved with the reeling gait of Baladeva, and Ācārya Śekhara saw Him in the form of Rāma.

Vanamālī Ācārya sees a golden plough in the Lord's hand —

119 Vanamālī Ācārya saw a golden plough, and all danced together, overwhelmed with bliss.

Anubhāṣya.

Caitanya-maṅgala, Madhya-khaṇḍa: “With him was his son, named Vanamālī. Born in a brāhmaṇa family, he lives in the eastern land, Vaṅga. He saw the Lord's body fashioned of gold, adorned with jewels, like the peak of Sumeru. In the guise of Halāyudha the Lord of the three worlds dances.” “Vanamālī Paṇḍita,” mentioned in Ādi 10.73, also saw the golden plough and pestle in the Lord's hands. That one has the title “Paṇḍita,” and this one the title “Ācārya”: are they one and the same person, or two different people?

A dance lasting twelve hours —

120 So the dancing went on for four praharas; in the evening they all bathed in the Ganges and went home.

*By the Lord's order, *kīrtana* of Kṛṣṇa in every home —*

121 When the Lord gave His order to the townspeople, they began to hold saṅkīrtana in every house:

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

When preaching the name in the town, the Lord first ordered the townspeople who lived near Śrīvāsa's courtyard to chant the name of Hari while clapping their hands; gradually *mṛdaṅgas*, *karatālas* and the like began to be played. From then on *saṅkīrtana* has spread from door to door, and it continues to this day.

A song of the names —

122 “*Hari haraye namaḥ, kṛṣṇa yādavāya namaḥ, gopāla govinda rāma śrī-madhusūdana*.”

123 The great sound of saṅkīrtana rose with mṛdaṅgas and karatālas, and nothing could be heard but “Hari! Hari!”

*The *yavanas* and the Kāzī oppose the *kīrtana* —*

124 Hearing it, the Muslims grew angry and all came to the Kazi to complain.

Anubhāṣya.

The townspeople's *kīrtana* of Kṛṣṇa, the Kāzī's anger, and the Kāzī's deliverance: see the *Caitanya-bhāgavata*, Madhya, Chapter 23.

Kāzī: the *phaujadāra* (district magistrate), Chāṅd Kāzī. In former times the land tax was collected by the zamindars — rājās or *maṇḍalas* (village headmen). Punishment, administration and the like were in the hands of the *kāzīs*. Both zamindar and *kāzī* were subordinate to the *subādāra*, the governor of Subā Bāṅgālā. The *parganās* of Nadīyā, Islāmapura, Bāgoyāna and others then belonged to Hari Hoḍa or to his descendant Kṛṣṇadāsa Hoḍa. But although they owned the land, it was the Kāzī who had taken over the government. It is said that Chāṅd Kāzī was the guru of the Nawab of Bengal, "Husain Shah." According to some, his other name was "Maulānā Sirājuddin"; others say "Habibar Rahamān." His descendants still live in that place, and Chāṅd Kāzī's tomb also survives.

*The Kāzī breaks the *khola* —*

125 In the evening the Kazi came angrily to one house, broke the mṛdaṅga and said to the people:

Anubhāṣya.

To this day in the village of Śrī Māyāpura there is a well-known piece of land called "Khol-bhāṅgār Ḍāṅgā" ("the mound where the *khola* was broken").

*The Kazi opposes the *kīrtana* and forbids it —*

126 "All this time no one here has dared to follow Hindu ways openly. Now you carry on with such zeal — on whose strength, I would like to know?

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

From the coming of Bakhtiyar Khilji up to the time of Cāṅd Kāzī, Hinduism in Navadvīpa had sunk into utter decline. Those who truly had faith in the Hindu religion would quietly say "Hari, Hari" once and then fall silent. That is why the Kazi said, "For so long Hinduism has not shown itself at all — by whose strength are you now undertaking such an effort?"

127 Let no one hold kīrtana anywhere in the town. Today I forgive you and go home.

128 But if I find anyone holding kīrtana again, I will take all he owns and strip him of his caste."

The distressed good people come to the Lord with their complaint —

129 With these words the Kazi went away, and the townspeople, in great distress, told the Lord what had happened.

*The Lord grows angry and orders everyone to perform *saṅkīrtana* —*

130 The Lord ordered, "Go and hold kīrtana! Today I shall destroy all the Muslims."

131 They all went home and held kīrtana, but in fear of the Kazi they were not at ease, and their hearts trembled.

132 Knowing the fear in their hearts, the Lord quickly called the people together and said:

133 "Today I shall hold kīrtana throughout the town. By evening, all of you, decorate the town.

134 In the evening light lamps in every house, and we shall see what Kazi comes to stop Me!"

135 Having said this, Gaurarāya set out in the evening, and He formed the kīrtana into three groups.

*The *kīrtana* is divided into three groups —*

136 Haridāsa danced in the first group, and in the middle one Ācārya Gosāñi danced in great joy.

137 In the last group danced Gauracandra, and Nityānanda Prabhu danced along with Him.

138 By the power of Caitanya's mercy, Vṛndāvana dāsa has described this at length in the *Caitanya-maṅgala*.[2]

*Singing *kīrtana*, He goes around the town of Navadvīpa —*

139 So, holding kīrtana, He wandered through the town, and in His wandering He came to the Kazi's door.

Anubhāṣya.

The *Caitanya-bhāgavata*, Madhya, Chapter 23: "May my mind cling to Your feet, (O Śārṅgadhara,) may my mind cling to Your feet! This is Caitanyacandra's first *saṅkīrtana*: the devotees sing, and Śrī Śacīnandana dances. In Nadīyā a road runs along the bank of the Gaṅgā, and along that road, ahead of all, Gaurarāya goes dancing. First Gaurahari danced a long while at His own *ghāṭa*, and then He went on to Mādhāi's *ghāṭa*. 'Viśvambhara, the Lord of all, dances along the banks of the Bhāgīrathī' (refrain). Reaching Bārakoṇā Ghāṭa and Nāgariyā Ghāṭa, the Lord passed through Gaṅgānagara and came to Simuliyā. At the edge of Nadīyā lies the settlement of Simuliyā, and there the Lord arrived, dancing all the way. Then the Ṭhākura took the road to the Kazi's house, and dancing He came to the Kazi's quarter."

140 The people shouted threats and made a great uproar: under Gauracandra's protection they had grown wild with boldness.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Then, by the strength of Śrī Śrī Gauracandra, the people grew bold and went almost mad.

The Kazi hides —

141 At the sound of the kīrtana the Kazi hid in his house, and hearing the threats and roars, he would not come out.

The rowdy people run riot —

142 Unruly people broke into the Kazi's house and flower garden; Vṛndāvana dāsa has described this at length.

Anubhāṣya.
See the *Caitanya-bhāgavata*, Madhya, Chapter 23.

The Kazi is called out through respectable good men —

143 Then Mahāprabhu sat down at his door and sent respectable men to call the Kazi.

The Lord honors the Kazi according to worldly custom —

144 The Kazi approached from a distance, his head bowed, and the Lord received him with honour and gave him a seat.

The Lord expresses surprise at the Kazi's behavior —

145 The Lord said, "I have come to you as a guest, yet when you saw Me you hid. What kind of conduct is this?"

The Kazi's reply —

146 The Kazi said, "You came in anger, so I stayed hidden to let You grow calm.

147 Now that You are calm, I have come to meet You. How fortunate I am to receive a guest like You!

148 By village kinship Cakravartī is my uncle, and village kinship is truer than kinship of the body.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
In one part of the village of Brāhmaṇa-puṣkariṇī the old house of the Kazis still stands. Joined to the other part of that village is Tāraṇavāsa, formerly Bilva-puṣkariṇī. That village and the Kazis' Brāhmaṇa-puṣkariṇī were one and the same

village, and so Mahāprabhu stood to Cāṅd Kāzī in the relation of a sister's son to a maternal uncle.

Anubhāṣya.
Cakravartī — Nīlāmbara Cakravartī. ***Cācā*** — a father's brother, an uncle; in colloquial speech, *kākā*. ***Sāčā*** — genuine, pure, true (*saccā*).

149 Nīlāmbara Cakravartī is Your maternal grandfather, so by that relation You are my nephew.

Anubhāṣya.
Nānā — maternal grandfather.

150 An uncle will bear his nephew's anger, and a nephew does not hold his uncle's offences against him."

151 So the two spoke in hints, and no one could grasp the inner meaning.

The Lord's words and the Kazi's reply —

152 The Lord said, "I have come to ask you a question," and the Kazi replied, "Ask whatever is on Your mind."

The Lord asks about the customs of Islam —

153 The Lord said, "You drink cow's milk, so the cow is your mother; the bull produces grain, so he is your father.

Anubhāṣya.
Anna upajāya ("produces grain"): the bull draws the plow and prepares the field for sowing and planting rice and other crops. In this way he gives the farmer the chief help in producing seed, grain and rice.

154 You kill your father and mother and eat them — what religion is this? On what authority do you commit such a sin?"

Anubhāṣya.
Ebā — "this," "or this."

The Kazi's words —

155 The Kazi said, “As You have the Vedas and Purāṇas, so we have our scripture, the book of the Koran.

Anubhāṣya.
Ketāba — a book.

156 That scripture distinguishes two paths, the path of worldly engagement and the path of renunciation, and on the path of renunciation the killing of any living being is forbidden.

Anubhāṣya.
Śarīʿat, *ṭarīqat* and *maʿrifat* — three kinds of path.

157 On the path of worldly engagement there is an injunction to kill cows, and if one kills by the order of scripture, there is no fear of sin.

158 Your Vedas too speak of the killing of cows, and great sages did kill them.”

The killing enjoined by the Vedas is justified because the animal regains its life —

159 The Lord said, “The Vedas forbid the killing of cows, and therefore no Hindu kills a cow.

160 The Vedas and Purāṇas command that one may kill a living being only if one can bring it back to life.

161 So the sages would kill a worn-out old animal (*jaradgava*) and restore its life by Vedic mantras.

162 The old animal became young once more, so this was not killing but a kindness.

The brāhmaṇas born in the age of Kali have no such power —

163 In the age of Kali the brāhmaṇas have no such power, and so now no one kills cows.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

(The Kazi said:) That scripture, the Koran, distinguishes two kinds of path: *pravṛtti* (the path of engagement) and *nivṛtti* (the path of renunciation). On the path of *nivṛtti* killing living beings is forbidden. But those who, like us, follow the path of *pravṛtti* do not become sinners if they kill cows by the order of scripture. And look at your Vedas: they contain injunctions to kill cows, and that is why great sages have killed cows from time immemorial.

Mahāprabhu said: The Vedas contain no injunction to kill cows. The statements about sacrifice performed by killing a cow that one does find in them concern the *jaradgava*, that is, a very old cow. The sages would kill a *jaradgava* and then, by Vedic mantras, bring it back to life in a youthful body. Such killing is no killing at all; it is only a kindness to the old cow. Since the brāhmaṇas of Kali have no such power, cows may not be killed now.

*(*Brahma-vaivarta Purāṇa*, *Kṛṣṇa-janma-khaṇḍa*, Chapter 185, verse 180; cited in the *Malamāsa-tattva*)*

164 “In the age of Kali one should give up five things: the horse sacrifice, the cow sacrifice, sannyāsa, the offering of flesh to the forefathers, and the begetting of a son by the husband’s brother.” (Brahma-vaivarta Purāṇa, Kṛṣṇa-janma-khaṇḍa, 185.180)[3]

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

The *aśvamedha*, the *gomedha*, *sannyāsa*, a *śrāddha* to the forefathers with meat, and begetting a son by the husband's brother — these five are forbidden in the age of Kali.

Anubhāṣya.

aśvamedhaṁ (a particular sacrifice in which a horse is killed) **gavālambhaṁ** (the *gomedha*) **sannyāsaṁ** (entering the fourth *āśrama*) **pala-paitṛkam** (a *śrāddha* to the forefathers with meat) **devareṇa** (by the husband's younger brother) **sutotpattiṁ** (begetting a son) — (these) **pañca kalau** (in the Kali-yuga) **vivarjayet** (one should give up).

The Lord examines the customs of Islam —

165 You cannot bring them back to life; all you do is kill. For you there is no escape from hell.

166 For as many thousands of years as there are hairs on a cow's body, the killer of a cow rots in the hell of Raurava.

167 The one who gave you your scripture was himself mistaken; not knowing the essence of scripture, he gave such an order."

Anubhāṣya.

Bhrānta (mistaken): because he approved of needless violence to living beings, his absorption in a "second" (*dvitīyābhiniveśa*) left his understanding perverted, that is, confused.

The Kazi has no answer and admits that his scripture is incomplete —

168 Hearing this, the Kazi was dumbstruck and could find no words. After some thought he admitted defeat and said:

169 "What You have said, Paṇḍita, is true. Our scriptures are recent and cannot stand up to reasoning.

Anubhāṣya.

Ādhunika (recent) — new, arisen within time; it is not *apauruṣeya* (not of human authorship) like the Veda.

Vicāra-saha naya (does not withstand scrutiny): since it does not establish the eternal, real truth, it is easily refuted by reasoning.

170 Our scripture is invented — I know that well; yet out of loyalty to my community I still accept it."

Anubhāṣya.

Kalpita (invented) — born of mental speculation, and therefore not eternal truth.
Jāti — one's community and loyalty to it.

171 The reasoning of the yavanas' scriptures is by nature unsound. Smiling, Mahāprabhu questioned him once more:

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

The scriptures of the *yavanas* are of three kinds: the old book of the "Yu" (the Jews), the Koran and the Bible. All these books have a beginning; none of them is beginningless like the words of the Veda. Therefore, since the reasoning in those scriptures has no firm root, it is open to doubt.

Anubhāṣya.

Adṛḍha vicāra (unsound reasoning) — reasoning that can be cut through, that is, refuted, by argument.

The Lord asks again —

172 "Let Me ask you one more question, uncle. Answer truly, and do not deceive Me with tricks.

173 In your town there is saṅkīrtana all the time — the din of drums and songs, singing and dancing.

174 You are the Kazi, with authority to oppose the Hindu religion; I cannot understand why you do not forbid it now."

In answer the Kazi tells of his dream —

175 The Kazi said, "Everyone calls You Gaurahari, and by that name I too shall address You.

176 Listen, Gaurahari: if we can speak in private, I shall tell You the reason."

The Lord reassures him —

177 The Lord said, "These people are My intimates. Speak plainly and have no fear."

Anubhāṣya.
Sphuṭa — clearly.

In a dream Śrī Nṛsiṁhadeva terrifies him —

178–179 The Kazi began: “When I went to a Hindu’s house, broke the mṛdaṅga and forbade the kīrtana, that very night there came a most terrible lion, with the body of a man and the face of a lion, roaring mightily.

Anubhāṣya.
Nara-deha, siṁha-mukha (a human body and a lion's face) — Śrī Nṛsiṁhadeva. He destroys enmity toward the devotees, toward devotion and toward Bhagavān, and destroys those who bear such enmity.

180 As I lay asleep, he leapt up onto me, laughing a terrible laugh and gnashing his teeth.

181 Pressing his claws into my chest, he said in a dreadful voice, ‘I will tear your chest open in return for the mṛdaṅga!

Anubhāṣya.
Phāḍimu — I will tear apart.

182 You forbid My kīrtana — I will destroy you!’ Terrified, I shut my eyes and trembled.

183 Seeing my fear, the lion grew kind and said, ‘I have humbled you only to teach you a lesson.

184 That day you did no great harm, so I have forgiven you and spared your life.

185 But if you do such a thing again, I will not bear it: I will destroy you with your whole family, and the yavanas too.’

186 With these words the lion went away, but I was filled with fear. Look — here are the marks of his claws on my chest!”

187 So saying, the Kazi bared his chest, and all who heard and saw were amazed.

188 The Kazi went on: “I have told this to no one. That same day one of my men came to me

Anubhāṣya.

Piyādā — a servant of low rank, a carrier of news or letters; in colloquial speech, a *cāprāsī*.

189 and said, ‘I went to stop the kīrtana, and suddenly a tongue of fire struck my face.

190 My whole beard was burnt and my face was blistered.’ Every one of my men who went there told the same story.

191 Seeing all this, I was seized with great fear; now I stay at home and do not forbid the kīrtana.

192 So the kīrtana went on in the town unhindered; and hearing of it, all the Muslims came to me with a complaint:

Anubhāṣya.

Mleccha: “One who eats beef, speaks much against [scripture] and is devoid of all proper conduct is called a *mleccha*.”

193 ‘The Hindu religion has grown beyond all bounds in the town; we hear nothing but “Hari! Hari!”’

194 Another said, ‘The Hindus cry “Kṛṣṇa! Kṛṣṇa!”; they laugh and weep, dance and sing, and roll in the dust.

195 They raise an uproar with “Hari! Hari!” If the Pādśāh hears of it, you will pay for it.’

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Even though the Pādśāh is your relative, he can punish you. The Pādśāh — the Pādśāh of Gauḍa, “Husain” Shah.

Anubhāṣya.

Pātsāha (the Pādśāh) — ʿAlāʾ-ud-dīn Sayyid Husain Shah (1498–1511 A.D.), at that time the independent ruler of Bengal. He killed his patron and master, the terribly oppressive Nawab Muzaffar Khan of the Abyssinian (Habshi) dynasty, and ascended the throne of Bengal. On taking the *masnad* of Bengal he assumed the name “Sayyid Husain ʿAlāʾ-ud-dīn Sharīf Makka.” Ghulam Husain, the author of the chronicle *Riyāẓ-us-Salāṭīn*, says that one of Nawab Husain Shah's ancestors had been the Sharif of Mecca, and so he probably took that name in memory of his family's glory. In the stone inscriptions of Gauḍa, however, he is known simply as “Husain Shah.” After his death his eldest son Nasrat Shah became Nawab of Bengal (1521–1533 A.D.). This cruel-natured nawab terribly oppressed the Vaiṣṇavas and, as a result of his own sins, was killed in a mosque by one of his officials.

196 Then I asked those Muslims, ‘That the Hindus say “Hari” is their nature — that I understand.

197 But you are Muslims: why do you take the name of the Hindus’ God all the time?’

198 One of them said, ‘I used to make fun of the Hindus. Some of them are called Kṛṣṇadāsa, some Rāmadāsa,

199 some Haridāsa, and they were forever saying “Hari! Hari!” — I thought they meant to steal someone’s wealth.

200 Ever since then my tongue keeps saying “Hari! Hari!” I do not want it to, yet it says it — what can I do?’

201–202 Another said, ‘Listen — I too mocked the Hindus in this way, and since that day my tongue repeats the name of Kṛṣṇa and will not be stopped. I do not know what spells and herbs these Hindus know!’

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

The Kazi said: “O Gaurahari, when I questioned that *mleccha* peon, he answered: ‘I said to the Hindus, “Some of you, calling yourselves Kṛṣṇadāsa, Rāmadāsa or Haridāsa, keep saying ‘Hari, Hari.’ But the word *hari, hari* means ‘I steal, I steal,’ so it seems you say ‘Hari, Hari’ (‘I take away, I take away’) because you mean to steal other people's wealth.” Ever since the day I joked with them like this, my tongue keeps saying “Hari, Hari” against my will, and I can do nothing about it.’”

Anubhāṣya.

Parihāsa (mockery) is one of the four kinds of *nāmābhāsa*, as it is said: “Chanting the name of Vaikuṇṭha — to indicate something else, in jest, for the sake of a tune, or with disregard — destroys all sins: so the wise know.” (*Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 6.2.14) Yet *nāmābhāsa* based on indication, mockery, musical filler or disregard is not merely the material pronunciation of syllables. Directed toward the eternal, real Substance, *nāmābhāsa* awakens remembrance of Viṣṇu, and so it destroys the *jīva's* desire for sense objects. As a result, the liberated *jīva*, now turned toward service, gains the qualification to utter the pure name.

*The *smārta pāṣaṇḍīs* complain to the Kazi —*

203 When I had heard this, I sent them all home. Just then five or seven Hindu unbelievers came to me.

Anubhāṣya.

Pāṣaṇḍī — a dull follower of *karma* who believes in many gods, an enemy of Viṣṇu and the Vaiṣṇavas, an idolater.

204 They said, ‘Nimāi has broken the Hindu religion. He has started a kīrtana the like of which we have never heard.

205 When we keep the night vigil for Maṅgala-caṇḍī or Viṣahari, then dancing, singing and music are proper.

206 This Nimāi Paṇḍita used to be a good young man, but since He came back from Gayā He does everything the wrong way.

207 He sings at the top of His voice and claps His hands, and the sound of mṛdaṅgas and karatālas deafens our ears.

208 Who knows what He has eaten to go mad like this? He dances and sings, laughs and weeps, falls down, gets up and rolls on the ground.

209 His constant saṅkīrtana has driven the townspeople mad. At night we cannot sleep; we lie awake.

210 He has given up the name Nimāi and now has Himself called Gaurahari. He has ruined the Hindu religion by spreading heresy.

211 The low-born chant Kṛṣṇa's name and rise higher and higher. For this sin Navadvīpa will be laid waste.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Nīca bāḍa bāḍa: he performs Kṛṣṇa's *kīrtana* with many low-born people, and by this the low are "growing," that is, rising.

212 In the Hindu scriptures, we know, the name of Īśvara is a great mantra; if everyone hears it, the mantra loses its power.

Anubhāṣya.

These polytheists (*bahv-īśvara-vādīs*) are called by the word *pāṣaṇḍa* because they considered the Lord, or the Lord's name, "a part of *karma*" (*karmāṅga*). They did not know how supremely magnanimous and glorious Kṛṣṇa's name is. Blinded by worldly high birth and social standing, they thought: if a low person, that is, one born in a low family, takes Kṛṣṇa's name, that is a special kind of sin; therefore taking Kṛṣṇa's name depends on good family or high birth. These polytheists equated the *mahā-mantra*, Kṛṣṇa's name, with other mantras for *japa*, and thought: if the *mahā-mantra*, which is to be chanted always, is spoken or sung aloud — that is, if it suddenly comes onto the tongue and reaches

the ear — then instead of revealing its own matchless supreme majesty and delivering everyone from Brahmā down to a blade of grass, it becomes fruitless. So opposed are they to the path of the Śrutis, these arguers whose reasoning rests on sense knowledge (*akṣaja-hetuvādīs*)!

213 You are the lord of this place, and all its people are yours. Summon Nimāi and drive Him out.'

Anubhāṣya.

Next they address the Kazi and say: "You are the all-powerful master of this place, and everyone in the village is subject to you. Therefore summon Nimāi Paṇḍita and expel Him from the community."

The Kazi consoles them —

214 Then I soothed them: 'Go home, all of you. I will stop Him.'

The Kazi's words to the Lord —

215 The great God of the Hindus is Nārāyaṇa — and my heart tells me that You are He."

The Lord's merciful words —

216 Hearing this, Mahāprabhu smiled and, touching the Kazi, began to speak:

**Nāmābhāsa* destroys sins —*

217 "Kṛṣṇa's name in your mouth — this is most wonderful! Your sins are destroyed, and you have become supremely pure.

218 You have spoken three names — Hari, Kṛṣṇa and Nārāyaṇa. You are most fortunate and most pious."

Anubhāṣya.

Nāmābhāsa arose on the Kazi's lips.

The Kazi speaks humbly —

219 At these words tears fell from the Kazi's eyes, and touching the Lord's feet, he said with deep feeling:

220 "By Your grace my evil mind is gone. Be merciful to me, so that devotion to You may abide in me."

The Lord's words —

221 The Lord said, "I beg one gift of you: let there be no obstruction to the saṅkīrtana in Nadia."

Anubhāṣya.
That the *kīrtana* of Kṛṣṇa's name should meet with no obstruction in Navadvīpa.

The Kazi's promise —

222 The Kazi said, "On all who are born in my line I shall lay a solemn charge (*talāk*): they shall never obstruct the kīrtana."

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
Tālāka — a solemnly made vow.

Anubhāṣya.
The Kazi's descendants still take part in the *saṅkīrtana* of Kṛṣṇa's name and have not the slightest objection to it.

The joy of the Lord and the devotees —

223 Thereupon the Lord rose, crying "Hari!", and all the Vaiṣṇavas rose with Him, raising the sound of Hari's name.

The Lord returns home with His associates —

224 The Lord set off to go on with the kīrtana, and the Kazi walked along with Him, his heart full of joy.

225 Then the son of Śacī bade the Kazi farewell and came back to His own home, dancing all the way.

226 Thus the Lord showed His grace to the Kazi. Whoever hears of it is freed from his offences.

*During the Lord's *kīrtana* in Śrīvāsa's house, Śrīvāsa's son leaves his body —*

227 One day the Lord was dancing with Nityānanda in Śrīvāsa's house — the two brothers together.

228 Just then Śrīvāsa's son passed away, yet no grief arose in Śrīvāsa's heart.

The truth is spoken through the mouth of the dead son —

229 The Lord made the dead son speak words of divine knowledge, and the two brothers Themselves became Śrīvāsa's sons.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

One night Mahāprabhu was performing *kīrtana* in Śrīvāsa's courtyard, and at that time one of Śrīvāsa's sons departed from this world. Fearing that the *rasa* of the *kīrtana* would be broken, Śrīvāsa forbade everyone to show any grief, and Mahāprabhu danced and sang *kīrtana* until late in the night. When the *kīrtana* ended, Mahāprabhu could understand that some misfortune had befallen the house. Learning that Śrīvāsa's son had departed, the Lord first expressed sorrow that He had not been told sooner. Then He had the dead boy laid before Him and asked him, "Boy, why are you leaving Śrīvāsa?" The dead boy replied, "I was destined to stay in Śrīvāsa's house for a certain number of days. Those days are over, and now by Your will I am going elsewhere. I am a *jīva*, eternally subordinate to You and dependent on You, and I have no right to do anything beyond Your will." Hearing the dead boy's words, Śrīvāsa's family gained divine knowledge, and no grief remained in them. Then the boy's funeral rites were performed. The Lord said to Śrīvāsa, "The son you had has gone. But Nityānanda and I are your eternal sons; We can never leave you."

Anubhāṣya.

See the *Caitanya-bhāgavata*, Madhya, Chapter 25.

The Lord gives His remnants to Nārāyaṇī, Śrīvāsa's niece —

230 Then He gave boons to all the devotees, and He honoured Nārāyaṇī by giving her His remnants.

Anubhāṣya.

See the *Caitanya-bhāgavata*, Madhya, Chapter 10. Certain characterless *prākṛta-sahajiyā* "Ṭhākuras," *pāṣaṇḍīs* by nature, wishing to present Śrīla Vṛndāvana dāsa as a *golaka*[10], say: "Śrīmatī Nārāyaṇī ate the remnants of Śrīman Mahāprabhu's food, or His chewed betel, and as a result, while a widow, gave birth to Ṭhākura Vṛndāvana dāsa." Such slanderous babble is wholly offensive, and therefore one must not listen to it.

*A tailor born in a *yavana* family sees the Lord's form and goes mad —*

231 A Muslim tailor used to sew Śrīvāsa's clothes, and the Lord let him see His own form.

232 Crying, "I have seen! I have seen!", he went mad with love and began to dance, and he became foremost among Vaiṣṇavas.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

A *yavana* tailor who lived near Śrīvāsa used to sew his clothes. When he watched Mahāprabhu's dancing with faith and was charmed, the Lord showed him the spiritual (*cinmaya*) nature of His own form. The tailor began to dance, mad with *prema*, crying, "I have seen! I have seen!" ***Āgala*** — foremost.

At the Lord's wish Śrīvāsa describes Kṛṣṇa's sweet pastimes —

233 Absorbed in ecstasy, the Lord asked Śrīvāsa for His flute, and Śrīvāsa said, "The gopīs have stolen Your flute."

234 At this the Lord cried in ecstasy, "Tell Me! Tell Me!", and Śrīvāsa began to describe the rasa of the pastimes of Vṛndāvana.

235 First he described the sweetness of Vṛndāvana, and as the Lord listened, the joy in His heart grew.

236 Again and again the Lord said, “Tell Me! Tell Me!”, and again and again Śrīvāsa told it, at ever greater length:

237 how the sound of the flute drew the gopīs to the forest, and how Kṛṣṇa wandered there with them all;

238 and within that he described the pastimes of the six seasons, and told of the drinking of madhu, the festival of the rāsa dance and the play in the water.

239 “Tell Me! Tell Me!” said the Lord, delighting in all He heard, and then Śrīvāsa told of the rāsa dance and its play of rasa.

Anubhāṣya.

Śrīvāsa's description of Kṛṣṇa's *madhura* (*śṛṅgāra*) *rasa* with the *gopīs* of Vraja deserves special attention.

240 So, telling and hearing, they passed the night until morning came, and the Lord embraced Śrīvāsa and filled him with joy.

In Ācāryaratna's house the Lord dances in the guise of Lakṣmī —

241 Then, in the house of Ācārya Candraśekhara, He enacted Kṛṣṇa’s pastimes, and the Lord Himself took the forms of Rukmiṇī and others.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

One night in the house of Śrī Candraśekhara Ācāryaratna the Lord assumed the form of Rukmiṇī and others and enacted a pastime. Advaita, Haridāsa and many others also put on various costumes.

Anubhāṣya.

On the Lord in the mood and guise of Rukmiṇī, see the *Caitanya-bhāgavata*, Madhya, Chapter 18.

242 At times He became Durgā or Lakṣmī, at times the spiritual potency (*cit-śakti*) herself; and seated on the couch, He gave the devotees loving devotion.

Anubhāṣya.

On the Lord, in the guise of Ādyā-śakti, giving the devotees breast milk and *prema-bhakti*, see the *Caitanya-bhāgavata*, Madhya, Chapter 18.

A brāhmaṇa woman touches the Lord's feet, and the Lord throws Himself into the Gaṅgā —

243 One day, when Mahāprabhu's dancing had ended, a brāhmaṇa woman came and clasped His feet.

244 Again and again she took the dust of His feet, and seeing this, the Lord was overcome with sorrow.

245 At once the Lord ran and threw Himself into the Ganges; Nityānanda and Haridāsa caught hold of Him and brought Him out.

246 That night He stayed in the house of Vijaya Ācārya, and in the morning the devotees all took Him home.

Anubhāṣya.

This incident does not appear in the *Caitanya-bhāgavata*.

The Lord cries aloud, "Gopī! Gopī!" —

247 One day, sitting at home in the mood of a gopī, the Lord was calling "Gopī! Gopī!", sunk in sorrow.

*A *pāṣaṇḍī* student, not understanding the heart of the matter, tries to stop the Lord —*

248 A student came to see the Lord and, hearing Him call "Gopī! Gopī!", began to say:

249 “Why do You not chant the name of Kṛṣṇa? Kṛṣṇa’s name is blessed. What merit is there in saying ‘Gopī! Gopī!’?”

The Lord chases the student to strike him; the student flees —

250 Hearing this, the Lord in anger heaped reproaches on Kṛṣṇa, and He took up a stick and rose to beat the student.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
Doṣodgāra — blaming with mockery.

251 The student fled in terror with the Lord running after him, until in great haste the devotees held the Lord back.

The Lord is calmed —

252 They calmed Him and brought Him back to His house, while the student ran off to the gathering of the students.

The students speak harshly of the Lord and grow angry —

253 Going to the place where a thousand students studied together, the young brāhmaṇa told them what had happened with the Lord.

254 At this the whole crowd of students grew angry, and together they all began to revile the Lord:

255 “Nimāi alone has corrupted the whole land. He wants to beat a brāhmaṇa — He has no fear of dharma!

A plot to beat the Lord —

256 If He does such a thing again, we shall beat Him. Who is He, after all? What can He do?”

For their enmity toward the Lord they lose their learning and intelligence —

257 By blaspheming the Lord they all lost their intelligence, and the learning they had studied so well no longer shone in any of them.

Anubhāṣya.

For (*Śvetāśvatara Upaniṣad* 6.23): “Only to the great soul whose supreme devotion is for God, and for the guru as for God, are the meanings of these words revealed.” That is, the true meaning of these Śrutis, whose import is devotion to Hari, is revealed only in the pure heart of that great soul whose supreme (causeless and uninterrupted) devotion is for Viṣṇu, his supreme Deity, and equally for Śrī Gurudeva, the best of His servants. In no other heart is it revealed.

Śrī Prahlāda's words (*Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 7.5.24): “If a person, having offered himself to Viṣṇu, performs the ninefold devotion directly for Bhagavān, I consider that the best learning.” Śrīdhara's commentary: “If it is performed already offered, and not first performed and offered afterward, I consider that the best learning. The sense is: nothing of that kind have I studied or learned from this teacher.” That is, first self-surrender, then the activity of serving Hari — this alone is the rule. Only then may the study of scripture be considered the best. No learning or study can be higher than worship of Viṣṇu preceded by self-surrender.

Under the sway of ignorance (*avidyā*), the proud man who prides himself on worldly learning disregards Viṣṇu, the life of the bride of transcendental knowledge. Since that hypocrite does not surrender to Viṣṇu, the eternal, real Substance, knowledge does not dawn in his heart, stained with sin. Therefore it is said (*Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 11.11.18): “If one expert in the *śabda-brahman* is not absorbed in the Supreme, his labor yields him only labor, like one who tends a cow that gives no milk.” If someone, though thoroughly versed in the Vedas and other scriptures, is not devoted to Viṣṇu, the Parabrahman, all his labor in studying scripture ends only in useless toil.

258 Even so, the proud students did not become humble; wherever they went they laughed and spoke ill of the Lord.

*Seeing the wretched fate of the *pāṣaṇḍīs*, the Lord is filled with compassion —*

259 The all-knowing Lord knew their plight, and sitting at home He pondered how they might be delivered:

Who the nondevotees are —

260 "All these teachers and their disciples are given to ritual duty, fruitive work and austerity — yet they are blasphemers and wicked men.

The Lord ponders how to free them from the offense of enmity toward Kṛṣṇa —

261 Because of their offence of blaspheming Me, they cannot take up devotion unless I Myself lead them to it.

262 I came to deliver them, and the very opposite has happened. How can any good come to these wicked men?

Anubhāṣya.

The *Caitanya-bhāgavata*, Madhya, Chapter 25: "I tried to cure the phlegm with bits of *pippalī*, but instead the phlegm in the body only increased."

263 If they bow down to Me, their sins will be destroyed, and then, if I lead them to devotion, they will take it up.

Anubhāṣya.

A *smārta* student sunk in *karma* could not understand that the Lord's anger toward Kṛṣṇa and His reproaches of Kṛṣṇa in the mood of a *gopī* were transcendental, and he argued with the Lord. The Lord, full of the mood of a *gopī*, took him for Kṛṣṇa's partisan and angrily chased him, and the student fled. Seeing this, the so-called brāhmaṇas (*brāhmaṇa-bruvas*), sunk in *karma* and averse to Hari, deluded as they were, plotted to beat the Lord. And the Lord, to free them from their evil fate and misery, wished to accept the fourth *āśrama* — the *āśrama* of the guru of those who, in the eyes of worldly society, are highest in birth and proud of their *varṇa*. See the *Caitanya-bhāgavata*, Madhya, Chapter 25.

*The Lord wishes to deliver the *pāṣaṇḍīs* —*

264 Those who blaspheme Me and will not bow to Me — all these souls I must surely deliver.

*The resolve to enact the pastime of *sannyāsa*, honored by the world —*

265 So I shall certainly take sannyāsa; then, taking Me for a sannyāsī, they will bow down to Me.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

According to the scriptures, when a brāhmaṇa accepts *sannyāsa*, everyone — householders, brāhmaṇas and all the rest — bows to him with the thought of a *sannyāsī*, that is, knowing that a *sannyāsī* is worthy of obeisance. If I accept *sannyāsa*, the blaspheming brāhmaṇas will surely bow down to Me and receive good sense from Me.

*By bowing to the Lord as a *sannyāsī*, even the *pāṣaṇḍīs* — brāhmaṇas and other high castes — will be purified in heart, and the urge to serve will awaken in them —*

266 By bowing down they will be freed from their offences, and in their purified hearts I shall make devotion arise.

Anubhāṣya.

Mahāprabhu was convinced that even so-called brāhmaṇas, *pāṣaṇḍīs* by nature, would prostrate themselves before a Vaiṣṇava *sannyāsī*; and in those days such was proper conduct (*sadācāra*) as well. Nowadays, however, there are people even more arrogant than those so-called brāhmaṇas, who do not prostrate themselves before a Vaiṣṇava *sannyāsī*. For them the scripture enjoins: “A man who sees a Deity or a *tridaṇḍī yati* and does not bow down must perform atonement.” (A variant reading: “…if he does not bow down, he is purified by fasting.”) That is, if some so-called brāhmaṇa sees the Deity of Śrī Viṣṇu, the supreme Godhead, or a Vaiṣṇava *tridaṇḍi-sannyāsī* and does not bow down, then for that lapse he must perform atonement or be purified by fasting.

267 Then these unbelievers will be delivered. There is no other way — this is the best plan.”

At that time Keśava Bhāratī accepts alms in the Lord's house in Navadvīpa —

268 Having made this firm resolve, the Lord remained at home. Then Keśava Bhāratī came to the town of Nadia.

269 The Lord bowed to him and invited him, and when He had fed him, He made His request:

The Lord appeals to Bhāratī —

270 "You are Īśvara indeed — Nārāyaṇa Himself. Be merciful and set Me free from saṁsāra."

Bhāratī's words —

271 Bhāratī said, "You are Īśvara, the Lord who dwells within all hearts. Whatever You say I shall do; I am not my own master."

*Bhāratī returns to Kāṭoyā, and the Lord accepts *sannyāsa* from him —*

272 With these words Bhāratī Gosāñi went to Kāṭoyā, and Mahāprabhu went there and took sannyāsa.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

At the end of Mahāprabhu's twenty-fourth year, on the day of the *saṅkramaṇa* (the sun's passage into a new sign) that begins the *uttarāyaṇa* and that fell in the bright fortnight of Māgha, Mahāprabhu left Śrī Navadvīpa at the end of the night. He swam across the Gaṅgā at "Nidayā's Ghāṭa," reached Kaṇṭakanagara, that is, the village of Kāṭoyā, and accepted (one) *daṇḍa* from Keśava Bhāratī. On Mahāprabhu's order Candraśekhara Ācāryaratna performed all the ritual parts of *sannyāsa*. The *kīrtana* went on all day, and only when the day was nearly over was the shaving of the head completed. The next morning Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya, dressed as a *sannyāsī* and bearing the *daṇḍa*, set out to wander through Rāḍha-deśa. Keśava Bhāratī went with Him for some distance.

*At the Lord's *sannyāsa*: Nitāi, Ācāryaratna and Mukunda —*

273 With Him were Nityānanda, Candraśekhara Ācārya and Mukunda Datta, and these three performed all the rites.

274 Thus I have given an outline of the Ādi-līlā; Vṛndāvana dāsa has described it in detail.

Anubhāṣya.
See the *Caitanya-bhāgavata*, Madhya, Chapter 26.

*The Lord's states of heart in the moods of *dāsya*, *sakhya*, *vātsalya* and *madhura* (but not *śānta*) —*

275 The son of Yaśodā has become the son of Śacī, and He tastes the four kinds of His devotees' moods.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
Caturvidha bhakta-bhāva (the four kinds of devotees' moods) — the four kinds of devotional mood based on the *rasas* of *dāsya*, *sakhya*, *vātsalya* and *madhura*.

*Gaurasundara is Himself the *viṣaya-vigraha*, filled with the *bhāva* of the *āśraya*; refutation of the "Gaura-nāgarī" doctrine —*

276 To taste His own sweetness and the rasa of Rādhā's love, He has fully made Rādhā's mood His own.

277 The Lord has wholly taken on the gopīs' mood, in which they hold the son of Vraja's king as their own beloved.

278 And this is the firm certainty of the gopīs' love: it does not arise for anyone but the son of the king of Vraja —

Anubhāṣya.
Śrī Gaurasundara is Kṛṣṇa illumined by the mood and luster of Śrī Rādhā. Therefore, for the sake of serving Śrī Kṛṣṇa, He never gave up the heartfelt mood of Śrīmatī Rādhikā and the other *gopīs*, the mood of the *āśraya*. Never, like Śrī

Kṛṣṇa Himself, did He take on the conduct of the *viṣaya*; that is, never, conceiving of Himself as the enjoyer, did He display the ways of a “lecherous *nāgara*,” such as looking at other men's wives. The worldly, lustful Sahajiyā sect, lechers after other men's wives, try to load their own abominable lustful thirst and adultery onto the shoulders of Śrī Gaurasundara, the guru of the world, who displays the pastimes of an ācārya. But by this they only increase their offense at the feet of Śrī Svarūpa Dāmodara, the crest jewel of Vaiṣṇava ācāryas, and of Ṭhākura Vṛndāvana dāsa. The *Caitanya-bhāgavata*, Ādi, Chapter 15: “He never jested with other men's wives; when He saw a woman, the Lord moved far to one side. In this way He was playful with everyone — only at women would He not look even from the corner of His eye. In this *avatāra* the Lord would not even let the word ‘woman’ reach His ears — this is known to all the world. Therefore no great soul ever offers a prayer such as ‘Gaurāṅga-nāgara.’ Although every prayer befits Him, the wise still sing only of His true nature.” In these three verses the imaginary “Gaura-nāgarī doctrine,” which opposes the conclusions of devotion and is nourished by immorality, is clearly refuted.

*The *gopīs* have no love for any form other than Kṛṣṇa's *svayaṁ-rūpa* —*

279 Śyāmasundara, adorned with a peacock feather and guñjā beads, in a cowherd’s dress, His body bent in three places, the flute at His lips.

280 If Kṛṣṇa leaves this form and takes another, the gopīs’ love does not come near Him.

*(*Lalita-mādhava*, Act 6, verse 14)*

281 “What wise man can fathom the ways of the gopīs’ love for the son of the cowherd king — a love that moves on a path beyond comprehension? For even when He reveals a form of Viṣṇu, wondrous in its splendour, with four victorious arms, their love, alas, shrinks back.” (Lalita-mādhava, 6.14)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Once Śrī Kṛṣṇa, in jest, manifested the four-armed form of Nārāyaṇa, endowed with wondrous beauty — and the love (*rāga*) of the *gopīs*, instead of awakening, shrank. So which *paṇḍita* can understand the workings of the

gopīs' *bhāva*? For they follow the inaccessible path of *parakīya*, worshipping the son of Nanda alone.

Anubhāṣya.

Viśākhā's words to Savarṇā, the wife of Sūrya: **gopīnāṁ durūha-padavī-sañcāriṇaḥ** (whose nature is to move along a path hard to understand) **paśupendra-nandana-juṣaḥ** (of one who serves the son of the lord of the cowherds, Nanda, the king of the *gopas* — that is, wholly devoted to serving Kṛṣṇa) **bhāvasya tāṁ prakriyāṁ vijñātuṁ** (to understand) **kaḥ kṛtī kṣamate** (is able)? (For) **hanta**! **jiṣṇubhiḥ** (victorious) **caturbhiḥ bhujaiḥ** (the arms of the Nārāyaṇa form He has assumed) **adbhuta-rociṁ** (whose luster, whose beauty, is wondrous — unearthly and full of radiance) **vaiṣṇavīṁ tanuṁ āviṣkurvati** (when He manifests) **tasmin** (in Kṛṣṇa) **api yāsāṁ** (of the *gopīs*) **rāgodayaḥ kuñcati** (does not blossom).

*Wishing to hide during the *rāsa*, Kṛṣṇa shows the *gopīs* a four-armed form and so protects Himself —*

282 In spring, as Kṛṣṇa was dancing the rāsa by Govardhana, He made a sign to Rādhā and disappeared.

283 He sat in a secluded bower watching the path for Rādhā, and a troop of gopīs came there searching for Him.

Anubhāṣya.

Bāṭa — a path, a road. ***Ṭhāṭa*** — an army drawn up in ranks.

284 Seeing Kṛṣṇa from afar, the gopīs cried, “Look, there in the bower is the son of Vraja’s king!”

285 Seeing the gopīs, Kṛṣṇa was alarmed; He could not hide, and fear overcame Him.

Anubhāṣya.

Sādhvasa — fear, terror, apprehension, agitation of the mind, confusion.

286 So He took a four-armed form and sat there, and seeing Kṛṣṇa thus, the gopīs came near and said,

*The *gopīs* offer prayers to Nārāyaṇa —*

287 “This is not Kṛṣṇa; this is a form of Nārāyaṇa.” So saying, they all bowed to Him and offered praise:

288 “Obeisance to Nārāyaṇa! O Lord, be gracious: grant us Kṛṣṇa’s company and take away our sorrow.”

Anubhāṣya.
More — to us.

289 With these words they bowed and went away, and just then Rādhā came into view.

*As soon as Śrīmatī Rādhikā arrives, the four-armed form vanishes: the two-armed form is the *svayaṁ-rūpa* —*

290 Seeing Rādhā, Kṛṣṇa wanted to keep that four-armed form, to tease Her as well.

291 But before Rādhā two of His arms vanished; try as He might, Kṛṣṇa could not keep them.

Śrī Rādhā's inconceivable love for Kṛṣṇa —

292 Such is the inconceivable power of Rādhā’s pure love, which brought Kṛṣṇa back to His own two-armed nature.

*Kṛṣṇa's cleverness is defeated before Śrī Rādhā; Śyāmasundara is the eternal *svayaṁ-rūpa* — (*Ujjvala-nīlamaṇi*, section 7, the words of Śrī Rūpa Gosvāmī)*

293 “At the start of the rāsa dance Kṛṣṇa hid in a bower, but the doe-eyed gopīs saw Him; to conceal Himself, He cleverly showed them a four-armed

form. Yet before the splendour of Rādhā's love even the all-powerful Hari could not keep it. Ah, how great is Her love!" (Ujjvala-nīlamaṇi)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

At the beginning of the *rāsa*, Kṛṣṇa, in play, hid in a *kuñja*. Seeing the doe-eyed *gopīs* coming toward Him, He grew anxious and displayed His charming four-armed form. The ordinary *gopīs* said only, "This is not Śrī Kṛṣṇa, the object of our love." But how wondrous is the glory of Rādhā's love! As soon as Śrī Rādhā arrived, Kṛṣṇa, try as He might, could not keep that four-armed form.

Anubhāṣya.

govardhanopatyakāyāṁ (in the valley at Govardhana, at the site of the *rāsa* known as "Parāsaulī") **vasanta-kāle** (in spring) **rāsārambha-vidhau** (at the beginning of the *rāsa* dance, that is, when it was about to begin) **kuñje nilīya vasatā** (hiding) **hariṇā** (by Śrī Kṛṣṇa) **mṛgākṣi-gaṇaiḥ** (doe-eyed) **gopībhiḥ** (by the *gopīs* — in the forest Praviṣṭaka, called Peṭhā) **dṛṣṭaṁ svam** (Himself) **gopayituṁ** (to hide — for the many *gopīs* had surrounded that *kuñja* on all sides, and it was impossible to slip away from it suddenly) **uddhura-dhiyā** (with superb intelligence) **yā catur-bāhutā suṣṭhu sandarśitā**, **yasya** (of the glory of love for Kṛṣṇa) **śriyā prabhaviṣṇunā** (by Kṛṣṇa) **api sā catur-bāhutā rakṣituṁ na śakyā āsīt** — **hanta** (oh!) **rādhāyāḥ praṇayasya mahimā** (glory) — (so inconceivable is it). (In the *Gautamīya-tantra*: "…dwelling on the beautiful hill of Govardhana, eager to taste the *rasa* of the *rāsa* dance." Bhagavān is subordinate to *prema*; still, one cannot say that His majesty ceases to exist before *prema*, for it is eternal; rather, it becomes hidden.)

Nanda is Jagannātha Miśra; Yaśodā is Śacī —

294 He who was the king of Vraja is here Jagannātha, the father; she who was the queen of Vraja is here Śacīdevī, the mother.

Kānāi and Balāi of Vraja are Gaura and Nitāi of Gauḍa —

295 He who was Nanda's son is here Caitanya Gosāñi; He who was Baladeva is here Nityānanda, His brother.

*Nityānanda Rāma serves Gaura-Kṛṣṇa in all the *rasas* except *madhura* —*

296 Filled with three moods — parental love, servitude and friendship — Nityānanda is the helper of Kṛṣṇa Caitanya.

297 Giving prema-bhakti, He flooded the world; people cannot understand His wondrous ways.

*Advaita, the *avatāra* of a devotee, preaches pure devotion —*

298 Advaita Ācārya Gosāñi is the incarnation as a devotee (*bhakta-avatāra*); He brought Kṛṣṇa down and preached devotion.[4]

Advaita serves Gaura-Kṛṣṇa in two moods —

299 Friendship and servitude are His two natural moods, and at times the Lord treats Him as His guru.

*The *dāsya* of Śrīvāsa and the other pure devotees —*

300 Śrīvāsa and all the other devotees of Mahāprabhu serve Caitanya, each in his own mood.

*The Lord's potencies — Gadādhara, Svarūpa, Rāmānanda, Śrī Rūpa and others — serve Gaura-Kṛṣṇa in *madhura-rasa* —*

301 Paṇḍita Gosāñi and the others — whatever each one's rasa, in that very rasa the Lord comes under his control.[5]

Anubhāṣya.

These verses describe the gradations in the wondrous variety of moods in which Śrī Nityānanda and Śrī Advaita serve Gaura, transcendentally and supremely marvelously. The *Gaura-gaṇoddeśa-dīpikā* (11–16): "Gauracandra is in the form of a devotee, for He is the son of Nanda. Nityānanda, who in Vraja is Śrī Halāyudha, is a devotee by His very nature. Ācārya Advaita, who is Śrī Sadāśiva, is the *avatāra* of a devotee. Śrīnivāsa and the others are called devotees, for they are in the form of devotees. The foremost of the twice-born, Śrī Gadādhara

Paṇḍita, is the potency of a devotee. Śrīmad Viśvambhara, Advaita and the *avadhūta* Nityānanda — here three *vigrahas* are to be recognized, and all three are *prabhus*. One is Mahāprabhu, Śrī Caitanya, the ocean of mercy; two are *prabhus*, the illustrious great souls Nityānanda and Advaita. They are *gosvāmīs* and *vigrahas*; and together with Gadādhara, the twice-born, and Śrīnivāsa Paṇḍita, they make up the Pañca-tattva. On this the Gosvāmī Śrī Svarūpa, whose feet are lotuses, said: 'Here three *vigrahas* are to be known, and these three are *prabhus*: one is Mahāprabhu, and two are *prabhus*; so the saintly hold.'" Ibid., verses 23–24: Śrī Īśvara Purī served in *śṛṅgāra-rasa*, Advaita Prabhu in *dāsya-* and *sakhya-rasa*, and Śrī Raṅgapurī in pure *vātsalya-rasa*. See Ādi 7.10–17.

*In Vraja, the pastimes of Śyāma, the cowherd's son with the flute at His lips; in Gauḍa, the pastimes of Gaura, the embodiment of *kīrtana* in the guise of a brāhmaṇa and a *sannyāsī* —*

302 There He is Śyāma, the flute at His lips, sporting as a cowherd boy; here He is Gaura — at times a brāhmaṇa, at times a sannyāsī.

*Kṛṣṇa, filled with the mood of the *gopīs*, tastes love for Kṛṣṇa in the form of Gaura —*

303 Therefore the Lord Himself, taking on the mood of the gopīs, calls the son of Vraja's king "Lord of My life".

*Without following those who follow Rūpa, Gaura's *rasa* of separation (*vipralambha*) cannot be fathomed —*

304 He is Kṛṣṇa, and He is a gopī — a supreme contradiction! The Lord's inconceivable ways are very hard to understand.

Anubhāṣya.
See Ādi 17.276–278.

Gaura's inconceivable moods, full of supreme and wondrous variety, are beyond logic —

305 Let no one raise doubts about this by argument: such is Kṛṣṇa's inconceivable potency.

306 Inconceivable and wondrous are the pastimes of Kṛṣṇa Caitanya — wondrous His moods, wondrous His qualities, wondrous His ways.

The wretched fate of the logician: "The doubter perishes"[11] —

307 The wicked man who rejects this by argument rots in Kumbhīpāka, with no way out.

Anubhāṣya.

Kumbhīpāka — a particular hell, where sinners are cooked in a special vessel called a *kumbhī*. (*Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 5.26.13): "One who in this world cruelly cooks animals or birds alive — merciless, despised even by man-eaters — is cooked in the next world by the servants of Yama in Kumbhīpāka, in boiling oil." The *jīva* who kills living beings deserves Yama's punishment and is cooked in Kumbhīpāka.

*(*Bhakti-rasāmṛta-sindhu*, the wave on *sthāyi-bhāva*, 93)*

308 "What is inconceivable should not be put to the test of argument. And what lies beyond material nature — that is the mark of the inconceivable." (Bhakti-rasāmṛta-sindhu, 2.5.93)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

The truth that lies beyond *prakṛti* — that is the mark of the inconceivable. Logic (*tarka*) is material, and so it cannot touch that truth. Therefore one should not apply logic to what is inconceivable.

Thus ends the seventeenth chapter of the "Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya."

Anubhāṣya.

Dhṛtarāṣṭra wished to hear the names of the rivers, mountains, forests and other things on the earth, and in reply to his question Sañjaya said: **ye bhāvāḥ acintyāḥ** (beyond thought that is full of material enjoyment) **khalu** (certainly), **tān acintya-**

bhāvān tarkeṇa na yojayet (meaning: one should not assail them with arguments); **yat ca prakṛtibhyaḥ param** (other, beyond — in short, transcendental), **tat eva acintyasya lakṣaṇam**.

Only one who has faith attains service —

309 Whoever has faith in Caitanya's wondrous pastimes comes to His feet.

310 In the course of the story I have told the essence of this conclusion; whoever hears it attains pure devotion.

Repetition —

311 When I restate what the book has already told, the reader comes to taste its meaning.

*The chapters described after the manner of Śrī Vyāsa in the *Bhāgavatam* —*

312 So it is Vyāsa's way in the Bhāgavatam: as he tells the story, he restates it again and again.

Anubhāṣya.
At the end of the *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam*, in the twelfth chapter of the twelfth canto, Śrī Kṛṣṇa Dvaipāyana Vedavyāsa summarized the entire *Bhāgavatam* from beginning to end in 52 verses and so concluded the book. Following the path shown by that *mahājana*, the author too briefly recapitulates Śrī Caitanya's Ādi-līlā.

Repetition, briefly describing the chapters —

313 So now I shall count the chapters of the Ādi-līlā. In the first chapter I made the "auspicious invocation";

314 the second chapter is the "determining of the truth of Caitanya": He who is Svayam Bhagavān, the son of Vraja's king,

315 is Caitanya-Kṛṣṇa, the son of Śacī. The third chapter gives the "general" cause of His birth,

316 and within it the "special" cause, the gift of prema; the religion of the age is the preaching of Kṛṣṇa's name and of prema.

317 In the fourth I told the "root" cause of His birth: to taste the blissful rasa of love for His own sweetness.

318 The fifth determines the truth of Śrī Nityānanda: Nityānanda was Rāma, the son of Rohiṇī.

319 The sixth chapter considers the truth of Advaita: Advaita Ācārya is the avatāra of Mahā-Viṣṇu.

320 The seventh chapter gives the account of the Pañca-tattva — how the five truths together gave away prema.

321 The eighth gives the reason for describing Caitanya's pastimes and tells the great glory of a single name of Kṛṣṇa.

322 The ninth describes the wish-fulfilling tree of devotion, which Śrī Caitanya, the gardener, planted.

323 The tenth counts the branches of the main trunk and tells how all the branches gave out the fruit.

324 The eleventh gives the account of Nityānanda's branches, and the twelfth describes the branches of Advaita's trunk.

325 The thirteenth gives the account of Mahāprabhu's birth — how the Lord was born amid the chanting of Kṛṣṇa's name.

326 The fourteenth gives some account of the childhood pastimes, and the fifteenth tells of the boyhood pastimes in brief.

327 In the sixteenth I gave an outline of the pastimes of youth, and in the seventeenth I told especially of the pastimes of young manhood.

Anubhāṣya.

Verses 313 to 327 list the chapters. In the first chapter — the *maṅgalācaraṇa*, with obeisance to the gurus and others. In the second — the *maṅgalācaraṇa* that points to the truth of Gaura. In the third — the general cause of the *avatāra*: the gift of *prema*. In the fourth — the root cause of the *avatāra*. In the fifth — the truth of Nityānanda. In the sixth — the truth of Advaita set forth. In the seventh — the Pañca-tattva set forth, and its preaching. In the eighth — the introduction and the glory of the name. In the ninth — the description of the wish-fulfilling tree of devotion, and its preaching. In the tenth — the list of Gaura's associates. In the eleventh — the list of Nityānanda's associates. In the twelfth — the list of Advaita's and Gadādhara's associates. In the thirteenth — Gaura's birth pastime. In the fourteenth — the pastimes of childhood. In the fifteenth — the *paugaṇḍa* pastimes. In the sixteenth — the *kaiśora* pastimes. In the seventeenth — the pastimes of youth.

328 These are the seventeen chapters of the Ādi-līlā; twelve of them form the preface to the book.

329 In five chapters I have told the deeds of the five ages, very briefly, without going into detail.

Anubhāṣya.

The Ādi-līlā has seventeen chapters, or sections (*prabandhas*). Of these, the first twelve are only the preface, or introduction, to the book. The following five chapters, from the thirteenth to the seventeenth, are five sections on the five ages: “birth,” “childhood” (*bālya*), “boyhood” (*paugaṇḍa*), “youth” (*kaiśora*) and “young manhood” (*yuvā*).

330 Vṛndāvana dāsa has described all this in detail in the *Caitanya-maṅgala*, by the strength of Nityānanda’s order.[6]

Gaura's pastimes are boundless —

331 The pastimes of Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya are wondrous and endless; even Brahmā, Śiva and Śeṣa cannot reach their end.

Anubhāṣya.
See Madhya 21.10 and 12, and *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 2.7.41, 10.14.7 and other verses.

The supreme good for those who hear and chant Gaura's pastimes —

332 Whoever tells or hears any part of them is blessed; soon Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya will meet him —

333 Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya, Advaita and Nityānanda, Śrīvāsa, Gadādhara and the whole host of devotees.

Homage to the devotees who live in Vṛndāvana —

334 All the devotees who dwell in Vṛndāvana — humbly I place the feet of them all upon my head.

Obeisance to the gurus —

335–336 Placing on my head the feet of Śrī Svarūpa, Śrī Rūpa, Śrī Sanātana, Śrī Raghunātha dāsa and Śrī Jīva, I bow to them, and ever hoping for their mercy, I, Kṛṣṇadāsa, narrate the *Caitanya-caritāmṛta*.

Anubhāṣya.
Śrī Svarūpa — Śrī Svarūpa Dāmodara; see Madhya 10.102–127 and the *Anubhāṣya*.

Thus ends the seventeenth chapter of the “Anubhāṣya.”

Notes

1. In the edition this verse is misnumbered “62”. ↩

2. *Caitanya-maṅgala* is the original title of the *Caitanya-bhāgavata* (cf. Ādi 8.33–35). ↩
3. The verse is quoted in the *Malamāsa-tattva* (so the edition’s heading). ↩
4. “Bringing Kṛṣṇa down”: by His call Advaita brought Kṛṣṇa into this world (cf. Ādi 3). ↩
5. Paṇḍita Gosāñi is Gadādhara Paṇḍita. ↩
6. *Caitanya-maṅgala* is the original title of the *Caitanya-bhāgavata* (cf. Ādi 8.33–35). ↩
7. So in the edition: *taror api*; the verse reads *taror iva*. ↩
8. In the numbering now accepted, 10.81.16. ↩
9. Unclear passage: “সন্ধ্যা ধন্য দিগন্তর” (literally “evening, the horizons blessed”); the translation is tentative. ↩
10. In the *smṛti*, a *golaka* is a son born to a widow after her husband's death (*Manu-saṁhitā* 3.174). ↩
11. *Bhagavad-gītā* 4.40. ↩